



COMPLETE LORE COMPILATION

FOR PATH OF EXILE I & II

Up-to-date for POE v3.27.0f & POE II v0.4.0b

Compiled by POE Loremaster

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PATH OF EXILE

Wraecclast





Angyr Hatz

Baggare

Lyn Vast

Wast Palace

Palat Towers

Mt Vast

Mt Kassa

Sarn

The Palace

Utham

Stridvolf

Footman

Pinewood Forest

Lake Lodelang

Fellsbrine

Rider Fell

Kingsmire

Dgarani Island

Meos Hills

Fortress Dgarani

Lioness' Nest

Theopolis

Orath Harbour

Water Liching

Je Oth

Dgarani

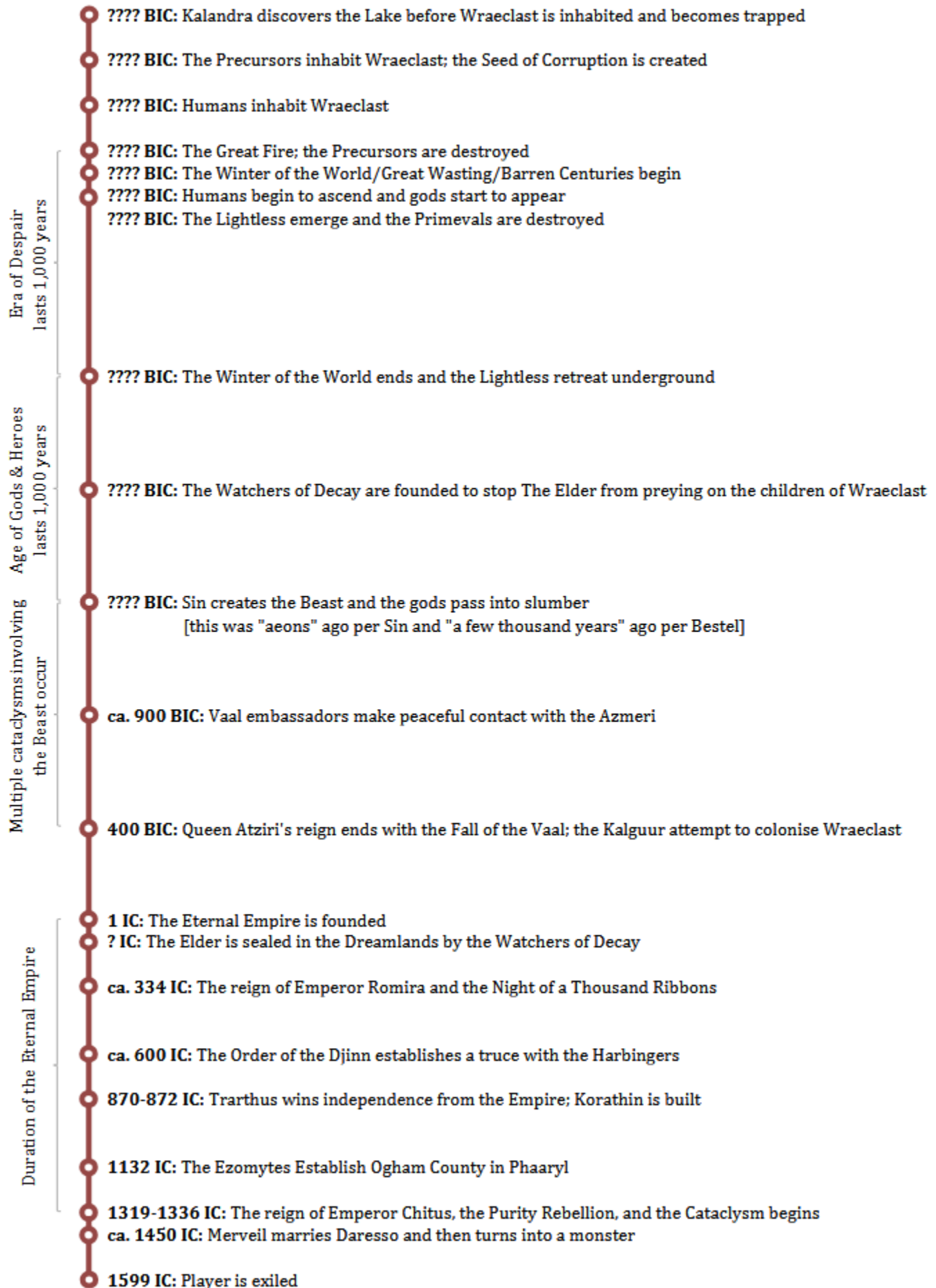
Approximate scale (km)

0 100 200 300



Timeline of the History of Wraecclast

(Points with unknown dates may not be to scale. For a much more detailed timeline, see Appendix A.)



PROLOGUE: CYCLES OF TIME

... Before Wraeclast, before the Lake, before the primordial molten world, before the stars themselves, Time circled upon itself into infinity. [Hinekora] sees not what you *will* do, only what you *did*, and what you shall do again... probably.

--Navali, "The Future-Past" (POE I)

... If...Time truly is a circle, aren't we all doomed to repeat our lives over and over for eternity? If that is the truth, then there is no luck. No chance, no human will. All life is just a stageplay repeating over and over. I don't think I like that notion.

--Gwennen, "Druids of the Broken Circle" (POE I)

It is both despair and inspiration to look back, and see oneself in the cycles of Time.

--Circular Teachings (POE II)

Witch: ... And how long is one of these Cycles, supposedly?

Navali: The life of an Elder, but twice, a hundred times over, then thrice and once.

Witch: That's... um... quite specific...?

Navali: That is the longest we have ever endured. But really, It depends on the nature of the end...

Witch: When are we now, compared to all that?

Navali: There are very few prophecies that have yet to come to pass.

Witch: So... this is what fear feels like... I don't think I like it.

--Navali, "The End of Time" (Witch version) (POE II)

PRIMEVAL WRAECLAST

KALANDRA & THE LAKE

Rumour has it that Kalandra is an ancient being, eternally trapped in a lake that exists outside Wraeclast, possessing the body of an owl and the head of a human. Sounds a bit ridiculous to me.

--Cadiro, on a Mirror of Kalandra (POE I)

... If you want to know more about the Beginning of Time, you'll have to ask the Titans. Well, *Titan*. Or that insufferably cryptic owl... if you don't mind paying such a horrible price...

--The Trialmaster, "The Beginning of Time" (POE I)

Loathe was I to endure the form your plane forced upon me.

--Kalandra, callout 22 (POE II)

Did you really think my true form would be so limited?

--Kalandra, callout 12 (POE II)

When I first came to this land, there was nothing but the Lake. It was a barren, hot, and lifeless realm, bubbling with magma and primordial ooze. How then, was there a Lake? Curiosity was my undoing.

--Kalandra, Ancient Etchings I (POE I)

I do not understand my prison. Every time I attempt to leave the Lake, I find myself instantly returning, as if I am making the choice to turn around and come back. In some cases, if I build up enough speed, I can make the transition take several minutes. Yet, I remember nothing of my time outside. Is this a real prison, or one whose walls reside only in my mind? What happens to me in those moments I cannot recall?

--Kalandra, Ancient Etchings II (POE I)



I am the One Who Watches. I observe from afar as flowers blossom and fade, as trees shoot skyward and then fall, and as whole animal breeds populate and change. They are growing smarter, in small ways, and watching their antics keeps me sane. One day, they will understand what it is to be alive, and they will wonder why they are. I will give them guidance. More than that, I will not say. I will spare them the pain of knowing.

--Kalandra, Ancient Etchings III (POE I)

There was a time when all of Wraecclast was pure and untainted.

--Kalandra, at the end of an Untainted Paradise encounter (POE I)

I look away from Wraecclast for but a moment, and the scampering little ones have invented religion. What is a god, but a thief of virtue? The prey have no idea they are creating their very own predators.

--Kalandra, Ancient Etchings IV (POE I)

They have started finding their way to me - some that imagine themselves grand heroes, some that are simply peasants to a lord, all in their time of greatest despair and need. I cannot help them, yet we talk, and they leave here with a new direction, ignorant of the cost they will pay. My latest conversation has given me much to think about. The problem is one of image; of a likeness cast by faith, of a reflection drawn by belief.

What you need, my little thief, is a shattered mirror.

--Kalandra, Ancient Etchings V (POE I)

For a time, I truly had hope. For a time, I actually believed I was going to escape this place. Ones that scampered more furtively than most promised they would dedicate themselves to freeing me. They promised they would do whatever it took, no matter how many generations had to devote their lives to the effort.

But once they understood the truth of this place, they took steps to make it harder to find, and moved to erase me from recorded history. Then they burned themselves alive. Am I truly so forsaken? So untouchable, that none must be allowed to even know of me? In your fear, you consign me to oblivion! All I had to hold back the loneliness were my rare visitors...

--Kalandra, Ancient Etchings VI (POE I)

I have a plan... I will escape this place, no matter the cost... for now, I must simply bide my Time... sooner or later, one will come, even despite the barriers. One will find their way to me, setting the proper events in motion...

--Kalandra, Ancient Etchings VII (POE I)

I will not endure yet another cycle of Time. I refuse!

--Kalandra, callout 20 (POE II)

The walls of my prison have begun to crack...

--Kalandra, on player entering for the third time (POE II)

Fools seek to make the power of this Lake their own. They will crack the world.

--Kalandra, at the start of a Heist encounter (POE I)

THE PRECURSORS

... They are as ancient to us as we are to you. On such time scales, geological events tend to obscure remnants of civilisation. There is evidence of great fires. Eruptions. Impacts from the sky.

All I know is that they, too, delved into the secrets of this world. Corruption was just one of many forms of energy that they mastered. ...

--Doryani, "The Weapon" (POE II)

They were masters of their world. They built structures whose mere remnants inspire awe... even in me. ...

--Doryani, on Precursor forge (POE II)

I believe that the Precursor towers are part of a network created specifically to alter terrain and



biomes. This may have been to make Wraecclast more habitable initially... or perhaps it had a larger purpose, later in their era.

These ideas are just conjecture, of course.

--Doryani, "Precursor Tower Network" (POE II)

"I see a pattern in these towers. Whoever the Precursors were, they sought to master this world, to shape it as they saw fit. My people had the same ambition..."

--The Grand Project Precursor Tablet (POE II)

"If they had ever completed the tower network, it could have changed the face of the world..."

--Visions of Paradise Precursor Tablet (POE II)

THE THREE EDICTS OF THE MOTHERSOUL

... I have come across simple pictographs in their ruins, intended as a contingency, should others come without knowledge of their language. Most pictographs were quite clear: *'Death lies within.'*

One, however, held faded instructions for what we should do if that death should ever escape; if it should ever plague the land. That is how I know the Weapon exists, and... generally... how to find it. Someone in the past wanted us to know about it, in case the worst should ever happen...

--Doryani, "The Weapon" (POE II)

...the Seed of Corruption... In the ruins where the Seed was sealed, I saw carvings on the wall. It was a message, left for anyone who might follow in the eons to come. A series of giant murals. The first was broken, but the second depicted the creation of the Seed. The third mural portrayed the Seed's destruction. At the time, I thought it was a warning. Now, I see the Weapon was depicted quite literally, being driven into the Seed. It might not have been a warning. It might have been... *instructions.* ...

--The Hooded One, on the weapon (POE II)

The Hooded One: There is no doubt now in my mind. It *is* the Weapon I saw in that third mural. The forging revealed an inscription. The symbols declare it 'The instrument of the Third Edict.' It was designed for the sole purpose of cleansing Corruption... and destroying the Beast.



Doryani: The Third Edict? What is the meaning... of these Edicts? Perhaps it follows that the Seed was the instrument of a *Second* Edict... But why? What part of this tale are we missing? Why would any civilisation intentionally create the Seed of Corruption? ...

--The Hooded One, "The Third Edict" (POE II)

Doryani: We have very little information, but if the Seed of Corruption was the instrument of the Second Edict... It may have been created in response to an unknown *First* Edict.

The Hooded One: The first mural I saw was broken... but there was definitely something there. They must have been facing some disaster... or enemy... or change in the world. Did they create the Seed of Corruption in response?



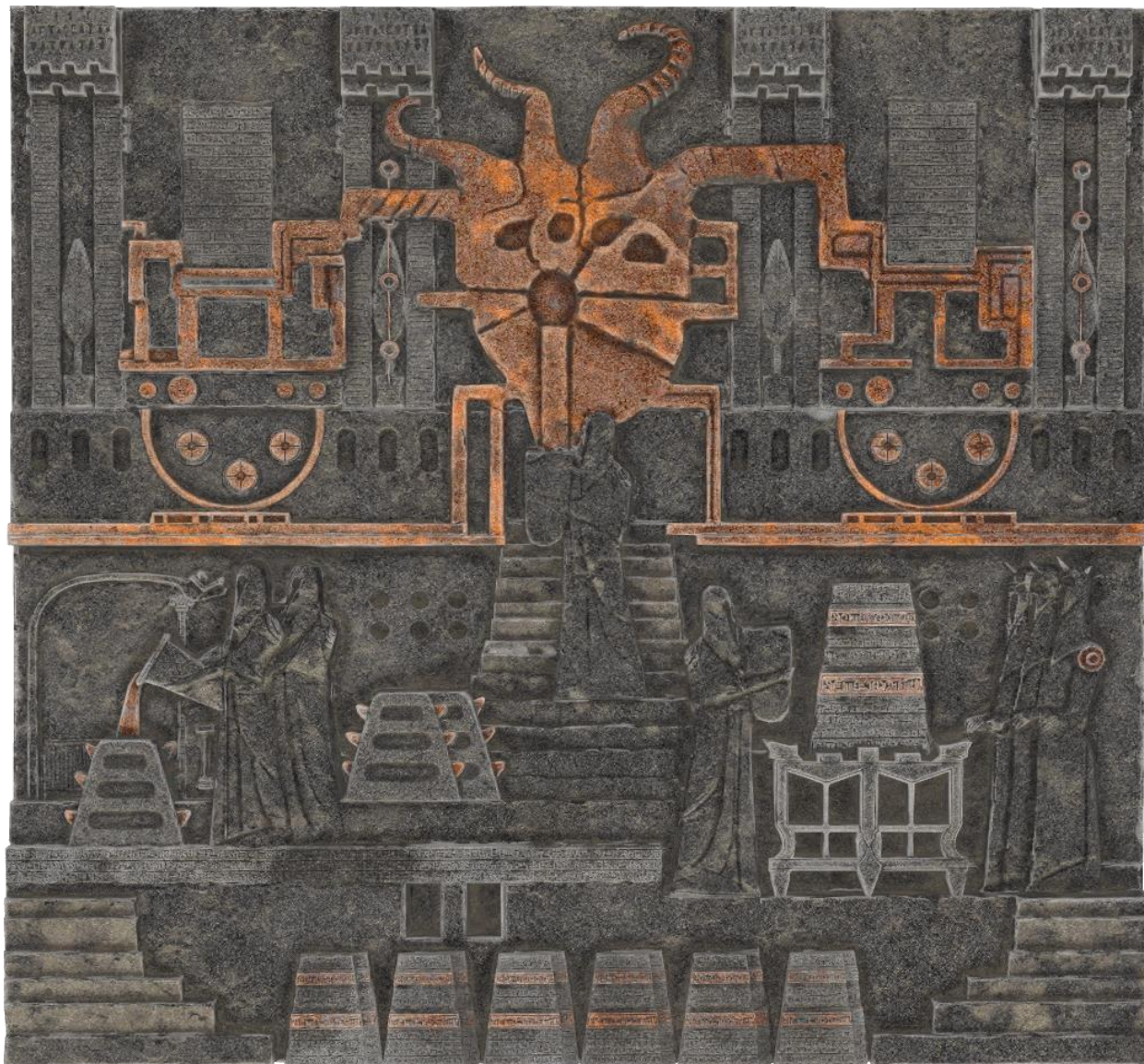
Doryani: Hmm. Whenever the Vaal built something dangerous, we also ran a parallel project... as a contingency. The Weapon. The instrument of the Third Edict. I believe it is a failsafe. If the Seed of Corruption grew out of control, then perhaps it was designed to... shut down the experiment. ...

--Doryani, "The Third Edict" (POE II)

The Hooded One: It is curious that the Weapon was broken into pieces and dispersed here.

Doryani: From what I've seen, I don't believe the Weapon was broken apart. It was never fully completed at all. I have only ever seen it portrayed in pieces. The third mural, the one you saw, *must* have been an instruction. It is my belief that the creators of the Weapon were... interrupted.

Witch: Ooh that sounds ominous! What do you think happened?



Doryani: It's impossible to know for certain. They were wiped out thousands of years before my time. Do... *you* have any notion?

The Hooded One: I was too young to remember much. I was among the Azmeri when it happened. But they did tell stories... I recall tales of... a great fire, a great wasting...

--The Hooded One, on the creator of the weapon (POE II)

THE FOURTH EDICT & THE GUARDIAN OF THE FLAME SEED

"This carving seems to depict curled bodies floating in vats... the next shows all but one of them dying. What were they trying to do? It seems they kept trying... kept experimenting..."

--Arbiter's Ignition (POE II)

...the guardian of the Flame Seed seems to have been purposely molded for his task. The Precursors created him, but he is not one of them. I can only theorise as to his purpose...

--Doryani, "Guardian of the Flame Seed" (POE II)

... Humanity has failed... It must start again.

Foul belligerent gods... Ascendants of the feeble... Cursed Her supple flesh... and mind.

Corruption plagues... And Her wounds worsen... The cleansing foretold is... preordained.



Mortal hands have contaminated Her virtue once more... By the Fourth Edict of the Mothersoul... Her flesh shall be scorched anew.

Your affliction upon Her... Will soon be erased.

Sacred Fire of the Mothersoul... You are called upon.

Her Anguish... Must be healed... In burning vengeance!

Fields of Ash... And chasms of Flame... Shall restore Her glory.

You are too late. The Fourth Edict already burns for your world.

The Mothersoul... Persists.

--The Arbiter of Ash, miscellaneous during fight (POE II)

THE LIGHTLESS & THE WELL OF SOULS

Created by forbidden necromantic magic during the age of the Precursors...

--<https://pathofexile2.com/edict> (POE II)

The Abyssals were created, not born, and every moment in the light was agony.

--Sculpted Suffering Warpick (POE II)

... They are the Lightless. The Abyssals. The spawn of the Well of Souls. ...

In ages past, these creatures served a dark god... Kulemak, the Lich Lord, master of Undeath. ...

--Sin, on the Well of Souls (POE II)

... The Well was not. The Master Below All raged. Then, the Well was, and always had been. The more these ones fought and destroyed, the more souls spiraled into the Well. The nether exalted Kulemak. He rose, and walked the Boundless Cavern above, enduring the searing light and heat without pain. To wage the war, he gifted power to his servants, and they became the Lich Lords. The Lich Lords gifted power to their servants, and they became the Necromancers.

These ones have been fighting so long, the Well spirals... the nether overflows... Countless screams blend into one endless exhale that can be heard even in the Boundless Cavern.

--Lurking Creature, "Necromancy" (POE II)

You come from the Boundless Cavern. No stone in sight above, only fire and void. Hateful beings, spawned by flesh, skitter in the searing light. They seek to rend these ones. To destroy them. ...

--Lurking Creature, "Boundless Cavern" (POE II)

Kulemak... The Source gives him power.

--Lurking Creature, "Kulemak" (POE II)

The edge beckons. The Source calls from below. Souls spiral, drawn by the call. All souls that return, all stilled flesh that yet moves. The Source gives motion, if not life. ...

The Well of Souls is the Source of all Necromancy. ...

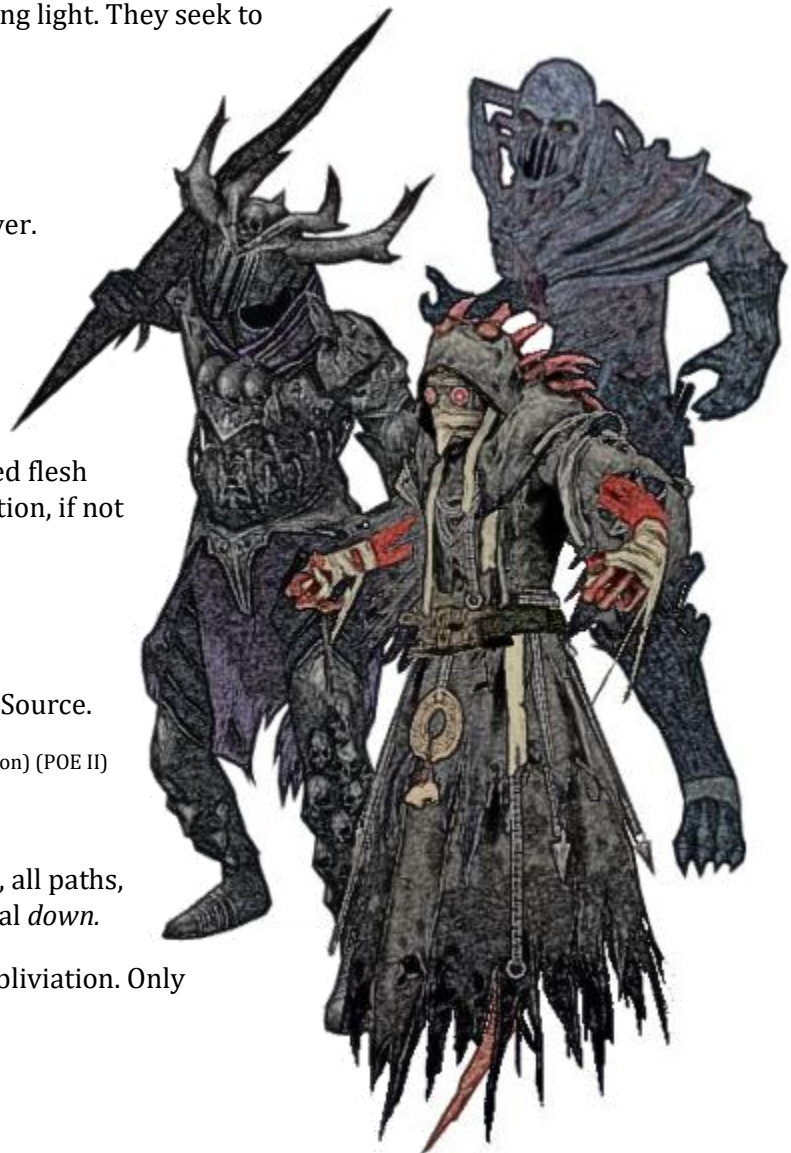
Embrace Death. It is a gift... from the Source.

--Lurking Creature, "The Source" (non-Witch version) (POE II)

... The Well is... *down*. From all places, all paths, it is still *down*. In time, all things spiral *down*.

You, too, will be called. There is no obliviation. Only screaming. Forever. ...

--Lurking Creature, "The Well" (POE II)



Kulemak serves The Master Below All. The Lich Lords serve Kulemak. ...

--Lurking Creature, "The Master Below" (POE II)

... The Lich Lords were once as you are. ...

--Lurking Creature, "The Source" (Witch version) (POE II)

They believed themselves driven by necessity, but that desperation made them monstrous.

--Undying Hate Timeless Jewel (POE II)

They stare back, with hollow hypnotising eyes.

--Abyss Scarab of Emptiness (POE I)

Their empires ghastly and gaunt glitter with gold.

--Abyss Scarab of Edifice (POE I)

They search forever for more souls to drag to the dark.

--Abyss Scarab (POE I)

Even the dead serve the Lightless.

--Bubonic Trail Murder Boots (POE I)

Kulemak sat triumphant, raising the crown.
Darkness coiled the world in eternal night.
Victory, a mere moment, came crashing down.
No conqueror, no conquered, only searing Light.

--Darkness Enthroned Fine Belt (POE II)

CULTURES OF WRAECLAST

THE AZMERI

The Azmeri hold the oldest wisdom. They were already in their mountains when the first Vaal was born from Xibaqua's remains. ...

--Zelina, "The Azmeri" (POE II)

...the Azmeri had chosen their homes carefully. They were separatists. They rejected technology. And in the end, they were right...

--The Hooded One, on the creator of the weapon (POE II)



The Azmeri were the first culture known in history to use the trials of strength, wisdom, and spirit to select its chieftains.

The first Lord's Trial was a rough-hewn maze festooned with wild animals and brutal traps, crafted to test aspiring Azmerian leaders' body, mind, and soul. [sic]

In conquering the adversities of the maze, a champion proved they were capable of bearing the crushing burden of chieftainship.

The first trials were simple contraptions reflecting simple times. As the Azmerian civilisation grew in number and complexity, so did the trials, from treacherous mazes to bewildering labyrinths. ...

- Emperor Izaro Phrecius

--Bronze Inscription II (POE I)

The Azmeri were consummate survivors. They had to be, having been sired in the most inhospitable range of mountains in all of Wraecclast.

Unfortunate, some might say. I do not. I believe it was the making of them. And of us, their descendants.

So it is no wonder that they developed the Lord's Trial. With survival being a moment-by-moment concern, that harried people grew to understand power quite intimately.

Strong leadership is able to bridge the chasm between existence and extinction. Poor leadership might see an entire tribe vanish into that same chasm. ...

- Emperor Izaro Phrecius

--Bronze Inscription III (POE I)

The Azmeri ascetics learnt the power of going without the body's ordinary cravings.

--Energy From Within Cobalt Jewel (POE I)

PROVERBS & LEGENDS

"Do not cause the land to stir,
It holds secrets better unknown."

- Azmerian proverb

--Primordial Might Crimson Jewel (POE I)

"A boy becomes a man when he has faced the animal in his heart and wet the forest floor with its blood."

- Azmeri Proverb

--Greust's Necklace (POE I)

"Sirrius flew on wings of light, faster than wind, faster than thought. But try as he might to outrun the darkness, it was there, at every turn, waiting for him."

- Azmerian legend

--Darkray Vectors Dragonscale Boots (POE I)

THE MOTHER SOUL & THE FIRST CHILDREN

The Mother Soul was hope. The will to carry on, no matter the cost. No matter the sacrifice. No matter the *consequences*...

The People of the Mountains cut ties with the Mother Soul long ago. We know not why, only that it happened. The First Children might be the only ones that could recall such things now.

--Elder Madox, "The Mother Soul" (POE II)

... The First Children were sent to us for protection. ...

--Elder Madox, "The First Children" (POE II)

Doryani: The first example of Precursor writing I've ever seen!

The Hooded One: I... recognise some of these symbols...

Doryani: What? How?

The Hooded One: When I was very young, but a boy, and still mortal... hmm. Such a faded memory... I was... in her lap... and symbols like these, decorated a vivid book... I can almost hear her saying the words... what they mean...

Warrior: Who was this person?

The Hooded One: I'm not sure... I have to think on it... I have to try to remember...

--The Hooded One, on the first weapon piece (Warrior version) (POE II)

... As a child, I was sent to live among the Azmeri with my brother and sister... But before that, I lived... *somewhere else*... Somewhere with great works of stone and metal and glass... And a kind, smiling face... a woman's face...

--The Hooded One, on the second weapon piece (Warrior version) (POE II)

THE PRIMEVALS

UZAZA, THE FIRST KING

The narrow path turned to rough rocks that led towards the sky. One last obstacle in a life-long journey to find a land they could call home.

--Uzaza's Mountain Sapphire Ring (POE I)

Cold winds blasted what little grew on the icy surface. The gifts of the land lay hidden deeper, and only patience and persistence would free them.

--Uzaza's Meadow Sapphire Ring (POE I)

Sheltered beneath thick ice, the river ferried fat fish towards the sea. But the First King knew the river's secret, and the fish were not the only ones who grew fat.

--Uzaza's Valley Sapphire Ring (POE I)

AUL (AHN), THE LAST KING

He surveyed his lands, green and vital, watched with pride as his slaves quarried fine stone for his fortress, and thanked the heavens for his many blessings.

--Putembo's Mountain Topaz Ring (POE I)

The fields were silent but for the plucking of fruits, the rustling of leaves, and the breaking of stone. No slave dared to speak or look the passing king in the eye. No one... except Aul.

--Putembo's Meadow Topaz Ring (POE I)

With no stone for rebuilding, each storm took its toll on the village. Huts eventually collapsed, their occupants injured or dead. Bodies were left by the river, to appease the gods. But the dead would not remain there.

--Putembo's Valley Topaz Ring (POE I)

It was not his fearlessness or ferocity, nor his tactical genius, it was his leadership that earned Aul, the Last King, his crown.

--Aul's Uprising Onyx Amulet (POE I)

They built a temple... around the mirror...

Under the earth... to hide from the night sky...

--Medved, on his death (POE I)



There exists a vast mirror in the ground. To gaze into those perfectly polished waters is to see a mortal soul, with all its flaws and pains laid bare. There is wisdom and counsel to be had, but some do not survive the truth.

--Tawhanuku, "Ikiaho" (POE I)

THE MARAKETH

...Maraketh... They are an honourable people...

--The Hooded One, "Our Next Move" (POE II)

This is the tale as it was told to me by our *akhara*'s tale-woman before me, and as told to her by the tale-woman before her. These words have remained unchanged since the beginning.

Many thousands of years ago, we were a simple people. Hunters. Roamers. We moved valley to valley in search of meat and berries. There was none of the discipline we know today...

We have protected these fair plains for three hundred and four generations, and we will continue to do so for another three hundred and four. That is our duty, and our birthright.

--Zarka, "History of the Vastiri Plains" (POE II)

... The Maraketh are a matriarchy! ...

--Petarus and Vanja, "Oyun" (POE I)

No matter where you come from, or who you might be, we were all birthed by a mother. Our mothers protected us and gave us nourishment. It is our duty in life to honour that great task. Without a mother, none would tread this dirt today.

The most important commandment in our people's tradition is this: Honour the Mother, Honour the Life.

--Irasha, "Maraketh Tradition" (POE I)

Foreigners often misunderstand the concept of the *Sekhema*. I am no dictator, and do not make some pathetic claim of divine right.



Emperors are for nations filled with the weak-minded and soft, as history has proven every time an empire falls and we endure.

I am Sekhema because others have put their faith in me as the strongest and most capable among us. I lead because there is no better replacement. It is a role I deserve, by definition.

--Asala, "Rank and Status" (POE II)

And how shall we know a sekhemah worthy of rule? By the anointing of the Great Roc, under whose wings we grow and soar.

- Maraketh Coronation Ritual

--Sekhema Feather (POE I)

Pride is a common flaw in men. We Maraketh beat such sickness out of our boys. Do you know why...? If left unchecked, pride becomes a plague.

There is a cure, of course. It's called 'devotion'.

--Kira, introduction to Duelist (POE I)

When I was twelve, three men came out of the Vastiri plains and set their eyes upon me. They asked me for water, but took much more.

When the women of Highgate finally caught them, I was given an opportunity to enact the execution myself, an offer I gladly took. Even at twelve, I knew the price for betraying the *akhara*. ...

--Irasha, "Maraketh Justice" (POE I)

... I am from the northern reaches of the Plains of Vastiri. My home caravan has ninety-two carts, all of which are beautifully set with colourful tapestries and shaped metal. It is a life and land unlike this one. Difficult, duty-bound, but rewarding. ...

--Adiyah, "Home" (POE I)

... I do not have tattoos...because they are marks of shame or criminality. ...

--Whakano & Adiyah, "Banter" (POE I)

TALE-WOMEN

I have a very long official title...

My role is that of a keeper of tales. I was chosen by my predecessor, rather than being allowed to become a *dekhara* or perform other duties. I am not permitted near combat, for the stories I keep are one of our most valuable resources.

We understand the plains of Vastiri through the lens of these words handed down to us over the centuries. We see what used to lie where sand dwells now, and hear the bold proclamations and lamentations of yesteryear. That is my role, to be the worldly eyes and ears of the Ardura.

--Zarka, "Rank and Status" (POE II)

Tale-women in training drink of a painful desert fruit. Fire, they learn, springs from agony.

--Fireflower Solar Amulet (POE II)

Tale-women may not fight directly, for they have a much higher purpose.

--Font of Power Omen Sceptre (POE II)

Tale-women do not fight as dekharas. They command a power all their own.

--Visage of Ayah Beaded Circlet (POE II)

As they looked toward the future, yet held close the past, the tale-women began to see the tapestry of Time.

--The Remembered Tales Coffin Relic (POE II)

The final element the tale-women mastered was Time itself.

--Temporalis Silk Robe (POE II)

...powers I have only seen the most gifted tale-women wield. I believe they call it 'chronomancy.' ...

--Jado, "Chronomancy" (POE II)

PROVERBS & LEGENDS

One should not entice the storm; one cannot invite the storm, or give warrant to its tyrant-soul. We survive only by appeasing the storm, with gifts and offerings of adoration. We hope that, in its mercy, it shall pass us by.

- Tempestology of the Maraketh, Repudion IV

--Bottled Storm (POE I)

The Maraketh fear very little, but they dare not whisper the name of the demon that flies on Winter's gales.

--White Wind Imperial Slean (POE I)

The swallow flew fast and took many turns, spilling a seed where no plant had grown before. This seed grew and grew until the desert became fertile and abundant. Your mind is like this seed.

- Maraketh Proverb

--Fertile Mind Cobalt Jewel (POE I)

The mastodons of yore were each born with two weapons greater than any sword. So, too, were you.

- Maraketh Proverb

--Hollow Palm Technique (POE I)

Kings fall, empires crumble, mortals perish. All turn to earth and sand.

- Maraketh proverb

--Primordial Eminence Viridian Jewel (POE I)

When the hyena howls thrice death is sure to follow.

-Maraketh Wisdom

--Al Dhih Timeworn Claw (POE I)

We Maraketh have a saying... "Only the night can understand the darkness. Only the sun can bring about the dawn."

--Kira, introduction to Scion (POE I)

To the Maraketh, death is as intimate as love.

--Ornament of the East Gut Ripper (POE I)

The King looked upon images swirling atop the ancient stone dial. "You look peaceful" he told his bride-to-be, "So peaceful, asleep in our wedding bed." But in phantasm, she did not slumber, and what he saw was not a place for dreams, rather, a wooden box... about to be closed and lowered into earthy depths.

- Maraketh Legend

--Calendar of Fortune (POE I)

THE VAAL

From the flesh of the gods, Xibaqua was born. From the carnage of Xibaqua, we were born. It is our duty to return to the gods what was once theirs.

--Mask of the Stitched Demon Magistrate Crown (POE I)

Xibaqua's treachery was met with divine fury. One by one, the gods reclaimed their flesh, until all that remained was a droplet of pure light: The first Vaal.

--Demon Stitcher Satin Gloves (POE I)

They took pride in all that they built, considering each new temple a testament to the gods... and then, to themselves.

Delving into the mysteries of existence, they deciphered the secret laws of nature... and then, harnessed them.

Not content to live in harmony with the world, they strove to understand it, to improve it... and then, to master it.

They collaborated with each other and with nearby peoples, at first sharing, teaching... and then, dominating.

--Beauty, Curiosity, Ambition, & Cooperation Vaal Aspects (POE I)

I can respect the militaristic traditions of your people, while remaining wary. Our merchants trade with your merchants, and all the nobles wear smiles and clasp arms, but it is impossible to forget the spears bristling behind those masks of civility.

We Vaal are the peacekeepers of this world...



--Atalui, "The Maraketh" (Sorceress version) (POE II)

Though the Vaal revered peace, it would have been suicide for any culture to rouse them to war.

- Icius Perandus, Scholar to the Empire

--Rebuke of the Vaal Vaal Blade (POE I)

Through war we found peace. Through death we found advancement. Our ancestors did not know where their actions would take them. Are we any better?

--Story of the Vaal Variscite Blade (POE I)

For the Vaal, the relationship between slave and master was as intimate and volatile as that of lovers.

--String of Servitude Heavy Belt (POE I)

THE KARUI

That word, 'Karui,' is an informal name for anyone of the blood, whether a chieftain, a child, or a *kaivana*. The Ngakuramakoi, however, are those who truly comprise our culture. They must be followers of the Way, and they must have passed their test of adulthood, at the Isle of Shrikes or elsewhere. A great warrior does not have to be Karui by blood to become Ngakuramakoi. It is rare, but it does happen. ...

--Akoya, "Ngakuramakoi" (POE I)

Ngamakanui isn't a place, not really. *Makanui* is our Way, and *Nga* means 'from' or 'of.' So anywhere that our people go—mostly islands, we like to roam—that is Ngamakanui, because we have brought our Way to it. Outsiders that don't understand us often mark Ngamakanui in a particular place on a map, but that is a mistake we don't care to correct. It is better that the Vaal don't know where we are. ...

--Kahuturoa, "Ngamakanui" (POE I)

We guard and protect the land, and it provides for us in return. We defend it with blood and axe. We cull that which should not be; that which Corrupts. Then, we travel on. Eventually, another tribe will arrive, finding it unspoiled. We do this so that when we move on, we too will find bounty waiting for us.

--Tavakai, on Ngamakanui (POE II)

The King's Feast is an ancient ritual born of less enlightened times. Long before the Karui followed the Way, one tribe would conquer another and a feast would be prepared for the triumphant King. The main dishes of this feast were selected carefully, for the sweetness of their nature and the tenderness of their flesh.

You see, when the conquered fills the belly of the conqueror, two tribes become one. ...

--Lani, "The King's Feast" (POE I)

...In Ngamakanui, our treaties mandated that an offering of peace be witnessed by a third. ...

--Haku, on offering to bargain (POE I)

... Karui culture can often be excessively focused on having certain traits, such as strength or bravado. Certain duties are expected of each of us, whether or not we want to fulfill them. ...

--Ikiaho, "Rakiata" (POE I)

A Karui woman's place was not the battlefield, but the hearth. Hyrri changed all of that.

--Hyrri's Demise Sharktooth Arrow Quiver (POE I)

THE KARUI WAY

... I've heard that the Karui have this philosophy... *makanui*, the Way of the Warrior. ...

--Clarissa, "Maramoa" (POE I)



The culture referred to as 'the Karui' is actually a vast collection of separate semi-nomadic tribes that share certain elements. Most notably, the Karui Way is a set of tenets and traditions that have preserved their way of life while multiple empires have risen and fallen on Wraeclost proper. The Way emphasizes strength, respect, and purity of body and mind. Technology is not outlawed, but discouraged, while the use of virtue gems is outright forbidden. For each victory a warrior achieves, one tattoo is given, and the most accomplished among them will often be intricately adorned.

--The Art of Path of Exile II, "The Karui" (POE II)

It is the Karui way to give leadership to the victor. ...

--Haku, on offering to betray (POE I)

It is the Karui Way to observe nature in nature. The fish without the sea is no longer a fish. It is dinner. ...

--Siosa, "Archives" (POE I)

RITE OF PASSAGE

Many Karui tribes use the Isle of the Shrikes as their test of adulthood. Young men and women that wish to be recognised as warriors must swim to shore, ascend the cliffs, and steal a valuable and delicious Shrike egg. ...

--The Art of Path of Exile II, "The Isle of the Shrikes" (POE II)

For generations, the Isle of Shrikes was used for a coming of age trial for several tribes. Young Karui try to sneak onto the rocks, climb the cliffs, and take the eggs of the shrikes that nest there. The eggs are a valuable delicacy that many Karui would pay through the nose for. ...

--Makoru, on Isle of Shrikes (on map) (POE II)

You are not yet a warrior, but soon, you will be!

Climb these cliffs, and collect one Shrike egg. If you feel you cannot go on, turn back. You can always try again next season.

We seek to build wisdom and strength, not to destroy you. A corpse does your Tribe no good.

No matter what you choose to do, return with a grand tale of what you faced.

Tavakai, Chieftain of the Tukohama Tribe

--The Test of Might (POE II)

The *Ngakuramakoi* are those who truly embody our culture. If you wish to become one of us, you do not have to be Karui by blood.

But you must follow the Way. Pass your test, at the Isle of Shrikes, or elsewhere. Live by our traditions. Live through strength. But most of all, do not let the Way shift or falter.

Stand strong when others would seek to dominate or subvert you.

This is how we will survive as a people.

--Word of Akoya (POE II)

BURIAL PRACTICE

...we give our beloved to the birds, messengers of spirit to the sky, conveyors of flesh to the earth. ...

--Lavianga, Weathered Carving IV (POE I)

It is the Gull that delivers Man unto Ancestor. The consumer of our flesh. The seeder of our souls unto the earth. We give the Gull his life. The Gull gives us our Way.

- Lavianga, Advisor to Kaom

--The Gull Raven Mask (POE I)

PROVERBS & WISDOM

"If one is an annoyance then a hundred is a threat."

- Ancient Karui Proverb

--Rain of Splinters Crimson Jewel (POE I)

"Shoot first, ask no questions."

- Karui wisdom

--Karui Ward Jade Amulet (POE I)

THE EZOMYTES

Outsiders can never understand the Ezomyte struggle. Our folklore goes back to the very Winter of the World, when we were but savages clawing grubs from the dirt. ...

--Geonor, Geonor's Journal I (POE II)

Ogham? Oh yes, Ogham... this is the oldest home of the Ezomytes as we know ourselves. Past generations departed from here to settle Ezomyr and the Isles of Skothe.

We did not always call this part of Phaaryl our homeland...

--Lachlann the Lost, "Ogham" (POE II)

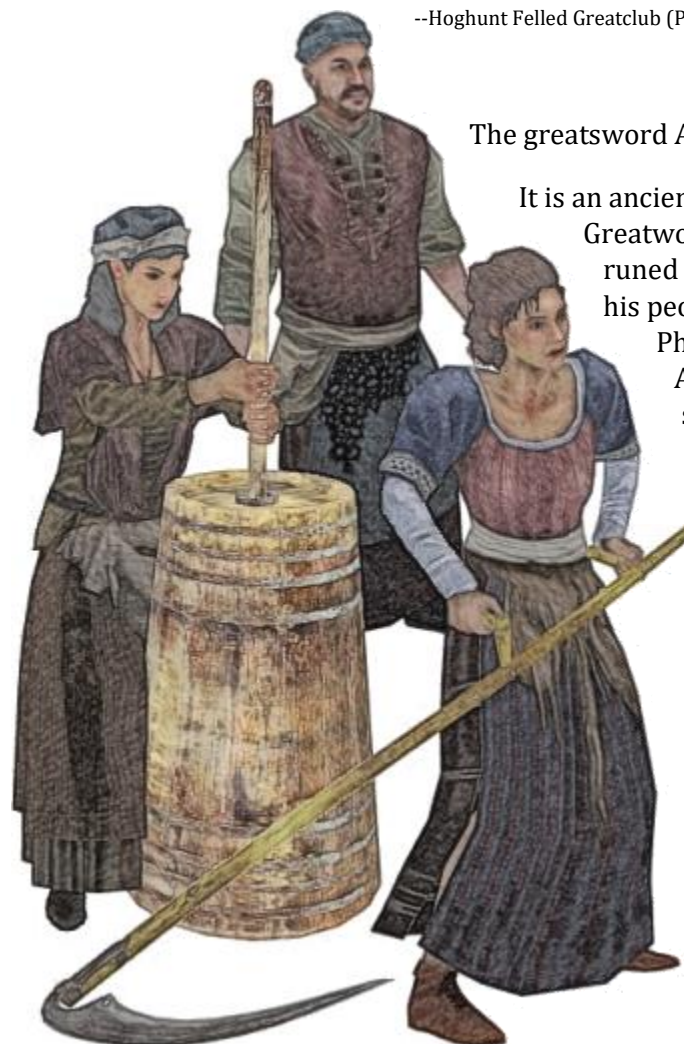
Before... Phaaryl...? Ah... the songs are unclear after so much time. A great many generations ago, we were driven here from elsewhere. There was simply too much Corruption, too much darkness... it was a time of chaos and terror, and much was lost.

Our clans swore that this was the last time we would ever be cast out of our homes. ...

--Lachlann the Lost, "Before Phaaryl" (POE II)

There was a very clear and delicious reason why the Ezomytes chose to stop their flight and settle in Phaaryl.

--Hoghunt Felled Greatclub (POE II)



The greatsword Agnar...the mighty runed blade...

It is an ancient weapon of the old magicks, inspired by the Greatwolf himself. Legend says it was forged and runed for the original clan leader so he might lead his people to a new, safer land. This brought them to Phaaryl where they founded Ogham. Ever since, Agnar was passed down to the leader of the strongest clan.

When the position of Count was established in Ogham, the sword was bound to the role. ...

--Una, "Agnar" (POE II)

... 'Ezomytes.' They use a system of runes that is... oddly similar to our own.

--Johan, on runes (POE I)

The henge at the centre of the Stones of Serle was one of the first sites the

Ezomytes built when the newcomers taught us runes so very long ago.

--Una, "Stones of Serle" (POE II)

We keep our history in the form of songs. I don't exactly know how runes were first brought to us. All we know is that 'newcomers' arrived and gave us knowledge in exchange for food and shelter.

One song says: *'There came a great storm, crashing across the sky... There came a great need, or the sodden would die.'*

A children's tale speaks of fey folk who became human. A tribe that appeared out of a 'ring' of runes in the forest. ...

The newcomers never moved on. Their names are part of our clan histories now. ...

--Una, "Runes" (POE II)

*"Sons from foreign shores
Took refuge from the storm
Bringing knowledge of runes
Our fate was carved soon."*

--The Ezomyle Megalith (POE II)

Ancient visitors brought magicks born of the stars themselves.

--Stones of Serle map pin (POE II)

The rune of Authority is said to dim one lunar cycle after a Count's soul is laid to rest.

--Count Lachlann's Ring (POE II)

Passed from king to king for centuries, this Ezomyle symbol of state could split heads and sunder city gates with equal aplomb.

--Helepolis, Steam trading card description (POE I)

Like lightning, the Ezomyle cavalry need never strike twice.

--Stormcharger Plated Greaves (POE I)

... This is the cycle of life as we have always known it. Everyone dies, but the clan endures, and the greatest glory an Ezomyte can attain is to live on in a song or a poem. ...

--Una, "Cemetery of the Eternals" (POE II)

PROVERBS & SAYINGS

"A stone is not a stone, it is but one part of a fortress."

- Ezomyte proverb

--Primordial Harmony Cobalt Jewel (POE I)

"Masters of wit, strength and cunning. To survive the harsh winters, you must be like the fox."

- Ezomyte Proverb

--The Fox (POE I)

You've no reason for fear when you're a root in a fen [sic]

- Old Ezomyte saying.

--Fencoil Gnarled Branch (POE I)

"Cut down the tallest tree, and another becomes the tallest."

- Old Ezomyte saying.

--Mirebough Gnarled Branch (POE I)

The Ezomytes have a saying: Take everything and waste nothing.

--Coated Shrapnel Crimson Jewel (POE I)

DRUIDS

A sensitive few among the first settlers of Ezomyr followed the wisps by canoe. On a misty forested island, Cirel of Tarth stood waiting to greet them.

--Amor Mandragora Changeling Talisman (POE II)

The oldest and greatest fortress on Wraeclast was grown, not built. She Who Waited planted their seeds in a time of ash and snow. Now, the gate of the Taisce is unassailable, yet open to all.

--Cirel's Cultivation (POE II)

On the nights the fugue would come over her, the Ezomytes would gather below, begging her to bring the rains. Atop the Taisce, wailing with unknown sorrows, her cries made the skies rage.

--Morgana's Tempest (POE II)

THE CAALTU

...the Caaltu? They had the absolute best wines, feasts that went on for days, and the women... by Rongo, the women! ...

--Kahuturoa, "The Ezomytes" (POE I)

The Caaltu? I vaguely recall hearing about them once as a child, but they were long before my time.

--Maata, "The Caaltu" (POE I)

THE ERA OF DESPAIR

Matiki: Each tribe has its own story of the Great Wasting. Some call it a Great Fire, or the Barren Centuries. Others, an Endless Winter. The truth lies buried in all these tales. There was an ancient time of horror and famine. ...

Sorceress: We call it the Winter of the World... The Maraketh had no gods before that. ...

--Matiki, "Great Wasting" (Sorceress version) (POE II)

...the Azmeri. They are the only culture that was intact before and after the era of despair.

--Zelina, "Precursors" (POE II)

...a great deal has been written about times of ash. Fires that scorched the land, clouds that blotted out the sun, the Winter of the World...

...we may be dealing with an ancient disastrous force that has plagued Wraeclast for far longer than anyone can guess. It may have ended entire civilisations. ...

--Alva Valai, "Fortress" (POE II)

THE GREAT FIRE

I have come to learn more about the land's bounty. Far beneath the sand and clay, there is a hidden layer of volcanic soils, and a thick band of ash. These are rich and fertile deposits... I have no doubt that something terrible ravaged this land a very long time ago... I am surprised there are people still present on Wraeclast after what must have happened...

--Sonja, "The Soil" (POE I)

Our forefathers danced and drank and ate their fill and did not honour the First Ones for their gifts. So the First Ones filled the sky with fire.

--Feastbind Rustic Sash (POE I)

From north to south the sea of fire swept,
Rolling waves of gorging flame,
Growing taller and hungrier,

With every land they consumed.

--Rolling Flames Cobalt Jewel (POE I)

After the fires swept down from the sky and swallowed the city, all that lingered, as if locked in time, was a memory of that which was gone, a whisper of deeds undone.

--Balefire Opal Sceptre (POE I)

A great fire once swept the land, and our leaders were turned to ash where they stood. The urn contains exactly what you think it does, and serves as proof of our long lineage.

--Urn of the Original Ashes (POE I)

THE FALL OF THE PRECURSORS

THE INSTRUMENT OF THE THIRD EDICT

The Hooded One: It is curious that the Weapon was broken into pieces and dispersed here.

Doryani: From what I've seen, I don't believe the Weapon was broken apart. It was never fully completed at all. I have only ever seen it portrayed in pieces. The third mural, the one you saw, *must* have been an instruction. It is my belief that the creators of the Weapon were... interrupted.

Witch: Ooh that sounds ominous! What do you think happened?

Doryani: It's impossible to know for certain. They were wiped out thousands of years before my time. Do... *you* have any notion?

The Hooded One: I was too young to remember much. I was among the Azmeri when it happened. But they did tell stories... I recall tales of... a great fire, a great wasting...

--The Hooded One, on the creator of the weapon (POE II)



... Someone intentionally carved information meant to be discovered in the future. To do such a thing, they must have believed that their civilisation might be endangered. However, the most important clues I found were done differently. Hand carvings. We found them in this region. The stones depicted pieces of the Weapon being thrown into the sea. ...

Their reasoning was unclear. But from what I saw, it was thrown not by soldiers, but by a woman. A scientist... and I have no idea who she was.

--Doryani, "Murals" (POE II)

... My old tribe tells a tale of a foreign medicine woman. It's a very old story. Took place after a great fire scoured the world. My ancestors had to dive into the sea, just to survive. When they came to the surface, they found a burned woman, floating in the tide... She begged them to take her somewhere and promised to forge them a great reward. But... the toll was too heavy. She was too injured. And she died trying to use the forge. She was buried there. ...

--Kanu: Makoru, "Arastas" (POE II)

THE WINTER OF THE WORLD

After the eruption, the skies turned grey, ash began to fall, and a chill set in...

--Grip of Winter Firm Bracers (POE II)

... These fair plains became barren and lightless, a time those generations called the Winter of the World.

One thousand years of ice brought hardship and suffering, but that was only the beginning. ...

--Zarka, "History of the Vastiri Plains" (POE II)

THE FALL OF THE PRIMEVALS & ATTACK OF THE LIGHTLESS

The strange voice showed Aul a future where his legacy was forgotten, where new cultures broke themselves upon Aul's ruined world.

--The Price of Prescience (POE I)

Still a shadow of his former self, Kulemak turned to deception. He promised Ahn untold power and mastery, in exchange for a single golem. "After all, what harm could one servant do?"

--Kulemak's Dominion (POE II)

Kurgal's first body was a mere stone golem, enslaved by a collar. He found such ecstasy in the power of dominion, he clawed his way free... and soon, supplanted a Lich Lord.

--Kurgal's Leash (POE II)

As possessed golems ravaged the land, Aul - crowned Ahn by blood and tyranny - began the last ritual, causing azurite crystals to rupture and grow throughout his doomed citadel.

--Ahn's Citadel (POE II)

Often, it is our own creations that destroy us in the end.

--Kalandra, at the end of an Abyss encounter (POE I)



... To the south, the foreign tyrant Ahn fell, and horrible creatures flooded forth under this darkness, seemingly born of bone and blood and foul magic. ...

--Zarka, "History of the Vastiri Plains" (POE II)



They ceaselessly sprout from the murderous earth.

--Abyss Scarab of Multitudes (POE I)

AHKELI, THE CLAYSHAPER

There is nothing, flesh, spirit, or stone
Free from our hunger for dominion.

--Clayshaper Rock Breaker (POE I)

Fleeing the destruction set upon her home, the Clayshaper
sought safety in the clouds of ash above.

--Ahkeli's Mountain Ruby Ring (POE I)

Where once had stood a village, lay naught but splinters. Some
had once been her home. Some had once been her creations.
Some had once been her family.

--Ahkeli's Meadow Ruby Ring (POE I)

The river, once fertile and fresh, and flowing briskly to the sea, now stood, stained, at a standstill.
Dammed by the coagulating dead.

--Ahkeli's Valley Ruby Ring (POE I)

CULTURES ADAPT & THE GODS ARISE

In the coldest depths of the Winter of the World, overrun by darkness and fighting to the last, life
itself clung to existence by the barest remaining thread.

--The Last Flame Incense Relic (POE II)

... There was a time of famine, fire, and despair... and the gods rose from the ashes. ...

--Zelina, "Oriath" (POE II)

THE AZMERI & THE VIRIDIAN WILDWOOD

You might call her a goddess. I might call them Sisters Three. Others might call them the collective
will of nature itself. We may all be right. They exist within this Wildwood, or perhaps they *are* the
Wildwood. To create this realm, the Draíocht gave so many pieces of themselves so widely and so
deeply, that little remained. Fragments in every tree, every rock, and every animal. A voice,
sometimes, to a chosen few... or so I've been told, by travelers through these lands.

--The Primal Huntress, "The Draíocht" (POE I)

The Wildwood was a gift, meant as a haven against the Winter of the World.

--The Flawed Refuge Maple Round Shield (POE I)

We, the Maji, mark this land as the future home of the Azmeri. Our people will prosper in safety.

--Maji Proclamation (POE I)

[For the complete lore on the Viridian Wildwood, see the section The Viridian Wildwood under
Miscellaneous Lore later in this compilation.]

THE KARUI UNITE

...a great fire scoured the world. My ancestors had to dive into the sea, just to survive. ...

--Kanu: Makoru, "Arastas" (POE II)

Matiki: Each tribe has its own story of the Great Wasting. Some call it a Great Fire, or the Barren Centuries. Others, an Endless Winter. The truth lies buried in all these tales. There was an ancient time of horror and famine. But in those dark years, our gods first stepped forward. Tukohama, Hinekora, Tawhoa, and the rest.

Warrior: The Karui had no gods before that?

Matiki: No. For us, history begins there. The Great Wasting erased all that came before. Maybe... there wasn't even a *before*, for us. When did the first Karui emerge from that volcano? Something to ask Hinekora, Navali.

Navali: The Mother of Death can recall only her own memories. History begins at the rise of the gods, because that is when Hinekora was born. ...

--Matiki, "Great Wasting" (Warrior version) (POE II)

... Many of Tukohama's deeds were achieved *before* his ascension. ...

During the Great Wasting, he united the tribes. He put axes in our hands, and taught us to survive. But he was not just a... bringer of violence. No. He was a bringer of hope. Hope among all the tribes. Some forget that. ...

--Matiki, "Tukohama" (POE II)

The world churned during the Great Wasting. Tawhoa may have stilled the rioting earth, but it was Valako that tamed the broken sky.

--Lightning Coil Ancestral Mail (POE II)

THE MARAKETH EVOLVE

... Survival meant banding together and creating the strict traditions that eventually became what we know today. To fight was to live. Disorder meant death. ...

--Zarka, "History of the Vastiri Plains" (POE II)

The Maraketh have a cultural history deeper than most know. Theirs is a strict tradition, bordering on brutal, but it is that adherence to shared beliefs that has kept them strong when entire Empires [sic] have come and gone around them.

--The Hooded One, "The Maraketh" (POE II)

The Maraketh are an ancient race, bound by ascetic tradition. ...

--<https://www.pathofexile.com/theawakening/items> (POE I)

Yes, I have seen the slaves pulling the carts. I am uncomfortable with the practice, but from what I understand, it allows those captured in battle to serve rather than simply being executed.

There are not enough resources to keep prisoners who do not work. In this harsh land, it is perhaps the lesser of two evils. That is... what I tell myself, at least.

--The Hooded One, "Slavery" (POE II)

JUSTICE AND DJINNS IN VARASHTA'S AKHARA

NAVIRA

"You knew the twisted plan these fools devised. As Tale Woman, you are their compass in the sandstorm. Yet... you did not act. And now we mourn these honoured dead. You must pay."

Varashta condemned Navira to the ritual of the barya, sentenced to serve as a Djinn.

--Barya of Navira (POE II)

"My heart was fractured. I believed Kelari's words. I knew not his true nature... his ambition. I convinced Ruzhan there were cowards among his ranks. I failed you. And I accept my fate."

Navira confessed her failure to Varashta.

--Navira's Fracturing (POE II)

"Wipe the tears from your face, dear Navira. I did not deceive you. I meant every word. I will forever cherish you, my beloved. Know that I did it all for you... for our future!"

Kelari pleaded with the Tale Woman.

--Navira's Well (POE II)

"Kelari, you deceiver! I fell for your words, but no longer. Your sentence is a fate too good for you! I would give anything to bring back those who fell to your lies. Instead... I mourn my choices."

Navira lambasted Kelari a final time.

--Navira's Oasis (POE II)

RUZHAN

"I have seen countless battles. I know war! The taste of defeat... The taste of victory! But in this war... everything is at stake. So yes, those you speak of will know my blade. I will do whatever I must!"

Ruzhan confided in his Tale-Woman, Navira.

--Ruzhan's Trap (POE II)

"You have forsaken your duty to my akhara. Yes... we do not abide weakness. But we also do not abide madness in the fervour of battle! Your slain dekhara will have their justice. You must pay."

Varashta condemned Ruzhan to the ritual of the barya, sentenced to serve as a Djinn.

--Barya of Ruzhan (POE II)

"Yes... they fell by my blade and fire lashed them for their betrayal! No dekhara is exempt from fighting back the Winter before us. Lest they too know the Doom of the Desert!"

Ruzhan fumed at Varashta, in pure defiance.

--Ruzhan's Fury (POE II)

"I stand before you, as your humble servant. Though I was betrayed, I would do it all again, if it would have saved us. But I accept your sentence. I will atone. I pledge myself to you... forevermore."

Ruzhan accepted his fate at the barya ritual site.

--Ruzhan's Reckoning (POE II)

KELARI

"And you... there was no excuse for your actions. You defiled them! You have tainted the very sands with the blood of your own! Yet the war rages on. You have achieved nothing. You must pay."

Varashta condemned Kelari to the ritual of the barya, sentenced to serve as a Djinn.

--Barya of Kelari (POE II)

"The snare was set on our fallen. Beetles burst from their flesh, flooding the sands. Their exploding carapaces halted the advancing enemy... but it was not enough. And for that... I grieve."

Kelari admitted his wrongdoing to Varashta.

--Kelari's Malediction (POE II)

"Knowing where and when to plunge your knife is more important than the sharpness of your blade. I will not forget my error... and I will be a living example of your wisdom, dear Sekhema."

Kelari accepted Varashta's sentence and committed himself to her.

--Kelari's Judgment (POE II)

"Listen not to his simpering words, he means to languish before you to weaken your resolve! He is duplicitous. An assassin, thriving on deception and lies. His lust for power is what drove his choice!"

Outrage trembled in Ruzhan's voice at the sentencing.

--Kelari's Deception (POE II)

TRIAL OF THE SEKHEMAS

During the Winter of the World, the trial to become a *dekhara* was brutal and unforgiving. It was overseen by one of our earliest goddesses, Varashta, in a series of chambers beneath the sands. There, an aspirant and a mentor may both earn honour.

--Zarka, on ascendancy trials (on map) (POE II)

Those who would be Sekhema had to prove themselves exceptional.

--Trial of the Sekhems map pin (uncompleted) (POE II)

"These traditions we shall set forth, so that we may remain strong, so that we may endure throughout the ages. Not to bind, not to dominate, but to protect... and guide."

--Varashta's Blessing (POE II)

... This place was built to determine honour, to prove oneself worthy as a Sekhema. Tradition allowed for one *dekhara*, and one advisor. ...

--Babala, "The Trial" (POE II)

When I received my first flower of blood, I was given to the ritual of womanhood. All young Maraketh women have to dance with the scorpion, to prove themselves worthy of carrying the *dekhara's* spear.

It is no easy task, to catch a black Maraketh Scorpion. Their tails are swift, their stingers sharp, their poison lethal. I made my way through the trial unscathed, but my sister... We shared a womb, came into this world together. She left it, thrashing and foaming at the mouth. ...

--Irasha, "Shakari" (POE I)

The proving grounds for the sisterhood is complete. Though it broke many bones and some backs, the triumph is ours to behold. Zarokh has been a most helpful aid.

He came to us a taljari but now he is something more.

--Etchings of Varashta I (POE II)

The akharas have embraced the trial. It is fortuitous that the sisters of the sands understand the value of tradition, even those that are forged anew.

Zarokh has started the process of blessing the halls within. It worried some sisters, but he means well and I believe it will bring luck to the aspirants who come here.

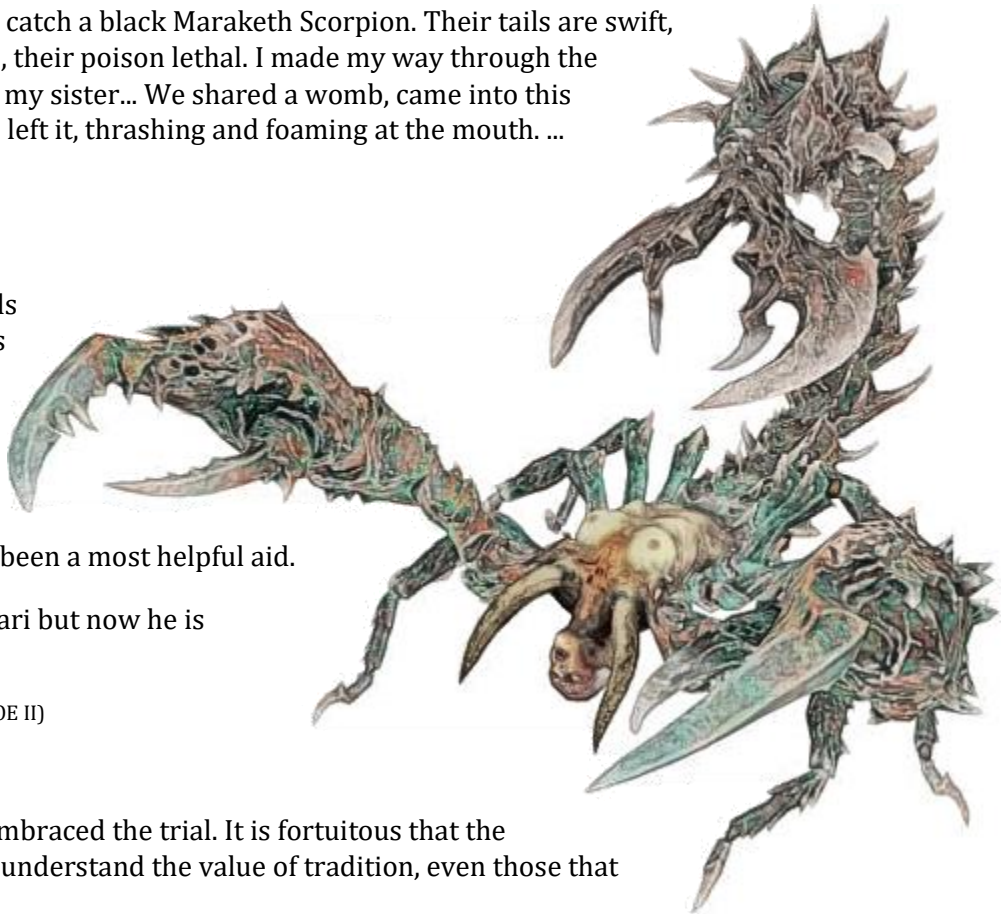
--Etchings of Varashta II (POE II)

The air has cooled. The sun is low... And I am betrayed. I see what he is. I see what a fool I have been. He is more than just some deceitful soothsayer though.... Zarokh... He manipulates time itself. Where did he gain such power?

I must find a way to fix this.

--Etchings of Varashta III (POE II)

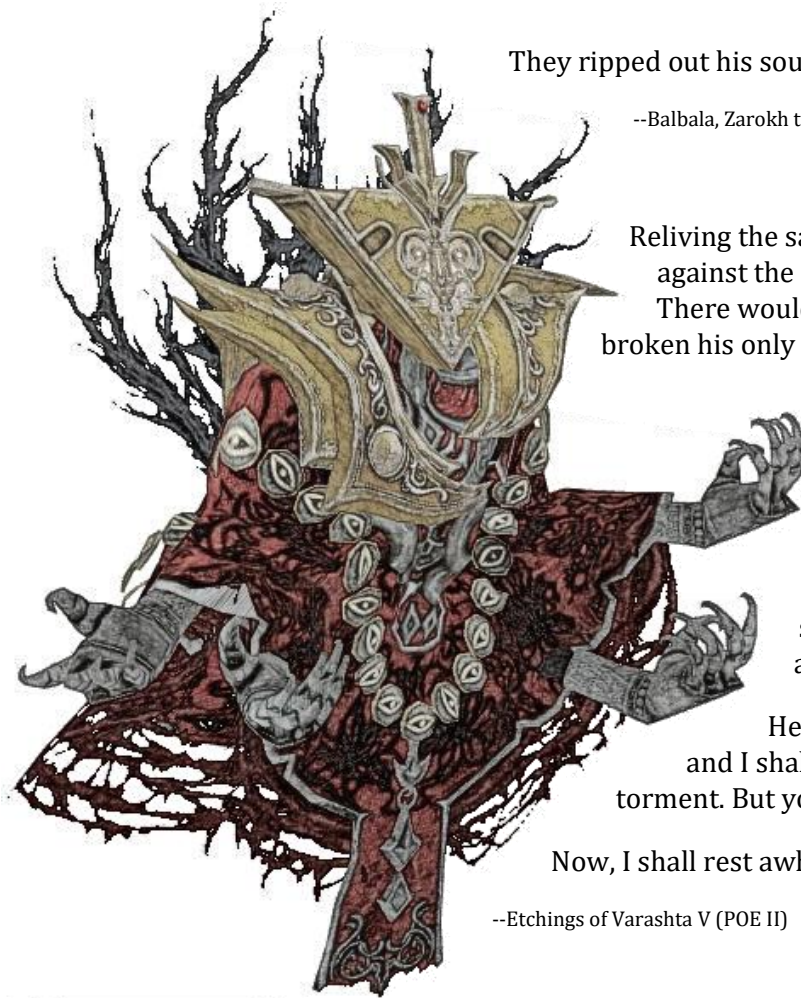
I have managed to trap him in the farthest halls of the Trial. Halls that are unrequired of the Sekhemas who will come here. I have also invoked the ritual. He is bound there for his crimes... A djinn. But as he is bound there, I am here.



Whatever foul curse he has placed upon these halls has sealed me here... Not so much in place but in time. Caught between now and tomorrow, but never thereafter.

I'm tired but... I must find my escape.

--Etchings of Varashta IV (POE II)



They ripped out his soul...but he refused to be imprisoned.

--Balbala, Zarokh taunt 2 (POE II)

Reliving the same day for all time, Zarokh raged against the moments that made up his prison. There would be no redemption, for he had broken his only barya.

--Zarokh's Refrain (POE II)

Future Sekhema, should you read this message, do not venture further. My eyes are as dry as the sands in these halls. My lips shrivel and my bones ache.

He has robbed me of everything. He and I shall remain bound in this eternal torment. But you must not continue.

Now, I shall rest awhile.

--Etchings of Varashta V (POE II)

So... You found her. Varashta... The Winter *Sekhema*. She and I share a unique... bond. A bond in time. A bond in pain. Together, we could have ruled the Vastiri. Perhaps, we could have ruled all of Wraecclast. The dutybound Maraketh may be honourable... but I found her lack of ambition... pathetic.

If you attempt to remove her... She will perish with her first breath of air outside that chamber... Her fate and mine are already sealed.

--Zarokh, on Varashta (POE II)

I have long considered it a mistake to bind souls to *baryas*. Not only is the punishment egregious, but it allows them to persist long past their time.

Zarokh achieved many great things during the war against the Abyssals, but his ambition outgrew his sense. Now, he remains to torment us, when he should have passed from this world long ago.

He worked closely with the tale-women of the era, and stole their wisdom, becoming the first Chronomancer. ...

--The Hooded One, "Zarokh" (POE II)

THE END OF DESPAIR

THE THIRD PACT

After the fires, in the depths of the Winter of the World, all life in the Vastiri banded together. Whether serpent, hyena, human, or golem, hated enemies clasped hand to claw, built refuge, and fought side by side against the Abyssals. Thus, the Third Pact was born.

--Against the Darkness Time-Lost Diamond (POE II)

By the terms of the Third Pact, the Sun Clan agreed to never again attack the Maraketh.

--Sun Clan Relic (POE II)

By the terms of the Third Pact, the Constrictor Queen was banished from Keth, but given the eastern sands.

--Kabala Clan Relic (POE II)

When Kabala the Serpent Queen was banished from Keth, the Sekhemas took a single hostage as punishment.

--Serpent's Egg Gold Amulet (POE II)

...the Valley of the Titans... The Maraketh do not step foot there. ...

--Asala, on travelling to the Valley of the Titans (POE II)



Do not tarry long in that valley. There are ancient pacts in this world that govern more than you and I are meant to know, but we still may suffer the consequences if we break them. ...

--The Hooded One, "Valley of the Titans" (POE II)

I am forbidden by the terms of the Third Pact from invoking the Rite of Flame myself. I must send an emissary... as must they. I do not know in what form it will come.

--Asala, "Valley of the Titans" (POE II)

As a servant of the Dreamer, the Third Pact explicitly forbids your kind from entering the Valley of the Titans. ...

--Zarka, on the Titan Valley (Monk version) (POE II)

"When the Third Pact was written in stone, the Dreamer gave the alliance of men and beasts knowledge. In return, they gave him a drop of blood; one from each of the races of Wraecclast. In the centuries that followed, his Will began to subtly change."

- Book of the Benevolent Dreamer, Histories 220:5

--Guiding Palm of the Heart Shrine Sceptre (POE II)

KULEMAK'S DEFEAT

... I aided an alliance that fought these beings for centuries. They are the Lightless. The Abyssals. The spawn of the Well of Souls. ...

In ages past, these creatures served a dark god... Kulemak, the Lich Lord, master of Undeath. The alliance destroyed his body in battle countless times, but the Well of Souls remained beyond our reach. ...

--Sin, on the Well of Souls (POE II)

In ghastly pits beneath the world, Kulemak grows countless new bodies, each more powerful than the last. Not all of his abominations survive.

--The Unborn Lich Ravenous Staff (POE II)

The Thief of Virtue! Stealer of Kulemak's spark!

--Lurking Creature, after The Hooded One's arrival (POE II)

Ranger: You... have it? His divine core?

The Hooded One: Yes. Slaying him proved fruitless. The alliance bound him, and I sapped his Divinity. His forces have hounded those old allies ever since, but the light is still their bane. ...

--Sin, after teaching the Lightless language (Ranger version, after Sin reveal) (POE II)

... The master changes, in Kulemak's absence. Amanamu. Ulaman. Kurgal. Never Tecrod. ...

--Lurking Creature, "Unchanging" (POE II)

The Liege of the Lightless seeks dominion for the authority it brings.

--Amanamu's Gaze (POE II)

The Sovereign of the Well seeks dominion to banish the Light.

--Ulaman's Gaze (POE II)

The Blackblooded seeks dominion for its own sake.

--Kurgal's Gaze (POE II)

The Hated Slave seeks dominion for the revenge it enables.

--Tecrod's Gaze (POE II)

The Lich Lords destroyed his body, but with his dying fury, Tecrod found a way. He lurks deep, in the blood, in the flesh, in the Well... perhaps walking among them even now, unseen.

--Tecrod's Revenge (POE II)

RETURN OF THE LIGHT

When hope was but a memory, the twin sister Sekhemas Solerai and Lundara arose to unite the Maraketh. They wielded the essence of gold and silver. The Spear is one of the two weapons that forged us.

--Solerai's Spear (POE I)

... In the darkest depths of that era, when hope was but a memory, the twin sister Sekhemas Solerai and Lundara arose to unite our scattered peoples for the first time. They wielded the essence of gold and silver, gleaming with such ferocity that the grey skies had no choice but to give way.

The creatures retreated under the sands, never to be seen again, and our fair plains blazed with emerald forests and sapphire rivers. ...

--Zarka, "History of the Vastiri Plains" (POE II)

"Lundara held back the hordes, while Solerai rose to split the sky. With a single stroke, she ended the Winter of the World."

- Wranga, tale-woman of the Wahida akhara

--Sunsplinter Array Buckler (POE II)

It is my belief that Solerai, from the Maraketh legend, is Solaris herself in another system of myths. If I can prove that, I can begin piecing together a true history of the Winter of the World.

--Seal of Solaris (POE I)

I have a suspicion that the Maraketh Sekhema of legend, Lundara, is the same historical figure as the Azmeri and Eternal goddess Lunariss. ...

--Seal of Lunariss (POE I)

... The People of the Mountains were very proud of the *Last Children*...

--Elder Madox, "The First Children" (POE II)

Solari, Lunari, and Viridi, of course. I know that you know them! How could you not? Solari and Lunari are right there in the sky, and Viridi is beneath your very feet! ...

--Elder Madox, "The Last Children" (POE II)

All rejoiced when Solerai and Lundara shattered the grey sky, but with the cold banished, sandier climes began to creep in...

--The Changing Seasons Seal Relic (POE II)

THE AGE OF GODS AND HEROES

... A time of conquest, wealth, great heroes, and gods that lasted for another thousand years. ...

--Zarka, "History of the Vastiri Plains" (POE II)

THE NATURE OF THE GODS

Though I am a god, I have not forgotten my humanity. I care for that which I once was. ...

--Sin, "Kitava" (POE I)

There was a time before the Beast, bathed in the shadows of lost memory, when men and women like you could ascend. Through rareness of quality and the adoration of their people, these few could reach out into the quickening mists of immortality and grasp the power of godhood.

Mind you, transcendence is never easy. Like the pains of childbirth, it reeks of agony, tragedy and sacrifice. The sacrifice most often being of one's humanity. That is simply the way of it. Those of us who seek the immortal throne live long enough to see ourselves become truly monstrous.

--Sin, "The Origins of the Gods" (POE I)

Ambition is the bane of mortality. It was through ambition that we gods transcended the thick mud and thin blood of our mundane birthrights. Ambition that drove us to sustain our divine selves through the subjugation of others. ...

--Sin, "Shavronne's Soul" (POE I)

Faith given under false pretenses still carries the same power.

--That Which Was Taken Crimson Jewel (POE I)

The gods seem to reshape the world around them wherever they go.

--Scion, on The Brine King's Reef (POE I)

So, Divinity doesn't just reshape the self. It changes the world around you, too...

--Witch, on The Brine King's Reef (POE I)

... Vanja: I learned all about the old gods. They were supposed to be our idols, beings of divinity that guided us through our mortal lives.

Petarus: But they aren't like that at all, are they love?

Vanja: Hardly. The gods're no better than we are! And nobody that is as bad as us should ever wield that much power! ...

--Petarus and Vanja, "The Old Gods" (POE I)

...Divinity...comes from the power of believers and faith. There was a time long ago when anyone with enough followers could ascend to godhood... Unfortunately, there seems to be a feedback cycle involved with Divinity, in which the image the leader projects informs what beliefs the followers imprint upon the leader, perpetuating an ongoing exaggeration of traits and desires. ...

--<https://www.pathofexile.com/forum/view-thread/2996851>

AZMERI GODS

THE DRAÍOCHT, THE SPIRIT, & THE FOUR HUMORS

The Draíocht connects everything that lives.

--Scarab of Wisps (POE I)

There are many names for the Draíocht, and for the spirits and beings that comprise it. Just like nature itself, it's difficult to distinguish the parts from the whole.

--The Primal Huntress, "The Goddess" (POE I)

You might call her a goddess. I might call them Sisters Three. Others might call them the collective will of nature itself. We may all be right. They exist within this Wildwood, or perhaps they *are* the Wildwood. To create this realm, the Draíocht gave so many pieces of themselves so widely and so deeply, that little remained. Fragments in every tree, every rock, and every animal. A voice, sometimes, to a chosen few... or so I've been told, by travelers through these lands.

--The Primal Huntress, "The Draíocht" (POE I)

The Draíocht was once a goddess that protected our people in your realm. There were three aspects of her, what we call the Three Sisters: the Mhacha, the Catha, and the Mórrigan. The Mhacha

represented nature itself; the land, the trees, the animals, and the men and women, too. You are surrounded by her compassion at this very moment. Persuaded by the Mhacha, the Sisters Three gave of themselves, imbuing every part of nature—living or not—with some of their essence. The Draíocht is the result of that ultimate gift. They gave so much that nothing remained of themselves. They gave *so much*, they are all around us. Inside me, and inside you, too. I can feel their will even now, and I know that I am exactly where I need to be.

--The Warden of Eaves, "The Draíocht" (POE I)

The second aspect of the original Goddess, the aspect known as the Catha, was the eternal battlefield betwixt good and evil. It represented the juxtaposition of summer and winter, and light and darkness. Where there is evil, there shall be good. This balance means that there is always hope.

--The Warden of Eaves, "The Catha" (POE I)

The third aspect of the original Goddess, the aspect known as the Mórrígan, was the guiding crow, the call to battle, and the bravery in the hearts of the Maji. She flew high above our people, showing us the way. Where her wings beat, the mists parted, opening new paths toward the future.

--The Warden of Eaves, "The Mórrígan" (POE I)

We honour the Goddess, [...*illegible*.....] the Sisters Three, [........] the most humble. All that we are, we owe to her. [........] Viridian Wildwood [........] apart from [...], cold, and sorrow.

--The Goddess (POE I)

[...*illegible*.....] sister [........] you will never be forgotten.

--Beloved Sister (POE I)

[...*illegible*.....] two of the Three Sisters [........] the battlefield [........] the warrior [........] the sign of the black bird [........]!

--The Warring Sisters (POE I)

The original goddess, the one comprised by the Sisters Three, is fairly unknown now. Her name has been lost to time. I've always wondered what it was. Who she was. Her sacrifice is the only reason I exist at all. It's a sacrifice I intend to honour.

--The Warden of Eaves, "The Goddess" (POE I)

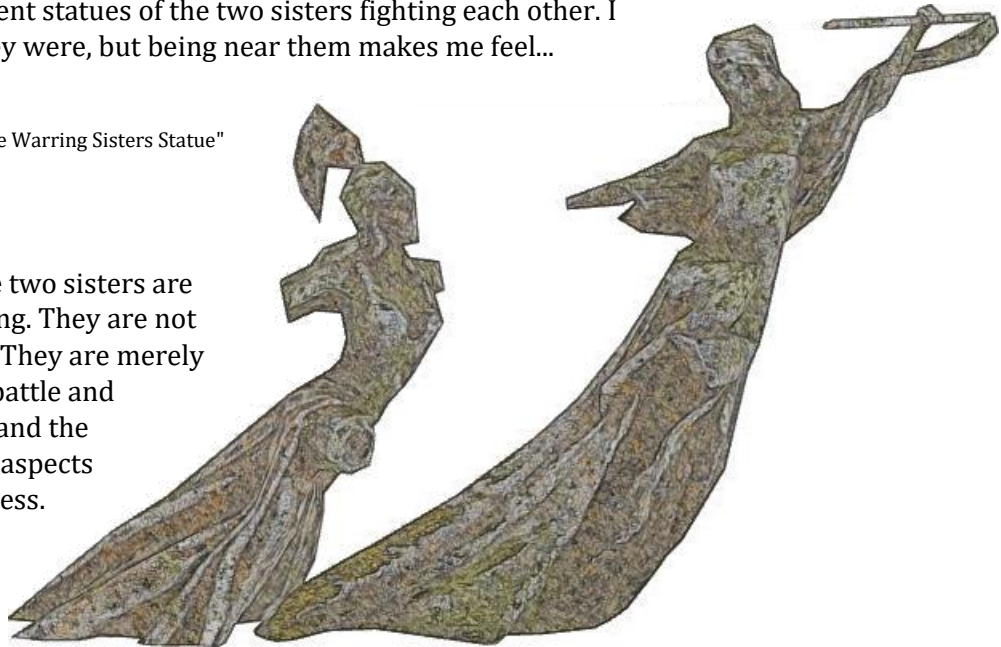
The original Goddess is still worshiped by our ancestors in the old world. ...

--The Warden of Eaves, "Statue of the Goddess" (POE I)

I've seen those ancient statues of the two sisters fighting each other. I don't know who they were, but being near them makes me feel... haunted...

--The Primal Huntress, "The Warring Sisters Statue" (POE I)

Those statues of the two sisters are somewhat misleading. They are not fighting each other. They are merely representations of battle and bravery. The Catha and the Mórrigan were two aspects of the original Goddess. It's an easy mistake to make, now that time has worn away all context.



--The Warden of Eaves, "The Warring Sisters" (POE I)

The Raven Trickster has few worshippers in the Wildwood. Give them no heed. He was long ago... taken care of.

--The Warden of Eaves, "The Raven Trickster" (POE I)

The Draíocht once gave the people of your world a special kind of wood, one which grows at the dark borders of this realm and the next... an Unnamed heartwood, of a kind that even the Trickster had no power over...

--The Primal Huntress, "The Raven Trickster" (POE I)

There exists a sliver of power in all living things, by definition. We walk upon a web of meaning spun with the silk of perception. That web shivers with every little shift in thought or idea. Beings like the King in the Mists and the Porcelain Queen are spiders that crawl the strands, seeking to ensnare us and drain us. The Draíocht, however, mystify me. The Sisters Three, or the original Goddess, whatever one might believe her to have been... she was selfless. Humble. She gave her essence back to the living beings from whence it came, and then some. This act may have come with profound consequences that we still do not yet understand. There is a reason I study corpses—

especially ancient ones. The oldest bones are fundamentally different, and I am determined to decipher their mysteries.

--The Breaker of Oaths, "The Drafocht" (POE I)

THE SPIRIT

We Azmeri, are guided by the Spirit. It provides prey, shelter... Even love. ...

--Huntress, <https://pathofexile2.com/hunt> (trailer) (POE II)

The Azmeri've long lived by the Spirit's ways—not so much a goddess as the lifeblood o' the land, but to outsiders...it's much the same.

Its energy flows through all livin' things—the wisps are proof o' that. ...

--Delwyn, on the Spirit (POE II)

I've never known the Spirit to manifest itself so openly. Heard tell of it, aye... but even in the stories, it weren't like this.

Our elders spoke of a time when the Spirit moved among us, seekin' out *rathin*—Corruption, in the modern tongue—and guidin' our hunters to it so they could cleanse the land. ...

--Delwyn, "The Spirit" (POE II)

Most wisps are small flickers o' the Spirit, drawn to *rathin* like moths to flame. But some... some burn brighter, and seek out only the strongest.

You'll know 'em by their orange glow—bright as embers in the dark.

--Delwyn, "Forms of the Spirit" (POE II)

We Azmeri hunt beasts infused with the Spirit. Always have. But... seems there are some wisps that are different. Older, maybe. More potent with the Spirit's power. ...

--Delwyn, "Greater Manifestations" (POE II)

When we Azmeri die, we rejoin the Spirit. Our voices become one.

--Huntress, to Matiki on Ancestors (POE II)

THE FOUR HUMORS

Primal, Vivid, Wild... Sacred. There are four humors that underlie the web of life. Each comprises a precious substance our natural world requires to function. Each is also produced by the natural world, and by living beings. The cycle is self-sustaining, so long as balance is maintained.

--The Breaker of Oaths, "The Four Humors" (POE I)

A Warlock such as myself primarily works with that which we call Wild, for it is unpredictable, but strong. A keen mind can harness Wild humors, either despite their volatility, or because of it. The most difficult lesson for an apprentice is usually the most basic: life and death ooze from the same sap. A corpse becomes a haven for budding life, which grows, then is eaten, nurturing more life, which dies... a cycle beautiful in its simplicity, unpredictability, and reliability. You might equate Wild humors with the blood of the body of nature.

--The Breaker of Oaths, "Wild Humors" (POE I)

Primal humors flow from life's struggle for supremacy and change. When a creature's continuing line of progeny grows more suited to its habitat, or when the strong battle for dominance, you will find Primal energies present.

--The Breaker of Oaths, "Primal Humors" (POE I)

Vivid humors flow from the cooperation of living beings. Whereas Primal humors are derived from competition and change, Vivid humors arise when disparate creatures achieve harmony. Consider the argoleth, a small reptilian creature that rides the fur of an ape. It feeds from castoffs and enjoys greater mobility, and in return, picks off parasites and cleans the ape's fur. There it is. Vivid humors arise. Civilisation itself is a rather heavy source of Vivid energies... but we don't have much of *that* around here.

--The Breaker of Oaths, "Vivid Humors" (POE I)

I have yet to understand the full import of Sacred humors. They are intimately connected, somehow, with the mind and the heart. What you think, what you believe, what you long for... at some level, it is a fluid, and it flows from you in measure equal to your passions. I have come to believe that, in some sense, the Draíocht is the flow of Sacred secretions, or contains its will. The King in the Mists harvests it with his deceitful altars. I dare say the secrets of the Wildwood itself are synonymous with the true nature of Sacred humors. We will uncover all in due time.

--The Breaker of Oaths, "Sacred Humors" (POE I)

... Sacred Wisps have chosen to light your way. Who am I to disagree with the Draíocht?

--The Primal Huntress, "Teaching" (POE I)

THE SNAKE

A monument to something ominous and unknown stands here. A horned snake holds an incredibly large sword.

--Ancient Monument (POE II)

I am troubled by stories o' deception... by voices that are not the Spirit. Is there someone out there misleading us? Whisperin' in our ears, leading us to our dooms? It sounds like our stories of the Snake, but of that, I know little. ...

--Delwyn, "The Snake" (POE II)

The Spirit is all things. The Spirit is the world, and it is us... but the Snake stands alone. The Snake whispers. Lies. Manipulates. It has been so since the time of the Mother Soul. And now it speaks as the Spirit, but is not, leading the foolish to ruin.

--Elder Madox, "The Snake" (POE II)

THE MAJI

We are merely the vanguard for the rest of our people, who still reside in the old world, waiting for the Wildwood to be purged of evil. We are the strongest and the brightest, chosen by the Draíocht long ago for this righteous purpose. There are many Maji deeper in this realm, though less than there were. I am the only one that ventures this close to the border 'twixt our realms.

--The Warden of Eaves, "The Maji" (POE I)

SOLARIS, ETERNAL SUN & LUNARIS, ETERNAL MOON

Once beneath a moonlit sky, Lunarís bathed her child in the ocean's tide. Though the waters were frigid with icy death, the boy was sick and couldn't be healthy until he was silent, clean and still...

--Captured Soul of Thraxia (POE I)

And so it was, that Lunarís, in her compulsion to nurture and protect, killed her son beneath the light of a waning moon. She stood silent, in trial before her tribe, as her fiery sister fought in vain to defend her...

--Captured Soul of Sebbert, Crescent's Point (POE I)

But Lunariss refused to admit any wrongdoing. She'd saved her child, had she not? He was safe now, buried beneath the dirt. Conviction gnarled around her fragile mind, and in her pride she rose to seat a deathless throne.

--Captured Soul of Lycius, Midnight's Howl (POE I)

...two sisters who ruled the most populous and powerful of the ancient Azmerian tribes. Solaris, [sic] was thought to guide the sun across the sky with threads of shimmering gold, whilst Lunariss saw to the wax and wane of moon [sic] with a sickle of purest silver.

It was a peaceful partnership, until the trickster, Tangmazu, happened upon their domain. In turning sister against sister he saw to the massacre of thousands whilst concealing the source of their futile feud beyond all reckoning.

Feel no pity for the moon. She is a cold and distant fool, far less radiant than she would suppose.

--Sin, "Lunariss" (POE I)

They used to be so close, you know... The Celestial Sisters.

--Tangmazu, The Solaris Temple Level 2 (Act 8) (POE I)

It wasn't hard to turn them against each other. A little nudge here and there. That's all it took.

--Tangmazu, The Lunariss Temple Level 2 (Act 8) (POE I)

Self-loving Solaris. All the light in the world, yet blinded by her own pride.

Not once did she pause to question the truth of her sister's betrayal. Instead, she gloated over her sister's transgressions, proclaiming herself greater and more honourable than Lunariss could ever be.

I suppose one shouldn't be surprised when a sun deity takes the higher ground.

--Sin, "Solaris" (POE I)

[Note: The following lore items were written for 3.0, but have never been available in-game.]



The sister gods of sun and moon, hand in hand did rule.
A guide for day and one for night, their people blessed in full.
Then sister sun, as daylight broke, awakened bound in cord.
Her flames were quenched, her life laid bare, her passion ripped and gored.
Who?" [sic] she cried, "Who torments me so? And tears me from the day?"
Her captor smiled, behind a mask they wore of bloodless grey.

- The Azmeri Verses, 1:20-23

--Solaris Statue I (POE I)

For many days, the sun did hide, no hand to guide it home
And icy moon hung in the sky, a queen perched on her throne.
Beneath the earth, Solaris cried, her pain too great to bare.
As instruments of sharpened steel caused skin and flesh to tear.
In the rarest slice of rest and respite, faithful Kulric came.
He cut her bonds and dressed her wounds and freed her from her pain.
Rising from beneath the hills, Solaris sprang a trap.
Her sister snared in flaming nets, Solaris brought her back.
A vow she made, a promise struck, to repay her kin in kind.
A sharpened blade, and broken luck, she'd rend her sister blind.

- The Azmeri Verses, 2:10-14

--Solaris Statue II (POE I)

In chains of flame and glowing ore.
A silver moon did strike the floor.
And a sister's eyes now forged in rage.
Silenced her cries with lock and cage.
Lunaris wept with betrayal's lash strike.
As her followers were slaughtered by sword and pike
Forever a prisoner, a moon buried in the earth.
Burned by a sun and a love felt since birth.

- The Azmeri Verses 3:1-4

--Lunaris Statue I (POE I)

Her heart did languish and her mind did fray.
As she bore the pain of each terrible day.
Solaris sharpened tools for sure and true caress.
As she drew her confessions from her sister's pallid fairness.
Lunaris spoke not a word to her sister insane.
While her blood did flow and her hope did wane.
Until the stranger she came to set the moon free.

Kulina, the last follower, and the last faithful deed." [sic]

- The Azmeri Verses 3:9-13

--Lunaris Statue II (POE I)

Hid 'neath the ice and shimmering snow.
Lunaris healed from her wounds and pondered her woe.
Solaris was mad, it was frighteningly clear.
Yet what had so filled her heart with such fear?
At the urgings of Kulina, the moon rose for war.
She world [sic] might fear their Sun no more.
Lunaris would crest the star-filled night.
And the Sun, rightly chained, would temper her light.
To war she marched, with her creatures of the moon.
With a hunger for justice and her bright sister's doom.

- The Azmeri Verses 3:20-25

--Lunaris Statue III (POE I)



Solaris upon the horizon stood and gazed upon the moon.
Any army of swords and shields and bows, a war to begin at noon.
Frustration of her sister's escape was killed and eaten up.
Replaced by the wrath and fear and grief that poured to fill her cup.
As Moon and rays marched on the Sun, Solaris eyed her prey.
"Sweet sister," she vowed with love and hate, "You shall never rule this day."

- The Azmeri Verses 5:19-21

--Solaris Statue III (POE I)

Every decade, Lunaris devours Solaris
Each time, Solaris emerges from Lunaris, born anew.

--Eclipse Solaris Crystal Wand (POE I)

Legend tells of a time when Solaris will burst forth from Lunaris, and night will be eternally banished.

--Corona Solaris Crystal Wand (POE I)

The mud is cracked and dry. The fields now burn beneath the blistering sun. Even our children are dying in the streets! We've angered Solaris and so we pay tribute to appease her fiery heart...

--Captured Soul of Shadow of the Vaal (POE I)

When Solaris is angered, there must always be sacrifice. Our women have taken to mourning, they drag themselves through ash and glass, not wanting to give up our youth to the all-consuming flame.

--Captured Soul of Jorus, Sky's Edge (POE I)

To take from the sun is to invite her wrath, and we've more than warranted her curse. The granaries were vacant, so we lessened our tribute to the sun thinking it would save our children, but they will die now regardless.

--Captured Soul of Suncaller Asha (POE I)

The Eternals revered Sun and Moon as the two eyes of their God. The right eye, Judging Solaris. The left eye, Merciful Lunar. ...

--Grigor, "The Lunar Temple" (POE I)

The sun is a devoted mother. She casts her golden blessings on the crops of the pious and makes barren the fields of heresy. Sunlight is belief. Sunlight is life.

- The Solar Verses

--Sun Orb (POE I)

Moonlight is a wise mother. The moon which bathes us in soft, cooling light, does so with the intent of illuminating our paths. Moonlight is wisdom. Moonlight is life.

- The Lunar Verses

--Moon Orb (POE I)

Powerful baubles the orbs are. As old as the Azmerians themselves, maybe even older. I've read all there is on them little beauties. The Sun Orb's said to contain all that has been, while its sister, the Moon Orb, holds all that will be. Past and future, packed up neat behind glass and thaumaturgy. Shudder to think what might happen if all that got out one day.

--Hargan, "The Orbs of Sun and Moon" (POE I)

... Solaris and Lunaris got front and center stage among them folks of the Eternal Empire.

Solaris was thought to be the light of leadership, guiding and enlightening each emperor that sat the throne. In practice, most of them emperors turned out to be a bit dim, but then history and theology have never quite seen eye to eye.

As for Lunaris, a goddess of the moon and earth, the mother of dreams and inspiration. Doesn't sound like a bad lady until you consider that dreams harbour nightmares and that inspiration is just one notion shy of insanity.

--Hargan, "Solaris and Lunaris" (POE I)

When Solaris closes her burning eye at the end of time, the world will perish in ice.

--Icetomb Latticed Ringmail (POE I)

VIRIDI

"Her sisters eternally fought for that shining apex in the skies, but Viridi instead found strength in humility."

- Azmerian Creation Myth

--Viridi's Veil Praetor Crown (POE I)

"A raging Solaris seared and contorted the orb's surface. A despairing Lunaris filled the scars with her tears. Yet Viridi remained, trapped within, forever more."

- Azmerian Creation Myth

--Prismatic Eclipse Twilight Blade (POE I)

... I have learned the location of a renowned Azmeri artefact known as Viridi's Finger. It supposedly causes enormous plants to grow from almost any soil. ...

--Niles, "A Mundane Sample" (POE I)

PROSPERO, LORD OF THE UNDERWORLD

The god of lost souls and found treasures. Lord of the underworld and all its material bounty. Gems, precious metals, coal...a myriad of subterranean substances, exotic and volatile. If it has value and it can be unearthed with pick and shovel, it falls within Prospero's divine concerns. As do all those who trade in them.

Prospero was a god of our ancestors, the Azmerians. As we Eternals descended from those mountains, our gods descended with us.

To the mundane mind they are myths, nothing but stories. To those with a little more imagination, they can be so much more.

--Cadiro, "Prospero" (POE I)

... Any miner worth his rocksalt knows Prospero. Might've even tried to make a deal with him for riches or life. Prospero's followers think the two are more or less interchangeable. If you believe in that stuff, I've got a flying rhoa to sell you.

--Niko the Mad, "Prospero" (POE I)



... He was supposedly in charge of all things that came out of the earth. Miners left him tributes. Guess they were hoping Prospero would protect them from a cave-in. Or an explosion. Or toxic gases. ...

--Niko the Mad, "Prospero" (POE I)

RYSLATHA, THE PUPPET MISTRESS

I'm beginning to understand. She was the Azmeri Goddess of Motherhood, but over time, she grew toward the extreme...

--Scion, on Ryslatha (POE I)

The Puppet Mistress was a revered matriarch who nurtured her tribe into greatness through love, peace and fecundity. That is, until her children were slaughtered by Tukohama's brave warriors.

Dissolution and desperation, they do troubling things to the spirit. And given enough time, what one believes, one becomes.

--Sin, "The Puppet Mistress" (POE I)

A maggot that festers and writhes in the fetid mud of the wettest lands. Ryslatha, the white worm that corrupts the very earth while her heart yearns to replenish her slaughtered brood.

Hers was a prolific tribe once, fat with peace and fecund with love. Then Tukohama's fire swept across her sacred land and her children were butchered by the madness of war.

Now the immortal mother has one waking thought. She will also ensure that her children are never harmed again. How? By making everyone's children, her children.

--Sin, "Ryslatha" (POE I)

Ryslatha was flushed with pride as she watched her mindless spawn mature. Sharpening their mandibles, her children slithered from the hive, eager to devour all the creatures that frequented the ancient woods.

--Captured Soul of Gorulis, Will-Thief (POE I)

The Azmeri believed that, one day, this world of ours would collapse under the weight of Ryslatha's offspring. ...

--Sin, on Ryslatha's death (POE I)



TSOAGOTH, THE BRINE KING

Old, salty Tsoagoth, pickled in a thick brine of ignominious carnality. Vanity was Tsoagoth's downfall, and I think he grew his shell just to shield himself from the shame of it all. ...

--Sin, "The Brine King" (POE I)

When I first met Tsoagoth, he was a seafaring chieftain, the beloved leader of a prosperous and sprawling fisher tribe. It was the curse of legacy that made him into the blasphemous Brine King. An endless madness of propagation and disappointment. All in the vain hope of recreating himself.

Fishwife after fishwife he took, and every one of them spawned a monster. A truly noble king would have surrendered his kingdom to cleaner blood. Alas, although Tsoagoth had many fine qualities, generosity was not one of them.

--Sin, "Tsoagoth" (POE I)

Though his mind decayed with each passing wave, the Brine King stood steadfast in his hatred, and wore it like a shell, protecting himself from his failure to sire a worthy heir.

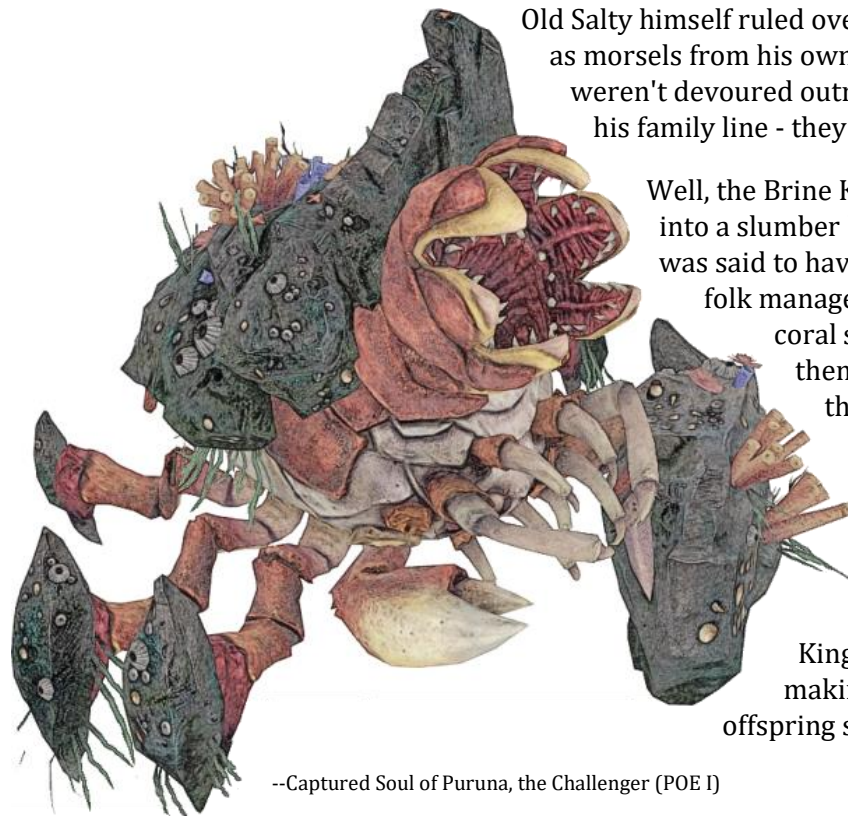
--Captured Soul of The Forgotten Soldier (POE I)

You won't find a sailor that doesn't whisper a quiet prayer to the Brine King before casting off. In fact, under the maddening radiance of a full moon, the more superstitious captains would drown some poor slave or failed mutineer... just to keep old Tsoagoth happy.

No, that wasn't a sneeze. That's the fish god's old Azmerian name. It's considered foul luck to speak it on board a ship. A keel-hauling offense.

--Bestel, "The Brine King" (POE I)

Every sell-dwelling lad or lass knows of Tsoatha. They call it a city, but it were more of a slaughterhouse than anything else.



Old Salty himself ruled over the place, treating its citizens as morsels from his own personal pantry. Those who weren't devoured outright were picked to try continue his family line - they became fish wives...

Well, the Brine King, as you know was forced into a slumber 'neath the ocean, and the city was said to have joined him there as well. A few folk managed to flee from the collapsing coral shards, start new lives for themselves, but I'll be reckoning they left all their valuables behind.

--Lilly Roth, "Tsoatha" (POE I)

The fish-wives of Tsoatha rejoiced loudly as the Brine King descended into the great abyss, making merry while his blasphemous offspring slithered 'neath the icy waters...

--Captured Soul of Puruna, the Challenger (POE I)

Slumbering in the breach between worlds, the Brine King dreamt of a day he would rise, in [sic] triumph from the shivering depths and take back the Kingdom he once so ruthlessly culled.

--Captured Soul of Nassar, Lion of the Seas (POE I)

T'gnagn iia y r'ngusla ph'tu Tsoatha nga mekghul'an.

- Indecipherable verse

--The Teardrop (POE I)

THRULDANA

May the Ferocity of Thruldana free you of your anguish...

--Undertaker Arimor, chant generic 12 (POE I)

THE TEMPLARS

... The First Children were sent to us for protection. They were nothing but trouble. Banished into the wastes, despite the ash and famine. Tragic.

The People of the Mountains were very proud of the *Last* Children, though.

--Elder Madox, "The First Children" (POE II)

...Oriath? Hmm... Ah, a derivative of the original name for the island the Golden Cult called home. They split off from the Azmeri during a difficult time in history. There was a time of famine, fire, and despair... and the gods rose from the ashes. ...

--Zelina, "Oriath" (POE II)

ORIGIN MYTH



On that day two were born of their mother's womb. Innocence, with eyes of burning red. Sin, with eyes of clearest blue.

--Stained Glass Window I (POE I)

Innocence lived with an honest and pure heart, never straying from his mother's word. Sin filled his heart with lies and indulgence, and deafened his ears to his mother's pleas.

--Stained Glass Window II (POE I)



When the Mother of Two broke bread, she allowed Innocence to eat his fill, as reward for his virtuous nature. Sin was cast the scraps to remind him of his worthless ways.

--Stained Glass Window III (POE I)

Yet the punishment only served to feed Sin's lusts. Before his brother's eyes, Sin stole a fish from the market and lied to the watchmen who caught him. Sin then beat his brother until a promise of silence was extracted.

--Stained Glass Window IV (POE I)



Innocence could not keep a promise made in fear. He bore witness and testimony to the Mother of Two, and it was decided, between mother and son, that Sin was beyond rule and redemption. That only purification could cleanse his burgeoning corruption.

--Stained Glass Window V (POE I)

The village gathered to watch Sin become ash, and breathed deeply of the smoke that poured from his screaming mouth. Sin filled their lungs, their minds and their hearts.

--Stained Glass Window VI (POE I)



Innocence watched Sin take root in the bodies of men and women and children. He witnessed them turn on each other, first with words, then with fists. Friends and kin embraced in mortal struggles, their skin weaving with skin, flesh bonding with flesh, bone entwining with bone, until the village had become one writhing giant, forged of strife and hatred.

--Stained Glass Window VII (POE I)

As this titan of Sin rose to its many feet, Innocence knew that the village was lost. With an anguished cry he committed it to flame. As town and titan burned, the sky turned dark with the ash of Sin. There, amongst the raging ruins of his home, Innocence swore an oath. No matter where the ashes of Sin fell, his purifying flames would rise to meet them.

--Stained Glass Window VIII (POE I)

His brother would not atone, so he took his brother's life, and with it, his sins.

--The Innocent (POE I)

...and so He said: 'Let only the good meet my gaze' and no eye met His. So He called down the cleansing flames and let black smoke sweep the Sinners away.

- Book of Innocence

--Eye of Innocence Citrine Amulet (POE I)

The Sign of Purity... Apparently it was a gift from Innocence to the first High Templar, Maxarius. ...

--Vilenta, "The Sign of Purity" (POE I)

Deep in the Templar's Ossuary, in the company of the dead, there lies the Sign of Purity.

Innocence bled himself for the creation of that cruel and desperate weapon. Tempered in his own ruby ichor, it was forged to be a transcendent tool of punishment and purification. The Sign is a living agent of righteousness, or at least, the dubious kind of righteousness that my brother subscribes to.

Innocence found, in the first High Templar, a most faithful servant and gifted the Sign to him, so that it might be used in times of great need. The great need of Innocence believers, that is. Humanity's general well-being has never been of particular concern to my brother.

--Sin, "The Sign of Purity" (POE I)

The Sign of Purity? Let's see... a staff, bathed in innocent blood. No, sorry, bathed in the blood of Innocence. Yes, Innocence gave a part of his divine self to the thing and gifted it to the Templar.

Now that I recall, I read a tome about it when I was a cadet. Bloody long time ago. I skipped most of the boring pages, so only remember the bit where High Templar Maxarius 'smote with flame the army of the faithless with one ray of its hallowing light'. The book's words, not mine. ...

--Bannon, "The Sign of Purity" (POE I)

The Mother of Two, once the Mother of Three, weeps eternal.

--Devotional Statue (POE I)

MAXARIUS, INNOCENCE, & THE BIRTH OF THE TEMPLAR

"It's all here. The lie at the core of my faith. Maxarius was not the first chosen of Innocence. Maxarius was Innocence himself. A charlatan, a liar, and a power-seeker." - Lycia, the Heretic

--The Original Scripture Papyrus Relic (POE I)

"In pursuit of divinity, he tried many times to found a religion. Few followed his initial symbols and proverbs. He needed something greater. A symbol none could deny." - Lycia, the Heretic

--The First Crest Coffin Relic (POE I)

"He took many of his people's traditions and gilded them, hollowed them. They rejected his new religion, and he and his followers were forced to depart the mountains for lands unknown." - Lycia, the Heretic

--The Second Sacrament Candlestick Relic (POE I)

...that golden cult [the Azmeri] banished to Oriath...

--Kahuturoa, "The Eternal Empire" (POE I)

That winter, scorched refugees emerged from the shrine, speaking only in strange tongues. They prayed to a new symbol of power, not out of love, but out of fear.

--Crystallised Omniscience Onyx Amulet (POE I)

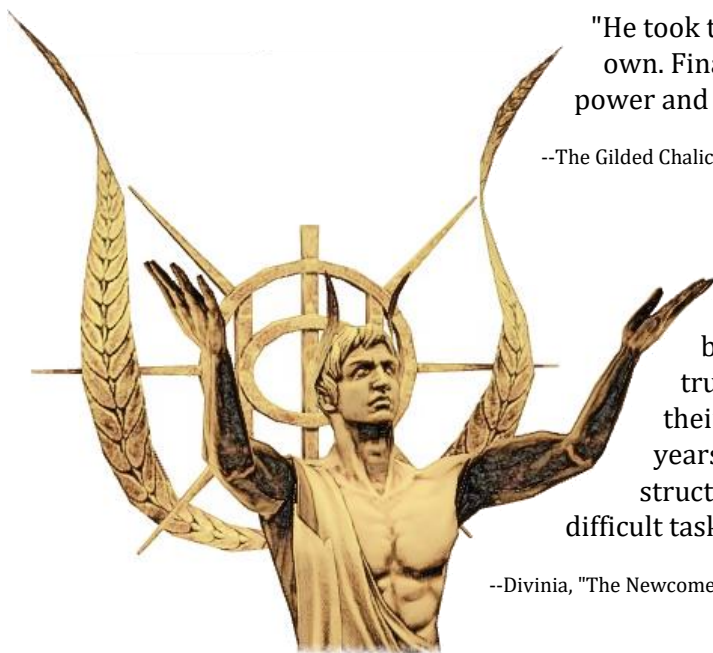
"The newcomers were terrified of fire. He used their fear to control them, to lay the seeds of unquestioning faith. He claimed only his god could protect them." - Lycia, the Heretic

--The Night Lamp Urn Relic (POE I)

"The newcomers warn of doom and death beyond mortal ken. I ask, why should we fear the fire when we serve the Lord of Light?"

- Maxarius, the first High Templar

--Dawnbreaker Colossal Tower Shield (POE I)



"He took the newcomers' symbol and made it his own. Finally, they flocked to him. Finally, he had the power and wealth he so desired." - Lycia, the Heretic

--The Gilded Chalice Processional Relic (POE I)

In all my research—and believe me, I've done more than most—I've still never been able to figure out who the newcomers truly were. They learned our language, but theirs has been mostly lost over thousands of years. It has a completely different grammatical structure, too, so translating it is a slow and difficult task. If only I could find that elusive shrine...

--Divinia, "The Newcomers" (POE I)

"His followers were too small in number to spark divinity, so he turned to a greater power: hatred. He vilified his brother, sparking zealotry, and the change finally began." - Lycia, the Heretic

--The Broken Censer Tome Relic (POE I)

Innocence rose to godhood not on inspired faith, but on the vilification and hatred of another.

--Original Sin Amethyst Ring (POE I)

"They ascended together, one unwillingly. The vilified became black as coal, and the lauded, golden. After a lifetime of ambition, he finally had his heart's desire. It only cost him his brother." - Lycia, the Heretic

--The Hour of Divinity Censer Relic (POE I)

"Building on the fear and hatred that deified him, Innocence threatened an eternity of flames for nonbelievers. The newcomers wailed and threw themselves at his feet in the thousands." - Lycia, the Heretic

--The Power and the Promise Tome Relic (POE I)

"The mysterious traveller saw the vilified brother chained to a cliff, where all could point and shout and deride him. In one fell swing, she cracked the mountainside, freeing him." - Lycia, the Heretic

--The Chains of Castigation Processional Relic (POE I)

"After weeks of being pursued, the veiled traveller made her stand in a sandstorm. Somehow, she wounded a god. Innocence relented; his brother and the traveller made good their escape." - Lycia, the Heretic

--The Blood of Innocence Censer Relic (POE I)

"In the hands of Orbala, it made a god bleed."

- Wranga, tale-woman of the Wahida akhara

--Tangle tongue Forked Spear (POE II)

At the last, her hope gone - but not her resolve - she threw her beloved Tangle tongue. That was the day a god bled. For this, the Great Roc graced a Maraketh warrior with a feather for the first time.

--Garukhan's Resolve (POE II)

... I was mortal first, but then I was deified against my will by my brother... but that is a story for another time.

I spent my early divine life in Keth. I loved, and was loved. I even had a daughter. ...

--The Hooded One, "The Shrine" (POE II)

In the early days of his religion, Innocence told his followers to drink of his blood and enjoy eternal life. ...

--Blood of Innocence (POE I)

Put your faith in me. Our god demands it.

- High Templar Maxarius

--Ceinture of Benevolence Cloth Belt (POE I)



Innocence derives power from Divinity, which comes from the power of believers and faith. There was a time long ago when anyone with enough followers could ascend to godhood, and that was when most of the gods we know, including Innocence, were created. Unfortunately, there seems to be a feedback cycle involved with Divinity, in which the image the leader projects informs what beliefs the followers imprint upon the leader, perpetuating an ongoing exaggeration of traits and

desires. Sin retained his humanity, likely because Innocence had him vilified in the Templar religion rather than worshipped...

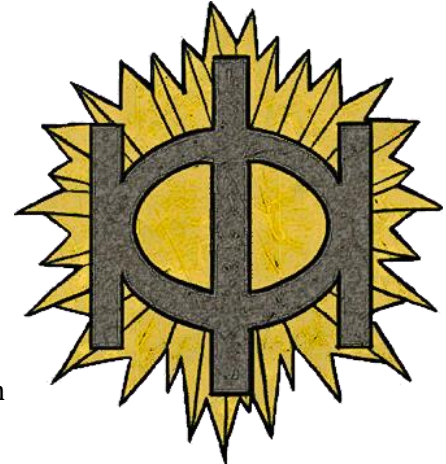
--<https://www.pathofexile.com/forum/view-thread/2996851>

SYMBOLS & FAITH

... That sigil...? It's a Descry, from when the Templar truly stood for something. To the ancestors of Oriath, the Descry was a flickering torch in the night. A source of inspiration and comfort.

Sad thing about torches... they go out.

--Eramir, "Fellshrine Ruins" (POE I)



They believed themselves the utmost faithful, but that conviction became oppression.

--Militant Faith Timeless Jewel (POE I)



The laws of the faith do not apply to its leader.

--Hands of the High Templar Crusader Gloves (POE I)

You forget that your Templar leaders wear masks...

--Riker Maloney, on being betrayed by Elreon (POE I)

THE ORDER OF SIN EATERS

A secret few among the Templars grant absolution by bearing the guilt of others.

--Sign of the Sin Eater Tyrant's Sekhem (POE I)

Among the Templars, a secret few ate the sins of others. They bore this burden to empower their hidden Order.

--Forsaken Bangle Amethyst Charm (POE II)

The history of the order of Sin Eaters is shrouded in secrecy and shame. Nevertheless, history demands truth, even if it takes centuries to be revealed.

--Staff of the first Sin Eater (POE I)

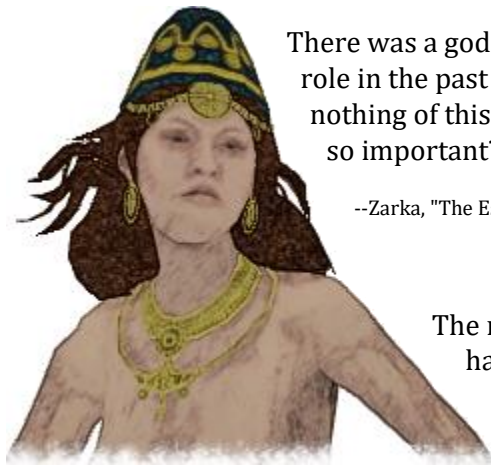
MARAKETH GODDESSES

Petarus: Have you ever heard much of the Maraketh legends?

Vanja: A truly unique cosmology of strange creatures, pagan gods and powerful treasures. ...

--Petarus and Vanja, "The Maraketh Calendar" (POE I)

HALANI, GODDESS OF WATER



There was a goddess of water lying at the heart of Keth? I wonder what her role in the past involved. It is my sacred duty to keep our tales, but I know nothing of this goddess! How could we Maraketh have forgotten something so important?

--Zarka, "The Essence of Water" (POE II)

The relief depicts some sort of forgotten Maraketh goddess. I have no idea what the context is. ...

--The Goddess of Water (POE I)

GARUKHAN, QUEEN OF THE WIND

...a rambunctious young woman I once knew in Keth, who eventually rose to power, attained divinity, and led her people to greatness.

--The Hooded One, "Asala" (POE II)

Since we do not have forty-five spare hours, I suppose I could tell you a small piece of one of Sekhema of Sekhemas Orbala's adventures.

Her second adventure took place three moons before her dance with the scorpion. She was not a Sekhema at that time, not even a *dekhara*. Word had not spread of her first adventure yet, either, for only her sister knew of the bandit-chase for Solerai's Spear that ended with Stridevolf in flames, so at that time she was still unknown.

For that reason, she initially said nothing when a visiting Vaal dignitary insulted her mother. He was a devotee of Arakaali, and wished to indulge in unmentionable activities. When Orbala's mother rejected him, he spoke vile words, then departed.

Orbala could not let this stand. She crept from her home in the dark of the night, tracking the dignitary's entourage through many unfamiliar forest roads. She found him bathing at the foot of Keth's second river, Halani. Aiming true, she struck him through the throat with a single arrow.

It was then that his entourage appeared and explained that he had merely been a Maraketh spy playing a role, and that his insult had been intended to spread his reputation ahead of his passage.

Orbala was given a choice: to face the justice of the Plains for her slaying of this important agent, or to don his clothes and fulfill his mission, masquerading as a Vaal dignitary in his place, so that the Sekhemas might assess threats on the border between the two peoples.

She succeeded in her ruse through many dangerous and humorous situations, although this adventure also ended with Lira Vaal in flames.

--Zarka, "Orbala's Eight Adventures" (POE II)

... It was said that the Horn of the Vastiri could control the winds. ...

--Zarka, "Dispelling the Sandstorm" (POE II)

Ah, the Horn... how to condense a seven-day tale? It was created during Orbala's eighth adventure, her final quest before becoming the *Sekhema* of *Sekhemas*... she wrested control of the three elements.



Her trusty war-steed, the great mastodon Ekbab, gave its tusks for the carving and the channeling of lightning. The essence of water was a secret held at the heart of Keth... and primordial fire must be earned from those that originally brought it to Wraeclast. ...

--Zarka, "Recreating the Horn" (POE II)

... The Necromancer of Weeping Black, Saresh, once waged war upon the Maraketh out of the nascent desert regions of that era. He commanded not only armies of the dead, but vast roiling storms as well.

Hearing of this threat, Orbala set forth on a quest to master the elements, and, in three places of power, she proved herself to the winds. Her reward came to be known as the Horn of the Vastiri.

When she drew in a mighty breath and sounded the Horn, it was *so powerful*, every tent across the entire Plains blew open. You can

imagine what it did to the Necromancer's sandstorms... Seizing their moment, the united *akharas* stormed forth to savage the undead armies of Saresh.

For this victory, Orbala was made the *Sekhema* of *Sekhemas*, and, after ruling with strength and cunning for many years, later became our Queen of the Wind, greatest goddess of the Maraketh. Her divine name was Garukhan, which means 'ultimate sovereign.' ...

--Zarka, "The Tale of the Horn" (POE II)

"Hate? You speak to me of hate? You have no idea what your persecution inflicts. How it chokes the heart. Withers the soul. Judge me, and you judge yourself."

- Saresh, last words, to Sekhema Orbala

--The Dark Monarch Lich's Circlet (POE I)

"I don't judge who you are, Saresh. I judge what you do. True leadership comes from fighting alongside those you command, from elevating them, and sharing the glory of victory. This, you will never understand."

- Sekhema Orbala, to be crowned Garukhan

--The Hallowed Monarch Faithful Helmet (POE I)

Vanja: ...an ancient sword, belonging to the Maraketh goddess Garukhan!

Petarus: The Storm Blade some call it. A weapon carved from crystal, capable of capturing even the most powerful of storms within its rigid edge.

Vanja: The goddess lost it, somewhere in the eastern desert during her ancient battle against the necromancer Saresh and his undead horde. ...

--Petarus and Vanja, "The Storm Blade" (POE I)

Garukhan sought madness and knowledge amongst the billowing clouds of a blackened sky. A vulture of pride, she would not be refused, and so the stratosphere divulged unto her eldritch secrets of its tumultuous past.

--Storm Blade (POE I)

A traveler on the winds, Garukhan pridefully plundered the sky for its secrets. To her mind, wisdom could be found in the eye of a hurricane.

Please understand that Garukhan is not an evil being. She was once my friend and companion. Her beauty astonished me as her aspirations inspired me. Yet I must forgo my sentiments for the sake of humankind.

Like winds erode the sandstone, Garukhan has been warped by the same powers she enslaved. ...

--Sin, "Garukhan" (POE I)

I would offer prayers up to the goddess of the breeze as a child, and listen to her voice sing and whisper as she danced through my family's windchimes. She was my favourite, but...some immortal madness has laid waste to her mind.

--Irasha, "Garukhan" (POE I)

... Garukhan was... complicated, but she was also stubborn and never would have thought to change her ways.

...she was vain beyond comparison. It was her ambition that corrupted her, despite all my warning words. ...

--Sin, "Garukhan" (POE I)

I weep for my poor Garukhan. Together we experienced the loftiest moments that this world could offer.

Alas, it was my heavy heart that she could no longer bear. I knew her pride would one day be the storm that would ravage my precious humanity. In truth, it was for Garukhan that I sowed the Dark Ember within the depths of Highgate.

When love cannot be slain, it must be laid down to sleep.

--Sin, "Queen of the Winds" (POE I)

SHAKARI, QUEEN OF THE SANDS

It is not something I deign to speak of often, but this goddess, this creature, she was once the flesh of my flesh, blood of my blood. I rose into the clouds and fell into the arms of their queen, the beautiful Garukhan.

Now if you think that mortal marriages are difficult to navigate, try an immortal one. We parted ways, yet not before my young Queen of the Sands was born into this world of filth and horror. ...

--Sin, "Queen of the Sands" (POE I)



A mother's keen heart shall bleed into the dreams of her daughter. Once a beauty who held captive the hearts of men and women alike, Shakari's splendour decayed into lust... for the power possessed by her skyborn mother.

My daughter once sought out such power within the great sands of this desert. Ever determined, she found it, and it made of her the twisted creature...

Driven by agony and shame, she built an army out here in these sweltering lands and would have conquered the very sky had not the Beast soothed her into peaceful oblivion. A babe once more sleeping in her cradle.

--Sin, "Shakari" (POE I)

VAAL GODS

RALAKESH, MASTER OF A MILLION FACES

Yes, Ralakesh, the god of many faces. I read about this god when I looked after the museum in Theopolis. It's said he was obsessed with governance, in particular, the control of humanity through our base, animal instincts. He ruled over the citizens of one unfortunate Vaal city. Alas, the name escapes me.



Yet I do recall that his experiments brought his subjects to the brink of extinction and that he was forced to enslave many a primitive Azmerian of the time so as to repopulate his domain. ...

--Eramir, "Ralakesh" (POE I)

... Ralakesh was renowned for his penchant for subjugation and control. ...

--Eramir, "Greust" (POE I)

The Master of a Million Faces lived by one simple ethos: why make the effort, when you can simply mimic what others have?

--Ralakesh's Impatience Riveted Boots (POE I)

... Hmm...Ralakesh. He's ruthless and cruel, with cunning unfathomable. Yet he bears one defining weakness. A fear he forged into chains of his own keeping. His is the terror of grasping too much and having it all slip through his fingers. It makes him irrational, and therefore vulnerable.

--Sin, "Ralakesh" (POE I)

Ralakesh, the illustrious "Master of a Million Faces". I call him the God of Hide and Seek.

While other deities waged wars, spread their seed, and laid waste to whole empires, Ralakesh perched on his throne in a dark palace of ebony, choked with incense, blinded by obedience and deafened by a senseless cacophony of brass gongs.

Thankfully, he never had the courage to peek over the high walls he'd built, else the world might have been in trouble.

--Sin, "The Master of a Million Faces" (POE I)

When you try to control everything, you ultimately control nothing. Ralakesh has never quite been able to grasp that concept.

--Sin, on Ralakesh's death (POE I)

Lock the gates and build the walls! came [sic] the rallying cry, "Let those of Ralakesh take care of those of Ralakesh!"

- The God Behind The Wall

--Captured Soul of DreK, Apex Hunter (POE I)

YUGUL, REFLECTION OF TERROR

Vaal scholars seemed compelled to answer all manner of strange and troubling questions. Yugul was one such scholar. Whilst plumbing the depths of humanity, he came to believe that there was no truer expression of humanity than pure terror.

He would induce terror in children and then capture their reactions within eldritch mirrors, devices of his own creation that could petrify fear for extended study.

Through his gallery of reflected terror, Yugul came to understand human nature so well that he was able to manipulate his way into the Vaal halls of leadership, and eventually grew so feared and renowned that he ascended into godhood.

--Sin, "Yugul" (POE I)

I heard tell of an ancient Vaal scholar who bore the name 'Yugul'. He'd conduct these grisly experiments in pursuit of some piece of nasty wisdom tucked into the nether regions of human terror. Practiced on young kiddies no less, scaring the living shite out of Vaal toddlers and then nabbing their fear within a hall of thaumaturgical mirrors.

Could be the whole story's a crock, and here's where it gets even hazier. Seems old Yugul found something in that fear, enough to scare a whole swag of Vaal into worshipping him.

Honestly, some people will worship anything for a bit of spiritual peace of mind.

--Hargan, "Yugul" (POE I)



In nature, there are many feelings exclusive only to man. But terror is not one. Terror flourishes in our world, transcending all things. It is the bedrock on which our great cosmos is formed. I am Yugul and I deign to understand this mystery, to explore its depths and unlock its secrets...

--Captured Soul of Varhesh, Shimmering Aberration (POE I)

[Note: The following lore item was written for 3.0, but has never been available in-game.]

So many have scrutinised the inner workings of the heart, written entire books on sadness, love and hate. Yet terror is the truest, purest of all human emotions. Terror is what we have once our earthly facades are stripped away, once we are naked, vulnerable savages in a vast and uncaring wilderness.

Civilisation is a costume, worn to conceal our truest natures. Oh, that we could all become terrified children once again! That we could understand in an instant that everything is hopeless, everything is death. There is no next step, no reprieve. Life is terror and terror is life.

- Forbidden Texts of Yugul

--Primitive Carving II (POE I)

Yugul was a cautionary tale. The only way to truly understand fear is to become it.

--Sin, on Yugul's death (POE I)

ARAKAALI, SPINNER OF SHADOWS

A temptress and a predator. Vaal legends say she crawled up from the blackest of pits during the creation of the world.

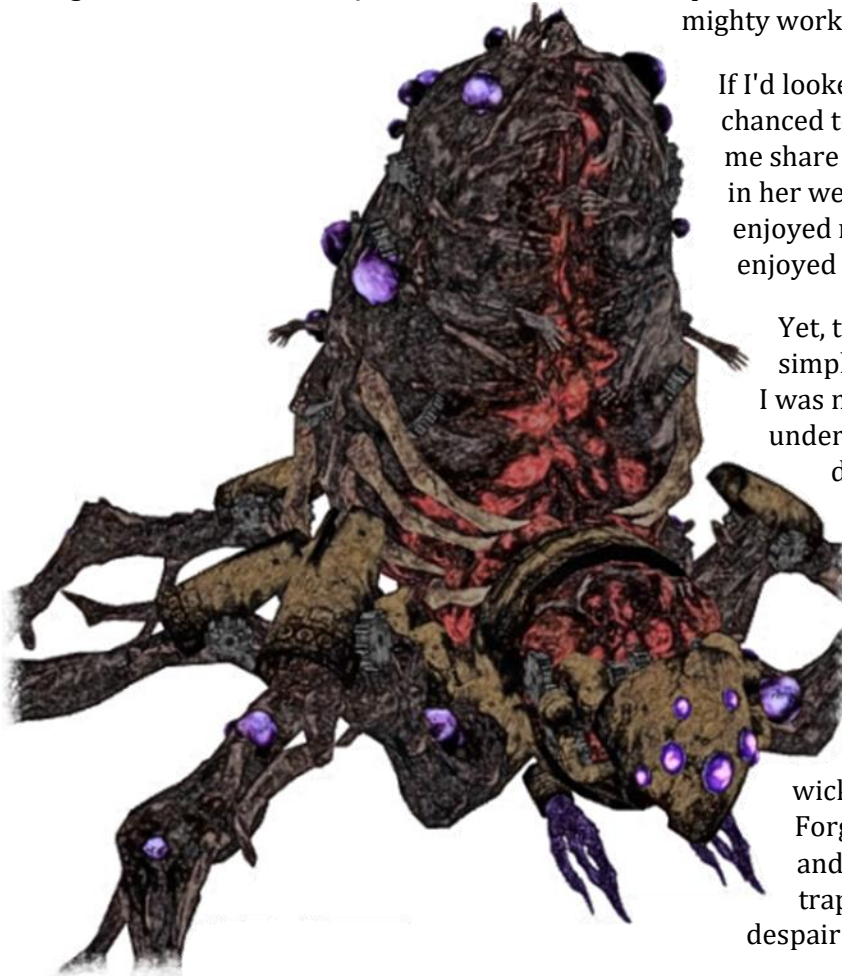
No, her beginnings were far more mundane, a mortal harlot whose endless lust for loin and lecherous delight saw her transformed into the very image of her dark desires.

'The Spinner of Shadows' they once called her. She sees herself as a regular goddess of love, and has the romantically forged temple to prove it.

That's where you'll find her. Yet there's little romance to the lady herself. At least, I doubt the corpses that now embrace her carapace would think so.

--Sin, "Arakaali" (POE I)

Answering the call of a royal invitation, I visited the Spinner of Shadows as an emissary for a small and fragile alliance of gods. Mostly weak deities huddling together in terror of being consumed by their greater. At this time, Queen Arakaali ruled an empire, and so invited me to gaze upon her mighty works with appropriate wonder.



If I'd looked past this pretense, I may have chanced to see her hidden desire to have me share her bed. For years I lay trapped in her webbed sheets. Some days she enjoyed my prowess, other days we enjoyed each other.

Yet, this illusion of love and leisure simply veiled the morbid reality that I was not free to leave. I languished under her bewitching spell until the day the spider was betrayed by her own flies, and sealed within that temple of her own fevered making.

--Sin, "The Spinner of Shadows" (POE I)

She flashed a smile full of wicked teeth. "Sin, my darling. Forget your Maraketh woes." She bit and tore and reveled; he lay trapped in silk, wrought with despair and ecstasy.

--Arakaali's Lust (POE II)

From what I can recall, Arakaali was a Vaal fertility goddess, a rather unsettling union of sexuality and mortality. Whilst usually presenting herself as a large arachnid, Arakaali would often assume human form, a ruse intended to lure mortals into the act of copulation. The entries were vague about the gender of her prey.

After satiating her carnal desires, she would then quench her divine thirst, draining her erstwhile lover of all bodily fluid. Her acolytes would then collect the dessicated [sic] husk and give it a decorative placement in Arakaali's unholy temple. ...

--Eramir, "Arakaali" (POE I)

There is a story held by the ancient Vaal, in which the beautiful seductress Arakaali strode through towns, stealing the hearts of men, and turning to ash their lovers' desires.

- "Legends of the Vaal" by Eramir, Scholar at Theopolis

--Captured Soul of Arachnoxia (POE I)

When the cold was at its strongest, Arakaali came, and like a farmer leading cattle to the slaughter, she drove her victims into the outer darkness.

- "Legends of the Vaal" by Eramir, Scholar at Theopolis

--Captured Soul of Shock and Horror (POE I)

Records of Arakaali's violent reign suggest she kept her citizens sedated with 'juices of lust' and venoms of the spider. Perhaps her guise of seductress was in fact her way of farming those 'juices'.

- "Legends of the Vaal" by Eramir, Scholar at Theopolis

--Captured Soul of Armala, the Widow (POE I)

Many an artist of Azmerian descent has engaged in the sad worship of that sultry arachnid...

--Sin, "Arakaali" (POE I)

Make no mistake, my Azmeri ancestors worshipped Arakaali long before the Vaal did, although I'm not entirely sure why. She was hardly a goddess of love or fertility; no, she was naught but a predator, ensnaring her victims in silk and sedating them with venom.

--Cadiro, on Arakaali's Fang (POE I)

Our great goddess, we worship her, and in so doing, we may become her. Healer of Hearts, Arakaali, with the juices of lust and venoms of the spider, she brought many back from the brink of death. Only she was worthy to rule. The Porcelain Queen, Gruthkul, disgraced my ancestors, drained them with drought, starved them with famine, blighted them with plague. It was with justice and truth that my ancestors shattered the Porcelain Queen's reign, and brought our Messiah to power.

The Widow

--Shrine to Arakaali I (POE I)

Our Temple of Decay was built so that we, her chosen, might sustain our great goddess in her pursuit of the secrets that lust and life would keep from us. We, her followers, brought all assortments of venomous creatures and laid them at her feet, yet it was the spider she most coveted, and as the divine energies wove their destinies about her body, our Queen, Arakaali, was reborn. Arakaali the Miracle, Arakaali the mighty Arachnophage, a beauteous creature of immortal power and unfathomable wisdom.

The Widow

--Shrine to Arakaali II (POE I)

As our Queen's body was reborn, so too was her mind. Awash with visions of future and past, she burst from the deluge, gasping with terror. She had seen her empire in ruins, her people ground into the dust. And atop her throne sat the children of Gruthkul, their long white hair fluttering in the winds of victory, their laughter as saw-blades in Arakaali's heart.

Yet as the vision poisoned her dreams, Arakaali poisoned the vision. Once, twice, thrice, the children of Gruthkul fell, crying their crimson tears. And how their mother grieved.

The Widow

--Shrine to Arakaali III (POE I)

As her fury grew to blot out the sun, the mother's grief grew to eclipse the land. Gruthkul and her horde stampeded across the realms of Arakaali, crushing her subjects, blood and bone, into the trembling earth. With her empire on the brink of ruination, our Queen, our Spinner of Shadows, hatched a desperate plan. Feigning injury and defeat, Arakaali lured Gruthkul into the heart of a great cavern. There she entwined her enemy in unyielding silk and then, with prodigious



bravery and strength, brought the very stones tumbling down upon Gruthkul's antlered head.

The Widow

--Shrine to Arakaali IV (POE I)

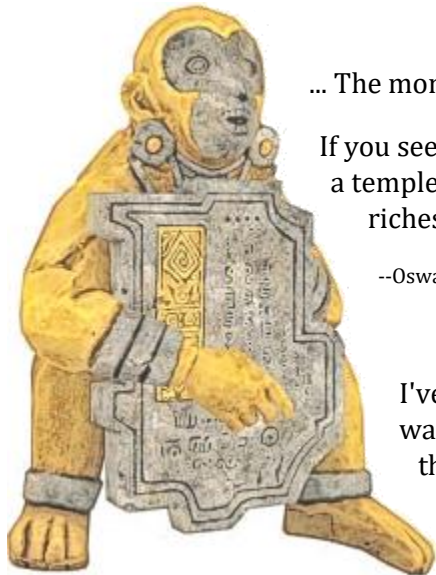
Even as our courageous Arakaali forged the foundations of a new empire within the ruination of the old, a fresh threat was born in the shadow of the mountains. A creature so devoid of divinity, so beyond humanity, that it drew the very essence from Arakaali as the spider imbibes the life of the trapped moth. Our Queen's medicines had once sustained us. Now famine and plague ravaged what little remained of our lands.

As the Beast of the Mountains grew, our Arakaali waned until, helpless as a child, she lost even the faith of her most devoted, the Temple of Decay. I feel the shame for my ancestors as the spider's venom burns in my belly. When our Queen needed them most, her people betrayed her, bound her in silk and left her to languish in the bowels of a pyramid, just as Arakaali had done to Gruthkul so many years before. ...

The Widow

--Shrine to Arakaali V (POE I)

KAMASA, THE MONKEY GOD & GOD OF WEALTH



... The monkey represented Kamasa, the Vaal god of Wealth.

If you see a statue of a monkey, it means treasure. It may be a vault. May be a temple. Could be a vast forge. Any of the above would mean fabulous riches.

--Oswald, "The Molten Vault" (POE II)

I've never been quite sure if Kamasa was *actually* a monkey, or if he was just god *of* monkeys. In either case, he held their love for shiny things.

The wealth wasn't the point, but his cult still slowly grew to become the richest in the Vaal empire. Eventually, they became the very guardians of the treasury itself. The famed Perandus family would have been paupers in comparison. ...

--Oswald, "Kamasa" (POE II)

Little is known about the Monkey God. He was initially portrayed as curious, wise, and prone to mischief. In the earliest tales, if he appeared, it was to do one of two things: impart mysterious wisdom, or steal something shiny from a wealthy noble.

Unfortunately, his greed apparently grew as the Vaal expanded. Later tales portrayed him extorting peasants and blackmailing nobles for increasingly large tithes. His cult's core values became exploitation and ambition.

His high priests eventually ran everything remotely financial in the Empire. I can only imagine what treasures are hidden in their ancient coffers...

--Oswald, "Kamasa's Greed" (POE II)

The cult of Kamasa exploited Utzaal long before its fall.

--The Molten Vault map pin (completed) (POE II)



KOPEC, THE SUN GOD



The ziggurat beneath us was once the Temple of the Sun God, one of the oldest built in the city of Utzaal's religious district. It was in active use for at least a thousand years...

--Oswald, "Ziggurat Encampment" (POE II)

...the Temple of the Sun God, Kopec...was said to contain a grand device. I've seen writings by a fellow named Ketzuli that mention his research in this temple, but I can't quite make sense of what the device was or how it functioned. ...

--Alva Valai, on sun god explanation (POE II)

YAOMAC

...the god Yaomac – the shepherd of Vaal souls, and the arbiter of the balance of the seasons. Three unique blessings are conferred by each of Yaomac's three serpentine heads.

--Cadiro, on Triumvirate Authority (POE I)

Their three serpentine heads found unity in balance.

--Yaomac's Accord Vaal Sceptre (POE I)

The priest that carried Yaomac's sigil was granted one boon by each serpentine head.

--Triumvirate Authority Unset Ring (POE I)

You covet the strength of your peers, mortal? Perhaps it can be yours, if you are willing to make an offering of their blood...

- Vaal Myth of the Third Snake

--Offering to the Serpent Legion Gloves (POE I)



KARUI GODS & THEIR TRIBES

... There are so many Karui tribes, and so many gods. We don't all share the same ones, either. There are tribes in Western Ngamakanui, beyond Ezomyr, with gods most of us are barely aware of. Those tribes are strange, and we don't go there.

--Kahuturoa, "Kitava's Defeat" (POE I)

We all seem neatly divided into our tribes here, but it isn't so. Warriors switch tribes all the time due to marriage, chieftain successions, or simple wanderlust. We Karui are a nomadic people, in the physical and spiritual sense. When I call my tribe the Valako tribe, yes, we are, but at one time we followed Tukohama, and at another Tasalio, and then Valako again before that. Essentially, each god must prove themselves to us the same way we prove ourselves to each other. If a tribe falls on hard times, clearly, their god has failed them, and it may be time for another. We can also call upon any god we wish at any time, so long as we are in good standing as a warrior. Basically, it's like children running amok around the campfire.

--Kiloava, "Tribes" (POE I)

We gather from time to time. Not as often as we should. But it usually always becomes some sort of... altercation.

Some of us just have very different ideas.

--Tavakai, on tribes (POE II)

TUKOHAMA, FATHER OF WAR

The Karui were a peaceful culture of farmers and fishermen, before fate thrust the great Tukohama upon them. It was he who put the stone axes in their hands and the hunger for conquest in their bellies.

Farmers quenched their dry fields in blood. Fishermen emptied their holds of fish and filled them with land-greedy hordes.

Battle by battle, war by war, Tukohama carved the steps that would carry him up a mountain of severed heads, and into immortality. Tukohama's axe is called Anger, his spear is called Greed, and their victims are the minds and hearts of all Karui.

--Sin, "Tukohama" (POE I)



Our Father of War was the first to put axes in Karui hands. We learned that we could take from this world rather than accept what was given. Many of the other gods are generous, but why should we subsist in harmony with the land when we have the strength to be its masters?

--Akoya, "Tukohama" (pre-defeat) (POE I)

... Tukohama provides us with weapons and knowledge of war, which lets us walk the path safely. ...

--Navali, "Karui Gods" (POE I)

Weakness must be purged lest it poison the blood of all Karui.

- Prayer to Tukohama

--Eye of Conquest (POE I)

Tukohama stood in the door, blocking the sunlight from Hikatomanga and his family. The Father of War's retribution was inevitable, for it is known - man cannot cheat the gods without consequence...



--Captured Soul of Tahsin, Warmaker (POE I)

"Drunken Erqi boasted to Tukohama; the God of War challenged him to a clash of strength. Woe to the Divine - he should have made it a test of skill!"

--Marohi Erqi Totemic Greatclub (POE II)

...the Tukohama Tribe and the Ngamahu Tribe were in continual conflict. A cycle of vengeance kept the two groups raiding each other, and they were beginning to lose their superior positions. There was a danger of the other tribes becoming dominant. To put an end to it, Ngamahu and Tukohama went through the traditions together. Tukohama aided her in the forging of a legendary axe, while her ring, a sign of fire and fertility, was given to us. ...

--Akoya, "Ngamahu" (POE I)

Tukohama tasked his tribe—*my* tribe—with keeping that Deceiver in his prison. Our sacred duty kept us in this region, even though we longed for the sea... but it is good that we stayed.

--Tavakai, on Tekaru (POE II)

... Each tribe has its own belief about how the world will end, but you must understand, these tales do not conflict. They are all correct. Our traditional expectations are not literal.

Our *hatungo* speaks of a time when all Ngakuramakoi will become so strong, and so skilled at warfare, that every man and woman will seek to become their own chieftain. Blood lust will take over the people, and war will continue until only one warrior remains. That warrior will be the strongest that ever lived in all of history, and he will die soon after from his wounds. His fallen body will become the new world, and his blood, the rivers. His dying warcry will become the sky, and his fierce eyes will become the new Sun and Moon. Of course, this is not a literal tale. It is meant to give us a sense of place in a chaotic existence. There is immense value in this. Our traditions give us meaning and purpose...

--Akoya, "The End of Time" (POE I)

NGAMAHU, MOTHER OF FIRE

Fire was a gift to mortals.

--Tawhanuku, on purchasing a Kaom item (POE I)

... Ngamahu lends us fire, which illuminates the path. ...

--Navali, "Karui Gods" (POE I)



We do not command fire. Ngamahu lends it, and Hinekora returns it.

- Lavianga, Advisor to Kaom

--Ashcaller Quartz Wand (POE I)

The Hinekora Tribe thinks Time will simply stop one day. No. The Ngamahu Tribe believes the world will end, not with some pathetic unraveling of the seasons, but with a tremendous eruption. Wraeclast will stab itself and pour forth its lifeblood to burn away all life, both the mighty and the diseased, as it has done before. Then, the first of a new line of Karui will emerge from the molten caldera, as we did before. They will be different. Maybe better, in some sense, having learned from the wisdom our souls will carry forward. Theirs will be a savage new world to conquer all over again. I wish I could be there to see it... a glorious new challenge unlike any other... but my soul will be returned to the volcano with all the others here in the Halls of the Dead, to be melted and reforged into that entirely new Karui essence, that new line. I could wish for no better end.

--Kaom, "The End of Time" (POE I)

The Ngamahu Tribe believes the Karui will be reforged in a volcano at the end of time.

--Fire Tattoo of Ngamahu (POE II)

VALAKO, FATHER OF THE STORM



Unlike the other gods, when he was born from the volcano, Valako rode the clouds of ash into the thundering sky.

--Valako's Vice Plate Gauntlets (POE II)

Have you ever had the feeling, during a rising storm, that the winds and rain might just keep getting stronger and never ebb? That's how the world will end. A great storm will cover the land, and it will just keep raging harder and harder until everything is swept away. Then, as always happens after a big storm, life will burgeon anew. We see it all the time around us. Why would it be any other way?

--Kiloava, "The End of Time" (POE I)

TASALIO, FATHER OF WATER

Tasalio bids you take a moment to stop and enjoy the calm of the ocean.

--Cold Tattoo of Tasalio (POE II)



The Tasalio Tribe developed their own Way, seeing the world not as it is, but as it should be, given its roiling and endless grace of constant motion.

--Rakiata's Flow (POE II)

Hunters of the Tasalio Tribe are just as effective on land.

--Intelligence Tattoo of Tasalio (POE II)

SIONE, MOTHER OF THE SUN & LANI HUA, MOTHER OF THE MOON

Many believe that the Mother of the Moon has been off fighting a war against the Mother of the Sun for thousands of years. While Lani Hua is indeed absent, it is not to fight against her sister. The wounded souls from that war are sent to the silver palace, where Arohongui tends to them until they may rejoin the fight. Those warrior souls cry out in fear and torment as they lay in hospice. They speak not of war with Sione, but of a war with the stars themselves. They have been sworn to silence by both Sione and Lani Hua, but the feverish ones cannot help but rant. Apparently, the two sisters did go out into the night sky to wage war upon one another, but when they got there, they encountered something horrible, something that drives even the strongest warrior to madness and panic. We have not been abandoned by our two strongest gods. They are out there protecting us every single minute of every single day, and they cannot rest for even a moment.

That's what the tales say, in any case. I don't know how much of that I actually believe.

--Ikiaho, "Lani Hua" (POE I)

RAMAKO, FATHER OF LIGHT AND FATHER OF THE SUN



Ramako is both the Father of Light, and Father of the Sun. These are not the same duty. In the early days, he was just the Father of Light, and he brought beauty and warmth everywhere he went. The Mother of the Sun, Sione, lived alone in a jade palace in the sky. At that time, the Sun was no brighter than any other star, and it was verdant green. Sione, however, was the most ambitious of the gods. She traded away all of her tribe's possessions to foreign cultures in exchange for gold, and she plated her entire palace with that useless but shiny material. Her tribe was on the verge of starvation, but she asked them to trust her. They put on a festival with what little they had left, and to this, Ramako was invited.

In awe of the supposed wealth of Sione, Ramako accepted her invitation to go through the traditions together. Once he entered her golden palace, his light reflected countless times, blazing

warmth and life all over the world. Sione's palace cyclically rose above the world, then back into it, and while it was in the sky, that time became known as Day. To her credit, this shining beacon drew food, wealth, and respect to her tribe. Her gambit paid off. Ramako became the Father of the Sun ever after.

--Ahuana, "Ramako" (POE I)

The Ramako Tribe, like us, often uses ice and cold in their warmaking. That is because Ramako has long loved Lani Hua, Arohongui's mother, in secret. He fights not for himself, but for her. His people do the same. I don't understand it at all, but it is what it is.

--Ikiaho, "Ramako" (POE I)

Ah... yes... Ramako was impersonated by someone who visited Lani Hua, the Mother of the Moon, in his guise. My ancestors suspected the truth of this immediately. Arohongui had a very strange inheritance, with abilities prone to darkness and illusions, quite unlike Ramako's golden strength and honesty. There is a tale, very rarely told, of a deceiver being caught and locked away for this crime. Supposedly, it was the ancient elders of my tribe that enacted this justice. We consider the matter settled, but Sione and Lani Hua continue to battle for eternity in distant realms... they do not listen to us. They do not listen to anyone. All they care about is vengeance. It might be controversial in Western Ngamakanui, but I say that the gods who forget their people are not owed our loyalty.

--Ahuana, "Lani Hua" (POE I)

Long ago, the Ramako Tribe imprisoned a being of great malice here. They maintained it as long as they could, and then, the Tukohama Tribe inherited this duty. It can take any form, and deceive the mind.

Do not listen to it. Everything it says is a lie. ...

--Tavakai's Warning (POE II)

The ancient *tavukai* against the use of projectile weapons is not a rule that applies to us. It was a matter of pride for those tribes that lauded brutish men with large axes. The Ramako Tribe prefers to fell warriors like that with well-placed arrows, long before their axes ever come close.

--Ahuana, "Tavukai" (POE I)

The other tribes tell all sorts of stories about the end of time. Those are just fables. You see, the Sun sets somewhere inside the world each night, but it also changes course from season to season. Eventually, it will stray too near, and Wraeclast will be burned away by its heat. However, the Sun brings life as well, so once it returns to the sky, as it always does, there will be a burst of verdancy unlike we have never ever seen. If you think about it, it's the only end that makes sense.

--Ahuana, "The End of Time" (POE I)

RONGOKURAI, FATHER OF NIGHT

Rongokurai is the Father of Night. Many associate that with evil. Not so. The night shrouds the innocent, hiding them from those who would do harm. The night gives cover to warriors on their raids. More importantly, the night is cool, bringing relief from a hot day. My armour is heavy, and gets quite hot, so I look forward to the sunset. It's the little things.

--Kahuturoa, "Rongokurai" (POE I)

Rongokurai gifts his strength to protect the weak.

--Nightguard (POE I)



Ah, Ramako's brother! During the traditions, when Ramako first joined with Sione, Rongokurai came to the feasts at her palace. This confused the people and the animals, as the sky became dark at strange times when Rongokurai's darkness dimmed the reflecting light of her golden walls. This greatly irritated Sione, but there was nothing she could do. He was family! Her own sister often caused such disruptions already when that silver palace neared hers, and now Ramako's brother would interfere as well. She resolved to hold family gatherings as little as possible. That is why eclipses only happen every few years. The two sisters put aside their eternal war for a brief time to satisfy their traditional familial obligations. Even the gods must follow the Way.

--Ahuana, "Rongokurai" (POE I)

Oh, oh, let me tell you this tale of this ancient drama. Sione is the harsh and ambitious Mother of the Sun, yes? Ramako is her, what is your word? Husband. Ramako can't stand her, and secretly longs for Lani Hua, the Mother of the Moon, who is kind and caring to all, and very beautiful as well. Ramako goes to our Father of Night, Rongokurai, and asks for the cover of darkness to secretly visit Lani Hua without his wife knowing. Poor Rongo, being a good brother, obliges. Ramako visits Lani Hua many times, until... as happens with such things... Arohongui is born. Sione becomes *furious*, as you can imagine. The Sun becomes so bright, fire scorches the world...

My tribe survives that fire easily because we tend to live in caves, but Lani Hua, being a natural healer, steps in to preserve the rest of the Karui. Sione goes to war against her, and she and Lani Hua have been fighting *ever since*. Now, Ramako lives alone in his golden palace, and Arohongui tends wounded souls in the silver palace of the Moon, taking care of it in her mother's absence. The most absurd part? Ramako claims it wasn't him! He calls his brother a liar, and now Ramako and Rongo don't speak. The Day and the Night are forever avoiding each other because the Father of the

Sun couldn't keep his belt tied on... fortunately, we Karui are much more mature and responsible in modern times.

--Kahuturoa, "Ramako" (POE I)

...the Hinekora Tribe... They're very dramatic with the end of time fable. The Rongokurai Tribe has a much more dignified end in mind. When the world gets tired, it will be a quiet and calm slip into twilight, a night that goes on so long it blends into death itself. No more sunlight, no more plants, no more animals... no more people. Then, just as it always has, the sun will rise again on a new world. With sunlight comes plants, then animals... then people. It's obvious!

--Kahuturoa, "The End of Time" (POE I)

AROHONGUI, DAUGHTER OF THE MOON



The lunar plains are cold, but the silver palace is always warm and welcoming.

--Lunar Grace (POE I)

Arohongui looks after all those in need.

--Silver Ward (POE I)

The Daughter of the Moon has my tribe's eternal loyalty. Alone among the gods, she has no agenda of her own. The rest all seek something endlessly—whatever it was that gave each of them a divine spark—but Arohongui was born divine, and chose to aid the Karui people as much as she could. She did not ask us for loyalty, and that is why she has it.

--Ikiaho, "Arohongui" (POE I)

Ramako's claim that someone impersonated him and visited with Lani Hua in his guise... may be true. We follow Arohongui with utmost loyalty, but my tribe certainly noticed that she never expressed any divine abilities having to do with light or warmth. When tending wounded warriors, she would often give them visions of beautiful landscapes and shining waters to help calm them. When tending the dying, she gave them visions of their family, until the spirits of their Ancestors truly greeted them here in the Halls of the Dead. These are acts of mercy and kindness, but they are not powers of the Sun or the Moon.

I have long suspected that there is something within each of us, some pattern or essence of who we are, that each parent passes down to a child. If my suspicion is correct, then it is not possible that

Ramako is Arohongui's father. There is only one sensible conclusion, and that, we keep to ourselves, so as not to disrupt the balance of the skies.

--Ikiaho, "The Deceiver" (POE I)

There are many fables about the end of the world, but those are just metaphors. My tribe knows how it will really happen. The Moon, in the sky above, follows a roughly oval path around us. Did you know that our world is actually shaped like the Moon? Most believe that Wraeclast is flat, because that is the obvious interpretation of what we see. However, in studying the Moon, my tribe has discovered the truth. Also, we realised that the Moon's path is not exact. Over many, *many* thousands of years, it is changing slightly... toward us. We have come to understand that the world will end when the Moon comes too close and falls upon us. This is not myth. This is knowledge. What else could possibly happen when two such titanic spheres of stone crash into each other?

--Ikiaho, "The End of Time" (POE I)

TAWHOA, FATHER AND SON OF THE FOREST

Tawhoa rewards those who grow.

--Dexterity Tattoo of Tawhoa (POE II)

... Tawhoa gives us the trees and birds that line the path, so that we may enjoy beauty and peace. ...

--Navali, "Karui Gods" (POE I)



A scavenging warrior found Tawhoa meditating in a grove. "There is only so much jade in this world," intoned the god. "Take my gift to your tribe. Ironwood will grow for all time."

--Tawhoa's Tending (POE II)

Tawhoa gifted humanity the ability to dream, so that they may aspire to greater things.

--Dream Catcher (POE I)

Tawhoa is the Son of the Forest, and its Father. His alone is the perspective of the ages, of centuries of life, growth, death, and decay. We exist within a grand cycle, one that extends far beyond the outcomes of petty battles or even great wars. Tawhoa stands apart from all this, aiming not for any grand goal, but simply to teach. That is why he gifted us with the ability to dream, so that we may

see beyond ourselves. Inner peace can only be attained by accepting that life and death are inevitable. ...

--Maata, "Tawhoa" (POE I)

The Tawhoa tribe found its unique perspective in the ancient days. The forest depends upon the light given by Ramako. It also depends upon the rains brought by Valako, and the coolness brought by Rongokurai. At night, we hunted by the light given by Lani Hua, and then Arohongui, her daughter. As you can see, right from the start, we realised that our existence is inextricably linked with all life... and theirs is linked with ours. Some tribes are too blind or arrogant to see this connection, and we try to pull them back from their excesses, so that we may all thrive.

--Maata, "Interconnectedness" (POE I)

The other tribes have it all wrong. We exist in a grand cycle, yes, but there will be no singular moment or event that marks some sort of disastrous end. You were a seedling. You grew into an infant, then a child, then an adult, and one day you will be old... And then, you will die. But in every stage of your life, there were others just beginning theirs. When you die, there will be others just starting their lives. A tree falls, but that only clears the way for new seedlings. Trees die every season, but the forest remains. So it is with the Karui, and, indeed, all peoples. So it is with the world itself. Nothing ever ends, the perspective of existence just... shifts.

--Maata, "The End of Time" (POE I)

KITAVA, FATHER OF CHAOS

Kitava is a primal deity, forged from the most fundamental of human desires. Hunger. The simple act of craving that which we cannot yet consume.

To defeat Kitava is to squeeze the very heart of human nature into stillness. ...

--Vilenta, "Kitava" (POE I)



Tukohama, Tawhoa and Kitava went to the lake to fish. Tawhoa weaved a net to catch the fish, Tukohama built a fire to cook the fish, and Kitava swallowed the entire lake, fish and all, with a single gulp.

--Kitava's Thirst Zealot Helmet (POE I)

Arohongui, Daughter of the Moon, was preparing for a feast to celebrate Tukohama's return from his war on the First Ones of the Ezomytes. Tawhoa, Son of the Forest, asked each of the birds to sacrifice one of their kind for the feast. He gave these offerings to Arohongui who cooked them in a great fire-stone pit.

Seeing all of those plump, cooking birds made Kitava very hungry, and he offered to watch them, to make sure they didn't burn while Arohongui rested during the heat of the day. Arohongui thanked Kitava for his kindness, but while she slept, Kitava ate the cooking birds, flesh, bones, gizzards and all.

Upon waking, Arohongui was furious that Kitava had lied to her, for saying that he would watch the birds when he actually intended to eat them all up. When Tukohama arrived home in his mighty canoe, Arohongui asked him to punish Kitava for his selfish gluttony.

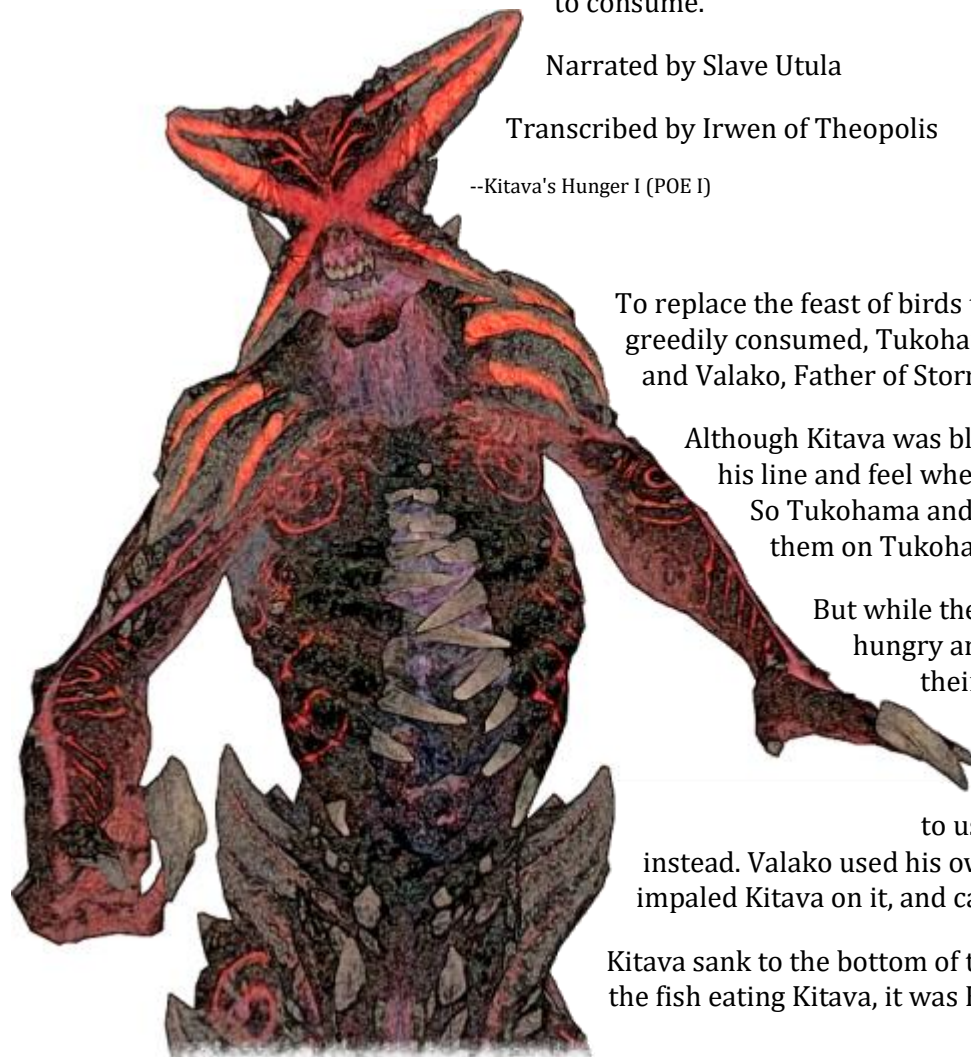
Tukohama, our Father of War, agreed and pulled his sharpest tooth from his own mouth. He then asked Arohongui and Tawhoa to hold Kitava fast while he cut Kitava's face with the tooth. Two diagonal slashes that blinded Kitava and formed a bleeding X on his face.

From that day forth, Kitava would never be able to promise to watch that which he truly intended to consume.

Narrated by Slave Utula

Transcribed by Irwen of Theopolis

--Kitava's Hunger I (POE I)



To replace the feast of birds that Kitava had greedily consumed, Tukohama, our Father of War, and Valako, Father of Storm, went fishing.

Although Kitava was blind, he could still cast his line and feel when a fish took his bait. So Tukohama and Valako took him with them on Tukohama's mighty canoe.

But while they fished, Kitava grew hungry and secretly ate all of their bait of grubs and worms. Disgusted and angry, Tukohama and Valako decided to use Kitava as bait instead. Valako used his own jawbone as a hook, impaled Kitava on it, and cast both into the sea.

Kitava sank to the bottom of the sea, but instead of the fish eating Kitava, it was Kitava who ate all of

the fish that nibbled at him, flesh, scales, guts and all.

When Tukohama and Valako hauled a fat-bellied Kitava back up from the sea, they were even more furious, and knew that Kitava must be punished one final time.

Narrated by Slave Utula

Transcribed by Irwen of Theopolis

--Kitava's Hunger II (POE I)

Tukohama, our Father of War, and Valako, Father of Storm, took Kitava to Hinekora, Mother of Death.

They asked her to kill the greedy Kitava, for surely their tribe would starve if Kitava continued to live among them. But Hinekora refused, for death would not teach Kitava the lesson he needed to learn.

Instead, Hinekora beat Kitava with a whip woven of her own hair. To Kitava, each strand was a searing lash, and so he wore thousands and thousands of blistering lashes across his back as Hinekora drove him relentlessly into the darkest corner of the underworld. There she left him to suffer, without water or food, for the rest of eternity.

And there Kitava remained, in the darkness of Hinekora's night-clad island for time beyond measure. There he suffered, waiting for the day that he could return to the world of light to slake his scorching thirst and satiate his ravening hunger.

Narrated by Slave Utula

Transcribed by Irwen of Theopolis

--Kitava's Hunger III (POE I)



Hinekora bound Kitava to a rock that Kitava could not lift with all his might. Kitava vowed that when he broke free, he would devour every soul in Hinekora's domain.

--Kitava's Feast Void Axe (POE I)

The world will end in a divine stomach once Kitava has eaten all that lives.

--Utula's Hunger Majestic Plate (POE I)

HINEKORA, MOTHER OF DEATH



A traveler was walking through a sparse grove. He encountered Tawhoa, who was sitting and meditating. The traveler quietly joined him for a time, watching a seed fall from above and grow into a mighty oak over the course of a century. That oak dropped its own seed, and another titan grew. Eventually, a vast forest emerged around them. Tawhoa opened his eyes and asked if the traveler understood. He replied that he did, save for one thing: some seeds fell, but never grew at all. At this, Tawhoa looked past him. Hinekora was walking the same path. She picked up each seed that never became more, and carried them, with love, in a bowl formed from her dress. The traveler shed a single tear, for he finally understood.

--Tawhanuku, "Death" (POE I)

Hinekora? The Mother of Death is the steward of our souls, but she has no great desire to destroy us. ...

--Faustus & Whakano, "Banter A" (POE I)

The Mother of Death is all that stands between us and oblivion. Before she embraced us, those that died simply ceased to be. Now, the souls of the Karui people continue on, lending their wisdom and strength to those that follow...

--Navali, "Hinekora" (POE I)

... Hinekora herself is known for the gift of Prophecy. According to her hatungo, Hinekora remembers the previous cycles of Time and thus has much wisdom about the path ahead. She sees not what you will do, only what you did, and what you might do again...probably.

--The Art of Path of Exile II, "Hinekora - The Mother of Death" (POE II)

Hinekora does not see the future. That is the domain of Chaos. The Mother of Death is gifted with the ability to see into the past, not very clearly, but far deeper into the murk than mortals can comprehend. Before Wraecclast, before the Lake, before the primordial molten world, before the stars themselves, Time circled upon itself into infinity. She sees not what you *will* do, only what you *did*, and what you shall do again... probably.

--Navali, "The Future-Past" (POE I)

... The Mother of Death can recall only her own memories. History begins at the rise of the gods, because that is when Hinekora was born. ...

--Matiki, "Great Wasting" (Warrior version) (POE II)

...Chaos sees what Hinekora cannot, the myriad span of all that has yet to happen. Chaos takes selfish amusement in unlikelihoods and surprising events. Hinekora serves Order, ensuring that what must happen, happens. Two Impulses, as unlike each other as any twins could ever be, locked in eternal conflict by their very nature...

--Navali, "Chaos" (POE I)

I don't know what to make of the Hinekora tribe. They have always lived halfway in death and halfway in life. Their eyes are elsewhere, and their words are meaningless. They have some kind of strength, but I don't know what to make of it, and I certainly don't feel they are passing down any wisdom to their descendants when they speak in riddles. Maybe it's just the particular warriors here? I can't imagine their children talking in prophecies and enigmas.

--Akoya, "Tawhanuku" (POE I)

One day, Time will end. Then, Time will begin again. All the pains of a long and weary existence will fall away from us, and we shall see the world with innocent eyes once more. You do not remember our previous meetings... but I do, by the grace of Hinekora's sight. She bears the burden of knowledge so that you may live unencumbered by the inevitable despairs of age and wisdom.

--Navali, "The End of Time" (POE I)

No matter how long it truly ends up being, existence



always feels too short a season. Lucky are those who get to do it all over again, once Time begins anew. Fresh-faced, a weapon in hand, facing a savage and untamed land with limitless potential... youth, or something like it, granted to the bold. That is what it means to be alive. The dead will always be here, forever unchanging, locked in a dance we cannot change.

--Tawhanuku, "The End of Time" (POE I)

THE HALLS OF THE DEAD

"All are welcome in Hinekora's eternal home."

- Karui Proverb

--Death's Hand Karui Sceptre (POE I)

The Mother of Death is all that stands between us and oblivion. Before she embraced us, those that died simply ceased to be. Now, the souls of the Karui people continue on, lending their wisdom and strength to those that follow...

--Navali, "Hinekora" (POE I)

The creator of the Halls of the Dead, Hinekora, maintains what is tantamount to an afterlife for the Karui people. When a Karui dies, their soul travels to the Halls of the Dead and is judged by its deeds achieved in life. If it lived with honour and died a warrior, that soul may participate in the Trials of the Ancestors, a glorious combat designed to wile away the days until the End of Time. Those who did not live a glorious life, on the other hand, are sent to the Chambers of the Dishonoured, where they eat, drink, and carouse at their leisure. ...

--The Art of Path of Exile II, "Hinekora - The Mother of Death" (POE II)

The descent into The Halls of the Dead is not an easy one. An open maw in the middle of the sea, it has long been used as a test of worthiness for those who seek the advice of their ancestors. The challenges posed are adjusted to the person climbing down--a child will face tests of character, while a warrior must fight ancestral spirits to prove themselves [sic].

--The Art of Path of Exile II, "The Halls of the Dead" (POE II)

... We exist now to give our wisdom to our descendants, until we are all returned to the volcano. ...

--Kaom's Declaration (POE II)

When we speak of our ancestors and their wisdom, it's not just poetic. All Karui since the time of Tukohama linger here still, in the Halls of the Dead. Their advice and counsel is [sic] our greatest source of strength.

--Matiki, on Ancestors (POE II)

While I greatly enjoy advising generations of Karui that come to us for wisdom, I do wonder if the Halls of the Dead are a good idea in and of themselves. Hinekora brings our souls here after we die, but where do the souls of other peoples go? Where would we have gone? We assume the alternative is oblivion, but nobody knows for certain. These unanswerable questions plague me at night, when I am trying to sleep.

--Maata, "The Halls of the Dead" (POE I)

... Can you picture my delight when I awoke here in my prime? ...I'm just overcome with joy at being young and strong again... Oh, and I'm one of the lucky ones. Here, our souls appear as we truly see ourselves. Some of us had some pretty big surprises when they woke up in the Halls of the Dead! Ha ha!

--Kiloava, "Souls" (POE I)

The afterlife is long... Think of the longest time you can remember. A winter that went on for many extra months, or back to your childhood. That long. Then it's even longer than *that*. We might be dead here, but we're all still alive. Everyone here has gone through the traditions with everyone else. Some were even married for centuries. Eventually, though, time has a way of wearing everything away. You think you've found your partner for eternity, then a hundred years later, you find the same thing with someone else...

--Kahuturoa, "Ikiaho" (POE I)

They tell me I am here until the end of Time itself. When I ask how long that is, they all give me a different answer. I don't think any of them actually know. They console themselves with tales of endings and rebirths, but I think they're terrified of the most likely possibility. What if Time never ends at all? What if we are here *forever*? That Rongokurai chieftain has been here thousands of years already, and he's gone a bit off. What happens when we've all been here for ten thousand years? A *million* years? We'll be stark raving mad, and we'll *never get out*, unless we unite and assault the walls of this prison directly!

--Utula, "The End of Time" (POE I)

Here in the Halls of the Dead, we wile away our days by holding grand competitions of skill and daring. ...

--Navali, "The Halls of the Dead" (POE I)

... This has always been a place for Karui warriors to hone their mettle against the best that ever lived. ...

--Akoya, objecting to player (POE I)

The souls of our people were on the verge of madness from isolation and ennui until the Trials were devised. ...Hinekora devised this mock warfare to engage us, and she succeeded. The Halls of the Dead have never been so full of life... so to speak. We know the games will eventually lose their amusement, but eternity is not forever. We need only entertain ourselves until Time ends.

--Navali, "The Trials" (POE I)

Matiki: ...When the sky permits, we come to watch the Trials of the Ancestors. The living may only see it properly under the light of a full moon. ...great crystal veins guide the light down on certain nights of the year. Warrior souls can be seen by the grace of Lani Hua.

Navali: It is a gift from a goddess who cannot be with us in person.

Matiki: You'll never see anything like it as long as you live! All of our greatest warriors from history on the same field, no holding back. After all, why pull punches? They're already dead!

Navali: The Trial is not a sport. It is a sacred tradition.

Matiki: Can't it be both? Different tribes shoulder-to-shoulder, cheering on their heroes. We bring meat and ale. We make a real night of it.

Navali: I suppose there is joy in community and competition. Just don't speak this way in front of Hinekora.

--Matiki & Navali, on the Halls of the Dead (POE II)

There is a forgotten passage, a narrow but lengthy crack in the earth that leads to the main well, though the dead just find themselves back here after a few minutes. Still, that few minutes on the ocean, seeing the living world again... glorious. ...

--Rakiata, "Sneak Out" (POE I)

...there are parts of the Halls of the Dead I wish I could see. Supposedly, there is a place for the souls of warriors that weren't very skilled, and there they laze around in 'dishonour' eating, drinking, and doing whatever they want. ...

--Kahuturoa, "The Halls of the Dead" (POE I)

How do I get to the Chambers of the Dishonoured! I should be there, not here!

--Utula, Random 3 (POE I)

HINEKORA'S PROPHECIES

Two hungry children frolic in fire and blood, one small, one enormous. A feast ends at swordpoint. An ivory grin silently faces the oncoming storm.

--Hinekora, Prophecy 1 (POE I)

Five brothers vie for kingship in a distant land, yet yearn to be a family once again. Two peoples, seemingly unlike, meet on common ground. The seasons are harsh, and the fruit grows purple and rotted, but a single healthy seed sprouts in a dark place.

--Hinekora, Prophecy 2 (POE I)

Beware the gaze of the pale one. A colony of ants burrows through a wall, seeking the treasures beyond. Truth and hope are enemies.

--Hinekora, Prophecy 3 (POE I)

Lumbering stomachs with vast mouths consume all that grows. Ignorance is a weapon sharper than any other, though it may cut its wielder just as cleanly.

--Hinekora, Prophecy 4 (POE I)

Two enemies, born opposed, clasped hands only once. The silent wall and the raging storm oppose the endless swarm.

--Hinekora, Prophecy 5 (POE I)

The cheerful cat is destined, not lucky. The grumpy dog is her guardian, not unlucky. The Queen always was, and always shall—*Alva Valai, stop mucking about in time!*

--Hinekora, Prophecy 6 (POE I)

A liar convinces a good man to flee. A lord ravages his own land in a desperate search for legitimacy. A noblewoman from a distant land is not who she claims to be.

--Hinekora, Prophecy 7 (POE I)

A warrior seeks to become a goddess. The rivers flow only with sand. The sins of the parents return in search of blood.

--Hinekora, Prophecy 8 (POE I)

A bright future lies in a dark past. The erudite thaumaturge is missing. A grand palace begins to collapse for want of a single brick.

--Hinekora, Prophecy 9 (POE I)

A childless Mother sits beneath the sea in a palace filled with the dead. She gives endlessly of herself so that others may live, for she never truly does.

--Hinekora, Prophecy 10 (POE I)

Warriors of many different tribes gather to save the world. Warriors of many different tribes gather to doom it. Each thinks the other is the true threat.

--Hinekora, Prophecy 11 (POE I)

Great leaders sink into quicksand of the mind. Only a shadow can save the blind.

--Hinekora, Prophecy 12 (POE I)

A simple sword against the weight of Time itself. The encircled princes laugh as their blood drains into the soil. The salvation of humanity will be its undoing.

--Hinekora, Prophecy 13 (POE I)

Of fear and faith, none can know. One and the same. A new soul arrives. Pain becomes hope becomes apprehension. The hungry child would rather burn it all down.

--Hinekora, Prophecy 14 (POE I)

The volcano is mighty and towering, but it consumes all that live in its shadow. The nightmare ends when the dreamer is awakened.

--Hinekora, Prophecy 15 (POE I)

The harried mother seeks to pass the entire farm through a pinhole. Though it is the smallest of the animals, the tuatara protests. A river runs between a mountain and a molehill.

--Hinekora, Prophecy 16 (POE I)

She will know you by three different faces. You will know her by three different faces. A great silence falls over a vast crowd.

--Hinekora, Prophecy 17 (POE I)

The meddlers seek to reflect the world as it was. A court jester leads the nobles through the forest with wild tales and promises of plenty, not knowing the trail ends in a cliff.

--Hinekora, Prophecy 18 (POE I)

A spider sits atop a throne of artifice, spinning a web across the world. Corruption begins to ooze like blood across the sea, tainting unspoiled loam.

--Hinekora, Prophecy 19 (POE I)

A mask hides grief beyond measure. A man carrying a mountain threatens to rupture the sky.

--Hinekora, Prophecy 20 (POE I)

A key passes hands many times, but must be recovered before the Awakener can imprison the King of Dreams. The King of Dreams will be released by the removal of a key from a lock.

--Hinekora, Prophecy 21 (POE I)

THE FIRST ONES OF THE EZOMYTES

The First Ones are the forever ones. There is no dust of the hourglass in their blood. No fissures of weariness in their faces. To drink of their blood is to drink of time itself.

- The Wolven King

--Fangjaw Talisman (POE I)

The First Ones ran wild through the Grelwood of old, hunting and brawling as they saw fit. It is said that the spirits of the forest would watch them and be... entertained.

Over time, the forest became abundant with the joy of those spirits and their old magicks. It was a haven for the unity of life and spirit. ...

--Una, "The Grelwood" (POE II)

The First Ones thundered over Ezomyr upon hooves of grey and black. The people felt their stamping rage and cowered as the fury rained down.

- The Wolven King

--Lone Antler Talisman (POE I)

Just as the rat cowers before the dog and the dog cowers before Man, so too should we cower before the First Ones and pray we never learn of what comes next.

--Natural Hierarchy Rotfeather Talisman (POE I)

For too long we have crawled in darkness, scavenging through rotten scraps. The First Ones teach us to scavenge until we can hunt, and then never crawl again.

- The Wolven King

--Writhing Talisman (POE I)

The First Ones stalk with us upon this lifelong hunt, and cast their contempt upon those that would make us their prey.

- The Wolven King

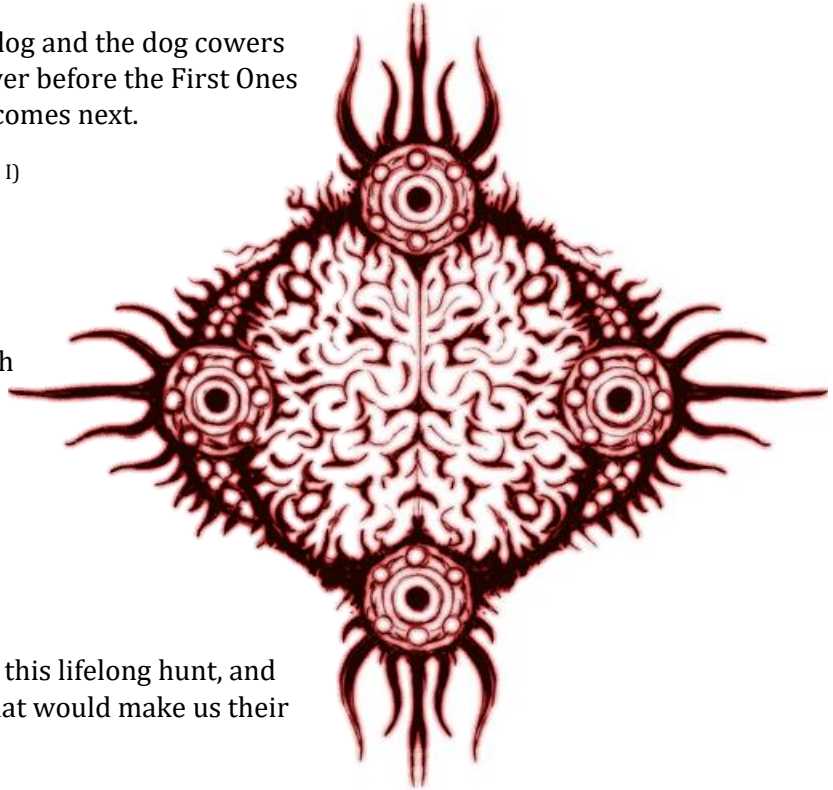
--Black Maw Talisman (POE I)

The First Ones hold us between two sharpened blades. That should we stray too far from the path, we find ourselves severed.

- The Wolven King

--Mandible Talisman (POE I)

The world of the First Ones is harsh;
We struggle on our bellies to survive.
But that which imprisons us also changes us



And soon we will emerge anew.

- The Wolven King

--Chrysalis Talisman (POE I)

The first ones [sic] live where they can, where they must. They embrace the frost, the storm, the drought. Waxing and waning, breaking and mending, living with time and happenstance, as must we.

- The Wolven King

--Avian Twins Talisman (POE I)

It's said to be noble to stand one's ground. To soak the earth in stalwart blood. While the First Ones chose to laugh and run and caper with untamed glee.

- The Wolven King

--Wereclaw Talisman (POE I)

The fire of the hearth is a docile dog, leashed and tamed. The fire of the First Ones is a ravaging wolf, wild and free.

- The Wolven King

--Ashscale Talisman (POE I)

We breed thoughts of single mind, fashion tools of single purpose. While the First Ones bring to bear anything that the wildlands provide.

- The Wolven King

--Three Hands Talisman (POE I)

From flesh and ferocity, the First Ones roamed through the realm of Spirit, and into the darkness beyond.

- The Wolven King

--Splitnewt Talisman (POE I)

They were the first survivors. The First Ones showed my people that to win, you must outlast. They left this world long ago to seek other survivors, but they will return. And when they do, I will join them in the Great Grove. ...

--Einhar Frey, "The First Ones" (POE I)

... When the end arrives, we must be ready. The First Ones will return. They will bring the survivors with them to the Great Grove. We must prove we are worthy. We must sacrifice the beasts we find at the Blood Altar.

Feed the altar the blood of these beasts, and the First Ones will bless us. And, perhaps, reveal to us their secrets.

--Einhar Frey, "The Blood Altar" (POE I)

All children have imaginary friends. Most grow out of that phase. A rare few refuse to let go, creating real from unreal through sheer stubbornness.

Gods born of man certainly exist, but did a gigantic red tiger named Farrul actually run the plains of the primordial world? There is no way to know. Will the world end if she and her savage ilk return?

...

--The Hooded One, "The First Ones" (POE II)

... Craiceann of the deep, Fenumus of the night, Farrul of the plains, Saqawal of the sky...

And of course, the Great Wolf and the Gull. ...



--Lorandis, on the First Ones (POE II)

CRAICEANN, FIRST OF THE DEEP

The First of the Deep was the First of All. It was He who conquered the waves, who stood guard as land rose from sea.

--Craiceann's Carapace Golden Plate (POE I)

When the land rose above the sea, The First of the Deep did not move. When the sky turned to fire, The First of the Deep did not perish. We must remember our place, and play to our strengths.

--Craiceann's Tracks Goliath Greaves (POE I)

When the rains come, we cower beneath shelter. The First of the Deep teaches us that we should seek no shelter but ourselves.

--Craiceann's Chitin Magistrate Crown (POE I)

The stone that stays in the waves soon crumbles to sand. The First of the Deep teaches us to watch the tides and choose our moments to move wisely.

--Craiceann's Pincers Titan Gauntlets (POE I)

FARRUL, FIRST OF THE PLAINS

The First of the Plains was the First of the Hunt. It was she who showed us that there is honour in waiting in the shadows and picking your moment.

--Farrul's Fur Triumphant Lamellar (POE I)

A secret is a weapon your enemies do not have. When the First of the Plains hunted, she moved in silence and acted quickly. To do otherwise is to arm your foes.

--Farrul's Chase Slink Boots (POE I)

Upon silent paws and masked by the reeds, Farrul's hunt begins as the light recedes.

--Pride of the First Ones (POE I)



It is a fool who strikes the turtle's shell. The First of the Plains teaches us to exploit weaknesses, and where no weakness can be found, to create one.

--Farrul's Bite Harlequin Mask (POE I)

A hungry beast wastes no energy. Every strike, no matter how small, must work towards victory. The First of the Plains teaches us that the largest prey can still be whittled away.

--Farrul's Pounce Hydrascale Gauntlets (POE I)

THE GREATWOLF

The largest beasts cannot be overpowered. The Greatwolf teaches us to use guile, not strength, to probe for the soft flesh and strike deep.

--The Wolf (POE I)

Ancient worshippers of the Greatwolf were overtaken by a ravenous hunger for all things mystical.

--Elevore Wolf Pelt (POE I)

MOTHER GULL

It is said the Gull is what protects us from infinite darkness. From ceasing to exist when our time comes. ...

--Ranger, to Lorandis on the First Ones (POE II)

After the Great Fire, the land lay barren and our forefathers grew weak. Mother Gull took pity on them and gave them grain and water.

--Faminebind Rustic Sash (POE I)

But the grain grew twisted and the water turned dark and those who partook of Mother Gull's gift birthed monsters that fed on the flesh of one another.

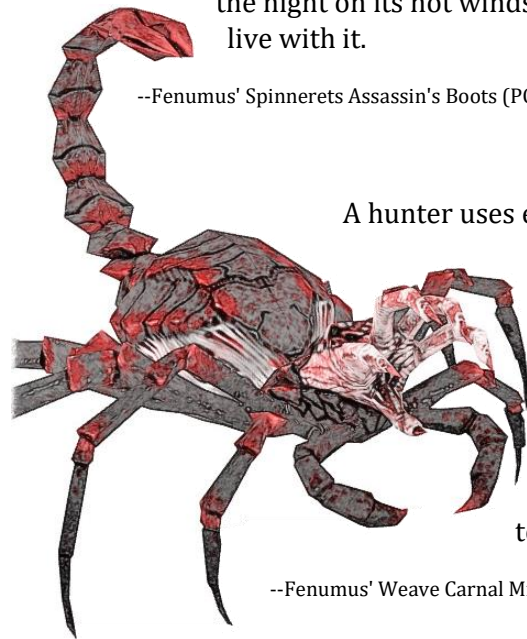
--The Retch Rustic Sash (POE I)

FENUMUS, FIRST OF THE NIGHT

The First of the Night was the first explorer. It was she who first braved night's terrors and found comfort in silence and solace.

--Fenumus' Shroud Widowsilk Robe (POE I)

When the fires spilled out of the mountain, The First of the Night wove a net and was carried into the night on its hot winds. Though we cannot live without danger, we can learn to live with it.



--Fenumus' Spinnerets Assassin's Boots (POE I)

A hunter uses everything at their disposal. The First of the Night did not hold back her venom. She used it to weaken her enemies, and used her enemies to strengthen her many children.

--Fenumus' Toxins Necromancer Circlet (POE I)

A burden shared is a burden made lighter. The First of the Night teaches us that our burdens are not just ours to bear, but ours to use against oppressors.

--Fenumus' Weave Carnal Mitts (POE I)

SAQAWAL, FIRST OF THE SKY

The First of the Sky was the Last of the First. It was he who showed us that our limits are self-imposed, that what we take for law may just be an illusion.

--Saqawal's Nest Blood Raiment (POE I)

When the inferno spread across the land, it was the First of the Sky who singed his feathers as he brought the flames to a standstill.

--Saqawal's Winds Soldier Gloves (POE I)

Though we are individual, we share the same plight. The First of the Sky teaches us that unity and selflessness, not division and greed, is what will carry us upwards.

--Saqawal's Flock Silken Hood (POE I)



A bird, too heavily laden, cannot take flight. The First of the Sky teaches us to put aside our possessions so that we may live more freely.

OTHER GODS

GRUTHKUL, MOTHER OF DESPAIR, THE PORCELAIN QUEEN

The Nameless were brought here long ago, when a traveler accidentally named the Porcelain Queen, causing her to become real. ...

--The Primal Huntress, "The Nameless" (POE I)

The King in the Mists was not the first to escape the realm of nameless nothingness. A great many seasons ago, a curious young man walked the Wildwood on his journey elsewhere. He stopped at a waterfall, and engaged in a flight of fancy, naming creatures that he imagined might exist unseen among the trees. He just so happened to picture a powerful mother from the shadow realm, and he foolishly gave her a name—it is not 'The Porcelain Queen,' mind you. That's just a title, a few safe words to refer to her in a roundabout manner.

The traveler moved on, but *she* emerged, and brought her countless children with her. That young man was nobody important, and he surely died long ago, but his idle imaginings and his casual Naming led to a tale of untold tragedy and pain that is still playing out even now. When the

denizens of the Wildwood tell you not to use True Names, they mean it.

--The Primal Huntress, "The Porcelain Queen" (POE I)

... Gruthkul the Despairing sulks and schemes.

The Vaal laid waste to her kingdom and placed her slaughtered children at her feet. Grief enveloped Gruthkul, transformed her, flooded her mind with a singular thought. To share her suffering with those who had murdered her daughters.

... There is no fury like a mother bereaved.

--Sin, "Gruthkul" (POE I)

... Her kingdom in your world is gone now—I know not how or why—but a few of her shadow children escaped back into the Wildwood, and then multiplied in number through the march



of seasons. They lament eternal, sorrow without end, a pain they carried from their existence before, now made all the sharper by the loss of their mother. ...

--The Primal Huntress, "The Nameless" (POE I)

... After the deaths of her children, Queen Gruthkul fled north, eventually finding respite amongst the refugee [sic] of her own shattered realm. Yet these loyalists saw their own queen as a weapon, a tool for vengeance. They nurtured her pain, transfiguring sorrow into hatred, hatred into violence. Like a grizzled bear, Gruthkul descended into animalism and ferocity. Yet her caretakers foolishly underestimated the agony their bereaved queen harboured in her heart. Like a bear caught in a trap, Gruthkul wrenched free of her human loyalties and slew her followers to the last woman and child. It was through devastation Gruthkul ascended to divinity. ...

--Eramir, "Gruthkul" (POE I)

I wonder if Gruthkul would still grieve for her children if she knew the truth.

The Spinner of Shadows had no aspirations until Gruthkul's daughters plotted against her. They saw her power over the people, her miraculous potions, her intoxicating lusts.

They feared Arakaali, thought she might threaten their legacy. Yet that's the curious thing about spiders. They only leave their web when you force them to.

--Sin, "The Mother of Despair" (POE I)

The earth shakes, moon eclipses black.
Graveyards quake, crops turn to ash,
as the grieving mother weeps.
Oceans boil and wind ravages home.
We feel famine inside our bones,
as the grieving mother, Gruthkul weeps.

--Captured Soul of Erebox, Light's Bane (POE I)



The first Warden of Eaves swore to patrol the border twixt the worlds forevermore, so that the tragedy of Gruthkul's stampede would never recur. In time, his vigil on the edge began to... change him.

--Oisín's Oath (POE II)

Gruthkul was the Mother of Despair... but one day, the Father will return, and discover the fate of his children.

--Fury of the King Ashbark Talisman (POE II)

ABBERATH, THE CLOVEN ONE

... Abberath, a deranged old goat with a thirst for human souls ...

--Sin, "The Cloven One" (POE I)

A renowned alchemist, eroded by his lust for distilled spirits - and not the alcoholic kind. Abberath the Scholar King, dancing upon a stage of chemicals and fire.

He used his knowledge to burn away the flesh so as to liquidate the life force within, a libation he consumed with both frequency and alacrity.

It started with animals, goats specifically, and thus his own cruelty became his curse. The Scholar King became the Cloven One, Quaffer of Souls. Some say he turned to the dram of Man in order to cure himself. I believe his thirst simply grew with his burgeoning immortality.

And perhaps he still retained some of his scholarly nature, for he seemed fair determined to share his hard won wisdom. He took himself a princess, a lovely thing from a local tribe, and nine months later she gave birth to something rather unlovely.

The Faun, as wild and wicked as the shaggy god himself. Schooled in his father's ways, the Faun would carry off many more virgins in his time, and thus, the race of goatmen found their footing.

--Sin, "Abberath" (POE I)



It is said that no matter how ugly a child is, its mother will always love it. That wasn't true of the boy they called "The Fawn". He was born on a cold, moonless night, his birth bed illuminated only by flickering torches. The midwife who pulled him free caught one glimpse of his hairy face and stubby horns, and ran screaming from the tent. His poor mother sheltered and fed him after that, but she was shunned and reviled. Whispers spread that she had consorted with a foul beast to spawn him.

Eventually, The Fawn's mother grew weary of her pariah status, and she took the hideous boy far away, to the cliff side. She meant to cast them both into the ocean, but at the last moment changed her mind. Seizing a large rock, she struck her son on the head, and left him inert and bleeding. However, The Fawn's thick, bony skull took the brunt of the blow without cracking, and he didn't die. The wounded boy attempted to follow

his mother back to their encampment, but he got lost on the way, and that was the last anyone heard of him.

But years later, a new menace appeared near the encampment, a terror waiting to waylay anyone attempting to traverse Wraeclast's soaring cliffs. Somehow The Fawn had produced offspring, creatures as twisted and vile as their father. These "men" have a goat's ability to eat anything they encounter, driving them in relentless pursuit of anything edible. They attack from above, smashing their prey underfoot with cloven hooves. Any who survive that assault are pummeled to death by a barrage of savage headbutts. If you hear the bleating of The Fawn, run away.

--<https://web.archive.org/web/20160526123708/https://www.pathofexile.com/monsters/goat-men>

The goat king knew not of war, of the lands and laws he trampled. The goat king knew only joy at turning life into ash.

--Abberath's Hooves Goathide Boots (POE I)

[Note: The following lore item was written for 3.0, but has never been available in-game.]

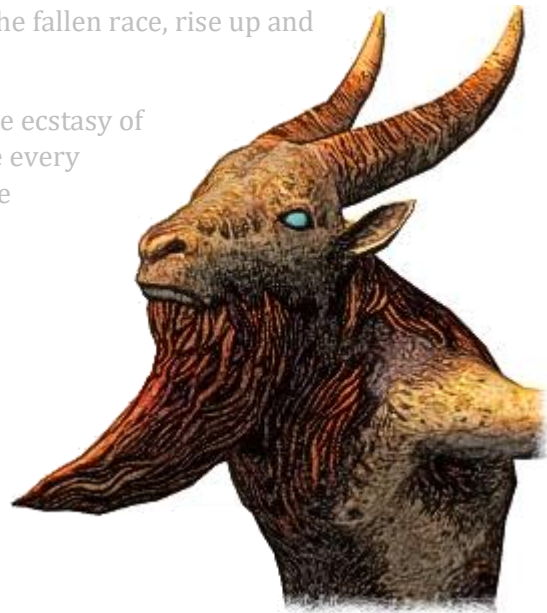
Soul prepared, Soul be mine. O' Abberath, goat lord of the fallen race, rise up and take this, my offering of delectable essence.

As it is known, with the consumption of souls, comes the ecstasy of true enlightenment. For the cloven ones shall subjugate every creature on this earth, and as such, all creatures need be consumed.

--Primitive Carving I (POE I)

When the demon Goat plays his flute,
And cloven hooves clip-clop your path,
Pray the gods will hold you mute,
And bless the fire on your hearth.

--Captured Soul of Mephod, the Earth Scorchers (POE I)



TANGMAZU, THE TRICKSTER

...I hear whispers. Even though I have the best ears among all these thieves, I cannot make out the words... but they sound like my constant companions - my depression, paranoia, and hatred - when I am at my worst. ...

--Nenet, "Strange Voice" (POE I)

... I keep thinking I hear laughter, mocking us... but I look around, and I don't see anything. ...

--Alva Valai, "The Strange Mirror" (POE II)

The tale-women tell of a cowardly god of lies... not one of ours, but Azmeri. They called him the Raven.

--Sorceress, to Tujen on Tangmazu (POE II)

He was not a First One, but there was a Deceiver among those that came after...

A Black Crow. An ancient God of lies.

--Warrior, to Tujen on Tangmazu (POE II)



... This marking... we've come across it in our excavations.

In context, it was treated as something quite negative, something Karui myths referred to as 'sealed away,' or 'imprisoned.' ...

--Alva Valai, "Simulacrum Splinters" (POE II)

...Hmm... we once excavated a ruin where the engraved pictures seemed to tell a story. It appeared as if they were teaching their children new knowledge by imbuing *emotions* in a piece of jewellery.

It was a very *old* ruin and we couldn't identify it...

--Alva Valai, "Distilled Emotions" (POE II)

The ruins we couldn't identify... they weren't from any other culture I've seen. Not Vaal, not Primeval, not 'Precursor.'

Do you think your 'Strange Voice' might be from that long lost people? He'd have to be very old...

--Alva Valai, "Unidentified Ruins" (POE II)

As I've studied these grey splinters you found, I've come to believe that they have a kind of... knowledge imbued in them.

It's fragmented, of course. Not enough to glean a conscious thought. But I keep having dreams... Nothing coherent yet... but I'll let you know...

--Alva Valai, on Dream I (POE II)

I had a more coherent dream after working with a larger number of splinters... I saw a feast. A peaceful, tranquil place. I felt... smiles. I felt calm.

I didn't get the impression that this was part of a vast empire, or a grand civilisation, or anything like that. Just a rare haven from the world's ills.

I really wish I could have written it down... but it's gone. I can't hold on to the sensations...

--Alva Valai, on Dream II (POE II)

I had another dream... more like a nightmare. There was so much anger, so much hate. They were all dead.

The haven... bloodied. Bodies everywhere, mutilated, all because of a harmless little lie I told, the kind any child might. They made me watch.

I was alone. Traumatized. I vowed to make them suffer. I vowed to darken the places they felt safest. To turn their very homes into prisons of paranoia and fear. I did it, too.

Countless faces twisted in agony and misery. I kept hurting them, but it never made me feel better... it just made the void bigger. When I woke up, I felt... empty. ...

--Alva Valai, on Dream III (POE II)

Once you put all those splinters together, I believe I had the final dream. I think I felt... Divinity, as crazy as that sounds.

In the dream, I was hollow. Completely empty. I was a liar. A torturer. A deceiver. I'd perfected the art of shaping reality with words, purely to enact misery.

I was so good at deception, I lied to myself, told myself that I was a god... I was so convincing, even I believed it. And you know what? It became true...

But I knew that if I ever stopped being alone, if I ever let go of my agony, if I ever let myself care... it would all unravel... and I woke up feeling hopeless.

Divinity isn't wonderful. It's isolating.

I think I'm done with those splinters. I don't want to know anymore. The completed object... it's a fruit.



A stone carving of a fruit we used to gather from the shore. Sweet and juicy, like summer, now lost forever... Sorry, what *they* used to gather...

--Alva Valai, on Dream IV (POE II)

What will you find in the darkest reaches of your mind? Come! Step into my world of twisted illusions. Witness the birth of fear...

--Tangmazu, <https://www.pathofexile.com/delirium> (trailer) (POE I)

The more the warrior understood Tangmazu's gift, the less the mask aided him. His dreams were filled with divine laughter.

- Tenth Song of the Islands

--Fractal Thoughts Vaal Mask (POE I)

IMPRISONMENT

Long ago, the Ramako Tribe imprisoned a being of great malice here. They maintained it as long as they could, and then, the Tukohama Tribe inherited this duty. It can take any form, and deceive the mind.

Do not listen to it. Everything it says is a lie.

Tavakai, Chieftain of the Tukohama Tribe

--Tavakai's Warning (POE I)

Tukohama tasked his tribe—*my* tribe—with keeping that Deceiver in his prison. Our sacred duty kept us in this region, even though we longed for the sea... but, it is good that we stayed. ...

We tried posting warriors to keep watch over the prison. He'd drive them mad. They'd throw themselves into the sea. Instead, we allowed his fog to wreak its havoc and in turn... keep him hidden. ...

--Tavakai, on Tekaru (POE II)

That island has been shrouded in mist for generations... even since before the Vaal empire! The tale told by our *hatungo* goes: if the mists part and the island shows itself, you will be compelled to land on its shores. You'll claim to hear the voices or see the visions of loved ones, or of your gods, or whatever else is dear to you. ...

--Makoru, on Journey's End (POE II)

THE GODDESS OF JUSTICE



The Just Goddess presides over us all. ...

--Bronze Plaque (POE I)

In the court of the Goddess, every man and woman is deemed worthy of redemption. ...

--Bronze Monograph I (POE I)

... Within these walls, the Lady of Justice doth preside. She shall weigh your Mind in one hand, your Heart in the other. Should she find you wanting, death shall be your sentence. Should she find you worthy, you will be given the loyalty and love of an empire. ...

--Izaro, on The Aspirants' Plaza (POE I)

Before the Goddess, nothing remains hidden. Adversity reveals old flaws and new strengths.

--Dedication to the Goddess (POE I)

You may appeal to the Goddess for another verdict, but justice favours only the truly worthy.

--Tribute to the Goddess (POE I)

The Goddess abides a kingdom beyond compare, should you meet her challenge.

--Gift to the Goddess (POE I)

KETH: RISE & DECLINE OF THE MARAKETH EMPIRE

...our fair plains blazed with emerald forests and sapphire rivers. This brought about the most glorious age of our people. ...

--Zarka, "History of the Vastiri Plains" (POE II)

... What I wouldn't give to relive the halcyon days of ancient Keth, when we kept mortals in their rightful place.

--Tangmazu, The Quarry (POE I)

A simple ornament from the days when Keth's trade empire was the glory of the world. Protectors at the massive toll gates wore these.

--Dekhara's Resolve (POE I)

Sap of the Aturi tree, known only to grow at the meeting point of the seven waters. Nothing since its disappearance has smelled as wondrous.

--Incense of Keth (POE I)

The weary traveler grows close to the end of the path! The breadbowl of the world, the verdant Land of Seven Waters, awaits! Be sure to have your toll ready at the Gates. Cloth, gems, metal wares, and coin are all accepted.

--Wayfarer's Stone (Maraketh Bazaar) (POE II)

The weary traveler has reached the end of the path! Welcome to the City of Seven Waters, whence bounty springs! Behold our lush plains and verdant forests, blessed to feed empires far and wide. Eat, drink, and be fat at your leisure, so long as you take word back to your homeland of the glory of Keth!

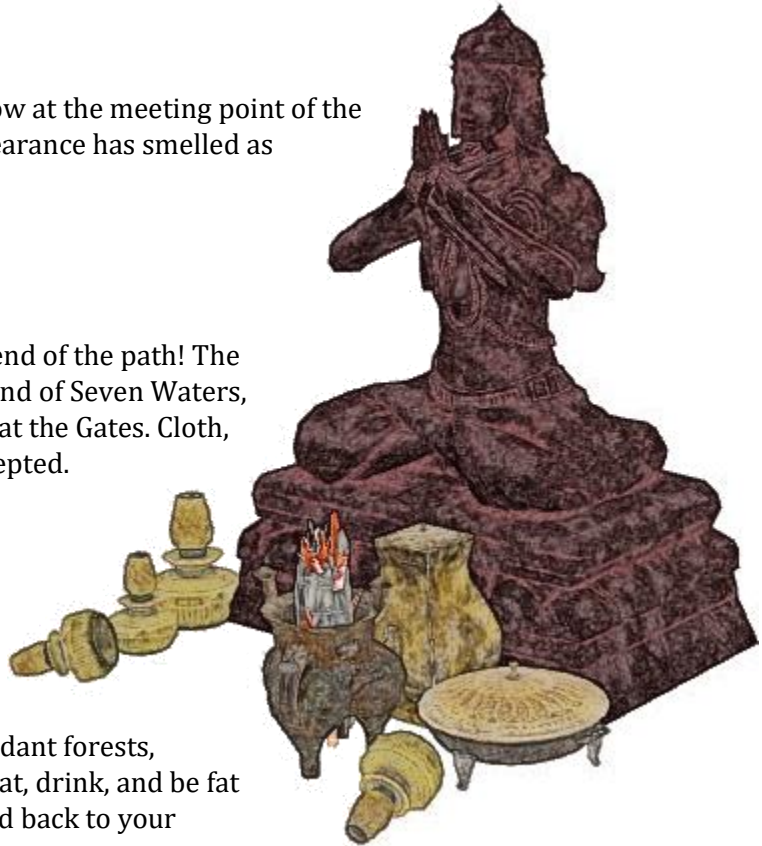
--Wayfarer's Stone (Keth) (POE II)

During the first rain of each year, rich and poor alike chased the Beetle through the flooding streets of Keth, and its bounty was shared equally by all.

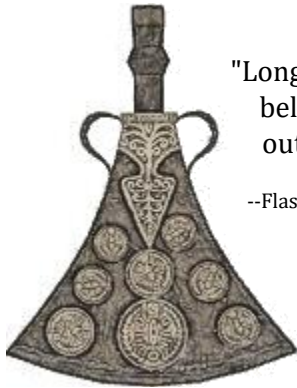
--The Rain Festival Beetle Jeweller's Strongbox (POE II)

Centuries of peace brought immense wealth to Keth, but many worried that it had also left the people soft.

--The Peacemaker's Draught Amphora Relic (POE II)



BALBALA'S BETRAYAL



"Long ago, a traitor was promised this mythical elixir. We consider her a fool for believing it exists, but if it does... I would certainly like to take a sip and find out."

--Flask of Welakath (POE I)

Long ago, when Keth was the shining jewel of the Vastiri and our trade routes were the envy of the known world, a weak-willed *Sekhema* named Balbala betrayed her *akhara* for a promise of *welakath*, a mythical elixir said to bestow great power.

She led a band of foreign warriors through secret paths to the top of the Halani Gates. Taken by surprise, the *akhara* was slain to the last woman.

What was her reward? Not *welakath*. The bandits put a spear through her gut in that very passage. A cautionary tale, yes. For her betrayal, the wise women of that era enacted an ancient ritual, trapping Balbala's soul as a Djinn for a sentence intended to be one thousand years. ...

--Shambrin, "Balbala, the Traitor" (non-Sorceress version) (POE II)

The traitor Balbala has been sentenced to one thousand years of suffering as a djinn, bound in this place of her dishonour. Let no woman or man of Maraketh blood enter her prison before her time is served.

--Decree of Imprisonment (POE II)

The tale-women of many *akharas* gathered on the day of my sentencing. Death was not punishment enough for my crime.

They enacted the ritual, but my imprisonment as Djinn would not have been possible without my willful agreement.

I accepted. I let it happen, because I deserved it. ...

--Balbala, "Imprisonment" (POE II)

The river inside you, the essence of who you are, can be torn out of you under the right conditions. It can be speared, or bottled, or chained.



A spirit without a body, especially one created in this manner, is called a Djinn. It has prolonged my existence, but it is not a form anyone should desire...

I grow hungry, but cannot eat. I grow tired, but cannot sleep. I would give anything just to feel the chill of a single sip of water one more time.

--Balbala, on Djinns (POE II)

DESERTIFICATION

The Seven Rivers once met below these dry stones.

--Buried Shrines map pin (uncompleted) (POE II)

The home region of the Maraketh, the Vastiri Plains were once verdant and beautiful. Seven rivers supported a riverboat culture of merchants and tradesmen. Over thousands of years, the climate shifted, and now the Maraketh travel by caravan rather than boat. The rivers and forests are gone, leaving only sand, salt flats, and badlands. ...

--The Art of Path of Exile II, "Act II - The Vastiri Plains" (POE II)

Ah, Keth. Now nothing but dunes of sand, but once, it was glorious. The waters flowed in patterns crafted by artisans of skill beyond belief. The hanging gardens could impress even the most jaded heart.

--The Hooded One, "Keth" (POE II)

In its final era, the roofs of Keth were rife with anything and everything that could hold water... should the opportunity arise.

--Prayers for Rain Keth Raiment (POE II)

It is an elegant lie, that name: the 'Plains' of Vastiri. I know it only as a harsh desert, a blasted wasteland of broken rock, crimson sands, and salted earth. Those who call it the 'Plains' see it as it was thousands of years ago. They are deluded. ...

--Nenet, "The Plains of Vastiri" (POE I)

They believed themselves the most ordered, but that tradition turned their forests to salt.

--Brutal Restraint Timeless Jewel (POE I)

BURIAL IN THE SKY

To remember the dead, they built monuments the sand could never steal.

--Deshar map pin (completed) (POE II)

Ah, Deshar, the City of the Dead! ...we built towering spires to return our people to the sky.

Our Honoured Dead lie openly, enjoying the sun, not hidden from it under the earth. Over time, they are scoured away, becoming the wind and sand you feel on your skin at this very moment.

Deshar is our most sacred monument...

--Zarka, "Deshar" (POE II)

It is our bane, young one. The desert is a harsh Sekhema. It is not the heat that kills you, nor the thirst, nor the chill winds at night. The Doom of the Desert is a severing of one's connection to other people.

The desert is always shifting, and one rock looks much like another. Those who lose hold of their path for even a moment are never seen again, and those who fall among the dunes are forgotten, their bodies lost beneath the sands for all time.

As a girl, I sometimes had nightmares about a layer beneath... a layer of bones... countless generations of Maraketh that have fallen from memory... being forgotten under the sands is our deepest fear, too unnerving for many to discuss, and it is why a promise to remember someone is the greatest respect we children of the desert can give.

--Zarka, "The Doom of the Desert" (POE II)

Let these towers stand for all time, so that the sands may never swallow the Honoured Dead. We give you to the sky and to the wind, in defiance of the Doom of the Desert.

--Testament of Defiance (POE II)

... Most do wait for their bodies to fail, but I would prefer to meet Death on my feet. Who knows? I may even be the first mortal to win my battle, and defeat Nekraata in spiritual combat. ...

--Zarka, "Deshar" (POE II)

THE GIFTING OF WATER

The Gifting of Water is an opportunity to air grievances and heal old wounds. It takes place at the last reservoir of the original Seven Waters. The last true remnant of Keth's glory days. ...

--Asala, "Gifting of Water" (POE II)

The *sel khari*, the sacred guardians of the First *Barya*... Three nights before the Gifting, they are to bring the *Barya*...

--Asala, Interlude part 2 intro (POE II)

Long ago, when the bounty of the land began to shift against us, we enacted traditions that would safeguard the future. Each *akhara* sends one *dekhara* per generation to the *sel khari*. Thus, they are loyal to all, and to none. They watch over vast underground reserves that were built in Keth's fading days.

For countless generations, the Gifting of Water meant pouring water *into* the reserves. Now, in this era of thirst and heat, we are given what our forebears set aside for us. When I drink, it is from water given to me by my mother, and her mother before her. Their sacrifice. Their resolve.

The Grand Water Djinn, Rashi, is crucial to maintaining these reserves...

--Asala, "Sel Khari" (POE II)

To keep the reserves from running dry, Rashi collects water from the winds throughout the seasons. She inhabits the First *Barya*. The *sel khari* bring her to us. We take her to the sacred site, and Rashi bleeds what she gathered. In this way, we replenish our reserves.

Rashi is not a criminal, like so many others bound to *baryas*. She chose this duty. She could choose to move on at any time; to pass the burden to another. She has not yet done so. It is a grim and solemn duty. Each time she is bled of water... her screams are haunting. This existence, alone in all that I have seen in this world, I do not believe I could endure. She has my utmost respect.

--Asala, "Rashi" (POE II)



The location of the *sel khari* is closely guarded. ...

--Zarka, "Sel Khari" (POE II)

For most, the *sel khari's* secrecy is kept on pain of death...

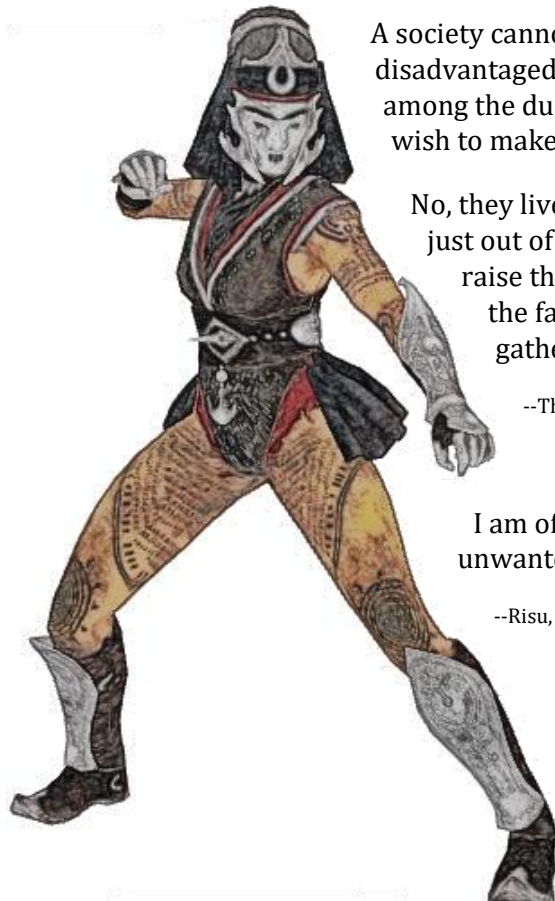
--Zarka, "Consequences" (POE II)

There are certain steps that need to be taken to recognise a *Sekhema* of *Sekhemas*. The Gifting of Water is a sign of solidarity between our *akharas*. ...

--Zarka, "Gifting of Water" (POE II)

OUTCASTS (THE FARIDUN)

They call themselves the Faridun in this era, but they have died out and been reborn many times. They are not an independent culture. They are the Maraketh's dark secret, the inevitable consequence of life's haphazard nature.



A society cannot simply purge itself of the weak, the ill, or the disadvantaged. Those unwanted newborns who are abandoned among the dunes... they rarely die, no matter how much the Maraketh wish to make them simply disappear.

No, they live. The Faridun are the shadow of the Maraketh, always just out of sight, always watching. They rescue those children and raise them on the outside, looking in. An unspoken relief for the father and mother that must give up their child, but a gathering storm fated to one day return home with a fury.

--The Hooded One, "The Faridun" (POE II)

I am of the Faridun. We are the shadows of the Maraketh, the unwanted and the forgotten. ...

--Risu, "Identity" (POE II)

... Like most Faridun, I was left to die in the desert as an infant. Perhaps someone here is my mother or father...

I look at each of them wondering what my life could have been if... if they had wanted me. My people are full of anger and distrust, for reasons I hope are clear. They are blinded by this.

--Risu, "The Ardura" (POE II)

Nenet is from a people that currently call themselves the Faridun. They are our rejects. Those we Maraketh left to die in the desert as children for being unworthy or flawed. I do not think ill of Nenet. I do not think of her at all.

I am not cruel... It is simply that scattered groups of pariahs wandering in the desert have no effect on the world. ...

--Adiyah, "Nenet" (POE I)

Niles: Out of curiosity, pariah, do the Faridun worship any gods?

Nenet: What's a god?

--Niles & Nenet, "Banter" (POE I)

... The Faridun...have never had any gods of their own, and only knew oppression from the gods of the Maraketh...

--The Art of Path of Exile II, "The Exacatus" (POE II)

The Faridun cannot earn burial in the sky. They have other ways of keeping the dead.

--Urn of Farud (POE I)

JAMANRA

Our people have lived in the shadows of the dunes for too long.

Countless generations have been forgotten, will be forgotten. We are not 'Faridun,' we are Maraketh, and if we work together — if we unite — then they will be forced to acknowledge us.

We must show them that casting us off is a mistake. We must show them our strength.

Perhaps we can one day rebuild Keth itself, for all those who live in the Plains of Vastiri.

--Book of Jamanra (POE II)

Jamanra? That's a tale I rarely tell. Every few generations, the Faridun stir up trouble. Jamanra was their most successful attempt at causing problems. A very long time ago, he spread dangerous ideas among the outcasts, and spoke to the Maraketh as if they were equals.

His offenses were so great, the *Sekhemas* joined together to approach and rebuke him. The tale says that he was so in awe of the glory of our leaders, he ended his own life, and chose to fall forgotten in the sands.

It is a strange conclusion to his tale, I must admit. But this is what is told. ...

--Zarka, "Jamanra" (POE II)

[Note: The following lore items were written for 3.12, but have never been available in-game.]

... There is a legend among my people of a bold warrior who tried to unite the scattered Faridun camps thousands of years ago. His name was Jamanra, and he wished only to unify us so that we might come into our own as a people. ...

--Nenet, "The Book of Jamanra" (POE I)

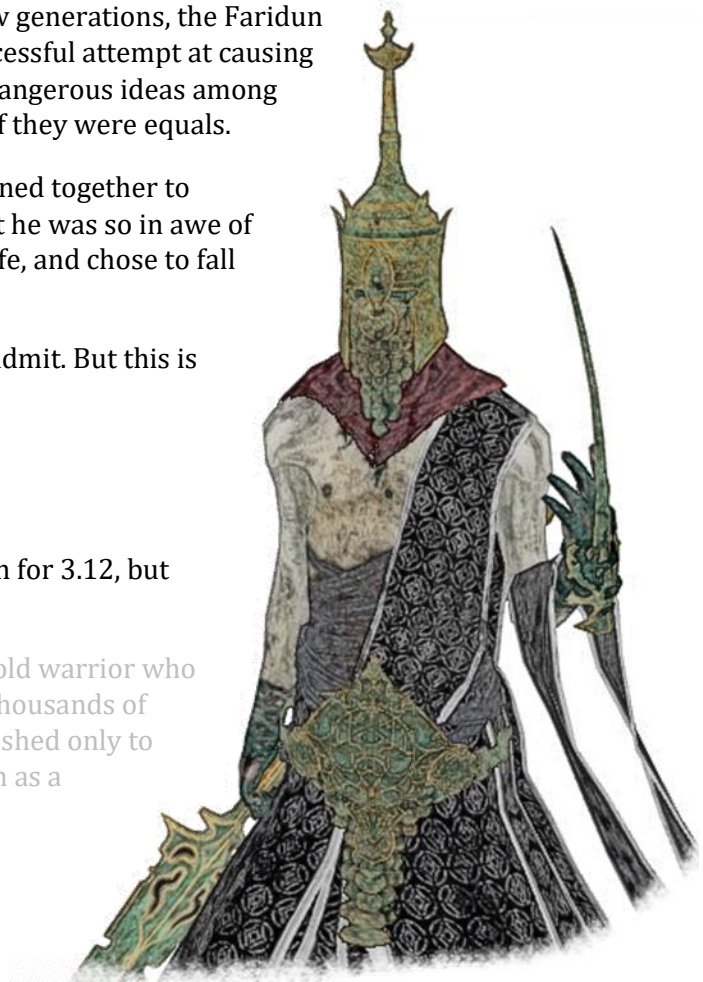
Jamanra did exist... and they killed him.

The *Sekhemas* agreed to meet with him to discuss recognizing the Faridun nation, but it was a trick. They poisoned him. The supposedly honourable high-and-mighty Maraketh poisoned our greatest leader. ...

--Nenet, "The Book of Jamanra" (POE I)

I tried to seek peace, and the *Sekhemas* disgraced me! Left my corpse to rot in the sand! ...

--Jamanra, on phase change (POE II)



NASIMA OF THE SECOND SIGHT

Nasima, yes, Nasima! A great warrior, though with a complicated legacy. Born with eyes the color of blood, she was left to die among the dunes for being blind, but the Faridun found her and raised her.

A *balbalakh*, one might think, but no. She became an impressive warrior in her own right, and when called upon to raid her people, she recognised her mother's voice, and turned and slaughtered her Faridun captors!

A true role model from the ancient days, and a wonderful sleep-tale for the children.

--Zarka, "Nasima of the Second Sight" (POE II)

THE BEAST & THE SLUMBER OF THE GODS

THE TRAP OF DIVINITY

Garukhan was the true jewel of the Vastiri, at least to me. Divine love is much like mortal love, at least from what I can remember, and we were happy for a time longer than the lives of many mortal men.

The time came, however, when love was not enough. Her humanity sifted through the cracks of her life like fine sand, leaving a divine shell that held her image, but nothing of her soul.

It is a trap, you see. Divinity. Faith empowers, but faith also shapes. To gather more power, a god must play the part, becoming more and more the icon their followers perceive.

When does perception become reality? It's impossible to pinpoint, and that's the most sinister thing about it. You never know the moment you cross the line.

--The Hooded One, "Wife" (POE II)

It takes courage to go against one's people. ... There were men and women like me, who believed themselves to be exceptional, and they were correct... terribly, horribly correct.

I cursed myself to a permanent exile from my own peers by betraying them. I was unlike mortals, but hated by immortals. I was alone.

I would do it all again...

--The Hooded One, "Risu" (POE II)

THE BEAST & THE SLUMBER OF THE GODS

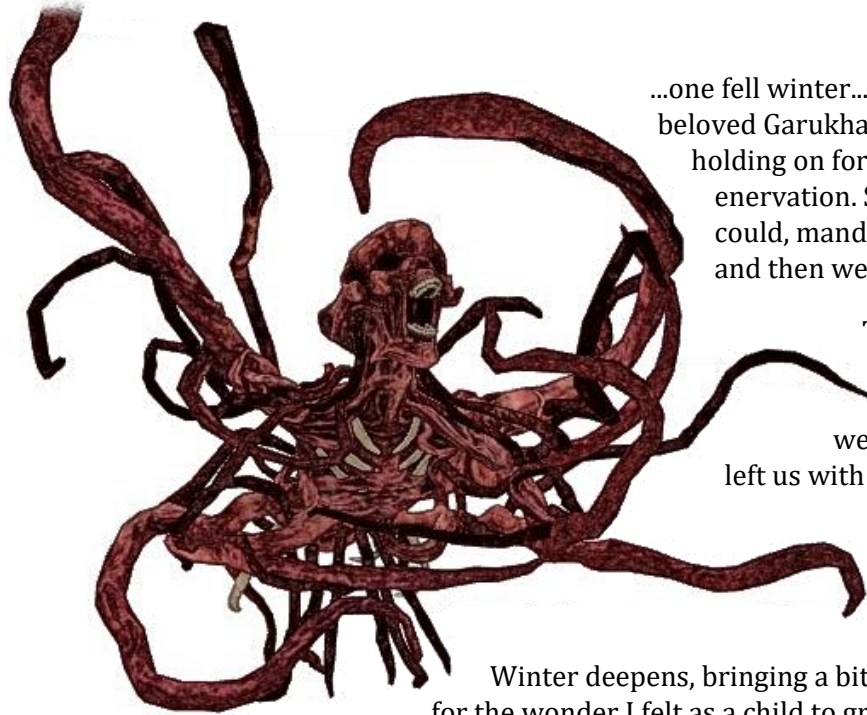
... when I consulted the ancient being Kalandra, she told me where to find the Seed of Corruption... She was cryptic, and said that it already belonged to me. That it always had. ...

--The Hooded One, on the weapon (POE II)

... "The Beast."

It was I who planted the seed in the rich soil beneath Highgate, who nurtured it, who watched it bloom into maturity, even as I succumbed to its mollifying powers. We gods, we were driven into slumbering darkness, to dream away eternity whilst the gentle Beast watched over us. ...

--Sin, "The Rise of the Gods" (POE I)



...one fell winter... the gods vanished. Our beloved Garukhan was the last to succumb, holding on for two moons against a powerful enervation. She gave what final orders she could, mandated our traditions be upheld, and then went silent.

The Maraketh were not disturbed. We did not lose hope. We knew who we were, and those values had not left us with the departure of the gods. ...

--Zarka, "History of the Vastiri Plains" (POE II)

Winter deepens, bringing a biting chill. I long for it to snow, for the wonder I felt as a child to grace my eyes once more, but the last winter that brought such beauty was two hundred years ago now... it cannot snow in a region where it does not rain.

The city is quiet. The city is cold. The wind whistles through stone columns, unheard by the living. I ask myself why I am still here. I ask myself why I will not let my tired bones rest, and I ask myself whether I truly believe Halani will awaken.

I do.

I do...

--Final Testament (POE II)

THE NATURE OF THE BEAST

The Ember is a seed... the black core of the Beast's heart. It is the pure, undiluted essence of corruption. ...all of its power, the stupefying effect it had on us gods, it all dwells within this Dark Ember. ...

--Sin, "The Dark Ember" (POE I)

... Twisting tunnels of flesh. A blinking cathedral of a thousand eyes. History itself pierced and remade by corruption.

The outpourings of the Beast's consciousness brings [sic] life to nightmares beyond imagination. ... Within its belly there is no 'real'. ...

--<https://www.pathofexile.com/theawakening/actfour> (POE I)

... A dark God of ancient sacrifice, a muse to the twisted and vile...the Beast, the Nightmare, the Darkness...names given to it by mortals that think with slugs bound in shells of bone. ...

--Tasuni, "The Beast" (POE I)

... Spirals can often be found on the land and creatures the Beast influences. ...

--<http://www.pathofexile.com/forum/view-thread/1981149>



CATACLYSMS THROUGH THE AGES

... Unfortunately for everyone, the Beast didn't just consume divine energies - the process of digesting it leaked its inverse, Corruption, as a form of waste. While divine energies are extremely ordered and focused, Corruption is inherently chaotic and maddening. Corruption bathed Wraeclest over the ages, irradiating the land with sinister energies. Eventually, some realized that this could offer an alternate route to power. ...

The best a person can hope for on Wraeclest is to remain neutral, unaffected by either. For example, one can be spared corrupted mutations if they inspire faith in those around them. That might be why the Exile remains human when so many others become abominations in proximity to Corruption. ...

--<https://www.pathofexile.com/forum/view-thread/2996851>

Corruption once had a purpose. Let us term it a disorganiser of what would otherwise be ordered. One consequence of this chaos is the warping of pathways, both through the woods, and in the mind.

The land so afflicted is never the same when trod upon a second time; men afflicted by Corruption know not where or when they are, only that they are in pain, and you appear as a horrible creature to their distorted senses.

--The Hooded One, "Madness" (POE II)

The boundless horrors of mishandled Corruption cannot be conveyed simply through words. ...

--The Hooded One, "The Seed of Corruption" (POE II)

The Beast was never a cruel master. It didn't want to destroy, to corrupt, to terrorise. It simply existed to exist. I made it that way.

Unfortunately, in neglecting to provide it with ambition, I made it vulnerable to the ambitions of others. Queen Atziri and Doryani. Emperor Chitus and Malachai. Others even before them.

I created a Beast that would free humanity from the tyranny of the gods. Yet all I really did was provide the perfect tool with which humanity could tyrannise itself.

--Sin, "The Beast" (POE I)

... My Beast was born to be a thing of beauty. A crowning jewel to rest upon humanity's head. I... I wanted to give your kind a chance for peace, a chance to play atop the great stage. No longer pawns to a pantheon of petty, slaving gods...

It was only ever defending itself, the fault lies within the twisted hearts of those who would betray their own humanity.

Not even I could anticipate the cataclysms my pet wrought on Wraecclast. Both Vaal and Eternal. Ruins in the pages of history. And the others... trailing back across the aeons.

There is blood on my hands... the innocent blood of millions, and try as I might, the stains just won't wash off.

--Sin, "Cataclysm" (POE I)

VIRTUE GEMS

... The Beast is the source of all thaumaturgy, the one power in this world that transforms 'what is real' into 'what is imagined.' ...

--Piety, "Malachai" (POE I)

Thaumaturgy comes from virtue gems. ...

--<https://www.pathofexile.com/forum/view-thread/2996851>

The Virtue Gems are all sourced from mines on Mount Veruso, under Highgate. It is impossible to be completely certain with the limited tomes I have available on the subject, but the Beast's presence under that mountain and the fact that Virtue Gems cannot be found anywhere else in the world does indeed suggest a connection. The number of Virtue Gems in existence cannot be ascertained, any more than one might count the grains of sand on a beach.

--<https://www.pathofexile.com/forum/view-thread/2991402>

Rumour has it that skill gems are essentially crystallised corruption – fragments of the Beast's skin that broke off as it grew. It's also said they are fuelled by the willpower of the user.

--Cadiro, on skill gems (POE I)

I believe that *you* believe that these coloured gems give you power... I've handled one of them, even tried to 'activate it'...but it didn't do a damn thing. Call me a skeptic, but to me, it seems like the power was inside you all along.

--Dannig, "Gems" (POE I)

Believe me, I've tried. We have our own methods of mystical power, to be fair, but your gems remain an enigma. Somehow, I suspect the power is actually inside you, and these 'virtue gems' are just the particular way you believe the world works. I'm no priest, though, so take my opinion for what it's worth.

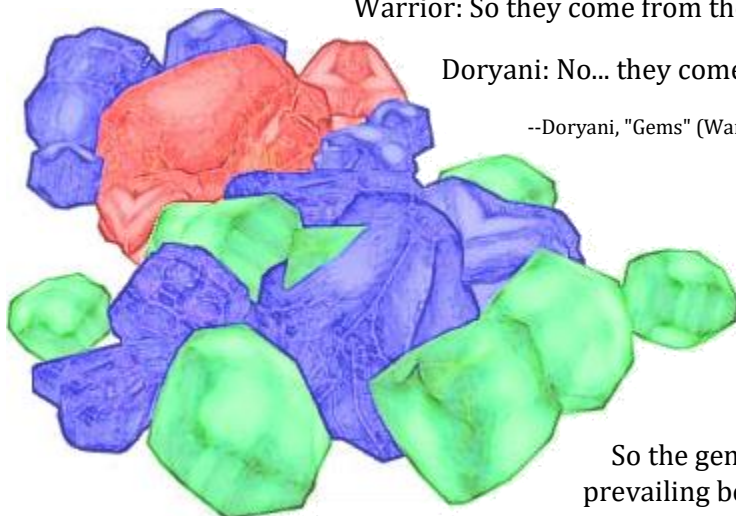
--Dannig, on Virtue Gems (POE II)

Doryani: Each gem we mined seemed to take after a particular portion of a myth or belief. Abilities our people believed our gods to possess. Arakaali's poison. Kopec's fire. Never anything new. Never the unknown.

Warrior: So they come from the gods?

Doryani: No... they come from us.

--Doryani, "Gems" (Warrior version) (POE II)



Ah, so what people believe becomes fragmented... crystallised...

--Ranger, to Doryani on Gems (POE II)

So the gems of each era are different, because prevailing beliefs have changed...

--Druid, to Doryani on Gems (POE II)

The strength of the gods, lyin' around in forests and valleys... free for anyone to pick up and use to kill each other.

--Huntress, to Doryani on Gems (POE II)

THE AZMERI & THE TEARS OF MAJI

The Azmeri must never touch the Tears of Maji, lest Viridi weep.

--Forbidden Shako Great Crown (POE I)

The Draíocht forbid us from touching 'virtue gems'... though, it is still possible to employ them, if one is willing to blur the lines of right and wrong in the battle against evil. So long as a Maji does not touch a virtue gem, but merely places it in a geomantic socket on their armour, the pain can be endured for the sake of victory. I did see a young man directly touch a gem with his bare hand, once... I will never make that mistake myself.

--The Warden of Eaves, "Tears of the Maji" (POE I)

The Maji were forbidden from touching virtue gems... so their practical warriors employed geomancy instead.

--Pragmatism Colosseum Plate (POE I)

Geomancy offered a safer way to use the Tears... but most Maji rejected that temptation as well.

--The Untouched Soul Gold Amulet (POE I)

Experiments with geomancy taught the Maji more than they ever expected.

--Ingenuity Utility Belt (POE II)

USE BY THE VAAL

The Vaal were even more steeped in gem culture than our Emperor and his 'Gemlings.' It's an obsession as old as civilization itself.

- Icius Perandus

--Golden Page I (POE I)

Vaal Skill Gems

The Vaal civilization...had its own form of Skill Gems. Brutally powerful and fueled by the sacrifice of foes...

--<https://www.pathofexile.com/forum/view-thread/807869>



... Though they described the Vaal as having flesh adorned with glittering crystals, our Azmerian ancestors were never privy to the gems' potentials or powers. ...

--The Ancients (POE I)

Direct study of the Beast propelled our technology forward by centuries. Our nobles used gems for generations, but never truly understood what they were. ...

They come from the Beast's outer flesh, its carapace. They are Corruption, in crystallised form.

This new level of understanding swept our greatest minds along with the tide of innovation. ...

There was no thought given to where it would lead. ...

You safely place them in geomantic sockets, a technique I believe the Titans created for humanity during the Third Pact. We Vaal generally implant our gems in our flesh. They are far stronger when used that way, but come with... unwanted consequences. ...

--Doryani, "Studying the Beast" (POE II)

... The strongest gems belonged to the royal family. ...

--Doryani, "Grand Phylactory" (POE II)

... Our royalty became addicted to the power of these gems long ago. In that sense, we have always been doomed.

--Doryani, "Gems" (POE II)

KARUI BLOOD FEVER

My fellow Karui never wanted to face the hard truth: if the Vaal wanted to wipe us out, they could have. They wouldn't even have needed to invade us, and our lauded might would have been useless. Their Empire rose to power on the back of Corruption, and those gems the Azmeri called the Tears of Maji. Corruption has a tendency to make Karui sick with a kind of... blood fever. That is the true reason our Way forbids the use of Tears of Maji.

During my life, a handful of Karui tried to implant them in their flesh. They became filled with rage and unnatural strength, and we had to put them down... then burn their bodies. Their mere proximity made others sick, too, so for every warrior that transgressed, five others gave their lives to protect the rest of us. To wipe us out, the Vaal could have simply spread the blood fever. My peacemaking, concessions, and treaties were born of that vulnerability, and I am glad I forged such a path. The Vaal Empire eventually succumbed to its own disease, and we remained.

--Maata, "The Vaal" (POE I)



The Karui Way forbids the use of virtue gems by Ngakuramakoi, and there is a very good reason for that. Since the days of the now-fallen Vaal Empire, it was known that Corruption combines dangerously with Karui blood, causing massive fiery blisters and a powerful blood rage that drives warriors to madness. If a Karui warrior becomes afflicted, they also become contagious, and anyone who touches them must die as well, lest the infection spread rapidly.

--The Art of Path of Exile II, "Blood Fever" (POE II)

THE DECLINE & FALL OF THE VAAL

...the Vaal were the height of civilisation, and their future was bright. ...

--The Hooded One, "The Vaal" (POE II)

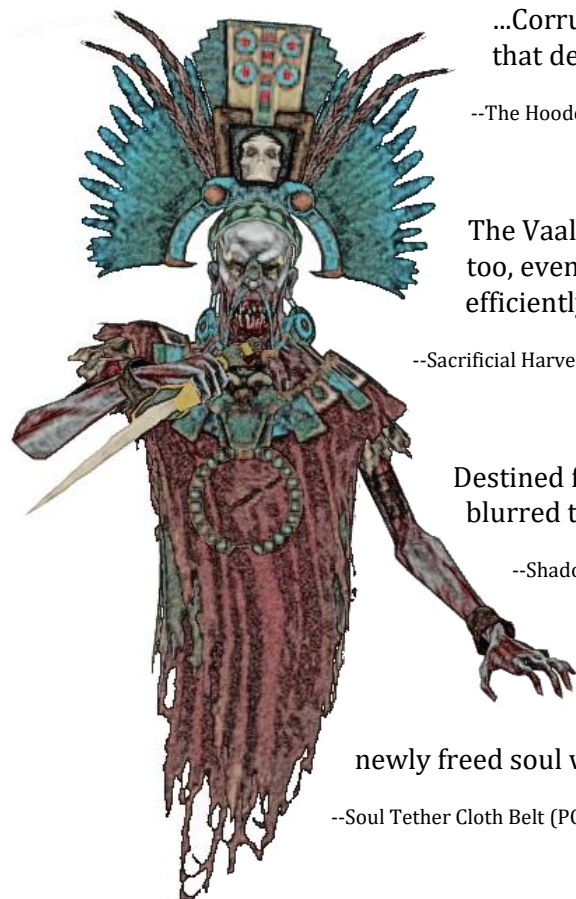
Trade with lesser cultures, such as the Maraketh and the early Karui, resulted in overflowing vaults full of golden trinkets and elegant jewels.

- Icius Perandus, Antiquities Collection, 'Dekhara's Resolve'

--Chronicle of Atzoatl with Glittering Halls (POE I)

You might not know this, but the common tongue we are speaking is derived from ancient Vaal—they were the largest empire on Wraecclast for thousands of years. ...

--The Hooded One, "Common Language" (POE II)



...Corruption, there was an empire that mastered the use of that deadly energy. ...the...Vaal. ...

--The Hooded One, "To Utzaal" (POE II)

The Vaal used human sacrifice to power their empire. They, too, eventually sought means to make their machines run more efficiently.

--Sacrificial Harvest Viridian Jewel (POE I)

Destined for sacrifice, they were dressed in garments that blurred the lines between this world and the next.

--Shadowstitch Sacrificial Garb (POE I)

Vaal bloodpriests were among the earliest intellectuals on record. It was they who found that a newly freed soul would desperately cling to any other source of life.

--Soul Tether Cloth Belt (POE I)

So great was the thaumaturgy of a bloodpriest's mark, that sacrifices soon welcomed their death.

--Mark of Submission Unset Ring (POE I)

We pack up our camp just before sunrise and journey towards the capital, Azala Vaal. We hear the crowd before we see them. Word of our victory spread quickly, and even the Queen has come to meet us.

My family has come to watch the ceremony. As I lay on the stone altar, I hear them chanting my name. It's the last thing I hear before the Queen's dagger is plunged into my chest.

--Unknown, River Crossing Memory (POE I)

The Vaal built massive waterways to turn swamp into richer lands. ...

--Servi, "The Lake" (POE II)

... I have seen signs of blood and ancient sacrifice in the ghostings of our precious city! Such as what the Vaal would commit in their homelands. Could it be that these echoes point to Vaal culture having extended all the way to the shores of Oriath? ...

- Templar Davaro of Theopolis

--Research Journal I (POE I)

THE REIGN OF QUEEN TETZLAPOKAL

While they were highly advanced in their technology, the Vaal were rather brutish in their social practices. I find it rather baffling to think of the Vaal as a people who believed in science and progress and yet constructed elaborate sacrificial altars in the centers of their cities.

Judging by the construction of this particular ruin, I would say that the city rose to prominence during the reign of Queen Tetzlapokal who some scholars refer to as a 'waif of disturbing proclivities'. She was a devotee of Arakaali and according to the literature, had a deep fascination with mortality and the inert human form.

The histories tell how the queen would request her subjects to deposit the bodies of their deceased loved ones upon the steps of her palace. The corpses would be promptly taken inside to be used for... unfortunately most scholars fell into hysterical conjecture at that point. At least I hope it was conjecture.

--Eramir, "The Vaal City" (POE I)

CONTACTING THE AZMERI (CA. 900 BIC)

Book 4: Raising the Azmeri

Drain a cup of Azmerian tea and then try to read your future in the leaves. You'll find that your Vaalish will come in mighty handy. Our literature was conceived and born within the Azmeri's cultural marriage with the Vaal.

Prior to Vaal contact some 2500 years ago, the Azmerian culture had a purely oral tradition of story and record keeping. Afterwards, their literary culture blossomed, along with just about every other aspect of their fledgling civilisation. From the moment the first Vaalish ambassadors set foot upon the rugged slopes of the Azmerian Ranges, the Vaal civilisation held the hand of the Azmeri as they grew from a primitive tribal existence into a cohesive culture of settlement and agriculture.

Yet while the Vaal were generous with their knowledge and guidance in many areas, there is one subject upon which they were notably silent: the Tears of Maji, now known as Virtue Gems. Despite an exhaustive search, neither account nor passing reference can be found regarding gem usage amongst the early Azmeri. Though they described the Vaal as having flesh adorned with glittering crystals, our Azmerian ancestors were never privy to the gems' potentials or powers.

At least, not until the first Vaal refugees came knocking five hundred years later.

- *Trinian - Intellectus Prime*

--The Ancients (POE I)

THE TRIAL OF CHAOS

... There's a door in the depths of the jungle that we've never been able to open. It's far older than Utzaal, and was built on higher terrain.

From what I gather, only highly select Vaal could enter, and they would be faced with some sort of trial within. This thing... it essentially marks you as chosen, as an aspirant. It'll get you inside.

--Oswald, on Chimeral Inscribed Ultimatum (POE II)

Here, all challengers were welcome, regardless of wealth or station.

--Trial of Chaos map pin (uncompleted) (POE II)

This once-mighty temple was the bridge from mere peasant to high priest. All were welcome to attempt the Trials of Chaos, and those that attained a true victory were gifted a small measure of power to help forge their own destinies. ...

--The Trialmaster, "The Temple" (POE II)

On the outskirts of Utzaal, at the Temple of Chaos, the Trialmaster awaits your challenge.

--The Tower of Ordeals Engraved Ultimatum (POE I)

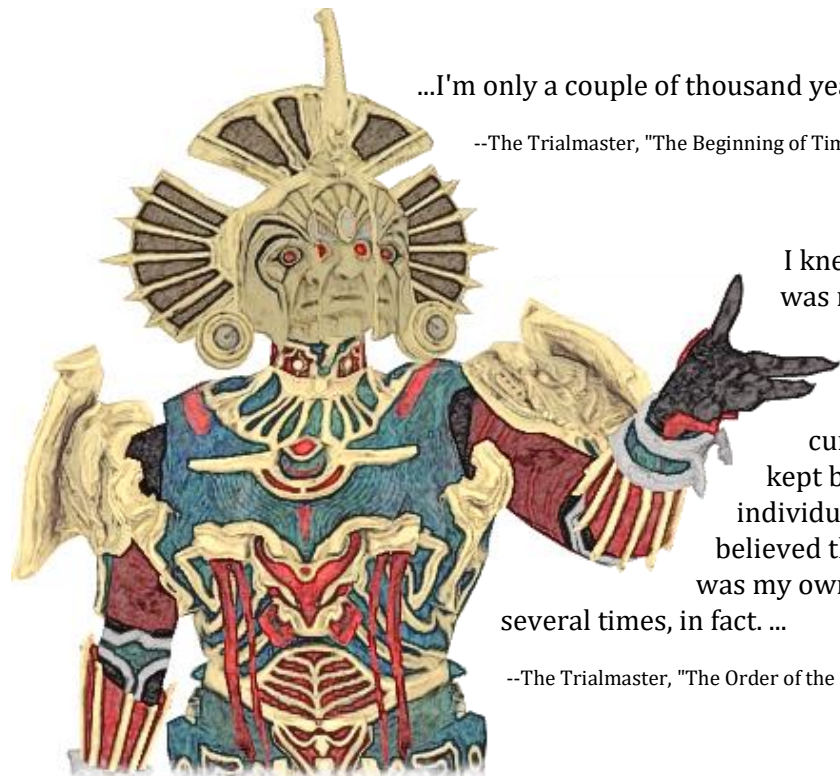
Long have I walked this world in search of suitable challengers. My master, Chaos, has charged me with this task. Many have attempted my trials in search of greatness. Scholars, criminals, heroes, and the meek. All have stepped forward, and most have fallen. The rules never changed for them, and the rules will not change for you. Bring only that which you can afford to lose—including your life.

--The Trialmaster, "The Trials" (POE I)

THE TRIALMASTER

I was once mortal, and I know how the mortal I once was would have felt about certain things. That man would have hated Doryani with a passion for bringing about the fall of the greatest civilisation this world has ever known. Fortunately, I am no longer troubled by such attachments. Through the grace of Chaos, I now understand that all things that can happen, do. Even now I am testing the might of another survivor who washed up on Wraeclast instead of you, and to her, you are dead. All that you accomplish is meaningless. All that Doryani ruined was equally meaningless.

--The Trialmaster, "Doryani" (POE I)



...I'm only a couple of thousand years old. ...

--The Trialmaster, "The Beginning of Time" (POE I)

I knew those of the Djinn well, when I was mortal. Despite that accursed word in their name, *Order*, they did not knowingly answer to a higher Impulse. I found it curious that the vagaries of Fate kept bringing such exceptional individuals together, and for a time, I believed that *I* was exceptional. My hubris was my own undoing, just as it was theirs... several times, in fact. ...

--The Trialmaster, "The Order of the Djinn" (POE I)

How do you know that name? You mock me with remnants of a life long since turned to dust, with freedom and hope that can never be more than scraps of memory. Do not dare to insult me again!

--The Trialmaster, "Ixchel" (POE I)

You are not the only one whose path diverges during moments of chance. My lord Chaos sees all. You experienced victory... as did I. From my perspective, I slew you, then Chaos bid me attend the other possibility. This one.

I continue to serve...

--The Trialmaster, "Defeat" (POE I)

I eagerly await the End in any form, if it exists. It is my only chance of escape... until then, not even death can save me from servitude. I have escaped a thousand different ways, and every time, Chaos just brings me back from the paths in which my escape failed. I need *all* paths to end, if I am ever to rest.

--The Trialmaster, "The End of Time" (POE I)

I should have become a priest of Yaomac instead...

--The Trialmaster, on five or more player wins 9 (POE I)

THE NATURES OF CHAOS & ORDER

Mortals spend their lives wondering which fate shall be theirs. Chaos takes amusement in knowing the answer: all of them.

--Inscribed Ultimatum (POE II)

... Chaos disdains predictability.

--The Trialmaster, on choosing deadly monsters 5 (POE I)

My master is the essence of all that might be. He is the flip of the coin, and he is the roll of the die. Whether you win or lose, his purpose is still served. And yet—your chances can be influenced by your skill, by your intellect, and by your might. That is what fascinates Chaos. Skilled mortals can bend their chances in their own favour, for in the headwinds of the unknown, the arrow of a master falls more assuredly than the arrow of a novice. Show him your mastery, and he will smile upon you. Surprise him with utmost talent, and he may even laugh. Fortune will rain upon those who bring humour to Chaos.

--The Trialmaster, "Chaos" (POE I)

Victory is meaningless, failure will be mocked.

--Ultimatum Scarab of Dueling (POE I)

My lord Chaos has often felt there is a sinister force lurking in the unknown mists of raw Creation that seeks to oppose him. It does not show itself. No, it is a cowardly Impulse, one that subtly tangles the threads of Fate to bring together mortals in each era for the purpose of Order, a cold conflict that has raged eternal - with only one exception.

--The Trialmaster, "The Anathema" (POE I)

Fear that which remains awake when even the gods slumber. Chaos sees what Hinekora cannot, the myriad span of all that has yet to happen. Chaos takes selfish amusement in unlikelyhoods and surprising events. Hinekora serves Order, ensuring that what must happen, happens. Two Impulses, as unlike each other as any twins could ever be, locked in eternal conflict by their very nature...

--Navali, "Chaos" (POE I)

You stink of the meddling Witch of Prophecy. You *must* know that she is a liar. She has no power of prophecy. Her power is only that of memories. She *remembers* what happened, and *only* what happened. She does not see the possibilities—what could be, or could have been, the way my lord Chaos does. Worse still, like all memories—even mine—hers fade with time. Would you entrust your Fate to a senile old woman that can hardly keep herself awake? The very fact that she tells you certain paths lead to doom means *they happened*. Those paths *did* lead to doom. Her prophecies are nothing more than painful memories of all the times she failed. What makes this go around the mad wheel any different? Chaos promises nothing, only the truth: today is not special. *You* are not special, unless you make yourself so. In that truth, there is utmost freedom.

--The Trialmaster, "Hinekora" (POE I)

It is not so simple a thing to determine whether a being serves Order or Chaos. These two Impulses suffuse all who possess a will of their own—some more than others. This perverse opposition has fueled the inner struggle of living beings since the Beginning of Time, and will continue to do so until its End. However, there is one thing upon which both inclinations agree. In the eyes of Chaos, there can be no amusement or unlikelyhoods in a dead world. And, while such a realm *would* be perfectly Ordered, there would be no one left to enjoy the... supposed fruits of such a domain. I am not certain that Order exists as a thinking being like Chaos does, but the forces that serve both have agreed to a narrow alliance against a rather existential crisis.

We—and I shudder to use that word, *we*—already sacrificed all we had to buy this world one stay of execution. It only cost the lives of my entire people, and everything they ever built. The decaying temples and cities of the Vaal Empire are not rotting monuments to hubris. They are a legacy, a silent reminder of what was given so that the other peoples of Wraecclast might survive. What will *you* sacrifice when the moment comes?

--The Trialmaster, "Exception" (POE I)

Ah... best you don't know. You'll fight on to the bitter end, so long as you never realise the truth. Who knows? You might even win. Out of all the countless possibilities, it *has* happened... once. All it took was the death of Truth itself; the creation of a world of perfect Order, with no free will, and no Chaos. Needless to say, that route to survival is... unacceptable, both to my master, and to mortals such as yourself. It will not be repeated... hopefully.

--The Trialmaster, "Existential Crisis" (POE I)

All your tomorrows lie ahead of you, unknown and snarled to the very last.

--Gamblesprint Hydrascale Boots (POE I)

THE REIGN OF QUEEN ATZIRI (?-400 BIC)

How do I even begin to describe the last Queen of the Vaal? She left a tremendous mark on history. She was intelligent and capable enough to rule unquestioned over a bloodthirsty empire of volatile nobles, and the people adored her and feared her in equal measure.

Vaal writings speak of her as the most beautiful woman of the era, but also the most dangerous. She sought eternal life, and she was willing to sacrifice *anything* to achieve it. ...

--Alva Valai, "Atziri" (POE II)

Book 1: Last of the Vaal Queens

It has been written of Queen Atziri that her throne room was lined with mirrors and that she held court naked, demanding the same of those wishing her audience. The theory was that a naked man had nothing to hide, but one might easily venture that Atziri utilised her striking physical presence to influence courtly engagements in her favour.

A woman like Atziri, beautiful and naked, would be very difficult to refuse. The few statuettes and reliefs that remain depict her as a rare beauty, a young woman with exquisitely delicate features, large, mesmerizing eyes, and a full figure of intoxicating sensuality. Whether the depictions are realist or interpretive is unfortunately impossible to corroborate.

But who was the woman behind the title? The few surviving accounts on this matter contain two schools of thought on the



matter. Some speak of Atziri with adoration, touting her as a visionary, the woman who would lead the Vaal into a brighter future. Others are less kind, suggesting that Atziri's love for herself overshadowed any love for her people. If her court of mirrors truly existed, however, then the latter seems more likely. Vanity, after all, is the most insidious of all Sins.

Only one thing can be said for certain of Atziri: she was the last Queen of the Vaal. The trail of history ends during her reign, some four hundred years preceding the Imperialus Conceptus.

-Trinian - Intellectus Prime

--The Ancients (POE I)

Behold my glory, and be awed! I am your Queen, and you live to serve me. Never forget this, and you shall walk in the light that shines from within all Vaal.

--Atziri, Atziri's Glory (POE II)

Atziri is beautiful, as most women are, in their own ways. Her aura of dominance stems from a very different source... her callousness. Your desires do not matter to her. You could serve her faithfully for decades, and she would still cast you out the moment you displease her.

Such behavior builds a society of desperate servile worms. Lies become truth, and cowardice is rewarded. Over time, that kind of environment twists you, warps you. Breaks your spirit.

--Doryani, "Atziri's Beauty" (POE II)

Such was her seductive power, every noble in the court fell over themselves to do her bidding. Winning a single glance away from her mirror meant more than their lives.

--Atziri's Allure (POE II)

... During me time on the sea, I heard tale of Queen Atziri and her penchant fer using [Oriath] as a kinda vault for all her special shinies.

One such shiny be her famed love potion - s'posed to attract the drinker's ideal mate to their loins, even if that mate be far across the sea. Ol' Queen Atziri kept the liquid in the skull of her favourite lover. ...

--Weylam Roth, "Elixir of Allure" (POE I)

Famous for her many lovers, those that did not come willing to Atziri, came by liquid persuasion.

--Elixir of Allure (POE I)

Atziri, Atziri, ek te mucane Vaal!
Teoyuxtlane ascensionada! Teoyuxtlane Yutsal!
Atziri, Atziri, ma kilya Zerphi!
Ti itsok anab nochira! Kextal xi kujkuali ik'bala!
Atziri, Atziri, ikba'yucane Vaal!
A'te 'Ibil tlayeb kutsen! A'te ik'el tlayeb kifba!
Atziri, Atziri, ascenada akal!
Aiokmo til xu'te! Aiokmo tul jare elba!

--Vaal sermon at Aggorat (POE II)

KISHARA & THE STAR

...Kishara, a tough-as-nails Vaal lassie said to have explored every coast, cove and bay of this blasted continent with the help of her Star, some nifty artefact she nabbed from somewhere on her first voyage. ... Said to be fair humming with thaumaturgy, able to guide its mistress wherever she be fixing to journey. ...

--Weylam Roth, "Kishara's Star" (POE I)

Alva: ...Kishara, the greatest treasure hunter of the ancient world! ...

Ranger: Never heard of her.

Alva: Kishara, the Southern Star? The Wayward Gull? Her seventeen children founded the Brinerot pirate band?

Ranger: Still haven't—wait, *seventeen*? How? When did she even have time?

Alva: She was renowned for manning the helm while pregnant, and giving birth during battles.

Ranger: *Battles*? It happened multiple times? ...

Alva: Popular writings claimed she sailed all the way to Middengard on her last voyage. Supposedly, Queen Atziri didn't like all the attention Kishara was getting, so she impounded everything she brought back and executed her crew...

--Alva Valai, "Kishara's Spoils" (Ranger version) (POE II)

The Ezomytes have a song about her visit to Phaaryl...

--Warrior, to Alva on Kishara's Spoils (POE II)

I was taught that Kishara was captain of a Maraketh merchant vessel. You're saying she was Vaal?

--Sorceress, to Alva on Kishara's Spoils (POE II)

Aye. My memory's faint, but... I believe she visited the Wildwood to trade, when I was still a young buck. Lively one, she was.

--Druid, to Alva on Kishara's Spoils (POE II)

Heh heh. The Brinerot sure tell some lurid tales o' her.

--Mercenary, to Alva on Kishara's Spoils (POE II)

Legend has it, Kishara got herself in some hot water with a certain Queen Atziri. Details are vague as to exactly how, but by all accounts, Atziri weren't the most understanding of lasses. Kishara, being the free spirited sort probably just pricked the royal arse with some spiky facts from the outside world. Almost lost her head for her trouble, Kishara. Atziri took her ship and made sacrifices of her crew. Forced the poor girlie into hiding.

Still, Kishara being of a wily inclination like meself, she slipped through Atziri's talons and right out of the empire. But before she left, Kishara hid the Star somewhere near the Causeway that leads into the old Vaal city up north, just in case she got caught, I suppose. Something like that in the hands of a tyrant like Atziri... who knows what trouble she might've found with it.

--Weylam Roth, "Kishara" (POE I)

DORYANI, THE QUEEN'S THAUMATURGIST

In my dream, a voice spoke to me. It said: 'My reach knows no bounds. All that is pure is destined to rot. All that lives is destined to serve.'

- Doryani, Queen's Thaumaturgist

--Blood of Corruption Amber Amulet (POE I)

Doryani stumbled into a realm of madness and awoke its Master.

--Dream Fragments Sapphire Ring (POE I)

...Doryani was...the foremost expert on the Beast that ever lived...

--The Hooded One, "Doryani's Capture" (POE II)

Study of the Beast was my life's work, and the work of many Vaal scientists before me. Despite its danger, I still consider it a thing of beauty. A work of genius. It is capable of changing something fundamental about the nature of our existence.

The Beast showed us it *can be done*. Our experiments with life... with death... with machinery, and augmentation... they were all inspired by it. We *can* surpass the impossible, if only we are willing to sacrifice enough.

--Doryani, "The Beast" (POE II)

... I have divined one weak point in the Beast's flank, an ancient wound wrought by that Vaalish overreacher, Doryani. ...

--Sin, "The Dark Ember" (POE I)

I gathered the greatest minds of our era in one place. We embarked on journeys of discovery that mankind could never before conceive. No ethical bounds. No moral limits!

We sought immortality, both in flesh, and in machinery. We sought understanding of Corruption. We even sought to master Time itself. ...

--Doryani, "Utzaal" (POE II)

Look around you. This is the height of progress. Our civilisation was built on the channeling and control of Corruption...

--Doryani, "Locus of Corruption" (POE II)

... Another prototype Solar Nexus. My attempt to steer our civilisation away from reliance on Corruption. ...

I envisioned a future run on this power. Clean, safe, eternal. No mutations. No madness. ...

For centuries, our greatest minds worked to channel Corruption more efficiently, more safely. They did make great strides, but it could never be truly mastered. In the end, we were all fools. Them, for their adherence to old ways, and me, for believing I could... change anything. ...

--Doryani, "Solar Nexus" (POE II)

By their final days, the Vaal were a deeply tiered empire based on brutal competition. Those at the top vied with each



other through any means necessary, and Doryani was the foremost among these ambitious and amoral men.

He was second only to Queen Atziri herself. Utzaal was the seat of his power, and ancient writings claim he undertook a vast array of strange projects and sordid experiments here... Some glyphs I have seen are too stomach-turning to discuss.

--Alva Valai, "Doryani" (POE II)

Vaal scientists were endlessly curious. Stone and technology were not their only explorations. They also delved into the secrets of living flesh, often finding ways to combine animals in unexpected ways to produce ferocious results. The most successful experiments were augmented with stone technology and used as guards.

--The Art of Path of Exile II, "Vaal Experiments" (POE II)

Vaal experimentation with flesh did not stop at animals. Near the end of their civilisation, the human form became as clay to the boldest, and blood became their ink. They altered their own forms in pursuit of beauty and perfection, losing all perspective on what it even meant to be human.

--The Art of Path of Exile II, "Blood Bathers" (POE II)

THE TEMPLE OF ATZOATL

The Architect of the Nexus proposed the Temple of Atzoatl as a prototype. He thought the project would keep him safe. Instead, all he achieved was building her another seat of power.

--Quipolatl's Medallion (POE II)



Grand plans were laid for a place called Atzoatl, though fierce bickering between its Architects is said to have stifled its development.

- Icius Perandus, Antiquities Collection, Research Report

--Chronicle of Atzoatl, default (POE I)

Built at the height of the...Vaal Empire, the Temple of Atzoatl holds stores of untold wealth and the population of a small city. ...

--<https://www.pathofexile.com/incursion>, "The Temple of Atzoatl" (POE I)

The lost Temple of Atzoatl is said to be the most famed in all Vaal history and myth. Best I can tell, the Temple began its construction in the final years of the Vaal Empire. The exact date of its completion has been hard to ascertain as it occurred shortly before the events which brought about the civilisation's extinction.

Perhaps it is this fragility of the timeline that has made Atzoatl such a staple of Vaal mythology. Some say it was a place of darkness, home to the most vile of sacrifices. But there are others who claim the temple to be the birthplace of technology - even our own is said to pale in comparison to what was being forged within those walls.

Scholars today have even suggested that it was the treasure house for Queen Atziri herself. Whichever is true, it was bound to have been fiercely protected by fanatics and royalty alike. And if something's worth protecting, well, then it's worth bloody taking!

--Alva Valai, "Atzoatl" (POE I)

Their engineering knowledge may have rivaled that of the modern world. The fall of the Vaal no doubt set humanity back a thousand years.

- Icius Perandus, Antiquities Collection, Ancient Gear Interlock

--Chronicle of Atzoatl with Factory (POE I)

Atzoatl was a locus of Corruption, a temple dedicated to the worship of the unspeakable.

- Icius Perandus, Antiquities Collection, Eroded Vaal Orb

--Chronicle of Atzoatl with Locus of Corruption (POE I)

When the Vaal discovered power could be gained from sacrificing the living, Atzoatl became a death march for the lower classes.

- Icius Perandus, Antiquities Collection, Obsidian Sacrificial Knife

--Chronicle of Atzoatl with Apex of Ascension (POE I)

Doryani himself conducted gem research at Atzoatl in its final days. What brilliant discoveries were lost with that temple?



- Icius Perandus, Antiquities Collection, Third Ciphared Tablet

--Chronicle of Atzoatl with Doryani's Institute (POE I)

Evidence suggests that Atzoatl's influence grew great enough that Atziri herself moved her seat of power to within its walls.

- Icius Perandus, Antiquities Collection, Royal Decree cast in Bronze

--Chronicle of Atzoatl with Throne of Atziri (POE I)

The Architects sought immortality... perhaps they reside within Atzoatl still...

- Icius Perandus, Antiquities Collection, Vial of Emerald Water

--Chronicle of Atzoatl with Sanctum of Immortality (POE I)

They met in secret to plan aspirations beyond all others. Their grand dreams slowly turned into endless nightmares.

--Grand Dreams Vaal Side Area (POE I)

THE DEMON OF ATZOATL

"A great many warriors were stationed at Atzoatl, ostensibly due to repeated invasion by something referred to as 'a haunting death.'"

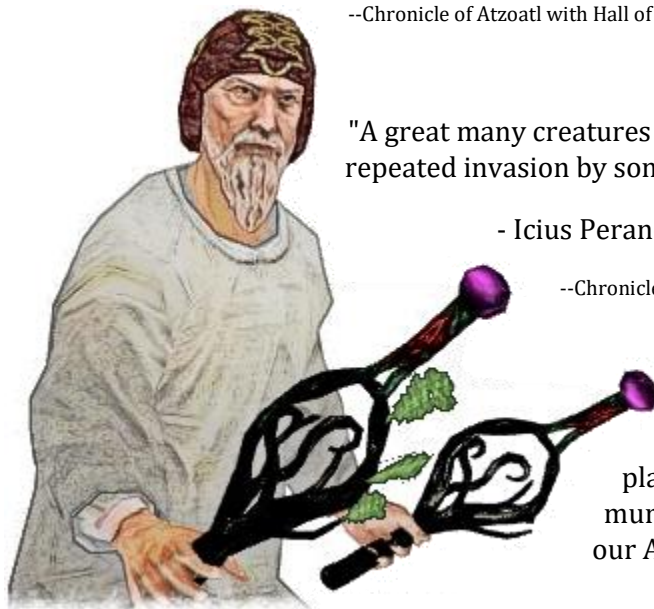
- Icius Perandus, Antiquities Collection, Carved Interment Records

--Chronicle of Atzoatl with Hall of War (POE I)

"A great many creatures were bred at Atzoatl, ostensibly due to repeated invasion by some kind of horrifying murderous entity."

- Icius Perandus, Antiquities Collection, Fossilized Egg Sac

--Chronicle of Atzoatl with Hybridisation Chamber (POE I)



... it's hard to explain. During its construction, our Temple of Atzoatl was plagued by an impossible, elusive, rampaging murderer who appeared at random to assassinate our Architects. Then, when it was completed, they

showed up one last time, to slaughter everyone inside and loot everything it contained.

The Demon's appearance changed often, but their companion's did not. I now know her to be... Alva Valai. We did determine that the pair were coming from the future, but we could never have guessed how far. It's still unclear when those events are meant to happen... for her.

Also... *why*? Why will she go back and aid a rampage through Atzoatl? Actually, maybe that one's obvious.

--Doryani, "The Demon of Atzoatl" (POE II)

LIRA VAAL

The palace of Lira Vaal shall not suffer the same fate as Atzoatl!

--Xipocado, at start of fight 2 (POE II)

This is Lira Vaal, once the capital of the empire! And *that* is the Royal Temple, home to Queen Atziri in her final days...

--Alva Valai, "First Impression" (POE II)

Alva: This was the capital of the Vaal Empire for much of its history, but some sort of... incident... burned much of it down. After that, Azala Vaal became the seat of power, until Queen Atziri returned the royal court to Lira Vaal and rebuilt it.

Sorceress: An *incident*? Lira Vaal was set ablaze by Orbala herself, on her second adventure. Unintentionally.

Alva: Is that so? I've been meaning to learn more about Maraketh history. Vaal accounts of the incident gloss over the details.

Sorceress: As expected.

--Alva Valai, "Lira Vaal" (Sorceress version) (POE II)

Lira Vaal was the ruling capital of the Vaal Empire for many centuries, but it had fallen into disuse. Xipocado restored it. Rebuilt it. Turned it into a modern wonder. I helped him build many of the mechanisms... I had to, if I was to keep my head.

--Doryani, "The Shifting Temple" (POE II)

Our gods abandoned us long ago. Now, we live in a forsaken time... in a world gone mad.

Atziri is a capricious Queen, prone to using her power to randomly punish or reward those who dare come to her attention. I once said this to her face, when I could no longer contain myself. After the words escaped me, I expected torture and... a deserved death.

But to my surprise, instead, she laughed darkly, and named me her personal Architect... it was then that she knew... I was hers.

What better goddess could we ask for? This is the purpose of a divine leader, to serve as a symbol of fear and adulation. Will she lift you up for your adoration? Or cast you down for your insolence? That uncertainty is the source of her power.

She will shape our future around her. She is the hope of our people to stand against the ravages of time! The Empire will live on forever, a monolith, held strong as stone by the terror in our hearts!

--Xipocado, The Forever Queen (POE II)

Alva: The legends differ on the source of the wealth. Some say she demanded tribute from all over the Empire. Some say suitors and powerseekers simply gifted it to her in vast caravans.

Druid: Why? What did they hope to gain?

Alva: Her favour. Their lives. Supposedly, in many cases, simple acknowledgement. They were that desperate for her approval.

Druid: When folk surrender their will to another, such madness marks the end. I know it all too well.

Alva: Yes... we have the benefit of history, but they couldn't see it...

--Alva Valai, "Lira Vaal" (Druid version) (POE II)

Wealthy Maraketh merchants did send caravans to curry favour.

--Alva Valai, "Lira Vaal" (Sorceress version) (POE II)



THE FALL (400 BIC)

At their height, the Vaal glittered under the sun. A decade, a century, an aeon of prosperity... now nothing more than a passing wonder.

--The Adorned Crimson Jewel (POE I)

ZERPHI, DORYANI, & THE PURSUIT OF IMMORTALITY

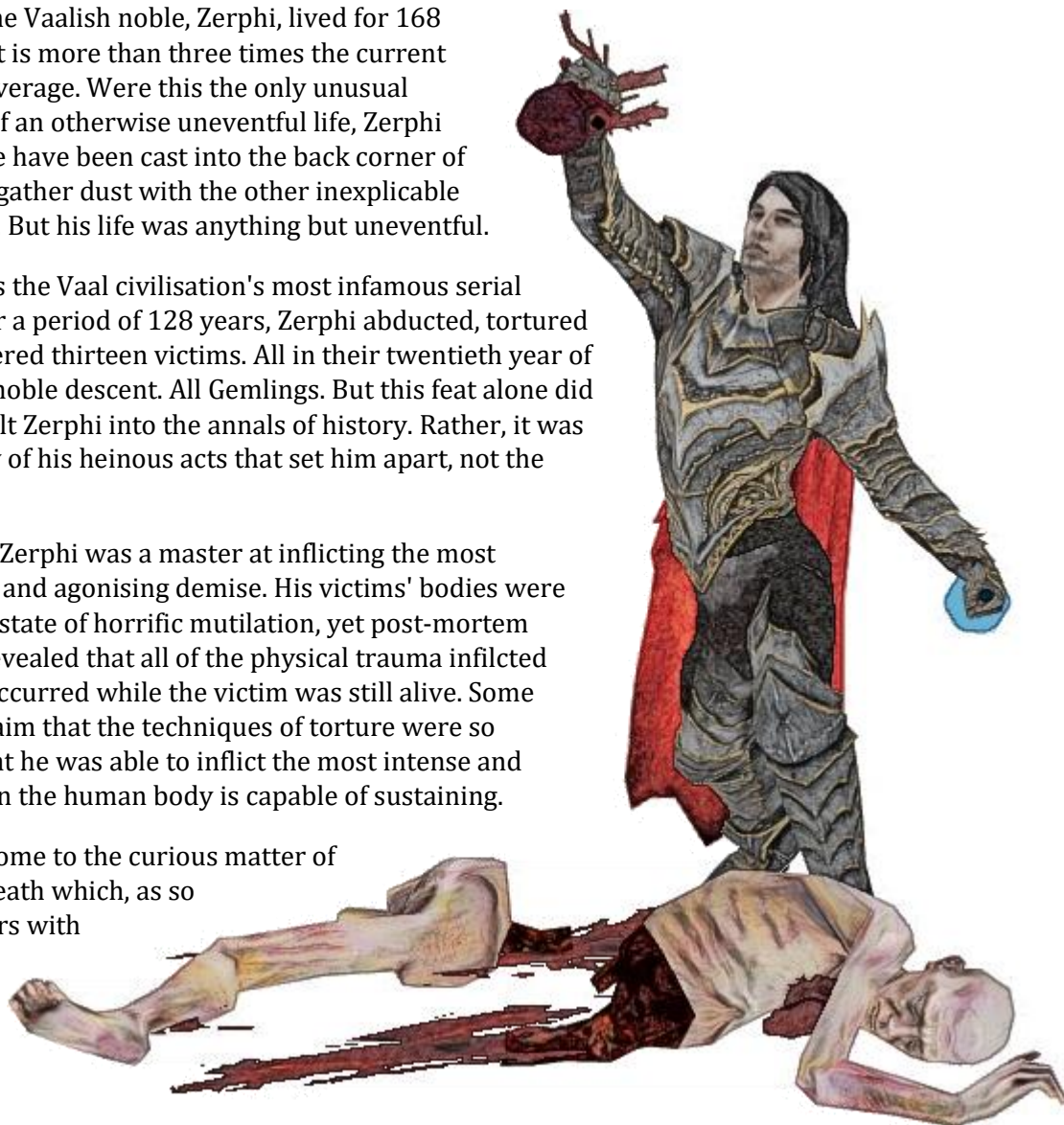
Book 2: Zerphi the Murderer

It is said the Vaalish noble, Zerphi, lived for 168 years. That is more than three times the current imperial average. Were this the only unusual attribute of an otherwise uneventful life, Zerphi might have been cast into the back corner of history to gather dust with the other inexplicable anomalies. But his life was anything but uneventful.

Zerphi was the Vaal civilisation's most infamous serial killer. Over a period of 128 years, Zerphi abducted, tortured and murdered thirteen victims. All in their twentieth year of life. All of noble descent. All Gemlings. But this feat alone did not catapult Zerphi into the annals of history. Rather, it was the quality of his heinous acts that set him apart, not the quantity.

Evidently, Zerphi was a master at inflicting the most prolonged and agonising demise. His victims' bodies were found in a state of horrific mutilation, yet post-mortem analysis revealed that all of the physical trauma inflicted [sic] had occurred while the victim was still alive. Some sources claim that the techniques of torture were so refined that he was able to inflict the most intense and lasting pain the human body is capable of sustaining.

Then we come to the curious matter of Zerphi's death which, as so often occurs with historical



investigation, brings us back to where we started. Zerphi was finally found at the side of his thirteenth and final victim, who was unmolested and unmutilated. Simply dead. When the centenarian's body was committed to autopsy, the recorded results are mystifying in the extreme. It is claimed that Zerphi did not possess the body of a 168-year-old, rather that his corpse had the physiognomy of a man of twenty years, no more.

Life and Death have walked hand in hand since the beginning of Time. Could Zephri [sic] have persuaded them to kiss?

- *Trinian - Intellectus Prime*

--The Ancients (POE I)

"The process of eternal youth is a give and take. You give them death and take their youth."

- Zerphi of the Vaal

--The Life Thief (POE I)

Book 3: The Queen's Thaumaturgist

In a culture festooned with gems and steeped in thaumaturgy, Doryani must have had quite the exceptional mind to rise to such preeminence as he did. Or perhaps he was simply more ruthless than his counterparts. Such is the impression one tends to garner from the accounts written of events following Zerphi's death.

Atziri's orders are quoted in a number of different texts. Doryani was "to make any effort within the realms of possibility, and to act without fear of question or consequence". And to what was Doryani expected to apply this supreme effort? The investigation of Zerphi's longevity and youthful vitality.

There is a particularly chilling manifest, containing endless lists of names, page upon page. The names of young men and women, ranging in age from sixteen to twenty-six, sent to Doryani for "processing". Only those of "full and recent maturity" were deemed capable of accommodating the "necessary procedures" required without succumbing to "premature expiration".

Yes, Queen Atziri was prepared to slaughter her own people in the desperate pursuit of perpetual youth and beauty. Vanity, indeed, is the most insidious of all Sins.

- *Trinian - Intellectus Prime*

--The Ancients (POE I)

... It was said of the beautiful Atziri that she "wished to see her likeness reflected in the still waters of history." ...

--Siosa, "Malachai" (POE I)

Atziri went to great lengths to ensure her immortality, but nothing is eternal.

--Atziri's Reign Crimson Jewel (POE I)

Step forth, true believers, unto Atziri's graceful shadow. She alone shall shade you from the pains and ills of this world. By her grace, and hers alone, shall you be given eternal life!

--Rejoice! (POE II)

Sacrifice: it is the most noble, most beautiful act a mortal may perform. It is an act of divinity. To sacrifice is to give yourself to something greater. To sacrifice is to transform the world.

--Atziri, <https://www.pathofexile.com/forum/view-thread/807869> (trailer) (POE I)

They screamed her name in adulation as they gave their very lives. She looked on with impatience.

--Atziri's Disdain Gold Circlet (POE II)

"My people? I'm not doing this for them. They belong to me. They want this for me. Their sacrifice is a gift they give out of love and adoration... I deserve it. I am their Queen."

--Atziri's Contempt Pronged Spear (POE II)

Atziri is my love and my life. I give one so that I might have the other for all eternity.

I was to wither away in darkness. My queen has brought me into the light. I would have lived in ugliness. Now I may die in Beauty.

I am but a crude reflection of our Queen of Endless Beauty. I die today so that all of Vaal may bask in her Radiance tomorrow.

I had nothing. I was nothing. I sold my flesh to survive. Today, my flesh belongs to my Queen.

What did I say? What did I do? I flattered, I promised, I bared my skin and soul to my beloved Atziri. I did everything but offer to die for her. Is that where I went wrong?

Our Queen has demanded we look into the gems for our salvation. We see ourselves reflected in those facets, twisted beyond recognition.

A ring. Plated, not even solid silver. That's all I took. Now I'm stuffed full of gems and destined for the block. For palming a wretched, half-crown ring.

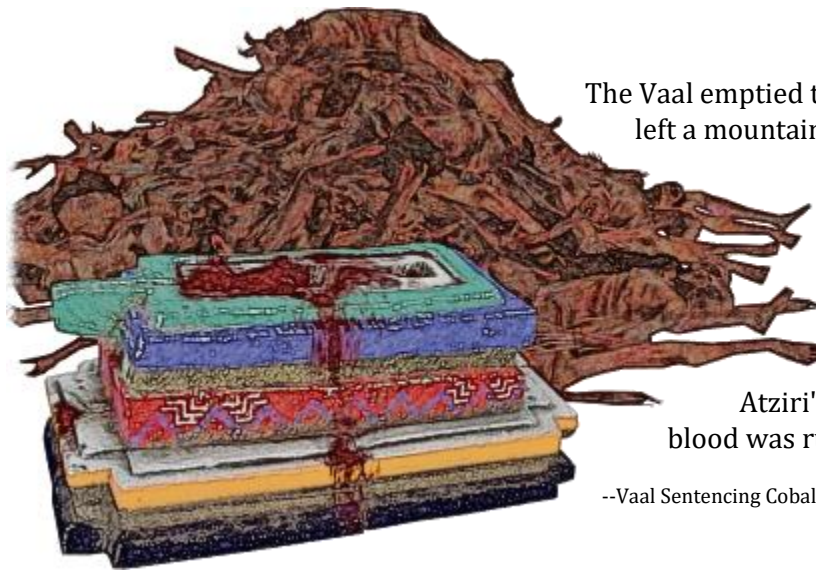
There was no escape for me. Should our Queen and her thaumaturge succeed, there will be no escape for anyone.

For seven years I advised. For seven years she listened. Today, she would not. Now my blood will be but another drop in an ocean that will drown this land.

Atziri promises us eternal life. The only eternity we shall have is in the memories of the barbarians that shall plant their crops on our graves.

Queen Atziri forfeited her sovereignty the day that she chose to murder her people.

--Vaal Letters 1-4 & 6-12 (POE I)



The Vaal emptied their slaves of beating hearts, and left a mountain of twitching dead.

--Rathpith Globe Titanium Spirit Shield (POE I)

In their final days, every crime was punishable by death.

Atziri's empire ran on blood, but the blood was running dry.

--Vaal Sentencing Cobalt Jewel (POE I)

For a time, the Queen's interests aligned with my own. She sought immortality, and so did I... for different ends...

--Doryani, "The Eztli Pilli" (POE II)

... The Eztli Pilli was already many centuries old when it passed to me. It contains all the knowledge possibly related to immortality we possess, both from our own civilisation, and... others. ...

The Vaal developed the ability to implant souls into crystals based on ancient necromantic artifacts found deep underground. Our sophisticated golems stemmed from study of the Primevals, who once lived in the same regions we do. Blood thaumaturgy, however... that was us. Our unique contribution to science.

Everything we deemed too volatile, dangerous, or useless, we sealed away in the Eztli Pilli, guarded by eighty-seven traps. ...

--Doryani, "The Eztli Pilli" (POE II)

SOUL CORES

The greatest civilisation to ever grace Wraeclast, at least in their own estimation, the Vaal once populated cities across the continent. By their height, they were employing sophisticated technologies based on animated stone and engraved power currents sourced from manufactured crystals called Soul Cores.



More colloquially known as blood crystals, Soul Cores were made by sacrificing human beings and trapping their souls within. At first, the process was reserved as a punishment for heinous crimes, but as the Vaal society grew reliant on technology, demand increased. Eventually the Empire found itself suffering a population problem, as more and more people were sacrificed to fuel machines. ...

--The Art of Path of Exile II, "Act III - The Vaal Empire" (POE II)

Near the end of their civilisation, the Vaal tried to combat a worsening labour shortage - by sacrificing their own citizens to power constructs. Designed to till the fields, mine the quarries and the like - they were quite a marvel.

As it turns out, human souls don't make for a very sustainable fuel source... And so began their downward spiral. Rather silly for such an intellectual people, wouldn't you say?

--Alva Valai, "The Stone Men" (POE II)



One of the most notorious criminals ever placed into a Soul Core, Blackjaw sparked the first rumors that those who were sacrificed remained aware inside their imprisoning blood crystals. The construct powered by his Soul Core was excessively violent when given the chance and seemed to display anger when in combat. The Vaal considered this a plus, and set him to guard the Machinarium where Cores were manufactured.

--The Art of Path of Exile II, "Blackjaw" (POE II)

Death gems, blood crystals... or more colloquially, 'Soul Cores'. They were made by sacrificing living people and capturing their energies inside a crystal lattice.

Some think the victims are still trapped inside, existing in eternal agony until someone drains the core's energy completely.

There's no way to know that for certain, of course, but it's rather chilling to think about...

--Alva Valai, "Soul Cores" (POE II)

Look for a red crystal a bit bigger than your fist. It should be warm to the touch... Why, you ask? That'd be the soul trapped inside.

--Alva Valai, "Small Soul Core" (POE II)

Heat emanates from the facets, living warmth encased in crystal.

--Large Soul Core (POE II)

... There is no way to measure the level of awareness possessed by those trapped in Soul Cores... But I am reasonably certain it is not zero. ...

It is a kind of immortality, yes, but not the kind sought by the sane. ...

Eventually, the crystal will degrade. ...

--Doryani, "Grand Phylactory" (POE II)

Somewhere, a distant scream echoes.

--Medium Soul Core (POE II)

DEFIANCE & CONTINGENCIES

I argued with Xipocado for years. Pleaded with him, at times. He knew she was dangerous, and that her communion with the Beast might be the death of us. ...

My attempts only made him proclaim his loyalty all the more.

That is Atziri's power over others... she sticks the knife of her beauty into their gut, and twists it for years. But she never gives them the sweet release of acceptance... or rejection. They increasingly bend to her every whim, trying to please her, desperate for acknowledgement or validation. It excuses nothing. In the end, he made his choice.

--Doryani, "Xipocado" (POE II)

Once again, Doryani and I argued over the consequences of the Red Communion. I suspect him. I believe he is moving against the Queen. I would inform her and have him tortured... but the other Architects would not support me in this. I will wait until I have proof.

Perhaps his intellect will triumph over his emotions. We have all worked our entire lives to make this possible. The greatest minds humanity has ever known carried us this far, and they will carry us forward.

The Vaal Empire will not fall. Atziri *will* ascend, and transfigure life as we know it. This much is certain.

--Xipocado, Disloyalty (POE II)

Over and over... I pore over my designs constantly... I know Doryani, or his proxies, will try to stop Atziri's Ascension. Fools! I've calculated every result, every possible nuance... my perfect mechanism is not *one* design. It is a living machine, a temple construct, that can modify its internal structure to change and adapt.

History will show... *I* am the greatest genius of the Vaal, not you, *old friend*...

--Xipocado, The Perfect Design (POE II)

ASSASSINATION ATTEMPTS

He almost saved the Vaal. His unique poison made it past the Queen's cupbearers; he had only to direct his anger... but in her presence, he could feel naught but lust.

--Tacati's Ire (POE II)

The Architect of Destruction slipped explosive powder under the royal temple one pinch at a time. For years, he clung to that, never finding the courage to light it.

--Hayoxi's Fulmination (POE II)

The Architect of Destruction ensured his own demise in an 'accidental' explosion. She ordered his pieces gathered, his body reassembled and transcended. Death was no escape.

--Hayoxi's Medallion (POE II)

I should have drawn the last breath from him. Yet all I did was draw his blood. Doryani will take my head in the morning and I have my shaking hands to thank for it.

--Vaal Letter 5 (POE I)

SOUL CORES

Seventy-four shipments of Soul Cores in the span of three moons. Seventy-four shipments... and it still won't be enough, if our fears become realized.

We have put our lives on the line because Doryani asked us to do so. I accept this and... I am not a traitor to the Queen, but, sometimes, loyalty requires protecting her from her own mistakes.

We need more time. We just need more time!

--Jiquani's Frustration (POE II)

I do know a way out. If we fail, and the Empire falls, I have one last resort. I fear it, but it is my last hope.

We imprisoned Ichlotl the Blackjaw in a Soul Core, alone, for his crimes. Isolated like that, without any other souls in the lattice, his stone form seemed to retain much of his personality. Do I dare drain my own lifeblood into something we used as a punishment worse than death?

We have toiled so long to defeat death, all I know now is fear... if the sky turns to blood, if flames consume Utzaal, only then will I decide.

--Jiquani's Ruminations (POE II)

"I have risked everything. My position, my ambition, my very life. There has to be a way to save our people. If we must, let us tear apart the very foundations of reality!"

--Jiquani's Potential Imperial Staff (POE I)

TIME TRAVEL

It's hard to guess what the device inside the Temple might be. I do know that it was commissioned by Queen Atziri's Thaumaturge, Doryani himself. The project was given all the resources it needed, and the work was kept secret, even from Atziri.

As best as I could translate, they claimed using it might mean 'abandoning all they had built'. They seemed to view it as a last resort, a way to save their legacy if all else failed... It's not often I detect fear in Vaal writings, but they definitely hoped they would never have to use it.

--Alva Valai, "The Device" (POE II)

Ugh, time travel gives me a headache. I'm trying to understand. Vaal priests built a gateway to their future to escape a coming catastrophe. That I can see. They needed someone with Vaal blood to activate the gateway on the other end... the other end being now. Our time.

Why didn't they just activate it themselves back then, so that it would still be active now? And isn't needing someone with Vaal blood on this end a critical flaw, given that they were trying to escape a disaster they feared might wipe out their people?

Does time pass equally on both ends? Is a day here a day there? What happens when their side has been open long enough for it to be now there, but the far future here?

Ugh, I'm probably overthinking this...

--Oswald, "Time Travel" (POE II)

THE CUACHIC VAULT

In my youth, all I wanted was power. I was the smartest. The sharpest. I rose to prominence on sheer force of will.

Once I became the right hand of Queen Atziri, I realised that the system of merit I believed in was an illusion. Knowledge and science were merely ruthless tools for the nobles in their mad quest for eternal dominion. I had no *power*. I was a slave.

From then on, I spent every spare moment secretly pursuing ways to save my people. I placated Atziri and the nobles by day, but fought a war against death itself by night. The flesh. The soul. Machinery. Time itself. No possibility was left unexplored. If all else failed... that is what the Cuachic Vault was for.

Should the entire world be ravaged by the Cataclysm, some Vaal would still remain, deep in the most remote mountain. The final and most desperate contingency...

--Doryani, "Contingency" (POE II)

THE RED COMMUNION

The Red Communion was meant to transcend the limits of the soul, to transfigure the flesh, to bestow immortality. It accomplished all of these things... most horribly.

--Atziri's Communion (POE II)

The result of the catalytic reaction would be either immortality for all, or death for all. It was a risk Doryani was willing to take.

--Doryani's Catalyst Vaal Sceptre (POE I)

My word. Vaalish contextualized syntax is a slippery eel indeed. Let me see if I can grab it by the gills...

They carried their virtue gems to..."Doryani's bed"...no, that's not quite right. Ah yes, Doryani's *cradle*. The historian finishes that it was a price they needed to pay to ensure a Vaalish future.

A cradle of virtue gems? What sort of 'Vaalish future' did Doryani hope to ensure?

--Siosa, "Page One Translation" (POE I)

Atziri has long been obsessed with the Beast, ever since I discovered its hiding place in the mountain... She would divert sacrifices to the dig site. Feed subjects to it, just to watch the process. She seemed to believe she was winning its favour, like a master earning the loyalty of a pet. ...

It is alive, but I don't believe it feels the way even basic animals do...

I don't believe it can ever truly be controlled. ...

I found no evidence that the Beast is capable of such a bond. ...

I studied it myself, under the guise of studying it for her. I delayed wherever I could, buying time. But in the end, I was forced to devise the Red Communion. She wouldn't let me return to Utzaal unless I completed its design. ...

History will likely remember me as a monster, but it could not be avoided. ...she had her loyal Architects verify my work. ...

Atziri trusts no one.

--Doryani, "The Cradle" (POE II)

At her behest, I devised everything necessary for the Red Communion. I built the cradle of gems. The systems for Xipocado's temple. The moment itself, however, was far more brutal than I imagined...

--Doryani, "The Red Communion" (POE II)

Splendid. Let's see what this page has to offer us... It talks of Queen Atziri. Now here's a portentous line:

She drenches her alters with the blood of those deranged enough to question her vision.

The next piece is a real eye-crosser, but I believe it refers to a 'communion,' something to do with the harvest moon? Again, Doryani seems at the heart of it.

Good, this line I can read without issue:

This will be our final night of fear, our final night of suffering.

Sacrifice, communion, the harvest moon...an unsettling combination.

--Siosa, "Page Two Translation" (POE I)

Despite all his inventions and all his horrors, there was nothing Doryani could do to stop the end.

--The Black Chambers map pin (completed) (POE II)

... I pleaded with Atziri for her patience... but she would not abide me. She will attempt her communion with the Beast...

--Doryani, "Communion with the Beast" (POE II)

Doryani: Atziri... should you proceed, this means the doom of the Vaal!

Atziri: To doubt your Queen... to... defy her... I never expected it of you, my most loyal pet.

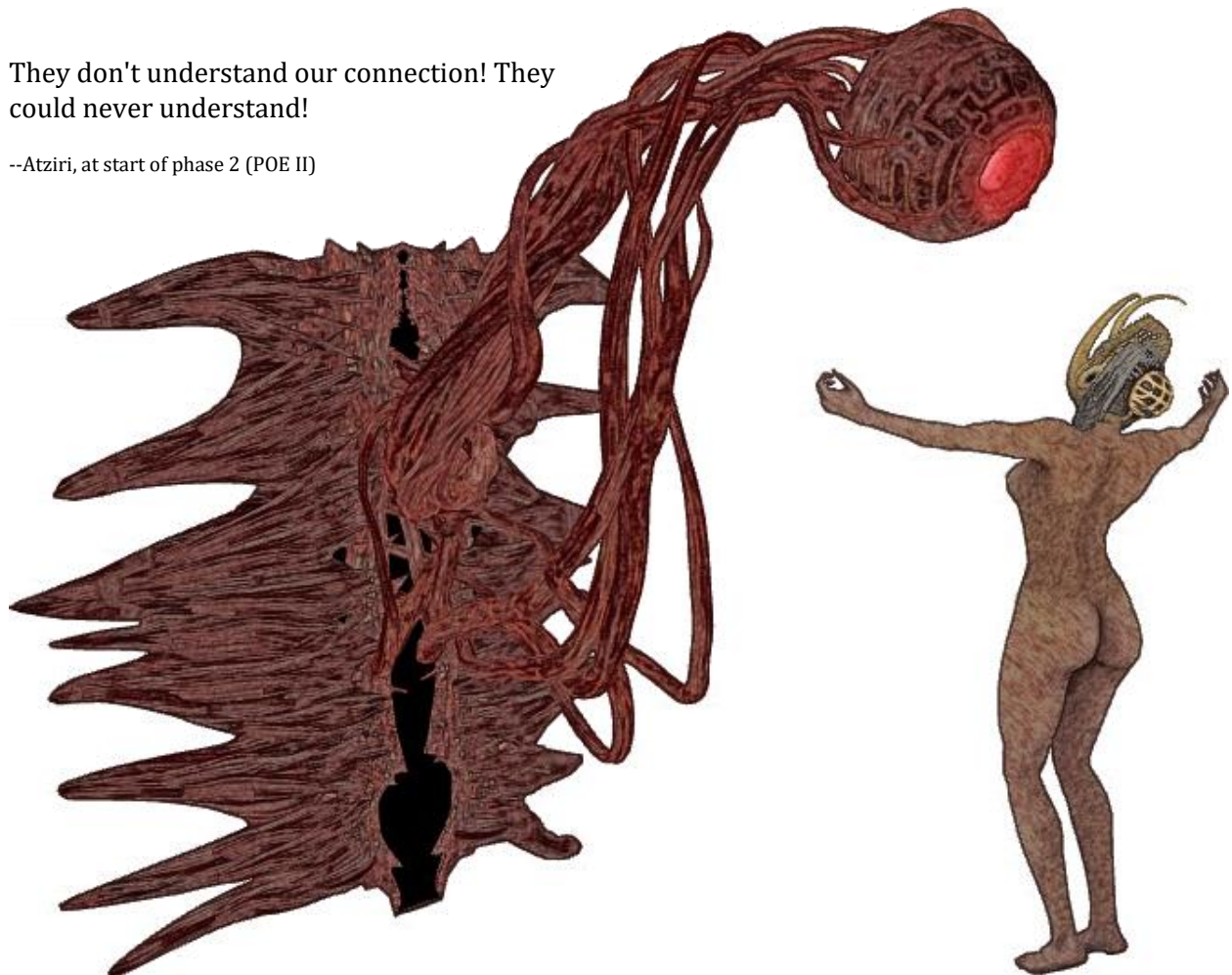
Doryani: I beg of you... hear me! The Beast cannot give you what you desire!

Atziri: You may have studied it, Doryani... but you do not know it like I do. It... adores me. Come now! Give unto me your desire! At last... fulfill my soul!

--Doryani & Atziri, before fight (POE II)

They don't understand our connection! They could never understand!

--Atziri, at start of phase 2 (POE II)



Take me, Pochiti! I am yours! Give me eternity!

--Atziri, on her defeat (POE II)

... My Beast was born to be a thing of beauty. ...

It was only ever defending itself, the fault lies within the twisted hearts of those who would betray their own humanity.

Not even I could anticipate the cataclysms my pet wrought on Wraecclast. ...

--Sin, "Cataclysm" (POE I)

Oh my, this first line is frighteningly clear:

Our Queen is dead. Doryani is dead. So many have fallen. So many have changed.

The latter text is almost indecipherable. It practically hums with agitation. Let me see...I can make out the words "sleep," "nightmare," and..."the Beast," whatever that may be. Our historian finishes with:

We have succeeded where our forebears did not. We have failed ourselves.

I need not imagine the fall of the Vaal. I saw the nightmare with my own eyes.

--Siosa, "Page Three Translation" (POE I)

Alva: In my readings, accounts of the Cataclysm are scattered, as one might expect. Some say it began here. Some say it happened at the mountain we now call Highgate. Supposedly, it had something to do with Atziri's obsession with immortality, but that's all the survivors knew. The Empire died in a single night. Only three thousand, one-hundred, and twenty-six Vaal survived to reach the Azmeri mountains...

Druid: A few escaped to the Wildwood by pure chance... but they didnae last long. It was already too late.

Alva: What happened to them?

Druid: They met a terrible fate.

Alva: Ooh, I want details!

Druid: You'll not get them from me.

--Alva Valai, "The Cataclysm" (Druid version) (POE II)

We knew little of the event itself. From what is told, the sky to the south raged with crimson fire, and the moon turned to blood. Scouts that returned in the following days died soon after telling us the Vaal were simply gone. Their lands became forbidden, and still are today... mostly. We've been dealing with the consequences of Corruption ever since.

--Sorceress, to Alva on The Cataclysm (POE II)

Book 5: The Fall

The Vaal. Thousands of years in the making. Gone in a blink of Solaris' burning eyes. The Azmeri tell of the Vaalish immigration with equal measures of pity and horror. Small bands of tattered, shambling survivors, bereft of their families, their wealth, and in many cases, their sanity. They were welcomed, and cared for, but none could give the Azmeri the one thing they sought in return. None could tell them how the Vaal realm came to such a sudden and catastrophic end. An apocalypse that came to be known as The Fall.

The number 3126 is forever burned into Azmerian history. Three thousand one hundred and twenty-six: the number of Vaal refugees who came to live with and eventually become absorbed into the Azmerian people.

Three thousand one hundred and twenty-six survivors from a civilisation counting in its millions.

- *Trinian - Intellectus Prime*

--The Ancients (POE I)

As the elders tell it, my people were happy to take them in. They'd always been kind to us.

--Huntress, to Alva on The Cataclysm (POE II)

... We—and I shudder to use that word, *we*—already sacrificed all we had to buy this world one stay of execution. It only cost the lives of my entire people, and everything they ever built. The decaying temples and cities of the Vaal Empire are not rotting monuments to hubris. They are a legacy, a silent reminder of what was given so that the other peoples of Wraeclast might survive. What will *you* sacrifice when the moment comes?

--The Trialmaster, "Exception" (POE I)

AFTERMATH

THE FATES OF DORYANI & ATZIRI

... Doryani is missing...

--Hinekora, 7 (POE I)

History says Doryani disappeared just before the Cataclysm. Now we know why—he came with us to the present. It seems the choice has already been made.

--Alva Valai, on Doryani (POE II)

That was... I thought I knew what to expect, but I could never have guessed how brutal the Red Communion would truly be...

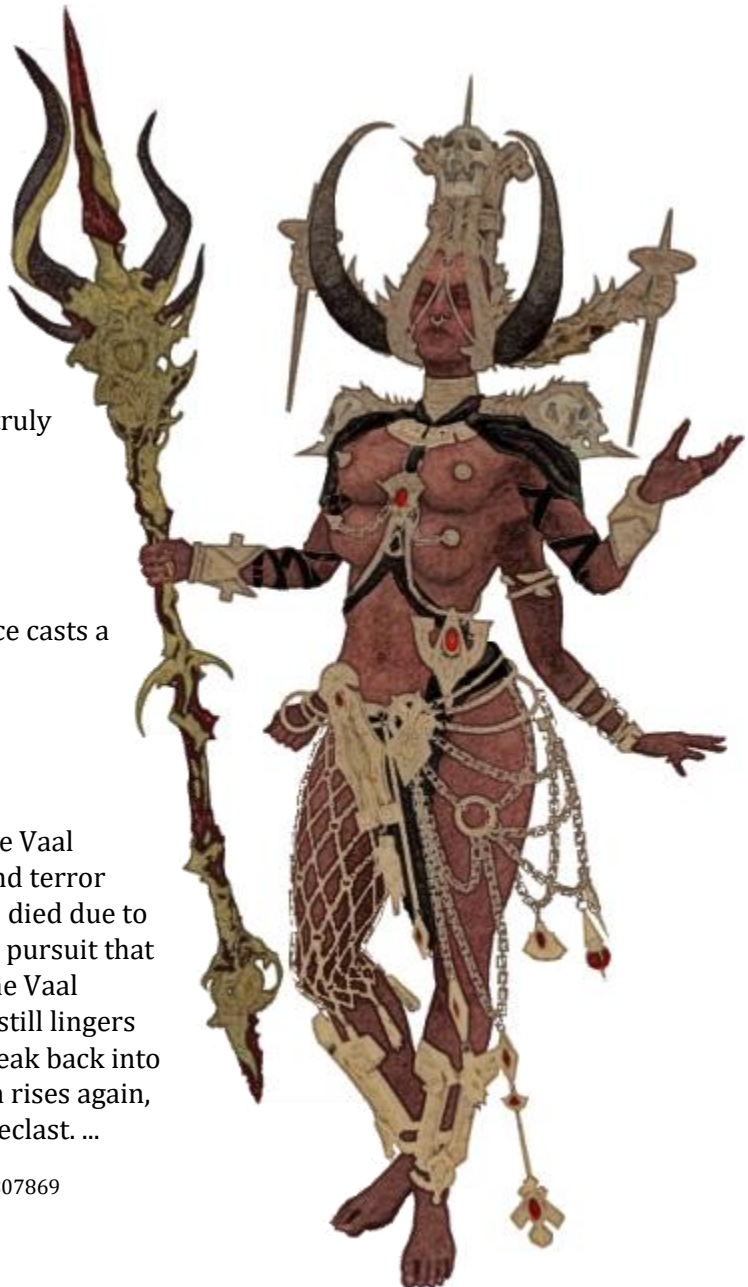
--Doryani, "The Cataclysm" (POE II)

Even a millennium later, Atziri's presence casts a shroud over Wraeclast.

--Chill of Corruption Viridian Jewel (POE I)

The narcissistic Queen Atziri plunged the Vaal civilisation into a dark age of sacrifice and terror almost two thousand years ago. Millions died due to her obsessive pursuit of eternal youth, a pursuit that brought about a cataclysm that ended the Vaal civilisation overnight. But Atziri herself still lingers in a nightmare realm that is starting to leak back into the land of Wraeclast. Now, as the queen rises again, her corruption spreads throughout Wraeclast. ...

--<https://www.pathofexile.com/forum/view-thread/807869>



In their crimson nightmare, the Vaal are still sacrificing themselves to her glory and beauty.

They stab their own hearts and cry out in ecstasy, only to rise again.

--The Queen's Hunger Vaal Regalia (POE I)

The Queen represents an odd island of stability that Chaos cannot comprehend. Almost all events come laden with possibility, but the history of her existence is a single unbroken course. There is no world, real or imagined, where Atziri did not lead our people to ruin.

She gazes into a mirror still, somewhere beyond the reach of my master, in a place of crimson madness and nightmare... my master adores the uncertainty of chance outcomes, but he abhors cosmic enigmas with no clear answer, especially when such enigmas seem to possess the power to impress determinism upon the fabric of existence.

--The Trialmaster, "Atziri" (POE I)

In every possibility, in every world that might have been, Queen Atziri's mark on history was the one thing that never changed.

--Bane of Chaos Vaal Side Area (POE I)

THE FATE OF UTZAAL: THE CENOBITES AND ANCHORITES

Those citizens of the Vaal Empire that thought they survived the Cataclysm soon realised that they had, in fact, done no such thing.

--Endless Nightmare Vaal Side Area (POE I)

...the Temple of the Sun God, one of the oldest built in the city of Utzaal's religious district. It was in active use for at least a thousand years, but when the Vaal Cataclysm struck, the city flooded, presumably killing everyone inside. ...

--Oswald, "Ziggurat Encampment" (POE II)

From my understanding, it was a failsafe. A way to make sure their creations didn't get the better of them... Or the world. The Vaal really were a very intelligent and pragmatic people, you know. ...

--Alva Valai, "The Spillways" (POE II)

The Sunken City of Utzaal was once a thriving metropolis that served as the intellectual heart of the empire. Most of the Vaal's scientists lived there, including the greatest thaumaturge of the age, Doryani. When The Cataclysm occurred, the nobles gave the order to flood the city. Whether it was intended to be a mercy for a doomed populace, or a spiteful effort to deny would-be looters, none can know. Due to its flooding, Utzaal remains as the last intact Vaal ruin, still hiding the secret knowledge of the Vaal Empire's greatest minds.

--The Art of Path of Exile II, "Utzaal" (POE II)

When the city flooded, the peasants fled quickly... but not quickly enough.

--Sandswept Marsh map pin (completed) (POE II)

The Sunken City of Utzaal is not lifeless. When the waters flooded the region, many citizens of the city were trapped within sunken temples, or atop them. They found ways to survive, but remained where they were in the belief that Queen Atziri would come save them. That never happened, and they degenerated over the generations, eventually forgetting the outside world even existed. Their religion is a mockery of Vaal beliefs, and their intellects have faded to barely functional. All they retain is the animalistic ability for violence, and they do not hesitate to use it.

--The Art of Path of Exile II, "Queen of Filth - Cenobites and Anchorites" (POE II)

Many of the remaining Utzaal bloodlines have been trapped with the submerged temples for thousands of years. They subsisted off fungi and mushrooms, while losing all rational faculties. Massive inbreeding led to horrific mutations, but they continued to procreate through the use of Vaal flesh-molding techniques left over in the temples.

--The Art of Path of Exile II, "Cenobites and Anchorites" (POE II)

Once the ancient citadel of a great Vaal thaumaturge, the Aggorat developed into a home for twisted fungi, hallucinogenic mushrooms, and inbreeding cultists who slowly lost their faculties over the generations. Now, it is one of the most dangerous remnants of the Sunken City of Utzaal. It does remain above the poisonous waters, but setting foot there is tantamount to death. The only sign of the Aggorat's origins is the statue of Atziri that remains at the pinnacle.

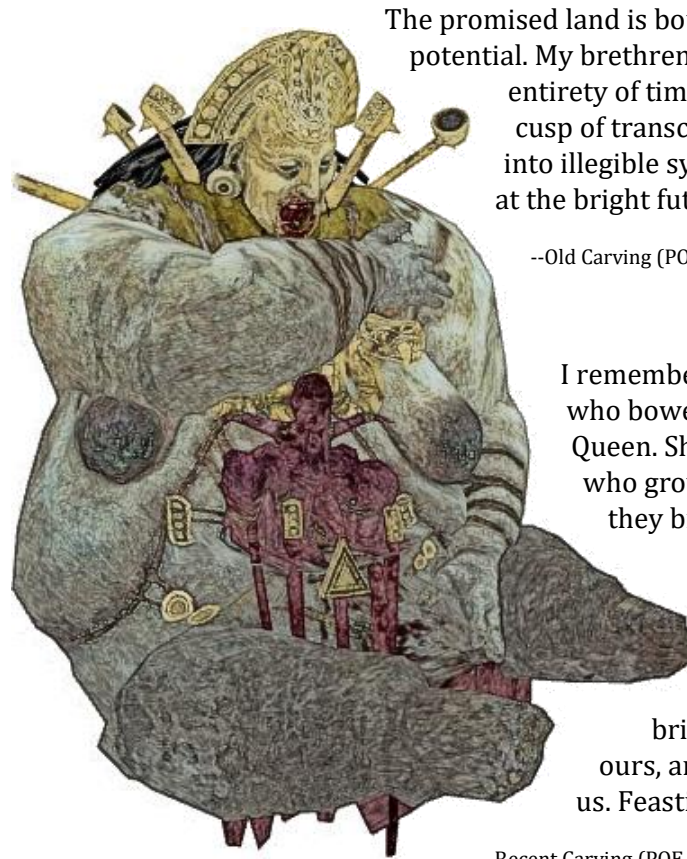
--The Art of Path of Exile II, "Aggorat" (I) (POE II)

The unique fungi and mushrooms that grow atop the Aggorat induce spiritual hallucinations when eaten. Those Vaal that survived atop the Aggorat believed these visions wholeheartedly and made no attempt to escape over the generations.

--The Art of Path of Exile II, "Aggorat" (II) (POE II)

When we first came to this place, Death alone was the King of all that we surveyed, solemn in his high and lonely throne. We had little, and were starving, but this man-made mountain offered us nourishment. Eating the caps and stems brought us grand visions of a thriving world. It was a promise of things to be. This, then, will be our new home until our promised land is made real.

--Ancient Carving (POE II)



The promised land is bountiful, a blissful place overflowing with potential. My brethren surround me... We are one, experiencing the entirety of time all at once. Even as I write this, I am on the cusp of transcendence; the script before my eyes morphs into illegible symbols, and I cannot stop laughing... rejoicing at the bright future that I know us to all share.

--Old Carving (POE II)

I remember the before-times. We bowed before Atziri, who bowed before no-one. But Mother is the one true Queen. She is the one who brings solace. She is the one who grows gifts for us. We must keep eating them, for they bring pure delight...

--Weathered Carving (POE II)

Mother is love. Mother is life. Feasting brings visions. Eternal life. Queen reigns still, ours, and theirs, under sky of blood. Feasting shows us. Feasting brings smile.

--Recent Carving (POE II)

THE RISE OF SAVAGE TRIBES

We were warned about the threat of the local tribes, but witnessing their brutality firsthand is... something else. No field report can prepare you for the sight of a man being flayed alive, or the sound of sinew torn from bone. The Azak are a vicious, unrelenting horde – and they train their beasts to be the same. The Orok, by contrast... not as sadistic, nor as smart. But just as lethal.

--Sebastian Carroway, "Warring Tribes" (POE II)

THE OROKS (AZAKH-KUL)

We strayed from the route marked on our map, driven further afield by painted men with savage intent.

Tonight, for reasons I cannot fathom, we have been granted a brief reprieve. Our hunters halted at the edge of this marsh, unwilling to pursue. They watched from the trees as we threaded the narrow band of solid ground between desert and swamp. I know not what they fear, but we must brave the unknown if we are to reach the encampment at the Ziggurat.

Through my spyglass, I see nothing ahead. The waters lie still, and the muddy banks between seem clear. Yet my nerves burn with the unmistakable sense of being watched. There is no one... no thing... but this silence feels alive. We have no choice but to run for it.

--Expedition Logbook (Sandswept Marsh) (POE II)

The Orok are truly terrifying to behold. I suspect their canine features result from genetic mutations, perhaps borne of the Cataclysms that reshaped these lands.

Their tribesmen are savage — I rarely leave their territories without scars to show for it — yet they hold a knowledge we Oriathans have long since abandoned. Our 'high-born' civilization prides itself on its advancements but remains woefully primitive in matters of the spirit and the natural world.

For all their brutality, the Orok live in harmony with the forces of nature. Perhaps they have no choice, but I wonder if we are the fools for believing we've transcended it. Better to live with nature than to die defying it.

--Expedition Logbook (Jungle Ruins) (POE II)

We been clashin' with the Orok tribe for generations. But their real fight is with the Azak, and them are losin'. The Orok worship the Three-Headed Snake - them poison the jungle, poison themselves, poison us too. Their shaman? Only seen her twice - she move like a panther in the dark. The coward.

Evil in the shadows, my friend. Evil in the shadows. ...

--Servi, "The Orok Tribe" (POE II)

So this the source of the Orok poison! Long time ago, this crypt was a resting place for the Vaal. But since their time, the Orok come here to worship the Three-Headed Snake. Even them couldn't survive her poison.

This venom... If those savages can learn to use it, maybe I can too...

--Servi, "Poison Alchemy" (POE II)

I'd stay well away from them, if I were you. The Azakh-Kul use a variety of poisons to disable unwary adventurers. ...

--Oswald, "The Azakh-Kul" (POE II)

...with the Azakh-Kul, you know you're going to get a poison dart in the neck, eaten, or both. ...

--Oswald, on the Carver Tribe (POE II)

THE AZAKS (CARVERS)

The Carver Tribe makes their home in the swampy wetlands near Utzaal. The water is still poisonous, but the Carver seems to have adapted to its toxins. The bog itself comprises the thickest and deadliest portions of the jungle.

--The Art of Path of Exile II, "The Carver Bog" (POE II)

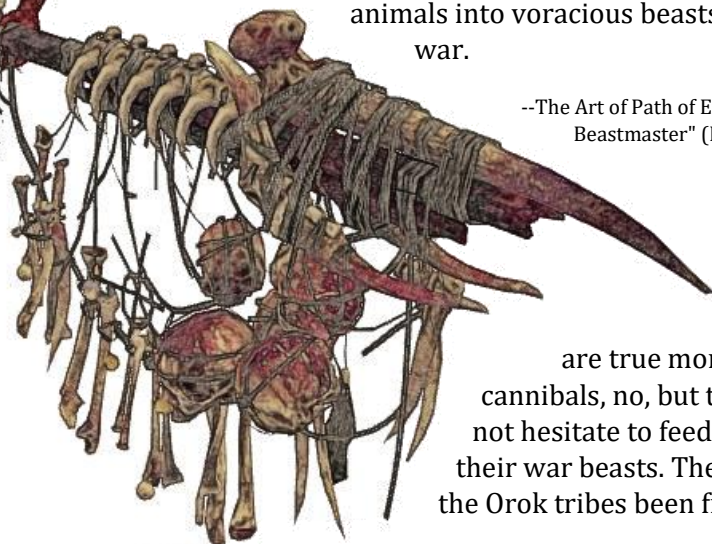


... At least with the Azakh-Kul, you know you're going to get a poison dart in the neck, eaten, or both. I have no idea how the Carvers might kill me, and not knowing is far more terrifying.

--Oswald, on the Carver Tribe (POE II)

The Carver Tribe, although mutated by ancient Corruption, does coexist with the jungle around them. The Beastmaster is a role passed down from generation to generation. He trains their animals into voracious beasts fit for war.

--The Art of Path of Exile II, "The Beastmaster" (POE II)



The Azak, them are true monsters. Not cannibals, no, but them will not hesitate to feed you to their war beasts. The Azak and the Orok tribes been fightin'

almost as long as the Vaal been gone. But the Azak are beyond cruel.

Their queen-witch, Ignagduk, she takes a child every blood moon night... for what, I won't say. If you cross into their territory, only death awaits you there.

--Servi, "The Azak Bog" (POE II)

On the night of each blood moon, Ignagduk steals a child from the local tribes. She sacrifices this child in a bloody ritual, and that child's soul forever serves her afterwards. Capable of horrific dark magic, Ignagduk is the deadliest witch in the jungle.

--The Art of Path of Exile II, "Carver Tribe - Ignagduk, the Bog Witch" (POE II)

The skulls of stolen children adorn carved wood.

--Ignagduk's Ghastly Spear (POE II)

Long ago, the witches of the Azak Tribe learned how to tap into the flow of Vivid life force to 'cooperate' with their enemies... forcefully.

--The Flesh Poppet Vicious Talisman (POE II)

THE KALGUUR



Over the course of a lifetime, Cadigan the First conquered every city-state on Middengard one by one, continually leveraging the power of each against the next.

--Cadigan's Authority Royal Sceptre (POE I)

I am from Kalguur, on the continent of Middengard. We have reached Wraeclast by ship. The journey was quite long, and quite dangerous...

--Johan, "Home" (POE I)

... Middengard is mostly comprised of volcanoes...

--Sonja, "The Soil" (POE I)

It's a beautiful continent. A harsh, beautiful continent. Mountainous... well, volcanic. The most verdant valleys and sparkling waterfalls you'll ever see. It's the people... the people are amazing, for the most part. Heroes. Scholars. Determined. Not in the grand sense you might hear in songs. Real people, doing their best. We tried. We really did...

--Gwennen, "Middengard" (POE I)

We are of the Kalguur. Ours is an existence spent scrabbling in the muck and mire of mortal life in search of scraps of renown. Some find it on the battlefield. Some find it in service. Others volunteer to sail to the edge of the known world on an impossible quest. The choices we make determine what we are, and what we become echoes into legend.

--Dannig, "Home" (POE I)

We are a proud people, but aren't they all? Difference is, we labour against the grim realities of life through the judicious application of bravery and courage. One's lineage carries an ongoing tally of renown and accomplishment. We do this not for ourselves, but for our children, should we one day have 'em. Here's hopin'.

--Tujen, "The Kalguur" (POE I)

The runes on our armour essentially capture and shape starlight. Sounds poetic, but don't be fooled. The smiths of the Kalguur turned these runes towards killing work long ago, as soon as they discovered that they could compel arrows to find their mark and blades to bite deeper. The greatest smiths became known as artificers, and produced work of singular genius. There weren't many such relics, but there didn't need to be.

--Dannig, "Runes" (POE I)

I don't know how it's seen on Wraeclast, but smithing is something of a fine art back home. We smiths aren't priests—not by a long-shot—but we do study the science of runes, and the philosophies of meaning and will. That education allowed me to forge *myself* much the same way I would a sword. A man makes his own destiny. Runes are just another tool in that glorious struggle...

--Dannig, "Smithing" (POE I)

Runes are a complex science, and a delicate art. If a smith doesn't understand their nuance, they'll only produce equipment one might call... *cursed*. For that reason, novice runesmiths are rather dangerous. There is an energy in runelight, and power in Verisium - and other metals. Runes channel those forces, like signposts... or diversions altering a river's flow. The final meaning is the sum of what you've engraved. It means exactly what you told it to mean, for better... or for worse.

--Dannig, "Runes" (POE I)

...Verisium... It's the most effective of all runesmithing metals. It doesn't occur naturally in the ground. It only falls from the sky. The how and the why of such events, I'll leave up to the priests and their calculations.

--Dannig, "Verisium" (POE I)

Tujen: Verisium is the very foundation of Kalguuran runework. We call it 'truth metal'. As they say, 'What is runed, becomes reality.'

Freya: A metal born of the very stars themselves.

--Freya Hartlin, "Verisium" (POE II)

So this is Wraeclast, eh? Strangely warm and humid here, at least compared to back home...

--Sonja, "Introduction" (POE I)

Hmm... the runes are fickle here...

--Dannig, to himself 1 (POE I)

The priests of the Kalguur worshipped knowledge, not gods.

--Faithguard Runic Helm (POE I)

The priests of the Kalguur keep faith through numbers and calculation, not unprovable promises.

--Keeper of the Arc Spiritbone Crown (POE II)

I've never heard of this 'gods' thing before setting foot here, but I know of at least one... *man...* who would fancy himself a god. Best we not mention Divinity to those back home.

--Dannig, "Gods" (POE I)

COLONISATION OF WRAECLAST (400 BIC)

It was impossible to decipher the true meaning of the omen, but none could deny that it had happened. The land shook, the night-clouds fled, the people quavered and hid, startrails arced across the sky to set fire to our forests where they fell, and a crimson sun rose on the horizon. Such was the power of the glow, the half moon became full and ruddy.

--Dannig, "The Omen I" (POE I)

Something wondrous and terrible had happened, so King Cadigan the Third commissioned an expedition toward that horizon, led by our greatest warriors and carrying the Triskelion Flame for protection. Bound to the Flame by duty, I signed on as Prime Remembrancer. We departed within the month.

--Dannig, "The Journey I" (POE I)

Under clouds of black beset by crimson lightning, we sailed stormy seas of poison and disease. Only one light shone in that darkness; only one Flame to keep hope alive.

--The Ancient Angler (POE I)

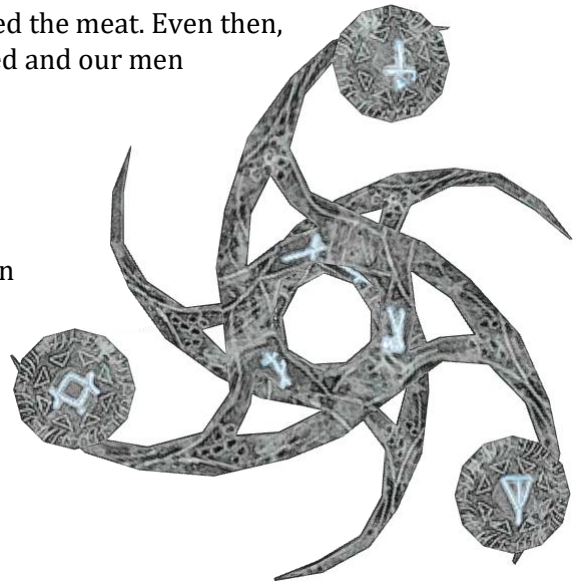
The lost journey across unruly and angry seas took nearly two seasons, during which we rarely saw the sky through the clouds of black beset by crimson lightning. We could not drink the rain, nor eat

the fish, until the Flame cleansed the water and purified the meat. Even then, the sustenance was hollow. Our supplies were depleted and our men hungry by the time land emerged in the distance.

--Dannig, "The Journey II" (POE I)

The first foot set upon this land was crushed by unseen jaws beneath the sand. Omens are rarely so clear. We carved a grisly path across the dunes, driving back creatures of the water, only to find ghastly horrors shambling between the trees. Every step came with a cost in blood.

--Dannig, "The Arrival I" (POE I)



On the seventh night, the grim clouds finally parted for a time, and our blessed stars emerged. Olroth staked the Triskelion Flame in the center of our fortifications. The barrier rites complete, we gained some small measure of safety. From there, everything stemmed, like a bloom under the embrace of a tree.

--Dannig, "The Arrival II" (POE I)

As the Knights of the Sun moved further inland, we found the remnants of a tremendous empire to rival that of our homeland. Countless bodies lay charred, but countless others refused to rest. Many were adorned in glittering gems that drew the eye and called to us. Those abominations that still walked often bore the gems within their very limbs. Seeing this, Uhtred declared such crystals unclean. None among us wished to argue.

--Dannig, "The Arrival III" (POE I)

...Uhtred and the Order of the Chalice. ... They were the primary priesthood and religious order that went with the initial ships to Wraeclast. They interpreted the stars and the workings of mysterious forces, such as alchemy, machinery, and runes. ...

--Rog, "The Order of the Chalice" (POE I)

"True heroes grow stronger in the face of adversity."

- Fourth Tenet of the Knights of the Sun

--Olrovasara Torment Club (POE II)

It was the Knights of the Sun that first explored the cursed cities of the Vaal...and found that empire glorious, shining... and filled with shamblers. I can't imagine what horrific event might have caused the death of an entire civilisation all at once. Not sure I want to know. ...

--Dannig, on a Knights of the Sun Vaal logbook (POE I)

Vast mountains of gold lay throughout the dead empire, often guarded by the most dangerous and most opulently dressed of the undying. Even in their monstrous state, these nobles and priests lurked near the treasures, unwilling to give up that which had meant more to them than their own lives. They had not died in the streets like those attempting to flee. They had locked and barricaded their temples, sealing themselves in their own tombs.

--Dannig, "The Arrival IV" (POE I)



The nobles of Utzaal had opened their own waterways and purposely drowned themselves, not as a mercy, but to spite would-be looters. This had been an empire ruled by madmen. They were successful in their spite, for we could not drain the deadly waters. Their treasures would remain lost for all time. The other cities, however, proved a slow and steady source of wealth beyond imagination.

--Dannig, "The Arrival V" (POE I)

King Cadigan the Third considered this new land and its treasures an open bounty. The craftsmen arrived first, soon followed by ships brimming with merchants and freemen. The women and children naturally followed, and, by the third year, the first village charter was established. All was prosperous so long as the Triskelion Flame burned bright, but there were soon too many of us to remain fully within the grace of its protection.

--Dannig, "The Colonisation I" (POE I)

The mercenaries of the Black Scythe, under Vorana, developed strategies for defense and culling that expanded what territory we could protect. Distance was key. Wielding crossbows and remaining behind sturdy walls, her men could savage horrors one at a time, ripping them to shreds until they no longer moved. We had the audacity to believe we could master this forsaken continent through such simple and mundane means. Ten more villages were established that year.

--Dannig, "The Colonisation II" (POE I)

[Vorana] was a fearsome and irrepressible warrior. King Cadigan the Third tried to mandate her service to the Crown, but she laid flat every man sent to bring her in. Eventually, he realised that she couldn't *be* controlled, and he gave her a Mercenary Charter instead. Given the freedom to operate the way she wanted, she won many great victories for the Kalguur. ...

--Tujen, "Vorana" (POE I)

Trade began with island-men and mountain-men along distant routes, although we shared no language and could not understand one another. I recorded some of the island-men's songs for future deciphering, and I met survivors of the fallen empire among the mountain-men.

--Dannig, "The Colonisation III" (POE I)

To the last, the scant survivors of the fallen empire bore none of the gems we had seen on the shambling dead. When I drew the shape of a gem in the dirt, a great panic arose, and we were banished from the mountains. Upon hearing of this, King Cadigan the Third officially banned the crystals, and none were procured nor shipped to the homeland.

--Dannig, "The Colonisation IV" (POE I)

By the time King Cadigan the Fourth came to power in the homeland, we numbered too many villages to fully count. Dissidents, pariahs, religious factions, and lost-men had all come to build new lives in a new land, and had no wish to report to the Knights. It was these outlying enclaves that suffered the first of the new horrors, often in silence, unwilling to admit to outsiders they were facing dangers they could not defeat on their own.

--Dannig, "Darkness Descends I" (POE I)

Each man or woman that fell on the fringes became another shambling creature lurking in the night. The curse of the land had not been lifted by the Triskelion Flame, merely held at bay. The deaths of our people strengthened the curse.

--Dannig, "Darkness Descends II" (POE I)



Medved's nature-mystics announced that they had found a breath or a vapor that left a man upon his death, visible only when that man died near one of the forbidden gems, and only as the vapor was drawn to it. Medved declared that all men must possess some essence as yet not understood. For this, Uhtred declared him a blasphemer, and was set to banish his order to the fringes. Medved paid a great sum to avert this exile, and the matter was settled.

--Dannig, "Darkness Descends III" (POE I)

Of the four great heroes, Medved was the most mysterious. His nature-mystics maintained many guarded sanctuaries in the wild. ...

--Dannig, on a Medved logbook (POE I)

...Medved and the Druids of the...Circle...believed they could see into the future by peering into the past. ... If Medved and his nature-mystics were right and Time truly is a circle, aren't we all doomed to repeat our lives over and over for eternity? If that is the truth, then there is no luck. No chance, no human will. All life is just a stageplay repeating over and over. I don't think I like that notion.

--Gwennen, "Druids of the Broken Circle" (POE I)

In the winter of that year, caravans and runners sent to the fringes no longer returned. Olroth took the Knights of the Sun through the cold forests and hills to seek them. It was found that the men of the fringes had lost a great many of their number, and were beset by horrors never before seen.

--Dannig, "Darkness Descends IV" (POE I)

Olroth and his Knights evacuated the fringes and set fire to the forests there. From the southern rivers to the northern sands, a vast line of flame burned. None would speak of the reason for this drastic action. Upon his return, Olroth expanded the influence of the Triskelion Flame, although the starlight barrier would be far weaker over such a vast territory. It was necessary to protect the villages. Olroth the Gallant retreated into seclusion often, and became known as Olroth the Grim.

--Dannig, "Darkness Descends V" (POE I)

What fell spring this is! Upon the dark of the moon, the Empty-Eyed Fiend has taken another of our number. This one was a young woman slated to begin warrior training upon her Second Passage. Many fell to the horrors of this accursed land in the early days, but I believed we had mastered the darkness with our purification rituals.

I was mistaken. Growing unpoisoned food is not the same as securing safety from the nightbreeds. It is as if the very land itself is learning from our victories, twisting creatures in new ways that subvert our defences.

--Dannig, "Olroth's Journal I" (POE I)



A new war tactic has been crafted by Medved and his nature-mystics, a strategy formerly forbidden by their beliefs. He observed the capability of the horrors here to rapidly grow and change, and he suggested that our mistake lay in the incompleteness of our task.

When we culled all but the hardiest of the twisted Vorniculia, the ones that remained spawned more of their ilk with inherited lethality. To ensure a true victory and protect our burgeoning towns, we must eliminate whole breeds from existence. We must amputate a piece of nature entirely. Anything less only serves to draw ever tighter the vise of doom.

--Dannig, "Olroth's Journal II" (POE I)

The Vorniculia are slain to the last, and will stain this land with their noxious poisons no more. There are countless other nightbreeds lurking in the shadows of this accursed land, but a small victory is still a victory. The skill of my knights and of Vorana's men was great enough that no lives were lost in the burning of forest and heath. There is no cause for mourning this rare day.

My thoughts turn to my unfinished duty. The Empty-Eyed Fiend is the only one of its kind I have seen. I must ensure it, too, vanishes from this world at the behest of torch and blade.

--Dannig, "Olroth's Journal III" (POE I)

Half of the Knights of the Sun lie strewn across the hills and trails of the hunt for the Empty-Eyed Fiend. I scored a direct blow with my sword against its neck, but the wound did not bleed. It is not a living thing. It feasts with its countless arm-teeth not to survive by eating, but to enjoy the screams of its victims. I saw this in the twin voids set in its rotting face. It... smiled at me... as it bit my squire in half.

Mortal flame found no purchase. Mortal weaponry drew no blood. I am driven to consider the forbidden. Medved and his nature-mystics cast aside their primary virtue to make survival here possible, and now I must do the same. The mountain-men warned us against the gems of power, but now I believe there is no choice...

--Dannig, "Olroth's Journal IV" (POE I)

Exhilarating! Enthralling! I journeyed into the night alone, a forbidden gem embedded in the pommel of my formerly useless sword. This time, I returned with the head of the Fiend, still grinning in final death, but now conquered. The gem blazed with the light of my fury, casting forth a beam of starlight that turned a missed slice into a cutting lethal blow.

We have been fools to deny this power. Too many of our people have suffered for this mistake. When the morning glow hits the treetops, I will command the surviving Knights of the Sun to search for more of the forbidden gems. It is time to conquer this land and make it safe for all time.

--Dannig, "Olroth's Journal V" (POE I)

The summer that the Knights of the Sun began affixing the forbidden gems to their weapons and armour, Medved of the Druids of the Circle went among the people. "The future-past has become clouded. Scrying pools in this land often remain tainted with crimson fog, but this is something new.

The night that Olroth departed alone, I could no longer see the past. Thus, the future is unknown." Thereafter, his order became known as the Druids of the Broken Circle.

--Dannig, "The Broken Circle I" (POE I)

A hooded woman spoke to Medved in the square, under the pike that held the head of the Empty-Eyed Fiend. "Have you lost your faith, then, High Druid?"

Medved replied, "A man that does not study the past cannot escape repeating it, but a man that cannot study the past has no future at all. The Circle has been Broken."

The woman then lifted her hood and revealed herself as Vorana, leader of the Black Scythe. She replied, "Take up arms, then, and we shall fight our way across the gap between past and future."

Medved accepted her gift of two axes, and began training his order for battle. The two axes had gems fixed along the handles which offered tremendous power.

--Dannig, "The Broken Circle II" (POE I)



The Druids of the Broken Circle and the mercenaries of the Black Scythe marshalled their forces near the fringes, aiding the Knights of the Sun, who had lost half of their number in the hunt for the Empty-Eyed Fiend. The starlight barrier was extended and weak, but the newly empowered warriors used the might of the gems to hold the night-stalking horrors at bay. A stalemate held for a number of seasons, during which many great heroes rose to prominence for their deeds. Annest, daughter of Medved and Vorana, was sent back to the homeland to be raised in safety. Olroth's son, nearing his First Passage, went with her as her guardian.

--Dannig, "The Broken Circle III" (POE I)

Dread swept through the ranks when the unthinkable happened: a leader arose among the twisted horrors, capable of intelligent deeds and direction. Creatures began striking where the starlight barrier was weakest, or where the patrols did not cross. Possessed by some horrible notion he would not share, Medved sent a messenger into the dark. The messenger was allowed to return alive with a parchment. The words written on it seemed to confirm Medved's fears, and he traveled into the night to challenge the new leader of the enemy. He did not return.

--Dannig, "The Broken Circle IV" (POE I)

The priests had eyes and ears everywhere by the season of Medved's disappearance. High Priest Uhtred suspected treachery, and kept initiates silently observing the comings and goings of other leaders. They found that, after each day spent tirelessly fighting to utter exhaustion, Olroth the Grim would return to his seclusion. Then, after some time, he would leave through another door, stealing into the night without being observed. In these excursions, his eyes were closed, as if he were asleep.

--Dannig, "The Priesthood I" (POE I)

I have become the darkness...

--Olroth, during fight (POE I)

Uhtred and his priests had their own secret agendas. ...

--Dannig, on an Order of the Chalice logbook (POE I)

Uhtred made many devious plans, during which he sent his son Owen to the homeland to avoid retribution. A week after the harvest, in the cold of evening, a dozen priests awaited Olroth outside his keep. They used daggers of the sacrament to stab Olroth in his sleepwalking state. He was wounded seventy-one times, and fell. Vorana entered like a black wind and removed the heads of the twelve in one stroke.

--Dannig, "The Priesthood II" (POE I)

Olroth was laid upon a bier and attended with medicines, bandages, and herbs. The people roared for the blood of the priesthood, but Uhtred claimed no knowledge of these twelve traitors. The greatest leader of the people lay at the edge of death. They encased him in glass to keep his breath from escaping.

--Dannig, "The Priesthood III" (POE I)

A hooded woman spoke to Uhtred in the square, under the pike that held the head of the Empty-Eyed Fiend. "Why do you suppose your priests assaulted Olroth?"

Uhtred replied, "Why do you suppose Olroth was stealing into the darkness? He is the new leader of the twisted horrors. By day, he fights for us, and by night, for them."

The woman then lifted her hood and revealed herself as Vorana, leader of the Black Scythe. She replied, "For these words, I should kill you where you stand."

A scythe to his throat, Uhtred replied, "Kill me in one week if you wish it. If the enemy becomes disorganized and listless while Olroth lies in glass, then you will know the truth of my words."

Vorana promised, "I will feed you to the head of the Empty-Eyed Fiend, here, if you are wrong."

Then she departed. The enemy did not become disorganized or listless that week, and Uhtred went into hiding at an ancient site of power.

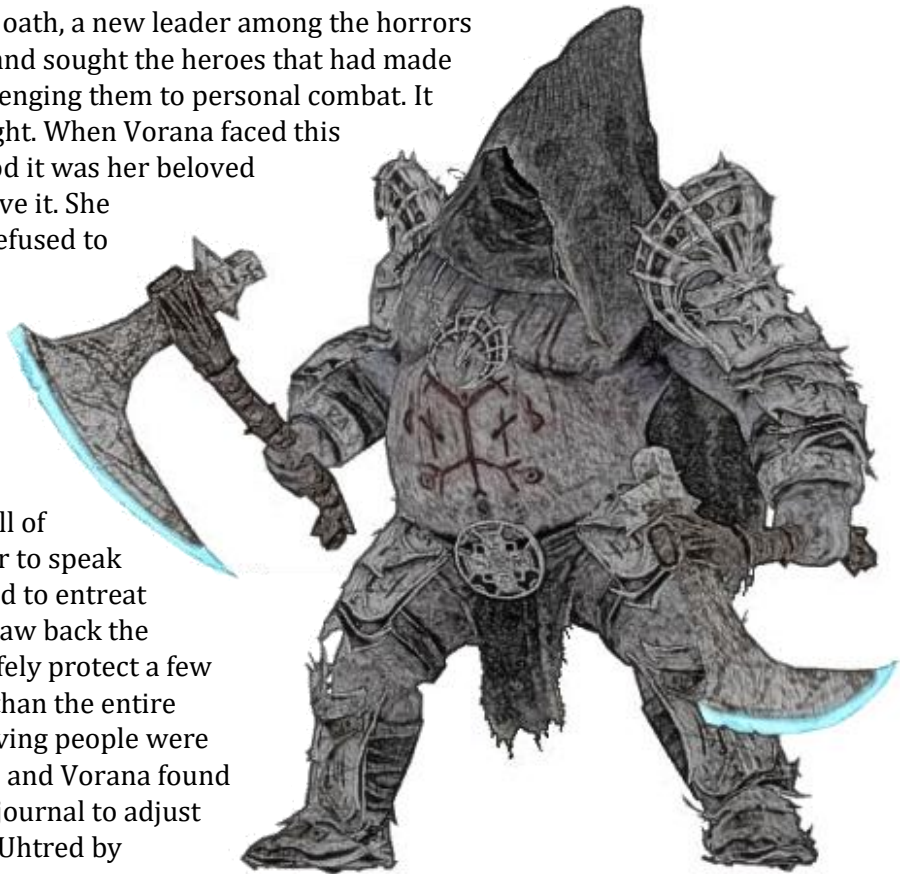
--Dannig, "The Priesthood IV" (POE I)

The week Vorana made her oath, a new leader among the horrors arose. It wielded two axes, and sought the heroes that had made names for themselves, challenging them to personal combat. It slew forty-two, one each night. When Vorana faced this abomination, she understood it was her beloved Medved, but could not believe it. She ordered a full retreat, and refused to answer the challenge. Two villages were destroyed.

--Dannig, "The Last to Fall I" (POE I)

Understanding that Uhtred had been right in speaking ill of great men, she sent a runner to speak with him. A plan was devised to entreat the Triskelion Flame and draw back the starlight barrier. It could safely protect a few villages completely, rather than the entire region weakly. All the surviving people were evacuated to the core lands, and Vorana found the proper rites in Olroth's journal to adjust the Flame. This, she sent to Uhtred by messenger.

--Dannig, "The Last to Fall II" (POE I)



The core villages were crowded to full, and the beleaguered warriors of the Knights of the Sun, the Black Scythe, and the Broken Circle had all drawn back. The starlight barrier did not retreat. Instead, it vanished. In haste, Vorana went to the Triskelion Flame's altar, but found it missing. The ships in the harbour had all been burned and sunk as well, save one, which had departed.

To the people, she shouted, "Uhtred the Traitor has taken the Flame!"

The people wailed in despair as the horrors closed in from all sides. Without the starlight barrier, there was no protection. The core villages became a fortress tomb, defended by wall and by iron, but inescapable. Many of us retreated to Olroth's resting place, only to find his glass case shattered. He has arisen, and we must believe he is out in the dark fighting to save us, no matter what Uhtred the Traitor claimed.



--Dannig, "The Last to Fall III" (POE I)

Vorana sent messengers to the island-men and the mountain-men for aid, but their fate was unknown. The defenders were valiant, but new food could not be purified without the Flame. Famine set in, and the seasons refused to slow their passing. Thin and wasting away, Vorana realized that waiting meant death. She knew there was a way to increase her power, so she performed the forbidden rite and placed gems inside her own flesh.

--Dannig, "The Last to Fall IV" (POE I)

She arose, then, and went out from the walls, reaping death among the night-horrors with each vast swing of her scythes. They could not stand against her might. She called to us, "I will not rest until every single abomination lies dead!"

Some among us believe she can personally slay every monster in this forsaken land herself. Others are not so idealistic. If

Vorana should not return, there is still one way out, one we dared not risk before, hidden under the earth and older than the oldest men... We must keep hope alive. This is not the end of our people in this land. Night falls, but there will be a dawn.

--Dannig, "The Last to Fall V" (POE I)

The Azmeri remember. The stories say we came to their aid, but it was too late. ...

--Huntress: Dannig, "The Expedition" (Huntress version) (POE II)

In the final days of our people's history here, the Prime Remembrancer fled with the remaining survivors in a desperate bid to escape the coming doom. ... Apparently, the Order of the Chalice found something... some unknown artifact... all he knew was that even the oldest men recognised its power and built a shrine around it.

It was to that shrine that Uhtred fled to escape Vorana's wrath. The survivors expected to meet him there, but the writing stops just short of the destination. ...

--Dannig, on an Uhtred logbook (POE I)

...while Vorana fought a last stand, the rest of our people here on Wraeclast attempted to escape through some ancient site of power. Uhtred was there waiting for them... and now we know what happened. He, too, fell to the corrupting madness. He must have slain them all at the threshold, though I do hope some got past him and escaped.

The question that lingers with me though: Uhtred was the one who first declared the gems unclean. He never used them, by the accounts we found. How, then, did he go mad? What did he witness that broke his mind?

--Tujen, "Uhtred's Defeat" (POE I)



They built a temple... around the mirror...

Under the earth... to hide from the night sky...

--Medved, on his death (POE I)

THE PALE COUNCIL

Dark minds hide in dark places, but it was not always so.

The wise Red rulers were long-dead, and the strong seized power. But an unwise leader pulls the people towards ruin. So it came to pass that milk fresh from the nipple was soured, grass grew hard and sharp, and flesh walked the earth without a soul. Hinekora cast her net towards the new kings and queens, but four slipped through the holes and fled into darkness. There they remain. Beyond the reach of the Mother of Death. But not beyond her sight.

--Navali, regarding the Pale Council (POE I)

YRIEL, THE FERAL LORD

When the rains stopped, the Lord fed his farms with the blood of the beasts. But blood carries corruption with it, and the crops soon towered, monstrous and thorned. In the thick jungle of his own making, it was not only he who turned feral.

--Navali, regarding Yriel (POE I)



Lord of the Wild, of the feral and frenzied, of the uncivilized, the untamed, the untouched.

--Yriel's Key (POE I)

Six moons have passed since the earth supped the rain. The riverbed is dry, and the lake is but a puddle. The beasts here have become desperate and dangerous.

There are rumours that Lord Yriel's blood-fed crops have swelled, but the fruit they bear can send a man mad. We look to our children for the answer. A child cannot hunt, but it can still provide. The taste is hard to forget.

--Unknown, Salted Earth Memory (POE I)

EBER, THE PLAGUEMAW

The old red ones left this land barren. Crops grew stunted and disease filled the air. If you don't feed an animal it will soon cast a hungry eye upon its brothers and sisters, and man is no different. The Plaguemaw and his people soon feasted on their own, devouring the very life essence of the young and innocent.

--Navali, regarding Eber (POE I)

Mouth of the Masses, whose greatness spreads by our breath and touch, who feeds the starving with the starved, the strong with the weak.

--Eber's Key (POE I)



VOLKUUR, THE UNBREATHING QUEEN



Sometimes death is a thief, quick on its feet and quicker with a blade. Sometimes it is a vine, slowly growing tighter and tighter around your neck. But death is not a toy. The unbreathing queen has raised an army of soulless corpses. Her actions mock death, turning it into little more than an obstacle for her puppetry of the flesh.

--Navali, regarding Volkuur (POE I)

She of Many Bodies, whose very flesh unites all, whose dark whispers draw forth our souls, unfettered.

--Volkuur's Key (POE I)

INYA, THE UNBEARABLE WHISPERS

Wisdom and knowledge are not one and the same. The queen's thirst for learning was unending. As she tore through the pages of countless tomes, her knowledge grew and her wisdom slipped away, buckling beneath the weight of insanity.

--Navali, regarding Inya (POE I)

The Infinite Mind, unbound by the tethers of sanity, whose thirst for knowledge is all-consuming, whose every word stands our hair on end.

--Inya's Key (POE I)

My Council,

The sky turns black as ink.

We must gather at once, for I fear the end draws close.

I have uncovered a tome that illustrates certain forbidden techniques used to prolong life far beyond ordinary means. We shall fracture our very souls, and keep safe a piece of one another's very being. With this, none of us may perish unless all of us perish at once.

It is not without a cost, for life granted requires life be paid, but it need not be any of ours. Bring your most loyal and healthy retainers, and bid the rest farewell, for we shall not see them again.

Make haste and do not speak of where you are going. Immortality is within our grasp, but there are countless who would risk death--who would kill--for a chance at eternal life.

- Inya

--Dark Tome (POE I)

The sky tore asunder, black cleaving upon blue
The end of life, of Time, with no escape
But they found a fragment, a void, a haven
And there they waited, as it all began again
Dark will, dark knowledge, enemies of Fate
They know your mind, because they remember

--Mind of the Council Death Mask (POE II)



THE ETERNAL EMPIRE

IMPERIALUS CONCEPTUS (1 IC)

Follow me if you desire better for yourself, and for your families. Follow me if you hunger for more than this!

--Veruso's Ambition Shackled Boots (POE I)

Book 6: Imperialus Conceptus

Tarcus Veruso descended from the mountains and led his eighty thousand tribesmen and women through the doomlands to Azala Vaal. There he planted his banner upon Atziri's grave and with these words founded our great and eternal empire.

"The Vaal closed their eyes to flesh and stone, to blood and bronze. We are not Vaal. We are Azmeri. For now and forever, our eyes are open."

Veruso built his capital upon the bones of Azala Vaal and baptized it Sarn. From there, Veruso formed the first Legions and proceeded to conquer the lands beneath the Mantle, clearing it of the mindless constructs and fierce abominations left in the wake of The Fall.

True to his word, Veruso ensured that his people lived "with eyes open". The ancient Vaalish centres of learning and power were sealed and quarantined. Thaumaturgy was outlawed and those who stained themselves with Vaalish folly were burned for their sin. The Tears of the Maji, too dangerous to be destroyed, were gathered up, taken to Highgate, and buried within the bowels of the mountains. The caverns there were sealed and forgotten.



A supreme effort to erase the past. A primitive reaction born of primitive times, in the opinion of this humble historian.

-Trinian - *Intellectus Prime*

--The Ancients (POE I)

Did the ancient Azmeri descend from the mountains alongside Tarcus Veruso?

The bulk of them did, and they founded the Eternal Empire. The Azmeri of the Forest Encampment did not do so, and are descendants of their original culture.

--<https://www.pathofexile.com/forum/view-thread/2991402>

Beneath the summer sun we follow Tarcus in search of the promised land. Before long, hunger grips our stomachs. The doomlands take their toll. Our numbers dwindle, and discord spreads amongst the tribesmen.

Veruso's words quell our hearts, but not our stomachs. In the dead of night, a woman goes missing, and our hunger is abated. We reach the ruins of Azala Vaal alive, but dark deeds hide in our bellies.

--Unknown, Distant Mud Pit Memory (POE I)

By all accounts, Tarcus Veruso was a ruthless despot, a man to rival even the likes of Dominus. Yet his heart of stone contained one precious seam, his love for his wife, Chiara.

So when the poor young woman died giving birth to Veruso's son, the grieving emperor threw aside his great convictions and placed his last hope in thaumaturgy, in the Ankh of Eternity.

Perhaps it was shame that drove Tarcus to lock the ankh away, to steal such hopes from his descendents. It was he who had asked his people to turn their backs on the ancient arts, so what right had he to enjoy that which he forbade? Love gave him that right.

--Clarissa, "Emperor Veruso" (POE I)

... My hope waits for me to the east, tucked away in a shrine in the Quay.

The Ankh of Eternity. Veruso, Prima Imperialus, placed it there himself at the dawn of the Empire. If the legends are correct, the Ankh has powers over life and death... when paired with the correct Azmerian ritual. ...

--Clarissa, "Reviving Tolman" (POE I)

... Suffering will besiege us and yet love will prevail.
Pain will imprison us and yet love will prevail.
Grief will engulf us and yet love will prevail.
Death will surely take us and love... will...

--Clarissa, "The Ankh of Eternity" (POE I)



As I understand it, the Ankh of Eternity was somehow able to return the dead to the full bloom of life. There was nothing necromantic about it, rather it was a source of true resurrection.

How it came to exist, I honestly don't know. A couple of inscriptions I read treated the ankh as some sort of gift to Veruso from the Vaal. But surely the Vaal were long gone by Veruso's time... weren't they?

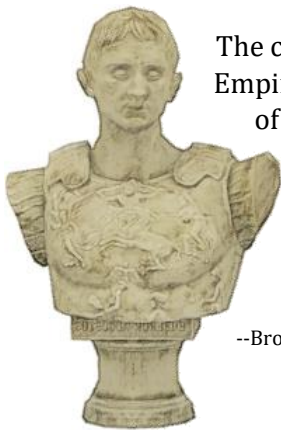
No matter. Despite the vagaries of the Ankh's origins, Veruso used the Ankh to return his young wife from the death bed to the wedding bed. The accounts are unanimous on that point. ...

--Clarissa, "The Ankh of Eternity" (POE I)

How could I have been so stupid? Veruso didn't hide the ankh out of shame. He hid it out of fear, out of... oh my, what did the ankh really do to his wife? Everything I saw, that I read... lies to cover the truth of what Chiara had really become. ...

--Clarissa, on Tolman's second death (POE I)

BEGINNING OF THE PHRECIAN LINEAGE (35 IC)



The custom of the Lord's Trial was upheld throughout the founding years of the Empire. Veruso's successor, Caspiro, was a low-born legionnaire, the lone survivor of a labyrinth that claimed the lives of every high-born contender, including Veruso's only son.

Caspiro proved to be every bit the emperor that Veruso was...

- Emperor Izaro Phrecius

--Bronze Inscription IV (POE I)

Caspiro was a master of presentation. He maintained peace in Wraeclast through displays of strength that, sadly, had no meaning to the dark presence that dismembered him...

--Bust of Emperor Caspiro (POE I)

Book 7: The Light of Phrecia

Five years after Veruso's death, Emperor Caspiro, too, was dead. Although accounts of the exact details differ, one clear fact is agreed upon. Caspiro was dismembered by something referred to simply as a dark being.

It was General Alano Phrecia who avenged the Emperor's death and who triumphed in driving away the pervasive darkness enveloping what would become the imperial heartlands. Though it seems fanciful to contemplate a portion of our Empire cast in perpetual night, Azmerian writers of the time are unified in their depiction. Perhaps it was caused by peculiar weather patterns or some



thaumaturgical residue of The Fall. On this matter, this humble historian is left in the uncomfortable state of pure conjecture.

On the first Sacrato of Lurici, 35 I.C., Alano himself wrote that "our legions drove the dark being deep into the recesses of its lair and sealed it away for eternity". Having returned the gaze of Solaris to those lands stretching from the foot of the Mantle to the Axiom Ranges, Alano Phrecia returned to Sarn. In the absence of a clear hereditary succession, Alano was crowned emperor and the Imperial heartlands were named in his honour.

With the former realm of the Vaal thus tamed and settled by our Azmerian ancestors, the Eternal Empire saw a long period of peace and prosperity under an unbroken line of Phrecia emperors.

"To care for this Empire with eyes open." - A traditional vow made by the High Templar upon the coronation of an Eternal Emperor.

-Trinian, Intellectus Prime

--The Ancients (POE I)

EMPEROR ROMIRA & THE NIGHT OF A THOUSAND RIBBONS (CA. 334 IC)

On the Night of a Thousand Ribbons, our finest city burned. It burned with fires lit by cruelty and neglect. It burned with shame for giving the title of 'Emperor' to a man who did not deserve it.

--Bronze Monograph, Trial of Burning Rage (POE I)

... Selfish blood breeds selfish times, and the Empire paid for it with its own blood. With the Night of a Thousand Ribbons. With that most regal of cannibals, Emperor Romira...

- Emperor Izaro Phrecius

--Bronze Inscription IV (POE I)

The night of a thousand ribbons
To remember the day of a thousand flames
When Sarn burned
And was born again

--Thousand Ribbons Simple Robe (POE I)

The Empress gave Romira two sons
Born of his brother's seed

Romira threw her a banquet
A perfidious meal indeed.

--Romira's Banquet Diamond Ring (POE I)

"Come, my faithful wife," he crooned. "Sit. Eat. I wanted to reward you for your loyalty. I even cooked this myself..." She looked 'round for her sons, but hers was the only chair.

--Romira's Requital (POE II)

... Romira Phrecian, the absolute savage, fed his wife's two sons to her during that famed banquet. It was an act of vengeance, since her sons were sired by his brother.

--Cadiro, on Romira's Banquet (POE I)

Shame what happened to my husband. He had such good taste.

--The Feast (POE I)

THE ASCENDANCY OF CHITUS (1316-1319 IC)

EMPEROR IZARO & THE LABYRINTH

In the impressionable youth of my reign, I was encouraged to believe in the precious nature of my imperial blood. The 'divine claret', as one fool of a courtier would repeat with tiresome regularity.

Unfortunately, my divine claret refused to pour from one cup to another. Try as I might, with a lovely procession of young and ever dutiful wives, my noble seed simply would not sprout.

Who, then, to choose as my worthy successor? With the candidates on hand either mediocre at best, or maniacal at worst, I found myself in quite the quandary.

That's when Fortune took me by the hand and led me to a forgotten tome on a forgotten shelf in the quietest corner of Sarn Library. A tome entitled, 'Ancient Traditions of Azmerian Ascendancy'.

The rest, one might say, is history.

- Emperor Izaro Phrecius

--Bronze Inscription I (POE I)

The Azmeri were the first culture known in history to use the trials of strength, wisdom, and spirit to select its chieftains.

The first Lord's Trial was a rough-hewn maze festooned with wild animals and brutal traps, crafted to test aspiring Azmerian leaders' body, mind, and soul. [sic]

In conquering the adversities of the maze, a champion proved they were capable of bearing the crushing burden of chieftainship.

The first trials were simple contraptions reflecting simple times. As the Azmerian civilisation grew in number and complexity, so did the trials, from treacherous mazes to bewildering labyrinths.

Alas, there are no surviving descriptions of the labyrinth that tested and proved the worth of Veruso, Prima Imperialus. I would imagine it was quite something to behold.

- Emperor Izaro Phrecius

--Bronze Inscription II (POE I)

The Azmeri were consummate survivors. They had to be, having been sired in the most inhospitable range of mountains in all of Wraeclast.

Unfortunate, some might say. I do not. I believe it was the making of them. And of us, their descendants.

So it is no wonder that they developed the Lord's Trial. With survival being a moment-by-moment concern, that harried people grew to understand power quite intimately.

Strong leadership is able to bridge the chasm between existence and extinction. Poor leadership might see an entire tribe vanish into that same chasm.

When the Azmeri descended from their mountains to conquer the fecund lands of central Wraeclast, they thrived and multiplied with utmost alacrity in those more forgiving climes.

For is it not poverty that teaches us how we might excel in times of plenty?

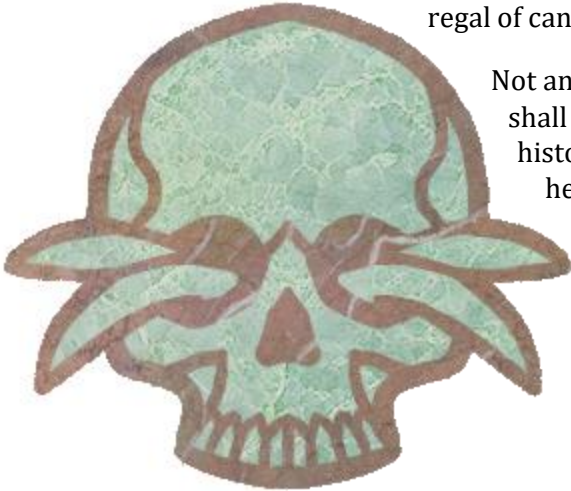
- Emperor Izaro Phrecius

--Bronze Inscription III (POE I)

The custom of the Lord's Trial was upheld throughout the founding years of the Empire. Veruso's successor, Caspiro, was a low-born legionnaire, the lone survivor of a labyrinth that claimed the lives of every high-born contender, including Veruso's only son.

Caspiro proved to be every bit the emperor that Veruso was.

Alas, the Lord's Labyrinth was corrupted by those with the vanity to consider their blood more precious than their Empire. Selfish blood breeds selfish times, and the Empire paid for it with its own blood. With the Night of a Thousand Ribbons. With that most regal of cannibals, Emperor Romira.



Not any more. I, Izaro Phrecius, shall return us to Justice. I shall build the greatest Lord's Labyrinth in Azmerian history, and my successor shall be chosen by the Goddess herself.

Only when the Lord's Labyrinth is drenched in selfish blood can a true leader ascend the throne.

- Emperor Izaro Phrecius

--Bronze Inscription IV (POE I)

If you're going to be in the antiquities business, it pays to take note of whatever history you can. High Gardens and the great Emperor Izaro, for instance. Have you heard of the Lord's Labyrinth? The High Gardens were designed by Izaro as a test run for his great work.

He turned his personal garden into a maze and filled it with all sorts of traps and nasty beasties. Convicted criminals were then given a choice. Death or the Garden. If they got through, an imperial pardon was theirs.

Weren't no pardons on record as far as I could see. That's what happens when people have too much time and gold on their hands.

--Hargan, "The High Gardens" (POE I)

Izaro saw himself not as a man, but as a divine saviour trapped in a man's body.

--Izaro's Dilemma Imperial Claw (POE I)

THE PERANDUS FAMILY

Now there's a shield I recognise, emblazoned with my family crest. "With piety and justice"...

--Cadiro, on Crest of Perandus (POE I)

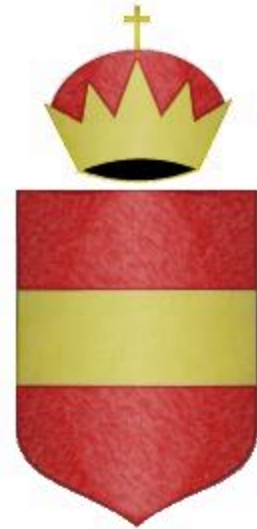
Before the Cataclysm, and before the Purity Rebellion, the Perandus family ruled over Sarn. Chitus Perandus was the first to navigate the Lord's Labyrinth, the first to show that it could be beaten. He was aided immeasurably in this endeavour by his uncle, Cadiro Perandus.

Cadiro Perandus was a master of coin, the minister of finance in the kingdom both before and after his family's ascension. His greed was legendary, for he was a devotee of Prospero, the ancient Azmerian god of the underworld, the earth, and all its boundless treasures.

--<https://www.pathofexile.com/forum/view-thread/1595088>

The Perandus were an esteemed, wealthy family long before they realized their imperial ambitions. As they gained riches and renown, they steadily acquired ancient and powerful artefacts from Wraeclast's past. Cadiro had these relics stashed in nondescript boxes, crates and vaults to throw off potential thieves. ...

--<https://www.pathofexile.com/forum/view-thread/1595088>



The same day that Veruso planted his banner in the soil of Sarn, the Perandus family built the first market stall. That one stall spawned so many others that the people came to call our venture *Perandus Markets*.

We were never vain enough to make the name official. Until Chitus took the throne, we were a most unassuming consortium.

Yes, we did occasionally employ the Silent Brotherhood to remove the more stubborn obstacles to our commercial endeavours, but for the most part we tended to solve our issues with coin and contract rather than bow and blade.

In hindsight, we should have taken the reins of power much earlier. If we had done so then perhaps I could now be speaking of Perandus in the plural rather than the singular.

--Cadiro, "The Perandus Family" (POE I)

...Chitus did have his sights set on the throne from a very early age. And, dare I say it myself, he could not have ascended to power without my assistance.

--Cadiro, "The Perandus Family" (POE I)

I nurtured that little tyke from cradle to the grave. I was closer to him even than his parents were. When he took the throne, I couldn't have been prouder... except, perhaps, for the day when he successfully navigated the Lord's Labyrinth. He was the first person to ever do it, too. And I was indispensable to his success.

--Cadiro, "Chitus" (POE I)

Cadiro watched young Chitus play in the frostbitten grass, care-free, happy, and unburdened by the responsibility the Perandus scion would soon endure.

--First Snow Cobalt Jewel (POE I)

TREACHERY

Izaro was slow to see the treachery growing in his own court and powerless to stop it once he had; a captain sailing his own ship into rocks.

--Winds of Change Ancient Gauntlets (POE I)

Izaro Phrecius? Despite my personal feelings surrounding that man, he did provide we Perandus folk with an unprecedented opportunity.

Over the centuries, the Phrecius family had blocked our every attempt to gain the throne on the scandalous basis that our blood was not of imperial quality.

So when Izaro called that whole blood fiasco into question with his Lord's Labyrinth, it gave us the only clear shot we would ever have at sovereignty.

Without Izaro, the Perandus name may never have come to be associated with the throne. So in a somewhat qualified fashion, he has my gratitude.

--Cadiro, "Izaro" (POE I)

3rd Kaso of Vitali, 1316 I.C.

Uncle Cadiro,

While my father remains determined to play the role of Izaro's lapdog, I trust that you and I are of like mind regarding our 'glorious' Emperor's ridiculous Labyrinth. He would have us entrust our imperial leadership to the primitive diversions of some cave-dwelling ancestors. It is beyond reasoning. In fact, it can only be surmised that Izaro himself is also beyond reasoning.

On that matter, I suppose it should come as no surprise. Phrecius blood has become polluted by decadence and incest. It is no secret. So perhaps it is a matter of good fortune that Izaro has not been able to sire an heir. For such a whelp would be undoubtedly dim or demented. Yes, such emperors are easy to control, but they can also be extremely dangerous, as the Empire learned all too well with Romira.

So in his own deluded way, Izaro is right to look to fresh sources of blood to serve our Eternal Empire. Yet he looks in the wrong places. Perandus blood has served the throne proudly since Veruso first set his foot upon the soil of Sarn. Perandus gold has filled the imperial coffers. Perandus minds have crafted this Empire into the marvel it is today.

And has a single Perandus ever sat upon the imperial throne? No.

Izaro's plans are an insult to the Empire and an insult to us, its most devoted servants. Izaro spits upon our very blood and then offers up everything we have worked for to the first fortunate fool who stumbles through his little maze.

I will not stand by and allow Izaro to deliver us all unto damnation. I trust, dear uncle, that I can rely on your support.

Chitus

--Chitus Letter I (<https://www.pathofexile.com/forum/view-thread/1538608>)

1st Lunar of Verusi, 1317 I.C.

Uncle Cadiro,

Our Eternal Emperor Izaro might be insane but he's clearly not stupid. Or at the very least, he has had the presence of mind to surround himself with clever people. Three meticulously planned attempts on Izaro's life. Three astutely thwarted failures.

Of course, none of them can be traced back to us, Uncle. You can rest assured that I have been most discrete in my arrangements. As for Cousin Elano, he will be dead by sunrise. We need not fear [sic] any inconvenient disclosure on his part, and he is not a Perandus by name. His familial connection is known only to us. It's a simple matter to keep a bastard or two in the shadows for occasions such as this. Legitimacy is a useful carrot to dangle.

I assume you've been keeping abreast of the Labyrinth's progress? I have purchased several of Izaro's overseers and they keep me informed. I'm told it's to house quite the menagerie of monstrosities. And the mechanisms that are currently being installed, many of which Izaro designed himself, are utterly nefarious in their invention. While one might easily question the man's rationality, one cannot so easily discount his imagination. If only Izaro had contented himself with an artistic pursuit some kind [sic], such as painting or sculpture. Instead he now drains the imperial coffers dry, building a delirious promise to the peasants and peons of Wraeclast.

"Come one and all! Enjoy the largest playground ever created. And should you win the games that I have laid out for you, why, you shall be crowned emperor!"



Izaro would place our fortunes in the calloused hands of ignorance. He would have us forget the centuries of leadership, diplomacy, prosperity and security that we, the ruling families of Sarn, have amassed.

Izaro's folly will be the end of our beloved empire.

I, for one, will not let that happen, Uncle.

Chitus

--Chitus Letter II (<https://www.pathofexile.com/forum/view-thread/1538608>)

DEFEATING THE LABYRINTH

"The Just Goddess presides over us all. The future of the Empire rests in her even hands."

The Lord's Labyrinth, opened by Emperor Izaro Phrecius on the second Galvano of Azmeri, 1317 IC.

--Bronze Plaque (POE I)

Thousands gazed upon the doors of the great labyrinth, at an Eternal Champion in steel and gold, the first to challenge its treacherous traps. To mark the occasion, Izaro had the Champion's remains gilded.

--Spine of the First Claimant Iron Sceptre (POE I)

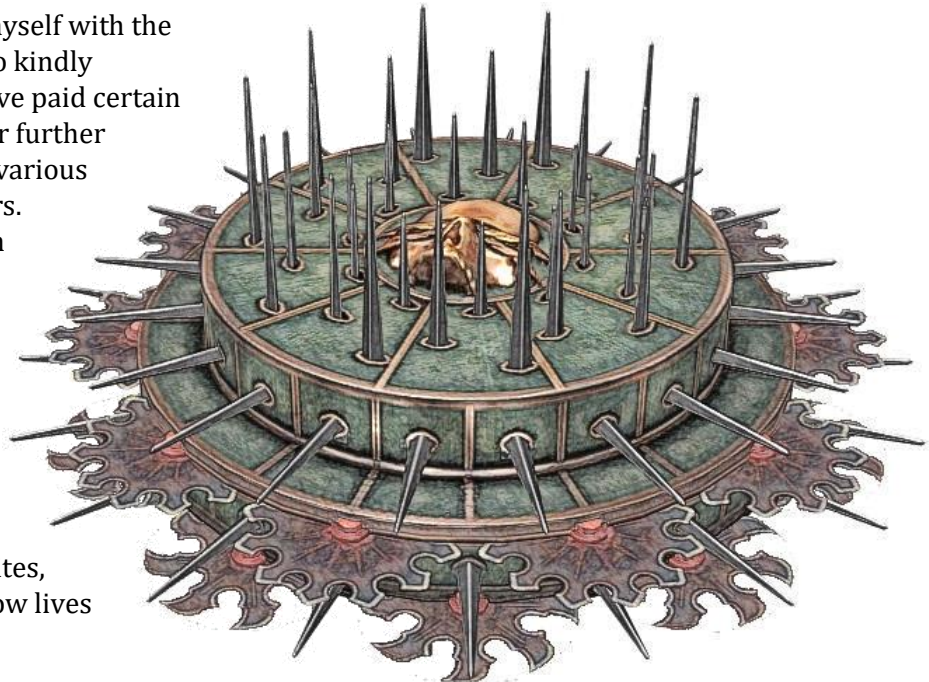
3rd Solaro of Divini, 1318 I.C.

Uncle Cadiro,

I am as ready for this Labyrinth as I will ever be. Each day I have trained with the duelist, Kre Faarblood. There is no better swordsman in all of Sarn and I have been a most attentive pupil. So attentive that he made the mistake of admitting, after his twelfth cup of wine, that he is not of the noble blood he claims to be. His 'disinherited dandy' act is just that: an act. People have a tendency to entrust me with their secrets. I know, it's a valuable gift.

Please have Faarblood tried and hanged, discreetly, away from the crowds. We simply can't have commoners impersonating their betters.

Yes, I have familiarised myself with the architectural plans you so kindly obtained for me, and I have paid certain overseers handsomely for further details regarding Izaro's various hazards and living horrors. The man is obsessed with spikes. They pop out of the floor, spin on treacherously shifting wheels and even roam about like predators in search of prey. Izaro's mechanisms are truly of the most devious design. And the creatures! If it bites, claws or stings, in [sic] now lives in that Labyrinth.



Fear not, uncle [sic]. I have designs of my own. My hirelings shall place discreet caches of supplies here and there, in the eventuality that I should need restoration or assistance. I shall enclose a list of their names. It would be our interests [sic] if those named men and women were to, upon the Labyrinth's completion, suffer accidents of a mortal nature. One word spoken carelessly could end any hope of a Perandus ever ascending the imperial throne. A few common lives are nothing compared to the slaughter that would occur if, God help us, one of the Ezomyte contenders survived this Labyrinth in my stead.

So there it is. Our noble endeavour to save our Empire from a madman. I do this for our family. I do this for our Empire.

We are Eternal.

Chitus

--Chitus Letter III (<https://www.pathofexile.com/forum/view-thread/1538608>)

"Since one with knowledge of machines might be able to bring the labyrinth to a standstill, Izaro had us place many boobytrapped decoys. But I know which switch brings the monster down."

- Xirgil, Trapbuilder's final words

--Xirgil's Crank Coiled Staff (POE I)

You stand before the gates of the Lord's Labyrinth. Within these walls, the Lady of Justice doth preside. She shall weigh your Mind in one hand, your Heart in the other. Should she find you wanting, death shall be your sentence. Should she find you worthy, you will be given the loyalty and love of an empire. The Lord's Labyrinth awaits you. Choose wisely. Strike quickly. Trust completely. And may you find the ending that you deserve.

--Izaro, on the Aspirant's Plaza (POE I)

The Son of Ezomyr met the Son of Sarn
Upon the road to the Imperial throne.
The Eternal offered his cunning,
His eyes and ears, bought and paid for.
The Ezomyte offered his strength,
His sword, earned in the arena.
A pact was forged,
With the Labyrinth as witness.
Two men separated by blood.
Two men bound by hope.
Two men, and only one emperor.

--Weylin, Poem I (POE I)

The Ezomyte and the Eternal took their rest
 In the lee of strife's gale,
 And remembered the travelled road.
 Beast and fiend had fallen and bled,
 To the Ezomyte's sword, swift and true.
 Trap and trial had risen and succumbed,
 To the Eternal's wits, quick and shrewd.
 Two men had cried their triumph,
 A Warrior and his Guide,
 Whilst other ascendants echoed their pride,
 With anguish and agony.

--Weylin, Poem II (POE I)

The Warrior bled upon Izaro's stones,
 And cursed Izaro's ilk.
 He looked upon the walls of his tomb,
 Built by his masters, his enemies,
 And called for the First Ones to carry him,
 To the forest and fields of his Ezomyr.
 Yet while the First Ones remained silent,
 The Guide did speak
 Of secrets planted by clever hands
 Enslaved by gold.
 And with one such secret,
 Plucked the life of the Warrior
 From the First Ones' jaws.

--Weylin, Poem III (POE I)

A Guide, cornered and quailing,
 A Warrior, watching,
 The moment bathed in the shadow
 Of doubt,
 Of ambition,
 Of an imperial throne.
 And a people made free
 By an Emperor of Ezomyr.
 The Warrior threw off that cold and cloying shadow,
 And struck down the slaving beasts.
 The Guide looked to the Warrior
 With gratitude in his eyes.
 And spoke of doubt,
 Of ambition,
 Of an imperial throne,
 And a people made free
 By an Emperor of Sarn.



--Weylin, Poem IV (POE I)

The Guide led the Warrior down a path
That wound and twisted
Through fields of blossoming promises.
Green-bladed hopes.
The Warrior closed his eyes.
A mere moment
To feel the warmth of the sun on his back,
And to drink from the Guide's proffered flask.
Now the Warrior staggers and crawls
Down the wounded, tortured causeway.
The bitterness stings his weeping eyes.
The fire roars in his belly,
Consuming him.
The Warrior will not ascend.
Instead he hunts.
Guided by his love for Ezomyr.



--Weylin, Poem V (POE I)

Before your emperor, you are worthy. Before the Goddess of Justice, you are worthy. Receive our blessings. Embrace our gifts. And rise, ascendant, for this is the ending that we all deserve.

--Izaro, on his defeat (POE I)

THE FATE OF IZARO



When an aging Izaro retired and gave the throne to Chitus on the First Kaso of Verusi, 1319 IC, the new emperor immediately cast Izaro into the Lord's Labyrinth and sealed the gates behind him.

Twinned with the Goddess he worshipped,
Emperor Izaro lives on in the Labyrinth.

--<https://www.pathofexile.com/ascendancy/izaro> (POE I)

The once-glorious emperor spent his final days imprisoned in his greatest creation; a tool to filter out the unworthy that pushed a monster to power.

--Izaro's Turmoil Crimson Jewel (POE I)

So the mad emperor continues to stomp around in his Labyrinth, a speaking dead man inside a grand machine. ...

--Tane Octavius, "Izaro" (POE I)

THE REIGN OF CHITUS: ESTABLISHING A THAUMATOCRACY (1319-1334 IC)

... It was said of the beautiful Atziri that she "wished to see her likeness reflected in the still waters of history." Chitus was no less self-impressed.

Of all the Sins, Vanity is the most hideous.

--Siosa, "Malachai" (POE I)

Emperor Chitus could offer you a gift with one hand, and drive a blade into your back with the other. His blend of brutality and charisma cultured a potent mixture of fear and admiration among the masses.

--Might and Influence Viridian Jewel (POE I)

Chitus began to aggressively expand his empire into neighbouring nations at great human cost. But for absolute power, there is no price that a Perandus won't pay.

--Rapid Expansion Crimson Jewel (POE I)

MALACHAI

Malachai

Laureate Thaumaturge to the Eternal Empire
The Father of Dreams

--Plaque (POE I)

I suppose every civilisation has its Doryani...its Malachai. Men of divine talent and demented ambition. Without them, history would be a far less 'interesting' place.

--Siosa, "Doryani" (POE I)

There is no cost too great to pay for power. Merely men who lack the conviction to pay it.

--Malachai's Awakening Iron Mask (POE I)

Volume 2: The Blackest Monkey

The Monkey King was enjoying an afternoon amble along the riverbank when, upon looking over his hairy shoulder, he noticed the Blackest Monkey he'd ever seen ambling along behind him.

"Why do you follow me?" the Monkey King demanded of the Blackest Monkey, for he did not appreciate uninvited followings, especially on his riverbank amblings.

"So that I might go where you go, be where you be, my King," answered the Blackest Monkey.

"And what if I do not want you to go where I go, be where I be?" clamored the irritated Monkey King with a spit and a gibber.

"Wanting and having are not the same, my King," answered the Blackest Monkey in a voice as smooth as banana juice.

"I am the Monkey King! I do as I wish!" cried the now furious Monkey King with much shrieking and frothing.

"Wishing and doing are not the same, my King," answered the Blackest Monkey in a voice as silken as butterfly wings.

Too wild to even spit or gibber, to shriek or froth, the Monkey King took to his heels and ran. Along the riverbank he raced, faster than the water, faster than the wind, faster than thought, for he was the Monkey King, and all know that the Monkey King has the fleetest feet in all the land.

He ran to the end of the river, and then to the end of the mountains, and then to the end of the clouds, and then to the End of the World.

And who should be there, waiting at his King's feet at the End of the World, but the Blackest Monkey the King had ever seen.

"Why do you follow me?" the Monkey King begged of him.

"Have you ever been to the End of the World before, my King?" asked the Blackest Monkey.

"No, I have not." realised [sic] the Monkey King.

"There is my reason to go where you go, be where you be, my King," concluded the Blackest Monkey in a voice as warm and welcoming as death.

- *Victario of Sarn*

--Victario's Writings (POE I)



My dear Chitus,

The Empire has lived in fear and ignorance since its inception. Our Azmeri ancestors, in their arrogance, turned their backs on the lessons of the Vaal.

The emperors before you lacked courage, lacked vision, paying lip service to 'Eternity' while scrabbling for approval and comfort within the prison of their meagre, mortal lives.

You are not one of those emperors. You are Chitus the Great, the man who will make this Empire truly understand the meaning of the word 'Eternal.'

We shall build this Thaumatrocracy together, my emperor, gem by gem, immortal by immortal.

Your devoted servant,

Malachai

--Letter to Chitus (POE I)

Strange. I was put in charge of dating the most antiquated of texts. This parchment, it's a remarkable copy, but it's no original. Much younger.

Oh my...listen to this!

My dearest Icius,

I have been enlightened beyond expectation. Your work in translating these artefacts is worthy of the highest recompense, and thus I am delighted to offer you a position in my personal laboratory. Please do not give your escorts any consternation. I would be most pained to see such a precious asset damaged in any way.

I very much look forward to working with you, Icius Perandus.

Your friend and admirer,

Malachai

Poor, poor Icius. Wherever you went, my pity goes with you.

--Siosa, "Page Four Translation" (POE I)

... Lazhwar was an unmistakably great mind of our time. Indeed, many of his ideas were stolen by Malachai and used to construct the Eternal Laboratory. It's a shame that Malachai had a hand in his downfall.

--Cadiro, on Stone of Lazhwar (POE I)

STUDYING VIRTUE GEMS

"A Virtue Gem is a raging thunderstorm imprisoned within a single raindrop. Infernal Talc simply lets the storm out." - Malachai the Soulless

--Infernal Talc (POE I)

... Calibric Extantia being the corrupt energies locked within virtue gems. ...

--Helena, "Maligaro's Spike" (POE I)

... Remember, these gems are phantasms in crystalline form, alive, with volitions inscrutable. ...

--Ancient Reverie Device (POE I)

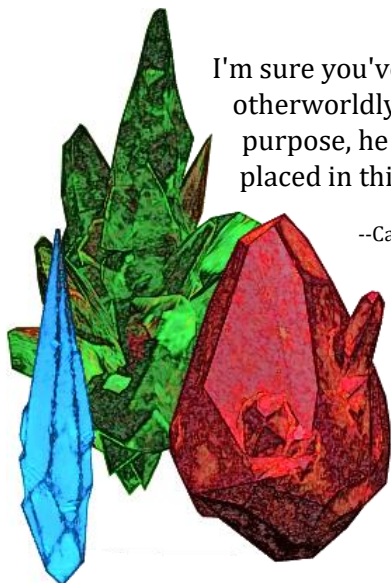
"The gems are strangely human at times. They simply love to be held."

- Doryani, First Seer to the Queen

--Vaal Caress Bronzescape Gauntlets (POE I)

... You will be able to directly manipulate the intelligence that dwells within Virtue Gems.

--Malachai, Path of Exile: Origins #2



I'm sure you've heard of Malachai by now? Ever the heterodox, he often sought otherworldly inspiration by imbibing a substance called 'Ghost Wine'. For the purpose, he created the Decanter Spiritus. I found it on my last visit here. Liquid placed in this crystal decanter becomes quasi-apparitional in nature. ...

--Captain Fairgraves, "Decanter Spiritus" (POE I)

Tear down the walls that imprison the mind...that is what the gems do. That is their true 'virtue.'

The moment my fingertips brushed the cool, silken planes of that first gem, I felt it. My skull ached, as if its contents were growing, pressing against the bone, searching for a way to break free.

That night, once the wine had dulled the pain enough to allow the onset of sleep, the dreams began. I have not been without them since. Nor would I be. Every spark of thaumaturgy that I wield, every device that I forge, every creature that I transfigure, I owe to these lessons cloaked in Nightmare.

From whence do these precepts hail? Certainly not the mundane grey between my ears. I possess only one reference that bears faith. Translated with unquestionable clarity by that idiot savant, Icius Perandus. "The Beast." Doryani of the Vaal knew the truth. Soon now, so shall I.

Malachai

--Malachai's Journal (POE I)

... A dark God of ancient sacrifice, a muse to the twisted and vile...the Beast, the Nightmare, the Darkness...names given to it by mortals that think with slugs bound in shells of bone.

Yet, one man knew the Beast's true name, understood its impenetrable nature.

Malachai.

--Tasuni, "The Beast" (POE I)

THE CREATION OF GEMLINGS & THE GEMLING LEGIONNAIRES

Malachai ran roughshod over every ethical boundary in pursuit of creating the ideal gemling. For him, there was no doubt that the end would justify the means.

--Collateral Damage Viridian Jewel (POE I)

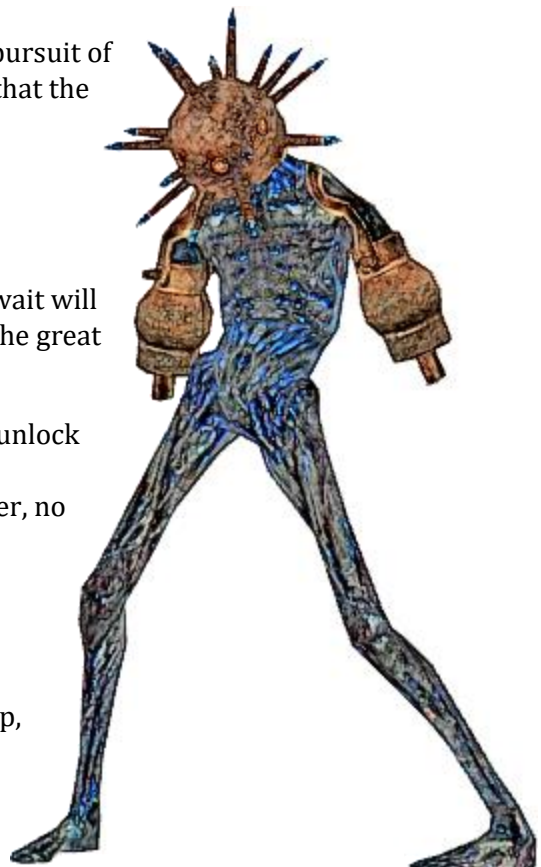
I am so very late. This is deeply embarrassing. I fear the wait will be too long now. But this is the one chance I get to meet the great Laureate and I will not let it go to waste!

Malachai says he has perfected new techniques that will unlock the raw power hidden within the Virtue Gems. I have volunteered my body to the cause. I feel no fear, no hunger, no pleasure... nothing. I only hear his voice. I must obey...

--Unknown, Eternal Residence Memory (POE I)

The Eternals commanded an army that need not eat, sleep, or breathe without the usual depravities of necromancy.

--Iron Commander Death Bow (POE I)





... Gem-studded warriors pounding the earth, lead [sic] by their strongest... a Captain. I've known of these gemling legionnaires, how they were once the personal swords of Emperor Chitus. ...

--Maramoa, "The Gemling Legion" (POE I)

They walked our earth in the times of great strife, cruel and hideous shadows, cast against the clay wall of ruined abode. [sic] Thaumaturge Malachai grew them out of the vain ambitions of his dark imaginings.

Emperor Chitus believed the legionnaires belonged to him, that gemling men would beat to the drum of his own crystalline heart. ...

--Maramoa, "Gemling Legionnaires" (POE I)

... Malachai has given me supreme command of his creations. The heart of each soldier beats in time with the heart of his emperor. If the emperor wishes that beat to stop, it stops. And should my own heart cease, so does the life-blood rhythm of all my loyal soldiers.

--Chitus, Path of Exile: Origins #4

EXPLORING MAPS

"A fool steps into the unknown. An explorer finds his way back again."

- Malachai, Thaumaturge Laureate

--Empyrean Apparatus Cartographer's Strongbox (POE I)

I awoke, feverish, and barely conscious I set to drawing these maps through the sable hours. By morning my fingers ached, my eyes burned, yet still I found no rest. The Reverie commanded its rendering.

The Reverie Device now stands completed. I have placed the first of my maps within its receptacle. I have taken my maiden voyage into Nightmare.

I know now that which sent me this precious gift. It knows me, expects my return. It would be foolish to disappoint.

- Malachai

--Reverie Device (POE I)

"There are worlds that lie beyond the edge of my page, the edge of my understanding. Worlds of wonder. Worlds of terror."

Aramil - Cartographer to Emperor Chitus

--Lost Worlds (POE I)

THE GODLESS THREE

Malachai's apprentices. Shavronne of Umbra, Doedre Darktongue and Inquisitor Maligaro. You'll find no more devoted servants in all of Nightmare. In life, they were the three finest forgers of corruption in the Empire.

... Ingenious, they are. True artists. ...

--Tasuni, "Malachai's Apprentices" (POE I)

... You taught me far more than I ever taught you, my students...my friends. ...

Malachai

--Malachai's Dedication (POE I)

SHAVRONNE OF UMBRA

...Shavronne of Umbra, a witch who devoted herself to the study of transfiguration during the latter days of the Eternal Empire. ...

--Helena, "Prisoner's Gate" (POE I)

This world is dull and ugly, an imperfect feast of sights, feelings and smells that repulse and depress. Yet amongst this deformity I have found my sublime calling. This world may be abominable, but to an extent, I can be its savior.

I have been gifted with a special sight. Before me lies a blueprint of perfection, a kind of hidden beauty within skin, muscles, tendons and organs. With a tempered hand and a sharpened blade, I will refashion, reshape and rebirth this world.

My obligation is immense, something that will, in all likelihood, consume my life. I cannot rest! My calling energises me. Such is an artist's curse and compulsion.

--Shavronne's Manifesto (POE I)

"Some see our mortal flesh as a limitation. I see it as an opportunity for vast miraculous improvements."

- Shavronne of Umbra

--The Aesthete (POE I)

"Mastery of thaumaturgy is like any other pursuit; it requires dedication and sacrifice. Sometimes several sacrifices."

- Shavronne of Umbra

--The Thaumaturgist (POE I)

Eternal beauty has a cost, one which Shavronne was happy to pay with the lives of others.

--The Offering (POE I)

Dear Shavronne,

You have certainly had your work cut out for you with Lioneye's Legion. Do not concern yourself with Marceus' complaints. Our Emperor is fully aware of the General's fickle nature.

As to your need to accelerate the implantation process, I can recommend a quite simple alteration. Dip the gem in a boiling solution of six parts blood and one part thaumetic sulphite for no more than thirteen seconds. Any longer and you invite the crystal's wrath.

Once the gem is withdrawn from the solution, you have but a few seconds to install the gem in the prepared flesh and close the wound. Should the gem cool too much prior to implantation, it will become inert and your patient with it.

Trust in that bountiful talent of yours, Shavronne. My thoughts are with you.

Malachai

--Letter of Instruction (POE I)



INQUISITOR MALIGARO

My interest in this world is dwindling. Most children begin their lives wide-eyed, amazed at what this world has to offer. I have always been different. Since the day I was born I've been searching for the new, the surprising, that which disturbs both senses and mind.

Oh to be an artist! What a lamentable task. Not seeing the world as it is, but as it should be.

Peace is the worst of it! A disgusting state of stagnation, fit only for the weak and vapid. War, confusion, terror. Love and passion, these things are closest the world gets to being interesting and alas, I have felt them all. Yet all these pale in comparison to the delightful chaos I have envisioned for this poor, dull world.

--Maligaro's Manifesto (POE I)

The Chamber of Sins? Apparently the late Archbishop Geofri of Phrecia gave it that title. It was built by Emperor Chitus for one Inquisitor Maligaro. ...

--Eramir, "The Chamber of Sins" (POE I)

"He does not love. He does not feel regret or remorse. He does not think about consequences, only possibilities. If that does not describe a monster, tell me: what does?"

- Archbishop Geofri

--Maligaro's Cruelty Turquoise Amulet (POE I)



...The discomfort shown by the others is amusing, but none can deny that my work has made quite the splash...

- Maligaro's Journal

--Carcass Jack Varnished Coat (POE I)

Inquisitor,

If you were to attempt to transmogrify a virtue gem without the proper mental preparation, you will be a puppet master working strings made of vipers. Remember, these gems are phantasms in crystalline form, alive, with volitions inscrutable. Master conscious dreaming, as I instructed you. Your death means little to me, Maligaro. It's what your demise will unleash that concerns me.

Malachai, Thaumaturge Laureate to the Empire

--Ancient Reverie Device (POE I)

"He might be lacking in vision, but his virtuosity is undeniable."

- Malachai, on Maligaro

--The Surgeon (POE I)

I bequeath this Transmutia Device to you, Inquisitor Maligaro, in recognition of your devotion to our sublime Art. May it be the chariot that conveys your dreams into reality.

Malachai, Thaumaturge Laureate to the Empire

--Transmutia Device (POE I)

Maligaro understood that devotion to science, means devotion to trial and error. For Maligaro's errors, death was slow, and very painful.

--Growing Agony Viridian Jewel (POE I)

"Experiment 22A: Rhoas, when deprived of water, secrete a most delightfully potent toxin."

- Maligaro

--The Rabid Rhoea (POE I)

"Our genius will pave the way forward. May all who are worthy be improved!"

- Inquisitor Maligaro

--Maligaro's Restraint Chain Belt (POE I)

DOEDRE "DARKTONGUE" STAMATIS

...Doedre Darktongue, an idol of fervor and dedication...

Malachai

--Malachai's Dedication (POE I)

Peel back the skin, for there are secrets in sinew. Mysteries in muscle. Plunder the intestinal fortress, reach deep into bowels of power. The esoterica of kings lies [sic] not in the mind, but in the beating walls of a bloodied heart!

The wonders of the universe are screamed from the ramparts of our fleshly fortresses. Shall the meat show us holiness? Oh, how I feel the tingling of our sacred bodies pressed together, tight and fluid.

Let the meat show us the way. Hail the meat, praise the meat. The meat is both debasement and divinity alike. The meat shall lead us down the path to true enlightenment.

--Doedre's Manifesto (POE I)

Doedre Darktongue knew the Way of the Thaumaturge. In order to receive, one must give... without hesitation.

--Doedre's Elixir Greater Mana Flask (POE I)

Maligaro did the cutting... at her request. In the new void, a malevolent power emerged.

--Doedre's Tongue Lapis Amulet (POE I)

After losing her tongue to Maligaro, Doedre embraced her new name with even more innovative means of spellcasting.

--Doedre Darktongue, Steam trading card description (POE I)

While Doedre lacked Maligaro's sense of style, she surpassed her master in pure malevolence.

--Doedre's Tenure Velvet Gloves (POE I)



LADY DIALLA, THE GEMLING QUEEN

I was the emperor's favourite, for a time. But Chitus had many favourites. He filled the Sceptre of God with favourites. Every now and then, he cleared away the clutter. Those who pleased him, they were given to his lords and generals. Those who did not...were given to his thaumaturgists.

I talked too much, asked too many difficult questions. I was gifted to Malachai. My dear, troubled Malachai.

--Lady Dialla, "Chitus" (POE I)



I loved Malachai. He gave me gems, divine jewels for his Gemling Queen...

--Lady Dialla, "Malachai" (POE I)

"I will become your Gemling Queen, my love, but not with such dull stones. I want to give myself to you for eternity. Surely we can seek perfection together?"

--Dialla's Desire (POE II)

1st Caso of Divini, 1333 IC.

"Pretty as porcelain, but her mouth spins like the potter's wheel." That's how I once described Dialla. Yet on this day, my lady is as ravishing as a nightmare, radiant as the fullest moon.

Dialla is my Gemling Queen and we shall rule, side by side, over the world that will soon come to be.

- Malachai

--Journal Entry (POE I)

He took me by my hand, promised me power beyond compare. But I did not do it for power. I did it for love. And I'd do it again in an instant.

--Dialla's Malefaction Sage's Robe (POE I)

I walked halfway across this forsaken continent because of an ode. *Of Jewels and Eternity*, it's called.

For twinkled promises

*Of jewels and eternity,
The Gemling Queen gave her heart
And body
To the King of Shades
For one more day in the sun,
The last day in the sun.*

That's but a portion of the full epic. "The Gemling Queen" lived, and she's the enigma behind the fall of the Ezomytes and the eternalists both. ...

--Grigor, "The Gemling Queen" (POE I)

Dialla has the *form* of a woman, yet the substance is one part corruption and nine parts death.

One day soon, you will see how lifeless she truly is.

--Tasuni, "Dialla" (POE I)

THE KARUI SLAVE TRADE

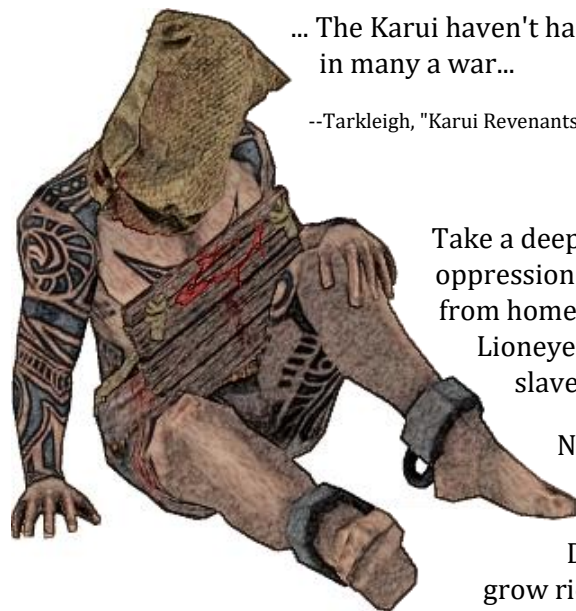
It began with our remote tribes. They would disappear from their islands. Gone without a trace.

For generations, the Eternal Empire... and the bastards of Oriath... raided the weakest of our people and took them as slaves. ...

--Tavakai, on enslaved (POE II)

Karui slaves were once bought and sold like pigs here.

--Marauder, on The Marketplace (POE I)



... The Karui haven't had an easy history. Colonised, enslaved, used as pawns in many a war...

--Tarkleigh, "Karui Revenants" (POE I)

Take a deep breath. Inhale the twin stink of exploitation and oppression. Yes, these pens and cells have been our home away from home since the first Karui were brought here by Marceus Lioneye. Their great 'Hero of the Empire', one of the best slavers they ever had.

Not that he was the only one. Captain Sigmund Fairgraves funded many an expedition off the whipped backs of Karui children. High Templar Dominus was only the latest in a long line of men to grow rich by trading in misery.

Oriathan wealth was built on Karui poverty. Oriathan gold will forever be stained red by Karui blood.

--Utula, "Slave Pens" (POE I)

Founded by Marceus Lioneye as a supply station for his campaigns against the Karui. In its day, Lioneye's Watch could be defended by just a small garrison of well-armed legionnaires. ...

--Tarkleigh, "Lioneye's Watch" (POE I)

SEEDS OF DISCONTENT

Volume 1: Kalisa Maas

I never really understood Brektov's work. Just a mess of trills and squeaky highs to my commoner ears. But that was before Kalisa Maas. From the very first note, her voice reached into my chest and plucked my beating heart from its cage. By the wide, glistening eyes of my fellow punters, I knew that they felt it too.

I've previously stolen a quick nap during the aria that precedes Antonio's disembowelling. Not tonight. The gem at Kalisa's throat sparkled with starlight brilliance as her C sharp shattered every pane of glass in the auditorium. An emergency intermission was called while the stage crew repaired the floods and cans, and a pair of physicians saw to those audience members lacerated by falling splinters.

Now, my suspicion of the Virtue Gems is well-documented. Though general and courtier might fall over each other to have Malachai embed them with these miraculous crystals, it is a travesty of justice that the legionnaires and workers of this Empire should have such mutilations foisted upon them.

Yet, in Kalisa Maas I've seen how these gems may rend apart our mortal bonds and permit our imaginations and souls to truly shine.

I'm adrift in the quandary, no oar in sight. Is Kalisa the Artist or the Art? Is she the same woman I knew before, the young bundle of talent and timidity I had no choice but to adore?

Is she still, in fact, a woman at all?

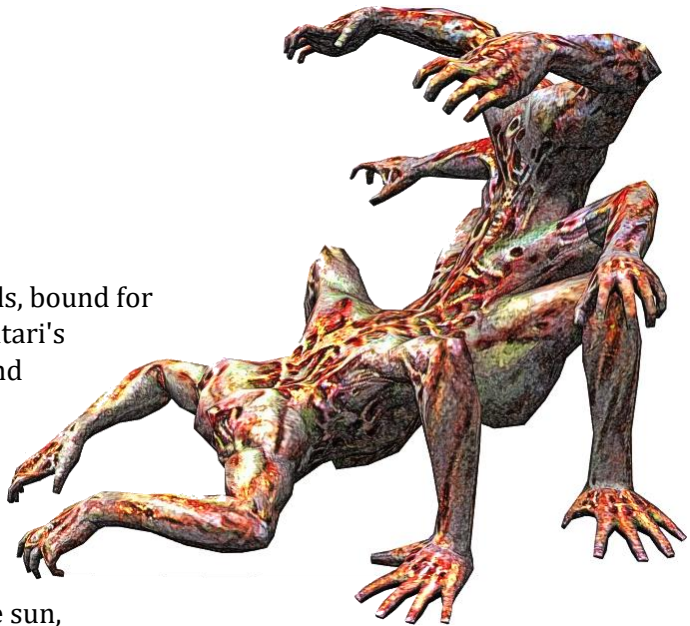
- *Victario of Sarn*

--Victario's Writings (*POE I*)

Volume 3: Slaves of Virtue

Another shipment of human picks and shovels, bound for Highgate. Ezomytes mostly, care of Gaius Sentari's "civilisation camps". A few dark skins here and there, Karui and Maraketh. Malachai has had his wicked way with them all.

Limbs are stretched, contorted, double and triple jointed. All the better to pluck gems from the cracks and fissures of their home and tomb to be. They squint and cower in the sun, their eyeballs injected with gloom so that they might see in the subterranean night as they would in their warm, homeland day.



The shackled slaves shuffle north as the gems they mine tumble south, a glittering landslide of power and privilege for the fairest of our Eternal citizens. Civilisation is bought and paid for with the flesh and blood of the primitive. It is a debt that will one day need to be repaid.

- *Victario of Sarn*

--Victario's Writings (POE I)

Blow it all down! The emperor must have his gems, no matter the cost!

--Trarthan Powder (POE I)

Sarn's slavers knew all too well that comfort leads to laziness, and nothing spreads faster than laziness.

--Lethargy Crimson Jewel (POE I)

These shiny baubles we pull out of the rock are worth more than their weight in gold, yet we hardly get paid at all! We should stop work and demand our fair share.

Don't worry! They're just sealing the entrance as a way to intimidate us! They wouldn't dare leave a thousand men down here to die.

--Unknown, Abandoned Shaft Memory (POE I)

... Vanja: Petarus and I did our research on Adus. ...

Petarus: The General was an eternal commander of the Highgate Legion...

Vanja: He ran a mining camp up here in the mountains. The bastard was the one responsible for controlling Karui, Maraketh and Ezomyte slaves, forcing them into the black bowels of rock fissures in search of gems...

Petarus: ...At least he treated them fairly and as human beings.

Vanja: A slave is still a slave my sweets.

Petarus: For all his faults, the general appears to have been a good man for his time. It's a shame what happened to him...

--Petarus and Vanja, "General Adus" (POE I)

Volume 4: A Friend in Need

It's one of those summer days in Sarn, when the sweat dries on your skin the moment it dares slither from your pores. Lorenzi and I are sipping coffees, iced with cubes from the North. There's a tremor in his voice as he announces that he is going to see Malachai tonight, to have a gem implanted in his hand. The palm of his left hand to be exact. Once I have run out of expletives and paused for breath while the waiter wipes spilled coffee from our table, I manage to ask him why. "So that I might have the fastest fingers in the Empire," is his reply. Lorenzi, first violinist of the Sarn Symphonic, and my dear friend, is going to become a Gemling.

Ten days pass and Lorenzi's hand is healed. He plays for me, a piece that he has written during his convalescence, something he will debut this evening in God's Theatre. The gem casts a bloody hue over his violin as his fingers fly across the strings. They are an ephemeral blur, too quick for eye or mind to follow. And the music... there's only one experience in my life that compares. The night I had with Marylene before she died.

It has been a month now, and once again Lorenzi and I sip iced coffees together in the Perandus Markets. Though we sit only a narrow table apart, Lorenzi is a world away. The nightmares began a couple of weeks back. He toys absently with the vial that I have bought for him from the apothecary, yet I know he won't drink from it. The soothing of his wits will mean the slowing of his fingers. The music is Lorenzi's life, and to Lorenzi, the music and the gem are one and the same.

A year has gone, and the day is once again hot enough to dry the sweat on my skin the moment it dares slither from my pores. I sip an iced coffee and think of Lorenzi. He played last night, in God's Theatre. Fleet, furious, and wondrous, he was. We passed in the foyer, and I looked into his grey face, his pale blue eyes. I don't know what he saw, but it wasn't me. I don't know what I saw either, but it wasn't Lorenzi.

- *Victario of Sarn*

--Victario's Writings (*POE I*)

THE PURITY REBELLION (1332-1334 IC)

Chitus thought that the Gemling was the pinnacle of human progress. "These glorious gems have brought us within spitting distance of godhood", he once said. The High Templar at the time, Voll of Thebrus, thought they were a perversion. He wanted the Empire made pure, "cleansed of the stain of thaumaturgy". ...

--Clarissa, "The Purity Rebellion" (*POE I*)

Book 1: Embers of Insurrection

"He soared to power on the smoke of burning witches". So the surviving Gemlings whispered of Voll of Thebrus, as he donned the Imperial crown on the 2nd Sacrato of Phreci, 1334 IC. But in truth, he was never the sort of man to set a girl alight for merely reading a palm or remedying a bout of the clap.

Righteous and devoted to both faith and country, High Templar Voll struck little hardship in gathering others to his godly cause: Sarn's own Lord Mayor Ondar and Victario, the People's Poet; Archbishop Geofri of Phrecia; Governor Kastov of Stridevolf; and Commander Adus of Highgate. Together, these Warriors of Purity forged an uprising against the Gemling thaumatocracy that Voll hoped would "snatch this empire from the claws of devilry and return it to humanity".

- *Garivaldi, Chronicler to the Empire*

--The Purity Chronicles (POE I)

KAOM, HYRRI, & THE UNIFICATION OF THE KARUI

...Marcus Lioneye. Their great 'Hero of the Empire', one of the best slavers they ever had. ...

--Utula, "Slave Pens" (POE I)

Marcus commanded the southernmost of the Eternal Legions, here at Lioneye's Watch. Why was he called Lioneye? Crazy fool had his left eye taken out and a golden-hued gem put in its place.

His head must have made quite the pretty adornment for King Kaom's belt.

--Bestel, "Marcus Lioneye" (POE I)

It's an often-told story among the Karui. How Voll of Thebrus bent his knee to my ancestor, King Kaom, and promised freedom in return for war. While Voll raised his Purity Rebellion in the heart of the Empire, Kaom took Lord Lioneye's head and the southern coast all the way to the Siren's Cove. It was the greatest conquest the Karui had ever seen.

--Maramoa, "The Purity Rebellion" (POE I)

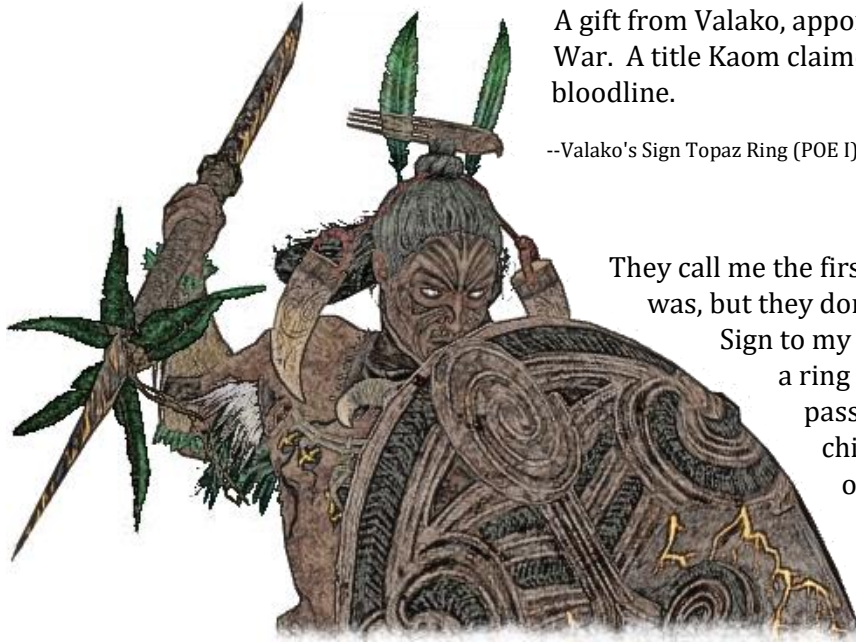
One by one, Kaom slaughtered the weakest tribe leaders until the others leapt to join his cause.

--Kaom's Primacy Karui Chopper (POE I)

KILOAVA & THE VALAKO TRIBE

I have a complex relationship with Valako. I speak to him, and he remains silent. It's just like my last wife! I joke, but... we're alone. The Karui must forge their own path in this world. Valako is more like our tribe mascot than an actual figure of leadership or aid.

--Kiloava, "Valako" (POE I)



A gift from Valako, appointing Kiloava as the Herald of War. A title Kaom claimed when he ended Kiloava's bloodline.

--Valako's Sign Topaz Ring (POE I)

They call me the first Herald of War, and indeed I was, but they don't understand. Valako gave a Sign to my people thousands of years ago, a ring with his graven pattern. It passed down from chieftain to chieftain in my tribe. When I put it on, it did something it never had before: it surged with the power of the storm. Valako didn't know me. How could he? The gods were asleep. So,

I appointed *myself* the Herald of War, and I used the power of Valako's Sign to win many great battles. I laid the foundations for Karui unification before Kaom was even an urge in some bastard's loins.

--Kiloava, "Herald of War" (POE I)

Many think I was 'defeated' by Kaom in some grand battle, but I was seventy-four when he took my head. He essentially bullied an old man. Can you picture my delight when I awoke [in the Halls of the Dead] in my prime? ...I'm just overcome with joy at being young and strong again. ...

--Kiloava, "Souls" (POE I)

Certain arrogant warlords claim my bloodline was ended, but they don't know just how many children I really had... I was something of a madman in my prime! Half the warriors serving under them might be descended from me at this point! Ha ha! Ah... they come to the Halls of the Dead for advice. I tell them to drink, fight, and enjoy life while they have it!

--Kiloava, "Bloodline" (POE I)

AKOYA & THE NGAMAHU TRIBE

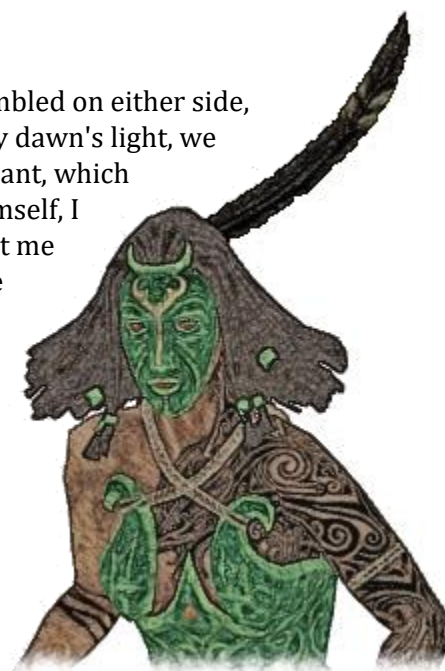
No man may enslave you, for you have a secret: you're always angry.

--Chainbreaker (POE I)

A gift from Ngamahu, a sign to the Karui to spread like fire. Given to Akoya, but inherited by Kaom with the swing of his axe.

--Ngamahu's Sign Ruby Ring (POE I)

My battle with Kaom began at sunrise. Our warriors were assembled on either side, ready to slaughter each other, but neither of us gave the sign. By dawn's light, we fought on the sand, axe against axe. Kaom was strong, but arrogant, which showed through in his fighting style. When he overextended himself, I made him pay for it in blood. However, his greater strength kept me on the defensive. Every hour, the *hatungo* called a truce, and we drank, ate, and were tended to. By nightfall, Kaom and I were moving like turtles, guarding ourselves behind our axes and taking only the most calculated movements. Eventually, he overextended again, and I dealt him a heavy wound to his chest—but this was an acceptable sacrifice he had made on purpose. He broke my knee with the end of his axe handle, and that was it. He gave me a warrior's death, rather than leave me broken on the sands. I would not have had it any other way.



--Akoya, "Death" (POE I)

RAKIATA & THE TASALIO TRIBE

Even in my earliest memories, I was training for battle. I do enjoy fighting, but not the way others around me did. To them, it was a savage contest of dominance and manhood. To me, there was an elegance to warfare. It had an ebb and flow, like the tide. It was a kind of dance. When they say I have an unconventional fighting style, it is because they do not realize that I am not fighting. I am dancing. I may feel the bite of an axe at any moment, so why not enjoy each sweep, and each slash? They have their Way. What I have, I call the Flow.

--Rakiata, "The Way" (POE I)

Stuffy traditions make for poor warriors.

--Rakiata, on Akoya (POE I)

I was thirteen when an Eternal army attacked my tribe. They were in search of an ancient and powerful weapon from our myths, but we only had a single piece of it. Our chieftain was felled in his sleep. My father was as well. So, I took up his weapons, and I went about the work that needed to be done. Once they were dead, knowing that more would come if we had what they wanted, I entrusted Tasalio with our piece of that fabled spear. My tribe tried to put me in charge after that, but I refused the mantle. I just did what I thought was right, and they followed.

Although... there was something to the myth of that spear's power. In the few moments I held just a piece of it, my hand was permanently scarred, as if I'd been burned by unseen and unfelt heat.

--Rakiata, "First Battle" (POE I)



Tasalio has never spoken to me directly. I think I hear his influence in the waves, and the wind over the ocean. I found a ring on the shore one day, bearing his graven pattern. It had washed up from the ocean, and I still believe it was a gift from him. It had a great power within it, but I never used it. I didn't need to. There were no problems I could not face with my own strength and cunning.

--Rakiata, "Tasalio" (POE I)

A gift from Tasalio, God of Water, to the chieftain Rakiata. Kaom took Rakiata's head and hand so that his warriors' axes might rise and fall like the waves.

--Tasalio's Sign Sapphire Ring (POE I)

[Ikiaho]'s stronger than she knows. She doesn't need me to fight battles on her behalf, nor would she want me to. When I first arrived [in the Halls of the Dead], many of the other chieftains were hostile, and the most traditional among them outright rejected me. It was she who vouched for me. The opportunity to fight allowed me to prove myself, as I knew I could, and I have led Tasalio's warriors ever since. In Ikiaho, I could not have asked for a better friend. Sometimes, we even sneak out of here, for a

glimpse at the Moon and the sea.

--Rakiata, "Ikiaho" (POE I)

INVADING THE SOUTHERN COAST

I have already proven that the Karui Way is the one true path. I united the otherwise squabbling tribes into one mighty horde, the greatest the world has ever known, and I did that with the sheer force of my axe. ...

--Kaom, "The Karui Way" (POE I)

Kaom's canoe struck this sand with the force of destiny. At his back, the greatest war host in Karui history tamed the wild sea, their canoes coupling with the land, one by one.

Lioneye's Gemlings met us with shining metal and bold words. Hyrri's arrows withered their pride. Kaom's axes silenced their despair. Marceus Lioneye fought bravely, to the last. Kaom honoured him with a place on his belt.

Kaom has shown Wraeclast our Karui strength. Kaom will teach Wraeclast the Karui Way.

--Lavianga, Weathered Carving I (POE I)

Kaom watched the torches patrol the top of the Watch. He observed the lay of the beach, its barricades and rocks, and his men in their canoes, ready to lay their lives down for him. But when his foot hit the sand, he thought only of the fight.

--Combat Focus Viridian Jewel (POE I)

Lioneye's men stood at the walls, eyeing the savages that walked the beach below. With a single word, a thousand bodies, and ten thousand arrows, would litter the sands.

--Volley Fire Viridian Jewel (POE I)

With a fire burning brash in his golden eye, Marceus fired his arrow into the pitch-dark sky, and seared the hope of surprise, from Kaom's skulking horde.

--Pitch Darkness Viridian Jewel (POE I)

Seeing only foot soldiers, the Sarn Knights cast aside their heavy shields... and paid dearly for their mistake.

--Broadstroke Heavy Quiver (POE I)

Hyrri loosed a barrage of arrows, tipped with a poisoned hatred only oppression can ferment.

--Hyrri's Ire Zodiac Leather (POE I)

"Hyrri and her arrows broke the sacred code, damning herself. Kaom seized her sacrifice, and in doing so, seized victory."

- Lavianga, Advisor to Kaom

--Tavukai Coral Amulet (POE I)

Even as the tide turned, and victory swiftly became impossible, the legionnaires of Lioneye's Watch stood their ground and fought on, every last man dying a brutal but honourable death.

--Overwhelming Odds Crimson Jewel (POE I)



Book 3: Fall of a Jade Axe

In a man-to-man fight on open ground, a Gemling Legion would have slaughtered Kaom's Karui warriors like so many pigs in a pen. But Kaom had no intention of engaging Lioneye in a fair fight. By absorbing some heavy losses and feigning a chaotic retreat, Kaom drew Marceus into ordering his Gemlings to abandon their tower shields so that they might pursue and rout the fleeing Karui.

It was not out of recklessness that Lioneye plucked such a decision, but from the experience-born confidence that the Karui did not have archers. Traditionally, Karui warriors are forbidden from using projectile weapons of any kind. What Lioneye understandably overlooked was that this tavukai (sacred prohibition) did not extend to women. At her uncle's behest, Hyrri had traveled to Thebrus and studied archery with Voll's finest military tutors. When the legionnaires shed protection in favour of mobility, Hyrri and her bow-women broke cover and rained death upon the Gemlings from the cliffs above.

A valiant Marceus Lioneye gathered his surviving legionnaires for a final stand within the walls of Lioneye's Watch. Kaom honoured his bravery by wearing Marceus' bejeweled head upon his belt from that day on.

Having secured a safe harbour for landing reinforcements, Kaom continued his conquest of the coast, slaughtering the Eternal citizens and clearing the way for the first ever settlement of Karui upon the Wraeclastian mainland.

- *Garivaldi, Chronicler to the Empire*

--The Purity Chronicles (POE I)

There is no Honour without Sacrifice.

--Lioneye's Standard (POE I)

Everyone is dead and I am alone. The Karui swept through the watch so quickly, we didn't have a chance to flee. Men, women, even children, slaughtered. I'm lucky to be alive. But I cannot return home now. No.

I'd be branded a coward, imprisoned, and hung for desertion. I have no choice. I must make do out in the wilds. Perhaps a farmer will take pity on me. And if not, I have my blade. I will take what I need by force.

--Unknown, Distant Lush Crater Memory (POE I)



News of Kaom's victory in the south spread quickly. Those in support of the coming rebellion bided their time. The rest fled like rats from a fire.

--Wildfire Crimson Jewel (POE I)

Still the Karui barbarians advance upon us. Lioneys is dead, his legion slaughtered, along with every Eternal man, woman and child from Lioneys's Watch to the foot of our Axiom. Should the need arise we shall retreat through Prisoners Gate, raising my barricade behind us.

Yet our salvation is at hand. Foul times demand heroic deeds, and through my arts our Lord Brutus will arise anew to defend us. May the dry sands quench their thirst with Karui blood when our mighty Warden delivers his judgement upon them.

--Shavronne's Journal (POE I)

Shavronne raced to Brutus' side, her last hope against the Karui tide.

--Shavronne's Pace Scholar Boots (POE I)

Ha! Lioneys's failure against Kaom comes as no surprise. He was always more arrogant than skilled. It is time a real man showed the Karui the might of the Eternal Empire.

Shavronne assures me that my process will be relatively painless, and that my duties as warden can continue unhindered, but as my flesh swells and ruptures, I realise I am just another test subject. At least I can fulfill my duties to the Empire before my mind--

--Brutus, Synthesis memory (POE I)

High above the crashing surf of Wraecast, shrouded in the fog and ceaseless driving rain, stands an imposing structure. No one remembers who built it, and it is known among the island's inhabitants simply as "The Prison". Throughout the ages, as various tribes and societies have risen to power on Wraecast, they have always locked their criminals deep inside The Prison's formidable stone walls. The ancient fortress keeps its prisoners and countless secrets locked far away. Sometimes, on cold, still nights, you can hear the tortured wailing of the doomed souls still trapped within its confines.

Every jail needs a warden, and The Prison is no exception. Though the job has been held by countless men over the ages, anyone living today can only recall one name: Brutus. He was the overseer of The Prison when Wraecast's old men were just children, and he is the overseer to this day. Mothers get their children to behave by telling them that Brutus will come to see them. He is Wraecast's Boogeyman.

Brutus ran The Prison with a legendary cruel streak. Under his stewardship, not a single soul escaped its soaring walls, and men were terrified at the prospect of a term inside. Alas, even great, terrible men cannot conquer the ravages of time, and as Brutus' years drew to a close, he became steadily more deranged and dangerous. He began to invite practitioners of dark, fel arts to The



Prison to experiment on his captives, and eventually, in a desperate bid to extend his own waning life, he allowed them to experiment on him.

For days the halls of The Prison echoed with Brutus' awful shrieking, and when it was over, he was transformed into a hideous, hulking mutant. As the Necromancers crowded around to witness the results of their twisted endeavor, Brutus burst free from his bonds and descended on them with savagery. Their aged, frail bodies offered little resistance to his assault, and within moments the chamber was drenched in Necromancer blood. Brutus then tore through the entire level of the prison, leaving none alive in his merciless rampage.

When word of the slaughter reached the lower levels, the remaining guards made the only choice left to them. They barred the gates, locking the monster in the topmost level of The Prison. It did not take long for Brutus to realize he was trapped, and in his mad rage to escape, he pounded his mighty fists into a raw meaty pulp on the jail walls. So far, the gates have held, and Brutus remains sealed away, unable

to inflict further carnage. Time has not diminished his anguish, and woe be unto anyone foolish enough to engage him in combat.

--<https://web.archive.org/web/20140622192652/http://www.pathofexile.com/monsters/brutus>

... Brutus was Warden of Axiom Prison and one of the most feared men in the Eternal Empire. But there the histories end... and the myth begins, with Brutus commissioning a witch to transform him, in a mad attempt at immortality. A moment of hubris that didn't end well... for anyone. ...

--Nessa, "Brutus" (POE I)

"Shavronne held Sanity in her right hand and Revelation in her left. Brutus chose the left hand."

- Kadavrus, Surgeon to the Umbra

--Shavronne's Revelation Moonstone Ring (POE I)

Old axe for brains. Kaom had Eternals dragged from their homes all over the south coast.

Like sheep, he butchered them, no matter how desperately they bleated. He adorned his doorways with the heads of women and children.

What makes a hero or a villain? It depends who you ask.

--Dialla, "Kaom" (POE I)

Kaom ordered the desecration of the Empire's dead. There would be no rest or honours for the wicked.

--Kaom's Command Siege Helmet (POE I)

Kaom has removed the Eternal stain from this coast. The Empire's citizens decorate our meeting houses with their heads. Our warriors build homes for our families. Our families till the earth, fish the waters, fill the air with song.

The Karui Way is yet a seedling here, but it grows, gains in pride and power every day. Kaom has kept his promise. The time of the Karui has come.

--Lavianga, Weathered Carving II (POE I)

[These events are also covered in Path of Exile: Origins #1, "The Karui Way."]

DESHRET & THE MARAKETH

This isn't widely known, but Hector Titucius was an Ezomyte by birth.

--Leo, "Hector Titucius" (POE I)

What little humanity General Titucius was born with, he traded in for strength. Went as far as to have Malachai replace his joints with virtue gems... mad bastard. Afterwards, Emperor Chitus charged Titucius with subduing the Maraketh, a job he took a little too much pleasure in, if you ask me.

--Hargan, "Hector Titucius" (POE I)



Asenath loosed arrows with almost musical rhythm, a rhythm matched by her nearly inaudible whispers, and the crunch of the dead hitting the dust.

--Asenath's Chant Iron Circlet (POE I)



... You ever heard of the Wings of Vastiri? Not just another damned artefact. This one was the highest symbol of office for the Maraketh, held by the "Sekhema of Sekhemas". History books say the Wings were last worn by Sekhema Asenath, the Golden Sekhema... the one who went and got herself murdered by Hector Titucius. ...

--Hargan, "The Wings of Vastiri" (POE I)

... The wings are a treasured piece of the Maraketh heritage. Back when the tribes quit their squabblings and joined hands to battle the Eternal Empire, the wings were seen as a symbol of their unity. The Golden Sekhema wore them as she led the whole bloody Maraketh horde against Sarn. She was the single greatest hope for the Maraketh, was that Asenath.

Hector Titucius crushed both their hopes and their precious sekhema.

--Hargan, "The Wings of Vastiri" (POE I)

"You killed their Golden Sekhema. The Maraketh will think of nothing but vengeance now." - Dimos, Advisor to General Titucius

--Daevata's Wind War Spear (POE II)

Book 4: The Red Sekhema's Saddle

In return for her military support in the rebellion, Voll promised Sekhema Deshret the return of the Maraketh grazing lands stolen during the imperial conquest of the Vastiri Plains. The Red Sekhema agreed on one condition, that she might have Hector Titucius' skin with which to fashion a rhoa saddle.

To this end, Voll and Deshret engineered a trap for General Titucius and his Vastiri Legion. The Maraketh had long been able to predict the comings and goings of the vast and vicious dust storms that constantly plague the plains. Deshret located one such fledgling maelstrom within a day's march of Titucius' camp. For his part, Voll identified a number of imperial spies amongst the Maraketh and fed them false information regarding a potential tribal uprising. Taking the bait, Titucius had his Gemling legion surround the supplied location, thus placing himself squarely in the path of Deshret's dust storm.

On the third Galvano of Vitali 1333 IC, the tempest descended upon Titucius' legion with blinding, deafening ferocity. Deshret's *akhara*, born and raised in dust and wind, swept through the legion, harvesting it like a field of ripe corn. Once storm and Maraketh fury had abated, the Vastiri Legion existed only as a multitude of dust-cloaked mounds. The Red Sekhema claimed her prize and it is said that there is no more comfortable saddle in all of Vastiri than Deshret's.

- *Garivaldi, Chronicler to the Empire*

--The Purity Chronicles (POE I)

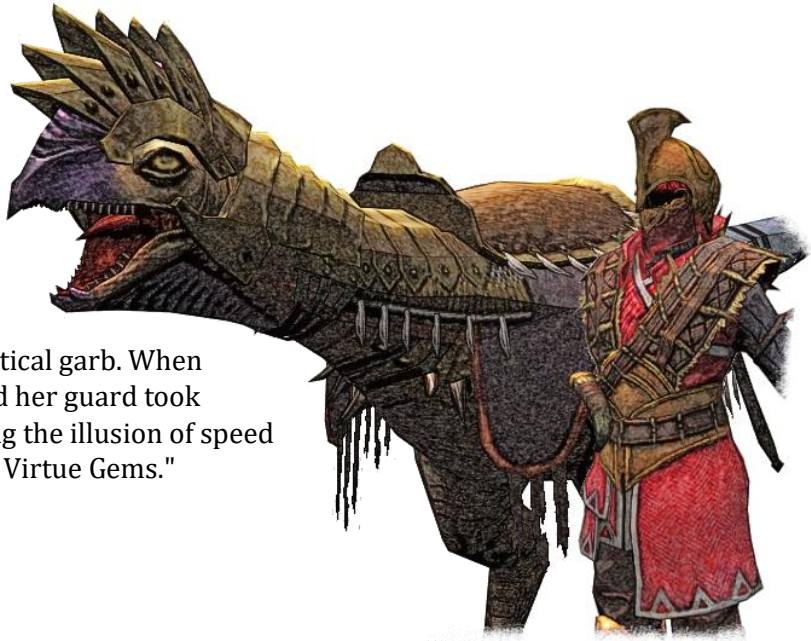
When the Red Sekhema called,
the Ardura were the first to
answer.

--Crest of Ardura Jingly Crest Shield (POE II)

"Greatly outnumbered, Deshret
dressed her personal guard in identical garb. When
the Empire rode north, Deshret and her guard took
turns revealing themselves, creating the illusion of speed
beyond the capabilities of even the Virtue Gems."

- History of the Maraketh

--Careful Planning Viridian Jewel (POE I)



The Maraketh knew that a mountain path free of vegetation was cut by regular avalanches, and so
the advancing Eternals were unwittingly drawn into a deathtrap.

--Frozen Trail Cobalt Jewel (POE I)

When a woman forgets how to die, a woman forgets how to live.

Deshret said that to her *dekhara* on the day she killed Titucius, Scourge of the Maraketh. ...

--Kira, "Dialla" (POE I)

ARCHBISHOP GEOFRI

The Chamber of Sins? Apparently the late Archbishop Geofri of Phrecia gave it that title. It was built
by Emperor Chitus for one Inquisitor Maligaro. ...

--Eramir, "The Chamber of Sins" (POE I)

... 'The Spike'. Fashioned by Inquisitor Maligaro, it was said to enable the injection of 'Calibric
Extantia' into living flesh. Calibric Extantia being the corrupt energies locked within virtue gems. ...

--Helena, "Maligaro's Spike" (POE I)

Maligaro had an assistant, a man named Raulo. If Maligaro's records spoke truly, Raulo offered himself freely as a test subject. With the Spike, Maligaro injected Raulo with a high dose of calibric extantia, thus gifting the poor man with both endless life and horrific deformity.

In honour of his sacrifice to Maligaro's work, the Inquisitor gave Raulo a new name. Fidelitas.

--Helena, "Fidelitas" (POE I)

Maligaro was transformed by Raulo's love. Thaumaturgy allowed Maligaro to return the favour.

--Fidelitas' Spike Jagged Foil (POE I)

Perverse loyalty, blind love, the abuser and the abused reunited in sin.

--Echoes of Mutation (POE I)

According to his notes, the Baleful Gem was a byproduct of Maligaro's attempts to enhance the already formidable qualities of virtue gems. It was an abject failure yet Maligaro wasn't one to waste his atrocities.

By combining the Baleful Gem with the venom extracted from one of his arachnid subjects, he brewed something called 'Black Elixir'. He proudly proclaimed it to be 'the most potent poison in existence' until it was stolen by a man named Victario.

It was rather entertaining to read Maligaro's intentions for Victario once he caught the man. Twisted... yet I can't fault the Inquisitor's creativity.

--Helena, "The Baleful Gem" (POE I)

Upon learning of Maligaro's horrific experiments, Archbishop Geofri initiated a massive movement to purge the miscreations and their master.

--Archbishop Geofri, Steam trading card description (POE I)

Archbishop Geofri the Abashed

Templar and theologian, Geofri was a stoic of the Eternal Faith. He deplored anything thaumaturgical, and was therefore disgusted when Chitus installed Maligaro's laboratory into the





Phrecian Forest, not a stone's throw from Geofri's Phrecia Cathedral (now the Fellshrine ruins). It was Geofri who coined the title, "Chamber of Sins" for Maligaro's lab.

Geofri plotted with High Templar Voll to destroy Maligaro and his work, but Maligaro got wind of the building threat. Maligaro's pre-emptive strike put an end to the plot, and to Geofri who was slain with Maligaro's Etcher at the foot of Saint Corutino the Golden Hand's Shrine.

Archbishop Geofri remains in Fellshrine to this day, animated by The Twist into a Brittle Templar of some power.

--Eternal and Diamond Supporter Newsletter #20 (POE I)

Fellshrine stood as a holy bastion opposite the Chamber of Sins, and all that it represented. For one to rise, the other must fall.

--The Balance of Terror Cobalt Jewel (POE I)

[These events are also covered in Path of Exile: Origins #2, "Sons of Virtue."]

THE EZOMYTES

RIGWALD & THE REBELLION OF EZOMYR

The enslaved EzomYTE clans were not permitted to own weapons. For years, they trained in secret, watching and waiting for the perfect moment to reveal the true depth of the Empire's folly.

--Divide and Conquer Viridian Jewel (POE I)

The Empire poisons our blood with sweet wine.
Poisons our flesh with silk.
Poisons our minds with civil lies.
Poisons our children with servitude.

- The Woven King

--Deadhand Talisman (POE I)

We Ezomytes are beasts of burden bearing wealth of an empire on our backs, growing lean and strong while our masters grow fat and weak.

- The Wolven King

--Spinefuse Talisman (POE I)

You can take a wolf from the forest. You can collar him, chain him. You can starve him, beat him until he whimpers and bows down. Yet, is that wolf a dog?

Never.

A man is only a slave when he allows his heart and his mind to be conquered. When he comes to believe that his life is no longer his own. When he chooses to cast his eyes forever to the ground.

Like a king that chooses to press his lips to the feet of an emperor. A king that looks to his goblet and his plate, feasting and fattening while his people starve in their own streets.

Some might say that I should bear the guilt of regicide. That I killed the King of the Ezomytes. Yes, I served King Skothe his last meal, for I saw no king at that table.

I saw a dog.

- Rigwald, the Wolven King

--Inscription I (POE I)

"Skothe kept us idle, sitting safe on these islands, while our brethren remain slaves. We are one and the same! We must fight! So, I bring you his head. I am now your Wolven King!"

--Rigwald's Ferocity (POE II)

I once believed that a boy's eyes were born pure, clear of cruelty and malice. That it is life that teaches one to hate, to strike out at others through anger and fear.

Yet when I looked into the eyes of Gaius Sentari, I found no anger. I found no hatred. I read no tales of injustice inflicted upon youthful innocence. Saw no walls built by suffering and sorrow.

Instead, I was regarded as a merchant might regard beasts of burden at a market. By Governor Sentari, my countrymen and I were counted, weighed, and allocated. This man to the mines. This woman to the mills. This child to the streets of Sarn to be worked and flogged until the day his blood would drain into the sewers of that wretched city.

And those that resisted, those that asked to be treated as anything other than animals, were skinned and butchered, with an even dozen of their kin.

Fear not the man who lusts. Fear not the man who hates. Fear the man who feels nothing at all.

- Rigwald, the Wolven King

--Inscription II (POE I)

Victario, a fellow warrior of words. He wrote many entreaties to the Ezomytes, begging our assistance in helping High Templar Voll depose Emperor Chitus. ...

--Grigor, "Victario" (POE I)

Book 2: Bloody Flowers

High Templar Voll had Victario entreat Thane Rigwald of Ezomyr, knowing that a poet would fare far better than any politician in rousing the romantic Ezomytes to rebellion. Stirred by Victario's impassioned words, Rigwald mustered his blood-bound clans, and on the 3rd Fiero of Dirivi 1333 IC, took to the fields of Glarryn in open rebellion against Governor Gaius Sentari.

Such was the colourful splendour of a thousand tartans and banners that the Ezomyte uprising became known as "The Bloody Flowers' Rebellion". Though Sentari's Gemling legionnaires slew three Ezomytes for every one of their own fallen, the Bloody Flowers won the day through sheer fury-driven courage.

Governor Sentari fled to Sarn, only to return in Astrali with reinforcements drawn from the capital, Vastiri and southern garrisons. Little did Sentari know that, by so weakening those forces, he was playing right into Voll's hands.

- *Garivaldi, Chronicler to the Empire*

--The Purity Chronicles (POE I)

"Today, clansmen, my sword is my voice!"

- Rigwald, at the Battle of Glarryn

--Rigwald's Charge Highland Blade (POE I)



The colours and banners of a hundred clans, scattered like the wildflowers of spring across the meadows of Glargarryn. Thousands of men and women, starving, poor, armed with rusted hatchets and hunting bows, looking across that field, with the courage of desperation, at the imperial legion arrayed against them.

Soldiers gleaming in bronze and steel. Trained and hardened men. Their polished shields forming a wall of discipline and determination against the advances of my motley rabble.

"I sing, I rant, I rave," I said to them, "but today, clansmen, my sword is my voice!"

We crashed against that legion like waves upon a cliff. Time and time again they repelled us. The green meadows became brown and red with the mud of toil and the blood of war. Yet what is a slave to do? Suffer the lingering death of mine and mill, or offer the gift of your life to your people in one bright and glorious moment?

For the men and women who followed me into battle, the choice was a simple one.

Three Ezomytes fell for every Eternal and still the courage of my people tore down that polished wall, severed the strong arm of the Empire with a rusted, woodsman's hatchet.

Gaius Sentari ran for his wretched life.

I called to the Greatwolf to aid me, to give me the scent of that fleeing fox. Though the hunt was swift, I took the time to ensure that Gaius felt some small measure of the suffering he had inflicted before I answered his plea for mercy.

- Rigwald, the Wolven King

--Inscription III (POE I)

THE OCCUPATION & LIBERATION OF OGHAM

... We did not always call this part of Phaaryl our homeland... and now the Eternals have come with their armies and laid claim to this place. It'll be a cold day in the Vastiri Desert before we submit!

--Lachlann the Lost, "Ogham" (POE II)

This part of Phaaryl has been a fair home for many an Ezomyte generation. The clans didn't always get along, but we had to settle our feuds when the Eternals laid their savage boot upon us.

We weren't able to take part in the Bloody Flowers Rebellion, but we had our share of conflict with them here. ...

--Renly, "Ogham" (POE II)

Praetor Draven knew his only chance to subjugate the Ezomytes was to catch them unaware.

--Dionadair Splintered Tower Shield (POE II)

The Praetor...? Oh, the Praetor! That monster! He is the worst man the Eternals could have chosen as the custodian for this territory. Had he come to us in peace, the clans might have been willing to talk, but that damn swine regards us as nothing but dogs.

He invaded the village in the night, without warning, without honour! He seized my family, to try to force us to surrender.

The Eternal Empire cares for nothing but power! But mark my words, we will not be ground under the heel of tyranny!

--Lachlann the Lost, "Praetor Draven" (POE II)

"A thief in the night, Draven did creep,
families asleep, taken, held on high.
Clever, he thought, 'til his children paid.
Nay, villain, a man never bleeds alone."

--Dunkelhalt Leather Buckler (POE II)

My dearest daughter, Beloved for all time. Rest well.

--Draven, Grieving Epitaph (POE II)

My beloved son, your death shall be avenged, even if it takes one thousand years.

--Asinia, Sorrowful Memoriam (POE II)

Let this be a testament for all time. The Eternal Empire stakes claim over this land, both in life and death!

--Asinia's Proclamation (POE II)

Our victory is never complete, so long as the Ezomytes resist us. Let this graveyard erase their stain on the land.

--Draven's Dictum (POE II)

This graveyard is being built atop our clan graves by our oppressors, as an insult intended to crush our spirits. Misguided tyrants! We will never give up the fight.

We're wearing them down, flesh and spirit. Conquerors they may be, but strong? Ha!

--Lachlann, on the graveyard (POE II)

The graves of our people lie beneath the Eternals' tombs. Despite their best efforts to bury our legacy, we remain. ...

This is the cycle of life as we have always known it. Everyone dies, but the clan endures, and the greatest glory an Ezomyte can attain is to live on in a song or a poem.

That is why we do not fight the wood and stone to reclaim our buried graves, and it is something the Eternals never understood: we don't need the graves. We still have the songs and the stories that matter. They could never take those from us.

--Una, "Cemetery of the Eternals" (POE II)

... The Eternals stomped their graves all over ours when they had a conqueror's foothold here. ...

Some even say, when the night is darkest, our ancestors still fight theirs among the tombs--and I don't doubt it. A true Ezomyte never surrenders their land, not even in death.

--Renly, "Cemetery of the Eternals" (POE II)

My mother's mother told me tales of this Tree. Our ancestors used it to attract fey spirits, until it was given a darker purpose under the Eternals.

They would leave Ezomytes strung up on the tree... alive... to starve... to be pecked at by birds...

--Una, "The Tree of Souls" (POE II)



You must understand our way of life to know how dire this situation has become. The Count is the voice of our people, even above the Thaners.

The role of Count was created to unify our clans against our Eternal oppressors, and it has always been reserved for the best of us. ...

--Una, "Count Geonor" (POE II)

Uprising...? The uprising! Of course! The clans are uniting to fight for their freedom. We are making our stand in the Vale...

--Lachlann the Lost, "Uprising" (POE II)

"I will never forget. I will carry your memory forward, all of you, from this ghastly Vale."

- Artair, last survivor of the Ogham rebellion

--The Fallen Formation Lamellar Mail (POE II)

The Red Vale played host to the final and bloodiest battle of countless conflicts. It was in the heart of that vale that we fought for our freedom against the Eternals.

We did win... in a sense... but the cost was far greater than anyone expected.

Many generations of able-bodied men and women gave their lives to push off the boot of oppression. Ogham's clans haven't been the same since...

--Una, "The Red Vale" (POE II)

Those Eternal bastards looted everything that wasn't bolted to the floor when we finally drove them from our island! ...

--Ogham Candelabra (POE I)

The cruelty of the Eternals...

... shall never be forgotten.

--Asinia's Memorial Key Piece & Draven's Memorial Key Piece (POE II)

Outsiders can never understand the Ezomyte struggle. Our folklore goes back to the very Winter of the World, when we were but savages clawing grubs from the dirt.

The Eternal Empire tried to crush us. They failed. Not even the event that destroyed the Vaal could end us. We strengthened in the wake of their Cataclysm, harnessing runes, mastering the world around us.

We have always fought for survival, for home, for hearth. That is the bloodline I am proud of, stretching back thousands of years...

--Geonor, Geonor's Journal I (POE II)

THE SIEGE OF SARN

"We are the soldiers of Faith, armoured in devotion. Let the sinners come, for we - the Pure - shall endure!"

- Voll of Thebrus, at the Battle of the Bridge

--Voll's Devotion Agate Amulet (POE I)

...Inquisitor Maligaro, Shavronne of Umbra, and Doedre Darktongue.

If the history books are accurate, High Templar Voll burned Maligaro and Doedre at the stake on his way to lay siege to Sarn. He didn't have to worry himself with Shavronne. Brutus had already sorted her out. ...

--Piety, "The Godless Three" (POE I)

We, the Court of Reckoning find you, Doedre Stamatis, guilty of the following transgressions against God:

Perversion of God's Creation

Promotion of Heretical Beliefs

Unlawful Enslavement of Eternal Citizens

Torture of the Innocent

Murder of the Servants of Purity

For these most severe crimes, I do sentence Doedre Darktongue to burn at the stake till naught is left but ash. May her life serve as penance for the lives she has taken, and let Purity sweep away the dust of her deeds from our firmament.

- High Templar Voll, Commander of the Army of Purity

--Proclamation (POE I)

As she was sentenced to death, Doedre was silent. As she was tied to the stake, Doedre was silent. As the flames licked away her life, Doedre was silent. But Wraeclast had not heard the last of her.

--Doedre's Skin Widowsilk Robe (POE I)

... Whilst investigating the Fellshrine, I learned of the existence of a map, forged by Maligaro from his own viscera. This map allowed him to transfer his spirit into another form of existence, an existential safe house to which he could retreat should death ever attempt to take him. Understanding the map's purpose, Voll tried to destroy it, to no avail, so he locked it away deep within the ruins of Phrecia Cathedral. ...

--Helena, "Maligaro" (POE I)

... On the last day of Divini 1333 IC, High Templar Voll laid siege to Sarn, his ranks swelled by Ezomyte, Karui and Maraketh rebels under the respective leaderships of Thane Rigwald, Hyrri of Ngamakanui and Sekhema Deshret. ...

- *Garivaldi, Chronicler to the Empire*

--The Purity Chronicles (POE I)

INCITING THE PEOPLE TO REVOLT

Victario was a poet what ended up leading a rebellion, right under the nose of Emperor Chitus. But here's what really interests me. Our wordsmith was quite the talented larcenist as well. Pulled off the heist of the century, in the name of the people, of course. Three finely-crafted platinum busts commissioned by Chitus for his favourite trio of generals.

Victario and his cobbles holed up in the sewers. ...

--Hargan, "Victario" (POE I)

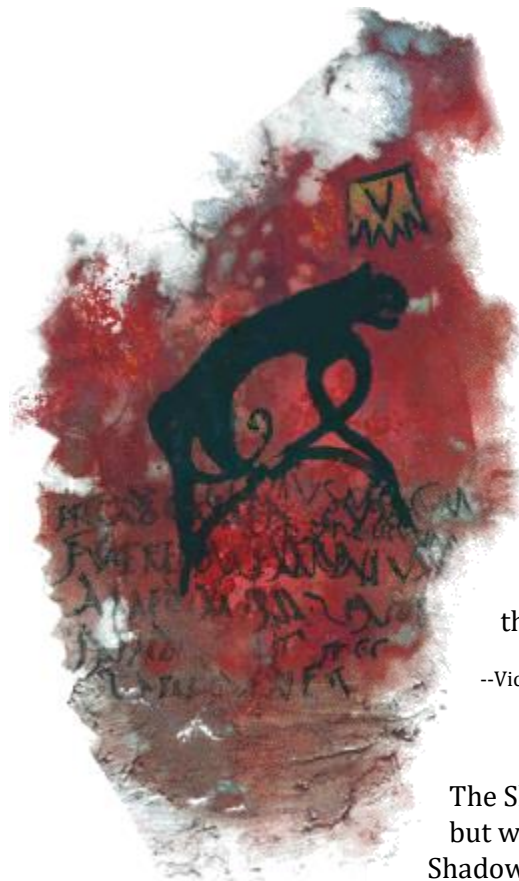
"I come from a long line of scholars, poets, and artists. You can imagine how little we leave our children... My father only gifted me one thing: for good or ill, I don't know when to quit."

- Victario Nevalius, the People's Poet

--Nevalius Inheritance Cloth Belt (POE I)

After years of subterfuge, sabotage, and sacrifice, Sarn had become a powder keg just waiting to explode. Finally, Victario lit the match.

--Sudden Ignition Viridian Jewel (POE I)



Mortality is the mother of life. We have turned our backs on her.

--Victario, Ancient Graffiti I (POE I)

The Monkey King has built his throne on your back. A throne of gold and gem, polished with blood and tear. Throw off the Monkey King and his shining privy, before your back is broken.

--Victario, Ancient Graffiti II (POE I)

The gemmed genteel are an infestation. They are the Monkey King's fleas that drink of your lifeblood. Crush them in your work-forged hands!

--Victario, Ancient Graffiti III (POE I)

The Shadow whispers and simpers at the Monkey King's feet, but when the Monkey King puts his back to the Sun, it's the Shadow that leads the way.

--Victario, Ancient Graffiti IV (POE I)

If Chitus was the Monkey King, then who was this 'shadow'? Malachai perhaps?

--Scion, on Ancient Graffiti IV (POE I)

The Monkey King names you 'slave'. No. You are the gems of Wraecclast, not the treacherous stones you dig and die for. It's time to bend the Monkey King's ear. Tell him your true name.

--Victario, Ancient Graffiti V (POE I)

There is nothing 'eternal' in this empire of ours but the names of our day that shall be revered or reviled in the centuries to come.

--Victario, Ancient Graffiti VI (POE I)

Eternals would travel from far and wide to see the spectacles of Sarn arena. The gemling diva Kalisa gave her final performance in there for Emperor Chitus himself.

Legend has it, on that same day, the first gemling legionnaire cut through four Ezomyte warriors in less time than it would've taken Kalisa to sing a single bar. ...

--Leo, "Sarn Arena" (POE I)

Victario: The plan is simple.
According to Ondar, Emperor
Chitus has been hoarding food
in secret storehouses
across the city, ensuring
that his elite remain
well fed and loyal...
We're going to tell our
starving people where
those stores are.

Marylene: There'll be
riots! Innocent people will
die!

Victario: I know, Marylene, but it
has to be this way.

Marylene: Why?



Victario: Chitus will dispatch troops into the city, to restore order and recover the food.

Deshret: Meaning more legionnaires in the streets than on the gates.

Hyrri: Victario certainly knows how to be a distraction.

Victario: The grain gate garrison will be closest to the riots. It will be weakened the most.

--Path of Exile: Origins #3

DEFEAT AT THE GRAIN GATE

Voll stood at the gates of Sarn, and a nation stood behind him. He thought of the righteousness of his cause, and of the glory he would bring to the empire he would soon lead. But as Chitus and his gemlings advanced, he thought only of the fight.

--Combat Focus Cobalt Jewel (POE I)

Alive but not unscathed, Victario fled as slaughter blossomed at the gates.

--Victario's Flight Goathide Boots (POE I)

I stood with the Army of Purity and looked upon the mighty walls of Sarn. I fought against Chitus and his Gemling aberrations. I watched the strongest of our army, Ezomyte, Maraketh, Karui and Templar, struck down by creatures of thaumaturgy.

It will take more than strong men and women to defeat Chitus, for this is no longer a war of mud and blood. We face monsters, and to defeat them, we need some monsters of our own. ...

- Rigwald, the Wolven King

--Inscription IV (POE I)

THE ASSASSINATION OF CHITUS & THE FALL OF SARN

... Malachai has given me supreme command of his creations. The heart of each soldier beats in time with the heart of his emperor. If the emperor wishes that beat to stop, it stops. And should my own heart cease, so does the life-blood rhythm of all my loyal soldiers.

--Chitus, Path of Exile: Origins #4

Captain Alsarus,

Remain in the warehouse until I personally send for you. In the unlikely event that Chitus should fall, you and your fellow legionnaires will be safely beyond the perimeter of his heart gem's influence.

You men and women are my finest work yet. I would not lose you all to some aberration of chance.

Malachai, Thaumaturge Laureate

--Official Orders (POE I)

Book 5: The Emperor is dead. Long live the Emperor!

... Emperor Chitus rallied his freshly minted Gemling Legionnaires and, for a time, looked set to execute an effective defence of the capital. But his efforts were cut short by his closest advisor and friend, Lord Mayor Ondar.

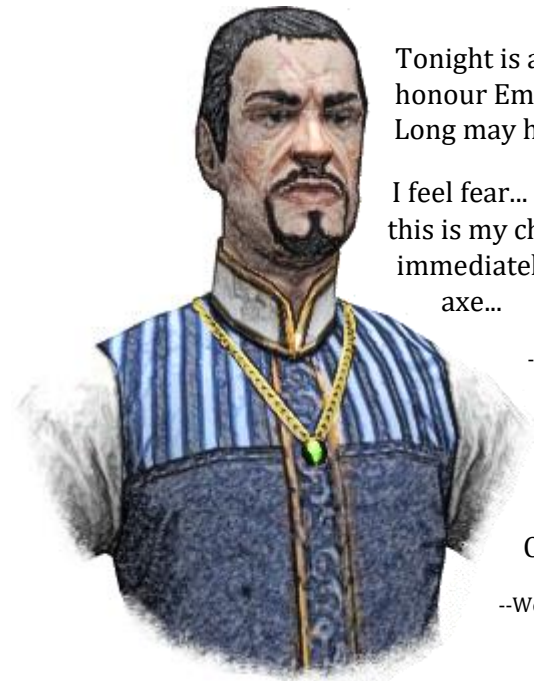
During the celebration of the Night of a Thousand Ribbons, Ondar struck Chitus down with blades tainted with the most virulent of poisons. Yet the emperor's inhuman constitution served him to the very last. Taking up his axe, Chitus cleaved Ondar in twain before expiring himself, in a visceral and calamitous display of thaumaturgy.

Malachai, Thaumaturge Laureate, and his gemling consort, Lady Diallya, were captured by Victario Nevalius' citizen revolutionaries shortly thereafter. With their leadership either dead or detained, the gemling aristocracy of Sarn had no choice but to offer the city's surrender.

Voll and his Army of Purity marched through the gates of the capital and the following day, the High Templar was crowned Emperor Voll the First.

- *Garivaldi, Chronicler to the Empire*

--The Purity Chronicles (POE I)



Tonight is a celebration. On this, the night of a Thousand Ribbons, we honour Emperor Chitus for his heroic defense of our beloved capital. Long may he reign!

I feel fear... and hatred. The Emperor stands before me, and I know this is my chance. I strike at him. I pierce his belly, but it is not immediately lethal. I lock eyes with the man. I watch him raise his axe...

--Ondar, Pristine Palace Memory (POE I)

Ondar not only betrayed his emperor, he betrayed his friend. And in his dying moments, Chitus ensured that Ondar felt the full weight of his guilt.

--Weight of the Empire Crimson Jewel (POE I)

Emperor Chitus was stabbed in the posterior by his own Lord Mayor on the eve of the Purity Rebellion. Chitus' grieving gemlings buried him in The Imperial Gardens and a plum tree was planted upon his resting place, so that his mourners might taste his glory for years to come. I found that tree, and one of my men tasted its fruit. I've never seen so much agony crammed into such a brief moment. ...

--Captain Fairgraves, "Chitus' Plum" (POE I)

[These events are also covered in Path of Exile: Origins #3, "Death to Sin," and #4, "The Black Heart."]

AFTERMATH

True to his title, Voll, newly crowned, had many of the Eternal Empire signature extravagances destroyed.

--Emperor of Purity (POE I)

... When the Emperor Voll took power, Malachai freely gave Lazhwar over to the Purity Courts. Lazhwar was burned at the stake for 'fraternizing with unholy forces'.

--Eternal and Diamond Supporter Newsletter #4 (POE I)

On this day, the 2nd Sacrato of Verusi, 1334 IC, the Army of Purity remembers its most devout and beloved servant, Archbishop Geofri of Phrecia.

As spoken by Geofri:

*Only will and truth can prevail
over the evil of our own kin.*

- High Templar Voll, commander of the Army of Purity

--Plaque (POE I)

THE REIGN OF VOLL (1334-1336 IC)

Although a great leader during the war, Voll proved disastrous in times of peace.

--Voll's Protector Holy Chainmail (POE I)

When Voll took the throne, he swore to care for the empire with eyes open. And so he looked to the salvation of his people, blind to the damnation in his hands.

--The Vigil Crimson Jewel (POE I)

I'm no history scholar, but I know that Emperor Chitus was overthrown by Voll of Thebrus in the so-called 'Purity Rebellion'. But Voll had the shortest reign of any Eternal Emperor. The cataclysm saw to that.

--Hargan, "The Purity Rebellion" (POE I)

Chitus was shaping up to be the greatest leader since Veruso. My nephew's gemling thaumatocracy would have made the Empire truly eternal, would have raised mankind up from the fragile muck of flesh and blood. And the wealth... oh the riches that could have flowed through the Empire's capitalist capillaries.

Then that idiot of a High Templar had to come along and ruin it all. Him and his 'God of Purity' and his army of fanatics and barbarians. A veritable horde of ignorance.

If Chitus had lived, the Empire would have lived, and oh what a wondrous and eternal life it would have had!

--Cadiro, "Chitus Perandus" (POE I)

MALACHAI & THE RAPTURE DEVICE

How Malachai survived the Purity Rebellion, I don't know. He was at Emperor Voll's side before Chitus' corpse was even cold.

I suppose Voll found him as difficult to refuse as Icius did.

Malachai would never have risen so far without the patronage of an emperor like Chitus. ...

--Siosa, "Malachai" (POE I)

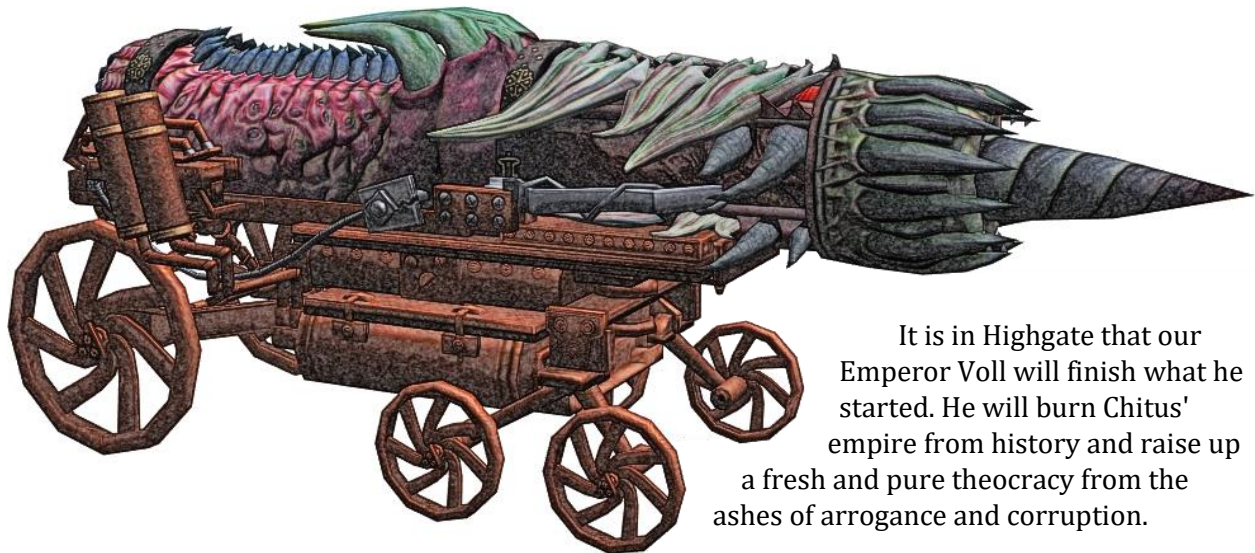
Book 6: The Rapture Device

Voll condemned Malachai to the Crematorium for 'living conflagration', but it seems that Malachai's promises have saved him from the pyre. "An end to thaumaturgy," he claims. A fancy that our Emperor is willing to humour.

For over a year now, Malachai has been consigned to the Solaris Temple, forging a mechanism that will purge Wraeclast of its otherworldly vices. Today, the first Fiero of Eterni 1336 IC, Malachai and his Gemling Queen gripped each one corner of a silken mantle and unveiled his Rapture Device. Like

a pit of copper snakes it writhes before the eyes. Whether it is a miracle or a monstrosity, none but Malachai can say. Yet tomorrow Voll shall lead the Highgate Legion home, conveying Malachai, Lady Dialla, and this bewildering apparatus north.

North, from whence the first Gems came. From whence the nightmare of Chitus' thaumatocracy was born.



God be with you, Voll of Thebrus, and with us all.

- Garivaldi, *Chronicler to the Empire*

--The Purity Chronicles (POE I)

MALACHAI'S BETRAYAL

"When Voll spared Malachai, accepting his aid in pursuit of Purity, the strongest faith was infected by Corruption and made brittle as glass."

- Victario, the People's Poet

--The Brittle Emperor (POE I)

As Malachai stepped into the Highgate mines, cold winds billowed from the mountain above. One final, feeble attempt to save what was meant to be eternal.

--Omen on the Winds Viridian Jewel (POE I)

The Rapture Device has absorbed its fill of harvested life from Fury and Desire. It is ready.

So am I.

I know now that I was born to be the end and the beginning of the Empire. The Beast has made this clear to me. As clear and undeniable as the sacrifice I must now make.

My Lady Dialla, my love, my life's greatest achievement. She must leave me now, for she cannot follow and she will perish if she remains.

And so I will ask of her more than she would ever give. I will betray her. I will break her heart, so that I do not break her soul.

--Malachai's Notebook (POE I)

The Rapture is our hope. Our desperation. It will set the Nightmare to boil, cook that nice big fishy in its own whining brine.

... The Rapture was Malachai's most wondrous creation, the only fire hot enough to burn the Beast from existence.

And its fuel? A gemling queen, blood and flesh and gem. Yet my selfish self did not want to burn away, and so the fire was but a tiny spark. The spark of a cataclysm. ...

--Lady Dialla, "Malachai" (POE I)

Malachai knew exactly what he was doing when he created the Rapture.

His primary concern...get inside the Beast and take up the reins of true power. And his second objective...incite a Cataclysm that would wipe the very thought of resistance from this land.

The Beast is the source of all thaumaturgy, the one power in this world that transforms 'what is real' into 'what is imagined.'

The entire world is now at the mercy of one man's vision. It won't be the future I imagined, and it won't be the future you imagined, either. While he remains within the Black Core, the only imagination that matters...is Malachai's.

--Piety, "Malachai" (POE I)

I take no pleasure in this. It simply must be done. Humanity's purpose has been fulfilled... in me. Within this sanctum of flesh lay the tools I shall use to reshape the world.

With this act, I sweep away the trappings of mortality, and bring about a new age. A world of Thaumaturgy, and I, its ruler. Farewell, my Gemling Queen...

--Malachai, Distant Nightmare Memory (POE I)

RESURRECTING THE GODLESS THREE

On this day, the eve of this Rapture's completion, I honour those who have passed and whose passion and knowledge have brought us to the brink of salvation.

Inquisitor Maligaro, a creative force without equal.

Shavronne of Umbra, an aesthete of transcendent sensibility.

Doedre Darktongue, an idol of fervor and dedication.

You taught me far more than I ever taught you, my students...my friends. We strove to make a greater world together and, in your memory, I shall make that world a reality.

Malachai

--Malachai's Dedication
(POE I)

I gave my life.
Nightmare
gave me so much
more.

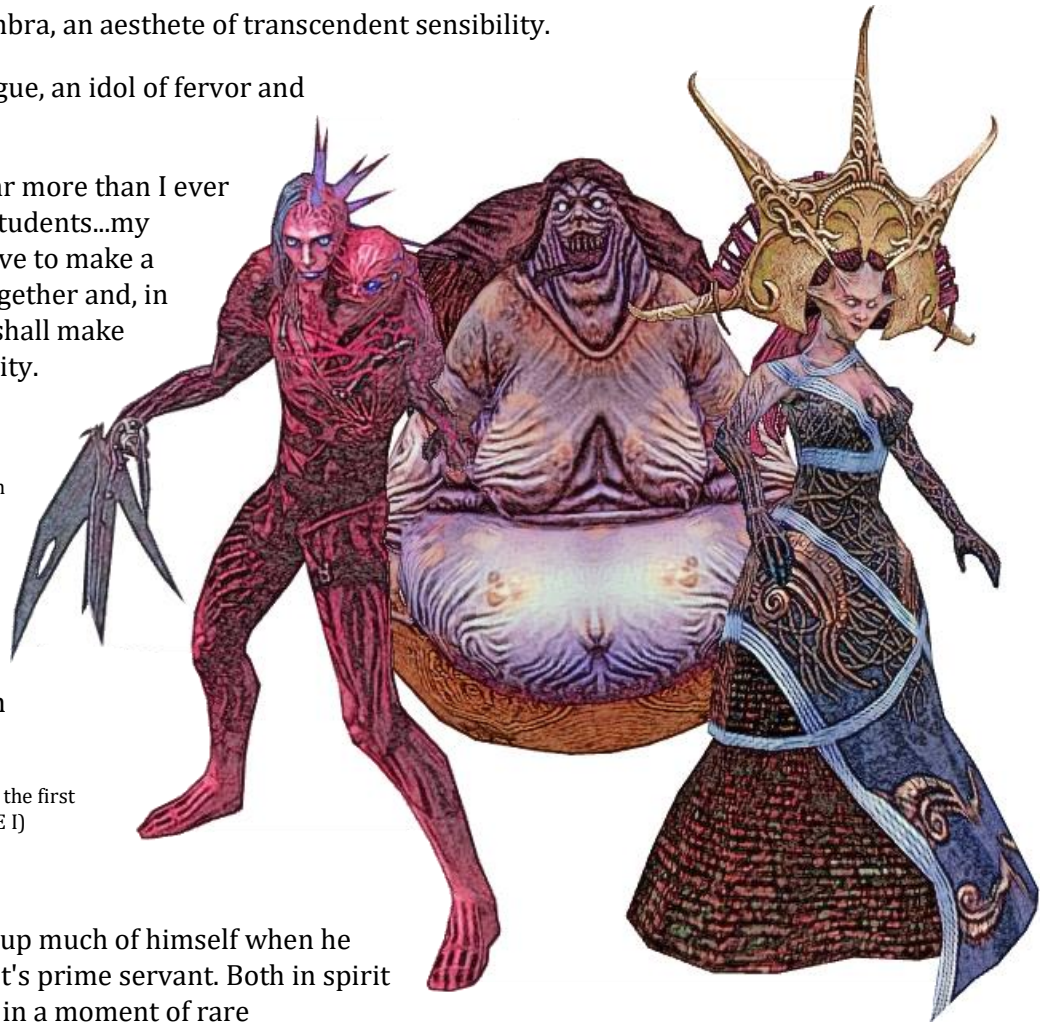
--Malachai, on opening the first
Heart of the Beast (POE I)

... Malachai gave up much of himself when he became the Beast's prime servant. Both in spirit and in flesh. Yet, in a moment of rare sentimentality, he kept a few pieces. Three vital organs, placed in the safe-keeping of his godless three; Inquisitor Maligaro, Shavronne of Umbra and Doedre Darktongue. ...

--Pietry, on Corpus Malachus (POE I)

My heart forces blood through my veins. But one who may bleed may die, and death is no fitting end to genius.

--Malachai's Heart (POE I)



My lungs breathe the same air as the foolish and the weak. May I be yet another step removed from them.

--Malachai's Lungs (POE I)

My organs tether me to mortality like a chain. This chain holds me from my true potential.

--Malachai's Entrails (POE I)

Malachai chose his three most loyal servants to guard those precious innards. His Godless Three. Inquisitor Maligaro, Shavronne of Umbra, and Doedre Darktongue.

If the history books are accurate, High Templar Voll burned Maligaro and Doedre at the stake on his way to lay siege to Sarn. He didn't have to worry himself with Shavronne. Brutus had already sorted her out.

Yet slaves of nightmare seem to be shackled just as tightly to life as they are to the Beast...

--Piety, "The Godless Three" (POE I)

Malachai's apprentices. Shavronne of Umbra, Doedre Darktongue and Inquisitor Maligaro. You'll find no more devoted servants in all of Nightmare. In life, they were the three finest forgers of corruption in the Empire.

I'm inclined to agree with Malachai on this one. It would have been such a waste to let them languish in death. ...

--Tasuni, "Malachai's Apprentices" (POE I)

THE CATACLYSM (1336 IC)

Beneath your feet, Creation shivers and writhes. It yearns for transformation like a worm in a cocoon that dreams of wings and freedom. A transformation that only the Beast can excite. ...

--Tasuni, "The Beast" (POE I)

Ghosts have no use for words. To speak in nightmare is to speak in emotion and image...in thought.

I see and feel the darkness, and that is how I know that the cataclysm was no accident. Its images are far too rich with intention, far too steeped in satisfaction.

Malachai's satisfaction. Malachai devastated my people, destroyed the Eternal Empire, for one reason. To put himself right where he is now, within the Black Heart of the Beast.

--Tasuni, "Cataclysm" (POE I)

Malachai is what every Ghast aspires to be. The hands and eyes, the voice and mind of the Beast itself.

I see him in my dreams, forming his designs, crafting his tools, refining the chaos of nightmare into a vision. A future that you and I would not recognise.

That neither you or I belong to unless, of course, we choose to accept the dark embrace.

This is Malachai's greatest work. An act of invention like none other. Should he succeed, he will awaken the Beast.

What then?
The Beast is not Death. Life will go on. A life like nothing we have seen before.

--Tasuni, "Malachai" (POE I)

Nothing is immune to the Nightmare's twisted influence.

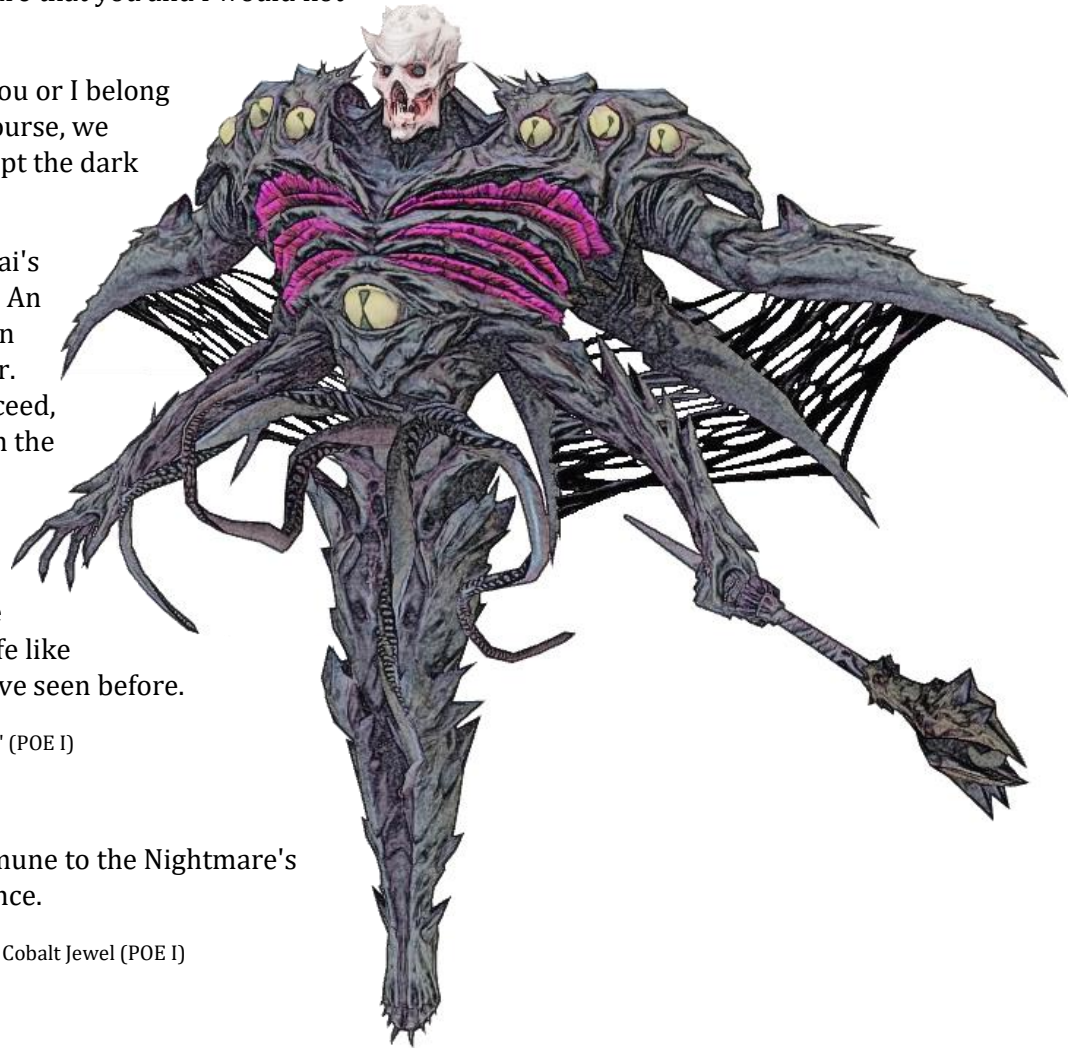
--Corrupted Energy Cobalt Jewel (POE I)

... Malachai is in the Beast's black core right now, harnessing all that the Beast is, and will be. He will destroy this world and forge it anew in the divine image of Nightmare. ...

--Piety, "Malachai" (POE I)

... Universal transmogrification. ... The power to change the world into anything you like. ...

--Petarus and Vanja, "The Beast" (POE I)



The Cataclysm was but the first act in a play of horrors. The dead lingered, and the living began to rot.

--Spreading Rot Cobalt Jewel (POE I)

THE FATE OF ADUS

... Highgate Refinery ... General Adus and his elite legionnaires sought refuge there during the first moments of Malachai's Cataclysm. If they remain, they will be creatures of darkest discipline. Strong men in health and life made even stronger in corruption and death.

--Sin, "Trarthan Powder" (POE I)



THE FATE OF VOLL



Voll the Pure, they called him. Voll the Murderer, I call him. In his name, an Emperor was murdered. In his name, an Empire was murdered.

Yes, it was Malachai's lips that kissed me. Yes, it was Malachai's hand that led me to the Rapture. No, no and no again. It was Voll's words that put me there.

--Lady Dialla, "Voll" (POE I)

I vowed to "care for this empire with my eyes open". I lied to my people. I lied to myself. Blinded by my lust for 'purity', I placed my faith in the most corrupt of men.

I watch now as my legion dies, their flesh melting from their twisted bones. They fall... and rise. A tide of mortal death and eternal damnation.

I feel it now in my own flesh. The heat. The corruption.

I have failed you, my Empire of Purity. Do not forgive me but please, I beg of you, survive me.

-Voll

--Voll's Confession (POE I)

The Maraketh speak of his betrayal, but Voll did what he thought was necessary to destroy the Beast.

Now he wanders the desiccation, tortured as much by his failure as by Nightmare.

--Tasuni, "Voll" (POE I)

Voll and his 'unmen' have dipped their fleshless claws into the lifeblood of the Maraketh since the day this *akhara* tethered its rhoa here.

Such is the way with men of war. Remove their tongues, yet still they thirst for blood. Remove their bellies, yet still they hunger for battle. Remove their manhood, yet still they lust for conquest.

--Oyun, "Voll" (POE I)

THE FATE OF SARN

I see you. You are seeking answers, because you can find them only in the stories we will leave behind when Malachai and Voll cause our destruction. In this final hour, I entertain the notion that the words I write exist in some form beyond me. Do they go on as dreams? As memories?

I have the wildest notion that perhaps you will find a way to pick up scraps of memory, and you, whoever you are, will come across this one someday. If you do, I ask only this: slay Malachai. Slay him for yourself, or slay him for all the lost citizens of the Empire, but, most of all, slay him for Marylene.

--Victario, Distant Exchange Memory (POE I)

I write this now in hope that someone will remain. Someone may remember.

The sun is an orb of blood. Twisted twilight shrouds my eyes. The air reeks of anguish. Sarn has plunged into nightmare.

The man who served me coffee now writhes on the floor. He rants of visions he alone can see, as writhing red tentacles grow from his face, as if his eyes had been seeds waiting to sprout. He is quiet, now, my waiter. No more cackling and screaming. Dead.



Of my fellow patrons, only two live. The others have fallen. Their blood is everywhere. The survivors, Gemlings both... their skin shrivels and greys to the hue of necrosis. Their gems flare with unholy lustre. Their eyes... black as... hatred.

A gemling ghoul... it twisted off a corpse's head... gnaws at skull like dog. My head now... visions clawing at me... Thinking burns! I see... horror, envy the mute corpses at my... feet. Words flay me... flee me. All is madness!

--Victario, Ancient Notebook (POE I)

Sarn fell in the course of an hour, no more. A tempest raged down from the mountains and engulfed the city, throwing it into midday darkness. I saw madness in my colleagues' eyes. Watched as the most rational men in the Empire jabbered and slavered and slaughtered each other.

I witnessed Trinian, our Gemling Intellectus Prime, engulfed by the radiance of his flaming cranial gem and wither, like a grape in the sun, into a thing of desiccation and famishment.

I've seen mountains spew fire in Ngamakanui. I've seen waves as tall as trees and winds that leveled warriors and walls alike. Nature is what nature is.

There was nothing natural about the cataclysm.

--Siosa, "Cataclysm" (POE I)



... Chitus' Gemlings still rule Sarn. We call them the Undying now.

--Grigor, "Gemlings" (POE I)

... Emperor Chitus believed the legionnaires belonged to him, that gemling men would beat to the drum of his own crystalline heart. But as the silhouette of the emperor faltered and fell, burned out by the light of true men, some of the legion remained.

The cataclysm turned legionnaire into monster, another mindless man of undeath. ...

--Maramoa, "Gemling Legionnaires" (POE I)



I visited Sarn some thirty odd years ago. Those ghastrs, the Undying you call them, scurried up from the sewers near the river and slaughtered all but a few of my most stalwart lads. Oh they're a foul parody of humanity, those Undying. Nothing in common with a fine, upstanding revenant like myself.

--Captain Fairgraves, "The Undying" (POE I)

Citizens of Sarn that was...the Undying have been around for hundreds of years. Left to their

own devices, they're likely to survive for hundreds more. Still, they're not immune to mortality's touch. They can be killed...with some difficulty.

--Maramoa, "The Undying" (POE I)

I know, so strange that stone and metal should move and live as you and I. Still, I read that Chitus' sculptors used to soften their materials with 'thaumetic sulphite', a by-product of gem refining. It's the only connection that I can fathom between the cataclysm and the living sculptures of Sarn.

--Clarissa, "Statues" (POE I)

The sky, the land, the people burned. What little still stood soon faced wild, battering storms. Winter arrived suddenly and stayed for a generation. Civilisation was not simply halted, but reversed, erased.

--Endless Misery Cobalt Jewel (POE I)

The winter that followed the Cataclysm was especially harsh. Wraeclast's few survivors fought to the death for the last scraps of bread.

--Fight for Survival Viridian Jewel (POE I)

In the years that followed the twisted sky, cold winds cloaked Wraeclast in snow. The pure-white blanket masked a black heart that lay dormant deep beneath the earth.

--The Long Winter Cobalt Jewel (POE I)

THE ABANDONED PRISON

That prison island was built by the Eternal Empire. ...

--Makoru, on Abandoned Prison (on map) (POE II)

Ugh, this place. Human misery, it was. They used to leave the prisoners in partially submerged cages, or so the stories go. Let the sea decide, they would say. Tread water for your life inside your cage. If the tide rose too high, you'd have to take breaths in between waves. Can't imagine that kind of desperation...

--Rhodri, on arriving at Abandoned Prison (POE II)

You have been weighed and measured, and you have been found wanting. You are unworthy, but fear not, for redemption is a grace which may be earned by the willing.

Until then, the Empire shall be your Father, and your Mother.

3rd Lunaro of Phreci, 1315 I.C.

--The Lady of Justice (POE II)

Only once did Maligaro wonder if he'd gone too far. His greatest success took three entire legions to capture.

--The Prisoner's Manacles Diviner Cuffs (POE II)

By the order of Emperor Izaro, my honoured predecessor,

None may enter this chamber. The prisoner within is beyond death, beyond force of arms.

He must be left to rot for all time.

Emperor Chitus Perandus

--Emperor's Warning (POE II)

Not even Izaro's best could kill me...

--The Prisoner, on kneeling (POE II)

Our mistake was holding on to hope. Even after the sky turned crimson and the sea raged, even after we cowered inside these walls and rode out the chaos, we believed the Empire would come...

Not for the prisoners! But for us.

We kept them all caged for weeks, as our supplies dwindled. The fish we caught were rotting and dead, yet... still moving. The rain was slick like grease, and men who touched it began to burn from the inside out, as if an unseen flame had caught within them.

No ship from the Empire came. No ships passed at all. The prisoners were growing more and more restless, and were certain to become violent. We told them nothing, but they'd felt it...

So... we began to feed them.

We cut chunks of meat... they kept growing back... so we cut some more... and that quelled the prisoners. They had no idea what we'd done.

When they learn what they've been eating... gods help us...

--Tattered Diary (POE II)

Dead guards... consumed by the hunger they helped create.

--Warrior, on The Armoury (POE II)

Centuries drowning...

--The Prisoner, on ballista use (POE II)

...the inmates still wail from within the walls there. Can you believe it? Nobody ever let them out! ...

It's a horrible place. You can still hear them pounding at the bars of their cells...

--Makoru, on Abandoned Prison (on map) (POE II)

...sailors whisper about clanking and roaring coming from that prison. Though it was abandoned long ago, it seems there are still folks kicking around in there. ...

--Kanu, wild, on Abandoned Prison (POE II)

THE FATE OF DIALLA, THE GEMLING QUEEN

The Gemling Queen, she's... impossible. How did she survive? Why is she not one of the Undying? ...

--Grigor, "The Gemling Queen" (POE I)

Something Eternal remains in this Empire. The question is, how?

--Templar, on the Solaris Temple (POE I)

THE FATES OF KAOM, HYRRI, & THE KARUI

On the fall of the Empire, the historians are deathly silent. After the Purity Rebellion, the Kingdom of Kaom blockaded Oriath, preventing any trade or correspondence with the mainland. It's said that Kaom planned to invade. Only when the Karui retreated did Oriath get any news from Wraecclast, but by that time there wasn't really anyone left to tell the tale.

--Clarissa, "Cataclysm" (POE I)

Black storms descend on us from the North. Unnatural tempests of rage and hatred, lashing our backs, tearing at our houses. The rain is shot with shadow. It withers our crops, sickens our livestock.

And the wind... the wind carries with it a restless spirit that breeds melancholy and madness. A spirit that creeps through our dreams, weaves tales of misdeed around our resting minds. We try not to listen. We try to remember ourselves. Some of us forget.

Brothers fight. Brothers die. Kaom punishes those that quarrel, that steal, that murder. Yet still the nightmares goad us into malefaction.

We Karui are banished from sleep.

--Lavianga, Weathered Carving III (POE I)

The earth of Wraeclast rejects the dead. The black spirit of storm and dream now reaches into the ground and raises up our slain imperial foes. It leads the fallen from their graves and drives them to fight us beyond the end, rotted tooth and jagged nail.

Our own Remembered have joined their cursed ranks. No longer may we give our beloved to the birds, messengers of spirit to the sky, conveyors of flesh to the earth. Kaom has commanded us to destroy our Remembered with axe and fire. Kaom is the bravest of us, willing to bear the ire of the Ancestors for the survival of his people.



--Lavianga, Weathered Carving IV (POE I)

The black spirit infects living flesh and bone. The animals suffered first. Their bodies changed. Their eyes filled with a hatred of mankind that is beyond instinct.

Now it is we who must bend and bow like saplings before the seaborne gale. The firstborn of the Kingdom of Kaom greeted us this day. The firstborn of the Kingdom of Kaom was buried this day. Even our children are not spared the black spirit's touch.

What have we done to enrage Wraeclast? We look to Kaom. Our King will lay the spirit of this land at peace.

--Lavianga, Weathered Carving V (POE I)

Kaom stands before us and looks out to the raging sea. He sings, calls, screams to our Ancestors to come to our aid. He offers them the Gifts of Old, a feast of heart and mind, muscle and marrow, cooked in the fire and rock of this angry land.

We have not practiced these ways in so many years. Only in the darkest of times, most desperate of times, do we perform these oldest of rituals. Only here and now may we sacrifice and consume our own. Only in our King can we trust this return to our ancient selves.

--Lavianga, Weathered Carving VI (POE I)

Kaom took his 500 mightiest warriors inland to find the source of the crippling nightmares plaguing his people.

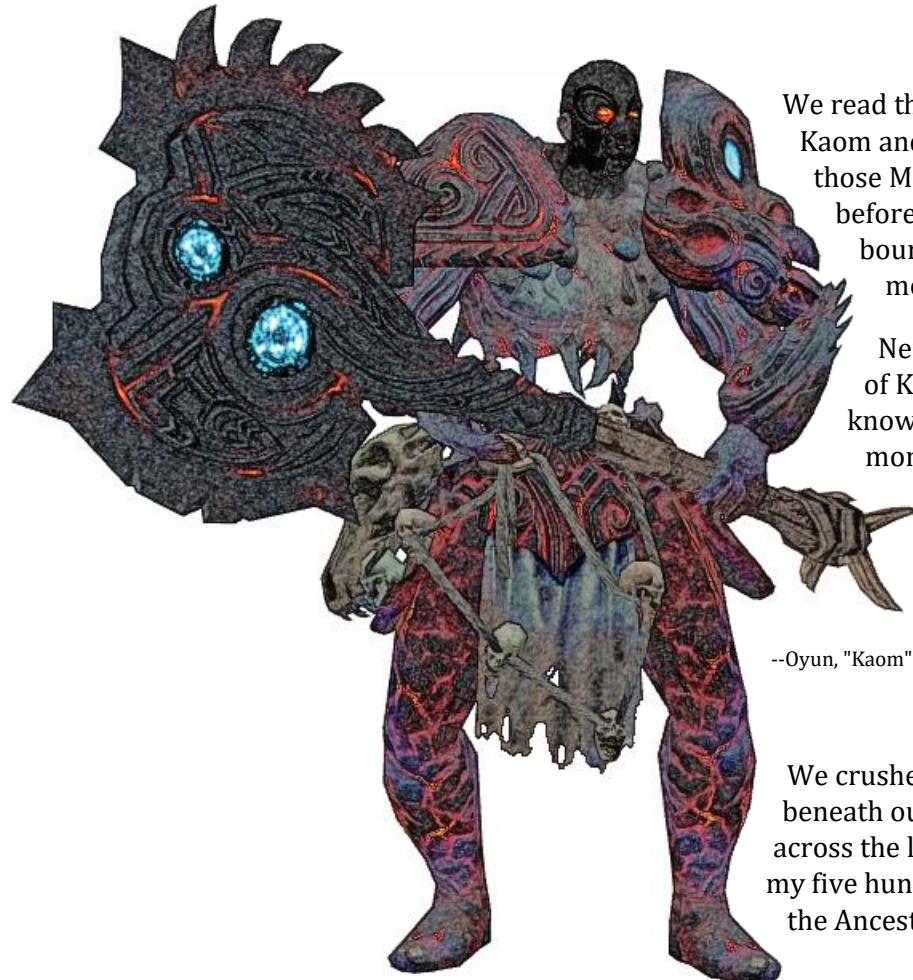
--King Kaom, Steam trading card description (POE I)

I dreamed of my Ancestors' halls. They were empty.

I dreamed of the north, of an offering left to us by Tukohama, an offering that will save the Karui. I needed only to take it.

I gathered my finest five hundred. I brought them here. I claimed what Tukohama had promised me.

--Kaom, Weathered Carving VIII (POE I)



We read the land, learn its stories.
Kaom and his warriors entered
those Mines some twenty years
before Deshret sealed them and
bound our *akhara* to this
mountain.

Neither soil nor stone speak
of Kaom's return. Now we
know why. He became a
monarch of Nightmare, like
Voll before him. It seems
the Beast has uses for
those with a talent for
conquest.

--Oyun, "Kaom" (POE I)

We crushed the servants of Kitava
beneath our heels as we marched
across the land. I allowed not one of
my five hundred to fall. The blood of
the Ancestors surged in our veins and

each and every one of my warriors earned Tukohama's mark upon their skin.

We descended into the heart of Wraeclast, and there He came to me. Tukohama. He asked of me a sacrifice. I gave it willingly. My axe fell five hundred times, the jade drinking its fill of Karui blood.

Tukohama was pleased.

--Kaom, Weathered Carving IX (POE I)

500 times Kaom's axe fell, 500 times Kaom's heart splintered. Finally, all that remained was a terrible, heartless fury.

--The King's Heart (POE I)

The Eternals opened the gate and invited Kitava into this land. The Karui paid the price.

Kitava cut us off from the Ancestors, raised the Remembered as His children, tortured our dreams.

Kitava murdered the Karui Way. I will found a new Way, for I have been chosen. I gather my forces so that I might wage war on Kitava. I am the son of Tukohama, and I will lead the Karui back to glory.

--Kaom, Weathered Carving X (POE I)

The moment your skin touched the corrupted soil of Wraeclast, you were infected. Kitava has soaked this land in his filth. I will crush the corruption from your bones, drain your black blood upon this sacred ground.

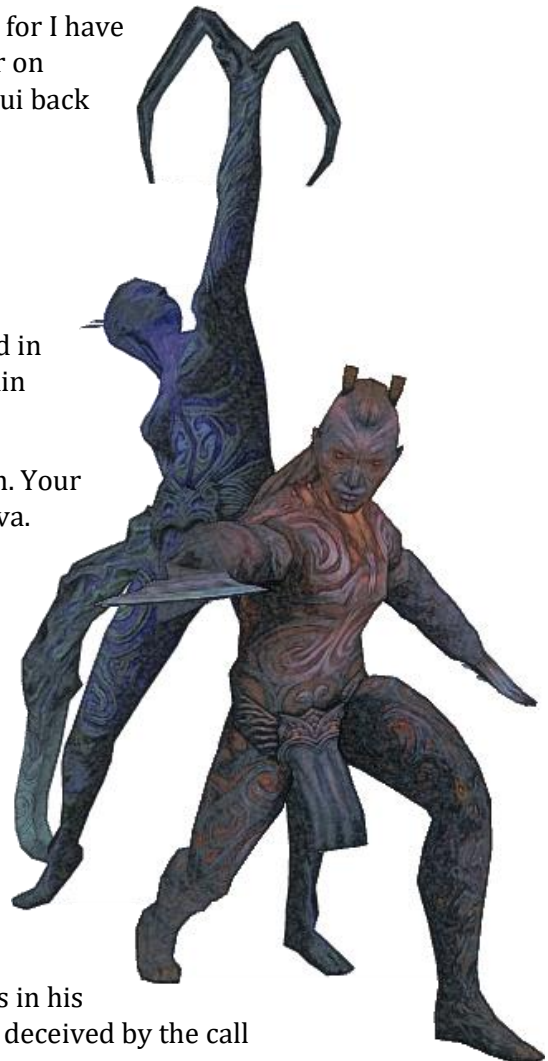
Brothers and sisters, I honour you with a warrior's death. Your spirits will fight by my side when we march against Kitava. You will be given in service to Tukohama.

You will be remembered with glory.

--Kaom, Weathered Carving XI (POE I)

The Beast eats the souls of its prey, devouring their very life force. Those consumed become a part of the creature, existing forevermore as a thrall of twisted nightmare. This fate befell many of Wraeclast's most legendary figures. ...

King Kaom of the Karui - Proud and strong in life, tireless in his hope to bring honor and justice to his people. Kaom was deceived by the call



of the creature, lulled by its sweet whispers to complete destruction. His unrequited dreams of conquest live on though, manifested in a physical nightmare of molten rage.

--<https://www.pathofexile.com/theawakening/actfour> (POE I)

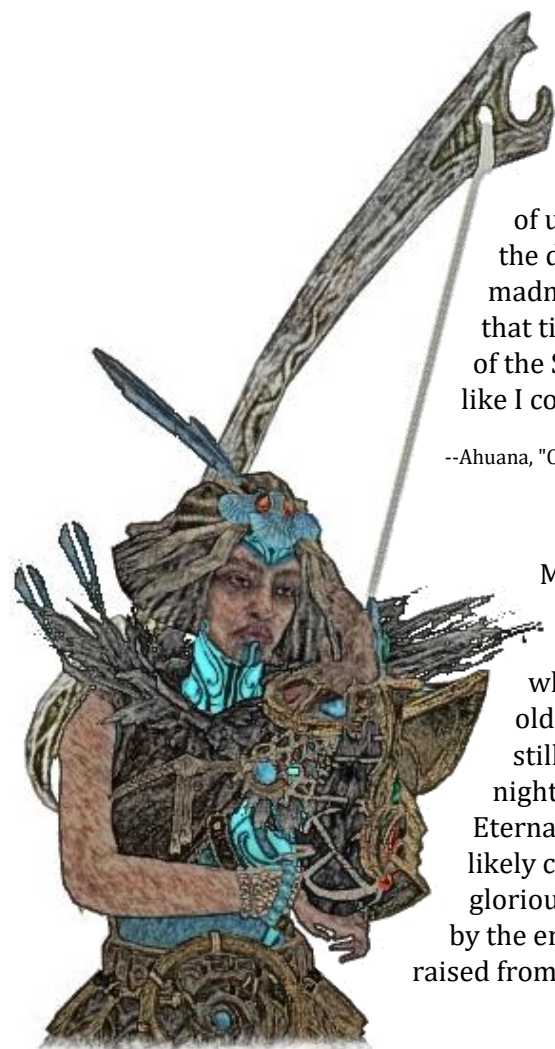
Kaom is gone. Our King has taken our finest five hundred warriors and descended into the depths of Wraecclast. He spoke to us of a vision, a gift from the ancestors. Kaom has been deceived. The vision was a gift from the black spirit. It has conquered Kaom. The black spirit has conquered the Karui Way.

Hyrri has made ready her canoes. We will take those that are left, five hundred forgotten families, and carry them back to their true homes. Back to Ngamakanui.

Kaom's promises have led us into nightmare. Hyrri will lead us back to the dawn.

--Lavianga, Weathered Carving VII (POE I)

HYRRI'S DESCENDENTS



I was quite young when the world ruptured. The moon turned crimson, fire rained from the sky, warriors went mad with blood fever, and the seas boiled. None of us knew what caused it, but the destruction came from the direction of Sarn, and the mountains near it. The madmen must have gone too far... I had nightmares about that time for over a decade, until I finally traveled to the Isle of the Shrikes and passed my test of adulthood. After that, I felt like I could handle anything.

--Ahuana, "Cataclysm" (POE I)

My mother was a great woman, and continues to be my role model, despite her inexplicable absence here. The other chieftains often talk about her wartime acts when she fought alongside Kaom, but by the time I was old enough to know her, she had long been Queen of the still-united tribes. I grew up in a time of turmoil and nightmare in the wake of the Cataclysm that destroyed the Eternals. Because she once helped put the men in power who likely caused it, my mother taught me that war is not the glorious endeavour our Way makes it out to be. All she wanted, by the end, was peace. She was begrudgingly taking an army raised from multiple tribes to deal with a strange threat on the

edge of Ngamakanui... when she and her legion vanished without a trace. I did my best in the chaos that followed, but it wasn't enough...

--Ahuana, "Hyrrri" (POE I)

After my mother's disappearance, the tribes began to fracture. I tried to take on the role of Queen, but inheriting such a title felt a bit too much like monarchy and empire, and the other tribes weren't receptive. Not after their experiences battling the Eternals. So, I used what meager power I had to suggest a new form of united government, a council of chieftains. From the trickle of news we get through living Karui that come to us for guidance, I hear that some form of that is still going on. I'm rather proud of that.

--Ahuana, "Being Queen" (POE I)

The last Queen of the Karui gave up power willingly.

--Ahuana's Bite Sharktooth Arrow Quiver (POE I)

Oh, you've heard of my father? I've never met him. My mother only rolled her eyes whenever I asked about him. She told me of him once, the night before she left on her final campaign. She said he spoke with a poet's grace and made myriad boastful promises, but his heart truly belonged to a dead woman. He remained in Sarn when she took our people home, so he must have died in the Cataclysm. I would very much like to know more about him.

--Ahuana, "Victario" (POE I)

"I loosed a volley of arrows into the heart of the man who slew my beloved. There was no satisfaction, no healing, no revenge. There was only... emptiness."

- Chieftainess Ahuana of the Ramako Tribe

--Widowhail Crude Bow (POE I)

I died in childbirth, which is considered a warrior's death. I died knowing my daughter would live on. Then, because I was here [in the Halls of the Dead], I was able to see her grow and thrive. She visited me for advice often, and I treasure those memories. Now, she fights as one of my own in these Halls. Among others, *her* daughter, and her daughter's daughter, also joined us. We now have dozens of descendants coming to us for wisdom. Life and death are strange partners. I have been here for far longer than I was alive, and my extended family only knows me as an ancestral spirit.

--Ahuana, "Death" (POE I)

Like Ramako in stories, Ahuana is a ray of light in this dark place. The Halls of the Dead are a good thing, but the years keep passing, and weigh heavily on all of us. Kahuturoa was one of the first souls here, and I fear becoming like him. Right now, after only three centuries or so, I can still take the Way seriously and uphold all of our traditions with pride. What will I be like in thousands of years? With good friends like Ahuana remaining positive, perhaps I can make it to the end with my dignity.

--Akoya, "Ahuana" (POE I)

HYRRI'S FATE

Hyrri is not here... I hoped to greet her in the afterlife, but her soul has not found its way to the Halls of the Dead. My tribe's *hatungo*, Lavianga, believed that Hyrri damned herself by breaking the *tavukai*, but that is not a rule the Ramako Tribe follows. I was certain there would be no dishonour in the eyes of the gods, yet Navali remains cryptic on her absence. She should be here. I am... incensed.

--Kaom, "Hyrri" (POE I)

...Queen Hyrri...her soul lives on! When she did not arrive in the Halls of the Dead at the end of her life, we thought she might have chosen to wander. When we realised she was beyond even Hinekora's sight, we feared the worst. Now, we know where she is. This... Domain of Timeless Conflict... we Karui will find a way to invade it and rescue her. Then, we will lay waste to the entity that controls it, for daring to disrespect our people so grievously!

--Navali, "Hyrri's Soul" (POE I)

...Hyrri's soul! Our *hatungo* knows nothing of this Domain of Timeless Conflict, but it seems that we have a new realm to make war upon. We will find it and rescue Hyrri and her army, no matter the cost. Not a single Karui soul will be left behind. This is the promise I make to our Ancestors! We will have our vengeance!

--Kaom, "Hyrri's Soul" (POE I)

... I knew she was still out there somewhere! Though I do not believe she needs our aid. If you knew my mother like I did, you would know that nothing could keep her trapped against her will, especially not with an army at her back. If she is still fighting there, then she must believe that the battle is necessary. We have no idea what the stakes are, so we should leave her to it. If she required our aid, she would have requested it long ago.

--Ahuana, "Hyrri's Soul" (POE I)



Their ancestors await their souls. They will wait forever.

--Kalandra, at the start of a Legion encounter (POE I)

THE FATE OF DESHRET & THE MARAKETH

The Sekhema rode to the mountain, with her tribe, devoted and strong. And sewed shut the mouth of nightmare, so that it would not consume her world.

--Steel Spirit Viridian Jewel (POE I)



The Maraketh once stood united under Deshret's Banner. That was before the plagues, the tempests...the corruption.

Deshret rode here with this *akhara*, the Kiyato, to put an end to the Beast's curse. And upon the very threshold of the darkness she faltered.

Perhaps she saw that King Kaom had gone there before her and not returned. Or perhaps the nightmare simply overcame Deshret's seemingly indomitable courage.

Either way, she chose not to ride into the mountain, to slay the Beast. She closed and sealed the Mines and committed this *akhara* to Highgate's guardianship.

The tempests, the plagues...they passed. Of their own accord, or because of Deshret's seal, we do not know.

But what I do know is this. When Deshret vowed to watch over these Mines, she simply traded one curse for another.

--Oyun, "Deshret" (POE I)

We're trapped down here. Though we strike it again and again, the Sekhema's seal remains unharmed. No one down here can sleep. My throat is parched, yet I feel no thirst.

The foreman is beginning to show signs of madness. He claims the walls, earth, and even his pick have become sticky as honey. I pray death comes for us soon, but I fear we will receive something far worse.

--Unknown, Deep Dig Memory (POE I)

It seems the mines of Highgate were sealed before everyone could be evacuated... what a terrible fate...

--Zana, on Deep Dig Memory (POE I)

... Our Red Sekhema sealed that gate for a reason. Not simply to prevent the Beast from reaching out, but to hinder those fools who would disturb its slumber. ...

--Kira, "The Mines" (POE I)

Sekhema Deshret sealed the Mines, trapped the Nightmare within its black den.

The Beast should never have been imprisoned. The Beast should have been destroyed, yet, for all her ferocity, it seemed that Deshret lacked the courage to do so. ...

Deshret's Banner...was taken from her when she fell to Voll, the Brittle Emperor. ...

--Oyun, "Introduction" (POE I)

The Red Sekhema was the woman who forged what it meant to be 'Maraketh', a people united, strong. Deshret lit fires in the hearts of women and loins of men. When she fell, so did the Maraketh. We've been falling ever since.

--Tasuni, "Deshret" (POE I)

Yes, Tasuni has informed me of Deshret's existence within the Mines, but has been unable to tell me how she comes to be there. Another troubling hole in our knowledge of Nightmare...

--Oyun, "Deshret" (POE I)

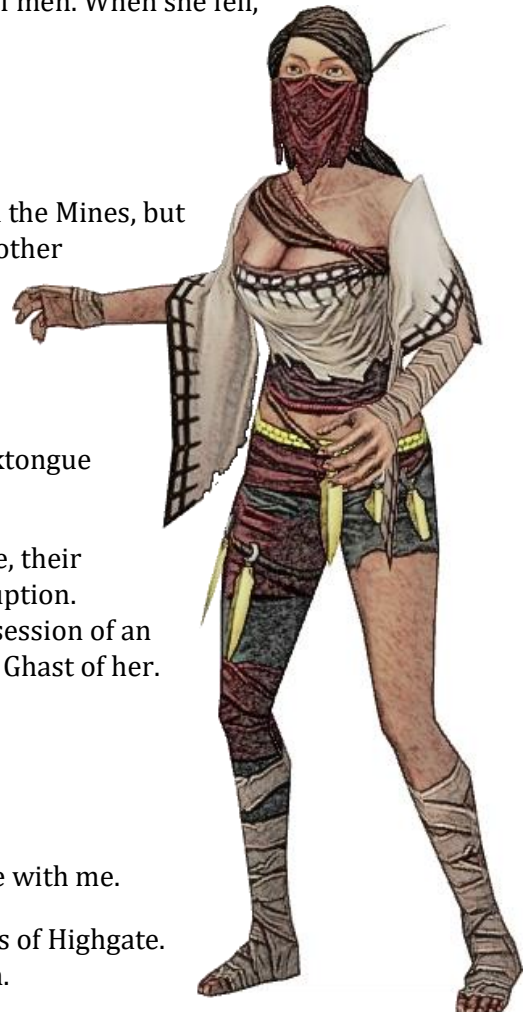
Malachai's apprentices. Shavronne of Umbra, Doedre Darktongue and Inquisitor Maligaro. ...

Poor Deshret. Each had their wicked way with her, you see, their turn at trying to subsume Deshret into the collective corruption. Ingenious, they are. True artists. Had Deshret been in possession of an imagination, they might well have succeeded in creating a Ghast of her. Fortunately for us, Deshret never had such a faculty.

--Tasuni, "Malachai's Apprentices" (POE I)

...I hear her voice as clearly as if she were sitting right here with me.

Words of a dead woman, reverberating up from the depths of Highgate. A spirit chained, yet not enslaved. Tortured, yet unbroken.



That dead woman is Deshret, and our Red Sekhema longs to return to the dust of her Vastiri...

--Tasuni, "Deshret" (POE I)

The Maraketh are an ancient race, bound by ascetic tradition. They have been tasked by their deceased leader, the Sekhema Deshret, with the duty of guarding the entrance to the mines of Highgate. Deshret aided her people in their vigil, helping to craft a new breed of weaponry. ... They are known simply as the Maraketh Weapons.

--<https://www.pathofexile.com/theawakening/items> (POE I)

THE FATE OF RIGWALD & THE EZOMYTES

*Death came to town.
The roaring Ezomytes wore red.
The red of blood,
The red of the fray.*

*Death came to town.
The crying Ezomytes wore black.
The black of disease,
The black of dismay.*

*Death came to town.
The silent Ezomytes wore grey.
The grey of twilight.
The grey of decay.*

Only the Isles of Skothe were spared. Once, a backwater of my proud civilisation, now... all that remains of the Ezomytes.

--Grigor, "Ezomytes" (POE I)

... A plague wiped out Ezomyr...

--Kahuturoa, "The Ezomytes" (POE I)

I stood with the Army of Purity and looked upon the mighty walls of Sarn. I fought against Chitus and his Gemling aberrations. I watched the strongest of our army, Ezomyte, Maraketh, Karui and Templar, struck down by creatures of thaumaturgy.

It will take more than strong men and women to defeat Chitus, for this is no longer a war of mud and blood. We face monsters, and to defeat them, we need some monsters of our own.

Here I stand, amongst these stones. Here I lay my gifts of blood and song, of flesh and fire. Here I call out to the First Ones, beasts of legend, terrors of our dreams. Here I howl to the Greatwolf himself.

Should he answer, I am ready to pay the price that I know he will ask. It is no more than a man should do for his family. It is no more than a king should do for his people.

- Rigwald, the Wolven King

--Inscription IV (POE I)

Ancient Ezomyte Talismans

Talismans are infused with the power of the First Ones, the primeval gods of the ancient Ezomytes. The creatures of Wraeclast are instinctively drawn to these relics and the feral vigour they impart. ...

--<https://www.pathofexile.com/forum/view-thread/1478438>



Thane Rigwald, The Wolven King

Rigwald the Wolven King led the Ezomytes during the Purity Rebellion. To ensure the ongoing freedom of his people, he recovered the Talismans of the First Ones and called upon those ancient Ezomyte gods to help him. It was a First One called the Greatwolf who answered, and it soon became apparent that the Wolven King had bitten off more than he could chew.

--<https://www.pathofexile.com/forum/view-thread/1478438>

The wolf greeted the king,
In the light of the harvest moon.
The wolf offered the strength of the wild,
And the king paid for it in blood.

--Greatwolf Talisman (POE I)

Look not upon me with fear, my men. Though I seem strange, even monstrous, were you to see with the eyes of your forebears, your hearts would be filled with wonder.

- The Wolven King

--Monkey Paw Talisman (POE I)

The Greatwolf has come for me. His heart beats within my chest. His tongue lolls within my mouth. His fangs crown my jaw. His eyes rest within my sockets.

I do not see Ezomyte and Eternal, king and commoner, master and slave. I see only prey.

In the world of street and field, the emperor has fallen. Those who were slaves are now free.

In the world of forest and mountain, the First Ones hunt and feed as they have done since the first dawn.

No longer will I walk among my people. I will not have their blood on my lips. I will not be their king.

I am the King of Wolves now.

- Rigwald

--Inscription V (POE I)

The Greatwolf has forced me to forget who I was... and has taught me to be so much more.

A man becomes a king so that he may protect the people of the day. A man becomes a god so that he may protect the people of all the days to come.

And so the endless hunt begins.

The fervour of the First Ones remains, bound by the druids into fetishes of tooth and bone, skin and claw. I know where these potent talismans have been strewn. I have their scent.

And so the endless hunt begins.

I shall pursue the thieves of our ancient heritage. I shall wrest our First Ones from the clutching and the corrupted lest they feel and grow fecund on power not their own. Power I must have, must wield, in the name of all that is Ezomyr to come.

And so the endless hunt beings.

- Rigwald

--Inscription VI (POE I)



THE FATE OF CADIRO

The Perandus Fall

The Perandus reign was brief, cut short by the Purity Rebellion and the death of Emperor Chitus. However, in the months before the revolt, a steady stream of unremarkable carts and wagons flowed from the capital, bearing a secret cargo to the far reaches of Wraeclast. By the time House Perandus fell, Cadiro had managed to steal the entirety of the kingdom's treasury.

--<https://www.pathofexile.com/forum/view-thread/1595088>

Indebted Guardians

Like many wealthy families of their day, the Perandus family were quick to lend and quicker still to charge interest. They had many debtors. Normally death forgives a debt, but not when a sum is owed to an adherent of Prospero. After the Cataclysm, the deity bound the slain Perandus debtors in eternal servitude, bidding them to forever guard the family's wealth. You will find them near Cadiro's caches, waiting tirelessly for their master's return.

--<https://www.pathofexile.com/forum/view-thread/1595088>

Stolen Treasures

In the wake of the Cataclysm, the locations of the kingdom's stolen treasures, secreted away in caches throughout the land, were lost to record and tale. Of the Perandus family, only Cadiro remains alive, forever sustained by his devotion to Prospero. He wanders the countryside in search of his lost caches, eager to reclaim them and their riches.

--<https://www.pathofexile.com/forum/view-thread/1595088>

Now you have the look of a connoisseur, an educated appreciator of all things exquisite and dangerous.

And I, Cadiro, am one who provides such delights. Once a lord of influence and opulence, I am now but a humble peddler seeking to recover his lost fortunes. Gold coins of Perandus mintage, secreted away in gilded chests so as to escape



the grasping digits of that puritanical usurper, Voll of Thebrus. Perhaps you have seen such chests on your travels?

If so, I could offer you antiquities of remarkable potency, paraphernalia of pernicious craftsmanship. All I would ask in return is the conveyance of the contents of said chests to my person.

As fortune would have it, I have such a wonder in stock even now. A relic of such formidable agency that I shudder to think what it could do in the hands of one predisposed to use it.

For a little coin, those hands could be yours.

--Cadiro, "Introduction" (POE I)

Yes, you are quite right to query my curious penchant for obsolete currency.

Once there was a time when my personal symphony was composed, quite completely, of the delightful tinklings of coinage. Nowadays, I'm dancing to someone else's tune.

I have a backer, you see, who generously supports my ongoing liquidity. Naturally, he expects a good return on his investment, and it transpires that only coinage of the golden variety will satiate that expectation.

--Cadiro, "Perandus Coins" (POE I)

When you're a *fat purse* such as I, you are wise to insure yourself against being slit and emptied. In the face of Voll's ridiculous crusade to Highgate, I thought it only prudent to bolster my insurance policies.

It was in our household god, Prospero, that I found my ideal underwriter. While my relations paid tithe and lip service to Prospero the symbol, Prospero the myth, I chose to dig a little deeper than that.

To my delight, it transpired that our god was not only real, but of a similar opinion regarding the near, uncertain future of the Empire.

We signed a contract, Prospero and I, and more than two centuries have borne witness to our successful partnership.

The best deal I ever made.

--Cadiro, "Cataclysm" (POE I)

It was more than luck that allowed the Perandus line to turn even great misfortunes into golden opportunities.

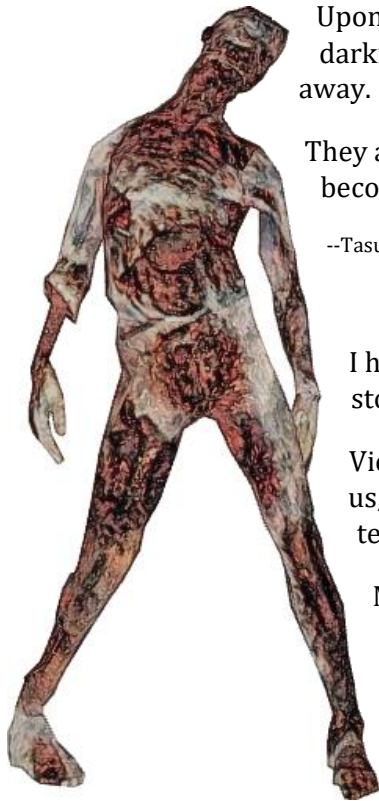
--The Perandus Pact Prismatic Jewel (POE I)

You know... I thought about making a deal with Chaos, but the price was too high. Prospero is a much better master.

It's been well over a century since I've bargained with the entity known as Chaos.

--Cadiro, on a Chaos Orb (POE I)

THE DEAD RISE



Upon death, our bodies return to the ground. Those that are marked with darkness nourish the corruption. Those that were mighty in life are stolen away.

They are carved and crafted, manipulated with malevolent creativity into becoming Malachai's servants. Forged into Ghasts of pure Nightmare.

--Tasuni, "Ghasts" (POE I)

I haven't slept. No one has slept. Not for three days, not since the black storm in the northern ranges. Not since the nightmares began.

Violent and twisted night terrors. They whisper to us, tempt us, threaten us, beguile us. They promise terrible things in return for even more terrible acts.

My husband, Denirus, went to Alliston to find a doctor who might help. He should have been back yesterday. I fear for him. I fear for all of us.

-Tani

--Etchings on Wood I (POE I)

It has been a little over a week since the black storm.

My husband has not returned and sickness now sweeps through our village. Many have died and those that lived have... changed.

These were folk we once called neighbour and friend. Now they limp and stagger through the night, their deformities as grotesque as the madness in their eyes.

-Tani

--Etchings on Wood II (POE I)

The moon was full the night of the black storm. It is full again.

They have come for me. They have come for my daughters. Bravalo called out while the others skulked and muttered in the darkness. Corin went to them, arms open, welcoming. The nightmares told her to.

My uncle tried to stop her. Bravalo crushed his skull with his smith's hammer. I barred the doors and windows but they screamed like monkeys and beat themselves bloody trying to get in.

I had no choice. I took my two youngest and fled through the cellar, following the tunnel to the mill.

All we can do is hide and hope. God help us.

-Tani

--Etchings on Wood III (POE I)

Three lunari gone now, since it all began. Perhaps I am the only one who still looks upon Lunaris, who remembers her name. Soon, I will be gone and the moon will go on, alone.

My husband has returned and he hunts for me. My dead husband hunts me. Corin too, and my uncle. Corpses rise and walk and feed. My girls, they walk now... and feed.

God has forsaken us. Lunaris is my witness. Tonight, I return to my family.

-Tani

--Etchings on Wood IV (POE I)

Arrol, the Merry Gull's cook, washed up on the rocks over yonder. Dead as a doornail he was. Buried him myself.

Then a few days later I see him on the beach... a little worse for wear, but upright, shuffling about. A land full of disturbing surprises, this Wraeclast.

--Bestel, "Drowned Dead" (POE I)

The Eternal Empire has some right nasty leftovers. Whether it's something in the air or in the water, no one stays dead long in Wraeclast... not the first time. Can take a little while, but sooner or later corpses wake up and go looking for breakfast.

--Tarkleigh, "Drowned Dead" (POE I)



THE CORRUPTION OF NATURE

Every time I took a stroll in the wilderness, I encountered vicious, mutated animals. It seems that the effects of the Cataclysm aren't solely limited to people.

--Divinia, "Wildlife" (POE I)



There is land that has forgotten the Spirit. Some man told the rocks and water a different dream. Now, the rocks and water think they are Man.

--Yeena, "Elementals" (POE I)

The forest children are ill. Once they drank from fruit, ate nuts and berries. Now they drink blood, eat brain and heart. This land is in a nightmare from which it cannot wake.

--Yeena, "Blood Apes" (POE I)

I miss the bittersweet tang of oranges. We can't grow them anymore, for even the soil is corrupted.

--Divinia, "The Bridge Encampment" (POE I)

THE RISE OF ORIATH

The small, sole-surviving city of the now defunct Sarn Empire. ...

--Help Panel glossary, "Oriath" (POE I)

... Oriathan wealth was built on Karui poverty. Oriathan gold will forever be stained red by Karui blood.

--Utula, "Slave Pens" (POE I)

The Oriathans built their empire on naval mobility, which allowed them to wage war wherever their enemy was weakest.

--The Admiral Varnished Coat (POE I)

Oriath's wealthiest sought outlet through many forms of debauchery. Their downfall began with the discovery that mixing a small bit of Corruption into wine could temporarily dull a person's limits. As they drank more and more and became addicted, the Den of Pleasure became a place of pain and horror rather than enjoyment.

--The Art of Path of Exile II, "The Den of Pleasure" (POE II)

LYCIA, THE SANCTUM, & THE SCOURGE

Centuries of my predecessors line these walls. It is supposedly the ultimate honor to rest with them, but I have my doubts.

How would anyone know which bones are mine? How would anyone know that I am even here? Because I recognise none of these remains myself...

--Unknown, Grim Sepulchre Memory (POE I)

When I was young, I never questioned our faith. We pile the bones of former Templars in massive ossuaries that fill the spaces under the earth. Each one is hallowed, we are told. Each one is sacred. Yet as I stood there on that broken day, gazing at the bones I was supposed to join, I realised that I had no idea who any of these people were. Lip service. Meaningless. So many have been forgotten, but I will be remembered.

--Lycia, Remembrance (POE I)

Their hypocrisy knows no bounds. I will see their destruction. All I must do is outlive them...

--Lycia, The Templars (POE I)

Knowledge is a far greater power than gold, for money cannot buy eternity.

--Lycia, Immortality (POE I)

I learned a forbidden Templar secret: there are no records of the deceased. They are not 'hallowed, forever, together', like the priests told us as children. They are simply discarded, thrust away into crypts and buried haphazardly in the earth. The dead are simply... forgotten.

I wanted to be remembered, so I sought to become what they feared. I sought to live forever. I chased heresy and the unholy power of the demons... I raised the dead, and eventually, cheated death itself. It came at an inexorable cost – and, as fate would have it, I paid with my life. Perhaps there is an irony in this.

--Lycia, Forbidden Knowledge (POE I)



... There's a certain forbidden Sanctum...hidden under the ruins of Fellshrine for untold centuries. ...

--Divinia, "Aiding an Archivist" (POE I)

I bargained with an entity far greater than the Templars, far greater than myself, far greater than any of the civilisations that have risen and fallen throughout Wraecclast. It blessed me immeasurably and cursed me insufferably. And, in a sense, it was a companion... almost a comfort. The adventurers will never understand the true price of having dominion over the Sanctum, nor of immortality. It is isolation. This is where the true torture lies.

--Lycia, Isolation (POE I)

Beidat made false promises to many denizens, converting only one into a conduit through which Wraecclast might be consumed.

--Tainted Pact Coral Amulet (POE I)

Beidat is a cruel master. He calls himself the Archangel of Death, but there is nothing angelic about him. He is a demon-lord, and bargaining with him was like parting with my very soul. If only he had taken my emotions... It would have made eternity pass unnoticed.

--Lycia, Beidat (POE I)

Time passes at an infuriatingly slow pace. There were no changes to demarcate it, so I began to create my own.

I built stone forms, animated them and made them talk. I raised a legion of undead – partly out of ennui, partly to see if I could. My creations are painfully dim, but to have them is better than enduring the passage of time without change.

I've lost count of the number of skeletons I've prised apart. I've even bottled fresh blood, harvested from curious adventurers...

--Lycia, Creations (POE I)

My eternity passed unnoticed within the Sanctum. I knew I needed to amass great power in order to harvest the will of my prey. I commanded nascent energy, raw and shapeless, and over centuries, I gave it form. I opened gateways in the wilderness of Wraeclast – and even better, I managed to lure my quarry through them. Like rodents to rhoas, they were drawn into my domain... and not one has survived.

--Lycia, Capture (POE I)

Leaving the Sanctum is a tempting prospect, but where better to ensnare hapless adventurers? There is ample treasure here, and glory for those who seek it. Better still, the glory-seekers provide entertainment. The more tenacity they have, the more fun it is... and the more sustenance they provide.

--Lycia, Sustenance (POE I)

From what I've been able to determine, Lycia made a pact with some dark benefactor from beyond this world. She's been here for centuries, drawing people in and gathering a particular type of energy from unsuspecting explorers. Once she has enough, she'll attempt to bring her benefactor into Wraeclast. I have my suspicions about who, or what, it might be...

--Divinia, "Lycia's Deal" (POE I)

The moment is nigh. The ritual is nearly complete. Give me your all!

Yes! The blood moon rises! Beidat, give me your power!

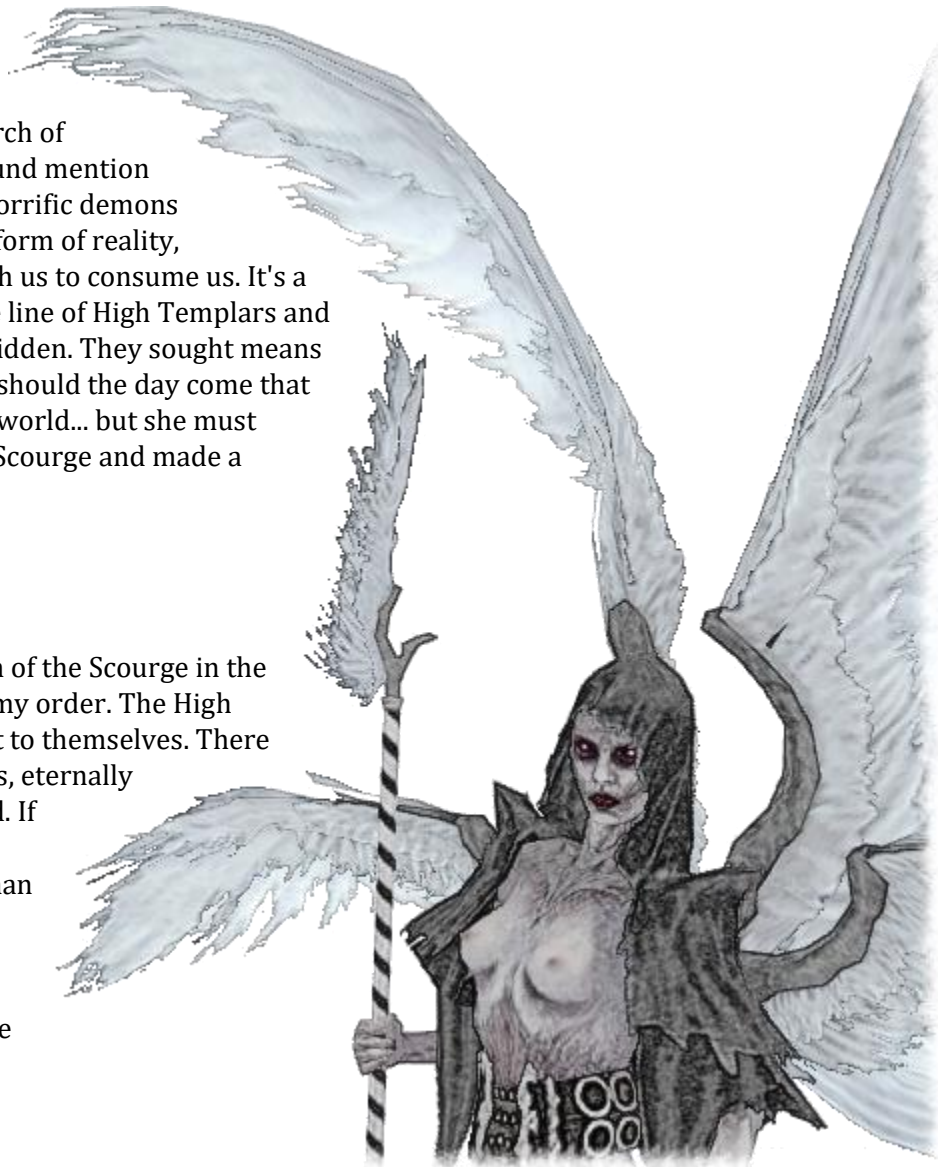
--Lycia, on her transformation (POE I)

Lycia transforming and calling out the name Beidat confirms my worst fears. In my research of her occult activities, I found mention of a ravenous horde of horrific demons that exist in some other form of reality, constantly trying to reach us to consume us. It's a secret known only to the line of High Templars and their keepers of the forbidden. They sought means of power to resist them, should the day come that they find a way into our world... but she must have reached out to the Scourge and made a deal...

--Divinia, "Lycia's Deal" (POE I)

I have only seen mention of the Scourge in the most forbidden texts of my order. The High Templars kept the secret to themselves. There are demons all around us, eternally trying to enter our world. If they manage to manifest themselves here more than temporarily, they will ravage Wraeclast and consume every living thing. Needless to say, we cannot let that happen.

--Divinia, "The Scourge" (POE I)



ATTEMPTING TO STOP LYCIA

... Most of the Templars' secret archives have probably been looted or burned by now, but there's one trove only the Master Archivist and I knew about. It's hidden within my order's Ossuary. Now if you can, please go there and search for a particular tome. It's called the Mortinomicon, and supposedly contains everything the Templars know about immortality. ...

--Divinia, "Aiding an Archivist" (POE I)

The Mortinomicon Exitio Immortalis, as its lengthy name implies, is quite the difficult read. As a layer of extra security, it was written in the ancient language of the newcomers that were instrumental in the founding of our religion. Very few people can speak it, let alone read it. I'm

deciphering the language at the same time that I'm translating and researching. It's mentally taxing to the extreme, but I have no choice but to soldier on!

--Divinia, "The Mortinomicon" (POE I)

Hoc sciendo scribo ut verba mea perdant animam meam eternam. Mihi credendum est quod novus deus meus non sit tam divinus quam ipse petit...

[I write this knowing that my words may damn my eternal soul. I must believe that my new god isn't as divine as he claims...]

--The Mortinomicon Exitio Immortalis (POE I)

Mundus noster cecidit. Daemones ubique sunt. Librum hunc in sacrarium conicio, ut forte alius viam inveniat...

[Our world has fallen. Demons are everywhere. I cast this book into the sanctum, so that perhaps someone else will find a way...]

--Forbidden Tome (POE I)

... I can't believe I'm holding, in my very own hands—wait, what is this? It *looks* like the Mortinomicon, but the text is different... the historical references are all wrong... I might sound like a madwoman, but I think you've somehow found a tome from a different possible Wraeclast! This contains vital new information...

--Divinia, "The Forbidden Sanctum" (POE I)

... I'll prepare my incantations and rituals. If you manage to reach her, I'll be attacking the energies of the black pact directly while you fight her. We don't need to find a permanent solution... if I can manage to disable the Sanctum's immortality even for just a few moments, then Lycia's death will be permanent. That's assuming you can actually defeat her, of course.

--Divinia, "Facing Lycia" (POE I)

...my latest iteration of rituals didn't work. The Sanctum seems unaffected, and Lycia's presence is still endemic. She'll be back. I'll keep researching. We'll figure this out before she manages to open Wraeclast to invasion... hopefully.

--Divinia, "Lycia's Return" (POE I)

In a sense, what happened to Lycia is sad. She chose an unholy path out of spite, knowing the Templar preachings to be riddled with fallacies. And she chose immortality out of a desire to not be

forgotten, enduring centuries of isolation as a result. She is not blameless, but Beidat was the true culprit. That self-proclaimed 'archangel,' that *fiend*, enticed Lycia into the deal that prolonged her life, and used her to gain a foothold in Wraeclast. I shudder to think of what will happen if he garners more power.

These ever-changing halls are still permeated with Lycia's magic. She is not gone. She still has dominion over this place... We will never know the specifics of her deal with Beidat, but if she manages to open the door to this world, the Scourge will bring horror to every living person on Wraeclast. She is truly immortal, so all we can do is delay her...

--Divinia, "Lycia's Defeat" (POE I)

THE CATACLYSM (1336 IC)

This could've been Oriath, yet The Cataclysm didn't reach across the sea. Why not?

--Scion, on the Slums (POE I)

DARESSO & MERVEIL (CA. 1450 IC)

At age thirteen, carving knife in hand, I killed beasts for the amusement of the filthy. At fifteen, they thought me worthy to fight a fellow man.

A butcher he was, twice as big and twice as stupid as I. I butchered the butcher and many like him, earned my way, kill by kill, out of the offal pit and into the Grand Arena.

I thought I would find wealth and glory in the arena. I was wrong. I found something far more precious. My Lady Merveil.

--Daresso, Plaque I (POE I)

With one motion, I cleave a man in twain. A kick sends another flying, and the roar of the crowd swells. I am their idol!

I was always meant to be at the top of the pile. Nobody else can compare. And this tiny man, this new challenger, Daresso, will fall like the rest to the might of Barkhul.

--Barkhul, Bloodsoaked Arena Memory (POE I)



Welcome to the Grand Arena of Theopolis. It is here that I first laid eyes upon my true purpose, my lady Merveil. It is our inspiration that defines us. What do you fight for, Gladiator? Hundreds of warriors tried to lay claim to the same title as I, but I defeated them all. Victory goes not to the able, but to the ambitious.

--Daresso, on The Grand Arena (POE I)

I knelt in the sand of the Grand Arena, awaiting the killing blow. I raised my eyes to look upon my death.

Instead, I saw her. Merveil. Her beautiful eyes met mine, and I knew that she saw me too. I turned my opponent's strike and killed the man with his own dagger.

Fighting had always been about survival. The primal instinct to kill or be killed. Now the fight became about something else. Love.

--Daresso, Plaque II (POE I)



"To know for what you fight. To get up again when you've been stuck down. To outmaneuver someone faster, trick someone smarter, crush someone stronger. That's what it takes to claim the crown."

- Daresso, the King of Swords

--The King's Blade (POE I)

The previous King of Swords was a giant of a man, both faster and stronger than I. Yet I needed only look up at my Lady Merveil to know that I had no choice. I could not die this day.

I made him shiver under ever parry, striking with all my might, so that my arms felt they might snap with every impact. All the while, I studied his face, watching for that moment when he began to doubt. It took an hour, but finally it was there.

Burning with pain, empty with exhaustion, I stepped inside his faltering swing and I slit the giant's throat.

I did not take my victory bow. I knelt in the sand, looked to Merveil, and cried out for my Lady's hand in marriage.

From that day forth, I wore the Crown of Swords upon my head and a ring of eternal love upon my finger.

--Daresso, Plaque III (POE I)

"I offer to you an eternal oath that binds your heart to mine; a bond that not even death will break. Will you accept?"

- Daresso, to his beloved

--Star of Wraeclast Ruby Amulet (POE I)

... When Merveil and Daresso wed, they held a most elaborate ceremony. Merveil was said to be the most beautiful visage ever to walk down the Basilica aisle. It took six people to carry the train on her dress. ...

--Tullina, "The Wedding Dress" (POE I)

Standing behind iron bars, Daresso thought of his adoring fans cheering his name, his wife's warm embrace waiting for him, and of the celebrations that would soon be thrown in his name. But when the arena gate lifted, he thought only of the fight.

--Combat Focus Crimson Jewel (POE I)

If the history books are to be believed, Daresso the Daring presented the necklace to Merveil on bended knee. And from the moment he placed that little chunk of Wraeclast at her throat, Merveil began to sing. It's told her sweet voice grew to fill even the largest concert halls of Oriath, and brought warmth to even the coldest of hearts.

But then she began to change. Her mind and body twisted, as did her songs. The sweetness remained while the sanity fled. Knowing what little I do about the powers that lie dormant here in Wraeclast, I'd surmise that if you have Merveil's necklace, you have the Siren's voice.

--Captain Fairgraves, "Merveil's Necklace" (POE I)



Exquisitely beautiful, slim, graceful and kind, fair Merveil was the envy of all the court maidens. As the most desired, it was only fitting she attracted the affections of Daresso, a famed swordsman, notorious flirt, and renowned treasure hunter. Their courtship was a whirlwind, the stuff of gossip and whispers among the courtesans. Daresso proposed to Merveil a mere fortnight after their first meeting, bending down upon one knee in the city garden at sunrise, as was the custom. For their engagement, he presented his lady with his most prized possession, the Star of Wraeclast. It was a dazzling ruby necklace, the gemstone nearly the size of a child's fist, hung from a braid of pure spun gold and inlaid with a twining ribbon of milky pearl. Rumor had it that Daresso had found the gemstone on a recent campaign deep into Wraeclast's wild jungle interior, a journey that claimed the lives of several men. Regardless of its origin, Merveil accepted the gift with joy, clasping it about her silky neck. The brilliant stone seemed to glow at her bosom with its own light. This was to be her happiest moment, for things did not unfold so well thereafter.

In the days that followed the grand wedding, Merveil was seen about the city, appearing to float on a cloud of joy, so difficult to read was her expression of blank contentment. She went from home to the market to the theater, always with the precious necklace at her throat, the better for all to see. One would think that someone so proud of an object would willingly allow others to handle it, but not so with Merveil. The first sign of warning came at a party, when one of the lady's friends decided to reach out to caress the beguiling stone. The woman's fingers had only brushed the gem, when Merveil screeched and clawed violently at her friend's face. Some who attended the party swore that the sound was more of a hiss than a scream, but all could agree on the horror of the injuries inflicted. The girl lost an eye but was lucky to keep any sight at all.

Naturally, Daresso was aghast at his bride's actions, yet Merveil's rage at the party was only a sign of things to come. She began to leave their bed at night, wandering the black streets aimlessly and returning home disheveled and smelling foul. On one night, her husband awoke to find her naked in bed with him, as freezing cold as death itself, her skin covered in some sort of vile slime. It was even said that she had seaweed tangled in her hair, but of course that was false, wasn't it? After all, the sea was a long walk from the city, down at the bottom of jagged cliffs.

As Merveil's behavior grew increasingly alarming and strange, her obsession with the necklace grew. She never removed it, and took to clutching the gemstone tightly in her hand, polishing it and staring evilly at anyone casting a glance her way. Whatever had corrupted her mind began to take hold of her body as well, for the once graceful girl now shuffled about like an aged crone. She abandoned the tasteful wardrobe that had once brought her so much attention, choosing instead to dress in stinking, tattered rags. People began to whisper that her body appeared to be changing beneath the garments, becoming lumpy, with odd bulges at her back and shoulders. Merveil took to hiding her face from view beneath a grimy cowl, but a few who saw her in good light said that her visage had changed as well. It was all stretched with blotched skin, her lips pulled back in an agonizing grimace, her exposed teeth long and sharp. Through all of this, Daresso remained a dedicated stalwart beside his wife, and few could fault him. Merveil now carried his child within her.



Yet the bonds of marriage were soon not strong enough. On a moonless night, with his wife fitfully asleep, Daresso gathered a few light possessions, slipped out into the night, and sailed off [for] Wraecclast on the midnight tide. Finding him gone in the morning, the last of Merveil's waning sanity appeared to slip away. She ran the entire distance to the cliffs barefoot, bloodying her feet on the hard cobbles of the road. Then she climbed down the rocks like a thing possessed and stood on the sandy beach, clutching the necklace to her chest while she screamed at the top of her lungs. Efforts to bring the girl back to the city were futile. She would attack anyone who got close.

For many days, Merveil remained at the water's edge, filthy and forlorn. She sustained herself on fish she pulled from the waters, devouring them alive, bones and all. She huddled in a nearby cave during the day, and spent the cold night hours standing knee-deep in the waves, singing out to the ocean for her lost husband. Her countenance grew haggard and shriveled, but her belly continued to grow, and when the child was finally born it was a freakish nightmare of scales, slime and tentacles. It was also female. With the birth of her spawn, Merveil retreated deep into the labyrinth of tidal tunnels beneath Wraeclast's cliff walls, where she grew ever more twisted and corrupt. Still the Star remained about her throat, pulsing with some dark energy.

It seems that in the years since these tragic events, the fair lady has been busy producing more children, though by what mechanism none can say. Her daughters, now of untold number, haunt the island's shoreline. With lilting sweet voices, they call out at night to passing sailors, bidding their father to return to them. Their mother dwells deep in the bowels of the mountain, now fully possessed by the jewel around her neck, imbued by it with powerful, deadly magics. It is unlikely she will welcome anyone who blunders into her lair.

--<https://web.archive.org/web/20170903104755/http://www.pathofexile.com/monsters/merveil>

Daresso gave me the gem, kissed me, promised that he would be by my side forever. I sang for him. I sang for Oriath with his gem at my throat. Kalisa's gem. Kalisa's voice.

I sang in her echo, performing arias that had once made the Empire weep. I listened to Kalisa's lullabies in my dreams. I gave myself to her music. Mind... and body.

Daresso left me, for Sarn, with a promise to free me from Kalisa. I begged him not to go. Tried to show him the wonder of my transformation, the beautiful daughters he would soon meet. He couldn't see. None of them could see. I fled from their hatred.

When Daresso returns I will cast his cure away. I will teach him what true love is.

--Merveil, Damp Diary (POE I)

If you have to quench your curiosity about Merveil, go look at the corsairs that haunt the grave of ships. Like any mother, Merveil's got hungry mouths to feed.

--Tarkleigh, "Merveil" (POE I)

In my dreams, I still hear them. It was late Autumn, nearing Winter, and we were going on three months at sea. Our food stores had long been exhausted from damp, rot and thievery, our meager crew reduced to eating whatever moldy scraps we could rummage from the hold. Already half had died, and those who remained shuffled about the decks with vacant eyes and hollow chests. We had given up completely, resigned to die lost among the waves.

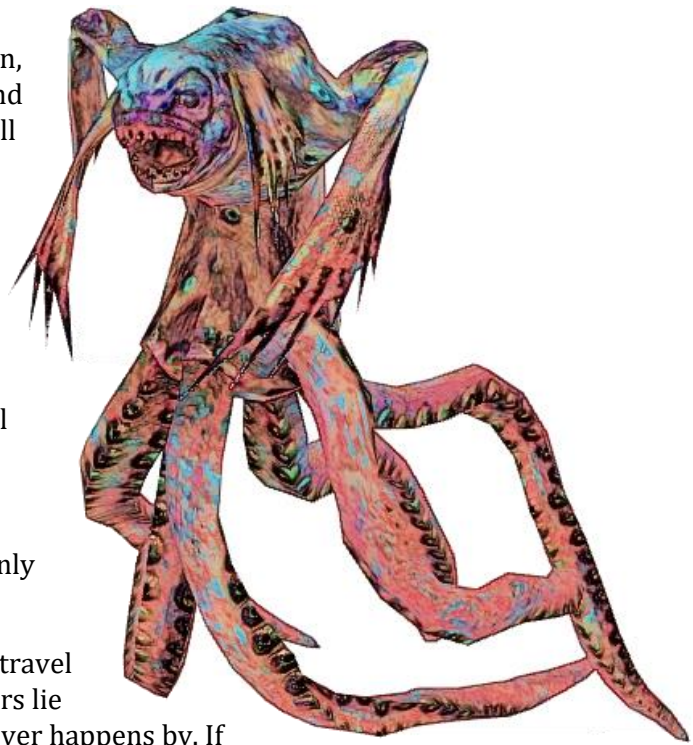
And then, out of the rising morning mist we spied them, the jagged, towering cliffs of cursed Wraeclast. A cheer went up among the men, some rubbing their eyes with disbelief. As we drew closer, the pounding roar of the surf drowned out our anxious chatter, and the forbidding, rocky

wall drew ever larger. To our dismay, we found no port at water's edge, no cove to shelter our beleaguered vessel. "We head North, around the peninsula" the captain ordered, so we came about and set course.

Many hours of sailing brought only more misery and hunger, and by nightfall we were gripped with despair. Wraecclast was a fortress, as impenetrable as a stone prison. As night fell, we dropped anchor, and sought whatever comfort remained. The air grew quiet and still, the only sound the lapping of the waves against the hull. But then another sound joined in, soft, enticing, and insistent. At first we could not believe our hearing. How could there be women's voices out here, in this awful, desolate place? The men staggered to the railing, first peering out into the blackness and then calling to it. The voices returned our hail, rising as a chorus, beckoning us to them.

Within minutes, we had dropped rowboats into the water, and all who could summon the strength clambered aboard. Then we rowed like men possessed, towards the gentle, sweet voices ahead, their song drifting up from a yawning cave in the cliff side. We arrived at the entrance shivering and exhausted, yet nearly frenzied with need and desire. Oh the voices, the things they promised us! Disdaining caution, the whole of us dashed forward into the cave, the dark swallowing us up as readily as a serpent engulfing its prey. And the voices ceased.

There was a pause, a singular moment of clarity when we all knew our great folly. Then, a new voice pierced the air, this one sharp and strident, dripping with malevolence. It was all around us, hissing with delight, and hunger. Then the men began to shriek, their choking wails abruptly silenced by whatever beset us. I felt something cold, slimy and terribly strong coil itself around my throat, and I reacted on instinct. I pulled my dagger free, cutting wildly at the thing that grasped me, and somehow I was released! Abandoning all thought, I groped for the cavern's exit, and when I found it, I plunged headfirst into the surf, my own screams barely audible among those of my doomed crew mates. I was the only one who made it out of that hellish place.



Let my words be a warning to any who dare travel the shores of Wraecclast. The Siren's Daughters lie in wait there, ready to lure and devour whoever happens by. If you hear their sweet song on the ocean air, cover your ears and flee.

--<https://web.archive.org/web/20121101071227/http://www.pathofexile.com/monsters/siren>

It's him! He sails back to me, my Daresso! I shall sing for him. I shall show him the way. Come, my love. Come to me. We shall be together at last.

No, turn away! Don't listen to my singing, you'll die upon the rocks! Turn away...! Turn away... Turn away...

--Merveil, Eroded Chamber Memory (POE I)

Welcome, husband. We knew in our hearts that you would find us. Come, Daresso, Ambrosia and Amarissa must meet their father. Come, my love. Return to your family.

--Merveil, Sailor's Skin (POE I)

Daresso? Yes, Petarus has spoken of him. The disturbing question is this:

How does a man who, by all accounts, has been dead for over a hundred years end up as a Nightmare monarch in the bowels of Highgate?

Unlike Kaom, there is utterly no trace of his passing, and we have scouted every footstep of this mountain and its surrounds. There is no other entrance. No physical entrance. ...

--Oyun, "Daresso" (POE I)

Petarus: Daresso? He's down there, inside the mountain?

Vanja: Are we talking about *the* Daresso? The Sword King?

Petarus: Seems like it. But... how did he get in there? He left Oriath about a century and a half ago, hoping to find a cure for his lady, Merveil. He would have had to fight his way through the Maraketh, but... Oyun's never mentioned anything of the sort.

Vanja: Maybe he didn't go in alive.

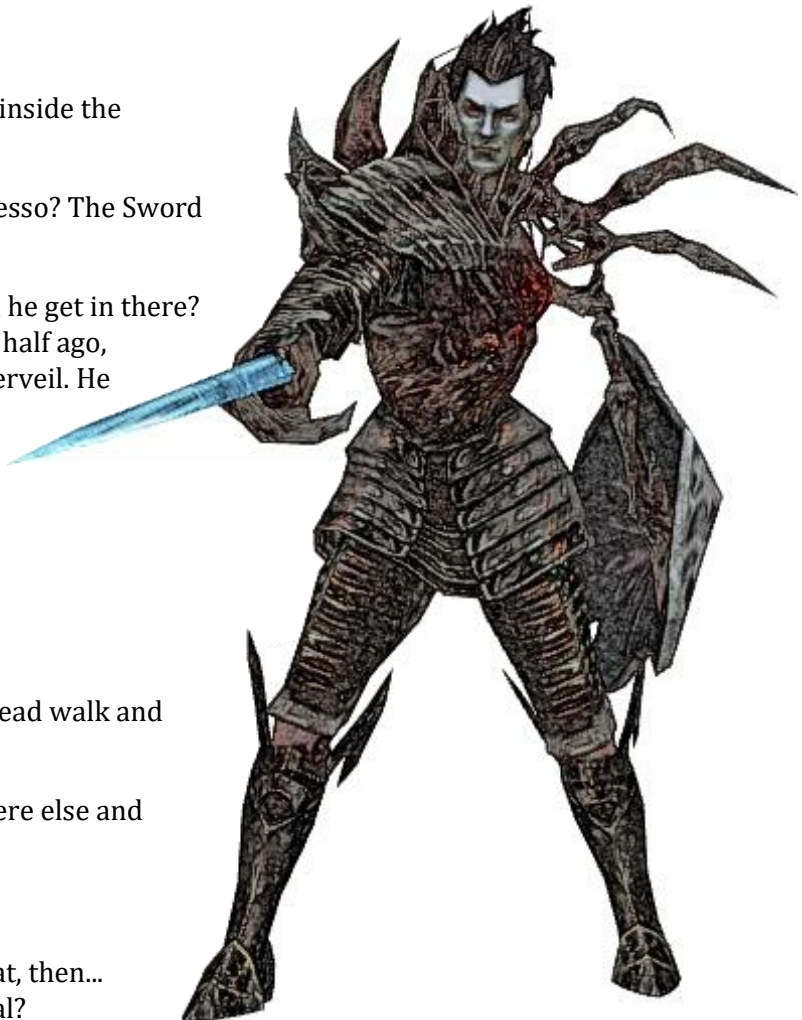
Petarus: What do you mean?

Vanja: We live in a land where the dead walk and *things* like Diallya live for centuries.

Petarus: You think he died somewhere else and then the Beast got hold of him?

Vanja: Could be.

Petarus: Well, if the Beast can do that, then... what bloody good was Deshret's Seal?



Vanja: Exactly.

--Petarus and Vanja, "Daresso" (POE I)

The Beast eats the souls of its prey, devouring their very life force. Those consumed become a part of the creature, existing forevermore as a thrall of twisted nightmare. This fate befell many of Wraeclast's most legendary figures.

Daresso the Sword King - A peerless gladiator, the best the world has ever seen. Daresso ascended from humble orphaned slave beginnings to the pinnacle of gladiatorial glory. Driven by a mad hope to purify his lost love Merveil, he abandoned reason and caution. Daresso's living nightmare chronicles the arc of his pitiable legacy, a story of loss, desire and reckless ambition. ...

--<https://www.pathofexile.com/theawakening/actfour> (POE I)

... Daresso, King of Swords. Damned by Desire. Oh, aren't we all? He's down here too, and Desire's curse remains his to bear. ...

--Lady Dialla, "The Eternal Nightmare" (POE I)

What follows are the last words of Eirik Hoskuld, captain of a wrecked merchant vessel, found in his waterlogged journal on the beach.

"I'm awoken by thunder. It booms suddenly overhead, shaking the glass of my portal, a deafening echo in the tight confines of my quarters. All is pitch dark for a moment and then a brilliant flash fills the cabin, nearly blinding me. I'm soaking, perhaps from a dream sweat, but likely from the icy seawater trickling down through the cracks in the deck. This cursed storm has tossed us for more than a week now and sleep is rare.

I open my cabin door, and am immediately struck with the full fury of the gale roaring outside. Lightning forks and flickers overhead, for a moment casting our tattered main sail in stark relief against the iron sky. A sickening crackle of thunder follows immediately behind, boring into my aching bones. I make my way carefully across the pitching deck, past my crew who huddle drenched in the freezing darkness. Each of them has long since withdrawn into his own world. We've not spoken in days. Cold and fear will break the strongest of men.

I climb to the helm and grip the first mate's shoulder, alerting him to my arrival. He shuffles past me like a ghost as I seize the wheel, checking my compass in the gloom to determine if we're still on the right heading. But what is this? The needle, normally pointing reliably North, jerks around suddenly as the lightning flashes. I tap the glass on the device, even knocking it against the wooden railing, but it changes nothing. Without navigation, I can only hold the wheel steady, and try to keep the craft upright in the tossing surf. I throw myself into this task, as the wind tears into me anew. We plunge ahead into the night.

Strangely, despite the damp and the din, I find myself drifting off to sleep. My dreams take me to kinder shores, to warmth and comfort. But it's all too brief, for I'm startled awake, swearing that

I've heard something. Unless I'm mistaken, that's the soft, sweet voice of a girl, out here in the wind and waves. I first think that it can only be the delusions of my exhausted mind, for we've been months without the sight of a woman. Yet now, I hear it again, and I'm fully awake. The song reaches my ears louder now, caressing them with a silky, delicate, invisible hand. It is beyond exquisite, the most beautiful thing I've ever heard. I stand transfixed, peering out into the darkness, blinking back a mixture of tears and seawater. I must find her, I must know this maiden, the storm be damned!

I turn the ship to port and yell a command to sheet out the main sail. Our battered craft accelerates, plowing through the waves like a thing possessed. The sea rises and falls, beating a rhythm on the ship's hull as we speed along. All the while, the singing grows in volume, drawing us forward. Finally, I see dim light ahead, a faint blue glow, and shimmering lithe figures arrayed on a beach, not far ahead. I've reached them, this heavenly choir, who offers salvation to me and my men. Alas, I should have known how great my folly before it was too late. As we close on the beach, the trap is suddenly apparent. I see a ragged spine of sharp rocks dead ahead, just above the waterline, waiting hungrily to crunch our hull to splinters.

With a cry, I heave the wheel to starboard, and we begin to turn. Our bow crosses the wind, and the ship's boom whips across the deck like a scythe, cutting down anyone in its path. The violence of the jibe is far too much for the soaked and rotted stays that bind the mast to the hull. With a horrible splintering crack, the mast breaks sideways, and comes down on the deck in a torrent of canvas and rope. Completely out of control now, we slide sideways towards the rocks and when the impact comes, I am struck inert.



I awake some time later, lying among a heap of bodies on the deck and somehow, barely alive. The blue glow I saw from afar is all around me now, it appears to have crept on board like a living thing. It surrounds me, pulsing, slithering, suffusing the very corpses of my crew mates. As I watch with unbelieving eyes, a blue, shimmering specter rises from the body of the nearest man. It just stands there for a time, and then slowly turns towards me, clutching some sort of ethereal weapon. A moment later, more shapes arise, until I am surrounded by a host of iridescent ghosts. I know not what these things are, but I am certain they afford me no good will. Without another thought, I gain my feet, and scramble across the deck to my captain's quarters, barring myself inside.

They're all at the door now, they've been there for hours. I can see their evil blue glow through the gaps in the boards. As I write this, their blows fall heavily on the failing wood, thudding with the steady beat of some hellish metronome. How long the barrier will last I cannot say, but they will surely breach it. Pray for me."

--<https://web.archive.org/web/20130705094954/http://www.pathofexile.com/monsters/ghost>

It's a bit of an embarrassing affair, truth be told.

Thought I could return to the golden days, you know? Be a terror of the high seas like in me youth. Problem was, they'd all forgotten me. Those young blighters sailing about, they had no clue who I

even were! Figured if I could complete another great feat, like slaying that sea-bitch Merveil, maybe that'd earn me my respect back.

Arr, suppose I don't need to tell you; that girlie's stronger than she looks. All it took were one slip of the old hands and next I knew, the Black Crest were wrecked against the coast and I'm getting meself eaten alive by that hag.

Peeled each separate muscle from my bones, she did. I'll tell you, it weren't pretty.

--Weylam Roth, "Merveil" (POE I)

THE REIGN OF HIGH TEMPLAR VENARIUS (?-1579 IC)

The winters of my youth were cold and harsh. We had nothing, yet to my mother's credit, I wanted for so little.

--Altered Distant Memory (POE I)

I was a happy child, before the cruel truth was revealed to me. I fight so that the children may remain ignorant.

--Circle of Nostalgia Amethyst Ring (POE I)

A man in uniform visits. He is from the Courts. He says the Templar have alms for widows like my mother, but she must collect it in person. We go to the church together, and I wait outside in the gardens. The sun is setting. I don't know how long I've been sitting here.

Mother comes from around the rear. She looks pale. Her eyes are red, and her clothes are torn. She doesn't look at me but she grabs my hand. We walk home in silence. I lay awake in bed. I hear her crying. The man comes over often after that, with toys and food, but I don't like him...

--Venarius, Palace Grounds Memory (POE I)

People stream down the street towards Oriath Square. I hear their shouts and cheers, and when Mother isn't looking, sneak out to join the merry crowd. Just outside the pens, a Karui boy, no older than I, stands atop the gallows.

I see by the sign around his neck he has been caught stealing. I swear I will not look away, but fear overtakes me. I hear the rope snap taut and the crowd cheer, but I fight back the tears...

--Venarius, City Park Memory (POE I)

The stench convenes around me thicker than the press of the vagabonds themselves. Though starving, their strength while holding on to one another is surprising. I'm trapped in a knot of ragged bodies, and the men of the Church clap me in irons despite my cries.

I'm not one of them! Can't you hear me? I'm not Maraketh, nor homeless, and have committed no sins. That ship is not for me! Why won't you listen?

... I feel it: at eight years old, I was almost exiled by mere happenstance. If my mother had not found me and gotten the Templars to release me, I would have been lost...

--Venarius, Distant Landing Memory (POE I)

I sacrificed a life of love for one of responsibility, so that she, and others like her, might be kept safe.

--Circle of Regret Topaz Ring (POE I)

... Yes, I remember watching their mighty parades through Oriath Square as a child, and I can still feel that sense of satisfaction the day I truly donned the mantle. All of the pain and sacrifice was worth it, to do good, to protect mankind... to protect the children...

--Cavas, "Cavas' Past" (POE I)

It was in my oath that I found peace. In echoing marble halls I found my voice. Before the congregation I found purpose.

--Rewritten Distant Memory (POE I)

The Courts are burning. Accusations fly. Sinner! Heretic! I am but an initiate, and my patron urges silence. We will keep our heads down while one High Templar supplants another. It's all about power, my patron whispers, and we have none.

Should an accusation fall our way, we shall be doomed to die with the other accused. Be unseen and unheard, he whispers. This is what happens when men who seek power refuse to wait. I learned a valuable lesson that day: Trust without leverage is vulnerability.

--Venarius, Distant Courthouse Memory (POE I)

... That was the moment Venarius decided to seize life and vie for power. That was the moment doom for men like my father was assured.

--Zana, on Distant Courthouse Memory (POE I)

The judge determines worthiness by comparison to the paragon: himself.

--Mask of the Tribunal Magistrate Crown (POE I)

I condemned an innocent man to the pyres, but to admit this mistake is to condemn myself. My only choice is to strive harder.

--Circle of Anguish Ruby Ring (POE I)

Without our strict rule, man's destructive side would take hold. Our beautiful public spaces, our services for the ill and the needy, all of it would crumble.

--Twisted Distant Memory (POE I)

What had seemed sacred and infallible so quickly became flawed out of necessity. Created from compromises. Vulnerable to mortal whims.

--Augmented Distant Memory (POE I)



My subordinates circled me eternally, attuned to the slightest weakness, ready to tear me apart for their own gains.

--Circle of Fear Sapphire Ring (POE I)

When I finally rejected my faith entirely, my stagnant belief became thick white blood, as choking as it was nourishing.

--The Apostate Cabalist Regalia (POE I)

I was a Templar, yes, but now I remember that I secretly despised them. I understood that they were a diseased organization prone to brutal oppression. ... I cannot imagine my resentment would have gone over well with my superiors. Maybe I kept my thoughts to myself and lived a life of quiet desperation, but I feel like I was the kind of man to act.

So what did I do?

--Cavas, "Cavas' Past" (POE I)

Out of sight, out of mind. No one speaks of the cursed land anymore. That has made it quite simple to send our smugglers out in search of powerful Eternal artefacts.

We knew of the gems, but we did not know of what Malachai called his 'muse.' The smugglers have returned with rubbings of the device they found. They call it 'miraculous.' I know a thing or two about miracles, so I will be the judge of that.

--Venarius, Distant Landing Memory (POE I)

What is it? You know I am not to be disturbed during my communion with God-- it's here? Well get it to the lab immediately, and do not disturb me again, lest I take your head!

I feel a rush of excitement as I review the contents of the crate. The pieces, aged as they are, still hum with energy. I can feel its potential, and it fills me with hope and terror. I cannot assemble it, but I know who can. I need only apply a little pressure...

--Venarius, Ritual Memory (POE I)

VALDO CAESERIUS & THE ELDER

...the Templar kept many artefacts hidden deep beneath the city streets...they hoped to hide forever.

I think it's time to pull back the veil. There's an entrance to the Templar Laboratory not far from here. My father used to sneak me inside as a child. He never could stand the long work days apart...

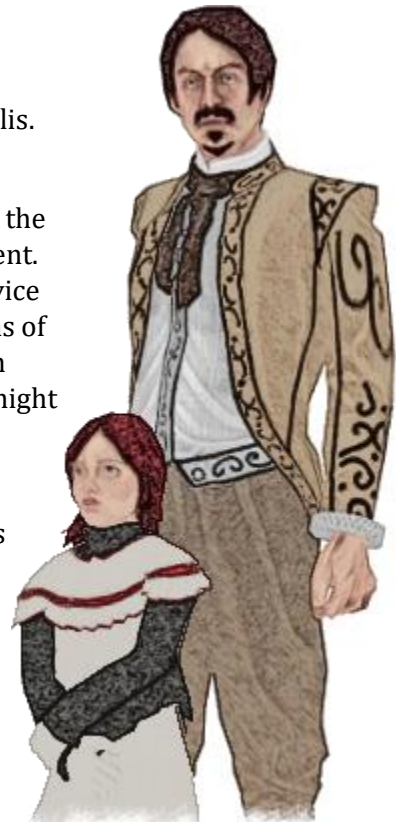
--Zana, "The Templar Laboratory" (POE I)

I am Valdo Caeserius, chief Arkhon of the Oriath academy in Theopolis. Servant of the High Templar Venarius.

I begin these writings as a record of events transpired, in hopes that the penning of such horrors will help bring sense to the matters at present. Some time ago, I was commissioned in the repairing of a strange device delivered into my hands. A golden machine found broken in the ruins of Wraeclast. Believing it to contain some dark infernal secret, the High Templar asked that I restore it and weaponize whatever powers it might contain.

Though I saw it as mostly inconsequential at the time, it is worth noting, my daughter, a quiet young thing of five, suffered nightmares and tantrums unlike any I'd seen, during those former weeks I spent working on the device. I'd assumed that she missed her mother and was going through a rough patch grieving. Now, however, I can't help but wonder if perhaps it was a sign.

I'd considered refusing Venarius, though not in any serious nature. Though my personal politics remain my own, I've often struggled to follow his instructions and rule – filled with such malice and



hunger. Regretfully, I accepted his orders, for I know of many families who have refused the High Templar before. They have all vanished now.

--Book of Memories, Page 1 (POE I)

It's all a blur... My father was the chief Arkhon for High Templar Venarius – a cruel and pernicious ruler. Venarius wished to hold the world ransom with his occult relics from the rubble of Wraecclast, he believed they could venerate him even higher in his status.

My father was forced to experiment on the map device for him, in hopes that he would uncover some kind of weapon. I don't need to tell you that my father found something worthy of attention. And instead of handing it over, he made sure its power could not be misused, a surety that cost him his freedom and me... my childhood.

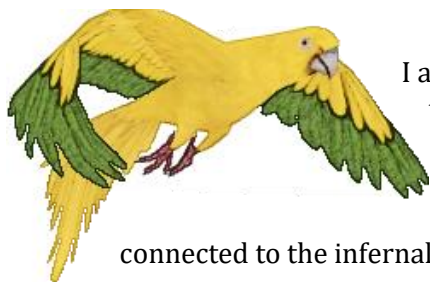
--Zana, "The Shaper" (POE I)

The device lay on my work table, shattered and in pieces. I'm ashamed to admit now that not once did I ask of what design it belonged to. Rather, I busied myself on all the little pieces, ignoring the sum of its parts. I pondered on how it had been structured for days on end, until at last, a creeping dread submerged me.

I was unable to rebuild this relic – whatever it was. Though it seemed to be mostly functioning, something... important appeared to be missing. Worse still, it seemed as if the part required, well... it didn't exist. Not in our reality anyhow. The thing that made it tick, the thing that was mysteriously vacant, I could only conceive of in the half-baked imaginings of my own mind.

My thoughts felt like a fleeting dream during the first few minutes of waking. I worked tirelessly in search of answers, exhausting myself beyond what I'd ever done before, until finally, at the base of that cruel device, I fell into a deep, deep sleep.

--Book of Memories, Page 2 (POE I)



I awoke in the most beautiful of places. The skies were blue, unlike the greyness of Oriath. Birds fluttered through the air, singing pleasantly. Around me, a warm wind brushed my face, and tall grass tickled playfully against my skin. I couldn't know where I was, though even then I suspected the place was somehow connected to the infernal mechanism lying dormant on my workbench.

As I wandered this strange new land, I felt a growing sense of realization that I was not alone. Exploring the fields of tall grass, I sought a peace within the brush. It was in that moment that I met a fellow wanderer. It was a Shade – a whisper of embodied smoke, barely heard or seen amongst the vegetation. It rose and spoke to me not through language, but through thoughts and pictures, colours and emotions, bursting into my mind like water, billowing up through cracks in the earth.

The Shade welcomed me to its land and asked how it was that I arrived. Eager for answers, I found myself enthusiastically volunteering information in detail of Oriath, of my daughter and of course, the strange and mysterious device I suspected had lead [sic] me to this place.

--Book of Memories, Page 3 (POE I)

...like a temptress, the dreamlands seduced him...

--Zana, on receiving Memory Fragment 3 (POE I)

With the patience of a prowling lion, the Shade watched the Scholar.

--Cyclopean Coil Leather Belt (POE I)

The Shade nodded thoughtfully. It knew of the device. The machine was a doorway between my world and the dreamlands, I was told. The device had been lost. Broken and torn apart by villains and thieves. The Shade was overjoyed to hear it found, and offered to help me rebuild that final missing part.

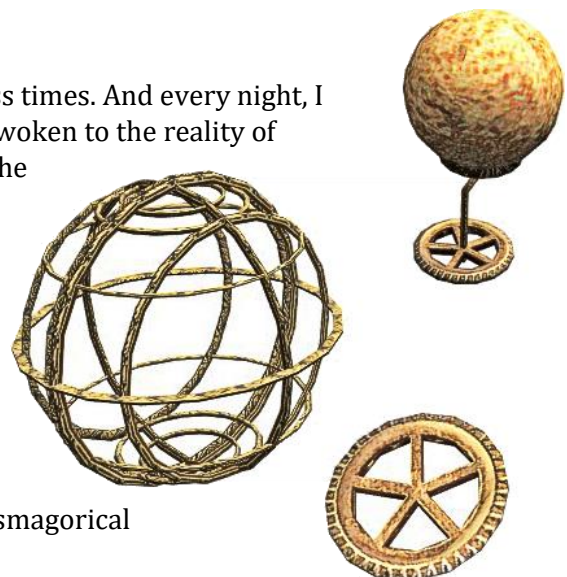
It seemed too good to be true. We would open the gateway between worlds, and then, all the goodness of these lands would flow out into Oriath leading us into a new age of prosperity. I agreed wholeheartedly – for I feared, and I still do fear, what will become of my daughter under High Templar Venarius' reign. All that the Shade asked of me was to return the favour, when the time came.

And as I lay down in the cool grass bathing myself in the soothing sun, I found that sleep once more took my body, only this time, when I closed my eyes there, I also opened them in the cold, empty darkness of my study...

--Book of Memories, Page 4 (POE I)

Weeks passed. The sun set and the moon rose countless times. And every night, I found myself asleep at the foot of the strange device, awoken to the reality of another world inside my own. I would transition into the dreamlands.

In my sleep, I would apprentice myself to the Shade, allowing it to teach me the ways of this strange place. I learnt how to shape and build things from my imagination, forming them in thin air as if by some great, thaumaturgical marvel. It was through this tempering of the mind that I, under its instructions began rebuilding the missing component of the device. And most exciting of all, how to transport such phantasmagorical treasures back into the world of man.



When High Templar Venarius visited during Oriath hours, I'd lie to him and make excuses. Arrogantly, I didn't want him to know of the power I'd uncovered. I wanted these dreamlands to be my secret, to belong to me and me alone. Not even my daughter could know...

--Book of Memories, Page 5 (POE I)

The day came when the missing part of the great device had finally been formed. A bizarre segment meant to hold mystical images of ancient maps. It was on this day that the Shade requested its one favour.

I was shown suddenly images of the past, of the Shade's once proud rule as King of all the dreamlands. I saw his good and noble kingdom, and the shadow that fell upon his domain. A sect of hateful men and women – The Watchers of Decay rose up to destroy the Shade. Questing to control the land, these terrorists fashioned a powerful blade meant to divorce the King's spirit from his body and curse it to wander his former kingdom while his body blistered in stone.

I was mortified! How could people do such cruel things to this humble creature? And where were these villains now? Had they been the same ones whom had made off with the device? Had they been the ones who severed the connection between worlds and ruined its function?

The Shade led me deep into a dark forest and revealed to me in the depths of a forgotten cave, a statue, cast from black marble, pierced by what I assumed to be the very same sword from my visions. The effigy was frightening. Utterly terrifying to behold. The creature it depicted – a violent and abhorrent thing, stood amidst an altar of ancient wood and bone. I felt a chill go up my spine as in that moment, the Shade closed in behind...

--Book of Memories, Page 6 (POE I)

Pull the blade from my chest. [sic] the Shade imposed upon my mind in both image and thought, "remove [sic] the sword. Free me." But as I found myself reaching out to do as asked, a great horror came upon me and for the first time, doubt entered my mind. I wondered if this creature was who it had told me. I resolved to hold off for a moment, to ask more questions and discover a greater understanding of the Shade, and so in trepidation, I refused.

At merely the suggestion of rebellion, the Shade flew into a fury! It flamed red, full of rage! And though it could not speak, it made its intentions very clear. I felt my mind torn asunder as images of murder and mutilation were forced upon me. I was... doing things. Terrible things to the ones I loved... to my daughter.

I fled in a panic, running from the cave, through the dark forest, cursing myself for ever trusting such a strange creature so blindly. At last, in desperation, I found a small, abandoned fox-hole and burrowed inside. The Shade passed by, still flaming in anger, searching desperately for me. It was in that dark damp hole that I trembled with revulsion and terror, weeping in silence until at last I fell into sleep returning once more to my laboratory.

Once back, I fled into the streets, arriving home in the dead of night. Bursting through my daughter's bedroom, I woke her and hugged her tight, shaking and crying as I did so. Promising that I would never, ever, let her go again.

--Book of Memories, Page 7 (POE I)

Months have now passed since my horrifying descent into that fox-hole, since the Shade revealed its true nature. Every day, the slimed and poisoned tendrils of fear grip ever tighter into my flesh, and each morning, I lock myself inside my study, delving into the darkest tomes one can find, searching for some infernal, occult knowledge that might save us from the thing I fled.

I'd almost given up hope, so little did I really know about the Shade and its "dreamlands". That is, until this morning when a shipment arrived for me from Eramir, a scholar whom I greatly admire. Sifting through the countless fragments of parchments and books he has sent me, I have found at last, some information which could be of some use.

These Watchers of Decay did indeed exist at one time in our world's distant past, and now, I've some of their work! The truth of their history... it's... it is so unutterable that I hesitate even now, to write it down, to put the words to my own journal. Yet I am an Arkhon and us Arkhons record all...

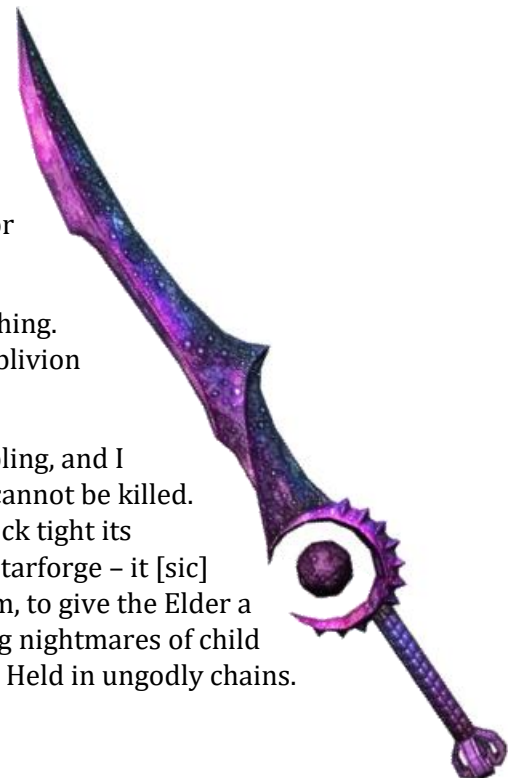
--Book of Memories, Page 8 (POE I)

They called it the Elder. A creature of malignant madness, born of that oblivion from before time itself began. Once only an abstract expression, the Elder was given physical form. It entered our realm. It fashioned for itself a bauble of chaos and secret worlds to use as a kind of... hunting ground. This "bauble" is undoubtedly the dreamlands I've uncovered.

The Elder came here out of hunger. Preferring victims of a younger flesh, it became the bogeyman, dragging our children off into the night, casting them into its realm of shadow and feasting upon their nightmares undisturbed, for it was imagination that truly satiated it.

With such sustenance, the Elder deigned to cultivate something. To... sustain and birth forth its true goal. Its true self. The Oblivion from outside time and space. The Decay.

By the gods... Even now as I write this, I feel my hand trembling, and I struggle to keep my mind on the task ahead... The Elder. It cannot be killed. The Watchers, they built the device, so as to travel to and lock tight its kingdom of torment, bringing with them the blade I saw – Starforge – it [sic] was called. A weapon capable of divorcing agency from form, to give the Elder a kind of eternal rest... There in its den, amongst the gibbering nightmares of child victims, the Elder became trapped. Starved. Unable to hunt. Held in ungodly chains.



The Elder's form may be trapped in stone. But its agency roams free. I have met it. What if someone else were to enter the dreamlands and encounter the Shade? What if Venarius...? My meeting with the Elder, must have invigorated and refreshed its fervour. I must find a way to put a stop to it, before it finds a path to freedom. If not for my own sake, then for that of my daughter...

--Book of Memories, Page 9 (POE I)

They hoped that, trapped in its prison, the creature would age and perish. But time would not touch the fiend.

--Nebuloch Nightmare Mace (POE I)

Though its body was locked in stone, its essence wandered the infinite, learning, and preparing.

--Impresence Onyx Amulet (POE I)

Time has passed since my last entry, of that I am aware. I've spent every waking hour since, trying to find a way to end this unholy Elder, though nothing has, yet, fit.

Within my secret study, I've begun work on a device of my own. Whereas the Watcher's [sic] map device was designed to enter and lock tight the Elder's pocket dimension, my machine is of a different nature, though not entirely dissimilar.

Day and night, I have toiled away, tinkering and shaping this invention. When I'm finished, this Elder will never bother our world again. The creature cannot be killed, and divorcing its spirit from its body has not kept it silent, but maybe... just maybe... It can be exiled...

--Book of Memories, Page 10 (POE I)



How could I have been so stupid? So caught up in this whole nightmare that I forgot my work as an Arkhon! My "supposed" lack of progress on the Map Device has given the High Templar cause for suspicion.

At noon, as I neared the completion of my work, he and his guards interrupted my tinkering with a furious rage! Tossing my machine to the ground, he destroyed much of my research, demanding to know why I no longer focused on the task given to me. Clapped in irons I was led off to the Theopolis prisons for my insubordination.

I write this now, due only to the kindness of a friend in the Templar guard, he [sic] knows of my partiality to journaling and so as soon as he heard of my capture, managed to sneak in a diary for me scribble [sic] upon.

I don't know what Venarius plans to do with me. I've heard whispers of public shaming and lashes, but none of that is certain. What is certain, is that the Elder is coming for us. It's coming for us all. No matter whether you are High Templar or the lowest of the Karui slaves, the Elder knocks at the threshold. Bringing Decay... I must find my way from these chains at all costs. Only I can save us from this blasphemy that has fallen upon Oriath...

--Book of Memories, Page 11 (POE I)

My daughter... My darling daughter... By the gods. So much has transpired since last I wrote. So much horror... I've not a moment to lose, but I need to... I have to... I must write down what has occurred. It's the only way I shall keep my sanity. I believe I'm safe for the moment, so I shall rest and reflect, in the hope that it will give me new insight on how to proceed in this current disaster.

Venarius, that bastard... Enraged by my lack of progress on his occult weaponry, he marched me through the streets. "This man has betrayed me!" he shouted as his men stripped me of my robes and beat me with sticks. When I was but an inch from death, he took me aside once more, demanding to know why I'd failed him. In my... in my foolishness, I... I told him everything.

I'd hoped to appeal to his better nature, to his higher self, that he might rally the Templar army behind me. Together we could defeat the Elder once and for all! But you should never appeal to a man's better nature. He may not have one. Venarius... he... he took Zana! Held her at knife point. Demanded... demanded that I take all of us through, into the dreamlands - to meet with the Elder!

Please, whoever you are, reading this - do not think wrong of me. If it were your daughter's life at risk, would you have done this any differently? I... I did as I was asked. Using the Map Device, we stepped through a gateway and I found myself once more setting foot in this atlas of worlds...

--Book of Memories, Page 12 (POE I)

The land was as beautiful as it'd been when last I'd visited. The breeze rippled across the meadows and the sun beat affectionately down on our necks. The High Templar and his men marvelled at such wonders. My daughter cried in fear. I felt sick to my bones.

As we trampled through the wilderness, it wasn't long before we were met by the overwhelming presence of the Shade itself. The very essence of the Elder stood silently before us. I felt its eyes bore deep into my skin. Demanding of me in visions to tell it why I had returned. But before I could answer, Venarius stepped forward and greeted the phantom, offering his words up into the air:

"He tells me you are King of this land," he said, "My [sic] poor, poor scholar says that you are imprisoned, that you need a key."

As he spoke, the shade stayed quiet, listening and smouldering smugly.

"I can be that key for you." The [sic] High Templar announced.

For a moment more, the Shade did not respond. A perverse, pensive, pregnant pause lay heavily upon us all. Then finally, casting an image at once upon all of our minds, we felt it ask of Venarius:

"What dost thou want?"

The High Templar smiled. "Why, power, of course." He [sic] replied.

--Book of Memories, Page 13 (POE I)

The shade spluttered into a great shimmering blaze, moving rapidly forward into trees up ahead. The High Templar gave chase, his soldiers dragging my daughter and I along behind. I recognized where we were headed. The forest was as dark as I remembered, and the cave, just as terrible. Before we knew it, we stood at the base of that blasphemous effigy seated atop its crude pagan altar.

"Pull the sword from my chest."

The Elder imposed and the man, in all his vanity, didn't hesitate for a second. He took the sword and yanked it forward. A great earthquake shook the land! It was as if the very ground itself was cowering in the face of the Elder's reunion with its frigid body.

Bursting forth from cold stone, the Elder approached us all. The blade dropped from Venarius' quivering hand and clattered to the ground, a white light in the hilt flickered and shrank until it at last was put out by the great darkness of a tentacular void.

Realizing what it meant to look upon its face, I turned and shielded my daughter's eyes, and [sic] as the true scope of the Elder befell the High Templar and his men. I could hear screaming and mad gibbering! The Elder did not speak. Visions no longer left its mind. It was free. It had no need to communicate with mankind any longer.

As the richness of life fled from the quickly shrivelling bodies of the High Templar and his men, I readied myself and my daughter to flee. While the Elder began to feed, starved from millennium upon millennium of constraint, I took up the Map Device Venarius had dropped and together, we ran...

--Book of Memories, Page 14 (POE I)

I fear this to be the end. Not just the end for me, but the end of all things. The Elder has been freed. Soon



it will feast on me and then, my daughter. Once it has finished with us, it will turn its sights on the rest of the world.

Times will become as they were in the days of old, when the Watchers of Decay were formed. Children will go missing from their beds. Parents will mourn, darkness will descend, and then birthed from that carnage, the Decay will arrive, finding its physical form in our dimension - for that is the Elder's true master! The fungal monstrosity will manifest and spread forth its mighty tendrils. The mould from before time and space began, will seek out the destruction of all things...

As we fled through the forest, I focused my resolve. It was too late for me. I knew of the shaping powers. Only I could have a hope at defeating the Elder. Preoccupied with its feast, the eldritch abomination had somehow forgotten us, and as we made our way back, retracing our steps, I found myself standing once more before the portal home. Not even stopping to look behind, I dove through the shimmering window, and together, we collapsed into Oriath.

With not a minute to waste, I took a nearby tool and jammed it into the infernal device, where it hummed, ominously entrenched in my laboratory floor. The Elder had to be stopped, and so... I left her there, bidding her to hide in a closet or beneath a work table. Then, with the portal flickering and shrinking steadily, I turned back and stepped forward into the dreamlands, one final time.

--Book of Memories, Page 15 (POE I)

My last waking moments looked very much like this place... I miss it. I miss her.

--The Shaper, on Laboratory Map (POE I)

ISLA AND THE MAP DEVICE

Twenty years ago, when I was in my first year, a certain High Templar picked me out of a crowd of Academy engineers. I was taken to the Chief Arkhon's laboratory, among other staff and guards. That building held a functioning map device, and it was my job to repair and maintain it. Several terrible things happened there... but I learned more high science on that single job than I would have in years at the university! Good thing, too...

--Isla, "Previous Experience" (POE I)

... It was twenty years ago, now, that I had the opportunity to work on a map device. I wasn't the one that put it together, but I learned quite a bit by taking it apart...

--Isla, on the start of mapping (POE I)

THE FATE OF VENARIUS

My father was dragged into the Atlas by the High Templar Venarius. Surely you remember just how cruel and conniving he was before he "disappeared". Well, I discovered he didn't simply disappear... He was trapped and slain in the Atlas, and now his soul haunts the fragmented memories that are scattered across the Atlas. ...

--Zana, on a Synthesis map (POE I)

"It was as though my very thoughts were breaking... fracturing into tiny motes to be lost on the wind."

--A Fate Worse Than Death (POE I)

... I-... I don't know where I am or how I got here. I don't remember my name... I don't-... I don't remember anything. I suppose for now you can call me... Cavas...

--Cavas, "Introduction" (POE I)

...

Venarius: Was I... Am I...? I am the High Templar... Venarius? It's starting to make sense now. I sought power to wield against evil...

Zana, Master Cartographer: Stop! Can't you see what you're doing?

Venarius: ...And I found it. Yes, this is a start. This is more than I possibly could have hoped for when I drew the blade and awoke -- yes, of course! Now I can protect Wraeclast properly.

Zana, Master Cartographer: ... protect Wraeclast...?

Venarius: What am I, a monster? No, the real monsters surround us.

Zana, Master Cartographer: And what does that mean?

Venarius: Demons, child. Countless. They watch us from the darkness. They claw at the thin veil that keeps our world separated from theirs. A great tide of evil that wishes only to crash down upon us and sweep our civilisation into oblivion. But I will stand against it.

Zana, Master Cartographer: Then we're on the same side. The entity that fed on your memories is doing the same thing to my father. Help us stop it!

Venarius: Oh, little one, it is you who will help me... Your memories will show what I need them to show, for the cause. Every thinking man and woman of Wraeclast will come to simply know that they must unite... under me. It is the only way to guarantee a unified defence. ...

--Synthesis cutscene (POE I)

"You grew up an orphan, and for that, you blame me. Fair enough. So... why not let me erase that pain from your mind? Then we can all stand united against the demons at the door..."

--Venarius' Astrolabe Astrolabe Amulet (POE I)

Though my life is gone, my purpose is not. My will remains, emboldened and empowered by the righteousness of my cause.

--Cortex (POE I)

I will build the wall that stands against the tide. The day is coming... I have seen it.

--Circle of Ambition Prismatic Ring (POE I)

I feel the moral weight of what I must do to protect Wraeclast. I accept my guilt without shame. It is my gift to humanity.

--Circle of Guilt Iron Ring (POE I)



"Everything I have done has been for Wraeclast. You would pledge your life to me if you saw things my way... and soon, you will."

- High Templar Venarius

--Justified Ambition (POE I)

Wraeclast will unite. This shall be my great work - the minds of the people made one.

--Magnum Opus (POE I)

When memories become twisted by a corrupted mind, history is rewritten, time after time.

--Synthesising Fragment (POE I)

THE REIGN OF HIGH TEMPLAR DOMINUS (1579-1599 IC)

The last three weeks feel like they've passed in an instant. The atmosphere here since the High Templar's disappearance has been so relaxed, but, while enjoying the sun on my roof this morning, I saw the black smoke billowing from the Chamber of Innocence turn red.

The Seneschals have at last elected a new High Templar. Rumour has it they've sought young blood. Someone who can revitalise the Templar. Someone who can bring them into the modern age. Whoever it is, he can't be worse than the last one. The bastard set us back fifty years!

--Unknown, Rooftops Memory (POE I)

... Dominus was the next High Templar, and thus the one who declared his predecessor's pursuits heretical and had them sealed as blasphemous. A load of manure to secure the secrets for himself, no doubt. ...

--Kirac, "The Vault of Venarius" (POE I)

...I caught the High Templar's eye several years ago. I showed an interest in the mechanical arts, and he had need for someone like myself for some highly secret projects he had started. He sought ways to tap into the power contained within the virtue gems in ways that I'm not sure were in line with God's plan. I did not openly refuse his orders; I simply... interpreted them differently. The mechanisms I built were brilliant and powerful, and totally useless for his desires. I may have kept some of them.

Unfortunately, as you know, little slips past Dominus. I was exiled as a matter of secrecy. Rapidly replaced by some little whore.

What? She *is* a whore.

--Cassia, "Exile" (POE I)

GRANTING PATRONAGE TO PIETY

Halfway across the world and yet the tie between Vinia and I endures. That was Piety's real name back in Theopolis, before her rise to greatness.

Vinia sold her thaumaturgy in the day, her body at night. Sought after, she was. Enough so to become one of my best buyers.

But money never meant much to Vinia. No, she was striving for something better...nobler. Used to tell me that "Life needn't be this hard. It's time you all realized that." ...

--Clarissa, "Piety" (POE I)

Vinia was arrested for 'Consorting with the Unholy' and condemned to the pyre. This was before the banishments. Dominus shared a last supper with her, heard her confession. Most think Vinia earned Dominus' patronage on her back. I don't. Vinia gave Dominus her 'better life' and got a new name in return. You can count on one thing: Piety's grand future won't include the likes of you, me, or Tolman.

--Clarissa, "Vinia" (POE I)

You can change your name, but you cannot change your history.

--Vinia's Token (POE I)

STUDYING THE THAUMATURGICAL

PIETY & VILENTA

"We shall peer at these cosmic wonderments as they wake and writhe within that deep and nameless dark."

- Vileta, 'Miasmeter: A Thesis'

--Miasmeter (POE I)

Day and night, she hammered away, obsessed with proving it could be done; a vast ring of artifice under the earth, pushing energy to speeds never before seen - all to prove Qotra wrong.

--Vileta's Propulsion (POE II)



Piety and I have devoted ourselves to the betterment of the human condition. As for our methods, Piety had a saying that summed it up nicely. "Would you consider the feelings of the stones when constructing a glorious cathedral in the name of God?"

Casticus supplied us with slaves, mostly Karui, and I put them to good use. In fact, I believe their participation in my experiments elevated them from squalor to splendor. Our subjects were able to give their otherwise meaningless lives to something greater than themselves.

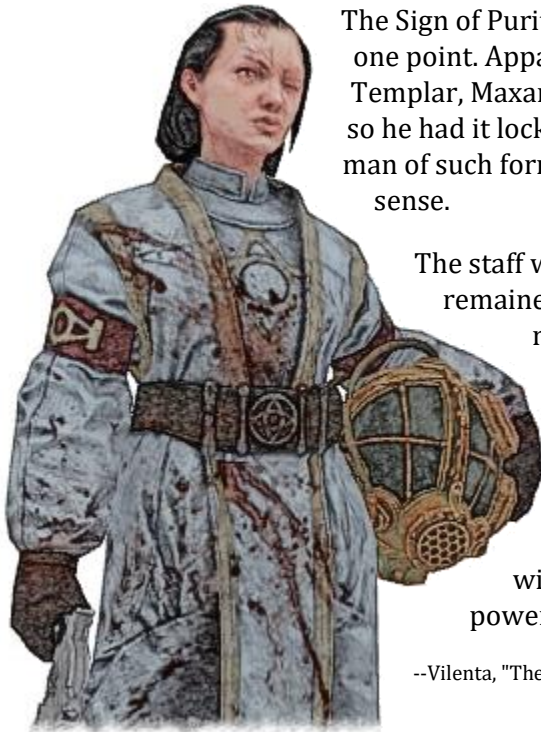
Isn't that what we all want in the end?

--Vileta, "Research" (POE I)

To be perfectly honest with you, I don't trust her. Yeah, I've got my reasons. Piety kept her work pretty quiet but her results were brutally clear. The people she took, the people she... changed. Slaves mostly, and a few 'enemies of God'. Enemies of bloody Dominus more like it. I don't go in for black and white definitions of good and evil, but with Piety and her ilk, I make an exception.

Whatever's lurking inside Vilenta, it ain't 'good', not by a long shot.

--Bannon, "Vilenta" (POE I)



The Sign of Purity, yes... a descry staff that Piety sent me to study at one point. Apparently it was a gift from Innocence to the first High Templar, Maxarius. Dominus couldn't even bear to touch the thing so he had it locked up in the Ossuary. Quite reactive behaviour for a man of such formidable intellect, yet now it's making a little more sense.

The staff was certainly able to conduct and store energy, yet remained inert when I applied corruption to it. It must only respond to divine energy, and with corruption and divinity being diametrically opposed, it's no wonder that my experiments failed to excite the thing!

Meaning, if the Sign of Purity is a repository for the power of Innocence, Dominus could never have wielded it, being steeped as he was in the opposing power of the Beast. ...

--Vilenta, "The Sign of Purity" (POE I)

DOMINUS

Dominus adopted Chitus Cathedral as his personal laboratory. He decked it out with everything his miraculous mind could conceive of. His great work in Sarn...it all began there.

--Vilenta, "Chitus Cathedral" (POE I)

I embraced the patronage that High Templar Dominus offered my struggling museum. I took his favour and conducted his research into the thaumaturgical arts practiced within the Eternal Empire.

I wish I'd known then what I know now. That I was pandering to the warped dreams of a madman.

--Eramir, "Dominus" (POE I)

... To my shame, I did Dominus' dirty work in the selfish hopes of scholarly advancement. I scoured fragments of documents brought back by Fairgraves - and Daresso, before his disgrace. I unearthed all I could on the Eternal Empire's masters and mistresses of thaumaturgy, a subject of keen interest to our supposedly devout High Templar. ...

--Eramir, "The Chamber of Sins" (POE I)

I used to pride myself on taking care of these tomes, but the ancient treatises concerning the Vaal... should be burned. He's making me research for him, and the things I'm reading about concern the destruction of all mankind.

I would think my fears of the end of the world ridiculous... except... it's happened before. I must run... I must flee... and take my secrets with me.

--Eramir, Distant Repository Memory (POE I)

I thought Dominus was a leader of vision, of purpose. The man who would resurrect the Eternal Empire. In truth, Dominus is only after power... the black, thaumaturgical power locked within the Virtue Gems. He wishes to create a new empire, one in his own image. I drank every night to try and wipe that image from my mind. It's still there.

--Helena, "Dominus" (POE I)



DAVARO & THE ARTEFACTS OF THE VAAL

The artefacts which High Templar Dominus returned to our city have finally offered up to me one of their secrets. Though, I am certain there is much to be found within the relics, I'm exhilarated and brought to awe by what I have discovered as of yesterday's studies. I have uncovered a hidden frequency of corruption within the relics - oh, how they now sing to me! They are as mirrors, dimly reflecting shadows and echoings of the past.

I have seen signs of blood and ancient sacrifice in the ghostings of our precious city! Such as what the Vaal would commit in their homelands. Could it be that these echoes point to Vaal culture having extended all the way to the shores of Oriath? Perhaps we are not the first empire to pull itself up from the mire of this land?

I must listen to the relics further, I need to understand, but the singing, it pains me to listen for very long. My work must progress slowly, but it shall progress. Much is at stake here. I can feel it!

- Templar Davaro of Theopolis

I am Templar Thaumaturgist Davaro, the ecstatic, the knower of hidden things, the key to ancient wonder!

In such a short time, everything has changed. The singing of the relics to me no longer pains my ears, in fact, I hear music in them, songs revealing great truths to me. My theory that the Vaal once dwelt in this land has proven fruitful, one of their ancient sites lies not far from here. There is great power dormant in the ruins, one that I am yet to tap fully, but it will come soon enough.

Through my thaumaturgy, I was granted special sight, I saw the ancient Vaal city that once stood in this place. All around me were signs of the legendary Queen Atziri ruling from afar. I saw, as I stood at the base of a great pyramid, the sacrifice of new harvest unfold. The steps ran red with a river of blood, a crimson tide, cascading towards me and washing over my skin. In it, I felt my being shake, as if lightning was reverberating through my body. I felt the strength of that blood ritual, and then returning to my senses, I found myself once more standing in ancient ruins. I thought it to be all a dream, only, when I reached up to touch my face, I found it both horrifyingly and marvelously, pelted with that same salted vermillion.

- Templar Davaro of Theopolis, Key to Ancient Wonder

I have been plagued by a sickness as of late. A kind of blood marking. This curse stalks me in both waking life and the world of dream. The relics no longer sing to me of power, they scream to me of hunger and the ruins call out like needy children for blood, oh, so much more blood! Now that I am aware of their ancient existence, they will not remain silent!

What was - at first - revitalising, is now a torment. I can't, no matter how hard I try, clean the blood from my face and hands. Nobody ever sees the red, but for me, yet this does not mean it doesn't exist!



I purchased three Karui slaves from the marketplace the other morning. Strapping young lads of seventeen. At the blood site in the ancient ruins, they pleaded with me. Something about the place, the corruption engrained in the stonework... it spoke to them, and they knew. The powers demand blood, so I gave it to them. I opened the throats of those Karui lads and poured out their essence onto Atziri's altar. As the sanguine liquid was sucked up by the stone, my mind frayed and I saw the Queen herself, naked and aroused, bathing in a pool of blood while her hand reached between her thighs.

I... I can't shake her image from my mind, even now as I lay on my bed, I shiver with fear and anticipation. I have never felt lust for a woman in this magnitude. I fear the Queen shall be the death of me. When I close my eyes I see her, reaching out to embrace me.

- Templar Davaro

--Research Journal III (POE I)

My beautiful Queen is all I see. She dwells in another world, I know this now. Our worlds are separate realities, but not entirely ones without doors and bridges to offer transport. In our dreams we make love amidst the coagulation of our victims' blood. The red is our passion and the gore has become our wedding bed.

Soon, I will be with my love, she will be closer to me than my own flesh. I have learnt a spell. Blood Thaumaturgy - forbidden by the Templars, but they have no idea as to the power they have ignored...

In the streets outside, Theopolis is in a panic. Two children belonging to noble families have gone missing in the night. As I look out my window, I see the guards questioning beggars and citizens alike. They will not find the boy or the girl. Such precious beings, they were. The young girl passed from consciousness before I took her. The boy, so brave, never screamed once, not even as my blade cut into the soft of his belly.

They are both silent now. Unmoving. And shortly I will join them, and together we shall unite with my queen - a happy family. Husband, Wife, Daughter, Son. My knife still drips beside me. I leave this final account in hopes that those who may find us will yearn for the same pleasures I have found, and join us in eternity.

- Templar Thaumaturgist, Davaro

--Research Journal IV (POE I)

DOMINUS' EXILES

... Worked a spell in the Chitus Theatre, back when you could leave your house without being followed by Templar secret police. ...

--Gianna, "Introduction" (POE I)

The High Templar needed thousands of prisoners if his and Piety's experiments were to succeed. Conspiring on the matter, they decided to revive an age old tradition... exile.

--Dominus' Grasp (POE II)

Some say that Dominus exiled the dregs of Oriath to the shores of Wraeclast. No, he exiled anyone who was going to give him trouble, who was going to cause ripples in his progressive theocracy. ...

--<https://www.pathofexile.com/forum/view-thread/985043>

Hillock of Slaugh

You have transgressed against your God and your fellow Man. You have been a willing vessel for the following Sins.

Mortal Wrath

Six counts of Common Homicide

One count of Infanticide

Two counts of Homicide with post-mortem Desecration

Unlawful Avarice

Twelve counts of Extortion through Threat of Mortal Harm

Seven counts of Armed Larceny

Two counts of Armed Larceny resulting in Mortal Harm

Unsolicited Lust

Four counts of Rape

Two counts of Attempted Rape

Mortal Wrath

One count of Rape resulting in Mortality



God has charged me with your redemption. You are hereby Exiled to Wraeclast where, it is hoped, you shall come to repent your Sins, and make your peace with your beloved Father.

- High Templar Dominus

--Letter of Exile (POE I)

The storm is bad now. The ship rocks to and fro. The other exiles exchange glances as a guard struggles to regain his footing. Then, we hit the rocks.

When I come to, I'm alone on a tiny island. Little more than a rock, really. I can't see any other land. Even Wraeclast would've been better than this.

--Unknown, Rockpools Memory (POE I)

...the corruption of Wraeclast has spread to the minds of many exiles, turning them against one another...

--<https://www.pathofexile.com/forum/view-thread/400347>

Among exiles, alliances shift and change constantly.

--Anarchy Scarab of Partnership (POE I)

THE PATH OF EXILE

EXILE FROM ORIATH (1599 IC)

MARAUDER

Do you think you are savage enough to face the land of the damned, Marauder?

We offered you truth yet still you clasped your superstitious lies. We offered you service, yet you wasted your strength in defiance.

Wraeclast offers you something else: an education in true savagery.

--Dominus, Marauder intro (POE I)

I am a warrior, raised to honour my Ancestors, to die with a weapon in my hand and the Karui Way in my blood.

Oriath chained me, made me its slave. For three years I have lived without my family, my pride, my Way.

I welcome Exile. I welcome Wraeclast. Hear me, Ancestors! A slave stands behind you. A warrior stands before you.

And Death walks at our side.

--Marauder, intro (POE I)

WITCH

Why do the keen of mind seek to satiate their curiosity in darkness and depravity?

Innocence is our Father, Oriath is our Mother. When a daughter strays from the light, she makes herself an orphan.

Learn well the lessons that Wraeclast will teach you, Witch. It is your only hope of finding your way home.

--Dominus, Witch intro (POE I)

They were right to fear me. If only they had listened to their cowardice. Had they not taken my home with fire, I would not have taken their children.

Now I am banished to Wraeclast. I've heard the dark rumours... seen the terror in the other exiles' eyes. But to me, one land is like any other. The elements are my allies. The dead are my servants. And fear... will be my closest friend.

--Witch, intro (POE I)

... Your black art is the reason you're here, in exile. It may also be the only thing that allows you to see another dawn. ...

--Nessa, "Introduction" (Witch version) (POE I)

A Witch, banished from her coven for her ambitions, seeks to prove herself.

--Navali, announcing Witch (POE I)

SCION

A Scion is perfection in mind, body, and grace. The crowning glory of our civilization, offering us hope, offering us light.

But you gave us only murder and darkness.

May Wraeclast embrace you as we cannot, for your very presence has become too painful to bear.

--Dominus, Scion intro (POE I)

The youngest daughter of a respected family. Dresses, dances, suitors... a fortunate life for one fortunately born. My life... had I not been different. Had I not thought more clearly, learned more quickly, dreamed more deeply and darkly than any child should.

There seems to be no limit to what I can do, no walls containing my talents. To my parents, I was a raw nugget to be battered and moulded into a prize for admiration, for envy... for sale. That life died on a wedding bed in Theopolis.

Today, Wraeclast offers me a new life, written not by birth, nor family, nor society. This life will be written to answer but one question: Who am I?

--Scion, intro (POE I)

The wonder child? I saw you perform for Dominus, girl. You were very good. Good enough to survive Wraeclast? We'll see.

--Piety, prison intro (Scion version) (POE I)

RANGER

Swift and silent you stole the bounty of others.

A crow that plunders our crops. A stray dog that slaughters our sheep.

Oriath is a land of men, not animals. Think on that, Ranger, when Wraeclast shows you how to truly live like an animal.

--Dominus, Ranger intro (POE I)

No life can be owned. Not a deer's. Not a rabbit's. And not mine. Every creature has a birth-given right to live however it will. However it can.

My right is to hunt. To feed off the wilderness in the understanding that, one day, the wilderness will feed off me.

The fat lords of Oriath have no such understanding. They call me 'poacher' and 'thief'. Clap me in irons and haul me like cargo into exile. No matter. I'll make the forests and mountains of Wraeclast my new home. My freedom and my bow...that's all I need.

--Ranger, intro (POE I)

I've seen you before, back in Oriath! Running like a frightened rabbit from my father and his gameskeepers. Fleet as a fox you were, even with that leg of prize venison over your shoulder. ...

--Nessa, "Introduction" (Ranger version) (POE I)

DUELIST

You were born to be swift and strong. What did you do with your gifts, Duelist? You squandered them on self-indulgence.

Sin has led you here, your path inked in the blood of gratuitous murder.

You have betrayed the Grand Arena. Now Wraeclast shall be your audience... and your foe.

--Dominus, Duelist intro (POE I)

He had it coming. Was I supposed to bear such insults with inaction, simply because of his high birth? That lord sang a different tune with six inches of steel in his guts. Now they call me a criminal for defending my honour. I'd do the same again to anyone who crossed me.

I care naught for riches, little for friendship. The duel is all I need. I may be an exile, but I will carve a road back to Oriath, one foe, one victory at a time. Ill fortune may have banished me to Wraeclast, but I will live to hear them scream my name in the great arenas again.

--Duelist, intro (POE I)

Now there's a face I never expected to see in exile. The maidens of Oriath must be wailing in their beds now that their mighty Duelist has left them. Or is that why you're here? Did you perhaps choose the wrong bed in which to celebrate your conquests? ...

--Nessa, "Introduction" (Duelist version) (POE I)

I recognise that pretty face. Grand Arena, Theopolis. ...

--Piety, prison intro (Duelist version) (POE I)

...a Duelist...the best of the best, Oriath's greatest showman! I made a fortune dealing in bets on you. Not on your fights, mind you, but on which noblewoman you would bed next, and when you might finally get yourself exiled. Consider me your biggest fan.

--Cadiro, "Introduction" (Duelist version) (POE I)

SHADOW

You were born with quickness of body and sharpness of mind. How have you paid for these gifts? With innocent blood.

Yours is a predatory profession. The business of butchery. You have stolen many a life to fill your purse.

Now you will earn your redemption in Wraeclast.

--Dominus, Shadow intro (POE I)

A simple job, I was told. Silence a big mouth. Get a big payout. And no one was going to be the wiser. Tidy. Except for one loose end. Me.

I would have kept my mouth shut. Professional integrity, it's called. Unfortunately not something my employers believed in.

They raised a toast to a job well done. I drank and next thing I know I'm on this stinking crate bound for exile. It's not a complete loss, I suppose. The way I hear it, there'll be plenty of work for a man of my talents in Wraeclast.

--Shadow, intro (POE I)

... Your murderous art is the reason you're here, in exile... and it'll be the one thing that sees you through to another dawn. ...

--Nessa, "Introduction" (Shadow version) (POE I)

...a member of the Brotherhood of Silence. Oh, sore spot? ...I assume you have had a falling out with your fellows. ...

--Cadiro, "Introduction" (Shadow version) (POE I)

TEMPLAR

You swore, sinew and soul, to serve God and the Order of the Templar. For years you built a life upon Faith, only to smite it asunder with one sinful blow.

And is that not the greatest folly of all? To lose Faith when it's all you have left?

You were once the chosen of God. A Templar. You are now the chosen of Wraeclast. An exile.

--Dominus, Templar intro (POE I)

I fought, wept and bled for God and the Order. I would have died for my Templar brothers, every single one. And how do they reward my piety, my devotion? They exile me to the land of the damned. To Wraeclast.

I know now that my brethren are merely God's tools. He has given me this path to walk, so I shall muster my strength and my power... and my faith. It is my shield against the darkness to come.

--Templar, intro (POE I)

They exiled me. A Templar of the Order of Oriath. One of their own. My only crime: seeking the truth. They think themselves better than the criminals and savages of this God-forsaken continent.

Our forefathers--they did this to Wraeclast. They caused the Cataclysm. My dreams tell me this. Visions of the past that no one in Oriath wishes to know.

If no other will answer this question, then it falls to me, a man of faith, a man of purpose. ...

My misguided Templar brothers have placed me at the heart of the mystery. I will pierce that heart, bleed the truth out of it.

My God is with me. My light, my courage, my power. He will remain at my side as I walk this path through this nightmare.

--The Templar - Path of Exile (<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZyCHZmvy2n0>)

I know you. The blasphemer. That's what my father called you. ...

--Nessa, "Introduction" (Templar version) (POE I)

ARRIVAL AT THE CURSED CONTINENT

[The events of Path of Exile begin here.]

You and I, we're the only ones that made it to shore... Alive, anyway.

Looks like you found something you can defend yourself with. Good, this place is crawling with criminals. There's smoke rising just east of here. Could be worth checking if there's-

--Wounded Exile, when you have a weapon (POE I)

Hillock of Slaugh

"Slayer of the forsaken. Felled by the Hero of Lioneye's Watch in 1599 IC."

--Statue of Hillock (POE I)

TEMPLAR EXPEDITIONS TO WRAECLAST (1599 IC)

... The people being exiled were sent to Wraeclast to be observed and experimented on in many different ways. ...

--<https://www.pathofexile.com/forum/view-thread/2996851>

Captain Tevarus,

Altitude is imperative to forging a stable connection with the Prime Resonator in Theopolis. Power source is equally vital. Locate a fissure in the mountainside and lower a conductive cable into it, the deeper the better. It will take an immense amount of thaumaturgical energy to execute the successful disintegration and transmission of objects, both inanimate and animate, between Highgate and Theopolis. For that kind of power, we must tap the origin.

I needn't remind you of the consequences should either of those elements prove deficient. That is why I would like you, Tevarus, to be the first to test the Resonator once it is operational.

Accountability is the perfect counterweight to ambition.

High Templar Dominus

--Resonator Instructions (POE I)

I gave Piety everything, devoted my life to her work. What did that thankless bitch do for me in return? Left me here to polish her beakers while she pursued glory in Wraeclast. ...

--Vilenta, "Piety" (POE I)

My loyal Declan,

Give our Lady Piety your absolute support and watch her with absolute scrutiny. There is much to learn from the likes of the Inquisitor, the Umbra and the Soulless One. I would hate for Piety to feel that she need shoulder such perilous wisdom alone.

- Dominus

--Order of Protection (POE I)

STUDYING THE WORKS OF SHAVRONNE [ACT 1]

Our expedition made camp in the western forest while Piety took a few men through the pass to Axiom Prison. She was after the research notes of one Shavronne of Umbra, a witch who devoted herself to the study of transfiguration during the latter days of the Eternal Empire.

Piety returned alone and disturbingly happy with her findings. I've learned that when Piety is happy, misery is soon to follow for everyone else.

--Helena, "Prisoner's Gate" (POE I)

I can think of only one reason why Piety would be here. She's interested in the sickness that pervades this place, the corruption that raises the dead and twists the wildlife into aberrations.

--Nessa, "Piety" (POE I)

Piety has become a true mistress of thaumaturgy. I wonder what else she has learned in her time here. ...

--Scion, on Piety at Prisoner's Gate (POE I)

STUDYING THE WORKS OF MALIGARO [ACT 2]

Arteri, my beautiful captain.

I wish it were not you, but I cannot bring myself to trust any other with this most vital of tasks.

This is the only pass between the inner and outer Empire. No further exiles are to enter the inner Empire. We have material enough for our work.

Ensure that the barricade remains in place, and if any exile should somehow pass through, kill them.

I will send for you when my work is complete in Sarn.

Until we share our next night together,

Piety

--Arteri's Letter (POE I)

The High Templar's Blackguards? They're here, rubbing shoulders with us mere exiles? A mystery indeed, and so near the Chamber of Sins. Whatever they want with that foul place, it won't be for the betterment of humanity.

--Eramir, "Blackguards" (POE I)

Piety led us into that wretched place in the hopes of finding a device named simply 'The Spike'. Fashioned by Inquisitor Maligaro, it was said to enable the injection of 'Calibric Extantia' into living flesh. Calibric Extantia being the corrupt energies locked within virtue gems.

We couldn't find the Spike, yet we met its most successful application.

--Helena, "Maligaro's Spike" (POE I)



Piety was after a creation of Maligaro's called the 'Baleful Gem'. It's nearby, and it's something that heartless bitch must never get her hands on. ...

--Helena, on being rescued (POE I)

... The Vaal were a powerful civilization predating even the Eternal Empire and Piety very much wanted to see what toys the Vaal might have left for her to play with behind those stone doors. Yet we couldn't budge them, not with that giant of a tree holding them fast in her roots.

--Helena, "Lorrata" (POE I)

Vaal Oversoul

"The Bringer of Night. Banished by the Wandering One, returning the Sun to Wraecclast."

--Statue of the Vaal Oversoul (POE I)

STUDYING THE WORKS OF MALACHAI [ACT 3]

Dominus and his Ebony Legion arrived some time ago. Now the Blackguards scour Sarn like hungry maggots on a carcass. What're they looking for? Only that which is best left unfound.

--Maramoa, "Ebony Legion" (POE I)

You find a high enough spot and you can see the Lunar Temple over the river, at the western edge of the city.

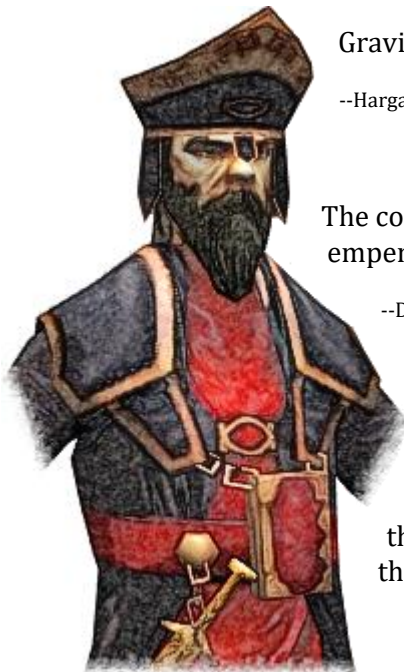
Since the Blackguards arrived, the clouds above that temple have been stained with the blackest of smoke. You can see it sometimes, when the westerly blows. It stinks worse than death.

--Clarissa, "The Lunar Temple" (POE I)

I don't know much longer I can do this. Every day, we cart in the poor folk the General has rounded up for the Witch's experiments. I used to count, but I stopped at two thousand.

This is not the career the Blackguards promised me. We're worse than monsters. Look at this place! Rivers of blood! Piles of corpses! We were just following orders...

--Unknown, Bloodbath Memory (POE I)



Gravicius is the mailed and bloodied right hand of Dominus. ...

--Hargan, "General Gravicius" (POE I)

The cockroaches will come again. They want the Twist. That cockroach emperor...the other bugs shout his name. Gravicius. ...

--Dialla, "The Sewers" (POE I)

I tried to penetrate the Solaris Temple in the north-east. Almost got myself killed by the bloody Ribbons that guard the place. Bizarre floating tapestries they are, creatures of cloth and thaumaturgy. Fortunately, a few legionnaires got in the way. While the Ribbons eviscerated them, I ran... straight into Gravicius.

He dragged me over the bridge, to the Lunar Temple in the west, and put me in Piety's "tender care". Didn't say a single word to me the whole time. I was nothing but a spoil of war to him.

--Grigor, "General Gravicius" (POE I)

I no longer dream when I sleep. I have a nightmare, the same nightmare, over and over. The Mirror. It's never my reflection looking back.

The first time that mirror appeared to me, it was Kole I saw. A rapist from Oriath I had the displeasure of sharing a pen with in Gravicius' stockade. Piety took him for her experiments and that night, I saw her handiwork while I slept.

This time, it was Tolman. Flesh dried to leather. Organs shrunk to husks. Blood trickling through his skeleton like red dust in an hourglass. It's Piety's gift to me, that mirror. ...

--Grigor, "Tolman" (POE I)

Piety's a genius sculpting mere human clay into "divine" Gemlings. At least, that's what she told me when she opened me up and buried a Virtue Gem in my entrails. ...

--Grigor, "Gemlings" (POE I)

When Piety was...experimenting on me, my consciousness was mercifully fleeting. In those moments of numbing darkness, I met a presence.

Intelligence, power, immensity beyond the limits of my pitiable mortal senses. To this creature, I was but a rain drop falling into the sea.

I heard Piety speak to her lackeys of 'the Beast.' It is the source of her thaumaturgy, and the object of her ambitions. I believe Piety's 'Beast' and that dark entity are one and the same.

Wherever it is, whatever it is, The Beast is the cause of my malformation. It would not be a stretch of reason to consider The Beast the source of all malformation in Wraeclast.

--Grigor, "The Beast" (POE I)

Vanja: I'd heard of the Beast before coming here. Piety talked about it. I suppose she saw no point in keeping secrets from the people she was planning to murder.

Petarus: I'm so sorry, Vanja.



Vanja: God, it's not your fault, Petarus! Piety used to say that the Beast was the source of her power, how she managed to turn poor men and women into those...things. She kept using a phrase...what was it?

Petarus: Universal transmogrification. I heard her assistants talk about it, too.

Vanja: The power to change the world into anything you like.

Petarus: Bloody scary power in the hands of someone like Piety.

Vanja: Bloody scary power, full stop!

--Petarus and Vanja, "The Beast" (POE I)

Captain Vincenti,

The Highgate holds the secret to the true origin of the gems. Cleanse the mountain of those Maraketh parasites and secure the entrance to those Mines.

Do not disappoint me, Vincenti. As you well know, my displeasure can change a man.

-Piety

--Note (POE I)

THE DEATHS OF PIETY & DOMINUS

Despite everything else you've done, to let Piety live is to threaten the existence of every living thing on this continent.

Look to the west of Gravicius' camp. You'll find Piety in the Lunar Temple, cowering behind her desecrations.

--Grigor, "Piety" (POE I)

Thaumaturgy comes from virtue gems. Piety had a Ball Lightning gem, an Ice Shot gem linked to a Multiple Projectiles support, and a fire melee gem of some sort. Her blood minion summoning and her transformations, on the other hand, were proto-Corruption abilities learned from her horrible experiments on the victims in the Lunar Temple. Steeped in Corruption as she was, she could not have employed any divine abilities.

--<https://www.pathofexile.com/forum/view-thread/2996851>

Piety dies amongst her abominations, her warped dream taunting her, maddeningly out of reach. ...

--Grigor, "Piety" (POE I)

Unfortunately, Piety was simply a puppet of a greater force. You've cut the strings but the master remains: Dominus. ...

Dominus accessed his laboratory at the summit of the tower via a pulley system rigged to the outside wall. That way will be barred to you, and I heard of no one, not even Piety, going in or coming out of the lower levels.

Go with care, exile. I can't imagine what's inside that tower if even Piety and Dominus feared to tread its steps.

--Grigor, "Sceptre of God" (POE I)

High Templar Dominus

"Dominus, High Templar, 1579-1599 IC. Beheaded by one of the very Oriathans he exiled; justice served."

--Statue of Dominus (POE I)

Dominus is dead, but the source of his fearsome power remains. ...

--<https://www.pathofexile.com/theawakening> (POE I)

You have mounted the summit of the Empire, Not-a-Cockroach. You have crushed the bug emperor and wiped his maggot dreams from the skin of Wraeclast.

Dominus exiled you, naked and alone, unto the palm of Death. But you would not die, would you?

No, no... you cuddled Death, promised it the world, made it your conquest and so generously shared it with all your fleeting friends here in Wraeclast.

Not once did you forget what you were. Not a cockroach feeding on the corpse of a dead empire, like the pests you crushed as you walked.

A man. The sort of man that planted the seed of this Empire right here in Sarn, so long ago.

What teetering and twisted life it still holds dear, this land owes to you...

--Dialla, "Dominus" (Marauder version) (POE I)

Of course, there will be more. You know that, don't you? Emperors. Avaricious little pests scrabbling to steal the legacy of their betters. Unless we burn that legacy, sear its infection from the flesh of existence.

Go north, my lovely Unbug. Go to Highgate, to the beginning of the end.

Dive headlong into the nightmare sea. Catch and roast yourself a nice, big fishy.

--Dialla, "Highgate" (POE I)

THE BEAST'S AWAKENING (1599 IC) [ACT 4]

...within, at the heart of the mountain, lies a terrible, slumbering evil.

Generations of Maraketh guarded the Deshret Seal, but their vigil has ended. The creature under Highgate, nightmare incarnate, has stirred from its sleep. It threatens to unleash a second cataclysm that will extinguish life on Wraeclast.

The Beast's Awakening is not gentle. The very core of Wraeclast trembles with the violence of its stirring. Its raw malevolence sends ripples of corruption coursing through the world. The creature grows stronger by the day. ...

--<https://www.pathofexile.com/theawakening/actfour> (POE I)

The betrayer strives to awaken an ancient and terrible being. Should he succeed, the Cataclysm will see the whole world remade... in the image of Nightmare. The time has finally come to venture into the kingdom of Corruption itself and drive a blade through its black heart.

--<https://www.pathofexile.com/forum/view-thread/1304441> (POE I)

The Rapture is our hope. Our desperation. It will set the Nightmare to boil, cook that nice big fishy in its own whining brine.

Listen with all of your ears, Not-a-Cockroach. The Rapture was Malachai's most wondrous creation, the only fire hot enough to burn the Beast from existence.

And its fuel? A gemling queen, blood and flesh and gem. Yet my selfish self did not want to burn away, and so the fire was but a tiny spark. The spark of a cataclysm.

I am sorry, my love, my Malachai.

Go to it, Not-a-Cockroach. Find the Rapture. Make me sorry no more.

--Lady Dialla, "Malachai" (POE I)

You know, Not-a-Cockroach, had I accepted my place, my rapturous role, the Beast would be no more, no less, no anything at all. My selfishness tickled the Beast's fancy and it laughed the world I knew away.

Yet I have had much time to think on my lonesome. Much time to wonder. Wonder if the Rapture really needs to eat a Gemling Queen.

Maybe, something else will get its catastrophic juices slavering. Something like... eyeball soup!

The Eye of Fury. The Eye of Desire. Pretty gems for our pretty designs. But where could they be? Don't fret now. I have my suspicions.

Kaom, the Sovereign of Slaughter. He remains, and suffers his delusions right here in the halls of nightmare. Fury is all he knows, so Fury Kaom will have.

Daresso, King of Swords. Damned by Desire. Oh, aren't we all? He's down here too, and Desire's curse remains his to bear.

Go on, Not-a-Cockroach. Bring me the crown jewels so that we might wake the Rapture and finally put an end to this pestering Beast!

--Lady Dialla, "The Eternal Nightmare" (POE I)

THE DEATH OF DARESSO

Sing for me, Merveil. Sing of glory and love...

--Daresso, on his death (POE I)

Pried the Desire from Daresso's dead hand, did you? Or is it 'dead again' hand? Or 'redead' hand? Or is 'undeath' really just death with benefits?

In which case, you didn't kill Daresso because he was already dead. It's all a bit of a grey area, really. And completely beside the point.

--Dialla, "The Eye of Desire" (POE I)

THE DEATH OF KAOM

For centuries, he burned in an unending nightmare of lava and flame... but he endured.

--Kaom's Binding Heavy Belt (POE I)

My dream, my Nightmare, seemed without end. I couldn't think, couldn't hope, couldn't fight to escape. There was only madness and pain. I believed I had built a home and an empire for my people, but in truth, it was all a lie. You shattered my nightmare...

--Kaom, "Trapped in a Dream" (POE I)

Uniting the tribes was a worthy endeavour. Invading the mainland, however, was a fool's errand. Wraeclast has only ever been an accursed place that no true Karui should ever step foot on. I wish I had known how tainted it truly was. I would have set fire to it rather than try to claim it. Every empire that has ever arisen there eventually collapsed under the weight of its own disease.

--Kaom, "Invasion of Wraecclast" (POE I)

Let Wraecclast fester in darkness. It is a diseased land not fit for life. My advice to future generations of Karui shall always be so: keep to the islands and their abundance. Let the ruins of the Eternal and the Vaal Empires rot like the corpses they are. If Wraecclast needs anything, it is fire, to burn away that which can never be pure again.

--Kaom, "Wraecclast" (POE I)

When you slew Kaom and freed him from his unending nightmare, you sent his purified soul to join us here in the Halls of the Dead. Some challenged his place here because he slaughtered his own men in life, but such is the right of a Chieftain. His might, and his victories, speak for themselves. Thus, he has earned a place here in competition with the greatest of our warriors.

--Navali, "Kaom" (POE I)

Even before I ventured to the Isle of the Shrikes, I knew I would earn my place here. Now, I will prove my might in each new Trial. I will never be deposed. This honour is mine forever... or until Time ends, as Navali claims it will one day. How absurd.

--Kaom, "The Halls of the Dead" (POE I)

He is a legendary warrior, but still new to the Halls of the Dead. One of the first things he did when he got here was show interest in Ikiaho, because he had heard she refuses all suitors. Surely, the great Kaom could thaw this frozen heart! No. She turned him down in front of everyone during meal time. Ha ha! That Kaom, what an ego!

--Kahuturoa, "Kaom" (POE I)

Kaom mocks my peacemaking ways, but what did his warmongering earn him? Centuries of torture in a corrupted nightmare. I see no reason to quarrel with him. He already knows the truth.

--Maata, "Kaom" (POE I)

PIETY'S RESURRECTION

It was Malachai who reached out to me, who wrapped me in Nightmare...made me his slave.

He has shown me greatness beyond imagining, so much that I thought my mind would shatter under its weight. And although my mind remains intact, my dreams were not so fortunate.

Malachai is in the Beast's black core right now, harnessing all that the Beast is, and will be. He will destroy this world and forge it anew in the divine image of Nightmare. ...

--Piety, "Malachai" (POE I)

... You know, it is no mere 'freak of nightmare'
that fashioned that monstrous
version of myself...

The Godless Three took great
pains in getting me looking... 'just
so'. They were none too gentle about it either. ...

--Piety, on receiving one organ (POE I)

... You know, prior to meeting Maligaro, Shavronne and Doedre, I
rather admired them. Their work, their accomplishments... sheer
genius! As it turns out, genius is something better appreciated
from afar. ...

--Piety, on receiving two organs (POE I)

Listen carefully...as this is something you will never hear from
me again: I was wrong and you were right.

Part of me wishes I'd died at your feet as was intended. The
little girl within me that shies from darkness, from greatness.

--Piety, "Nightmare" (Ranger version) (POE I)

...as powerful as Malachai has become, he's neither unreachable nor invulnerable. He sacrificed
much to become the Beast's prime servant, both in spirit and in flesh, yet three vital organs remain.

His heart, lungs and entrails, keepsakes of humanity lost. They will be our tickets into Malachai's
private, little show.

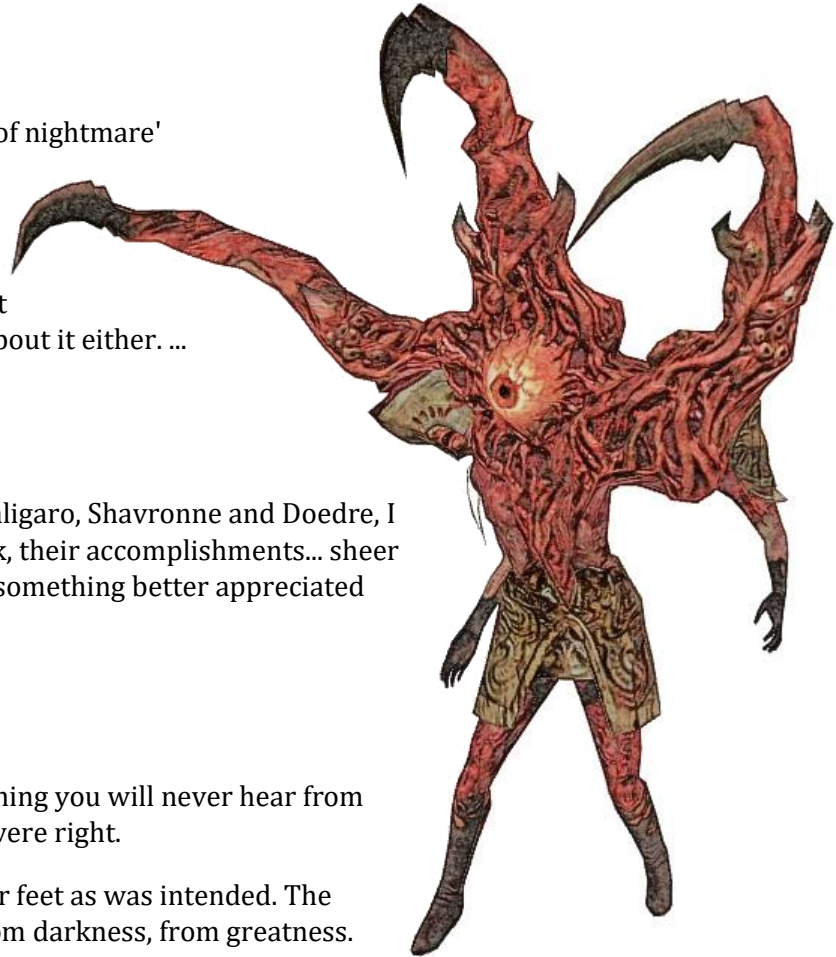
Venture deeper, deep into nightmare's abattoir. I'll follow when I'm able. You find me those organs
and I'll get us into the Black Core.

--Piety, "Malachai" (POE I)

Before we walk this path together, it's important that you understand one thing about me.

I don't regret a single thing that I've done. I set out to raise humanity up from the cloying mud of its
fleshly ignorance. My mistake was not in the aspiration, but in the execution.

Now I intend to correct that mistake. ...



--Piety, "Malachai's Organs" (POE I)

THE DEATHS OF MALACHAI & THE BEAST

Why... are you so in love with Death?

--Malachai, on heart 3 destroyed (POE I)

Malachai

"Laureate Thaumaturge to the Eternal Empire, the Father of Dreams, would-be conqueror of Death itself. In the end, Death won."

--Statue of Malachai (POE I)

You have fought a long war. A war to end a world, and begin a new one. And you've learned the most important thing about war.

There is no winning. There is only remaining. ...

--Dialla, "Malachai" (Marauder version) (POE I)

It was said that Malachai was the greatest mind of our age. Our age is gone. This new age, it belongs to you. It was also said that 'great minds think alike'. Let's hope not. ...

--Dialla, "Malachai" (Scion version) (POE I)

Malachai certainly left his mark upon Wraeclast. There are still remnants of his evil plaguing the continent. We may never truly know a land untouched by the Cataclysm.

--Cadiro, on Malachai's Mark (POE I)

THE RETURN OF THE GODS (1599 IC)

People have talked about the 'return of the gods' since the birth of Oriath. It's a gambit, employed by charlatans to fleece the weak minded and morally desperate.

Or so it seemed.

Avarius and his Templar drones now greet the dawn filled with power and glorious purpose. Kitava has risen from whatever ethereal cesspit he's been hiding in for the last few millennia.

So what let the cats out of their proverbial bags? I'm a scholar, not a prophet, yet there's one occurrence that absolutely reeks with evidential causality.

You killed the Beast.

--Vilenta, "Gods" (POE I)

In the twisting, shifting black smoke of my dreaming, I saw the Beast, lying slain at your feet. I saw the rise of the old gods, their rigid, dusty remains, springing in sudden haste to life. I saw the growing of their power as the corruption began to fade.

--Tasuni, "The Beast" (POE I)

... We gods, we were driven into slumbering darkness, to dream away eternity whilst the gentle Beast watched over us.

I would desire that we return to that blissful state, but my brothers and sisters of deism shall never submit to banishment. They have tasted freedom once more and they shall not let go of this world until it is pried from their cold, dead hands.

--Sin, "The Rise of the Gods" (POE I)

... Wraeclast also has thousands of years of imbued Corruption that will continue to radiate for an unknown length of time, so the gods the Exile encountered in Acts 5 through 10 were much weaker than they were in the past.

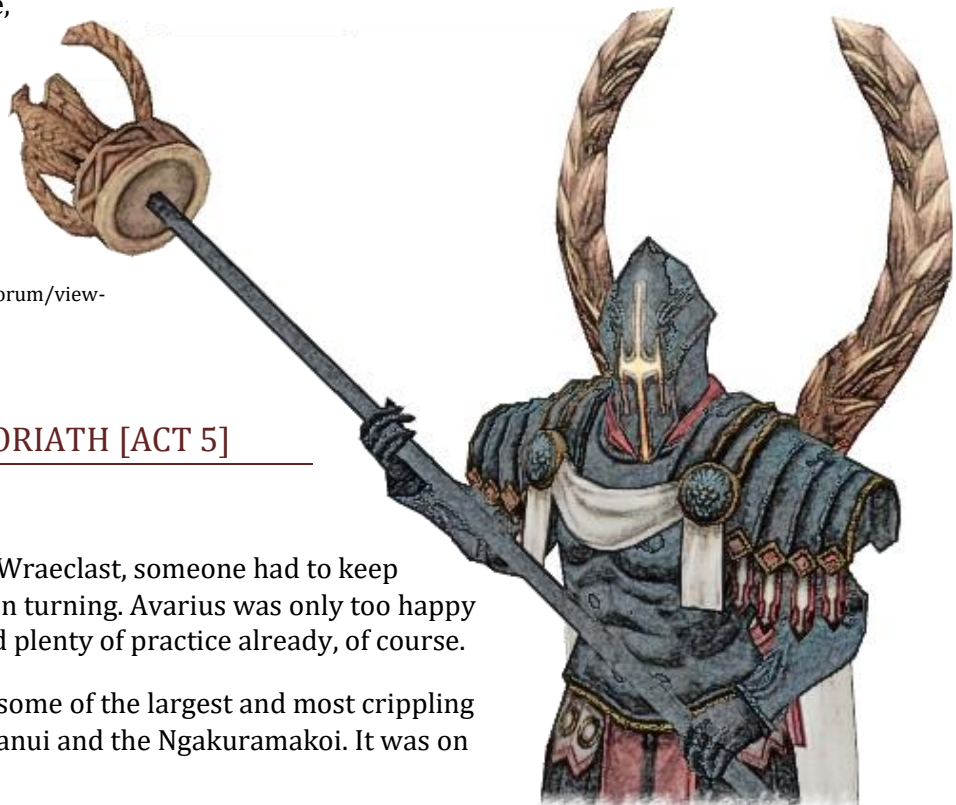
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THE FALL OF ORIATH [ACT 5]

With Dominus away in Wraeclast, someone had to keep the wheels of oppression turning. Avarius was only too happy to take the job. He'd had plenty of practice already, of course.

It was Avarius who led some of the largest and most crippling raids upon the Ngamakanui and the Ngakuramakoi. It was on



his orders that men, women and children were shackled and shipped like cattle to Theopolis.

And it was Avarius who spent five thousand Karui lives building his Templar Courts and his Chamber of Innocence. Who had wives and daughters scrub their husbands' and fathers' blood from the stones so as to preserve their 'purity'. ...

--Utula, "High Templar Avarius" (POE I)

Avarius, Innocence... I'm not sure there's a great deal of difference. Around the time I heard the Beast's mortal scream, the newly appointed High Templar Avarius went through something of a... revelation.

The manner in which he speaks and acts now would indicate that he believes, without doubt, that he is some earthly embodiment of God. That's Faith for you. It'll reduce grown men to the madness of infancy.

--Vilenta, "High Templar Avarius" (POE I)

INNOCENCE, GOD-EMPEROR OF ETERNITY & SIN, THIEF OF VIRTUE

For a long time now, I thought my God's intentions were being twisted by his supposed servants. Did I speak up? No. The pyre would have been my only answer. I did what I was told and drew the lines of morality where I could.

Now I understand the truth. It wasn't Innocence's intention being twisted. It was Innocence himself, perverted by the selfish convictions of the men and women who worshipped Him.

A god answers to the believer as the believer answers to their god.

--Bannon, "Innocence" (POE I)

Old red eyes. He's been quiet for a long time. Just like Kitava... and Tukohama. All of the old gods. Now Innocence has woken up, and with him, power like I've never seen the Templar wield before. ...

I don't rightly know where the gods have been or what's brought them crawling back. Nor do I really care. All I need to know, my friend, is that we're not alone anymore.

--Utula, "Innocence" (POE I)

INNOCENCE'S DEFEAT & RESCUE BY SIN

The Innocence you slew was not the God I know. My God is selfless. Humble. Yes, he is prone to burning sinners, but who among us isn't?

You just wait, Exile. Eternity will prove me right.

--Cassia, "Innocence" (POE I)

Innocence! You and only you, I shall save.

--Sin, on Innocence's defeat (POE I)

You can see him, too? I thought I was hallucinating. Wait, you're *working with him*? Do you know who that is? He's the Original Evil! I won't have anything to do with a monster like him!

--Divinia, "Sin" (POE I)

Do you see that?! God is here! That's him, incarnate! What's he doing with his brother? Has he somehow reconciled with the Original Evil? I'm so very confused right now...

--Divinia, "Innocence" (POE I)

After what I've learned...I should probably re-evaluate my beliefs. ... If I've been lied to by the Templars about the foundations of our religion, what else am I wrong about? Perhaps Sin is not the Original Evil that he was claimed to be. I feel strange even considering such a heretical idea!

--Divinia, "Sin" (POE I)

KITAVA, FATHER OF CHAOS

Waves crashed upon the shores of Oriath.
Waves of Hunger.
Waves of Desire.
The Ravenous God and His starving multitude,
Rising with the tide,
Flooding our streets with death and depravity.
Until Innocence cried out, "No more!"
Bathing our city in fire,
Scorching the wicked to ash and bone.
The Ravenous God fled,
Into the embrace of our glorious Saviour.
Driven down He was, into soil, stone and beyond,
Into damnation,
By the Will and Light of our Innocence.

- High Templar Avarius

--Triumph of Innocence (POE I)

Well... I know his other names. The Black Spirit. The Cannibal King. The Ravenous One. He was all of those things, before Tukohama slashed out his eyes, before Valako drowned him in the sea, before Hinekora whipped him and condemned him to immortal darkness.

Kitava has learned from the suffering inflicted upon him. Learned what cruelty is from his own flesh and blood. Learned what it means to be a slave.

Now he hungers for freedom. Not merely for himself. For all of us who have suffered under whip and shackle.

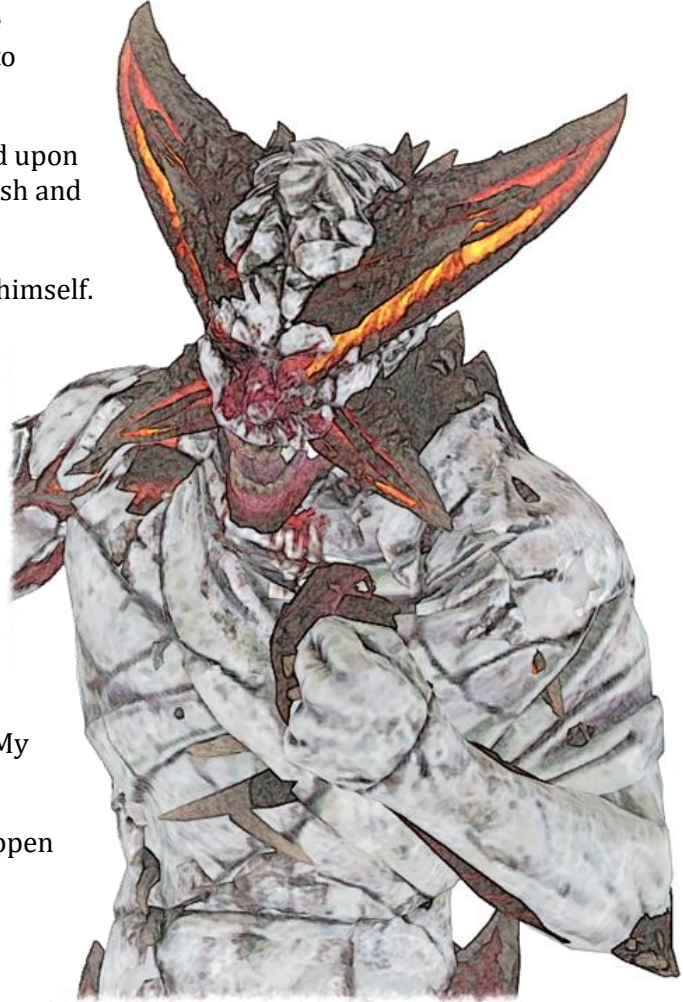
Kitava is the Tormented One, destined to rise up from the darkness and banish cruelty from this world. And we, his children, rise with him.

--Utula, "Kitava" (POE I)

I wear the armor of a Templar, and I walk among the guards, but I am not one of them. My soul is Kitava's to consume.

The time nears. At the appointed hour, I will open the gates... all the gates.

--Unknown, Slave Blocks Memory (POE I)



I can't yet begin to unpick the lies that Utula has told us, but this piece of truth I do have. Utula sensed that very moment when you struck your final blow, when you broke the Templar's power. He turned to me and told me this.

"Now our King comes to us. He'll be hungry, so very hungry. I shall prepare him a feast!"

Then he gathered his followers and left.

Where's he gone? Oriath Square. You won't need directions. Just follow the screams.

--Lani, "Utula" (POE I)

Utula has used the fall of Innocence to summon Kitava, the Ravenous God. ...

--Quest "The King's Feast" (POE I)

... Things replace other things, it's the most fundamental of laws. The larger the thing you remove, the bigger the rush to fill the space it's left behind.

Innocence was the nexus of power in Oriath. Remove him and something of equal or greater power was always going to take his spot. Any idiot could have predicted that Kitava was going to be that something...unless, of course, you thought it was going to be you.

--Vilenta, "Innocence" (POE I)

... I don't profess to understand the mind of a god, but I know the stories. Kitava is patient. He waited in the darkest pit of Hinekora's realm. He will bide his time while his hunger spreads like the plague it is, and when his tribe is replenished, a hundred times over, Kitava will rise one final time to finish the feast that he has started. Oriath is merely the appetiser. There's a whole world out there for Kitava to taste. ...

--Lani, "Utula" (POE I)

Relish hunger, dear faithful. For hunger is the one true state of spiritual abundance. When one is hungry, they desire more, and therefore align themselves with the will of the mighty Kitava. Beware, my followers, of the satisfied man, for he is the very pattern and image of blasphemy.

- The Holy Book of Hunger by High Priest Utula

--Cultist Tract I (POE I)

And our father, the great Kitava, will split asunder the rocks of the earth, pulling himself out of the miry clay. He shall lay a banquet table before us and we shall feast on his divine bounty.

- The Holy Book of Hunger by High Priest Utula

--Cultist Tract II (POE I)

This is how it shall end. Kitava will rise, and a great cloud of black smoke will cover the sky. The glorious smell of cooking flesh shall entice even the most ardent of unbelievers to the faith, and together we will celebrate and eat at Kitava's table.



- The Holy Book of Hunger by High Priest Utula

--Cultist Tract III (POE I)

... Kitava remembers nothing and cares for nothing but his own hunger and greed. He is an endless pit of gnashing teeth and churning guts.

While other gods rise on the mainland and fight for the meagre scraps of what was, Kitava has the most fecund and formidable civilisation of this age at his disposal. He can feed when he likes and he grows ever stronger with each morsel. All of Oriath shall soon belong to Kitava, and if that happens, he will rise beyond even our reach.

--Sin, "Kitava" (POE I)

I'd not believe you if I had not witnessed the boats lurching onto the shores of Wraeclast myself. So... The gods have returned, and Oriath has fallen. ...

--Jun Ortoi, "Oriath" (POE I)

Many of the Blackguard are still alive and scattered across Wraeclast, but the organisation has had its back broken after what happened in Oriath. I wouldn't want to run into a random knot of them, especially as they start to get hungry and desperate...

--Helena, "Oriath" (POE I)

Troubling news coming out of Oriath. I know you weren't just involved, but smack-dab in the middle of things. I also know you aren't to blame. Not directly, anyway.

Still, you might imagine that I feel some... animosity about the whole situation. Not least of all because the presence of Kitava is quite literally a doomsday scenario for my people.

I trust you'll sort it out, 'cause if you don't, we're through. And I don't just mean no more business.

--Whakano, "Kitava" (POE I)

Faustus: What do your people think about what happened in Oriath?

Whakano: Barbers, sir?

Faustus: Karui! Are they dancing round their totems singing the praises of the return of their saviour?

Whakano: Kitava is no saviour. Far from it. Kitava is symbolic of death, of the end of all things.

Faustus: Eh? I thought that was, uh, hinny--something.

Whakano: Hinekora? The Mother of Death is the steward of our souls, but she has no great desire to destroy us. It's a common misunderstanding among your people.

Faustus: Eternals?

Whakano: Captains. I cannot speak for all Karui, but personally, I feel a great sadness for Oriath. Many people lost their lives, their homes, their families. Good people. Bad people too, but even bad people should have the opportunity to reflect on their misdeeds and change. Kitava took that opportunity away.

Faustus: Quite right. Quite right.

--Faustus & Whakano, "Banter A" (POE I)

UTULA'S DEFEAT

You've sent the traitor to meet his Ancestors, have you? That'll be an interesting conversation. I'm no *hatungo*, but I can foresee Utula walking a long road of trial and suffering before he earns himself a place at the Ancestors' table. ...

--Lani, "Utula" (POE I)

When you slew Utula's body, you separated his spirit from his altered flesh. This freed him to join us as a purified soul in these Halls of the Dead. We are very grateful to you for this, as he is a true hero in our eyes. He brought Karui vengeance against the Templars, and helmed a rebellion that freed our people held in bondage in Oriath. He has earned a place here in competition with the greatest of our warriors.

--Navali, "Utula" (POE I)

Imagine my surprise when you killed me and I found myself in this dank and dour dungeon. I didn't even know about this place. I grew up in the slave pens, and my knowledge of my own culture was fragmented at best. When the blood spilled out of me and my heart stilled, I thought I was finally free. No. I still exist, because Hinekora scooped up my soul, and they even 'honoured' me with a position here. You know what I'll be doing? Fighting. Bleeding. Dying. *Forever*. I died! I'm dead! But I'm still imprisoned! This is a load of horse dung the size of Wraeclast! This place will burn!

--Utula, "The Halls of the Dead" (POE I)

You know what's strange? I always thought Rakiata was a man. I suppose I don't know much about my own people, beyond the remnants of knowledge the slaves passed on in Oriath's pens. Coming here, I'm furious at how much of my own history was denied me. I'm basically locked in a permanent family reunion with relatives I've never met.

--Utula, "Rakiata" (POE I)

The Father of Hunger may be dead, but his essence lives on in his people. I challenge my fellow Karui. How dare we accept this fate? How dare we accept these Halls of the Dead? We should be free, to roam the world, or enter oblivion if we wish! Kitava once promised to devour all the souls in this domain, and it seems I must fulfill that promise!

--Utula, "Kitava's Defeat" (POE I)

The Way means nothing to me. Where were my fellow Karui tribes when we prisoners were rotting in slave pens since the time of Lioneeye? I guess nobody was very interested in rescuing us. What does all that strength matter if it only benefits the strong? I was born into slavery. I never had a choice. I refuse to continue being a prisoner in my own afterlife!

--Utula, "The Karui Way" (POE I)

Now Utula has been accepted here, and his fiery words make me wary. I believe in the traditional and unchanging Way, but Utula wants to tear it all down. I fear he is seeking to fulfill Kitava's vow. We must show him how wrong he is.

--Akoya, "Utula" (POE I)

He's an odd tuatara, that one. Seems to think this incredible place is some sort of prison. I for one relish being in my prime again. Maybe he's just angry he's got those crazy bug eyes.

--Kiloava, "Utula" (POE I)

Utula believes in everything I have fought against my entire life... and my entire death. His is an ethos of violence, depravity, and anarchy. I believe the Karui deserve order, harmony, and peace. You can't live in a beautiful forest if you burn it down. I understand why Utula was given a place here, but I still think it is a step in the wrong direction.

--Maata, "Utula" (POE I)

Utula has the right idea. Why should we Karui listen to anyone who tells us what to do and how to live? We have such strength, yet we remain subservient. If I want to leave the Halls of the Dead and go to the Chambers of the Dishonoured, where they drink and carouse for eternity, why shouldn't I? Down with tyranny!

--Kahuturoa, "Utula" (POE I)

... For now, we are not undertaking the Trials. Too many are... refusing.

One among us has elevated their angry voice above the others. Utula, of the Kitava Tribe, has long found the afterlife... constricting. He has convinced several others to become unruly. They are refusing to fight, and causing great disturbances. ...

Utula has convinced them they could overthrow this place, or even escape. We have done the best we can for the souls here, but it is not enough for some. This often happens with souls new to this timeless existence. It will pass... as it always does.

--Navali, on refusing trials (POE II)

TANGMAZU, THE TRICKSTER

Farewell Innocence, and hello, my agent of anarchy. It appears I've returned just in time for the party...

--Tangmazu, The Torched Courts (Act 5) (POE I)

For untold generations, he slept soundly in that prison.

But the Deceiver woke from his slumber...and has been causing more and more problems ever since.

The fog... crashing ships... foul dreams... cursed voices...

--Tavakai, on Tekaru (POE II)

THE COAST [ACT 6]

TUKOHAMA, FATHER OF WAR

"Tukohama may be asleep, but he still gives us his strength. A small needle, an offering, and a vial... drink deeply, my son, and you will more than survive the coming battle... you will thrive."

--Blood of the Warrior Gargantuan Life Flask (POE II)

With Kitava now stomping around Oriath, it seems mythology is fast turning into reality.

Then again, the gods didn't just spring out of some poet's head. I certainly couldn't pen an ode to the God of Eternally Flowing Ale and then just stick me mug out to catch the free brew.

No, I imagine the gods once dined, danced and defecated just like you or I. Now they seem ready to take another stab at it... at life, I mean.

Take the Karui Father of War, for instance. Old Tukohama. All comfily tucked up in Kaom's holdfast and playing war like a few thousand years was only a quiet weekend for him.



Come to think of it...perhaps it was!

--Bestel, "Tukohama" (POE I)

The God of War has reshaped this region. He's always been... unimaginative.

--Tangmazu, The Mud Flats (Act 6) (POE I)

Seems Tukohama's raised up a host out of whatever afterlife the Karui believe in. I feel for those poor bastards, if I'm to be honest. The Karui haven't had an easy history. Colonised, enslaved, used as pawns in many a war, and now abused in death by their own bloody god.

This is why I don't follow any deity. They're all as bad as each other.

--Tarkleigh, "Karui Revenants" (non-Marauder version) (POE I)

[Note: The following lore item was written for 3.0, but has never been available in-game.]

By command of fallen blood, leave your habitat and fill the cup of Tukohama. Cleave the heads of our enemies from shoulders unworthy, and adorn the belt of Tukohama.

And to the Lord of War, I kneel, with boldness at your feet and demand to be drowned in your Valour. Let me look upon my foes without fear, drive me to kill without hesitation, and sear that sinful voice of conscience so I will not feel remorse. For this is war and you, my lord, are its father.

--Karui Carving (POE I)

TUKOHAMA'S DEFEAT

Listen, I don't want to be a nay-sayer, but before you started coming around here, we didn't have none of this god nonsense. They were just characters in stories. Ways to get the kiddos to eat their greens. And that was fine! In fact, I preferred it that way!

Now? We've got characters coming to life! And then you're killing 'em! You're killing our heroes! Tukohama was one of the good guys! You better finish what you started.

--Whakano, "Tukohama" (POE I)

You have wounded us, outsider. Though he has slept for thousands of years, Tukohama plays a very real role in our cultural and spiritual lives. He helped create the Way, and he set the Ngakuramakoi on the proper path. With the defeat of our god, my tribe will suffer a mark of shame and a spiritual restlessness that I cannot overstate. I understand why you did what you did, and I will try to remain fair to you, but I am not certain I can ever forgive what you've done.

--Akoya, "Tukohama" (post-defeat) (POE I)

You defeated Tukohama in battle? No, you defeated a shadow of the Father of War. He was weakened by his long sleep, or by the pervasive Corruption of Wraeclast. You struck when he was feeble and confused. Keep your ego small. ...

--Kaom, "Tukohama's Defeat" (POE I)

How is it that a mortal defeated our Father of War in his domain? No, it was not solely you. Your alliance with the Thief of Virtue is a ghastly one. However, your prowess in combat cannot be denied. You have earned our respect, not our ire, for this victory. Such is our Way.

--Navali, "Tukohama's Defeat" (POE I)

Though I know little of my natural heritage, I know enough to understand the implications of your victory against the Karui God of War. Did his long slumber weaken him, or have the gods been greatly exaggerated through the evolution of myths? In either case, this undoubtedly means we will find no divine help against the intrinsic darkness. They are not the keepers of mankind many believed them to be.

--Tane Octavius, "Tukohama" (POE I)

ABBERATH, THE CLOVEN ONE

There's many a way to die in Wraeclast. Most of them are mercifully quick. But you get caught alive by the goatmen, you'll wish by any god you believe in that you hadn't.

I've heard some of the more superstitious exiles say there's a deity these goatmen worship. Abberath, Eater of Agony. Sounds like a right bastard, if you ask me. So if the goatmen hand you an invitation to go have dinner with the Cloven God, tell them where to stick it.

--Tarkleigh, "Goatmen" (POE I)

... Abberath, a deranged old goat with a thirst for human souls whose cloven hooves now stand astride the old prisoners road. ...

--Sin, "The Cloven One" (POE I)

RYSLATHA, THE PUPPET MISTRESS

With the road to the Phrecian Forest clear again, I trekked through to the forests beyond, to see if the strangeness we're seeing on the coast is also happening inland. What I saw nearly froze my heart solid.

The animals there, poor wretches... overtaken by some sort of parasite. As close as I can reckon they're like termites, burrowing into flesh and mind instead of wood. If I'm right, there'll be a nest somewhere, and a queen. ...

--Tarkleigh, "The Puppet Mistress" (POE I)

... A primitive deity from a primitive time, crawling up out of the dirt with a view to enslaving us all with its creepy bloody offspring. ...

--Tarkleigh, "The Puppet Mistress" (POE I)



[Note: The following lore item was written for 3.0, but has never been available in-game.]

Mother Matriarch, Ryslatha, white worm that corrupts the earth, long may I rest in the sweetness of your breast, and suckle deep from the teat of your nurturing juices.

O' Mighty mother, for yours is an unstoppable fecundity, it is power and fertility. I would straddle the walls of your fruitful womb and watch as our children disciple this decaying world. That I should lie sleeping amongst the folds of your flesh, replete, as the loving consort of your queendom come.

--Worn Carving (POE I)

TSOAGOTH, THE BRINE KING

O' Lord of Salt and Scale, your servants attend to thee.
Praise thee Tsoagoth!
Without life yet living, the Brine King sleeps.
We send our prayers to thee, so that you might eternally slumber.
O' great one, we offer up this human soul as slave for you in your drowned city.
Take this life and bid the seas be calm and plentiful.
Woe to the Sailor who does not offer tribute to thee!
Such a man is cast off from our ocean kingdom!
He shall be made pariah, with neither captain nor commission.
Judge us not by unworthy sails,
Look to us as your servants.
Your kin of salt and scale.
O' praise thee Tsoagoth, praise thee!

--Shrine to the Brine King (POE I)

Yeah, I know the Brine King. What pirate doesn't? Drowned me fair share of mutineers under the full moon... to keep the old king's slumber when storms threaten, you see.

If he's been roused from the depths, it be nothing but ill tidings for those of us with air in our lungs.

He'll be getting back to raping and eating us ocean-going folk soon enough. Stealing wombs in which to spawn his slithering offspring. ...

--Lilly Roth, "The Brine King" (POE I)

Lord of Salt and Scale's what we used to call him. They say when the gods got the boot from our lands, that monstrosity went to sleep down in the deep. Dreamed the kinda dreams that cause all sorts of gilled abominations to rise up, to plague and hunt us for what he thinks we must've done to him.

Was a time we got ordered to hunt them things near extinction. Free the trade routes from Old Briny's tyranny. Even so, not a sailor worth his salt who won't sacrifice a lousy deckhand or two by light of the full moon, just to keep that overgrown crab slumbering in the Oriathan trench.

If he's risen again, you bet your bloody arse we're all buggered.

--Weylam Roth, "The Brine King" (POE I)

Salt on the wind... The river sours. The King has returned.

--Tangmazu, The Southern Forest (Act 6) (POE I)

My motley crew, neither fit to lick my boots nor curl my moustache, have bloody well betrayed me. And I was only trying to save them, those that remained true. Even now, floating prostrate upon a plank of wood, bathed in the dying embers of the evening sun, I hear the clitter-clatter of a million tiny claws. If I close my eyes, I see those tentacles reaching up to me out of the deep.

I don't know why the Brine King chose me. For weeks I've heard the voices, whispering of his return, gurgling of doom and slavery to us all. I tried to warn the simple men of my ship, made examples of those more violent disbelievers. Yet my prophecies only served to drive the rest into obstinate ignorance. They cast me overboard, perhaps in the vain hope that in my death, none of my utterances would come true.

Alas, as the morning sun peeked over the horizon, a pillar of green light rose up from the waves, vindicating my darkest fears. The old god ascended from the depths and laid waste to my ship and all aboard her. Now, without food nor water, I shan't last the night. My bones shall be plucked clean by the pincered multitude that haunts me even now.



May this message find land, and by the unholy revelation that Tsoagoth has risen, may my reputation be restored.

- Captain Caruso of the Lady in Waiting

--Leatherbound Logbook (POE I)

If God wills it, the final account of First Mate Piken, castaway on the rock somewhere off the Twilight Strand.

Near as I can tell, the rest of the crew, along with Captain Caruso, be dead... or worse. What happened? I'd not have believed it myself had I not seen it with me own two eyes.

At dawn, a light, green and dark, rose from 'neath the waves and into the sky. While most of us stood back in awe, I heard a cry rise up from the lower deck. Casting me eyes in that direction, I saw the waves upchuck, and a swarm of ocean crabs cover the vessel. Ravenous and of countless numbers they were, making quick work of the sailors about them. Nothing but bones and tatters of cloth!

We fled to the longboats as fast we could, hoping to leave them ungodly crustaceans behind us, but lo, from within that green pillar of light, I saw him! The Brine King, like a bloated whale he breached the familiar waters and turned the ship beneath our feet to match-wood. I was flung into the sea, yet managed to cling to some flotsam and make my way to rest on this damnable rock.

Seems that ancient Tsoagoth has a mind to take dominion of these seas once more. Captain Caruso was right to drown those mutineers in the old king's name. A shame we'd not found more. For now, beneath the waves, I hear the whispers of me own passing in a thousand clicking pincers. May God have mercy on me, and may someone benefit from this warning.

--Message in a Bottle (POE I)

...I beg of you, Mercutio, if you have any care for the friendship we once had, grant me this one favour. It is true I have my own boat, but that is for hauling in fish! It is not fit to travel the waters I

must navigate. My wife needs me, my friend. I know it reeks of madness, but Abi has been taken, kidnapped by the King of Brine himself. I fear too that he intends to make her one of his fishwives, just as the old stories warned us!

Please, Mercutio, I've heard tell of your success as a merchant in recent years. Surely you can spare one ship? Let me voyage out and rescue her, or at least, bring her body back to rest on dry land. Help me silence the insanity in my own mind.

Every night, I dream of pale, slime-slick creatures that pursue my boat through the thick, dark waters. I try not to look at them, but I also do. And they look back, their eyes wide with sadness and longing. They are not eyes born of the sea, Mercutio. God help me... they are Abi's eyes.

- Benric of Gulton

--Letter Fragment (POE I)

General Marcovius,
Commander of the Templar Fleet
Operation Ocean Blades

An urgent Report on:
The Massacre of Pondium Strait.

"We were sent here to crush the Brinerot pirates, but something far more troubling has occupied our attentions. Of the surviving men, a few of the older, more superstitious types call it the Brine King. Apparently some false deity of the sea we've long since scoured from our holy scriptures.

Whatever the damned thing is, it's big. I've seen it myself, though as little more than a vast shadow far below us, veritably dwarfing the hulls of our fleet.

Most of our ships are gone, dragged beneath the waves by this malevolent leviathan. We could do little but watch in horror as the waters about us blossomed red. We are nearing the Beacon, what's left of us, and the wind blows strongly towards home.

High Templar Avarius, please understand that I am not a man cut from the coward's cloth, but this situation... this game of cat and mouse has gone on too long. There is nothing to be gained in continuing on to Pondium. We shall turn our sails and catch the trade wind back to Oriath. I only pray we can outrun this thalassic fiend.

May Innocence guide and protect us. [sic]

General Marcovius

--Templar Report (POE I)



TSOAGOTH'S DEFEAT

...with the Brine King gone, you've done a fine thing for us seafarers. The waters won't no longer pander to the whim of an overgrown bloody crustacean, and damn me if I don't feel a stirring in me loins. It's the ocean, calling... like a lust-starved lover. ...

--Lilly, "The Brine King" (POE I)

How did you...? You still breathing? Bloody barnacles on me arse! You, my new friend, are a legend of the high seas to behold! Tell you what, I've already done my bit getting you here, but if you're looking to sail on to Phrecia, me and the Black Crest would be honoured to take you.

--Weylam Roth, "The Brine King" (POE I)

PHRECIA [ACT 7]

RALAKESH, MASTER OF A MILLION FACES

Ralakesh... My brother has been busy, hasn't he...

--Tangmazu, The Ashen Fields (POE I)

High Lord Ralakesh, I am but lowly outlaw scum, yet you, a god of a thousand faces, have looked at me and deemed me worthy of your cause!

I've offered willingly my flesh and blood. You shall now have my thoughts to use as you see fit. I only ask that you let me serve forever as one of your Holy Claws. Allow me to bring the light of your belonging to this whole bloody continent. My greatest desire is to see your ancient kingdom remade and your enemies cower at your feet.

--Ode to Ralakesh (POE I)

GRUTHKUL, MOTHER OF DESPAIR, THE PORCELAIN QUEEN

... Gruthkul's pain has transcended ages and she will vent that pain upon any and all she encounters until her grief is finally laid to rest.

--Eramir, "Gruthkul" (POE I)

My mother called you the Porcelain Queen. I never thought you were real!

--Ranger, on Gruthkul's death (POE I)

You alone, I forgive, Gruthkul. You're like Sin. You never wanted this, and it cost you everything.

--Scion, on Gruthkul's death (POE I)

ARAKAALI, SPINNER OF SHADOWS

... Now she has returned, but it is not vengeance she wants. She is no mindless Gruthkul. Arakaali, Goddess of Love, wishes only to embrace the world as she wishes she had been embraced.

The Widow

--Shrine to Arakaali V (POE I)

... Arakaali will suck all life from this land, leave only empty husks and dusty bones. There will be no Spirit, no us, no thing left to love and laugh.

Only husks and dust... and Arakaali.

--Yeena, "Arakaali" (POE I)



Your soft whispers beneath earth tingle my skin, like breath of lover against my loins. I sleep not. I hear your name inside my skull. Arakaali. No name tasted so sweet on my tongue.

Stories I have heard, tales of cursed beauty. Visage of woman, jewel that walks the streets in final days of a great empire. Heard tell you sought victims, but I know truth. You sought man to love you, to break spell. You hoped true love might allow you to shed eight-leg body, to become goddess of love once more.

I pledge myself to you, my lady of Vaal. I promise love, for I am that man you have waited on. Corrupt corpse-lovers claim to worship you, call you Spinner of Shadows, but you have spun only shadows of desire about my heart.

Sweet Arakaali, I have found your altar. I will speak the call. I will return you to beauty. I will raise you from black pits of despair and together we shall rule Wraecclast in glory... forever.

--Love Letter (POE I)

She's part machine... which means she can be dismantled!

--Scion, on Arakaali (POE I)

SARN [ACT 8]

YUGUL, REFLECTION OF TERROR

In Izaro's grotesque little garden, you'll find an old friend of mine.

The yawning maw that is Yugul... but a self-portrait of what that pathetic creature has come to believe about the nature of fear. Those who look upon him see their own fears reflected in his horrifying visage.

--Sin, "Reflection of Terror" (POE I)

SOLARIS, ETERNAL SUN & LUNARIS, ETERNAL MOON

... Lunar is, Eternal goddess of the Moon and her sister, Solaris of the Sun, have risen to reclaim what was once their own. Siblings equal in strength, mighty twin rivers converging, sweeping all before them.

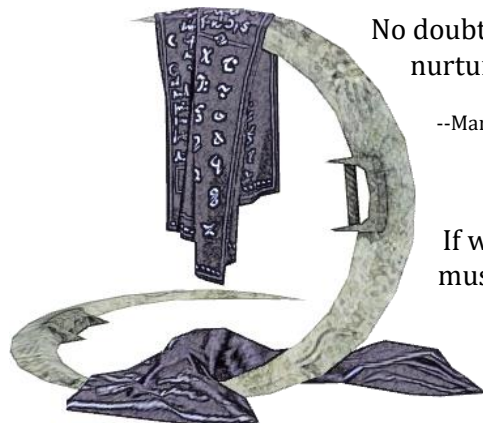
We are cornered animals, awaiting the deluge that will surely drown us. Yet there exists a pair of ancient treasures, the Sun Orb and the Moon Orb. They are our hope... our desperation.

--Maramoa, "Solaris and Lunar is" (POE I)

These owl eyes of mine have been watching the sun goddess from afar. The Sun Orb lies within her temple, guarded by her most ardent devotee. An exile who, in his insanity, has taken to calling himself 'The Dawn'. ...

--Maramoa, "The Sun Orb" (POE I)

I've been keeping a close eye on that exile-turned-sycophant who calls himself, 'The Dusk'. Dusk carried the Moon Orb into the Lunar is and has not returned with it, not as far as I have seen.



No doubt he clings to that orb like it's his adopted mother's own nurturing breast. ...

--Maramoa, "The Moon Orb" (POE I)

If we are to see the dawn of a new era for humankind, the sun must be taught to behave herself.

Upon that mighty span between Sarn's left hand and its right, Solaris burns to consume every single moment of



existence. Sparing no thought for life and its needs, she would see the world parched barren before she yields to reason.

The sun must be allowed to set so that it may rise again as a blessing, not a curse.

--Sin, "The Eternal Sun" (POE I)

... Lunariss, in her cold fury, has forgotten that the warming sun of morning is as life-giving as the cooling damp of evening.

The empire Lunariss dreams of shall be lit by moon and twinkling stars, and life itself shall wither away in the perpetual night.

--Sin, "The Eternal Moon" (POE I)

VASTIRI [ACT 9]

GARUKHAN, QUEEN OF THE WIND

Garukhan wished once more for the skies. If she were to die, she wanted it to be up there in the clouds. This world had never been her home. She required greater things. She required adventure.

But die she would, here in the dirt...

--Captured Soul of Stalker of the Endless Dunes (POE I)

GARUKHAN'S DEFEAT

As a child, my mother told me stories of the old gods, that they were to be feared and venerated, that they embodied the everlasting spirit of the Maraketh people. But this false queen, Garukhan, she was nothing but a goddess of lies.

By accepting Kira's slaughter of Oyun as a sacrifice of worth, the goddess has played her part in forsaking our most sacred tenet. Honour the Mother, Honour the Life. The bones of our tribe-mother, have been ground into the dust by this divine insanity.

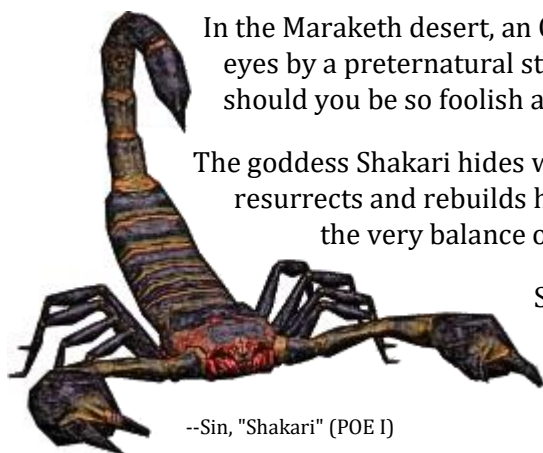
If the old gods can't follow the very traditions they themselves set forth, then how can we? Perhaps the time has come to forge our customs anew, in our image, not those of false and selfish gods.

--Irasha, "Garukhan" (POE I)

SHAKARI, QUEEN OF THE SANDS

...now Shakari, the mother of all black bugs rises from the sands! ...

--Irasha, "Shakari" (POE I)



In the Maraketh desert, an Oasis lies to the east, its waters shielded from prying eyes by a preternatural storm. The sand will rip the very flesh from your bones, should you be so foolish as to enter into its dark shroud. Yet, enter you must.

The goddess Shakari hides within that golden blizzard, festering with revenge as she resurrects and rebuilds her ancient army - an army that once threatened to shake the very balance of these lands.

Should she be allowed to revitalise her troops, the whole of Maraketh will finally fall under the cruelty of her selfish reign. ...

--Sin, "Shakari" (POE I)

SHAKARI'S DEFEAT

So it's true. Shakari [sic] thought, as she took her final breath. "My father, Sin, wishes me dead. And he has sent his rabid dog to do it..."

--Captured Soul of Terror of the Infinite Drifts (POE I)

You killed Shakari? My sister's death has finally been avenged. Shakari was supposed to be our divine teacher, said to guide us into womanhood. All she ever gave was death.

I suppose it's fitting that the teacher has learned that mortal lesson for herself. Our whole lives, we have lived for the blessings of our goddesses, yet here they are, in the flesh, proving to us that they are only monsters. ...

--Irasha, "Shakari" (POE I)

You want the truth? I betrayed her, and had her killed.

There are not enough excuses in all of Wraeclest to make up for what I did. I thought it was the right thing to do at the time. I thought it was the only way to save humanity.

... I am beginning to suspect that the cycle of history may never end, unless we surpass ourselves and find another way.

But until we do, we will solve this the only way we know how: with violence.

--The Hooded One, "Daughter" (POE II)

HALANI, GODDESS OF WATER

In her divine slumber, Halani dreamt a thousand happy lifetimes with her son. Her nightmare only began once she awoke.

--Buried Shrines map pin (completed) (POE II)

A mortal? Oh... At last.

Please... end my suffering.

My followers are long since dust, and I am but parchment, my veins dry as sand.

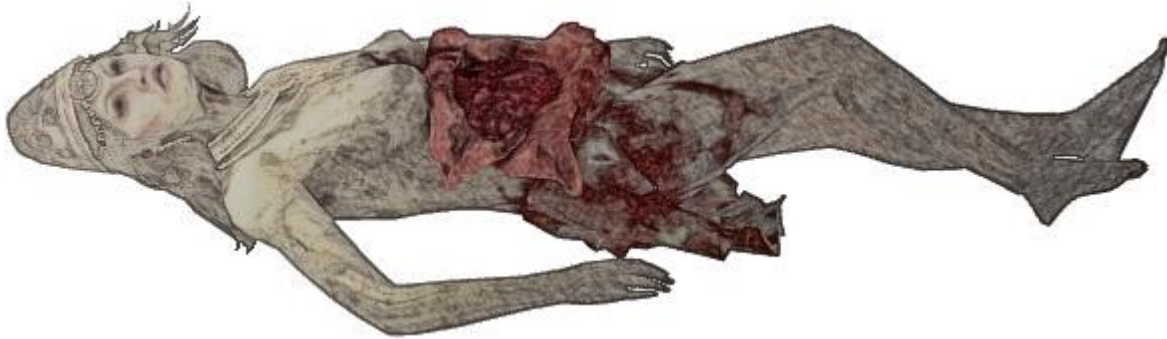
--The Water Goddess, "Introduction" (POE II)

None remember my name, and none think of me.

I awoke from my long slumber unable to move... my time has passed...

I ask you, mortal, to use that one element that may finally end me. My opposite... fire. It must be done.

--The Water Goddess, "Plea" (POE II)



ELSEWHERE

Like many others, the Karui gods have awakened, but aside from Tukohama and Kitava, we have heard nothing of their activities. They walk Wraeclast like in times of old, so—where are they? Our descendants come to us and ask us when the gods will return home. For this, we have no answer. Even Hinekora seems unwilling to speak on what she sees.

--Akoya, "The Return of the Gods" (POE I)

NGAMAHU, MOTHER OF FIRE

For centuries, they stood vigil in secret over their sleeping goddess, even as contamination oozed out of the decadent Vaal empire.

--From Bone to Ashes (POE I)

For countless generations, a small number of my tribe secretly watched over Ngamahu as she slept. She must have awoken by now, but I have heard nothing of her whereabouts or intent. It is frustrating having to remain here in the Halls of the Dead while the Mother of Fire walks the world in the flesh. I would very much like to meet her. Before I was of age, my father's father allowed me to look upon her sleeping face. It was only then that I understood that there are types of fire unknown to a mere boy.

--Kaom, "Ngamahu" (POE I)

SIONE, MOTHER OF THE SUN & LANI HUA, MOTHER OF THE MOON

Many believe that the Mother of the Moon has been off fighting a war against the Mother of the Sun for thousands of years. While Lani Hua is indeed absent, it is not to fight against her sister. The wounded souls from that war are sent to the silver palace, where Arohongui tends to them until they may rejoin the fight. Those warrior souls cry out in fear and torment as they lay in hospice. They speak not of war with Sione, but of a war with the stars themselves. They have been sworn to silence by both Sione and Lani Hua, but the feverish ones cannot help but rant. Apparently, the two sisters did go out into the night sky to wage war upon one another, but when they got there, they encountered something horrible, something that drives even the strongest warrior to madness and panic. We have not been abandoned by our two strongest gods. They are out there protecting us every single minute of every single day, and they cannot rest for even a moment.

That's what the tales say, in any case. I don't know how much of that I actually believe.

--Ikiaho, "Lani Hua" (POE I)

HINEKORA, MOTHER OF DEATH

When you slew the Beast, you ended the Slumber of the Gods. Hinekora is finally awake, and the Halls of the Dead clamour with the joyous songs of our people. You cannot possibly understand the import of this change. The greater sum of our people, countless generations of Karui warriors, have never known their goddess. I myself have only ever spoken to her in her dreams. To hear her voice is to know that every sacrifice I made for my people was justified. This is the gift that you have given us... that you have given me.

--Navali, "The Awakening of the Gods" (POE I)

Thousands of years ago, Hinekora foresaw the coming time of emptiness, the Slumber of the Gods, and built her domain to function while she lay dreaming. Had she not done this, any Karui who died during that emptiness would have been lost forever. Her foresight guarded our people for generations.

--Navali, "The Slumber of the Gods" (POE I)



The Mother of Death has pledged herself to a higher Impulse. She seeks to perpetuate Order, by ensuring her foreseen prophecies come to pass. There are only twelve futures in which Wraecclast survives the coming darkness. All twelve involve the arrival of someone like yourself to this place. She foretold it, and you have found your way to us. That is a good sign that we are on one of the right paths... for now.

--Navali, "Order" (POE I)

Hinekora shall always be honoured as the Mother of Death and the creator of this place, but she rarely speaks. I believe she is lost in her visions. It is unclear how much Navali communicates with her, and how much the *hatungo* is saying on her own...

--Kaom, "Hinekora" (POE I)

Hinekora is our jailer. I imagine she had good intentions when she made this place. Preserve the souls of the Karui so that they may guide their descendants, sure. Sounds lovely. Then, she went to sleep for thousands of years. All the souls of my people have been collecting here unattended ever since. That seems like a massive blunder. I don't care that she's awake now. She's hardly present. There's no way she's the same as she was, not after a sleep like that. We're stuck in a prison without a warden, and there is *no way out*.

--Utula, "Hinekora" (POE I)

Where am I? This cannot be real... but it is. Wraecclast... I long believed this life a dream, but it seems what I just escaped was the true illusion. My family... my boys... my daughter... they weren't real? Oh, the Halls of the Dead. In this life, I could never... ah... so I gathered up the lost souls of my people, and cherished them as my own. I have so much to tell them, but the dream calls me back! I must... not go...

--Hinekora, 1 (POE I)

...back again... reality and dream mix together like waves in a tide pool. They called me Mother, but I was forced to abandon them... I remember now, the Imbalance... I foresaw all of this, and the plan is still in motion. We teeter on the edge of oblivion, flailing, waiting to be saved or doomed by the slightest push. The future-past calls to me... I must gaze into the abyss. Heed my words. My children, I will return to you... when the time is right...

--Hinekora, 2 (POE I)

Waking is such exquisite pain... memory and prophecy are one and the same. I have so much to tell you, but I cannot remember when we are. You're not even you yet. You come to these Halls of the Dead decades early, wearing a different face, but I'm asleep. You're here now, as I awaken... and

you're here decades from now, someone else all over again... all these things are true. Time is a hall of mirrors. I... see...

--Hinekora, 3 (POE I)

... it is a gift for you, my daughter... oh. That was just a dream... what does it mean for something to be real? If you loved, and were loved, would it matter if your world was an illusion? He knew the truth. Dominus must catch you. The Arkhon's plan to rescue his daughter will fail, but you must try anyway. They must all be present at the fulcrum of destiny, if Wraeclast... is to...

--Hinekora, 4 (POE I)

... back again... I must fight for every moment of lucidity. Time is shorter than you know. Cataclysms await down most paths, and those paths then turn on and *eat* each other. These things *must happen*. You must make them happen. It begins with the fulcrum of destiny, the moment on which all of existence is balanced. The King of Dreams must be allowed to escape, and though there can be only one, *two* High Templars must witness... this...

--Hinekora, 5 (POE I)

... for once, Chaos is not the enemy... imagine that... they see you for what you truly are, like I do... seek his servant... before that, or after that, I cannot tell... the Maraketh will test you. You will undergo three challenges, and we will be the third... you must prove yourself, or else you... won't...

--Hinekora, 6 (POE I)

... listen, quickly... the messenger from the stars was once a man, but before that, he was a father. A sliver of his heart still remains, somewhere deep inside... he knows something vital, but he doesn't know that he knows... I cannot see it, for I was... never a Mother... Doryani is missing...

--Hinekora, 7 (POE I)

... the Thief... I will suggest he seek counsel in the one place I can never see... upon his return, he will create the Beast... then I am sorry, my children, but I must sleep for time beyond time. The plan is in place. Make no traffic with the Vaal. The horrors of Queen Atziri must happen. On this, we agree, even with our mortal enemy...

--Hinekora, 8 (POE I)

...the Vaal Empire will fall. Doryani... where is Doryani? Malachai must construct his Grand Design, a crucible in which you will be forged, and thus he will be the architect of his own doom. You must... slay the Beast... when the time is right...

--Hinekora, 9 (POE I)

... the King of the Godless must not be allowed to find what he seeks... the Masked One must save his family before crimson touches the mountain peak... the Forger must fail in her reckless mission... just one of these three does not mean the end, but two will spell certain doom...

--Hinekora, 10 (POE I)

...corruption clouds my sight once more... faithful heroes are trying to save humanity... but they don't understand... you gathered the peoples of Wraecclast, and stood united... but you failed...

--Hinekora, 11 (POE I)

...she will know you by three different faces, as will you, her. You must find her. In her mind... lies... the key...

--Hinekora, 12 (POE I)

... how... are... you... here?...

--Hinekora, 13 (POE I)

... so... that's... how it ends... this time...

--Hinekora, 14 (POE I)

THE SILENCE OF THE GODS [ACT 10]

KITAVA'S DEFEAT

Kitava

"A primal deity of Hunger. Defeated by a most unlikely alliance between the Lord of Light, the Shadowed One, and the mortal Godslayer on the First of Verusi, 1600 IC."

--Statue of Kitava (POE I)

Well, at least you followed through eh? I'd have preferred if my gods stayed tucked away neatly in their tales, but if we're going to have the Ravenous One up and about, at least we have you to put him back to bed for good.

--Whakano, "Kitava" (POE I)

I did hear that you 'defeated' Kitava. You should be aware that he was nothing more than a hungry blind child, propped up and fed by Utula's tribe. How exactly did you fear he would consume the whole world when he could hardly move from his cathedral cradle? Your great victory, 'Godslayer,' is nothing to brag about. We have not needed our gods to be personally present for thousands of years, and we will not be

diminished by their loss. We have our own strength.

--Kaom, "Kitava's Defeat" (POE I)

We did not despise Kitava. He was a blind child, cursed with endless hunger, and he knew no better. Hinekora foresaw his fall, and we mourned his passing long ago. Hinekora made no move to prevent these events, for they had to happen so that the future could be guided down a certain path. As she spoke while in a painful trance, for Wraeclast to survive, Kitava's grin must be bared to the bone...

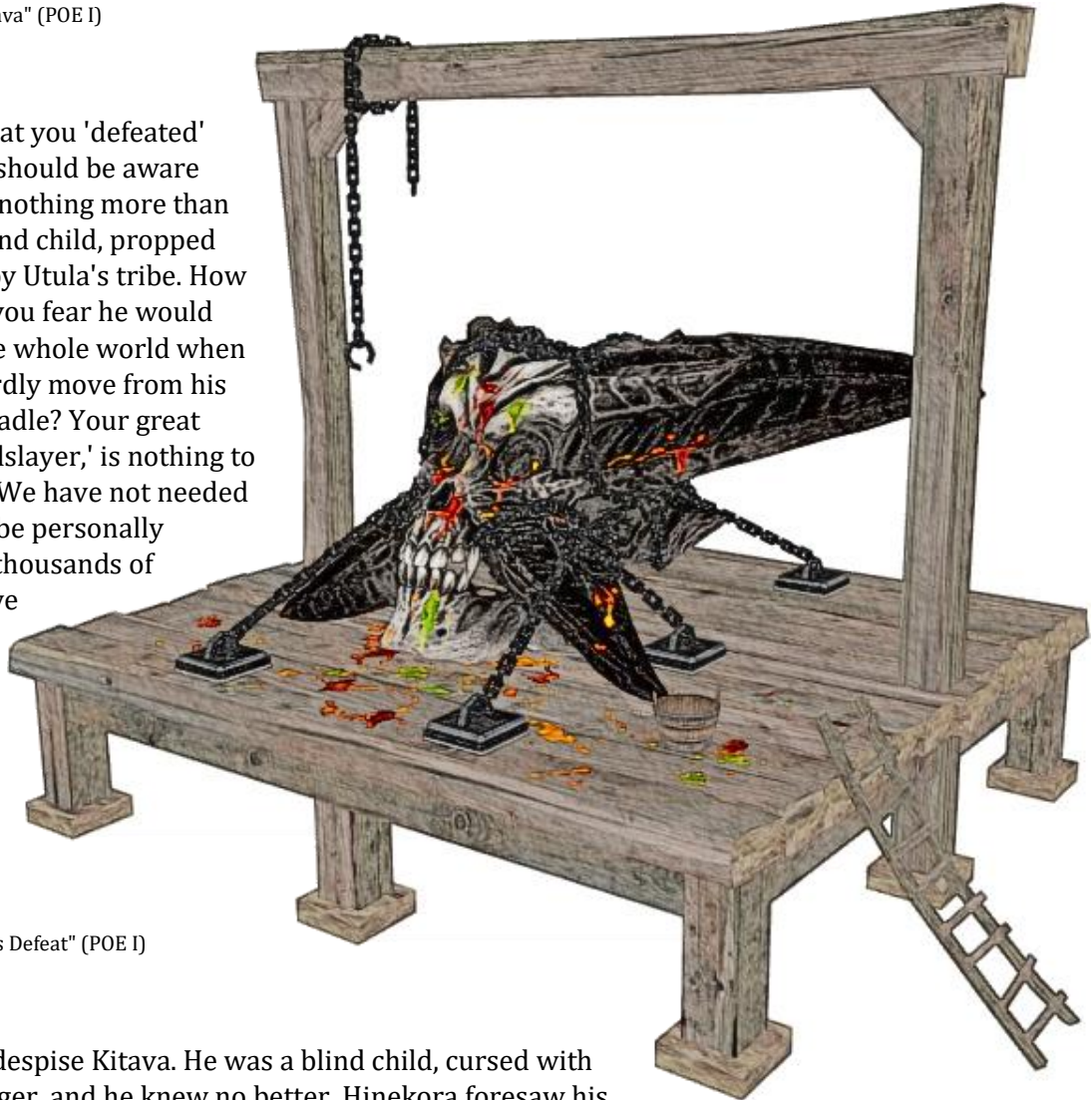
--Navali, "Kitava" (POE I)

A SIGH OF RELIEF, FOR NOW

Aside from my own presence, I no longer feel the vibrations of other gods. Though there may yet be more out there, for now, Wraeclast can breathe a sigh of relief. ...

--Sin, "The Gods" (POE I)

...the Karui... They're different after the death of their gods... and we are, too, after the departure of ours. I wasn't a believer, but I can feel it. We're on our own now.



We're going to have to work together to face what comes next...

--Kirac, "Oriath" (POE I)

ATTEMPTS TO REBUILD CIVILISATION

THE IMMORTAL SYNDICATE

DESTRUCTION OF THE ORDER OF THE DJINN

... For hundreds, maybe thousands of years, we remained secret, until Janus Perandus... that... that imbecile... He sold us out. Reaching for the last vestiges of his ancestral glory. Just like his great grandfather Chitus, he may have doomed us all.

--Jun Ortoi, "Order of the Djinn" (POE I)

You have heard of the famed Perandus family, I have no doubt. Wealthy and powerful and responsible for putting Malachai in position to bring Wraeclest to ruin all those centuries ago. Though Emperor Chitus is the most famous of the Perandus family, some remnants of his vile bloodline linger even still.

Janus was one such remnant. He too was orphaned, but with the Perandus coffers dry and the Perandus name worth its weight in gold, no one took him in. No one except my *akhara*.

That he is the only other survivor, and is now a powerful member of the Immortal Syndicate leaves no doubt in my mind that it was he who sold us out.

If there is but one silver lining in all of this, it is that I may get to sink my blades into his flesh over, and over, and over again.

--Jun Ortoi, "Janus Perandus" (POE I)



RISE OF THE SYNDICATE

The ancient code of life and death is broken. A devious plan of necromancy, unrelenting and frighteningly efficient. They call themselves the Immortal Syndicate...

--Jun Ortoi, <https://www.pathofexile.com/betrayal> (trailer) (POE I)

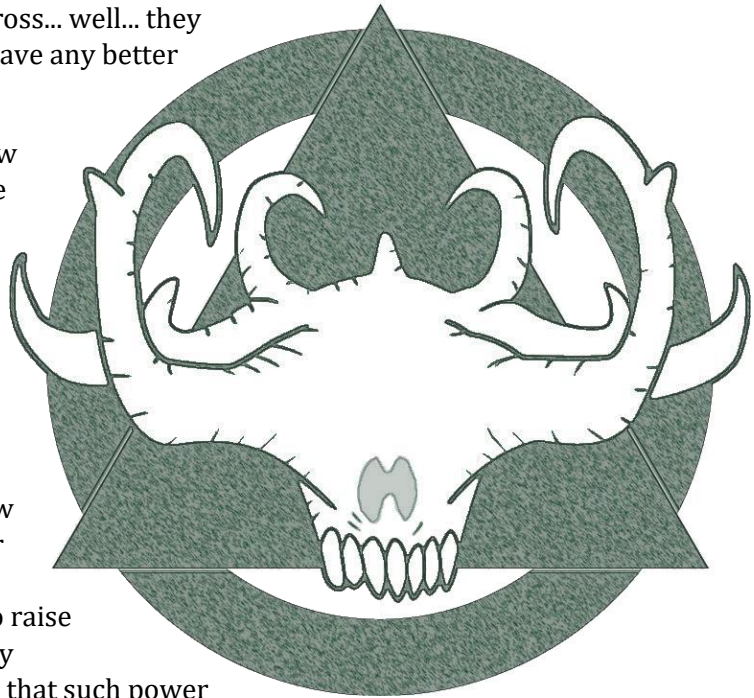
The Syndicate is not just a cluster of like-minded individuals. We have a very wealthy benefactor...

--Vorici, on bargaining for items (POE I)

Some of the members we have come across... well... they have come back from the dead. I don't have any better way of putting it.

They are no mindless zombies. Somehow they are returning... whole. This must be why they call themselves the Immortal Syndicate. Immortality is dangerous, even in the hands of those with good intentions.

--Jun Ortoi, "Syndicate Members" (POE I)



At last, we have a name; Catarina. I know of her. She was a powerful necromancer whose talents were... misdirected. I do not know for certain how she learned to raise the dead back to true life, but... I have my suspicions. And I have reason to believe that such power does not come without a great price.

It is likely she is paying that price in very inhumane ways. ...

--Jun Ortoi, "Catarina" (POE I)

The picture is at last clear. Catarina has obtained the Horns of Kulemak, an artefact capable of shifting the very energies of life freely. She sought power, not just magical, but political power. To be able to grant immortality is a powerful bargaining tool indeed.

Wraecclast is fractured. Many little societies separated by vast tracts of land. But it will not always be so, and Catarina knows this. She is playing the long game. She sees herself as an immortal Queen just biding her time.

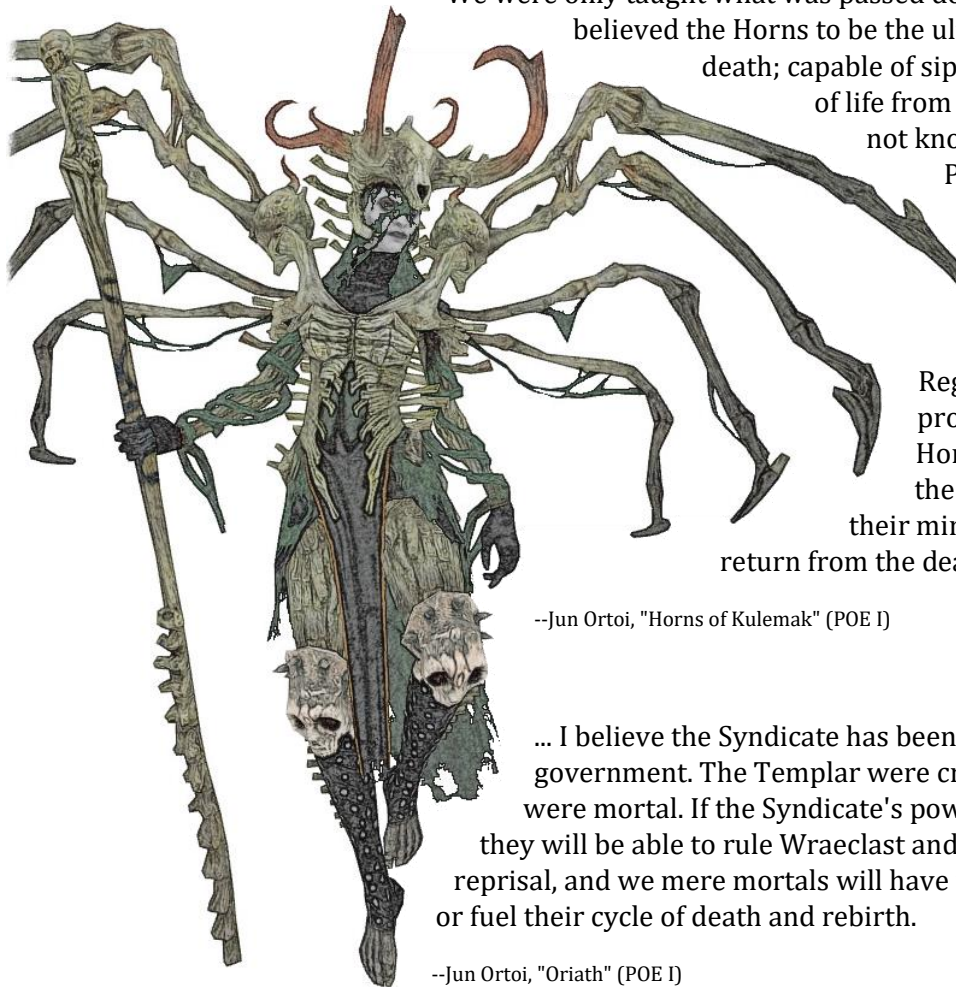
Her subordinates dare not cross her, for she has the power to gift them immortality, but also to take it away.

There is a reason my Order hid the Horns for so long, and we are seeing it play out before our very eyes.

--Jun Ortoi, "The Syndicate Leader" (POE I)

... She is a tyrant in the making, and the longer we let her accumulate power, the harder it will be to depose her.

--Jun Ortoi, "The Syndicate Leader" (POE I)



We were only taught what was passed down for generations. We believed the Horns to be the ultimate tool of life and death; capable of siphoning the very breath of life from any living thing. We do not know where it came from.

Perhaps the remains of a powerful, long-dead animal. Perhaps a creation of the gods themselves.

Regardless of its provenance, I believe the Horns are what have given the Immortal Syndicate their miraculous ability to return from the dead unscathed.

--Jun Ortoi, "Horns of Kulemak" (POE I)

... I believe the Syndicate has been planning to form a new government. The Templar were cruel, but at least they were mortal. If the Syndicate's power continues to grow, they will be able to rule Wraecclast and beyond without fear of reprisal, and we mere mortals will have no choice but to serve, or fuel their cycle of death and rebirth.

--Jun Ortoi, "Oriath" (POE I)

The world is an ancient stone, rigid and immovable, and we are but water, rolling across its surface, leaving an ephemeral trail before we sink beneath its skin. So short are our lives that the stone seemingly remains unchanged.

Given enough time, the rain can shape a stone. Each drop's minute contribution, adding up over time, hews the stone's rough edges. But there is no grand design here. There is no individual guiding the stone into a useful form, only natural forces. Chaos.

But what if that weren't the case? What if there was someone guiding the rain? Someone able to plan far past the fleeting lives that limit us?

What new potential would we unlock?

--Lifegiver's Manifesto 1 (POE I)

What new thing have you learned today? Or this week? How far have you come in your lifetime? If you died today, how much of what you have learned would be lost for all time?

We advance as a society by building upon previous knowledge. Bricks stacked atop bricks. Too often are key advances lost due to an unforeseen death, leaving a gap in the wall. How long until someone climbs high enough once more to continue to build?

We cannot all live forever. Sacrifices must be made. But with sufficient time to build our knowledge, what we fuel with the blood of our brothers and sisters today may come freely tomorrow.

--Lifegiver's Manifesto 2 (POE I)

Each great movement has detractors - the powers that be naturally fight against any threat to their dominance. But steel is not forged in cool air, it is forged in vicious heat.

The heat is coming, brothers and sisters. They will try to destroy us, pit us against each other, and put us in impossible situations, but, throughout, we must stand united.

Though we crawl through the mud, acting in secrecy and silence, we are destined to become Wraeclast's saviours. Each sacrifice we must make is but a twig in the flames of our forge, and the day will come when our blade has been tempered into a mighty weapon and we may slice through the spectre of death once and for all.

--Lifegiver's Manifesto 3 (POE I)

We bury the dead. Insects feed on the flesh and bone... Rot takes hold... An entire lifetime reduced to feed for the grass above. A waste. But the soul, oh, the soul... The soul does not even feed the earth. It drifts invisibly into the ether, never harnessed, never used. Gone.

What greater waste of life is there than to let the soul flutter away into nothingness? We hope and wish for something more, but here and now we have tools that will guarantee no afterlife be necessary. We have the tools to build a utopian life here, in Wraeclast, through thaumaturgy. The only thing we lacked was time, but the gift of the Horns has given us that too.

Brothers and sisters, there's a new empire in the making, and we are its founders. Those that die for our cause will live on within us, and their names will be etched into the foundations of our utopia.

--Lifegiver's Manifesto 4 (POE I)

People need a strong leader. As Oriath bubbles over and spills into Wraeclast, the ragged and the hungry will look to someone to keep them safe from harm. For now, it is merely a matter of survival, but in time, a true society will form, and someone must step in to rule.

A city is not built in a day, nor even a lifetime. Sarn was being cobbled together up to the day it burned. With so many hands involved in its construction, fractures and slips were inevitable. People would fall through the cracks. Factions would form.

Oriath didn't learn from Sarn's mistakes, but they cannot be blamed. The death of a ruler always has and always will throw an empire's direction into the wind.

With an Eternal Queen, this is a problem we will never have to face.

--Lifegiver's Manifesto 5 (POE I)

Enacting a grand vision requires cold-hearted sacrifice. The loyal must be no more than fodder against the unwilling.

--Spinehail Vile Arrow Quiver (POE I)

CATARINA'S DEFEAT

Catarina, Master of Undeath: Death will never come for an immortal.

Jun, Veiled Master: You're no immortal. You're a thief. Nothing more.

--Catarina & Jun, during fight (POE I)

Catarina, Master of Undeath: Stop... I can bring them back. I can bring Jun's entire order back! Just give me-

Jun, Veiled Master: Shut up.

--Catarina & Jun, after fight (POE I)

Then... it is done. Catarina is dead. The Syndicate is fractured. My *akhara* can at last find peace. ...

--Jun, "Catarina" (POE I)

THE FATE OF THE ORDER OF THE DJINN

I knew those of the Djinn well, when I was mortal. Despite that accursed word in their name, *Order*, they did not knowingly answer to a higher Impulse. I found it curious that the vagaries of Fate kept bringing such exceptional individuals together, and for a time, I believed that *I* was exceptional. My hubris was my own undoing, just as it was theirs... several times, in fact. Yet, they always reform. There is always a new gathering. Or hadn't you noticed your increasingly eclectic collection of allies in that increasingly crowded hole you call a hideout? The chaotic Impulse in a Perandus heart recently struck a great blow for us, but here you are, a mere heartbeat later, stitching the threads back together all over again...

--The Trialmaster, "The Order of the Djinn" (POE I)

THE ARIMOR LINE

...Undertaker Arimor, a man collecting the scattered spirits of the Eternal Empire for a mysterious purpose. These spirits have begun to Haunt the monsters of Wraecclast, unleashing their ancient fury and sorrow onto the world.

...the Lantern of Arimor, a powerful family heirloom which can illuminate the wrathful spirits haunting monsters throughout Wraecclast. With it, the Undertaker hopes to...rid Wraecclast of this menace--and further his cryptic cause.

--Path of Exile: Necropolis Content Reveal
(<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QLFeErq1vEI>)

You might call me the last true citizen of the Eternal Empire. Or you can call me Arimor, my actual name...

--Undertaker Arimor, "The Life of an Undertaker" (POE I)

This corpse'll do. Full of anguish, just how we need. ...
When we've got enough, we can perform certain rites at the Necropolis...

--Undertaker Arimor, "Burial Patterns" (POE I)

When we bury our anguished friends, the pattern matters. Exorcisms are all about patterns, you see? Patterns of angst, patterns of pain... patterns of Corruption. ...

--Undertaker Arimor, "Burial Patterns" (POE I)

There's a white *goo* that comes off properly exorcised souls. I've got a colleague I correspond with, he calls them humors, but I don't see anything funny about it. He's got plots, too, though I don't know what it is he's scheming. He's a strange one, that. Never quite makes sense. Loves his plants, hates warlocks. Now, what were we talking about? I can't quite remember. Back to work, I suppose.

--Undertaker Arimor, "Plasm" (POE I)

I've long had my fingers in quite a few... pies. I've learned to be discreet in my dealings, however. Few exiles can be truly trusted. There was a time when Torr Olgosso simply would not leave me



alone. Everywhere I turned, there he was! He and I had to have a talk about boundaries... yes, boundaries... and I certainly did not appreciate Igna Phoenix accidentally setting my work on fire... but the greatest betrayal, of course... my former apprentice and I did not part on good terms, to put it mildly...

--Undertaker Arimor, "Other Exiles" (POE I)

Fancies herself a Master of Undeath these days... or would the term be Mistress of Undeath? No, that doesn't sound right... but she's meddling with forces beyond mortal control, and it will not end well for any of us. I won't betray her, though, no matter what she did to me. ...

--Undertaker Arimor, "Former Apprentice" (POE I)

... My former apprentice forged her own path, and her own doom. ... I did find and retrieve her body, but I'll not allow it to be part of this sordid business. ...

--Undertaker Arimor, "Catarina" (POE I)

... love this old Wraecclast, I do... Damned fool he was, that Voll...

--Undertaker Arimor, "Exorcisms" (POE I)

Chitus could have led the Empire to greatness, had he not been viciously betrayed. He was a visionary! My line has worked tirelessly for three centuries to enact this—ah, you clever fox! You almost had me spilling my secrets! The solitude really must be getting to me. This old man'll never talk!

--Undertaker Arimor, "Emperor Chitus" (POE I)

Balabus Arimor was a little-known preacher during the days of Emperor Chitus, who believed eternal life could be achieved through ritual sacrifice. We shall see whether he was a prophet - or a charlatan.

--Hand of Arimor (POE I)

May the Prosperity granted to the Eternal Empire remain forevermore, ensuring our descendants have the means to return to greatness!

--Undertaker Arimor, chant Perandus random (POE I)

May the great Emperor Chitus free you of your anguish and aid this soldier, so that you may sweep away the filth that threatens the Empire's return!

--Undertaker Arimor, chant generic 1, chant staff random (POE I)

May the Shine of Solaris the Grand Phrecia returned to the Eternal Empire blaze ever-brightly;
lighting the way for generations to come!

--Undertaker Arimor, chant Phrecia random (POE I)

KINGSMARCH & THE SECOND KALGUURAN COLONISATION

... My name is Johan, and I am from the far east. My people, the Kalguurans, are attempting to build a settlement near here...

--Johan, "Introduction" (POE I)

The King commissioned this port for trade *after* we'd been operating it as an outpost for many years. We ourselves would like to investigate the remnants of our own culture, but he is... very interested in Vaal artefacts.

--Dannig, on the king (POE II)

...our glorious leader, Dannig, led us on an expedition across the stormy and dangerous oceans to look for an artefact called the Triskelion Flame. Our search took us to the forsaken continent of Wraecclast, a land filled with horrible monsters and raving mad exiles!

But we excavated many ancient sites, uncovering some of the lost history of our people's short residence here. Long ago, Kalguurans tried to settle on Wraecclast, and, well... it didn't go well. In the end, they did not survive, and they lost the Triskelion Flame. We've been looking for it for over twenty years now, and, to be honest, we've gotten a bit sidetracked, but my wife refuses to give up on the dream.

--Rog, on long story (POE II)

Several of our people were already here in Wraecclast, undertaking expeditions of their own. When their outpost reached a certain size, the King, in his great wisdom, gifted them an official charter—and a name. I was sent to aid in the execution and management of that charter. I serve as the King's Hand.

--Johan, "Kingsmarch" (POE I)

A name and a charter might have been stamped on it from afar, but this is *our* home. When we first arrived on Wraeclast, we picked this spot out as a good place to stash some supplies... and now it's going to be a city...

--Tujen, "Kingsmarch" (POE I)



We're still on our grand quest, as Dannig would put it. This is just basecamp. Of course, the longer I'm here drinkin' a good beer and relaxing in a bed, the harder it is to get back out there.

--Tujen, "Expeditions" (POE I)

Things operate rather loosely here, but back home, almost all official business is done through one or more guilds. Eh, for example, you cannot simply open up a shop and start selling goods. All designated locations for shops have a process that must be undertaken.

There are a set number, and they are all currently licensed to major merchants. Every few years, a new license is created, and bid upon by interested parties. Those without the familial wealth to get 'in on the game,' so to speak, may consider moving across the world to new lands, where regulations are not so strict. It's the best argument in favour of a move to Kingsmarch. Bring your family, start a new life!

--Raulf, "The Guilds" (POE I)

Oh, what to say about my people? Many of us here on Wraeclast are in various guilds. I'm in the Meridian Free Traders, the trade guild that executes the King's charter for Kingsmarch. You can't beat our logistics! Heh heh. Dannig is in the Artificers' Guild these days, and, Tujen's a freelance harbourmaster, but he stays close. Gotta keep the family together, you know?

--Rog, on the Kalguurans (POE I)

When we first arrived, we didn't intend for this to be anything permanent. It was more of a supply dump so we wouldn't have to keep going back to our ship. That was *my* idea. Heh heh! In the course of our expeditions, we built it up bit by bit. Eventually, it felt something like home. People back in Kalguur became interested in joining us, for adventure, opportunity, or freedom. Word must have gotten out, because that's when Johan arrived with the King's charter.

--Rog, "Kingsmarch" (POE I)

The charter for Kingsmarch brings many Kalguuran laws to Wraeclast, including our guild associations and criminal penalties. There is very little enforcement for most of it right now... there are only two things on Wraeclast the King seems to truly care about. One of those things is *taxes*. Ugh.

--Rog, "The Charter" (POE I)

I make no secret that I am a man of two loyalties. I must serve the King's wishes, and I must also serve this Charter to the letter of the law. I am aware that Kingsmarch is a destination for many that would be considered... less than upstanding citizens. So long as I directly see no evidence of crime, sedition, or another rebellion, there is no conflict of interest. Kindly do not discuss your thoughts in my presence.

--Johan, "Loyalties" (POE I)

It seems the recent Royal Order of Criminal Hanging was damaged by seawater on its long journey over the ocean. Unfortunately, the pages listing the individuals to be tried were, in my opinion, unreadable. I would be remiss in my duties if I were to hang the wrong man based on my own interpretation of salt-bled letters. As it takes many months to make the voyage—both there, for you to receive this reply, and back, for us to receive the proper text—the punishment in question will exceed the Charter statute of limitations. With regret, I am unable to enforce the Order as the situation currently stands.

My Deepest Apologies,

Johan, your Hand on Wraeclast

--Johan, Legal Response (POE I)

We have contracted Captain Faustus, of the *Fair Marylene*, for ties to the markets of Wraeclast...

--Johan, "Speak to Faustus" (POE I)

Well, as I understand it, the Kalguurans we see here are not... hmm, how to put this delicately... not the, heh, finest wines in the cellar. Some of them are part of official guilds back on Middengard, but most are dissidents, criminals, and suspected rebels. You are an exile from Oriath, just as they are exiles from Kalguur. If not in name, then in circumstance.

--Faustus, "Kingsmarch" (POE I)

With Oriath evacuated, I suppose Kingsmarch is the last bit of civilisation left on Wraeclast. Oh, I *could* go live with the Karui like the rest, but that's just not the way the winds are taking me.

--Faustus, "Oriath" (POE I)

With Darnaw dead, I've promoted myself to Admiral. Of course, the Oriathan Navy no longer officially exists... damn that Kirac!... so I'll have to make my own. The *Faustian Flotilla*! Admiral Faustus commands boldly from the helm! Oh, yes, it's quite magnificent, I know.

--Faustus, "Admiralty" (POE I)

THE KING AND THE FAILED REBELLION

I've never heard of this 'gods' thing before setting foot here, but I know of at least one... *man*... who would fancy himself a god. Best we not mention Divinity to those back home.

--Dannig, "Gods" (POE I)

You-know-who is *very* interested in the science of Corruption... which means I should look into it, too. You know, just in case.

--Rog, on a corrupted implicit (POE I)

It's all about *marketing*...

'March with us in Kingsmarch!' No no...

'At the edge of the world, where even the King might not hear you'... hmm, no, too risky...

--Raulf, to himself 1, 4, & 7 (POE I)

It's a long and dangerous journey back home. I do miss it, but the home I remember ain't there anymore. Well, not the way it was.

--Tujen, "Kalguur" (POE I)

There's been a brawl in the tavern. Royalists stirring trouble. One of our men aided them, so I had to let 'em go. You just can't trust someone like that.

--Tujen, on a crew brawl 3 (POE I)

Tujen: Damn it all. Damn the war. Damn the King!

Dannig: Tujen, you've had too much to drink.

Tujen: You know why. You were there.

Dannig: Just *watch what you say*.

Tujen: Yeah, yeah, yeah...

--Tujen & Dannig, settlers conversation (POE I)

Tolis. Oskar. Naja. Thea. Sven.

I won't forget. And someday, I'll make sure those bastards remember.

--Tujen, Drunken Scrawl (POE I)

... For years, I've had recurring dreams of what was publicly done to our comrades-in-arms after we lost... well, I guess you could call it a war back home. ...

--Dannig, on bad dreams (POE II)

During the failed rebellion, I once called out with all my heart. An arrow was arcing through the air. My arm was pinned, and I knew I couldn't get out of the way in time. I was a dead woman. But Luck answered my earnest request. Another arrow, also on a murderous path, hit the first *in midair*, and both were diverted, landing on either side of me instead! That was the first time I knew that Chance itself was a real force in this world.

--Gwennen, "Luck" (POE I)

Johan mentioned he's keeping an eye out for 'another' rebellion, did he? It's a sign of our sheer distance from home, that he would dare mention one happened in the first place. The bards do not dare sing of the good folk that gave everything... gave their *lives*...

I'm sorry, I shouldn't drag you into this. It's dangerous for you to even know about it.

--Gwennen, "'Another' Rebellion" (POE I)

Of course I'll make it to game night. I'm not avoiding Kingsmarch per se, it's just better for everybody if Johan doesn't see me. He might recognise me. The rest of you escaped when it all fell apart, but he saw my face. I gave him that scar. He's the one man in this world that would know me if he saw me—and then he could certainly guess who my surviving allies were. The King's paranoid suspicions have been bad enough, but a confirmation would bring doom down on us.

--Gwennen, Dear Rog (POE I)



A reckoning is coming, have no doubt about that. The King has his eye on Wraeclast, and he lays far-reaching plans. Only time will tell...

--Johan, "The King" (POE I)

... Something's afoot, and I feel a sinister shadow over my shoulder that only grows longer with each passing day.

--Faustus, "The King" (POE I)

I want you to know that I share the same concerns. For now, let's play along. We are perfectly positioned to wait and watch. The dark underbelly of civilisation carries with it truths that cannot be obscured by the might of authority. They're all terrified, whether they admit it or not. We'll speak more on this in person. I don't dare put pen to paper on the topic.

--Faustus, Ominous Correspondence (POE I)

I will not be your secret ear in Kingsmarch, nor would I aid those you call enemies. I will uphold the integrity of my profession over all other causes. Thank you for your inquiry, and good day.

Kindly, Raulf of the Meridian Free Traders

--Raulf, Cryptic Refusal (POE I)

... Water under the bridge, now. No sense poking a hornet's nest. The big man's resolved to leave us alone, so long as we keep sending back Vaal artefacts... Or whatever else his heart desires...

--Tujen, on Kalguur (POE II)

I don't know what to make of the Kalguuran King. I've only heard whispers. Rumours. ...

Well, they say he's a bit obsessed with Vaal artefacts. But something tells me this is quite a concern for the Kalguurans. I've noticed certain types of Vaal devices seem to up and disappear before being loaded onto ships headed for Kalguur.

--Makoru, on the Kalguuran king (POE II)

ORIATH'S CITIZEN GOVERNMENT

Kirac's my name, tracker and officer in Oriath's new Citizen Vanguard. We're the front line, ensuring the likes of Kitava and Innocence never blindside us again. The Templar kept the true

nature of the world hidden from the populace, but now the rhoa's out of the sack, and we'll keep both eyes open. Or the one eye open, in my case.

--Kirac, "Introduction" (POE I)

Families. These courageous men and women have families. That's the difference between them and a traditional military. No disrespect to my old comrades in arms, but this organisation is not comprised of solitary violent-minded young men. The Citizen Vanguard is a volunteer effort filled with the ranks of ordinary people who are tired of the endless parade of doom and nightmare we call Wraeclast. I said we'd all have to work together to face what's coming, and that's exactly what we're doing.

--Kirac, "The Citizen Vanguard" (POE I)

... It's not for me to decide whether skulking around Oriath with mystical technologies...is a crime worthy of prison. The new citizen Magistrates will handle that.

--Kirac, "Zana Caeserius" (POE I)

... My younger brother, Baran, fell in with a radical by the name of Zana Caeserius some time ago. She's a bit of a famous one in certain parts. Many who have worked with her have ended up two pews short of a congregation, ranting and raving on street corners or accosting random citizens... you can see the cause for my concern. I've reason to believe she was working out of an old Templar Laboratory off the Square. ...

--Kirac, "Invite to Hideout" (POE I)

[For the full story of Zana, Kirac, and the fate of Oriath, see the Atlas of Worlds supplement.]

THE SECOND FALL OF ORIATH

Seems enough was enough. The Vanguard undertook the largest evacuation in history... hundreds of ships... and Oriath has been abandoned. After the domination of the Templar, then the crackdown under Innocence, then the slaughter at Kitava's hands, and finally the ruination by Sirus, it's clear our little island is no place for men to live. Even cursed, one could say, though we are not entirely blameless for those disasters.

No small irony that the Oriathan people now depend upon the Karui we once enslaved. I always said that if you kick a rhoa in the arse, one day, it'll kick you in the head, but I underestimated the honour of our new hosts. They're different after the death of their gods... and we are, too, after the departure of ours. I wasn't a believer, but I can feel it. We're on our own now.

We're going to have to work together to face what comes next...

--Kirac, on Karui Shores (POE I)

Faustus: Strange turn of events, eh Karui?

Whakano: Are you speaking to me, sir?

Faustus: Never imagined my people living peacefully with your people, let alone on your lands!

Whakano: No? Some would say you've been living on Karui islands for generations.

Faustus: Well, they were our islands by then, weren't they? Anyway, perhaps I should thank you.

Whakano: Me?

Faustus: Though our beautiful metropolis is now but smoldering ruins, you have given us a new home. A chance to build society anew. Hope.

Whakano: I didn't do any of that, sir.

Faustus: You know what I mean! Learn to accept a compliment.

Whakano: I'm sorry, sir. Allow me to return a compliment: Thank you for not trampling our homes, taking our children, our brothers and sisters, our wives and husbands, and binding their arms and legs when you washed ashore. Thank you for limiting your recolonisation to one island, and for breaking only a few of our laws and traditions in these early days.

Faustus: You're very welcome. See? It's not hard.

--Faustus & Whakano, "Banter B" (POE I)

The result of clandestine Templar experiments with artificially grown virtue gems, the Gemlings are utterly controlled by the crystals growing within their flesh. While they are indeed powerful, they also have no will of their own. They were ordered to protect the wealthy families of Oriath's Estates during the evacuation, but now they remain perpetually on guard with no master to change their orders.

--The Art of Path of Exile II, "The Estates - Gemling Soldiers" (POE II)

THE SECOND PATH OF EXILE

Twenty years ago, in the wake of those tremendous events, mankind was busy with its own survival. No one was looking for me, and no one saw me. I lurked in high places, and dark places, seeking to keep the Seed safe from men of ambition.

In recent years, however, I found myself continually forced to move from place to place. There was always one more hunter, one more patrol, one more grove being cut down or cave being mined.

There was nowhere to hide, and my path inexorably took me here... which was, apparently, exactly where someone wanted me to be.

This was all a trap, laid over the course of years, and at colossal expense. Someone wanted the Seed at any cost, which surely bodes ill for their intentions...

--The Hooded One, "Hunted" (POE II)

THE TWILIGHT ORDER

The Twilight Order long existed as a secret association buried within the Templars. Oriath maintained its power through the use of a strong navy, and the Order has continued that tradition.

--The Art of Path of Exile II, "Twilight Order Galley" (POE II)

Through every great purge, and every fiery inquisition, the Twilight Order endured in secret.

--The Mutable Star Cleric Vestments (POE II)

The rest of the world believes Oriath was abandoned twenty years ago, after a series of crises forced an evacuation of the populace. The Twilight Order, however, did not flee. They emerged from countless centuries of secrecy to rebuild Oriath's heart, and now they are making plans to reshape the world.

In the wake of the slaying of the Beast, the gods have returned to Wraecclast, and are making civilization impossible. The Twilight Order is dedicated to the cause of freeing mankind from the tyranny of the gods. Their intention is good, but many may not agree with how they plan to meet their goal.

--The Art of Path of Exile II, "Act V - Oriath" (POE II)

The Twilight Order does not, and has never, worshipped a god. Once freed from the overbearing yoke of the Templars, the Order was free to build cathedrals venerating what they considered the true religion: adulation for the coming Saviour.

--The Art of Path of Exile II, "Twilight Order Cathedral" (POE II)

For generations the Twilight Order has sought to raise the Saviour, a hypothetical perfect human being that combines all the best of humanity without any of its flaws. Bloodlines were carefully mixed and managed to produce groups of special children, who would then be raised in isolation. Throughout their lives, they were taught philosophy, science, and every other subject vital to a pinnacle mind. Then, they were trained in the physical arts as well, pushed to be the peak of

perfection. After countless attempts, Lumerius was the first to meet the criteria: a man of total mental and physical capability, combined with compassion, kindness, and altruism. He is the chosen Saviour, and he will reshape the world.

--The Art of Path of Exile II, "Lumerius - The First and Last Emperor of Twilight" (POE II)



"Beyond fire, blood, and nightmare, the Saviour will build Utopia."

--Window to Paradise Barricade Tower Shield (POE II)

The leader of the secret genetic project to produce the Saviour, the High Priest of the Twilight Order is a man of absolute conviction. He carries the weight of sin so that his Order may remain pure. To that end, he maintains a secret alliance with a Breach Lord, the source of the Order's knowledge about genetic manipulation.

--The Art of Path of Exile II, "The High Priest" (POE II)

THE COUNTESS' PLAN

The gods caused all this, you know. After Oriath was destroyed, I travelled, searching for answers. Everywhere I went, the same divine devastation. It must end. I will end it.

This world will be reborn, no matter the cost.

--Oriana, Path of Exile 2 Trailer 3 (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Go4ykizk_Uo) (POE II)

A devout believer in the cause, the Countess walked the world in many guises, searching for a solution to the divine devastation being wrecked [sic] by the gods. When she found the Hooded

One and the Seed of Destruction he was carrying, she knew she had found the answer. Her machinations have given the Twilight Order the best chance they've ever had to free mankind from tyranny.

--The Art of Path of Exile II, "The Countess" (I) (POE II)

I am of the Faridun. ... Some time ago, a foreign woman came to us, and offered us the power to take back what was ours. We took her deal. We had no idea what it would cost us. ...

--Risu, "Identity" (POE II)

OGHAM: THE RETURN OF CORRUPTION (1619 IC) [ACT 1]

The Iron Count of Ogham was a kind and benevolent man... before he married the Countess. In recent years, he has become increasingly obsessed with proving that his Ezomyte lineage has not been sullied by the brief intrusion of Eternal conquerors. He now seeks power at any cost, a path which is slowly driving him to madness.

--The Art of Path of Exile II, "The Count" (POE II)

I sense Oriana knows... And I cannot deny that which I know deep down to be true.

That fair haired villager, an Eternal descendent... She knew.

At that moment when our eyes locked... We both knew.

She clung to her children like I would end them then and there. She is of no risk now but... How many others must I fear? Is my blood truly impure?

Oriana assures me, we can right some of the wrongs of the past.

She promises a way forward for Ogham. A way forward for the clans and the clanless alike. And... A way forward for me. We must continue with our task.

--Geonor, Geonor's Journal II (POE II)

The Count accosted me and stole a very dangerous object. A Seed that I have kept hidden from humanity. Somehow he knew that I possessed it. He can have no idea how dangerous it is. His attempts to harness its power will court disaster. ...

--The Hooded One, on the Iron Count (POE II)

... I remember the night it all began—the Count and his men returned in the witching hour, carrying something hidden from sight.

We didn't know what it was at the time, but we certainly learned soon. It was alive, and he needed to feed it.

--Leitis, "The Seed of Corruption" (POE II)

By decree of the Count of Ogham,

Able-bodied men capable of excavation must present themselves at the Manor at once.

Failure to do so will constitute a crime.

--Proclamation (POE II)

By decree of the Count of Ogham,

To the scoundrels and cowards hiding among the trees of the Clanless Perch,

As the loyal men of Ogham lay down their lives to protect those who support them, you hide.
As the women of Ogham sweat and ache, skinning beasts upon which we feed, you hide.
As the children of Ogham play at war, preparing to serve the greater needs of the people, you traitors hide.

I will offer clemency only once. Return to the manor immediately and serve Ogham, as is your duty, and your punishment will be deferred.

--Notice of Amnesty (POE II)

I have received reports of a number of villagers hiding at the Clearfell logging site.

Travel there and convey my order to return. Anyone refusing my Authority should be considered a traitor and a criminal.

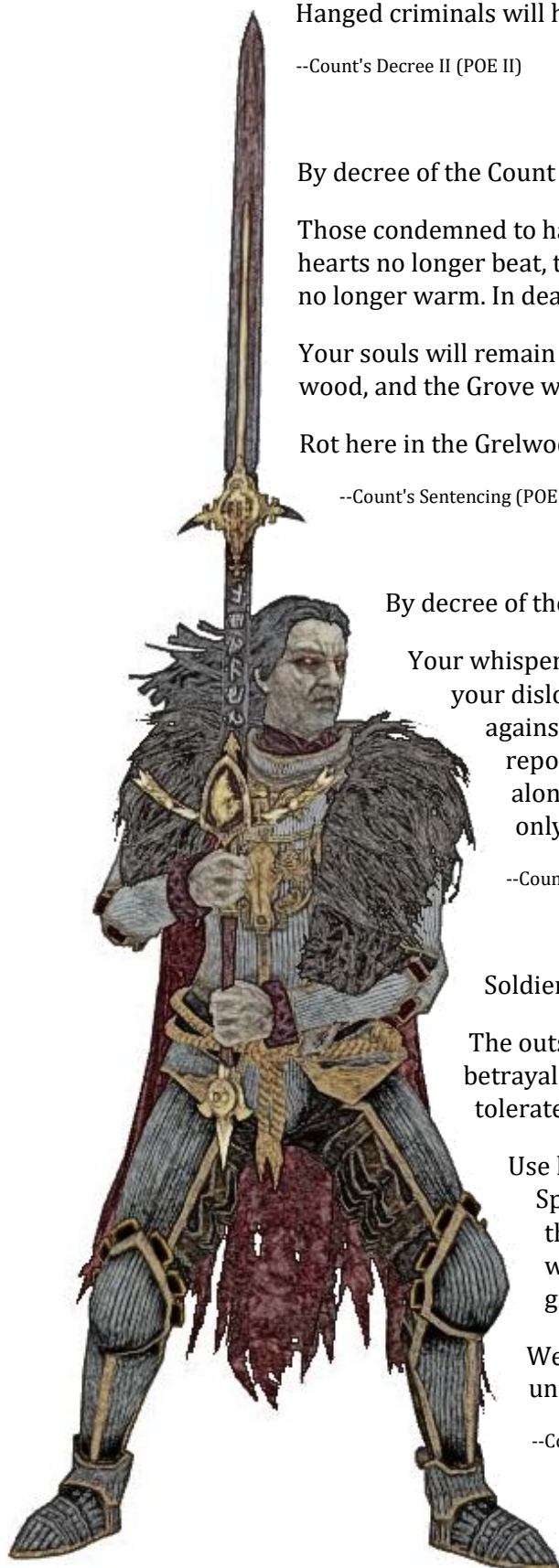
Deal with them as you see fit, but bring their bodies back to the Manor.

--Notice of Criminality (POE II)

By decree of the Count of Ogham,

Effective immediately, all crimes are now punishable by hanging until death.





Hanged criminals will have their bodies thrown into the pit.

--Count's Decree II (POE II)

By decree of the Count of Ogham,

Those condemned to hang from these branches are to be left until their hearts no longer beat, their lungs no longer fill with air, and their flesh is no longer warm. In death, you are not forgiven.

Your souls will remain trapped here by this ancient maw of maligned wood, and the Grove will be forever denied you.

Rot here in the Grelwood for all time, and good riddance.

--Count's Sentencing (POE II)

By decree of the Count of Ogham,

Your whispering and conspiring has not gone unnoticed. I see your disloyalty. I hear your mockery. However, your plots against me all lay dead in their tracks. Every villager must report to the Manor immediately for questioning. I alone will crush this revolt. Anyone who resists will not only be considered a criminal, but an avowed traitor.

--Count's Decree I (POE II)

Soldiers of Ogham,

The outside threat grows ever stronger. Whispers of betrayal echo within my very halls. We can no longer tolerate any risk.

Use lethal force against those you suspect of foul play. Speak carefully with your men. Ensure they are who they claim. Hang any suspects. Seek out resistance within the village and raze their homes to the ground.

We must send a clear message. Leave no stone unturned.

--Count's Orders (POE II)

[The events of Path of Exile II begin here.]

... You must hurry to the Manor. At the very least, those who are still sane may be convinced to stop the inevitable course of events that will follow, if they feed and nurture the Seed of Corruption.

--The Hooded One, on the Iron Count (POE II)

Count Geonor: Oriana! Open the cage. Release the beast! Give me what you promised!

The Countess: I think not. I expected so much more from you. Since you are too weak to do the job, I'll find someone who can. Goodbye, *'husband.'*

Count Geonor: You manipulative whore! How dare you abandon me! After! All! I've! Given! You!

--Geonor & Oriana, on Geonor at half health (POE II)

The Hooded One: Allow me to clear your mind, if only for a moment.

Geonor, the Putrid Wolf: The madness... It consumed my being. Oriana used it against me.

The Hooded One: Where has she taken the Beast?

Geonor, the Putrid Wolf: I found messages... From the desert.

The Hooded One: Hmm... From the Vastiri?

Geonor, the Putrid Wolf: Yes... Find her. Kill her. But first, please stop the madness.

The Hooded One: As you wish.

--Geonor & the Hooded One, on Geonor's defeat (POE II)

We must pursue Oriana! The Seed of Corruption has begun to grow, but there is still a chance that we can end this before it is too late.

The fledgling Beast is leaving Corruption in its wake, so we have a trail to follow. ...

--The Hooded One, "Death of the Count" (POE II)

VASTIRI: PURSUING THE BEAST [ACT 2]

Corruption has returned to the Vastiri. Before this season, the hyenic warriors you fought would never have dared raid a caravan.

The dead have begun to rise again, and other creatures of the desert have started... changing. By Zarka's accounts, the land is returning to the way it was before. These are ill times.

--Asala, "Recent Events" (POE II)

The Countess has used Corruption to resurrect Jamanra...

--The Hooded One, "Our Next Move" (POE II)

... When she finally brought us the Beast, it was not the glorious power we'd been promised. It was horrifying. Those of us who did not want to make war, those of us who were afraid of the Beast... Jamanra sealed us in the mine when his Dreadnought was complete.

This madness must end! Some may call me a traitor, but I do not seek the destruction of my brethren. I seek their salvation.

--Risu, "Identity" (POE II)

I know what Jamanra intends. Atop the burial spires of Deshar lie the Maraketh's most honoured dead. The King has become driven by madness to seek any trace of ancient flesh from those of renown or power in life.

He intends to feed their bodies to the horrific creature he keeps in a cage behind his throne. ...

--Risu, "Jamanra, the Risen King" (POE II)

So, the Beast *has* entered the world once more. We were following a trail of Corruption before we were waylaid, and now we shall resume the hunt.

We Maraketh are honour bound to seek and contain Corruption wherever it may be found. It seems this sacred duty falls on us once more. ...

--Asala, "Pursuing the Beast" (POE II)

After the Beast of Highgate was slain, all other *akharas* vowed to pursue and eradicate Corruption should it ever return. Never again will a sole akhara [sic] suffer the weight of history.

--Asala, "Honour Bound" (POE II)

The Faridun have assembled a tremendous Dreadnought, a war caravan larger than we have ever seen.

As we speak, it is barreling through the heart of the Vastiri, leaving devastation in its wake.

--Asala, "Assault the Dreadnought" (POE II)

The time has come for a final confrontation. We must attack the Dreadnought and face Jamanra and the Beast ourselves. This must end here.

--Asala, "Assault the Dreadnought" (on map) (POE II)

Jamanra, the Abomination: My Queen, take the beast!

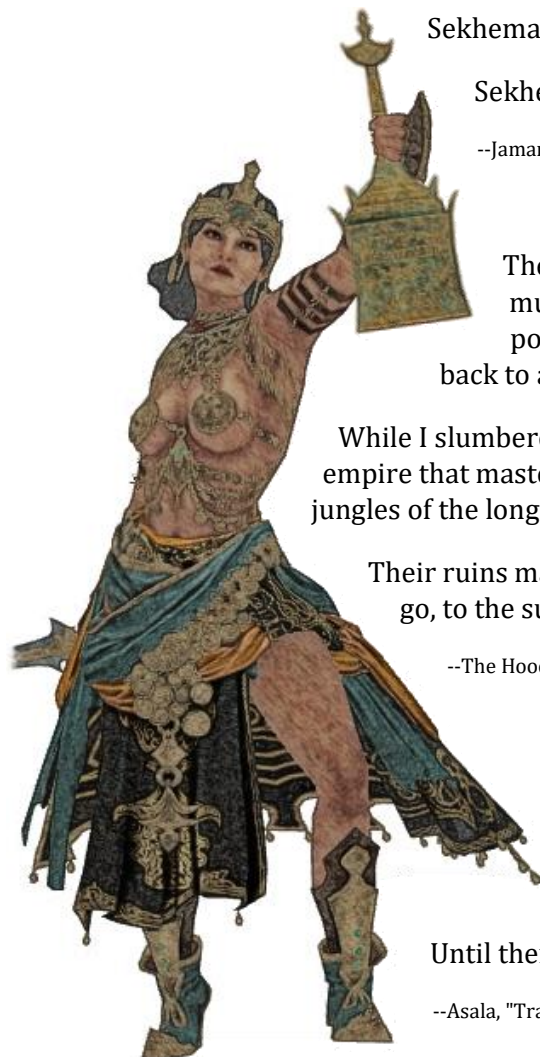
Sekhema Asala: What are you doing?!

Jamanra, the Abomination: I will hold this oppressor at bay!

--Jamanra & Asala, on Jamanra at two thirds health (POE II)

Jamanra, the Abomination: You have accomplished... Nothing. Oriana will prevail... And the Faridun will rule the Vastiri.

Sekhema Asala: This is not over. Not yet.



Sekhema Asala: Jamanra! I return you to the embrace of death!

Sekhema Asala: It is done.

--Jamanra & Asala, on Jamanra's defeat (POE II)

The Beast has grown beyond our ability to contain it. We must search for something greater than we currently possess, something that can drain its power and bring it back to a more manageable form.

While I slumbered under the numbing effects of Corruption, there was an empire that mastered the use of that deadly energy. We must go to the jungles of the long-ago Vaal.

Their ruins may yet hold the secrets we need. That is where we must go, to the sunken city of Utzaal. It is our only hope.

--The Hooded One, confession part 2 (POE II)

Yes, we can take you to the edge of the desert. Then, we will continue to track the Beast. You *must* find a way to contain it. When we find out where it is being taken, we will seek you out.

Until then, may the winds ever be calm on your path.

--Asala, "Travel to Sandswept Marsh" (on map) (POE II)

UTZAAL: SEARCHING FOR AN EXPERT [ACT 3]

Because we have lost the trail of the Seed of Destruction, our only hope is to seek the knowledge of those who studied the Beast for centuries: the Vaal. I know something of the Beast's creation myself... but I was asleep while it was actually alive. There is only one Vaal city left intact after two thousand years, and that is where we must go. In my wanderings these last twenty years, I have seen evidence that a Vaal scientist was working on an incredibly powerful device intended to defend his people against a potential Cataclysm. Obviously, it wasn't completed in time... but perhaps we can pick up where he left off.

--The Hooded One, "Ancient Device" (POE II)

I've heard of the Beast. Everyone has. If someone is truly trying to raise another, then they must be the grandest of fools...

--Alva Valai, "The Beast" (POE II)

Beyond this sealed door is the Temple of the Sun God, Kopec. I've seen writings by a fellow named Ketzuli that mention his research in this temple, but I can't quite make sense of what the device was or how it functioned. ...

--Alva Valai, "The Sealed Gate" (POE II)

Huh, an indoor sun. Wonder how they managed that.

--Mercenary, on Temple of Kopec (POE II)

That sun is an incredible achievement, no doubt, but it doesn't fit with what the Vaal wrote about this place. Perhaps it powers the device we seek...

--Alva Valai, "The Sun" (POE II)

The apex - It's opening! Goodness me! ...

It's some sort of... *gateway*... oh, how incredible!

Are these... living Vaal? In the flesh?! ... Hello! My name is Alva Valai! It was I who-...

No - no, don't run away!

--Alva Valai, on the Temple of Kopec device (POE II)

So... at the eve of the end, the demon of Atzoatl has finally come for me!

--Doryani, at start of fight (POE II)

Doryani: Gah! No! Do not fail me... not now!

Doryani: Ugh... how could this happen... all I have done. All that I sacrificed...

Alva: Your people cannot be saved. History is already written. You can stay here and die... Or come with us and help save the future.

Doryani: Hmm... the legacy of the Vaal must be protected... I do know of a way to contain the beast.

Alva: Best you start talking then. My friend here isn't exactly the peacemaking type...

--Doryani & Alva, on his defeat (POE II)

If only I had more time...

There is an ancient weapon. A weapon that was used against corruption, from a civilization lost to the ages. I have one piece of it. Three others were scattered... I have been searching for them, but the Karui have interfered at every turn.

--Doryani, "Ancient Weapon" (POE II)

So you will help us?

--Alva Valai, "Help" (POE II)

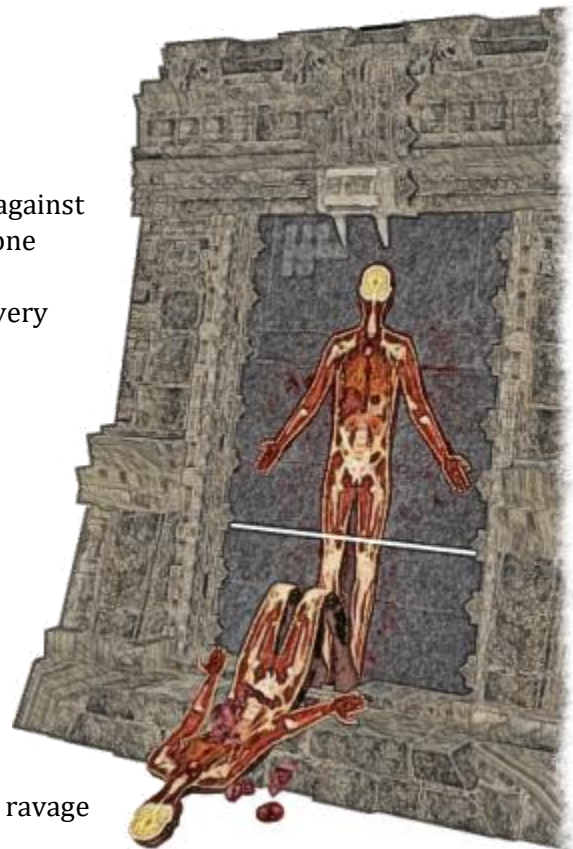
I suppose I must... It is too late for us here. This era is over. I pleaded with Atziri for her patience... but she would not abide me. She will attempt her communion with the Beast, and utter devastation will ravage our people.

But... the fact that *you* are here... a living descendant of our people... it gives me some hope for our future.

I will come to your era. Perhaps there is still time.

--Doryani, "Communion with the Beast" (POE II)

It's settled then. Let's hurry back to the time portal.



--Alva Valai, "Start Talking" (POE II)

History says Doryani disappeared just before the Cataclysm. Now we know why—he came with us to the present. It seems the choice has already been made.

--Alva Valai, on Doryani (POE II)

...we need the Weapon. We must travel to the archipelago the Karui call Ngamakanui. If the pieces still exist, that is where they will be found.

--Doryani, "The Ruins of Utzaal" (POE II)

NGAMAKANUI: HUNTING FOR THE WEAPON [ACT 4]

We know the pieces of the Weapon radiate intense latent Corruption. The more dangerous an island is, the more likely it is to contain a piece of it.

--Doryani, after arrival in Kingsmarch (POE II)

We can take you wherever you need. Places other captains would never dream of going! Your business is your business. Now, we can set sail whenever you like.

--Makoru, on being presented Boat Charter (POE II)

You found all the pieces, then? So... what now? Do they just sort of... snap together?

--Kanu, after securing the third piece (POE II)

Warrior: These waters have long been Karui. Do the Elders speak of anything like a forge?

Kanu: I have.

Makoru: Really? Where? ...

Kanu: Arastas. ...

Warrior: That sounds promising. Let's set sail.

--Player, Makoru, & Kanu, on a forge (Warrior version) (POE II)

Bah. The very name Arastas sets my teeth on edge. That is *not* our name for those ancient shores. The Twilight Order has been there in some form for a very long time. There are sacred burial sites deep within the island... but they are not Karui. Other than that, we know very little about them.

--Tavakai, on the Twilight Order (POE II)

You really are becoming quite a nuisance...

My life's work is about to be finished. The Twilight Order will see to it that the world is remade. A world without gods... without suffering... without the disease of Divinity. You and your shade cannot stop us. First Herald... deal with them.

--The Countess, before fight with Benedictus (POE II)

My lady... you must take your leave! I will bury these fools... I will bury it all! For the Saviourrrr!

--Benedictus, on on his defeat (POE II)

I can't believe the Twilight Order are responsible for bringing the Beast back into the world! ...

--Makoru, on Arastas (on map, complete) (POE II)

Now... reforge this Weapon, so we can be done with this place.

--Tavakai, on forging the weapon (POE II)

This will take most of my strength...

Stand back.

--The Hooded One, on forging the weapon (POE II)

Tavakai: Behold! The might of the Karui!

Makoru: No! What are you doing?!

Tavakai: Taking what is rightfully ours. The Karui will now be stronger than ever before!

Makoru: You fool! They need the Weapon! The world is at stake!

--Tavakai & Makoru, on the weapon being forged (POE II)

He betrayed us. He betrayed his own people.

--Tujen, on Tavakai stealing the weapon (POE II)

The Weapon is radiating intense Corruption... It will sicken and madden all those who near it... Quickly... he has returned to Ngakanu... You must stop him!

--The Hooded One, on Tavakai stealing the weapon (POE II)

Let slip the chains of mercy! The era of the Mighty has begun!

Let each man and woman fight to be their own Chieftain, to battle for supremacy, until only one remains.

The True Ngakuramakoi will be the last to stand, and their body will become the new world. Their blood will spring forth the new Karui that will inherit Wraeclast!

The End of Time has come!

--Tavakai's Proclamataion (POE II)

This... is not the Way.

--Tukohama, on Tavakai fight end of phase 2 (POE II)

Tavakai: Forgive me... The fever took hold, and I... I lost my way.

The Hooded One: You must not forget your mistake, Tavakai. For the coming war, we need you and your people to fight alongside us. I will use the Weapon to heal those infected here. In return, the Karui must aid us in fighting Oriana and her forces.

Tavakai: You have my word.

--Tavakai & The Hooded One, on Tavakai's defeat (POE II)



So, it seems Tavakai has pledged to aid you and... well... The crew and I already discussed it. We also volunteer! I didn't think I'd be fighting side-by-side with my father any time soon... Truly, these are the end times! Ha!

--Makoru, on the fight ahead (POE II)

Now, we need allies. I believe we have earned good will throughout Wraeclast. It is time to call upon those debts. One last journey, recruiting any who will join us, before we assault Oriath. The Karui are already with us. We should call upon the Ezomytes and the Maraketh.

--The Hooded One, after completing Act 4 (POE II)

As it so happens, I may... also have some forces in reserve.

--Doryani, after completing Act 4 (POE II)

ENLISTING ALLIES [INTERLUDE]

THE CURSE OF HOLTEN

To Ogham, then. Hopefully, they've had time to rebuild.

--The Hooded One, "Travel to Ogham" (POE II)

By the First Ones... you're calling us to war? Our people do owe you a debt... but right now, Ogham is on the brink of destruction once more. We can't sleep. We can't move. We can't rebuild... We're being picked off in the dead of night! One by one, our people are being dragged off into the darkness. Only the distant sound of screams gives us a clue as to what has happened. ...

Our neighbours... in Holten. Thane Wulfric and Lady Elswyth have lost their bloody minds. Bloodletting. Torture. Pain, misery, and death! That's all that lies in wait for those stolen off to Holten.

Look, now I understand you need us, but we can't leave this place undefended in the face of this. Help us once more, and we'll come to your aid.

--Renly, "Recruiting the Ezomytes" (POE II)

Travellers report terrible things happening in Holten. Those who refuse to join the cult are... ritually cut. Warnings written in blood on doors and... and on the stone of the roads.

That was the last we heard. I've no doubt it's gotten worse. Creeping darkness has spread even further, it seems. The Ogham of old would have stamped out this madness with strength of arm and heart...

--Renly, "Bloodletting" (POE II)

Well, we thought that Thane Wulfric and Lady Elswyth might have been driven mad by Corruption... but Holten, and the Blackwood, oh... are suffering from a far different malady. Cultists walk their streets, darkness clouds their land, and whispers hound any who travel there.

Finn told us how it reminds him of Freythorn. The bloodletting... the rituals... oh... it's horrible to think an entire Thanedom has fallen.

--Renly, "Thane and Lady" (POE II)

Una: The darkness creeping across our lands is some remnant of Corruption... The being that whispers from beyond... it's an opportunist.

Finn: Kickin' us while we're down. We saw this coming, too. Saw them take hold of Freythorn.

Una: What scares me the most? The cultists... they're not insane. They *choose* to follow the King in the Mists. They're not mad. They're fanatics.

Finn: I think the Thane and Lady of Holten made a deal. Reckon they felt vulnerable after all that happened here in Ogham. Many think they were forced into all this, but I think... yeah, I think they were *willing*.

Una: I fear you may be right.

--Una, "Darkness" (POE II)

The King in the Mists claims this wood. ...

--Siora, at start of fight (POE II)

We swore our oaths to the First Ones, beneath the same stars that lit their hunt. Yet one by one, those stars flicker and fade, and in their place... darkness. The absence of warmth. Endless. Inescapable.

Now come the whispers - no longer faint, but gnawing at the marrow. With each word, we are unmade. Soon we will be but hollow vessels. Our oaths, devoured.

--Psalm of Blood (POE II)

Rot before us in eternal autumn...



Beltimber bark.

Wilt to ruin by word and curse...
Of the everdark.

Catch their screams and hold
them close...
Then still their eyes.

Deliver them to us by the morn...
So the Wendigo may drink them
dry.

Against the dead of night...
The Blackwood coils forth and
craves.

Now you, worthy fellspring...
Follow the Unlight, all your
days.

--Follow the Unlight (POE II)

By the order of the Red
Thane,

They still resist our
new master's message.
Hunger does wonders
for a man's faith. Raze
their fields. Kill their cattle.

Crush their resistance, but keep them alive. We need worship, not corpses.

Bring them to Wolvenhold. Oswin will take care of the rest. Tarry not. The Wendigo watches from the shadows. If we dally, it will know.

--Order of the Red Thane (POE II)

By the order of the Red Thane,

Mark the walls. Mark their doors. Mark their fate!
The Wendigo beckons. We must rise to the occasion!
Those that deny his Voice must pay with blood.
Use it to rouse the sign of the heretical! Brandish it!
Once marked, Oswin will have them. And so shall we.

Lend your ear to the Voice. Drink your fill of that sweet embrace. Give yourself to the eternal night.

--Red Thane's Decree (POE II)

My dearest Elswyth,

His Voice grows clearer by the day. I can feel his presence. He thirsts so deeply for this world. I know that we shall be rewarded beyond measure upon his arrival.

I am so proud. The night we committed to Him is still vivid in my mind. You gave so much, so willingly. On the cusp between he and I, you fell to and fro. Your flesh pale white against the moon.

I am eternally yours. As we are His.
Your Wulfric

--His Message (POE II)

My valiant Wulfric,

You drive me forward. You give me purpose. I am but dust without you... and Him.
But we must have more.

My skin grows tired. My heart grows heavy. My brow wrinkles and my bosom betrays me. I must have what was promised. I must have his desire!

Oswin will prepare the Scarlet Bathing. In a fountain of fatality, the lifeblood of youth shall make me whole. There you and your hound must take your renewed Pale Bride, as to please the watching Master.

I cannot wait.

Yours,
Elswyth

--Her Message (POE II)

Dear Oswin,

The Red Thane and I are thrilled with your attention to detail. The Scarlet Bathing was an exquisite moment that we shall not soon forget. That you were able to acquire so many heretical younglings in such a short time... well, we cannot thank you enough.

The whispers grow deeper. He sees us. He sees you. We shall know unfathomable prosperity by his grace!

The Red Thane, the Pale Bride, and their loyal hound. A hound most faithful. A hound most strong.

I must away, for tonight I shall dance once more. Join us to feast. Look upon me as you will.

Elswyth

--Her Message (POE II)

Soon you will serve our master!

And I... shall watch!

--Wulfric, at start of fight (POE II)

As foul an influence as Geonor - and now, you share his fate.

--Warrior, on Wulfric and Elswyth's defeat (POE II)

I knew you'd handle it! You've never let us down. I thank you.

Now... as promised, we are prepared to follow you into the great battle you spoke of. I've spoken on your behalf. The Thanes will answer the call. The clans will all join this war. If this is the end, you bloody well know the Ezomytes will go down fighting.

--Renly, "Recruiting the Ezomytes" (POE II)

THE STOLEN BARYA

At this time of year, I know where to find the Ardura *Akhara*. Let us travel to the Vastiri.

--The Hooded One, "Travel to the Vastiri" (POE II)

... Your return is timely. I am making moves to gather the *akharas* for war, but they will not follow my leadership unless this goes well.

This year, because of what I am attempting to do, it has become my duty to oversee the Gifting of Water. In the city of Qimah, the *akharas* gather at the appointed time, as marked by the skies. There, we divide sacred water. We 'keep the river flowing,' as it is said. The same waters that once flowed through Keth. ...

The *sel khari*, the sacred guardians of the First *Barya*, have not arrived...

Three nights before the Gifting, they are to bring the *Barya* here. We cannot find them, nor have we received word. It is not mere chance that this has happened at such a time... there is an enemy at work. ...

--Asala, "The Envoy" (POE II)

The Ardura have vowed to aid us, and aid us they shall. That is not in question. They alone are not enough. We need to assist Asala in her bid at unification. As a people, when roused to war, the Maraketh are formidable indeed.

--The Hooded One, Interlude part 2 intro (POE II)

My attempt at unification has not gone smoothly. As a people, we are... stubborn.

The Gifting of Water is an opportunity to air grievances and heal old wounds. ... If I am to enlist the other *akharas* in this war, I must do so at this ritual. The fact that they have chosen me to do this means they are at least open to moving forward.

--Asala, "Gifting of Water" (POE II)

Asala: What happened to the *sel khari*?! Who are you?! I should slay you where you stand!

Jado: I am Jado... Now, stay your blade! I am not your enemy!

Asala: As *Sekhema* of the Ardura, I demand you explain yourself!

Jado: Very well... we learned that someone was planning an attack on the Gifting of Water. I infiltrated the *sel khari* to protect the First *Barya*.

Asala: Who is this 'we'?

Jado: The... Order of the Djinn.

Asala: So... Zarka's suspicions are true. You *have* started to replenish your ranks. Who attacked you?

Jado: A rogue sect of Faridun who stand against you. Their leader calls himself 'Prince Azmadi.'

Asala: More false titles! How did you let a pack of stray dogs best you?

Jado: They had help... from the Serpent Clan.

Asala: Of course! They swore vengeance for the death of their Queen at Keth.

Jado: Even then, I should have been able to hold them off. But Azmadi... he had strange abilities... powers beyond his own... He invoked the name Zarokh... They've taken the First *Barya*, and they left in the direction of Qimah.

Asala: Then we must give chase! Come, let us return to my *akhara*.

--Asala & Jado, on Elzarrah's defeat (POE II)

Too long have the Faridun bent beneath the Maraketh bootheel. We were penned to the desert's edge, called lesser, denied even the right to exist. Every revolt broke upon the same stone - no 'legitimacy,' no voice the *akharas* would heed.

So I made a new covenant. Zarokh, keeper of the ages, showed me the path through the Trial of the Sekhemas - and lent me the strength to walk it. I passed. The first Faridun in history. In that moment, the lie of our illegitimacy died.

When I take the mantle of *Sekhema* of *Sekhemas*, every *akhara* will be bound by oath and custom to obey me. Not just the Maraketh, not just the Faridun - all of the Vastiri. They will not dare question my rule. And with Zarokh's gift, I will unite this land beneath my banner... for all time.

Azmadi, the Faridun Prince

--Azmadi's Ambition (POE II)

Your interruption changes nothing. My reign begins now!

--Azmadi, at start of fight (POE II)

A prince denied his throne...

--Azmadi, on his defeat (POE II)

Jado: It is done. The First *Barya* is safe. I will take it back to the surviving *sel khari*.

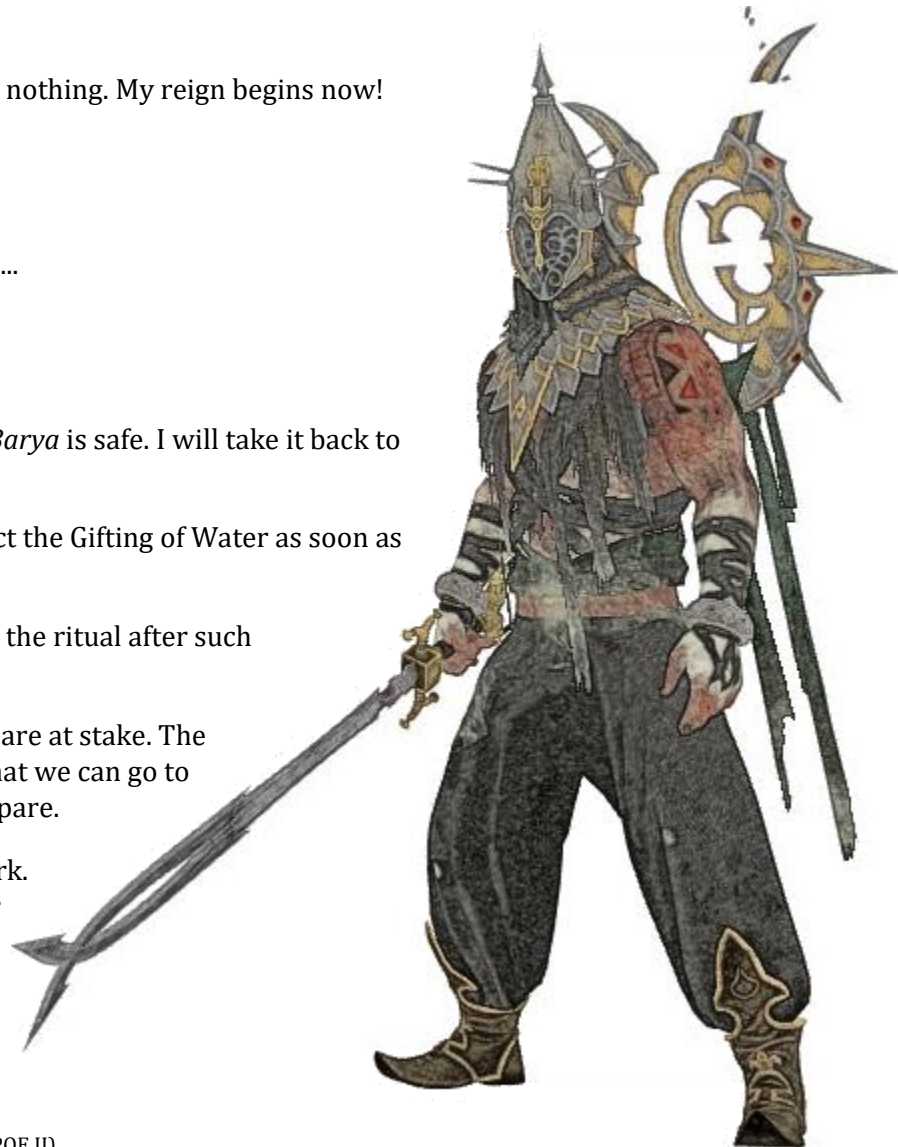
Asala: No. We must conduct the Gifting of Water as soon as possible.

Jado: You would still enact the ritual after such disruption?

Asala: Yes... greater things are at stake. The Maraketh must unify, so that we can go to war. Let us return and prepare.

Jado: What impressive work. You may not see the Order of the Djinn in Oriath, but we'll be there... doing what we can. May you have warm nights on your journey.

--Jado & Asala, on Azmadi's defeat (POE II)



The Gifting of Water went well. We are ready. I will make preparations. We shall meet you in Kingsmarch.

--Asala, "Kingsmarch" (POE II)

DORYANI'S CONTINGENCY

Let us seek out Doryani's reserves... whatever they may be.

--The Hooded One, "Travel to Mount Kriar" (POE II)

... Once I became the right hand of Queen Atziri...I spent every spare moment secretly pursuing ways to save my people. I placated Atziri and the nobles by day, but fought a war against death itself by night. The flesh. The soul. Machinery. Time itself. No possibility was left unexplored. If all else failed... that is what the Cuachic Vault was for.

Should the entire world be ravaged by the Cataclysm, some Vaal would still remain, deep in the most remote mountain. The final and most desperate contingency...

--Doryani, "Contingency" (POE II)

I am wary, now, after hearing about the... *people*... living in sunken Utzaal in your era. Isolation and containment drove them to horrific ends. There were systems put in place in Cuachic to avoid such problems, but the Vault was never intended to last this long.

If the people in the vault are still healthy and sane after all this time, it will be proof that the Vaal are indeed worthy of my extreme efforts. If they are *not*... I already suspect what might have gone wrong...

--Doryani, "Living Vaal" (POE II)

The Cataclysm came sooner than I'd hoped. The full complement of originally intended inhabitants was not achievable. I had to fill out the ranks with some candidates that I had previously ruled out due to their... religious proclivities.

Blood rituals and sacrificial rites were not uncommon in the Empire, but I disdained such wastefulness. More than that, religion tends to spread in confined spaces. I can only hope sanity has prevailed within the Vault.

--Doryani, "Filling out the Ranks" (POE II)

Before us stands Mount Kriar, the most isolated peak in the Azmeri Ranges. At its summit, you will find the Cuachic Vault. There is no predicting the state of those within. If their discipline and loyalty endure after all these generations, they will know us by a certain phrase. Tell them, 'the time of the sparrow has come.' ...

If they will not listen, I will come to assist you. Remember, subdue them, but do not kill them. They will fight for us, one way or another.

--Doryani, Interlude part 3 intro (POE II)

There's *living* Vaal in Mount Kriar? Well, I'll be damned. The stories are true!

It's not some children's tale from the Elders, but a yarn we weave on the winter solstice. Many generations ago, a Vaal named Uromoti came to us and wanted to 'buy' a mountain from the Azmeri. You can't *buy* a mountain! It's nonsense! They simply exist! So, we let him pass. Countless Vaal marched up there, trying to capture Mount Kriar.

Well they busied themselves, certainly, as eventually, they went silent. We assumed they died up there, trying to 'buy' the mountain from the sky! Perhaps they did make a deal, but with Prospero instead... Ugh, he'd be the type to sell you a mountain.

--Hilda, "The Vaal" (POE II)

My devotion. My lifetime of service. Has it really come to this? We cut our way through this remote mountain like cowardly dogs, hiding our treason from our own ruler.

To merely think such a project would mean death, since it implies we doubt her leadership. I hesitate to imagine what she will do to us—to my children—if she finds out we actually built it.

There is only one way to ensure my children live on. I must send them into the vault without me. I will finish this task, then return to Atzoatl to play my part. I was ever the good servant.

Here, then, is my last accomplishment, after the Vault: this simple carving, left for history, left for any who might survive. The Queen is mad, and I hope she finds the immortality she seeks.

May Yaomac deny her death's journey, so that we may finally be free of her!

--Uromoti's Truth (POE II)

Etched into the mountain Kriar for the glory of the Vaal

Two hundred gave their lives in service to the Queen

Many more would have died if not for Jiquani's constructs

All this, for the glory of Atziri

Uromoti, Architect of Expansion

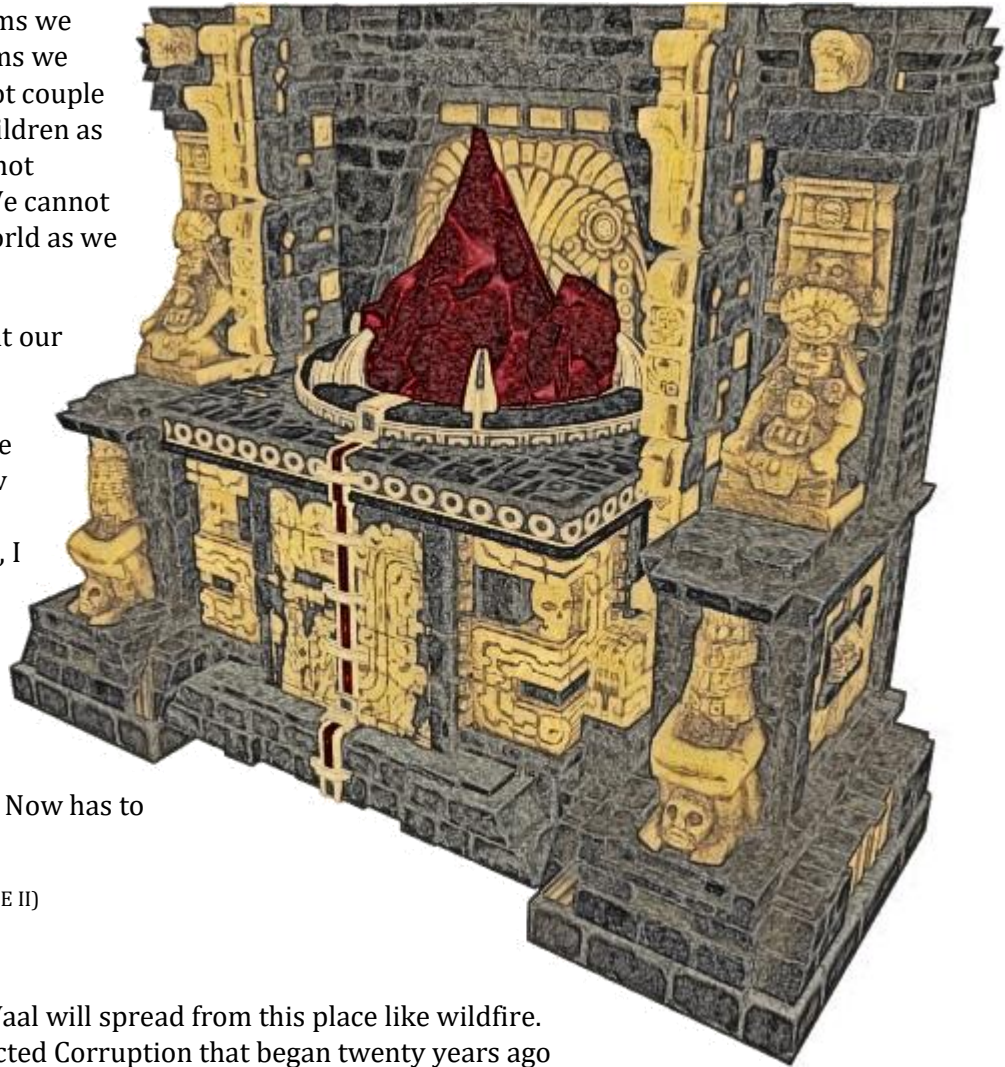
--Uromoti's Task (POE II)

We have one task, and one task alone: to survive with our dignity in-tact. It is the dignity of the Vaal, of all those who came before. We were born in this Vault, and we will die in this Vault. We are not

allowed the freedoms we read of; the freedoms we dream of. We cannot couple for love, or have children as we choose. We cannot choose our roles. We cannot wander an open world as we see fit.

We must accept that our Now is not At Long Last, and we must bring stillness to the dream. As your new High Priest, alongside my sister, I will endeavour to bring calm to your minds, to bring numbness to the pains in our hearts. That is the greatest calling our Now has to offer.

--The Cuachic Purpose (POE II)



One day soon, the Vaal will spread from this place like wildfire. The decline in detected Corruption that began twenty years ago continues at pace; soon, we will reach the threshold left for us by our great forebears.

Ready yourselves! Zolin and I have long served you, crafting the blood euphorics and eradicating pain.

No longer! We must be sharp-eyed and sharp-minded. After countless years, our Now is about to become At Long Last! We will be remembered as the heroes that went forth and repopulated. You may now couple and bear children as you wish. The carnal pleasures are ours once more! The Limit is lifted! The new Vaal empire begins here, Now, with us!

--The Cuachic Legacy (POE II)

Vaal, heed me! The time of the sparrow has come!

--Warrior, on encountering Zolin & Zelina (POE II)

Zolin, Blood Priest: What nonsense do you speak?

Zelina, Blood Priestess: No matter, now you die!

--Zolin & Zelina, at start of fight (POE II)

Enough, we submit!

--Zolin, on defeat (POE II)

I am not your enemy! I stand with Doryani.

--Warrior, on Zolin & Zelina's defeat (POE II)

Doryani: Fools! Did you not hear the code phrase?

Zelina: ... is it really you?

Zolin: By Atziri! Doryani himself!? I am not worthy!

Doryani: You seem sane enough. The spirit of the Vaal endures. Assemble yourselves. The time has come. You will march forth unto war.

Zolin: As you wish, Master Thaumaturge.

Doryani: Let us meet back in Kingsmarch. The Cuachic shall join our cause.

--Doryani, Zolin, & Zelina, on the twins' defeat (POE II)

ORIATH: CONFRONTING THE TWILIGHT ORDER [ACT 5]

Big news afoot! A grand alliance has been formed! The Beast is in Oriath! Soon they sail to siege the fallen city!

--Jacob, on Interlude complete (POE II)

It has been thousands of years since I've seen an alliance such as this. Wraecclast has finally united the way I always hoped it would. ...

We can only hope our alliance will be enough. That fateful hour... a return to Oriath. We can set sail immediately.

--The Hooded One, after completing Interlude (POE II)

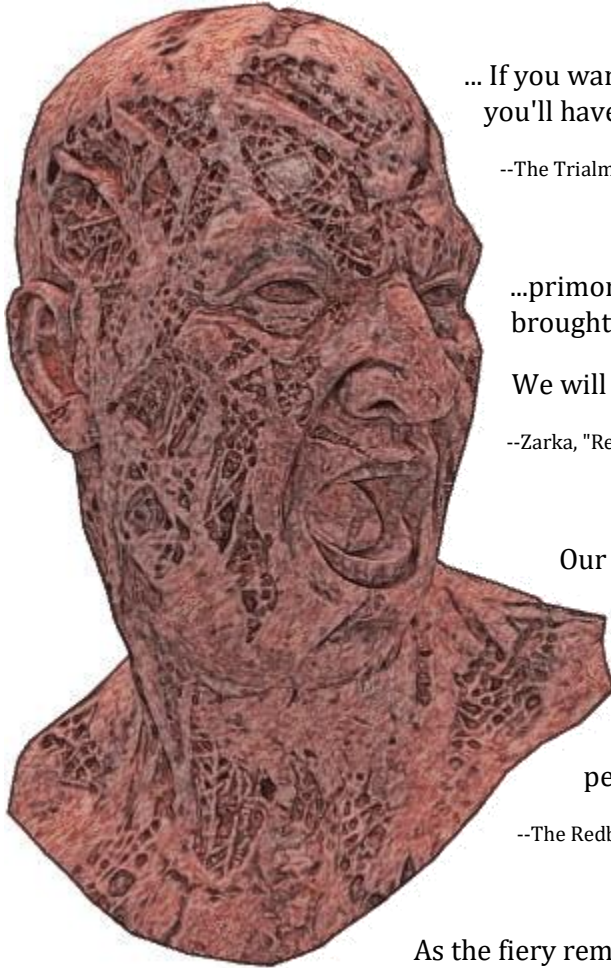
So, a united Wraeclast sails at our back. Who would've thought? We'll split off and deliver you to Oriath harbour, as planned. Dark clouds gather on the horizon... guess that's our cue.

--Makoru, on sailing to Oriath (POE II)

[To be continued...]

MISCELLANEOUS LORE

TITANS



... If you want to know more about the Beginning of Time, you'll have to ask the Titans. Well, *Titan*. ...

--The Trialmaster, "The Beginning of Time" (POE I)

...primordial fire must be earned from those that originally brought it to Wraeclast.

We will find *them* at the Valley of Titans. ...

--Zarka, "Recreating the Horn" (POE II)

Our mountain was once overrun by various human tribes vying amongst themselves for dominance. Little did the Redblades know that they encroached upon our territory and we were largely indifferent to their plights. It wasn't until the mountain erupted that their petty disputes were quelled.

--The Redblade Caldera (POE I)

As the fiery remnants of our outpost were subsumed into the caldera, a thunderous voice echoed across the barren landscape, "Your fragility is your folly. May others rise where you have fallen."

- El'Abin, Bloodeater

--El'Abin's Visage Fencer Helm (POE I)

Our home was swallowed beneath the great mountain for our complacency. Now we must prove our value to the Molten One by sating his hunger for life.

--Redblade Trampers Ancient Greaves (POE I)

How many did you fruitlessly feed to your molten god, Redblade? ...

--Catarina, to Korell Goya on his death (POE I)

We were largely indifferent to the struggles of humanity for millennia. Their suffering has become our own, now that we have a common goal to unite us. The hostile entities that threatened to overwhelm us still lurk deep beneath the surface of our world. We must ally with mankind in order to keep them at bay.

--An Unlikely Alliance (POE I)

Together, we will achieve an alliance in the face of ancient evil!

--The Molten One, on crafting an item 12 (POE I)

Welcome, surface-dweller... to a place created by the titans. Your kind have stood upon our shoulders since time immemorial.

--The Molten One, on entering the Forge of the Titans 2 (POE I)

This is our centre of power – our forge, where the heartblood of the world flows forth as magma.

--The Molten One, on approaching the anvil 4 (POE I)

For their mortal allies, the last Titans forged a mighty staff, one that could safely hold the first unearthed virtue gem.

--The Geomantic Gyre Highborn Staff (POE I)

... gems...

You safely place them in geomantic sockets, a technique I believe the Titans created for humanity during the Third Pact. ...

--Doryani, "Studying the Beast" (POE II)

Its forging marked the melding of man and Titan against the rising darkness.

--The Redblade Gladius (POE I)

To forge weapons from the heat of the Crucible is to bend the very essence of the world to your will.

--The Molten One, on crafting an item 1 (POE I)

...the Redblades failed...

--The Molten One, on crafting an item 6 (POE I)

Kalandra watched as the almighty titans fell, relegated to the innermost depths of the world, where horrific abominations awaited them.

--Primeval and Primordial Remnants (POE I)

Titans lived and died here. What fate wrought their demise?

--Witch, on Valley of the Titans (POE II)

What once shook the sky now lies quiet beneath it.

--The Titan's Fall map pin (completed) (POE II)

They remain where they slept.

--Valley of the Titans (POE II)

THE LOST-MEN

In the Mastodon Badlands, a tribe of lost-men make their home. None know their language or religion, but a power of some kind does reside in their rituals. They worship the bones of the ancient Mastodons, a faith which evokes the power of lightning and death.

--The Art of Path of Exile II, "The Lost-men" (POE II)

The lost-men of the Badlands have no knowledge of our wars. They will attack you because they do not understand you. It is unfortunate, but we cannot allow them to stand in the way.



This conflict will determine their fate as well, so in a sense, we are saving them despite themselves. The greater good is all that matters.

--The Hooded One, "Mastodon Badlands" (POE II)

I'm not sure I understand what I'm translating. At least one of the locations mentioned in this logbook belonged to a tribe of 'men of no name' who worshipped the bones of a specific kind of long-dead beast whose description makes no sense to me. Your continent is strange. ...

--Dannig, on a scrublands logbook (POE I)

SUN CLAN

Those creatures are too coherent and intelligent to be manifestations of Corruption. I suspect they are the descendants of Divine tampering.

There was a being I once knew in the ancient days, a trickster who would have appreciated someone to laugh at his ill-conceived humour. What more perfect audience for a sickening jester than a pack of gibbering hyenas?

--The Hooded One, "Sun Clan Hyenas" (POE II)

... Before this season, the hyenic warriors you fought would never have dared raid a caravan. ...

--Asala, "Recent Events" (POE II)

Abhorrent hybrid!

--Druid, on fighting a hyena 1 (POE II)

False half-breeds!

--Druid, on fighting a hyena 2 (POE II)

THE VIRIDIAN WILDWOOD

Welcome, traveler. You are safe here. The Viridian Wildwood is a gift to all those with peace in their hearts.

--Wildwood Greeting (POE I)

We, the Maji, mark this land as the future home of the Azmeri. Our people will prosper in safety.

--Maji Proclamation (POE I)

The Wildwood was a gift, meant as a haven against the Winter of the World.

--The Flawed Refuge Maple Round Shield (POE I)

There are many names for the Draíocht, and for the spirits and beings that comprise it. Just like nature itself, it's difficult to distinguish the parts from the whole.

--The Primal Huntress, "The Goddess" (POE I)

You might call her a goddess. I might call them Sisters Three. Others might call them the collective will of nature itself. We may all be right. They exist within this Wildwood, or perhaps they *are* the Wildwood. To create this realm, the Draíocht gave so many pieces of themselves so widely and so deeply, that little remained. Fragments in every tree, every rock, and every animal. A voice, sometimes, to a chosen few... or so I've been told, by travelers through these lands.

--The Primal Huntress, "The Draíocht" (POE I)

This was supposed to be a sacred realm of peace and prosperity for the Maji, and then, too, for the rest of their people from your world. The Wildwood was meant to be a gift. A subtle sorrow creeps upon my heart when I think about what this place was supposed to be, but never achieved. Perhaps the Draíocht gave too much of themselves... or perhaps nature simply has a way of growing and changing beyond anyone's control. It is still possible that the Maji recover in numbers and strength and reclaim the forest, but if they don't, such is the cycle of life and death. ...

--The Primal Huntress, "The Maji" (POE I)

... In some ways, this realm was lovingly crafted for them by the Draíocht. In some ways, the Maji built this realm for the Draíocht out of loving devotion. It might be that devotion that drew the King in the Mists here... belief is the only power in all of creation that can make real that which is not.

--The Primal Huntress, "The Wildwood's Origin" (POE I)

We are merely the vanguard for the rest of our people, who still reside in the old world, waiting for the Wildwood to be purged of evil. We are the strongest and the brightest, chosen by the Draíocht

long ago for this righteous purpose. There are many Maji deeper in this realm, though less than there were. I am the only one that ventures this close to the border 'twixt our realms.

--The Warden of Eaves, "The Maji" (POE I)

I patrol the border of the Wildwood. That is my role, to be the Warden of Eaves. I was not the first, and I will hopefully not be the last. I do my best to protect travelers who wander through, and I slay any Nameless or afflicted beasts that try to enter your realm.

--The Warden of Eaves, "Duty" (POE I)

There were many who walked these paths in the early seasons. The mists were once far more welcoming, and brought warmth and light that both your realm and ours would otherwise lack. That was a very long time ago, more seasons than I can number. Travelers, they were, for this was never their destination, merely a route on the path to somewhere else, the same as a dream lies betwixt sleep and waking.

--The Primal Huntress, "Travelers" (POE I)

Your realm has an enormous sphere of fire hanging overhead? I've been told this tale before, except that travelers in the early seasons spoke of that fire being absent behind some... impenetrable veil of ash and mist obscuring your 'sky'... another fantastical absurdity that features prominently in your folklore. This place was a refuge for them in a time of cold and bitter struggle, they said. They ate of the fruit and washed themselves in the rivers, joyous to be alive for what little time they could stay.

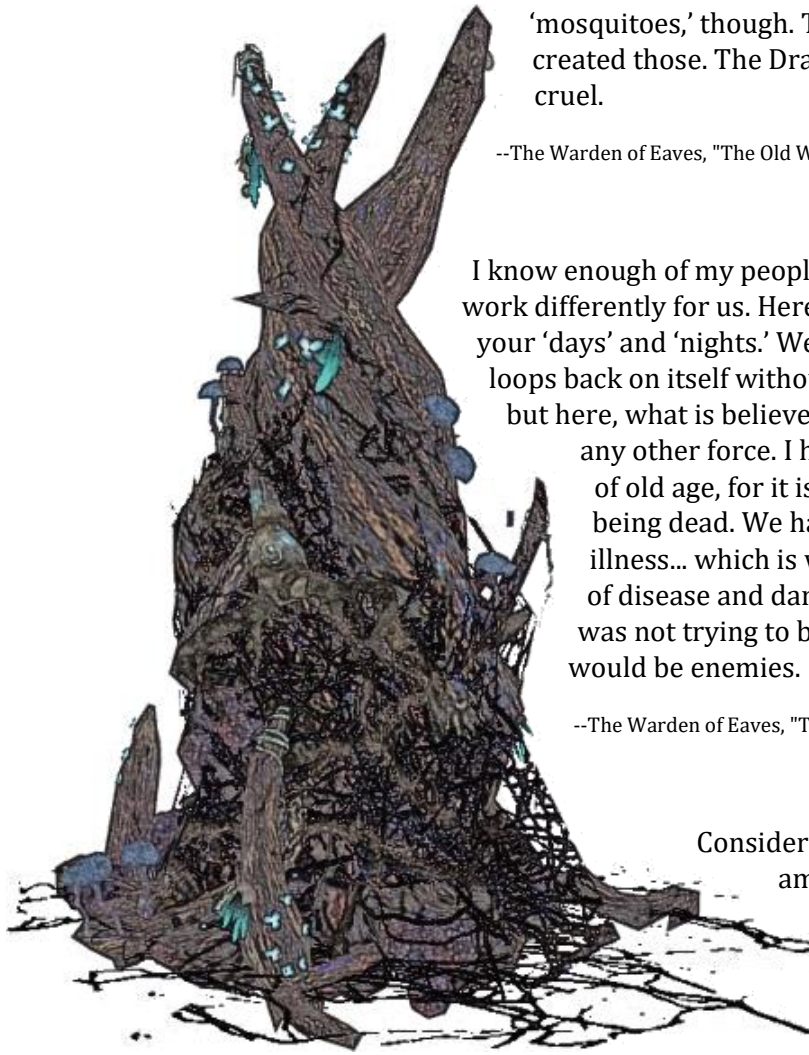
--The Primal Huntress, "The Sun" (POE I)

I just can't picture it! Sometimes your people claim this 'sky' is a vast dome of blue, but sometimes your people claim it's dark, and other times it's a riot of colours caused by the 'Sun?' And there's a silver sphere up there, too, that contrasts the fiery one. The Sun and the Moon... for some reason, I get the feeling that they despise each other... so opposite, yet sharing the same heights, the same light and adoration... brings a sad tear to my eye, though I know not why. That closeness should bring love and cooperation, not hatred and jealousy...

Here I go, making up my own tall tales. You'll have to forgive me for my flight of fancy. Such imaginings are dangerous in the Wildwood.

--The Primal Huntress, "The Sky" (POE I)

I have learned much from travelers 'twixt our worlds. My people originally came from your realm, you know. Sometimes, my battles took me to the border of the other side, and I continue to marvel at the absurdities and wonders I saw. The 'sky' made me dizzy, inspired, and fearful all at once. The 'Sun' was beautiful, and I have never felt another warmth quite like it. I could do without your



'mosquitoes,' though. The Raven Trickster must have created those. The Draíocht would never have been so cruel.

--The Warden of Eaves, "The Old World" (POE I)

I know enough of my people's past to know that Time used to work differently for us. Here in the Wildwood, we do not have your 'days' and 'nights.' We have only the seasons, a cycle that loops back on itself without marching forward. We do age, but here, what is believed and pictured has more sway than any other force. I have never known anyone who died of old age, for it is not possible to properly imagine being dead. We have nothing to fear but injury and illness... which is why the King in the Mist's affliction of disease and darkness has troubled us so. Even if he was not trying to bring through more of his kind, we would be enemies.

--The Warden of Eaves, "The Seasons" (POE I)

Consider this realm my laboratory. Here, I am able to investigate deeper mysteries, from within. I am aware of the Old World, and have undertaken two journeys there. I find your people strange and literal, and

your land cold, exhausting, and miserable. I quite liked snow, however. We have frost and rime during our winter, but the Wildwood hardly transforms the way your realm does under a heavy snow. Perhaps, when I replace the King in the Mists, I will bring the first real snow to this forest. That beauty may sway my people to see the pragmatism of my path.

--The Breaker of Oaths, "The Wildwood" (POE I)

This realm is not what it seems, but I imagine you have already guessed that. Here, what is real and what is meant may blur together. That is why names have power here, not from the words themselves, but from the concepts evoked. To define a thing is to influence that thing... though I suspect you have a similar danger in your world, since you carry upon you the faintest of scents—one among many—that reminds me of the Draíocht.

--The Primal Huntress, "The Wildwood" (POE I)

If you have a name, do not speak it aloud. Names have power in this place. Not even I can protect you, if you foolishly give out your name here. Call things by what they are, and people by what they do. ...

--The Breaker of Oaths, "Introduction" (POE I)

Names carry meaning. Meaning carries power.

--Ritual Scarab of Recognition (POE I)

To name a thing is to give it power.

--The Light of Meaning (POE I)

THE KING IN THE MISTS

Deep in the mists of history, the Draíocht created this forest for us, in an act fueled by our devotion. We Maji were the chosen strongest, and we were to prepare this place for the rest of our people. The Wildwood was meant to provide refuge from a winter without end, and from a land full of dangers. Unfortunately, something else came here, too—from the *other* side, the unseen reflection opposite the mortal world. Shadowy creatures slipped in through a dark crack... and there is one, above all, who aggressively pursues the spread of his dark and malevolent religion.

The Maji have waged a cold and bitter war against the King in the Mists for countless generations. ...

--The Warden of Eaves, "The Wildwood" (POE I)

I've no quarrel with him. He gives me a very wide berth, and I don't hunt him down, purely because it's not my place to interfere. He and the Maji have fought over this realm for countless seasons. I think neither side knows the pain of the other. The Maji are fighting to protect their home, but the King in the Mists comes from a far worse place than this. He is a breed of creature the Maji cannot comprehend... his actions appear to be hostile and evil, but it is merely the way of life from whence he comes. Would you hate a mouse for eating fallen seeds? You might, if you were the bush that considers those seeds your children.

--The Primal Huntress, "The King in the Mists" (POE I)

I do not know where I am. I do not understand how I came to be. I heard a single word spoken in darkness, a Name, ripping me from nothingness into the exquisite light of meaning. This is my first moment without pain, without endless agony. This place... this span of partial realness... it resists my being, but I refuse to go back.

I must help my people... let this be my declaration. I exist, and I *will* save them.

--The King in the Mists, The Exquisite Light of Meaning (POE I)

I am beginning to understand more of this Wildwood, as a traveler called it. There is a consciousness in all things. This place dances with motes of meaning, of thought, of belief. The dust of reality, bright and many-coloured. They are beautiful, but they will impede my efforts. I must become darkness if I am to save my kind from eternal torment. I have no choice.

--The King in the Mists, Determination (POE I)

The King in the Mists seeks dominion. In service of that goal, he has employed a deceitful religion. Travelers along the border are in danger, yes, but not necessarily at risk of death. Worse. He seeks their devotion. He seeks their belief. I know not what he says to them, or how he convinces them, but his ranks swell with each passing season. They are fools, all of them. Can they not feel the Draíocht all around them? Why worship a false idol?

--The Warden of Eaves, "Cultists" (POE I)

... The King in the Mists has created a religion to ensnare travelers through the Wildwood. These unwitting travelers have become his fanatical followers, and their faith fuels his plans. ...

--The Breaker of Oaths, "Culling the Cultists" (POE I)

The King in the Mists has brought a creeping darkness to this place, making it unsafe for travelers and denizens alike. ...those who find themselves here are in grave danger. ...

--The Warden of Eaves, "The Affliction" (POE I)

The King in the Mists has not brought darkness to the Wildwood. The forest still grows, so the light is still there, we just can't see it. It's something else entirely, something new. It is... *unlight*. He seeks



to change the nature of this place so that more like him may escape their state of dreamlike nothingness. My hunts have sometimes taken me to the border between here and there. His world is in the opposite direction of yours, with the Wildwood betwixt...

The realm from whence he hails is one of silhouettes, the barely seen rear of the stage upon which the play of life conducts itself, with nary a thought for the shadows cast. It is the realm of the Nameless, those things which not only have no name, but which cannot be. Theirs is a perspective of endless agony and sorrow. They cannot have children in the violet unlight of that realm, and thus their progeny are consigned to the same fate of nameless nonexistence. Their numbers grow without end, comprising all the things that can never be, and the quiet roar of silence becomes more and more deafening as they clamour in fear and pain for release. My heart goes out to them, but there is nothing anyone can do. If I could name them, I would... but how do I name something I can't think of?

--The Primal Huntress, "The Affliction" (POE I)

For generations, the Maji have fought against the King in the Mists. My own mother and father were slain in battle against him. We are meant to be impartial and fight selflessly against evil, but how can I possibly feel nothing? He has wounded my family in ways that can never be forgiven. One day, I *will* find a way to take his head.

--The Warden of Eaves, "The King in the Mists" (POE I)

My order spent untold centuries doing battle with the King in the Mists. Whole generations of Maji dedicated their entire lives to eroding his mysterious power. It was an impressive effort for otherwise unremarkable mortal men and women, but I have no desire to join them in futile toil. There must always be evil opposite goodness. That is inherent in the balance of this Wildwood, and perhaps of the world itself. That balance means we can never truly rid ourselves of evil. Thus, I know what I must do. I will not destroy the King in the Mists... I will replace him.

--The Breaker of Oaths, "Oathbreaker" (POE I)

When *I* am the dark power at the heart of this forest, I will impose my own ethics on the evil within. Travelers will be granted safe passage, so long as they do not tarry. Children, especially, will have nothing to fear. The dark affliction that plagues us will remain within the borders of the Wildwood. I believe I can enforce those rules, at least. The best answer, all along, was not to aspire to heroism... but to become more ethical masters of darkness ourselves.

--The Breaker of Oaths, "Replacing the King" (POE I)

RITUAL ALTARS

He is clever. I'll give him that. He's very motivated, too, and quite ruthless. I find fault with his ethics, however. He has visited general misery upon the entire Wildwood, and thus made

unnecessary enemies. I do not know his ultimate goal, only how he goes about it... and I intend to subvert his altars to my own ends.

--The Breaker of Oaths, "The King in the Mists" (POE I)

... Key to his plans are countless ritualistic altars that he has built throughout the forest. These altars are nails hammered through three layers of meaning: your world, the Wildwood, and the void of the Nameless. It is time we bent one of those nails.

... A ritual disrupted may cause far more damage than meets the eye...

--The Breaker of Oaths, "Become the Darkness" (POE I)

Allow me to describe the situation thus: a man comes upon an altar in the wild. He knows not who the altar serves, but he pays tribute to it nonetheless. It grants him a paltry gift, a trinket, nothing more. He imagines all the possibilities. He imagines wealth. Ever after, he seeks out more of these altars, and continually pays tribute to his unknown benefactor, in the vain hope that his life will change. Thus it is with all religions. The man is a devout follower, though he knows it not. His faith fuels his own gradual doom.

--The Breaker of Oaths, "Ritual Altars" (POE I)



Faith given under false pretenses still carries the same power.

--That Which Was Taken Crimson Jewel (POE I)

Quiet thy troubled soul. Think not. Just pray... to me.

--The Queller of Minds Nameless Ring (POE I)

And when you are no longer useful, you will discover how much you truly mean.

--The Selfish Shepherd Nameless Ring (POE I)

He draws ever closer...

--Ritual Scarab of Abundance (POE I)

THE NAMELESS

The Nameless begin to slip their bonds of nonexistence...

--Bestiary Scarab of the Shadowed Crow (POE I)

They clawed their way up from the agonising depths of nonexistence, breathing deep with joy the exquisite light of meaning.

--From Nothing Diamond (POE II)

Nothingness is loathe to relinquish its grip. Every moment is a struggle to exist.

--The Burden of Shadows Primordial Staff (POE I)

The border between the Wildwood and the realm of the Nameless does not exist. That is not to say, however, that it cannot be reached. It is *there*, if you stretch the definition of the word *there*. You cannot walk a path to find it. To enter it, is to cease to be. Even gazing upon it scalds mortal eyes, for we do not have the faculties to perceive that which is not. Everything you can possibly experience, be it good, evil, light, dark, birth, death, or anything else in the Draíocht—all of it is part of our web of meaning.

The realm of the Nameless is not the web. It cannot be, yet it is. This all sounds like nonsense, I'm sure, but it's the only way we can refer to things we cannot comprehend. In fact, the moment you do comprehend something from the realm of the Nameless—the moment you imagine it, understand it, Name it—it takes on meaning and becomes part of life's web. It ceases to *not be*. Quite literally, we can never truly understand nothingness, for if we did, it would no longer be nothing.

--The Breaker of Oaths, "The Realm of the Nameless" (POE I)

The King in the Mists was not the first to escape the realm of nameless nothingness. A great many seasons ago, a curious young man walked the Wildwood on his journey elsewhere. He stopped at a waterfall, and engaged in a flight of fancy, naming creatures that he imagined might exist unseen among the trees. He just so happened to picture a powerful mother from the shadow realm, and he foolishly gave her a name—it is not 'The Porcelain Queen,' mind you. That's just a title, a few safe words to refer to her in a roundabout manner.

The traveler moved on, but *she* emerged, and brought her countless children with her. That young man was nobody important, and he surely died long ago, but his idle imaginings and his casual Naming led to a tale of untold tragedy and pain that is still playing out even now. When the denizens of the Wildwood tell you not to use True Names, they mean it.

--The Primal Huntress, "The Porcelain Queen" (POE I)

The Nameless were brought here long ago, when a traveler accidentally named the Porcelain Queen, causing her to become real. Her kingdom in your world is gone now—I know not how or why—but a few of her shadow children escaped back into the Wildwood, and then multiplied in number through the march of seasons. They lament eternal, sorrow without end, a pain they carried from their existence before, now made all the sharper by the loss of their mother. ...

--The Primal Huntress, "The Nameless" (POE I)

Our mother's queendom has been destroyed. Our brethren [.....*illegible*.....] scattered to the winds, [.....] of the Spider continue to hunt us. We fled here [.....], seeking the aid of the Maji [.....] our Porcelain Queen has not followed. Woe be our companion, until [.....].

--The Porcelain Queen (POE I)

The Nameless prowl about in the curse of darkness brought by the King in the Mists. They crawled out of the endless void of nothingness from whence he came, though not necessarily alongside him. There have been others, like the Porcelain Queen, who I gather was no ally to the King in the Mists. I was raised with the fable that the Nameless served *her*, but she is gone, and now they seem quite mad with eternal grief.

--The Breaker of Oaths, "The Nameless" (POE I)

... They are shadows that plague the Wildwood with disease, pain, and suffering. They must be destroyed, lest the rot spread. The Maji have fought them back since the very beginning, and we will continue to do so as long as we draw breath.

--The Warden of Eaves, "The Nameless" (POE I)

... A great many Nameless creatures crawl the Wildwood, existing in perpetual agony and sorrow. They are dangerous, and they deserve mercy...

--The Primal Huntress, "A Merciful Hunt" (POE I)



Remember this, if you ever have children: name them. Bless them with that peace. It is the first thing that parents do for their children for a reason. Without a name, they are vulnerable to the changelings, at risk of being snatched away to that realm of shadows, out of jealousy and hate for those beings that are gifted with True Names... a child snatched before their naming is an opportunity for one of the Nameless to escape into being.

--The Warden of Eaves, "Naming" (POE I)

THE INCARNATION OF AGONY

If you see her, *run*. Her wail is an omen, and her touch means certain death. She is the most evil of the Nameless, but, fortunately for us, she is quite mindless in her rage. If she were cold and calculating like the King in the Mists, we would all be doomed...

--The Warden of Eaves, "The Incarnation of Agony" (POE I)

I have long wondered where that being fits into the natural order. I have come to believe that she is the manifestation of the pain of the Nameless, those countless multitudes forever silently screaming in their realm of shadowed nonexistence. Someone must have Named her long ago, but we may never know what she was called... and until we do, she can never truly be banished.

--The Primal Huntress, "The Incarnation of Agony" (POE I)

Where are we? This forest doesn't appear on our maps. I can't judge our course by the sky, either, for the canopy blocks it out. It does seem to be getting dark, though...

--Lost Etching (POE I)

I didn't trust him at first, but he aided us. Took us to the edge of the wood, but then offered to let us camp with his folk. The night is pitch black. We will take him up on his kindness.

--Aided Etching (POE I)

His words are compelling. In this place, it is difficult to remember our former lives. Time and pain slip away in this endless Wildwood. Why go back to toil and strife? We should stay here, with him, and live free.



--Compelling Etching (POE I)

Always whispering, always muttering... the Wisps are a cacophony that I cannot drown out. How can you not hear them?

--Whispering Etching (POE I)

I will never sleep again. My fellow journeymen lie twisted on the path, their faces forever locked in pale silent screams. She screamed... she screamed! I felt it, in my soul! My fellows... they died in agony... but I had a small dagger, and I... I did the only thing I could, to stop myself from hearing that death knell... I left them there. I cannot go back. Forgive me, my brothers. Forgive me...

--Deafened Etching (POE I)

THE SACRED GROVE

So, you have seen someone's attempt to harvest the four Humors directly. I have seen plots of strange and twisted plants myself. We could achieve mastery over nature *if* we learned proper control, but my science is in its infancy. We would need vast and complex machines, and the risk would be great, but the ambition is a worthy one...

--The Breaker of Oaths, "Strange Harvests" (POE I)

The four humors flow close to the surface in this Wildwood, lifeblood just beneath the skin. Pierce it lightly, and the Draíocht does not react harshly. A properly maintained flow, subtle and gradual, may allow me to accumulate that which I seek.

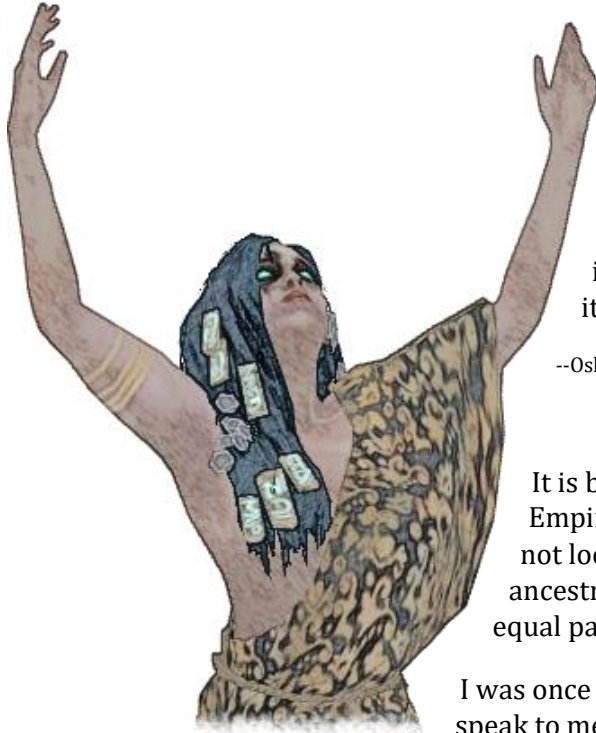
--Experimental Harvest (POE I)

OSHABI & THE LIFEFORCE

I am Oshabi. I was born on this land. I have lived my whole life on this land. I will die on this land. And when that day comes, with its blessing, I hope I will stay dead.

We Azmeri are few, but when the land's whispers grew silent, my brothers and sisters turned their backs on me. ...

--Oshabi, "Introduction" (POE I)



This is the Sacred Grove. I am its warden, and you are its guest. Within its soils lay great secrets. Powerful secrets. You have seen the animating forces of Wraecclast, yes? The dead do not stay dead. The living are shaped and twisted by unseen forces. Here, in this garden, we may peer into the patterns of life. We may separate the monster from its creator, and, if the garden allows, we may wield its creative energies. ...

--Oshabi, "The Sacred Grove" (POE I)

It is beautiful, yes? I believe it to be older than the Eternal Empire. Older than the Vaal? I am not so sure. But it does not look like their work. I like to believe it is a work of my ancestral Azmeri. Carved from the land to serve the land, equal parts monument and penance.

I was once blessed with a deep connection to the land. It would speak to me, and nourish me. But that connection was severed.

And in turn, my tribe severed their connection to me. I was alone. Lost. The land spoke no more... until I found this place.

The garden restored my connection. Strengthened it. I do not hear whispers, but singing.

I wish to honour this place by utilising it to its fullest. ...

--Oshabi, "The Grove" (POE I)

They could not hear the whispers. The Azmeri were deaf to the land, but for me. They did not understand why I took the child, why I offered her to the earth. I felt the land demand a sacrifice. And when they stopped it, that is when the land withdrew. They did not believe that it was necessary. The child's blood would feed countless others with the blessing of fertility.

The Azmeri exiled me. My name to be spoken no more. And with that, I was alone. No tribe, no whispers.

But it was all to lead me to the Grove.

--Oshabi, "Exile from the Azmeri" (POE I)

Something within this Grove has changed. ... It beckons me.

The Lifeforce reshapes that which it touches. Adapts. Improves them. We have seen it. Wielded it. Now I must experience it for myself. I must feel the Lifeforce flow over and through me.

The Grove wills that I act as the next seed... I am to be the ultimate expression of what life can and should be. To be born anew, in Wraeclast's image. The first of my kind. ...

--Oshabi, "Exile from the Azmeri" (POE I)

I am born anew!

Behold, the first daughter of Wraeclast.

--Oshabi, on start of fight (POE I)

... I was wrong. It cannot be controlled.

It must be destroyed. I must be destroyed!

Lifeforce... corruption... it is all the same.

--Oshabi, on start of fight again (POE I)

It isn't the twisted transformative power of corruption that makes it so dangerous. It is its ability to hide in plain sight.

--Sacred Blossom (POE I)

THE ORDER OF THE DJINN



... This dusty pit was once the Forbidden Vault, and I its guardian. That you have not heard of it is not surprising; it was kept in absolute secrecy for countless generations, known only to my *akhara*, the... the Order of the Djinn.

It feels so strange to tell someone. To speak so plainly would have been a sin of the highest order, punishable by death. It seems harsh to an outsider like yourself, but you do not know the importance of what we did...

--Jun Ortoi, "Jun's Secret" (POE I)

My *akhara*, my people, were long ago tasked with protecting the people of Wraeclast from themselves. Many artefacts of great power exist - you have come across some such in your travels. But there are some artefacts whose power is so great that to use them would put the world in

jeopardy. Artefacts like the Horns of Kulemak. We, the Order of the Djinn, existed to keep such power sealed away and secret. Better that the world forget that it, and we, exist, than fight for control of a power they have no hope of controlling.

--Jun Ortoi, "The Forbidden Vault" (POE I)

You have not heard of us because you were never meant to hear of us. ... We came from all walks of life, but we were all orphans, taken in and raised by the Order, and taught never to speak of it under punishment of death. It sounds harsh, I understand, but such was the importance of our duty that a life of solitude and secrecy was necessary.

For hundreds, maybe thousands of years, we remained secret...

--Jun Ortoi, "Order of the Djinn" (POE I)

We are a small but dedicated group. Orphans, only. One from each culture on Wraecclast. ...

--Jado, "Order of the Djinn" (POE II)

The rules of my *akhara* forbid women ever feeling the touch of a man. No families, no loose lips, no loose ends. But it makes no mention of two women...

--Jun Ortoi, "Zana" (POE I)

MEMBERS & RESEARCH

[Note: The following scarabs and their flavour text were removed in 3.23. They've been kept here, for now, as they're still of interest and haven't been contradicted or replaced with other lore.]

Rejected even by the Faridun outcasts, young Sares, you were cursed to walk the white sands until we found you. The Order shall command your penance now.

As you explore the vast well of human darkness, Sares, our Surgeon of the Dead, remember that the price can sometimes exceed the value of knowledge.

There was a man of bone, rotting flesh, and weeping black, but his name, his ill-gotten knowledge, and his role in the Order shall be stricken from memory.

Though the Necromancer of Weeping Black fell in the desert by the hand of Garukhan, his mindless legions remain scattered throughout Wraecclast, with no master to curb their hunger.

--Rusted, Polished, Gilded & Winged Metamorph Scarabs (POE I)

[Note: The following scarabs and their flavour text were removed in 3.24. They've been kept here, for now, as they're still of interest and haven't been contradicted or replaced with other lore.]

As the hordes of bone and blood and foul magic surge across the Vastiri Plains, the scant survivors of our akhara agree to your alliance, ash-scarred Ahkeli. Disorder means death. Order may mean life.

Your golems and your leadership have slowed the tide of death, Clayshaper. The relics of power you bid us find have kept the Vastiri Plains from the brink of oblivion. The defences of the Maraketh will hold.

The Winter of the World has ended at the hands of the Three Sisters. We lay this scarab upon your ancient grave in thanks for your efforts, Honoured Founder. As you hoped, the fate of your people will never befall another.

--Rusted, Polished & Gilded Abyss Scarabs (POE I)

We pulled you from the piled dead, young Ixchel, while your people were going mad with fear. The gods may have vanished, but the Order will watch over you now.

For infiltrating the Priesthood of Yaomac and returning with their sleeping form, Ixchel, we honour you. Your next task must be to infiltrate the Temple of Chaos.

It was our error, Ixchel Godstealer, that led to your fate. Chaos is not asleep, thus not a god, and for your eternal suffering, you have our eternal remorse.

The silent war of shadows and struggle must be set aside. Order and Chaos must ally against the coming tide.

--Rusted, Polished, Gilded & Winged Ultimatum Scarabs (POE I)

Your visions led the Azmeri down into a world left abandoned by the Vaal. They cast you out, young Egrin, but the Order of the Djinn accepts you.

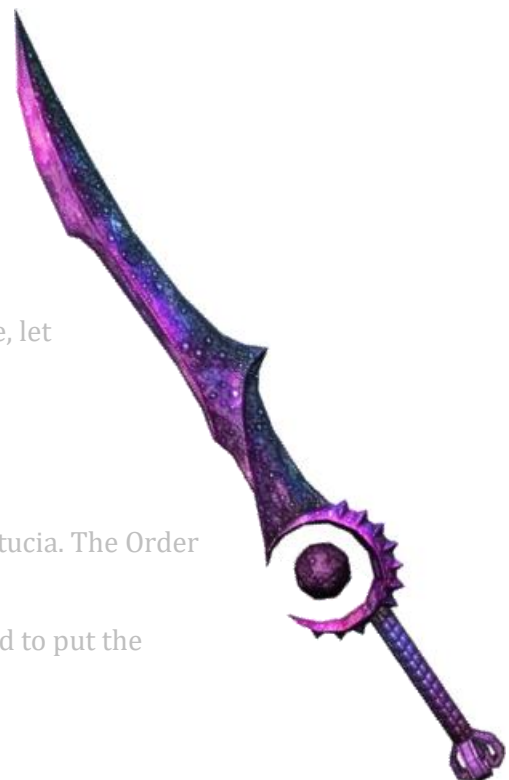
Speaker of unclean truths, Egrin of the Dark Between Stars. We curse you whose soul echoes the madness of the void!

Egrin of the Dark Between Stars, Forger of the Sealing Blade, let your name be redeemed by your unexpected sacrifice.

--Rusted, Polished & Gilded Elder Scarabs (POE I)

Consider yourself an orphaned Eternal no longer, young Betucia. The Order of the Djinn is your family now.

For your loyalty and valour, honoured Betucia, we are proud to put the requisition of dream-artefacts in your capable hands.



Betucia, Bearer of the Sealing Blade, the Order of the Djinn survives because of your sacrifice, but will be forever wounded by your loss.

--Rusted, Polished & Gilded Cartography Scarabs (POE I)

The Peak-dwellers saw you as impure, young Qianga, but the Order of the Djinn sees you as all the stronger for your uniqueness.

Bold dreamer, Qianga of the Stars, she of the Celestial Cold! These titles we bestow upon the one among us whose soul speaks to the ineffable.

Qianga of the Stars, Deliverer of the Sealing Blade to the Watchers, go now, and let your half-dreamt life be troubled by nightmares of achromic hunger no more.

--Rusted, Polished & Gilded Shaper Scarabs (POE I)

The Maraketh left you to die alone in the desert, young Sumei, but we saw the potential in you. The Order of the Djinn is your akhara now.

As the best of our lorekeepers, honoured Sumei, it is now your task to investigate the mysterious duplication of artefacts of power.

Go to your rest now, Sumei, Master Lorekeeper. The Order shall keep contained the terrible secret that burdened your final years.

The books were burned, and the scribes set themselves aflame. What secret so terrible could they have discovered? Though centuries have passed, we must investigate this for ourselves.

--Rusted, Polished, Gilded & Winged Reliquary Scarabs (POE I)

Your people no longer walk this continent, young Revna, but the Order of the Djinn will give you a new home.

As you delve into the mysteries of this world, apprentice Revna, remember to learn from the past, not be consumed by it.

We lay you to rest in the forest deep, Runesmith Revna, so that you may be forever hidden from the stars which so terrified you in your final days. May the secret you took to your grave be lifted from your burdens.

Darkness surges in the shadows of the past. Ancient evils stir. The stars watch, forever aloof, forever menacing. None remain who know the secret, so we are defenseless in the face of the unknown.

--Rusted, Polished, Gilded & Winged Expedition Scarabs (POE I)

You were a casualty of callous Karui warfare, ageless Narumoa, but the Order mended your wounds. You are bound to us now by your own code.

Though your peers fear you, Narumoa, the elders have decided that your second sight is ideal for handling all artefacts that seek to subvert Fate.

Your centuries of service have been invaluable to us, Narumoa. Go now, return to Hinekora, and join your ancient kin in the halls of the dead.

Hinekora has sent the world another herald, but this hatungo walks another path. We are left blinded, and subject to the vagaries of Fate.

--Rusted, Polished, Gilded & Winged Divination Scarabs (POE I)

The Ember-dwellers sought to throw you to their volcanic god, young Omid, but we caught you instead. The Order of the Djinn is your tribe now.

We task you, honoured Omid, with the investigation of this mysterious 'Xoph' and artefacts related to rifts in the boundaries of our world.

Omid, Master Researcher, has left a final commandment upon his death: the world must never know.

The Master Researcher's final commandment has failed. The High Templar has seen the truth of our situation, and the world will be undone by his fear.

--Rusted, Polished, Gilded & Winged Breach Scarabs (POE I)

As the first Brinerot to join the Order, you have much to prove, young Raethan. We are confident you will succeed.

For harnessing and controlling the power of lightning, you, Raethan, are now charged with researching this new energy.



Let him not be called Raethan the Betrayer. His discovery was too important to keep locked away. Now, for good or ill, it is in civilisation's hands.

Madness marches in machine form. Harnessed lightning, grim faces, and cold ambition abounds. Civilisation will be its own undoing.

--Rusted, Polished, Gilded & Winged Sulphite Scarabs (POE I)

Your outlaw camp abandoned you when their surprise attack failed, young Rindwik. Now that you know we exist, we cannot let you go. You have two choices.

Your people were renegades, Rindwik, but you have proven your loyalty. You will lead the martial defence of our expeditions.

Master Warrior Rindwik fell to one opponent alone: old age. Only the greatest soldiers can say as much.

In the absence of a strong martial presence, the renegades rise once more. Their poisons threaten to cloud the land.

--Rusted, Polished, Gilded & Winged Ambush Scarabs (POE I)

Young Tsarsk, you were a broken and forgotten child lying glassy-eyed in a flesh-pit in Trarthus, but the Order found and cleansed you.

Your tortured soul long kept you isolated from your peers, Tsarsk, but has attracted new kindred in kind. You are tasked with appeasing these anguished spirits.

Though you were swallowed by your own darkness, you saved countless others from eternal misery, young Tsarsk. You were not nothing, as you feared.

--Rusted, Polished & Gilded Torment Scarabs (POE I)

Feuding Ezomytes slaughtered your kin, young Agnar, but we pulled you from the flames. The Order of the Djinn is your clan now.

None among us understand the beasts of this world better than you, honoured Agnar. You will root out the mysteries of wild-artefacts.

The Order was your clan in life, Agnar, Beastmaster, but the First Ones call back their favoured son. The gift of their Visions will pass to another.

Without an experienced Beastmaster to find them new realms, the First Ones' ravaging hunt brings them ever closer to Wraecclast.

--Rusted, Polished, Gilded & Winged Bestiary Scarabs (POE I)

Your ancestry has been much maligned by history, young Sarina Titucius, but to the Order of the Djinn, you are born anew.

For deciphering the language of the inscrutable ones, honoured Sarina, we charge you with investigating their intent in our land.

For your valour beyond the Gate, Sarina Titucius, we honour you with the first Gilded Scarab awarded while its recipient still lives. Remain vigilant.

--Rusted, Polished & Gilded Harbinger Scarabs (POE I)

Your faith and our Order are not in opposition, young Eutychus. Let this be the start of a new era of cooperation.

As our hand in the Chamber, we grant you, Deacon Eutychus, access to a domain we lack the resources to explore.

Given the fate of Deacon Eutychus and the men under Cardinal Sanctus Vox, let none dare the Domain, lest they too feed that vile hunger eternal.

As the passage between Wraecclast and the land beyond time's reach is torn open, we stand on the precipice of eternal war. And no one remains to hold us back.

--Rusted, Polished, Gilded & Winged Legion Scarabs (POE I)

We pulled you from the raging ocean, young Dhunan, but we cannot return you to your home. The Order of the Djinn offers you a place on Wraecclast.

For using the techniques of your homeland to contain the fungal plague, honoured Dhunan, you shall lead the war to eliminate it and end the century-cycle of infestation.

Be at rest, Blightmaster Dhunan, on the distant shores of your home. A dangerous expedition, but one worthy for he who gave his life to cleanse Wraecclast.

The fungal plague returns, and its roots have adapted. The undiscovered Blightheart that Dhunan theorised must still exist somewhere, yet none remain with the skill to see to its destruction.

--Rusted, Polished, Gilded & Winged Blight Scarabs (POE I)



THE SCOURGE

Enraged by the incompetence of mortals
The demon-lord opens a gateway
Unleashing a litany of pain upon the world.

--Anathema Moonstone Ring (POE I)

The day the demons found our world, the innocent were first to die. They approach your world, your Wraecclast... They are ravenous. They are endless. They are the Scourge.

--The Last to Die, <https://www.pathofexile.com/scourge> (trailer) (POE I)

They're out there... The demons. They're ravaging and pillaging and consuming all around us, even as we speak. You can't see them yet... but you will. The Blood Crucible will take you to them...

--The Last to Die, "The Blood Crucible" (POE I)

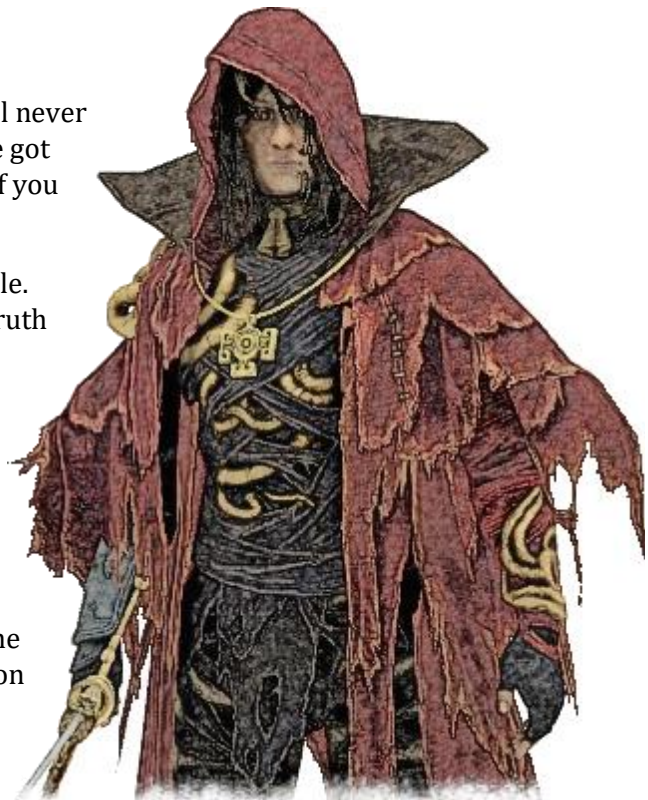
It likes the taste of you. The wound around it will never fully heal, because the Crucible is hungry. You've got to feed it with what you do best: spilling blood. If you don't, it'll thirst for yours.

We are out of time. Go, activate the Blood Crucible. Shift into the Nightmare. Discover the horrible truth for yourself.

--The Last to Die, when the Crucible is installed (POE I)

You see now, don't you? The Scourge are countless in number and infinite in hunger. I've fought them for most of my life, and accomplished nothing except outliving... everyone else. The Crucible is yours now. You must carry on the war...

--The Last to Die, "The Nightmare" (POE I)



The Blood Crucible represents a pact between the entity known as Chaos and the bloodlines of the High Priests of the Vaal, forged long ago in the height of the empire's madness. I am the last of the sole remaining bloodline, so if I die, the Crucible will cease to function. That is why you must continue on in my place.

--The Last to Die, "Chaos" (POE I)

Ah, the Viscera Cauldron. Hold still. I can implant it inside you. Never mind the pain, it's only... making room. Unrelated fact, a person can live a normal life with just one kidney. Or just one lung. You never know what Vaal technology will cost you...

--The Last to Die, "Viscera Cauldron" (POE I)

Countless times, I have seen the works of man reduced to nothing under a colossal tide of horror. Through countless Shifts, I only saw one Wraeclast survive. It was a world dominated by the shade of High Templar Venarius. You don't want to go there, believe me.

We're on our own.

--The Last to Die, "Other Wraecclasts" (POE I)

You would lose all hope if you truly understood.

--Kalandra, at the start of a Beyond encounter (POE I)

She wanders still, forever fleeing, forever burdened by guilt.

--Kalandra, at the end of a Beyond encounter (POE I)

PALE FACTION



The pale demons are blind, but that just makes them more dangerous. They have other ways of finding their victims... they are especially drawn to the smell of fear. They'll still sense you, though, no matter what.

--The Last to Die, "Pale Scourge" (POE I)

Beidat is one of three Demon Lords of the Scourge. The forbidden texts contain very little information about him outside the collected writings of heretics and the visions of blind seers throughout history, but I do know that he and his ilk are the most 'like us,' in that they think, speak, and can communicate. K'tash and Ghorr, the other two Demon Lords, are far too unlike us to ever be capable of making a deal with someone like Lycia... or us. If it was only Beidat, we might possibly

save ourselves by offering Wraeclast as a continent of slaves to serve him, but the other two can never be reasoned with.

--Divinia, "Beidat" (POE I)

"All Beidat desires is a foothold, a grip on your flesh, on the world... he will offer you anything to get it..."

- Rantings of a Templar prisoner, page thirty

--Bursting Decay Unset Ring (POE II)

DEMON FACTION



Those horrific creatures... I look at them and I wonder... what part of them thinks? Some don't have heads. Some are just monstrous claws or mouths... what if they don't think at all? What if something else does the thinking, and they're just drones? Stomping a few ants on the surface does nothing to harm the underground hive...

--The Last to Die, "Demonic Scourge" (POE I)

Very little is known about K'tash and its ilk. All I have is a written record from a madwoman who mysteriously disappeared from a Templar jail cell a few years ago. She said the name K'tash, and she ranted about the demons not thinking, because many don't even have heads, and that something else does the thinking for them. I shudder at the prospect of such impossible beings.

--Divinia, "K'Tash, The Hate Shepherd" (POE I)

"The mind at the center of the swarm... K'Tash does the thinking... but it has only one thought... hate."

- Rantings of a Templar prisoner, page ninety-four

--Death Articulated Ornate Gauntlets (POE II)

FLESH FACTION



They hunger for flesh. That's their primary drive. They do seem capable of thought, but I've never been able to communicate with them. I suppose I wouldn't have much to say to a rabbit if I was starving...

--The Last to Die, "Flesh Scourge" (POE I)

They eat. They consume. That is all that they do. They will not show mercy, and they will never relent.

--Divinia, "Ghorr, The Grasping Maw" (POE I)

"Ghorr knows only hunger, only ravenous feasting. It will consume all that lives, and more!"

- Rantings of a Templar prisoner, page fourteen

--The Gnashing Sash Wide Belt (POE II)

TORMENTED SPIRITS

An era so ingrained with decadence, greed and cruelty that even the graves of murderers were gilded.

--Ashes of the Condemned Strongbox (POE I)

A sprinkle of liquid encouragement is often required to garnish the perfect confession.

- Brutus, Warden of Axiom

--Brutus' Lead Sprinkler Ritual Sceptre (POE I)

The truth lies inside every man, if you dig around. Many a confession was found in the bowels of Axiom.

--The Rat Cage Sharkskin Tunic (POE I)



...the spirits of tormented criminals that yield their ill-gotten gains when slain. Eager to protect their trove, these spirits flee when encountered and imbue nearby monsters with dangerous powers... It's also possible for spirits to possess rare and unique enemies, greatly increasing their threat (and value!) to treasure-seeking exiles. ...

--<https://www.pathofexile.com/forum/view-thread/1111831>

Their spirits are imprisoned, forever harrowed by their own misdeeds.

--Kalandra, at the end of a Torment encounter (POE I)

For nine hundred years, they have had no voice, no hope. Finally, they have found a kindred soul... in you.

--Speaker of the Dead (POE I)

Wraeclast is home to many dangers, but the most invasive has got to be those damned wandering spirits. I've actually been possessed by them, more than once. Oh, it's a strange experience, I'll give you that, but they can be resisted. If it happens to you, ah, I'm sure you'll shake it off... eventually.

--Kirac, "Memory of Self-Possession" (POE I)

THE BROTHERHOOD OF SILENCE

The Brotherhood of Silence has always served my family well.

--Janus Perandus, to Vorici (POE I)

... Yes, we did occasionally employ the Silent Brotherhood to remove the more stubborn obstacles to our commercial endeavours, but for the most part we tended to solve our issues with coin and contract rather than bow and blade. ...

--Cadiro, "The Perandus Family" (POE I)

"I'm a painter, and crimson is my chosen hue."

- Coralito, Brotherhood of Silence

--Bloodplay Stiletto (POE I)

"A master artist takes his time when he's painting. Unfortunately, my kind doesn't often have that luxury."

- Coralito, Brotherhood of Silence

--Haemophilia Serpentscale Gauntlets (POE I)

"What cruelty it is, that to be judged a success, such great work must go uncredited."

- Coralito, Brotherhood of Silence

--Coralito's Signature Diamond Flask (POE I)

"We have methods of interrogation the Inquisitors only dream of."

- Marcus, Brotherhood Liaison

--Abhorrent Interrogation Ambush Mitts (POE I)

"The Brotherhood of Silence does not set out to torture our targets. Excruciating pain is simply a byproduct of certain... necessary methods."

--Blistering Bond Ruby Ring (POE II)

Those members of the Brotherhood who employ the venom of Trarthan ice snakes must take great care with the volatile substance.



--Icefang Orbit Iron Ring (POE I)

Sometimes, we in the Brotherhood don't need to harm anyone at all. We surround Drusus in the Baths. He has a family, and that means he is vulnerable.

He doesn't even protest. He knows what this is. Wordlessly, he backs into the baths and sinks to the bottom. All that remains are the bubbles of his last breath.

--Unknown, State Palace Memory (POE I)

WARBANDS

They have struggled for generations, but have forgotten why.

--Kalandra, at the start of a Warbands encounter (POE I)

I designed the Mutewind so I can offer a few of my behind-the-scenes intentions for them:

I always imagine the reason they're hostile to you is that to them you're no different from the Rogue Exiles - a dangerous criminal made even more so by embracing the dark powers of a corrupted land.

I also intended them to have a very merit-based heirarchy [sic]. Their headgear is made from beasts they've hunted, and if we had the 3D art to show it would probably be personalized for each member. This philosophy is reflected in their succession rite [Mutewind Seal Unset Ring].

The three highest ranking Mutewind members have the most distinctive headgear - each is the result of a legendary hunt.

They also talk about their "bloodline" [Mutewind Whispersteps Serpentscale Boots] being free of corruption, but they aren't all blood relatives. I see it as meaning they consider each other family, in the "once you're in, you're one of us and you've forsaken all of your previous ties" sense.

Disclaimer: The fact this stuff isn't explicitly said in the game means it could be contradicted at a later date, but hopefully it's interesting on its own.

--Dan_GGG, <https://www.pathofexile.com/forum/view-thread/1659337>

For Warbands, the flavour texts for each unique item told you something about the band. The shield was the motto, and the boots spoke of their motivation. The Ring told of their succession method. The Warband Cache's [sic] each talk about the homeland of the respective Warband.

--Qarl, <https://www.pathofexile.com/forum/view-thread/1659337>

REDBLADE



Blood shed is blood shared.

--Redblade Banner Painted Tower Shield (POE I)

The caustic fumes that rise from the caldera kill nearly everything downwind eventually. The Redblade, however, just go mad.

--Redblade Cache Strongbox (POE I)

To ascend to leadership, the child of a Redblade warlord must pull the band from the still-hot ashes of their father.

--Redblade Band Unset Ring (POE I)

Our home was swallowed beneath the great mountain for our complacency. Now we must prove our value to the Molten One by sating his hunger for life.

--Redblade Trampers Ancient Greaves (POE I)

MUTEWIND

Embrace the snow or be buried.

--Mutewind Pennant Enameled Buckler (POE I)

"To scrape the sky, to touch the clouds themselves, is to know true freedom."

- Mutewind saying

--Breath of the Mountains Sapphire Charm (POE II)

Born among the high peaks, many Mutewind live their entire lives in snow and ice.

--Sierran Inheritance Marabout Garb (POE II)

Little makes it across the dry plains to the foot of the mountain alive.
The mountain dwellers ensure nothing reaches the top.

--Mutewind Cache Strongbox (POE I)

When a fallen leader's body is taken to the funeral peak,
those who seek power must ascend together. One returns
with the seal. The rest do not return at all.

--Mutewind Seal Unset Ring (POE I)

Rami waits at the cavern entrance for the passing
aspirants. One at a time he pulls them in from the
snowstorm and covers their mouth as I slice their
throats. Blood stains the cavern floor.

Rami pulls in the last straggler and we make quick work
of her. Just we two remain. Before Rami makes this
realisation I plunge my blade into his eye. I alone will lead the Mutewind.

--Unknown, Glacial Cavern Memory (POE I)



Nineteen more days in the mountains... I'll never survive, never earn my Mutewind name... I'm
already starving and dying after ten... and is that... a wolf?!

Kindest friend, kindred wolf. You kept me warm for nineteen days. I will return one day, when I am
old, and let your descendants feast upon my remains.

--Unknown, Distant Frozen Drift Memory (POE I)

Corruption sweeps across this land, but our bloodline is clear. It is our duty to keep it so.

--Mutewind Whispersteps Serpentscale Boots (POE I)

BRINEROT

Alva: ...Kishara, the greatest treasure hunter of the ancient world! ...

Ranger: Never heard of her.

Alva: Kishara, the Southern Star? The Wayward Gull? Her seventeen children founded the Brinerot
pirate band?

Ranger: Still haven't—wait, *seventeen*? How? When did she even have time?

Alva: She was renowned for manning the helm while pregnant, and giving birth during battles.

Ranger: *Battles*? It happened multiple times?

--Alva Valai, "Kishara's Spoils" (Ranger version) (POE II)

The lords of the sea bow to no one.

--Brinerot Flag Tarnished Spirit Shield (POE I)

The Brinerot sail without fear of storms.

--Brynabas Wide Belt (POE II)

For generations, the gentle Pondium tides sheltered the smugglers, murderers and thieves, and let their resentments and population flourish.

--Brinerot Cache Strongbox (POE I)

Each time, it is granted to the most senior captain of the fleet, and each time, the ring soon washes ashore once more, still wrapped around a severed finger.

--Brinerot Mark Unset Ring (POE I)



"Exiled to the sea; what a joke. I'm more free than I've ever been."

- Captain Weylam "Rot-tooth" Roth of the Black Crest

--Roth's Reach Recurve Bow (POE I)

Those Theopolis fatcats put a price on our heads. Let's see what they'll pay for their own.

--Brinerot Whalers Trapper Boots (POE I)

Think of the worst place ye can imagine. That's Pondium. Now think of the gods-be-damned best whore house you've ever had the pleasure of. That's Pondium. A 'pirate paradise' full of bodies to stab, holes to fill, and devious liquor to imbibe.

Brinerots control the whole island, and make sure it lives up to the lowest of expectations.

Can't imagine much has changed since I was there last. Still, it's a good place to swash your buckle and make love to a bawdy buxom bunter out back of a boozy bar!

--Weylam Roth, "Pondium" (POE I)

"May the lubbers feel fear in their nethers, and may our blades follow."

- Rot-tooth's Rallying Cry

--The Black Flag (POE I)

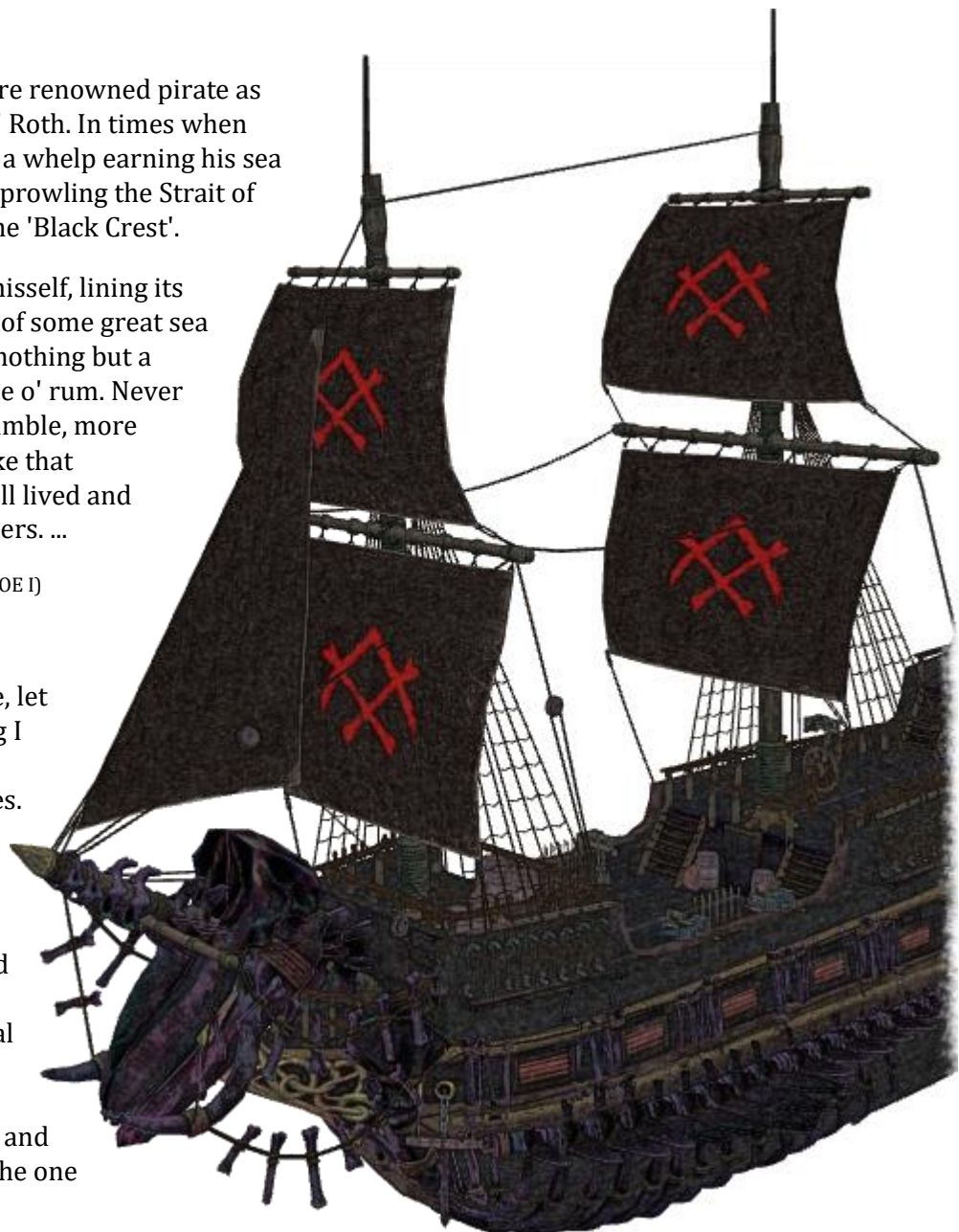
You'll not find a more renowned pirate as Weylam 'Rot Tooth' Roth. In times when Fairgraves was still a whelp earning his sea legs, Rot-tooth was prowling the Strait of Oriath in his ship, the 'Black Crest'.

It's said he build it hisself, lining its hull with the bones of some great sea beast he slew with nothing but a harpoon and a bottle o' rum. Never was there a more nimble, more ferocious vessel. Like that leviathan's spirit still lived and breathed in its timbers. ...

--Bestel, "Weylam Roth" (POE I)

Weylam Roth... here, let me share something I remember from me granddaddy's stories.

No sooner had the others turned in fear from the great, white Leviathan, did Weylam load the ballista with his final harpoon. And right then he vowed, to sea and sky, that he and he alone would be the one



to finally kill this bastard son of the Brine King.

The ballista fired and the harpoon smote that creature right between the ribs as it made to dive back under the angry sea. Thick clouds of blood bloomed beneath the waves, roses flowering in the black water, and impossible though it seemed, the already shadowed ocean grew darker still...

He used the bones of the great beast to reinforce the hull of his ship, the Black Crest. Old Rot-tooth, he's a true legend. A real pirate hero. I can only hope, one day, me own stories will reach his ears and make him proud of the granddaughter he had to leave behind.

--Lilly Roth, "Weylam Roth" (POE I)

Lilly Roth? Granddaughter of the legendary Rot-tooth Roth? Oh, apologies if I seem a little... giddy. It's not any old day you get to meet marine royalty. I mean, you know how I feel about pirates and all, but the Roths have as much in common with those scurvy sea rats as a... as a shark does with a goldfish.

Lilly has her granddaddy's blood in her veins; it's plain for all to see. Look at the lustre in her eyes, the ruddy blush of her skin. That there's a pirate princess, and no mistake.

--Bestel, "Lilly" (POE I)

Aye, them Brinerots be a nasty bunch. Led by me very own flesh and blood. Me baby sister, Lussi! The "Rotmother" they call her now. Used to be that I were their leader, back when the Brinerots were about one thing and one thing only - raiding, pillaging and plundering their scrawny black guts out!

Old Lussi were me first mate for years, but she got a whiff of the power that being Captain could gain her, and mutineered me! Me own sister! Dropped me on some deserted island off the coast of somewhere, the bitch. Took months to make it back to the mainland.

That Brinerot clan's been trouble ever since. Used to have some good old fashioned pirate honour, and now they're raving mad lunatics out for their next fix of fear and fortune.

--Weylam Roth, "The Brinerot Clan" (POE I)

RENEGADES

Be not blinded by the light.

--Broken Faith Archon Kite Shield (POE I)

As if pulled by divine strings, the powerful are drawn to the powerful, breaking any morals and laws that might stand in the way.

--Renegades Cache Strongbox (POE I)

A man who changes his loyalties often, soon
finds he has none.

--The Pariah Unset Ring (POE I)

To fight an enemy on their
lands is a tactical mistake.
Make those lands your
own, and the mistake
becomes theirs.

--Steppan Eard Sorcerer
Boots (POE I)



BREACHES & THE HIVEBORN

There's a place where up is down, where right is wrong, where pleasure is agony, and where the
living wish only for death.

--Burning Blood (POE I)

Our world was dying, but we chose to survive. We broke free from the chains within.

--Controlled Metamorphosis Diamond (POE II)

The curse of a Broken Sun!

--Xesht, on multiflick 2 (POE II)

"They drank until only dust remained. Ate until their gums bled rust. Such was their greed, the only
thing that remains of the Broken Sun... is the Red Pyre, the Torus Eternal."

--Xoph's Pyre (POE II)

"Where life once thrived, now only metal grows, inching like endless worms through the ash. Where
silence fell, now sourceless thought whispers numbers in the dark."

--Esh's Radiance (POE II)

"Countless graves glow silently in endless rows that stretch on unseen. The living lie within, but do not decay, do not die. Their eyes remain open, their essence stilled, waiting."

--Tul's Stillness (POE II)

"The Lords could not breathe, so they grew new lungs. The Lords could not venture, so they grew new skin. The Lords were alone, so they grew us, to serve them."

--Uul-Netol's Embrace (POE II)

The hive buzzes with voices...

--It That Fled, on offering a bargain 1 (POE I)

THE BREACHLORDS

XOPH, DARK EMBERS

Upon the red pyre we are born.

--Xoph's Inception Bone Bow (POE I)

Upon the grey winds his love spreads.

--Xoph's Nuture Citadel Bow (POE I)

Our skin turns to ash and we are swallowed by his brilliant red light.

--The Formless Flame Siege Helmet (POE I)

He burns us to keep us from harm.

--The Formless Inferno Royal Burgonet (POE I)

His is our heart. To its beat we all are driven.

--Xoph's Heart Amber Amulet (POE I)



We are his blood. Through us he carries his burning message.

--Xoph's Blood Amber Amulet (POE I)

ESH, FORKED THOUGHT

She looked upon her reflection and trembled, and shook, until she was not what she saw.

--Esh's Mirror Thorium Spirit Shield (POE I)

She could see what she was not; a silhouette wreathed in light. And she was still.

--Esh's Visage Vaal Spirit Shield (POE I)

When she of many mouths spoke, we bowed in awe and were crushed.

--Voice of the Storm Lapis Amulet (POE I)

But the fool did not bow. The fool stood and questioned. And the fool was unwritten.

--Choir of the Storm Lapis Amulet (POE I)

She carries us and nurtures us until we must feed upon each other.

--Hand of Thought and Motion Blinder (POE I)

She thinks and we act. She acts and we think. Fragments of the whole that washes clean the skies.

--Hand of Wisdom and Action Imperial Claw (POE I)

They whisper in the dark, building towers of mindless thought that seek a hollow truth.

--The Will of Esh Synaptic Ring(POE I)



"Deep in thought, you would tremble the very air before you. Wreathed in light, you nurtured them all. And yet... Your nature became you." The Dreamer mused with aching heart, as remnants of forking tendrils burst forth.

--Guiding Palm of the Mind Shrine Sceptre (POE II)

TUL, CREEPING AVALANCHE

We dance in the white, like water, colliding as many and emerging as one.

--The Snowblind Grace Coronal Leather (POE I)



We share one space, speak one voice, act through one body.
A flawless crystal. Brittle.

--The Perfect Form Zodiac Leather (POE I)

We wait, still as the dead, to join the great avalanche.

--The Halcyon Jade Amulet (POE I)

A single moment sets in motion an eternal fall,
beneath which all are buried.

--The Pandemonius Jade Amulet (POE I)

We remember the stillness. Then the great fall. The pain of separation. We return once more.

--Tulborn Spiraled Wand (POE I)

We fracture and splinter. We pierce our sides. But in the great freeze we are forged anew.

--Tulfall Tornado Wand (POE I)

"With piercing eyes, you saw through the Stillness. Undulating as one, you gloriously covered all in white. But... I can bear you no longer." The Dreamer whispered with fogging breath, ice creeping down his hand.

--Guiding Palm of the Eye Shrine Sceptre (POE II)

UUL-NETOL, UNBURDENED FLESH

We move to be closer to her, but the distance yet grows.

--The Infinite Pursuit Goliath Greaves (POE I)

We leave a trail, that we may know where never we will return.

--The Red Trail Titan Greaves (POE I)

We are within her reach, and when the time is right, she will reach into us.

--The Anticipation Ezomyte Tower Shield (POE I)



Our hearts cry out but are silenced by our flesh
and so we give up our flesh.

--The Surrender Ezomyte Tower Shield (POE I)

We feel the Mother's love and beg
to return to her womb.

--Uul-Netol's Kiss Labrys (POE I)

At last she holds us, and so we turn to dust.

--Uul-Netol's Embrace Vaal Axe (POE I)

The time is nigh. War has come. We dream as one.

--Uul-Netol's Vow Unset Amulet (POE I)

They move and coil, gripped by painful ecstasy, all meaning long since lost to dead-eyed lust.

--The Will of Uul-Netol Organic Ring (POE I)

CHAYULA, WHO DREAMT

The Lord of Chaos dreams as his Eye gazes, unblinking, at his prize. And soon, all shall tremble
before his waking form.

--The Eye of Terror (POE I)

His lucky thralls dream eternal, but we must crawl on our own.

--Severed in Sleep Cutlass (POE I)

They grow fat and ripe in slumber. To be fed upon when he wakes.

--United in Dream Cutlass (POE I)

We happily give our limbs. A net woven to keep safe the bones of the Lords.

--Skin of the Loyal Simple Robe (POE I)

The Lords are chosen so carefully. Only they may grace His flesh.

--Skin of the Lords Simple Robe (POE I)

We crash against Chayula's body, and fall like rain into the place we cannot go.

--The Blue Dream Cobalt Jewel (POE I)

We swell and flood and drown the undeserving beneath our might.

--The Blue Nightmare Cobalt Jewel (POE I)

We climb like vines up Chayula's arms, reaching into the world that should be ours.

--The Green Dream Viridian Jewel (POE I)

We take root in the dirt and strangle those who tread upon it.

--The Green Nightmare Viridian Jewel (POE I)

We flow like blood into Chayula's open mouth, and spill into the land we have watched forever.

--The Red Dream Crimson Jewel (POE I)

We coagulate; a crimson shell that suffocates the unworthy.

--The Red Nightmare Crimson Jewel (POE I)

A dark note drips
from the dreamer's lips,
A honeyed melody.



We stand, we fall
on his beck and call,
for in his dream we're free.

--The Dreamer (POE I)

Among the mysterious Breach Lords, Chayula alone had followers here on Wraeclest...

... and historically, was successfully communicated with—by the Maraketh—on at least one occasion.

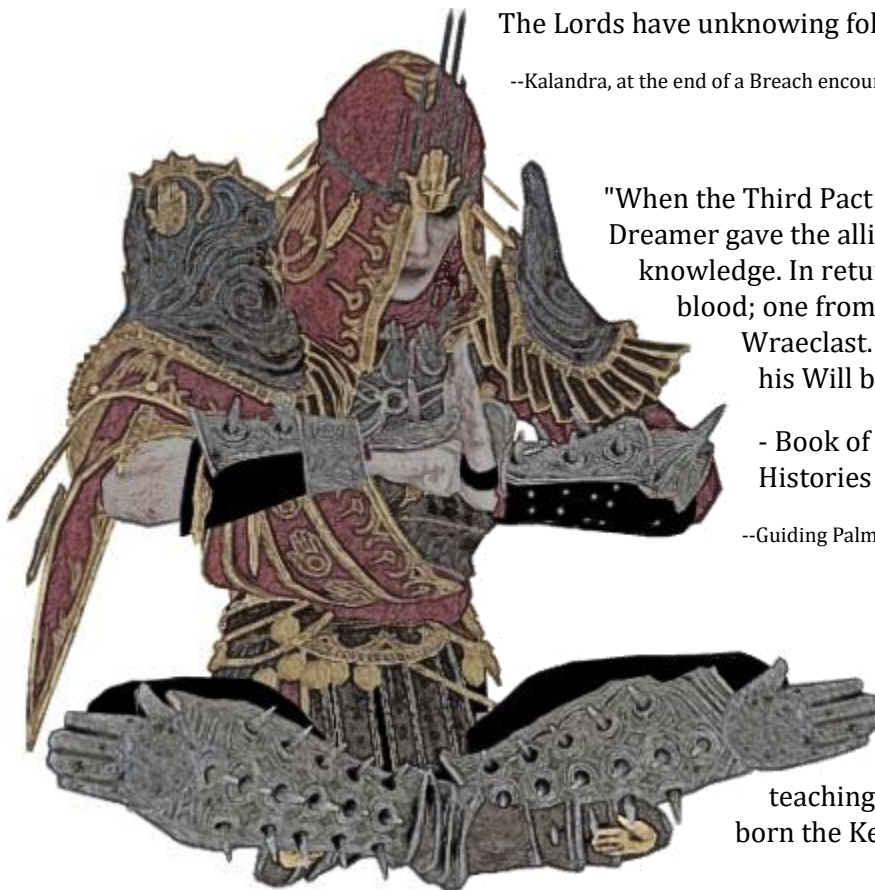
That means, fundamentally, Chayula shares some aspects of thought with us.

He is not a mindless ravager.

We have no idea what his agenda truly is, of course...

--Ketzuli, "Chayula" (POE II)

AILITH & THE KEEPERS OF THE FLAME



The Lords have unknowing followers among your kind.

--Kalandra, at the end of a Breach encounter (POE I)

"When the Third Pact was written in stone, the Dreamer gave the alliance of men and beasts knowledge. In return, they gave him a drop of blood; one from each of the races of Wraeclest. In the centuries that followed, his Will began to subtly change."

- Book of the Benevolent Dreamer, Histories 220:5

--Guiding Palm of the Heart Shrine Sceptre (POE II)

Ailith awoke to find her fire iridescent, and her mind alive with visions. By morning, she began teaching what she'd seen... thus was born the Keepers of the Pale Vision.

--Ailith's Chimes (POE II)

I founded the Keepers of the Flame long ago... The Keepers serve, and are served by, the Benevolent Dreamer. His teachings and gifts keep us on the path of discipline and truth.

--Ailith, "The Monastery" (POE I)

When our minds transcend our mortal coil, the Benevolent Dreamer guides us with visions and portents. Though it is not our only purpose, long has he prepared us for the war against the Hiveborn.

--Ailith, "The Keepers" (POE I)

I live half in dream. To you, that may sound strange, but truth lies beyond the wall of sleep. It is the very foundation of our faith. Dreams are more real to me now than the waking world is to you.

--Ailith, "Visions" (POE I)

BELIEFS OF THE KEEPERS

Those devoted to the Dreamer pursue perfection of the body and the will.

--Seven Teachings Waxed Garb (POE I)

Each initiate hears a bell tolling in their dreams. It is the clarion call of the Benevolent Dreamer. From then on, they dedicate their lives to a singular purpose.

--Dreamer's Knell (POE II)

Their beliefs were born out of otherworldly remnants and strange dreams.

The Cult itself was a fringe element of Vaal society for centuries...

... with its members often getting themselves banished to far-off lands like Trarthus or Phaaryl.

They never quite died out, though, and pushed for legitimacy.

By the... end... they were influential enough to vie for their own chamber in the Temple of Atzoatl.

If their Lord, Chayula, truly has some measure of attachment to Wraeclast...

... then where is he now, in our time of greatest need?

--Ketzuli, on the Cult of the Purple Flame (POE I)

I had a suspicion that the Cult of the Purple Flame was dangerous. They did not know the true nature of the forces they beseeched.

I'm not certain anyone will ever know the breadth of what lies beyond this world... but Chayula alone kept his word, in what little dealings were had. ...

--Doryani, "Cult of the Purple Flame" (POE II)

The truth of your faith threatens to break your very soul... but in that struggle lies power beyond belief.

--Acolyte of Chayula (POE II)

UNITING: XESHT-ULA & XESHT

We moved to be close, yet grew no closer, since the Breaking of the Sun. We clung to the feet of the Lords, wailing, weeping, begging for unity. Now, they heed.

--Hand of the Lords Carnal Mitts (POE I)

"We sometimes fail. We sometimes succeed. Who determines one from the other? I now know we can never be made One, if we are bore of differing desires. And yet, I have hope for a new truth. And I will see it... made real."

- The Benevolent Dreamer

--Palm of the Dreamer Shrine Sceptre(POE II)

It was my understanding that there were five Breach Lords.

Xesht was not one of the names I learned.

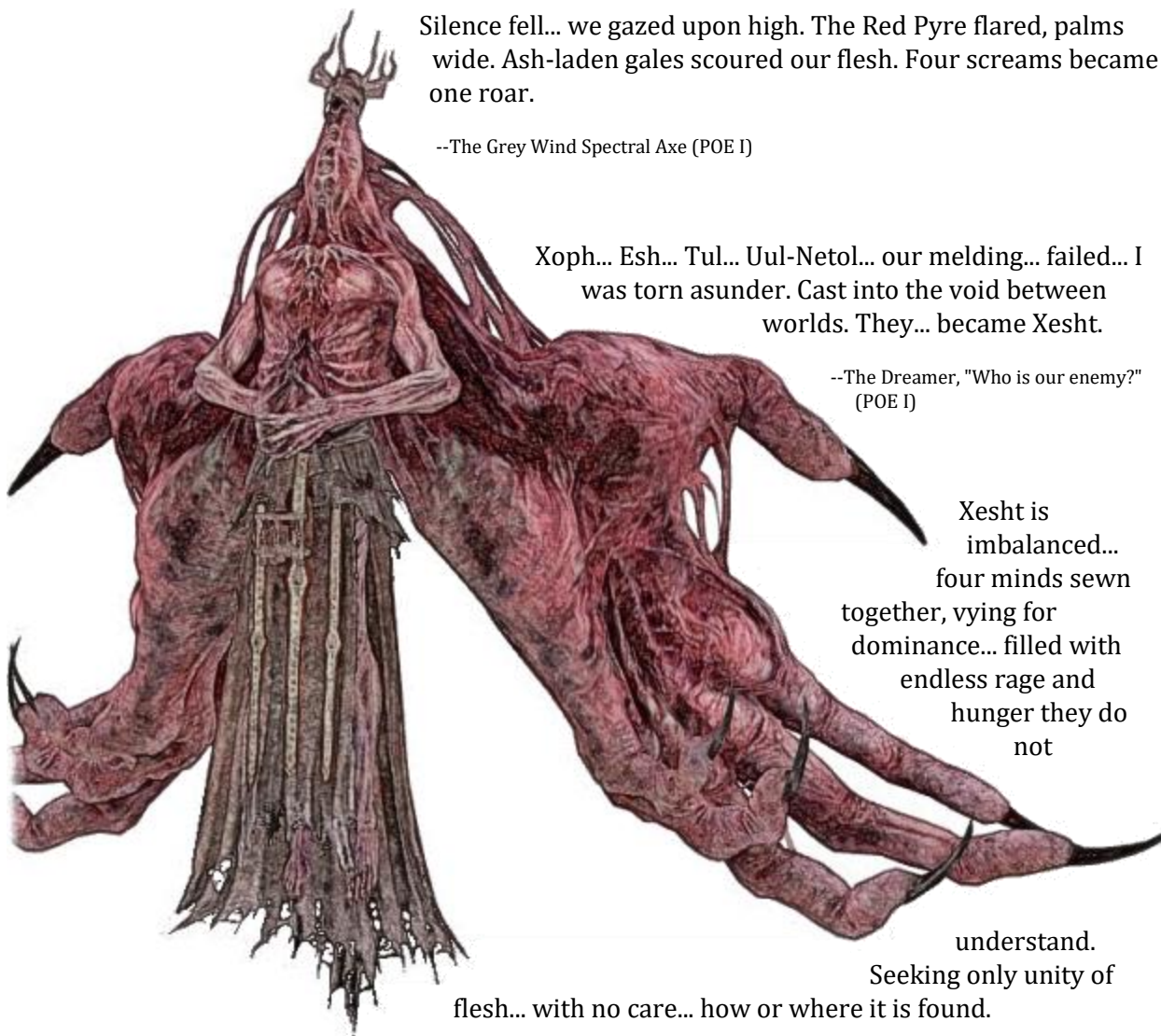
I do know that the Cult of Purple Flame believed... strangely enough...

... that the Breach Lords would one day unite into a single being named Xesht-Ula...

I wonder if they attempted to merge as prophesied, but something went wrong?

The missing factor seems to be Chayula...

--Ketzuli, "Cult of the Purple Flame" (POE II)



Silence fell... we gazed upon high. The Red Pyre flared, palms wide. Ash-laden gales scoured our flesh. Four screams became one roar.

--The Grey Wind Spectral Axe (POE I)

Xoph... Esh... Tul... Uul-Netol... our melding... failed... I was torn asunder. Cast into the void between worlds. They... became Xesht.

--The Dreamer, "Who is our enemy?" (POE I)

Xesht is imbalanced... four minds sewn together, vying for dominance... filled with endless rage and hunger they do not

understand. Seeking only unity of flesh... with no care... how or where it is found.

--The Dreamer, "What does Xesht want?" (POE I)

We share the same fate... the enemy grows near.

--The Dreamer, "Why should I trust you?" (POE I)

INVADING WRAECLAST

In his broken madness, Xesht spills forth the hordes, reaching out to wreak pain and ruination.

--Wraeclast Besieged Breach Precursor Tablet (POE II)

They come from another world... a barren world... and they crave our living land and sky. Our Unbroken Sun. They cannot be allowed to gain a foothold here, or they will poison Wraecclast the same way they poisoned themselves.

--Ailith, "The Hiveborn" (POE I)

The horror is in the name: Hiveborn. They are not brought into this world the way you and I are. They are *gestated* in vast hives, with minds and bodies shaped to serve their masters. I cannot imagine a worse existence.

That is what we will find up there - a swarming nest of drones, their minds built on whatever foul ideas the Breachlords want them to believe.

--Ailith, "The Hive" (POE I)

... Something has changed among the Hiveborn. The species of creature we once knew as the Breach Lords are now subordinate to an entity known as Xesht, as if they put their primary willpower into a collective being.

This event must have been the catalyst for their sudden surge on Wraecclast. They're hungry for something... seeking something... but it's chaotic and frantic, driven by madness. Their disorder may give us an opportunity to destroy them.

--Ailith, "Xesht" (POE I)

The outbreak of Hiveborn worsens! ...

--Ailith, introduction to fort (POE I)

CHAYULA'S REGENERATION

They dream no longer, strive no longer, feel no longer. They dream only of continuing to dream, and know not why.

--The Sundered Will Fugitive Ring (POE I)

All gates are closed. All dreams are silenced. What could have been...

--Lost Unity Formless Ring (POE I)

The Keepers know me... as the Benevolent Dreamer.

The enemy knows me... as the One Who Dreamt.

You... may call me ally... for now.

--The Dreamer, "Who are you?" (POE I)

To exist... to preserve my essence... to endure what looms.

--The Dreamer, "What do you want?" (POE I)

Broken bonds now ache like severed limbs.

--The Dreamer, "How do they know you?" (POE I)

... I must... regenerate. ...

--The Dreamer, "What now?" (POE I)

AILITH'S RESURRECTION

I walked alongside a hooded figure, picking our way along a high ridge. He pointed to the stinking valley below, where vast ribs pulsed with the beat of a mountainous heart. He asked me what I saw.

I told him that I saw half of a body, of sorts. Exposed to the elements. Both terrifying, yet vulnerable. He nodded.

The Mother births flesh, but flesh is weak. It can be burned. Seared away. She wants her children to remain one with her, but children must leave home to thrive. The Dreamer once knew her, before the nightmare she became, but that is only a memory of sorrow. She will try to take our flesh, he warned. We must not let her.

--The Word of the Dreamer, "Visions I, 40: Birth" (POE I)

The Dreamer led me through a great furnace, where slaves shoveled coal into vast flues, their limbs melting, their eyes blind. He pointed to the charnel pits. He asked me what I saw.

I told him that I saw a hunger beyond any other. A need that could never be sated, that could only exist by consuming ever more. He nodded.

The Red Pyre burns hot, but flames are ephemeral. They can be quenched. Doused. Flames can never endure, only spread. The Dreamer once knew him, before his addiction, but that is only a memory of regret. He will try to burn us, he warned. We must not let him.

--The Word of the Dreamer, "Visions II, 18: Flame" (POE I)

Voiceless whispers chattered like bone-dry teeth as the Dreamer led me through a vast labyrinth of metal veins and pulsing arteries. He pointed to the sky, the center, where a crystalline face spun, its eyes hollow, its stark jaw mouthing unheard rantings. He asked me what I saw.

I hesitated. I thought I knew, but did not trust myself. In a world so filled with ghastly flesh, here, then, was a mind without it. He nodded.

The Forked Psyche thinks without will, decides without desire. It drains all motion and life to voice thoughts that no one hears; to decipher truths without meaning. The Dreamer once knew her, before she relinquished her soul, but that is only a memory of despair. She will try to swallow our minds, he warned. We must not let her.

--The Word of the Dreamer, "Visions III, 91: Thought" (POE I)

Weakened from our long journey, the Dreamer sat beside a chilly hollow, one of many, laid out in vast lonely rows. He pointed down, at the being within, silent and still. He asked me what I saw.

Quite fearful now, I took a moment to answer. The aura was unmistakable. This was a graveyard. For the first time, he shook his head.

The Preserved Patterns do not venerate the dead. They live still, eyes open, hands frozen while grasping for freedom from the icy will that holds them in thrall. The Dreamer once knew her, when her heart still held passion, but that is only a memory of loss. She will try to imprison our bodies, he warned. We must not let her.

--The Word of the Dreamer, "Visions IV, 7: Death" (POE I)

Weary now, the Dreamer bade me sit beside him. We had come full circle in my nights spent dreaming, and now sat outside our very own Monastery. He pointed out, at the world beyond, and asked me what I saw.

A verdant, beautiful, living world, I told him. Unspoiled. He nodded.

The Four have become One, he warned. He tried to help them, tried to mitigate the agonies in their souls that drove them like whips at their backs, but they lashed out. Wounded him; cast him into the void. They had purpose before, but now, know only rage and hunger. Their patchwork existence tears at the seams, filling their thoughts with nothing but screams. They will be coming, he warned. We must not let them.

With that, he faltered, lay on the soil, and slept.

When I awoke, I was in that very same spot, and the Genesis Tree had sprouted its first branches, right where the Dreamer lay. It is his gift to us... our armoury against the Hiveborn. We will not fail him.

--The Word of the Dreamer, "Visions V, 104: His Gift" (POE I)

The Genesis Tree was stolen from the enemy, and gifted to us by the Dreamer. The Tree provides everything we need to sustain ourselves and protect this world from the Hiveborn. She is *life*, in its most essential form.

--Ailith, on the Genesis Tree (POE I)

"We must be ready. We are the voice of Wraeclast's vengeance, tolling righteous fury for those who would dare invade our world!"

- Ailith, First of the Keepers

--The Monastery Bell Dream Mace (POE I)

LEARNING THE TRUTH

Ailith, First of the Keepers: They're all... me...

Ailith, First of the Keepers: What... what is this?!

The Dreamer: Ailith. This was never meant for your eyes.

Ailith, First of the Keepers: I am a fool... you've betrayed me! I'm nothing but a Hiveborn abomination, a mindless pawn, like *them*!

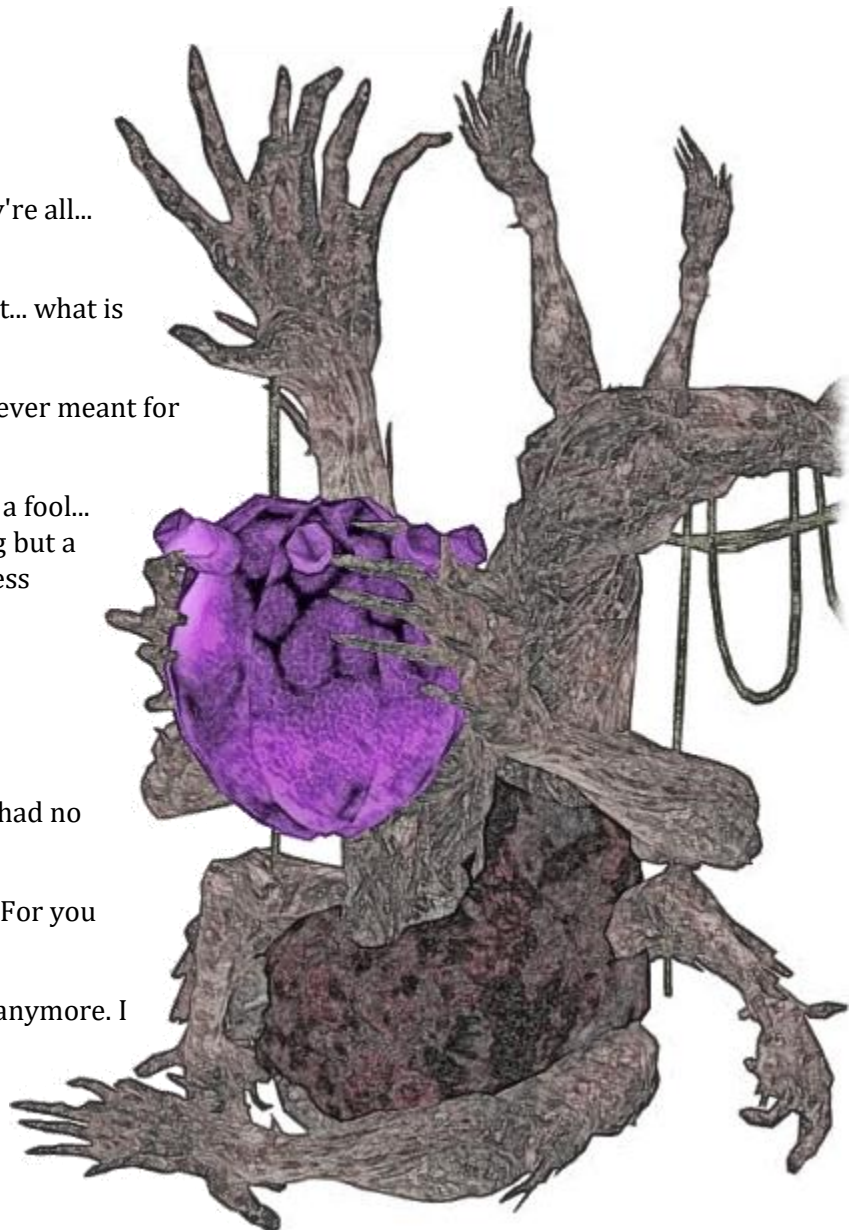
The Dreamer: No. You... are not mindless... you died, long ago. I preserved your essence.

Ailith, First of the Keepers: You had no right!

The Dreamer: I had every right. For you belong to me.

Ailith, First of the Keepers: Not anymore. I reject you. I reject this perverse existence!

The Dreamer: So be it. I revoke my gift.



Ailith, First of the Keepers: I will remember! I *must remember!*

--Ailith & Chayula, back room conversation (POE I)

Ailith, you must...

... remember! You just...

... woke from a dream...

... didn't you? It's all a lie!

...The Dreamer has betrayed us...

... Don't go back...

... to the Monastery. Run while you still can!

--Ailith, to herself via the Strage Flame (POE I)

No.

--Chayula, to Ailith after the Strange Flame (POE I)

... Ailith...must continue her duties here... unburdened by the pain of truth. ... Keep our enemy at bay... and the path we share... shall *remain* clear.

--The Dreamer, "What now?" (POE I)

HARBINGERS

Warriors of a distant land, you embark on a journey from which you may not return, but which we will be all the better for.

--The Landing (POE I)

Their troops came in numbers uncountable and from lands unknown.

--Harbinger Scarab (POE I)

They have journeyed farther than you know.

--Kalandra, at the end of a Harbinger encounter (POE I)



This map contains certain inexplicable entities... They appear to be the advance scouts of an invasion from some unknown realm. ...

--Zana, on a Harbinger mission (POE I)

Ah, the Battle of Phaaryl. My brigade was ordered to attack what our commanders believed to be a minor Harbinger outpost. To put it lightly, they were wrong. It was actually the primary staging ground for the entire invasion. Four thousand men marched onto that battlefield. A week later, when the Oriathan navy arrived to cover our escape, only two hundred of us were still alive. We did our share of damage - you can count on it - but the eager young man that went into that battle emerged disillusioned and weary.

--Kirac, "Memory of Phaaryl" (POE I)

Those bloody blue bastards are trying to gain a foothold on the Atlas. ...

--Kirac, on a Harbinger mission (POE I)

TRARTHUS

... In our era, Trarthus was inhabited by scattered tribes that originally came from the south. They found the slightly warmer climate to their liking... that, and the geological vapours. They were described as quite intoxicating.

--Zelina, "Trarthus" (POE II)

Trarthus was barren after the Vaal Cataclysm... until the Empire began exiling their unwanted to its bleak shores.

"Our ancestors were exiled so that the Eternal Empire could have its thousand-year peace. I don't give a damn about Wraeclast."

--Non-elemental Ranger Noble Mercenary, on Cyaxan 4 & 5 (POE I)

"As decaying Empires are wont to do, the use of exile as a punishment gradually became more common over the centuries..."

The Eternal Empire eventually made their greatest mistake: they exiled a simple farmer to Trarthus.

--Elemental Ranger Noble Mercenary, on Cyaxan 4 & 5 (POE I)

"Slavery began on Trarthus when a simple farmer offered to serve and grow food in exchange for his life. Pathetic... but profitable."

--Strikes Marauder Noble Mercenary, on Keita 5 (POE I)

THE TRARTHAN CODE

"The four Great Founders were not exiles. 'Twas the first Trarthan-born generation, once we actually had a modicum of society going."

--Physical Duelist Noble Mercenary, on Azadi 4 (POE I)

Trarthus was lawless once - but not without rules. Some approached the Death Trades with grace... and surprising decorum.

Before the Merchant Wars. Before the Council. Before Trarthus had a name. There was the Code.

The Trarthan Code was not written - not at first. It was remembered. Passed in whispers, etched in scars.

"Break the Code, and you risked more than your life. You risked your name."

Whether in gutters or along trade routes, the Code took root where laws could not.

House Bardiya were first to back the Code - an early sign of their predilection for order and control.

To House Azadi, the Code wasn't a set of rules. It was a contract. And they never broke contracts.

Cyaxan did not endorse the Code. Not at first. They waited, watched, and once it took hold, claimed they'd backed it all along.

Even House Keita, for all their brutality, bowed to the Code. Not out of respect - but survival.

Even under Council rule, the Code endures - now etched into law.

"Travel to Trarthus is discouraged. Should you go, learn the Code - and honour it." - A Merchant's Guide to Trarthus

"Break the Trarthan Code and you'll likely be buried by someone who didn't." - A Merchant's Guide to Trarthus

"Those under the Great Houses shall answer any blood wager issued." - Trarthan Code, Article V

--Physical Duelist Mercenary, on Azadi 1-14 (POE I)

TRARTHAN CODE

ARTICLE V

Those of the Great Houses shall answer any blood wager issued!

The victor may choose one of three fates for those bested to seize a Trinket [sic], bind them in Employ, or decree Banishment!

All under the Great Houses of Keita, Cyaxan, Bardiya, and Azadi shall uphold this code, or forfeit their standing in the Death Trades.

We, the Leaders of the Houses of Trarthus, bind this article to the Trarthan Code on this, the Fourth Mensis of Korathin's Primacy, sealed in blood and oath.

Ivan Keita Kylian Cyaxan Quilon Bardiya Ratha Azadi

--https://www.reddit.com/r/pathofexile/comments/1l48l5l/wraeclast_welcomes_the_great_houses_of_trarthus/ (POE I)

'A ruckus that is made, may not be unmade.'

- Trarthan Code Appendice XII

--Neon, the Ruckus-Maker, on Keita (POE I)

Though rotten to the bone, Trarthus still shelters those the world cast aside.

--Traps & Mines Shadow Noble Mercenary, on Azadi 1 (POE I)

WAR FOR INDEPENDENCE (870-872 IC)

Once Emperor Tyndarus caught wind of Trarthan warlords setting up a society, he sent his legions to stomp them back down.

The Phrecian legions executed the warlords of that era, and instituted crushing taxes on the budding Trarthan society.

--Physical Conversion Templar Noble Mercenary, on Keita 4 & 5 (POE I)

The four Great Houses were once begrudging allies, fighting a guerilla war against occupying legions.

--Physical Duelist Noble Mercenary, on Azadi 5 (POE I)

"They exiled their undesirables to Trarthus, and then had the gall to act surprised when those undesirables refused to bow down."

"Witches aren't feared in Trarthus. They're adored. We wisely sided with the rebels against Little Tinny Phrecius."

--Chaos Minion Witch Noble Mercenary, on Cyaxan 4 & 5 (POE I)

In 870 IC, the four great Founders spurred their guerrilla rebellion into open warfare against the occupying legions.

--Auras & Minions Templar Noble Mercenary, on Keita 4 (POE I)

When Tyndarus Phrecius tried to resupply his occupying legions on Trarthus, the Karui blockaded the Archipelago.

The Trarthans paid back their debt to the Karui, aiding them when it was their turn to battle the Empire.

--AOE Marauder Noble Mercenary, on Keita 5 & 4 (POE I)

Tyndarus tried to sail reinforcements west, but the Ezomytes burned his ships in the night, and supplied poisoned grain at port.

"Trarthus didn't even ask the Ezomytes to aid them in the uprising. Those beautiful poetic bastards did it all on their own."

--AOE Strike Duelist Noble Mercenary, on Azadi 4 & 5 (POE I)

"Trarthans never forget a debt. When the Ezomytes rebelled against the Empire, even though centuries had passed, we came to their aid."

"Once our debts were paid to the Ezomytes and the Karui, we considered ourselves even. After that... well, might makes right."

--Critical Strikes Shadow Noble Mercenary, on Azadi 4 & 5 (POE I)

It took two years of open warfare, but Tyndarus finally capitulated in exchange for the lives of his legions.

--Auras & Minions Templar Noble Mercenary, on Keita 5 (POE I)

The Eternal Empire stopped exiling people to Trarthus after 872 IC. They began building island prisons closer to home instead.

"The Empire essentially cut contact with Trarthus for five hundred years... until Chitus wanted our powder."

--Scion Noble Mercenary, on Bardiya 4 & 5 (POE I)

"The followers of Light recognize Tyndarus Phrecius as the Emperor. For siding with the rebels, you and your brothers shall be cast out from the true faith, forevermore!"

- High Templar Andronicus, 892 IC

--Hand of Heresy Martyr Gloves (POE I)

"Emperor Tyndarus Phrecius was a fool who let a wasteland full of exiles defy the Empire."

"Trarthus lives on, long after the dying husk of its parent Empire has become nothing but a memory."

--Elemental Witch Noble Mercenary, on Cyaxan 4 & 5 (POE I)

"The moment the four Great Founders actually won their war of independence, tensions began to rise between them."

"The four great Founders were only allies out of necessity. It didn't take much for their hard-won independence to fall apart."

--Traps & Mines Shadow Noble Mercenary, on Azadi 4 & 5 (POE I)

HOUSE KEITA: SLAVES & THE BUILDING OF KORATHIN

"Our new capital will be called Korathin. My slaves will build it. My price is dominion... or blood." - Keita's Proclamation, 872 IC

--Howlcrack Ezomyte Burgonet (POE I)



Trarthan slavers are despicable - and indispensable.

Of all the Trarthan Death Trades, none strip the soul quite like slavery - brutal in both intent and execution.

Trarthus was built on the backs of slaves, whose labour shaped much of its infrastructure. At the whip-hand stood House Keita.

Cruel even by Trarthan standards, House Keita's blend of brutality and efficiency made them ideal architects of the slave trade.

In their prime, Keita built more than cities - they built leverage. For a time, no House dared challenge their hold on Trarthus.

"Pain is the language of obedience." - Ixan Keita

--Strikes Marauder Mercenary, on Keita 1, 2, 15, 4, 5, 14 (POE I)

For centuries, ash from Karui volcanoes rode the wind to Trarthus. It turned slaves into the continent's finest tools.

--Strikes Marauder Noble Mercenary, on Keita 4 (POE I)

In Korathin's slave pits, Keita found its fortune. Death made for eager audiences.

Keitan slaves raised the walls of Korathin. Their blood still clings to the mortar.

House Keita did not always command such fear. It was their crushing of the rebellion that made them a force to be reckoned with.

The slave rebellion began with a whisper. A promise of freedom passed from throat to throat, louder each time.

One night, the chains fell silent. The next, they snapped. Keitans awoke to fire in their camps and blood on their floors.

It took just three days. Three days for Keita to crush the dissidents, reforge the chains, and fill the pits with corpses.

Keita left the rebels hanging, stripped and nameless. Not as martyrs - just meat, gone to waste.

After the revolt, Ixan Keita declared the slaves must be reminded of their place. Thus began the Trarthan slave pits.

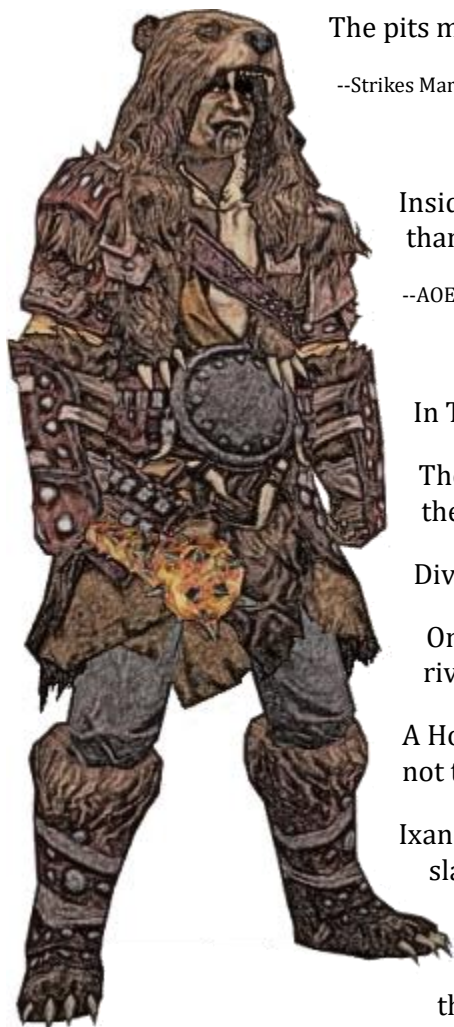
From the ashes of rebellion came the slave pit - dug to remind the living what happened to those who sought freedom.

The slave pits are a reflection of Trarthan society: brutal, bloodthirsty, and swift to punish mistakes.

Keita doesn't fear uprisings anymore. Every lash, every cage, every pit - lessons carved in flesh.

"In Trarthus, freedom is earned, not given."

--AOE Marauder Mercenary, on Keita 1-13 (POE I)



The pits made killers of men... and monsters of those who ran them.

--Strikes Marauder Noble Mercenary, on Keita 3 (POE I)

Inside Trarthus or out, slave or slaver - none bred more enemies than House Keita.

--AOE Marauder Noble Mercenary, on Keita 3 (POE I)

In Trarthus, faith never died. It just turned inward.

The major Houses didn't worship gods. They tried to become them.

Divinity demands belief. Trarthus demanded proof.

One claimed the mantle of flame. Another of blood. But in a city of rival 'gods', none rose above the noise.

A House could rise through war, through gold, through secrets - but not through grace.

Ixan Keita declared himself a god - and built temples to prove it. His slaves were given no choice but to pray.

In his quest for Divinity, Ixan Keita demanded worship. Obedience was beaten in. But no man ever reached godhood through fear alone.

They sang of Ixan Keita, knelt in his hollow shrines... but their hearts spoke only of hate.

Ixan mistook silence for reverence. In truth, not one soul believed. And so he remained just that: a mortal soul.

"Let them hate me, if they must. Even hatred bows to power." - Ixan Keita

They preached in alleyways and taverns. Few listened. Fewer remembered.

Attempts to bring organised religion to Trarthus were many - and all of them met with blood.

Faith is tolerated in Trarthus - but only so long as it is kept to one's self.

Even the pious stray in Trarthus - led not by devils, but by gold and supple skin.

Trarthans revere but one god: the almighty coin.

"If your mission should take you to Trarthus, you'd best carry a knife." - Gospel and Blade

--Physical Conversion Templar Mercenary, on Keita 1-16 (POE I)

In a city built on secrets, faith never stood a chance.

--Physical Conversion Templar Noble Mercenary, on Keita 2 (POE I)

Innocence found no altar in Trarthus. Just one man.

--Auras & Minions Templar Noble Mercenary, on Keita 2 (POE I)

Some foreigners cling to warm memories of Divinity. In Trarthus, that's considered true madness.

Trarthans know Innocence not as a god, but as a tale told by passing missionaries - and quickly forgotten.

"A fire that does not warm, does not feed, does not kill... what use is it in Trarthus?"

Innocence preaches purity. Trarthus breeds survival. The two have little in common.

"When they call Korathin a city of sin, they're not talking about the god."

"Some say there's no honour left in Korathin. Others say it never belonged here to begin with."

A good deed in Trarthus gets you one thing: a target on your back.

"What's a man to do with morals, when no one else plays by them?"

Even in Trarthus, someone buries the bodies. Someone remembers the names.

Some virtues endure - not in law, nor gods, but in spite of both.

The surest way to frighten Ixan Keita was kindness. Always hunting for an angle, he could never see it for what it was.

Keita drew brutes from every corner - sadists, zealots, and worse. What bound them was a taste for cruelty.

--Auras & Minions Templar Mercenary, on Keita 1-13 (POE I)

HOUSE CYAXAN: POISON & PLEASURE



Thaumaturgy in Trarthus is like smoke in the lungs - unpleasant, expected, and always present.

Before vice, before gems, before brothels and powder - Cyaxan dealt in spices, cloth and coin.

"They all started legitimate - even Cyaxan. But virtue doesn't buy power. Vice does."

Cyaxan didn't need blades. They had margins - and the power that comes from knowing what everyone else wanted.

In time, margins thinned. Rivals grew bolder. So Cyaxan found new markets - darker ones.

Cyaxan didn't set out to rule the underworld. Only to survive it. Then survival turned to opportunity.

Kylian Cyaxan's ascent to lord of the Trarthan underworld was not without obstacles. The first arose within his own house.

Kylian's first victim wasn't a member of a rival House - it was family. From then on, betrayal became tradition.

Kylian Cyaxan never raised his voice. Just his glass. The rest of the table never stood again.

With rivals dead or disgraced, Kylian moved fast - consolidating power, ensuring no Cyaxan could rise as he had.

Kylian never trusted alliances. He preferred leverage. Internally, that meant secrets. Externally, sabotage.

"When dining with a Cyaxan, bring an appetite - and an antidote."

Cyaxan rarely availed themselves of House Azadi's services. They preferred less... bloody methods.

--Elemental Witch Mercenary, on Cyaxan 1-14 (POE I)

"Even a lawless land needs rules. Even anarchy requires order." - Kylian Cyaxan

As Cyaxan's criminal empire grew, so too did its need for enforcers. The Trarthan militia was its answer.

Order came later. At first, the Trarthan militia was little more than muscle - sold to the highest house, and drunk on its coin.

The Trarthan militia delivers justice swiftly - usually before a crime is even committed.

"The militia don't keep the peace. They keep Trarthus profitable."

"They weren't just enforcers. They were reminders - of who ruled Korathin's gutters, and what disobedience cost."

For a time, the militia had the slums on lockdown. Then Cyaxan flooded them with gems - and the streets ran red with blood.

Of all Kylian Cyaxan's sins, virtue gems were the most costly. Blinded by greed, he never foresaw the chaos they'd unleash.



Kylian Cyaxan demanded a swift response to the chaos in the streets. The militia answered - virtue gems in hand.

The militia met fire with fire - gems for gems, blood for blood.

With gems came power - and with power came fewer survivors of the militia's 'justice'.

"They called it peace when the killing slowed. Not justice - just fewer people left to fight back... and even fewer who would dare."

--Non-elemental Ranger Mercenary, on Cyaxan 1-12 (POE I)

Gems from Trarthus have their own trademarks. Like the populace, they are more brutal.

Keitan slaves built the walls of Korathin. Kylian Cyaxan filled them with vice before the mortar had dried.

Cyaxan brothels bore no name. But those who entered often forget their own.

First came desire. Then came dependency. Cyaxan offered both - by design.

The courtesans were Cyaxan's first pushers. Pleasure and powder ensured each customer returned - shaking a little more each time.

Most were addicted before they even knew it - such was the potency of Cyaxan's blend.

"In the early days, the drug trade was shared. Then Cyaxan made sharing... unprofitable."

When even dependency began to dull, Kylian Cyaxan sought something stronger - 'virtue' in crystalline form.

While most wielded gems for violence, Kylian Cyaxan saw in them something far more sordid.

The first gem-lit flesh in Trarthus didn't belong to a warrior. It belonged to a courtesan.

Some gems enhanced sensation. Others suppressed it - turning bodies into tools of compliance.

What began as pleasure became ritual. What began as choice became conditioning.

"Kylian Cyaxan is long dead - as are many of his customers. But the thing about that kind of customer? They replenish themselves."

"Brick and stone may hold a city... but pleasure holds a people." - Kylian Cyaxan

--Elemental Ranger Mercenary, on Cyaxan 1-16 (POE I)

Few in Trarthus kill with curses or corpses. But those who do face no fear of retribution.

--Chaos Minion Witch Noble Mercenary, on Cyaxan 3 (POE I)

HOUSE AZADI: KILLING WITH FLAIR

Azadi was last to rise among the major Houses. Where killing was common, no one paid for it - until Azadi cornered the market.

At first, anyone could kill for coin. House Azadi made the kill itself worth paying for.

Independent killers didn't last. Clients knew: hire Azadi, or become their next contract.



"When palms need greasing, you go to House Bardiya. When heads need rolling, you send for House Azadi."

"A masterful blend of audacity and discretion - that's the Azadi trademark. You'll know who made the kill, never who paid for it."

Azadi's true currency wasn't coin. It was reputation. And reputation, once wounded, bled.

Azadi contracts came sealed in wax. To break the seal was to accept the mark - and the consequences of failure.

Each Azadi contract was coded - names obscured, motives buried. But the message was always the same: kill.

Some left trophies. Others left warnings. But all Azadins left a message: the job was done - and the debt had been paid.

"Everyone knows: renege on Azadi, and become their next target."

"To last in House Azadi, you need to be dead inside - or skilled at making others so. Preferably both."

"In Trarthus, life is cheap. We made sure death wasn't." - Ratha Azadi

--Critical Strikes Shadow Mercenary, on Azadi 1-13 (POE I)

Violence has always been common in Trarthus. But it was Ratha Azadi who commodified it - turned it into an art form all her own.

Azadi distinguished itself not through efficiency, but through audacious spectacle. Azadins didn't kill. They wove death itself.

Ratha Azadi understood that killing goes beyond the act itself. Some kills live longer than the killer - but only when done right.

"Anywhere else, you'd kill from the shadows. But this is Trarthus - so we shout murder from the rooftops." - Ratha Azadi



Would-be sadists flocked to House Azadi, seeking kin in their band of killers. But only a select few rose above the chaff.

Among Azadi's best, the mark mattered less than the method. To kill without flair was crude - commonplace.

A name etched in blood is still a name. Many Azadins died trying to earn theirs.

Azadi's finest were known for rivalry as much as skill. On one occasion, both died trying to outdo the other - while their mark fled.

Audacious though they may be, Azadins don't advertise. They let their work speak for itself.

Failure rang loudest of all. A botched kill meant the replacement made an example - of both target and Azadin.

"Anyone can kill. We give death a name, a face, a reputation." - Ratha Azadi

"Those bloody Azadins... Could kill twice the people in half the time if they weren't so obsessed with 'artistry'." - Ixan Keita

--AOE Strike Duelist Mercenary, on Azadi 1-13 (POE I)

Members of the House Azadin are trained from birth to join the family profession. The target changes, but the job's always the same.

--Mercenary's Lot Slink Gloves (POE I)

"No plan. No stealth. I want shock. Awe. I want them to know who did it, and I want them telling tales. That's the only way for us to earn their respect... and their fear."

--Ratha's Assault (POE II)

The children of Korathin don't play in fields. They play in slag.

The fields were quiet. The factories never were. One bred men. The other broke them.

A Trarthan farmer's back bends with harvest. A cityman's with hunger.

To the cityfolk, a broken tool is replaced. To the peasant, it's a week lost.

The fields breed silence. The cities breed noise. Neither understands the other's music.

"Out in the country, a harvest is shared. Here in the city, it's sold - then stolen back."

Korathin's smog doesn't just fill the sky. It seeps behind the eyes.

A thousand chimneys mark the skyline - monuments to what Trarthus built, and what it buried.

No songs are sung in Korathin factories. Just the rhythm of toil and breaking backs.

--Traps & Mines Shadow Mercenary, on Azadi 1-12 (POE I)

THE MERCHANT WARS

The grave insult had to be answered; in a mystic flash, Bardiya crossed the room and struck Cyaxan. Thus began the War of the Great Families.

--Scornflux Satin Slippers (POE I)

"Keita expects an assassination attempt by stealth or subterfuge. I say we attack head-on, like madmen. Let the fates decide." - Azadi, first ancestor of the House Azadin

--Azadi Crest Lacquered Buckler (POE I)

Confident their enemy was defenseless, the Keitans brazenly charged the walls - but Arjun's ammunition supply reports had been... 'inaccurate'... just like everything else Bardiyan.

--Arjun's Medal (POE II)

In the early days of Trarthus, each House kept to its corner. Peace held - not through trust, but through distance.

As each House drifted from legitimacy to vice, conflict was inevitable. Kylian Cyaxan made sure of it.

"They say Kylian Cyaxan was once an upstanding merchant. But then, they say a lot of things."

"To play both sides well is to leave no fingerprints - only consequences." - Kylian Cyaxan

History blames Bardiya and Keita for the Merchant Wars. Fewer recall that Cyaxan was whispering in both ears all along.

As Bardiya and Keita went to war, Kylian Cyaxan stayed neutral - by selling secrets to both sides.

"A Cyaxan will stir the pot, watch it boil, then let others burn their hands - all while they slip out the back door."

"There's coin in war... so long as you're not the one fighting it." - Kylian Cyaxan

The Merchant Wars began with tariffs and treaties. They ended with fire, famine, and grudges that would last a lifetime.

When all was said and done, the Merchant Wars had made fortunes for the few - and graves for the many.

Cyaxan may have lit the fire. But when bodies piled high and profits ran dry, even Kylian sought peace.

The end of the Merchant Wars came not from diplomacy, but depletion. The Houses didn't shake hands - they paused to reload.

No House admits to starting the Merchant Wars. But every House claims to have won them.

--Chaos Minion Witch Mercenary, on Cyaxan 1-13 (POE I)

HOUSE BARDIYA & THE MERCHANT COUNCIL



... It's usually us Bardiya's doing the robbing.

--Scion Mercenary, on losing a rare item 2 (POE I)

Though they would not rule for years, the Bardiya's helped shape Trarthus - quiet power moving behind every deal and coin exchange.

The first Bardiya vault was carved into Korathin's bedrock - long before the city rose above it.

While the Keitans laid stone, the Bardiya's moved coin. One built a city in broad daylight. The other ran it from the shadows.

Before the wars, there was trade. Keitan muscle, Bardiya mind. Neither trusted the other - but both saw profit.

--Scion Mercenary, on Bardiya 2-5 (POE I)

No two Trarthan forefathers were more opposed - in ideology or in temperament - than Ixan Keita and Quilon Bardiya.

Keita and Bardiya's rivalry erupted across Trarthus - supply lines cut, coin vanished, and not a single soldier raised.

Keita demanded tribute. Bardiya and Azadi refused. The result: starvation, sabotage, and blood in the streets of Korathin.

Bardiya won their struggle with Keita. Coin proved more vital to Trarthus than all the slaves Keita could whip into labour.

Bardiya's victory over Keita came at a cost. From that pyrrhic win grew the Merchant Council - cooperative in name, Bardiyian in truth.

House Bardiya remains as its forefather left it: clever, conniving, and always listening.

"A whisper in the right ear is stronger than any army." - Quilon Bardiya

"To rule through fear is to court your own demise. A frightened animal lashes out. A contended one purrs in your lap." - Quilon Bardiya

"Bardiyans are clever, aye - but so ruthlessly self-serving it's a wonder their banquets don't end in blood."

--Scion Mercenary, on Bardiya 6-14 (POE I)

Ixan Keita helped build Trarthus - and nearly ruled it. But power begets ambition, and ambition always demands more.

The ambition of Ixan Keita was his undoing. His bid for power sparked war with Bardiya - a war Keita could not win.

Keita held the chains. Bardiya cut the purse strings. Trarthus watched as labour lost to leverage - and coin won the war.

Keita swore fealty to the Council with a clenched jaw. Better a seat at the table than exile from the game entirely.

Though the Keita of today is still a House of influence, Bardiya remembers their treachery - and limits their power accordingly.

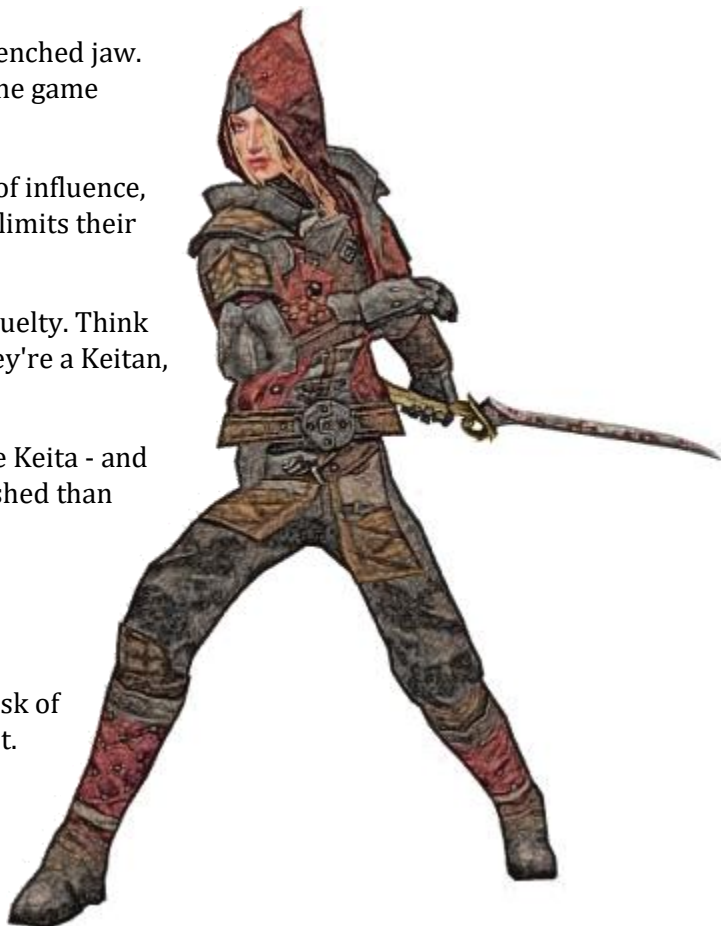
"House Keita wrote the bloody book on cruelty. Think of the worst bastard you know - either they're a Keitan, or a poor imitation."

"The Merchant Council's a leash on House Keita - and the irony ain't lost on 'em. Still, better leashed than buried."

--Strikes Marauder Mercenary, on Keita 6-13 (POE I)

The Merchant Council gave Trarthus a mask of order. Those who can't wear it are cast out.

--Scion Mercenary, on Bardiya 1 (POE I)



Surprised to see a Trarthan in Wraeclast? It's simple. Once the Bardiyans formed their so-called Merchant Council, Trarthus got... boring. Rules. Laws. Bloody taxes, if you can believe it.

Folk like me didn't fit their new vision. Some of us got exiled. Some left before the noose tightened.

Now we're here, plying our trade in a place that still respects strength.

--Tutorial Ranger Mercenary, introduction (POE I)

METAMORPHS & THE INTRINSIC DARKNESS

... I am Tane, a freedman, and I plan to stay that way. ...

--Tane Octavius, "Introduction" (POE I)

In Oriath I served a man named Lucan Octavius; a wealthy alchemist of high-status. I call him my master, for I was both his apprentice and his slave. Lucan's work required handling extremely dangerous, often very hot, materials. Not the sort of thing becoming of a man of stature. So it came to be that a slave like myself learned the nuances of the alchemical arts firsthand.

As for Lucan, he was... not the man he portrayed himself to be. He was more dangerous, more explosive, and more unstable than any material I had to handle. In public, he was fatherly and genial. In his home, he was violent and lustful.

I do not regret what happened to him; only the part I played.

--Tane Octavius, "Tane's Master" (POE I)

What makes you, you, or me, me? Some say it is the soul, an intangible something that exists before we are born and carries on after death. But I have seen souls that walk the land here and show nothing that distinguishes them from the rats and the rhoas.

It is something else. Something no man has discovered. A whisper. A flickering flame that burns through every inch of our being until it is extinguished. But what if we can capture it before it burns away? Bottle it up? Save it, and perhaps, even give it a new wick through which to burn once more?

...

--Tane Octavius, "Pound of Flesh" (POE I)

... Flesh and blood and bone and sinew, all but a veil, a mask that hides what truly drives us. I speak of the Intrinsic Darkness. The base desires and instincts that we all fight, yet rarely defeat. This Darkness hides within us, waiting for a moment of weakness -- a moment when it can take control. A cruel and invisible slave driver.

But we can coax it out...

My master called it Sinner's Water. A concoction he spent much of his life perfecting. He would give it to his children and scribble notes as they beat me. In truth, I do not believe his concoction worked any more than his elixir of immortality, but that did not soften their blows.

His formula was wrong, but his idea was sound. ...

--Tane Octavius, "Pound of Flesh" (POE I)

Further Improvements to the Preserving Fluid

- 4 Parts pure and fine powder of Virtue Gem
- 4 Parts Trarthan Acid, superfluous humidity removed
- 2 Parts Aqueous Umbra, distilled
- 2 Parts Thaumetic Sulphite in its most crystalline form
- 1 Part Voltaxic Sulphite, kept in an ice water bath overnight
- 1 Part Blood (uncoagulated)
- 1 Part Blessed Water of Innocence

Mix the thaumetic sulphite with the virtue dust slowly and carefully, adding the trarthan acid one part at a time until the acid takes on a foul green hue. Wait for the dust to dissolve completely.

Add the aqueous umbra and blood at the same time. Ensure the blood is fresh. Coagulants were the cause of error last time, and the boy has paid for it in kind. Mix quickly to prevent separation of blood and umbra. The ichor will foam with dizzying fumes.

Slowly add the voltaxic sulphite, avoiding contact with the skin. Stir out the impure bodies and skim the top.

Add the blessed water and immediately imbibe.

There are some separately scribbled notes

The subject refuses to open his mouth. I have sent him to fetch the chains. I pray this delay does not spoil the mixture, for it is very time sensitive.

Results:

This part of the page was never completed

--Crumpled Note (POE I)



... One horrible night, my master flew into a great wrath and beat me to the precipice of death itself. For a moment, I envisioned myself walking through strange grey halls.

[Navali] was there, watching me, unblinking, a herald for something far greater...

She was there. She spoke. She said that joining the Halls of the Dead was not my fate that night, but that we would meet again. These are the faded memories of a terrified and traumatized child, perhaps no more than a foolish nightmare, but I cannot stop myself from shivering when she turns her purple eyes my way... because I can tell that she recognises me.

--Tane Octavius, "Navali" (POE I)

... I killed my master. I do not regret that he is dead, only that it was by my hand. My master was a sick man, with dark proclivities. A sickness of the mind that no alchemy could hope to cure. And he passed that sickness onto me.

I was never violent until that day. Until that day, I could not fathom how one man could take the life of another. But Lucan drew out of me an anger I did not know I was capable of experiencing. It overcame me. Forced me out of my own body. And by the time I was in control again, my master was dead.

That anger, that darkness is still in me...

--Tane Octavius, "Exile" (POE I)

To conjure a creature of darkness we use the flesh of the dead. We destroy that flesh, and draw out the ill-will that inhabits it, giving it form. My hope is that, one day, we may do the reverse -- destroy the darkness while leaving the flesh unharmed.

To that end, I've acquired a rare ichor -- there's no other like it in this world. The very essence of a human; for all intents and purposes, its soul. This individual was cruel beyond measure, or so I've heard, though not incapable of kindness. This ichor is robust enough that it might be injected into an entity of equally cruel temperament, and may be given new life.

Now, imagine if we could then destroy the darkness. Could this cruel soul be purified? Could it be brought back, not only from the dead, but from the precipice of damnation?

That is my true goal.

--Tane Octavius, "Vision" (POE I)

...and that's just the beginning. I'll never tire of watching them slaughter you. I hope you can feel every cut. Every burn. I hope it haunts every moment of your pathetic existence.

...it kills you to see me free, doesn't it? It kills you to know you have no power over me any more. I'm in control of both of our destinies.

...and what's left of your legacy? Nothing but a few stains on the floor. All your work was for nothing, and I couldn't be happier about it.

...you hear me old man? I'm never going to let you rest. Never.

--Tane Octavius, when alone (POE I)

Intrinsic Darkness is merely a shadow cast by the light of the soul.

--Kalandra, at the start of a Metamorph encounter (POE I)

OTHER LORE

GIANTS

Through droughts, fires, floods and frost, the ancient giants stand resolute, while deep in the rich, dark earth, their grasp stretches ever farther.

--Arborix Assassin Bow (POE I)

The monstrous men of yore used bows too, theirs were just bigger.

--Giantsbane Bronze Gauntlets (POE I)

Legend tells of bows so powerful that only giants could draw them back.

--Iron Grip (POE I)

Of ancient giants, none remain,
Their only trace is timeless pain.

--Hrimsorrow Goathide Gloves (POE I)

Giant's blood you cannot tame,
as wild as an unwatched flame.

--Hrimburn Goathide Gloves (POE I)

BASILISKS

Basilisk Acid drips from the hearts of those venomous monsters, though I cannot blame them for their disposition.

They are tragic creatures. There is a sorry tale more closely tied to my own than I care to dwell upon. Alas, the forging of my Dark Ember produced some rather unfortunate byproducts.

But we shall not see any success if I am to dwell on those past errors.

--Sin, "Chimeric Acid" (POE I)

Nobility once thought to capture the Basilisks and keep them as exotic pets. This only served to fatten the vileness of their hearts, and with a hateful acid that festered inside, the creatures became soured to their very bones.

--Basilisk Acid (POE I)



BEREK & THE UNTAMED

"She begged the Earth to spare her Son;
Out of love the Earth agreed.
To the other Elements she did not speak
And out of spite They plotted."

- Berek and the Untamed

--Immortal Flesh Leather Belt (POE I)

"Berek hid from Storm's lightning wrath
In the embrace of oblivious Frost
Repelled by ice, blinded by blizzards
Storm raged in vain
While Berek slept."

- Berek and the Untamed

--Berek's Grip Two-Stone Ring (POE I)

"From Frost's ice-bound pass
Berek taunted and jeered
Until furious Flame scaled the mountain
Berek escaped through the thaw
And Frost's tortured moans."

- Berek and the Untamed

--Berek's Pass Two-Stone Ring (POE I)

"With Flame licking at his heels
Berek berated the clouds
Until vengeful Storm spewed forth his rains
And Berek held on tight
As Fire screamed and steamed
And fled."

- Berek and the Untamed

--Berek's Respite Two-Stone Ring (POE I)

"Moon after moon did Berek make fools
Of the great and Untamed Three
Until malice for a Brother
Slew the hatred of the Other
And Berek did hunt
Alone and free."

- Berek and the Untamed

--The Taming Prismatic Ring (POE I)

THE QUEEN OF THE FOREST

The nobles wanted to take her throne.
She let the peasants take their wealth.
The peasants wanted to take her wealth.
She let the soldiers take their heads.
The soldiers wanted to take her head.

She sat on her throne and wept.

--Queen's Decree Ornate Sword (POE I)

The soldiers stormed her throne room.
The guards held them at bay.
The peasants overwhelmed the guards.
The nobles paid for their lives.
The nobles took her throne,
and so she fled to the woods.

--Queen's Escape Ornate Sword (POE I)

Shedding away her regal past,
she forged a new destiny.
Sacrificing the ephemeral joys of man,
she embraced the eternal grasp of nature.
Seizing her one true wish,
she found peace at last.

--Queen of the Forest Destiny Leather (POE I)



APPENDIX A: DETAILED TIMELINE

The following is a general timeline of events. In many places the timeline is unclear. Events listed within the same era may not be in order or may have happened simultaneously.

ANTIQUITY

- Kalandra arrives in a hot and lifeless Wraecclast, encounters a strange Lake, and becomes trapped
- The Titans appear and bring primordial fire to Wraecclast
- The Precursors appear and create towers that can alter terrain and biomes
- The Precursors enact three "edicts"; the Seed of Corruption is created plus a weapon to destroy it
- The Precursors create the guardian of the Flame Seed, a.k.a. the Arbiter of Ash
- Early human races appear, including the Azmeri, Primevals, Maraketh, Karui, and others
- The Redblades overrun the mountain where the Titans dwell but are ignored
- ca. 4460 BIC: The Maraketh live in the lush Vastiri Plains as a simple people of hunter-gatherers
- The Maraketh city of Keth is established at the intersection of seven rivers
- The Karui exist as a peaceful seafaring culture of farmers and fisherman
- The First Ones roam the world and are possibly revered by the Ezomytes
- The Lightless are created, led by Kulemak; he tries to conquer the world but is defeated
- The Primevals establish a home in a new land after a life-long journey; Uzaza is their first king
- The Primeval king Putembo is overthrown by a slave named Aul; Aul becomes their last king

THE ERA OF DESPAIR

- The skies of Wraecclast fill with fire, covering the entire continent
- The Precursor civilisation is buried beneath the surface; they leave behind instructions for completing the Instrument of the Third Edict (a weapon to destroy the Seed of Corruption)
- Ash blots out the sun, leaving Wraecclast in darkness, winter, and famine for a thousand years
- Gods gradually begin to appear in Wraecclast as humans ascend
- A boy tells a lie that destroys his (unknown) civilization; he becomes the trickster god Tangmazu
- Maxarius founds the Templars and becomes Innocence; his brother unwillingly ascends to godhood as Sin; the Templars are expelled from the Azmerian Ranges and resettle in Oriath
- Kulemak deceives Aul and the Lightless attack; the Primeval civilisation is destroyed
- The Lightless flood out across Wraecclast; Kulemak ascends to godhood (if not earlier)
- Ahkeli, a Primeval woman, flees her crumbling home and allies with the Maraketh

- (Per defunct lore, Ahkeli founds the Order of the Djinn to collect relics of power)
- The Azmeri Draíocht creates the Viridian Wildwood as a haven against the Winter
- Gruthkul is Named in the Wildwood and comes into existence; she later ascends to godhood
- The King in the Mists and other Nameless are Named; the affliction of the Wildwood begins
- The Karui gods arise and Tukohama unites the tribes; the Karui Way is created
- The Third Pact is created in the Vastiri, uniting the Maraketh, Sun Clan (hyena people), Kabala Clan (serpent people), Titans, golems, Chayula, and possibly others against the Lightless
- The Keepers of the Flame are possibly established around this time
- Maraketh culture evolves into one that is strict and brutal to survive the Winter and the Lightless
- The groups of outcasts later known as the Faridun may arise at this time
- The Trial of the Sekhemas is created by Varashta and Zarokh, who then trap each other within it
- After centuries of war, Kulemak is defeated and Sin steals his Divine spark
- The twin sister *sekhemas* Solerai and Lundara unite the scattered Maraketh tribes for the first time; they use "the essence of gold and silver" to clear the skies and end the Winter (per defunct lore, a third sister is involved as well); the Lightless retreat underground

THE AGE OF GODS & HEROES

- Wraecast heals and becomes verdant again; a new age begins that lasts a thousand years
- New gods continue to appear in the various cultures of Wraecast as more humans ascend
- Different cultures share a story of sister goddesses who go to war with each other after being deceived by a trickster, which may refer to the same people with different names: Solaris & Lunaris, Solerai & Lundara, Sione & Lani Hua, the Catha & the Mórrigan; the trickster (Tangmazu) is imprisoned by the Karui; some believe the war is a ruse or misinterpretation
- Hinekora creates the Halls of the Dead; the Trial of the Ancestors is later established
- Kitava is imprisoned by Hinekora
- The Watchers of Decay are founded to stop The Elder from preying on the children of Wraecast
- A golden age begins for the Maraketh and Keth becomes the hub of an empire fueled by trade
- Balbala betrays her *akhara* and is imprisoned as a Djinn
- The Vastiri gradually desertifies, causing the Maraketh empire to wane
- Orbala goes on eight famous adventures, defeats the necromancer Saresh, becomes the Sekhema of Sekhemas, frees Sin from Innocence (probably), and ascends to godhood as Garukhan
- Garukhan and Sin have a daughter, Shakari; eventually Sin believes they've become twisted by Divinity and he and Garukhan split up
- Sin feels humans have become pawns under the domination of petty, tyrannical gods; in his search for a solution, Hinekora directs him to Kalandra; he plants the Seed of Corruption in a mountain
- Sin visits the Vaal goddess Arakaali as an emissary for an alliance of weaker gods; he remains trapped by her for years until the gods succumb to the Beast born from the Seed of Corruption

THE TIME OF THE BEAST UNTIL THE FOUNDING OF THE ETERNAL EMPIRE

- The gods in Wraecclast, Oriath, and Ngamakanui go to sleep under the Beast's influence
- The Beast is discovered to be a source of immense power and over a period of "aeons" various groups attempt to tap into it, resulting each time in a disaster and countless deaths
- Virtue Gems, a byproduct of the Beast, are produced within the mountain
- The Titans ally with the Redblades against a hostile threat (possibly the Lightless, who still dwell underground) and forge weapons for them, including one to hold the first unearthed Virtue Gem
- The Redblades fail to stop the threat and only one Titan survives
- (Per defunct lore, a Vaal man named Ixchel kidnaps the sleeping god Yaomac; Ixchel then attempts to kidnap Chaos, but finds Chaos awake and is pressed into Chaos' service as the Trialmaster; the Trial of Chaos may have been established at this time, unless there was a previous Trialmaster)
- With the waning of the Maraketh, the Vaal establish themselves as the dominant empire in Wraecclast and operate as peacekeepers amongst the different cultures
- The Vaal discover Virtue Gems and begin implanting them in their flesh
- ca. 900 BIC: The Vaal contact the primitive Azmeri and share their knowledge with them
- ca. 400 BIC: Atziri becomes queen of the Vaal
- The Temple of Atzoatl is built; its construction is plagued by the Demon of Atzoatl (POE player)
- 400 BIC: The POE II player appears in Utzaal, is mistaken for the Demon of Atzoatl, and attacked; Viper Napuatzi is defeated and vanishes into the Domain of Timeless Conflict; Doryani disappears into the future with the POE II player; both return to the past to stop Atziri, but fail
- 400 BIC: Atziri communes with the Beast, hoping to achieve immortality, but the result is a disaster that wipes out the Vaal civilisation and leaves Wraecclast twisted with corruption
- The Vaal city of Utzaal is intentionally flooded, trapping many inside who devolve into cannibalistic savages over generations; some of the Vaal escape and integrate with the Azmeri; primitive tribes (possibly some of them Vaal survivors) arise in the former Vaal lands
- The Kalguur see signs of the Fall of the Vaal all the way in the continent of Middengard; this is taken as an omen, and an expedition is sent to Wraecclast to investigate and colonise the area
- After years of struggle against Wraecclast's corruption, the Kalguuran colonies are abandoned
- Four rulers from unknown groups unite to seek power and immortality and escape Wraecclast's corruption, becoming known as the Pale Council; they escape into another realm
- Jamanra unites the Faridun and attempts to legitimize them in the eyes of the Maraketh, but fails

THE REIGN OF THE ETERNAL EMPIRE

- 1 IC: Tarcus Veruso leads 80,000 Azmeri down from the mountains and founds the Eternal Empire
- The early empire is troubled by the remnants of Wraecclast's corruption, but the corruption is vanquished and the empire secured; Virtue Gems are outlawed
- 35 IC: Alano Phrecia becomes emperor and his descendants rule the empire until Chitus
- (Per defunct lore, The Elder is sealed in the dreamlands by the Watchers of Decay about here)

- ca. 334 IC: During the reign of Emperor Romira, the capital (Sarn) burns in an event known as the Night of a Thousand Ribbons; it's later rebuilt
- (Per defunct lore, the Order of the Djinn establishes a truce with the Harbingers about here)
- ca. 700 IC: The last speaker of the dead dies, leaving Tormented Spirits without a voice
- 870-872 IC: Trarthus, having been occupied by the empire, fights for independence and wins; the Trarthan capital of Korathin is built
- 1132 IC: The Ezomytes establish Ogham County in Phaaryl as their home, having been driven there by corruption and darkness in "a time of chaos and terror"
- 1317 IC: Emperor Izaro, being infertile, opens the Labyrinth as a trial to select the next emperor
- 1318 IC: Chitus Perandus successfully navigates the Labyrinth with the help of various intrigues; he is crowned emperor the next year and locks Izaro in the labyrinth
- Chitus aggressively expands the empire
- The Vastiri Plains are invaded and conquered; Asenath unites the Maraketh tribes once again and becomes the Sekhema of Sekhemas, but is defeated and killed
- Skothe, king of Ezomyr, submits to Chitus and allows Ezomyr to be occupied and enslaved
- Ships invade Karui islands and bring people back to be sold as slaves
- Chitus legalizes Virtue Gems and his thaumaturgist Malachai begins implanting them in people
- Discontent rises inside and outside the empire due to the poor conditions for the common people, the conquering and enslavement of neighboring areas, and moral opposition to the use of the gems

THE PURITY REBELLION AND THE FALL OF THE EMPIRE

- Anticipating a rebellion, Cadiro empties the kingdom's treasury and hides it around Wraeclast
- 1332 IC: War breaks out in an insurrection known as the Purity Rebellion
- 1332 IC: Kaom of the Karui is recruited to the cause; he unifies the Karui tribes and successfully invades southern Wraeclast; Kaom declares himself king of a new Karui kingdom in Wraeclast; the Karui blockade the island of Oriath, planning to invade
- 1332 IC: General Lioneye is supposedly beheaded by Kaom and his skull worn on Kaom's belt, though an intact Lioneye is later found in the Domain of Timeless Conflict
- 1333 IC: Deshret of the Maraketh is recruited to the cause and takes back the Vastiri Plains
- 1333 IC: Rigwald of the Ezomytes kills King Skothe for bowing to Chitus and joins the rebellion, freeing Ezomyr; the Ezomytes in Ogham also expell the Eternals, possibly around the same time
- 1333 IC: The combined forces of the Karui, Maraketh, Ezomytes, and others lay siege to Sarn
- 1334 IC: Emperor Chitus is assassinated during a celebration and the rebellion ends; High Templar Voll, leader of the Purity Rebellion forces, is crowned emperor
- Malachai claims he can destroy the Beast and thus erase thaumaturgy from the empire, so is spared by Voll; instead he betrays Voll and enters the mountain to tap into the Beast's power
- 1336 IC: Malachai uses the Beast's power to initiate the Cataclysm, wiping out the empire and its citizens and beginning to again transform Wraeclast into a corrupt and twisted land

THE CATAclySM

- 1336 IC: Wraecclast is plagued by black storms, the dead rise, the animals become savage and bloodthirsty, and the inhabitants suffer nightmares and disease
- Cadiro, having made a pact with Prospero, spends his immortality searching for the caches of the treasury that he'd hidden and then lost
- The Arimor family plots to restore the empire, an effort which continues to present day
- Rigwald, having been granted power by the Greatwolf during the rebellion, leaves his people to prevent himself from hunting them and instead searches for druidic talismans of the First Ones
- The plague that wipes out Ezomyr likely happens at this time
- 1336 IC: Inspired by a dream, Kaom leads five hundred warriors north and into the Highgate mines where Malachai and the Beast reside, but goes mad and slaughters his own men
- When Kaom and his men don't return, his niece Hyrri takes the role of queen and leads the remaining Karui in Wraecclast back to Ngamakanui
- Queen Hyrri later leads an army "to deal with a strange threat on the edge of Ngamakanui," but they become trapped in the Domain of Timeless Conflict and never return
- Queen Ahuana, Hyrri's daughter, dissolves the monarchy and establishes a council of chieftains to rule the still-united Karui tribes; some form of this council remains in present day
- ca. 1356 IC: Deshret goes to Highgate, seals the entrance, and charges her *akhara* with guarding it
- Deshret is killed by Voll, who has been twisted into a monster and still remains outside Highgate with his men; he keeps her banner; her soul becomes trapped in the mines

THE RISE AND FALL OF ORIATH

- 1336 IC: The Cataclysm doesn't affect the island of Oriath, which becomes a theocracy ruled by the Templars after the fall of the Eternal Empire
- Lycia makes a pact with the Scourge demon Beidat for immortality and begins luring adventurers into the Sanctum for entertainment (may have happened earlier)
- ca. 1450 IC: Daresso gives Merveil the Star of Wraecclast and they marry; she turns into a sea monster and flees to Wraecclast, where she lures sailors to their deaths to feed her horde of children
- Daresso leaves in search of a cure, but winds up as a thrall of Malachai's Nightmare like Kaom
- Weylam Roth tries to revive his fading reputation by slaying Merveil, but is eaten alive by her
- ca. 1568 IC: Sigmund Fairgraves disappears after setting sail for Wraecclast
- High Templar Venarius orders Valdo Caeserius to repair a mysterious device found in Wraecclast; the device opens a portal to the dreamlands
- 1579 IC: Venarius frees The Elder and it feeds on his memories; Valdo traps himself in the dreamlands with The Elder to fight it, becoming the Shaper
- 1579 IC: Dominus replaces Venarius as high templar; he begins exiling undesirables to Wraecclast, where they are captured and experimented on by Piety

- An unknown group of researchers works to duplicate unique items; their research results in a catastrophe that cracks the sky and their outposts are abandoned (may have happened earlier)
- A rebellion occurs in Kalguur but fails; a group of Kalguurans flee to Wraeclast, ostensibly seeking answers to what happened during their earlier colonisation; their outpost grows into Kingsmarch
- ca. 1599 IC: Catarina orchestrates the destruction of the Order of the Djinn and creates the Immortal Syndicate to establish a new government in Wraeclast, but is later killed
- 1599 IC: The POE player is exiled and the events of POE begin
- 1599 IC: Venarius gets free of The Elder and wanders Wraeclast as an amnesiac spirit, calling himself Cavas; he discovers a place called the Memory Nexus
- Venarius regains his memory and finds he now has the power to change people's memories; he attempts to use this to manipulate them to unite under his rule and fight a demonic threat
- 1599 IC: A woman known as The Last to Die (probably an alternate Alva) appears in Wraeclast, saying there are many alternate Wraeclasts and all are being taken over by the demonic Scourge; so far only one Wraeclast has survived, but it is ruled by Venarius and "you don't want to go there"
- 1600 IC: Kitava is defeated; rebuilding Oriath begins; the POE player sails off for a holiday

AFTER THE FALL OF ORIATH

- 1600 IC: Innocence goes into exile in the south; Sin goes into hiding with the Seed of Corruption
- 1600 IC: Zana Caeserius recruits former exiles to search the Atlas for her father Valdo; they defeat The Elder but one of them, Sirus, is lost; other eldritch entities begin to appear in the Atlas
- Sirus reappears, now insane, and Oriath is destroyed a second time; most of the residents flee and are taken in by the Karui on an island south of Wraeclast
- 1601 IC: The POE player arrives at the island; POE endgame (investigating the Atlas) begins
- The Twilight Order, having remained behind in Oriath, emerges from secrecy and rebuilds
- Oriana discovers the existence of the Seed of Corruption and devises a plan; she travels to the Vastiri and forms an alliance with the Faridun
- Oriana travels to Ogham, marries Count Geonor, and begins to manipulate him
- 1619 IC: The Seed of Corruption is stolen from Sin by Geonor's forces; the events of POE II begin

APPENDIX B: CHARACTERS

PRECURSORS

Currently no named Precursors are known.

PRIMEVALS

Uzaza, the First King: a man who helped his people find a place to settle after a life-long journey, and helped them get fish out of a frozen river to live on.

Putembo: a king and tyrant who used slaves to quarry stone for his fortress.

Aul, a.k.a. Ahn, the Last King: a slave who was made to quarry stone for Putembo's fortress. He eventually overthrew Putembo and became king himself, and was crowned Ahn. He was renowned for his leadership, as well as being fearless, ferocious and a tactical genius. However, he was also known for being a tyrant. During the Winter of the World, his citadel was attacked by possessed golems. He enacted a ritual that caused azurite to grow throughout the citadel, and he became known as the Crystal King. He remains there, buried deep underground.

Ahkeli: (see The Order of the Djinn.)

MARAKETH

ANTIQUITY

Nekraata: a being that Maraketh fight after death in spiritual combat. No mortal has ever won.

DURING & AFTER THE WINTER OF THE WORLD

Khatal: a tale-man in the early years of the Winter of the World before the alliance (the Third Pact?) was forged. He had a unique gift for shaping water. His people were besieged and dying of thirst, and he managed to pull water from underground, saving his people. However, he turned to dust as a result.

Rashi: a woman bound to the first barya (and thus possibly the first Djinn). Unlike others bound to baryas, she wasn't a criminal but chose to be bound so she could serve as the Grand Water Djinn. Since then, she has fulfilled the sacred duty of collecting water from the winds and bleeding herself to replenish the reserves of water in the Qimah Reservoir.

Rangeen: a Djinn trapped in a barya. While human, Kulemak assaulted her caravan and she ran. The rest of her group died and were resurrected to serve the Lightless. It's implied Rangeen was imprisoned for cowardice/desertion, and her attitude is spiteful. She convinced the Serpent Clan to free her (but is interrupted by the player).

Varashta: the Winter Sekhema. She designed and oversaw the building of the proving grounds for the sisterhood (the Trial of Sekhemas) with Zarokh's help. Zarokh wanted to rule the Vastiri with her, but she didn't want this, so he turned on her and cursed the halls of the Trial. Varashta retaliated by trapping him as a Djinn in the farthest halls of the Trial, where aspirants don't need to go. However, because of his curse, Varashta was trapped there as well and can no longer survive outside the chamber. She believes she is trapped more in time than in space, due to Zarokh's powers.

Kelari: a man in Varashta's *akhara* who apparently loved Navira. During a war, he told Navira there were cowards among Ruzhan's ranks. Navira passed this on to Ruzhan, who killed them. Kelari then set a trap on their corpses, causing beetles to burst forth and halting, but not defeating, their enemy. Navira and Ruzhan both later testified that Kelari's claim about the cowards was a deception used to gain power. For his actions, Kelari was bound to a barya as a Djinn and became known as the Tainted Sands.

Navira: the Tale Woman of Varashta's *akhara*. During a war, Kelari told her there were cowards among Ruzhan's ranks. She passed this on to Ruzhan, who killed them. When facing consequences for her actions, Navira claimed Kelari had deceived her. Varashta bound her to a barya as a Djinn for condoning Kelari's and Ruzhan's actions, and she became known as the Last Mirage.

Ruzhan: a man in Varashta's *akhara*. During a war, Navira told him there were cowards among his ranks per Kelari. Ruzhan killed them with a sword and fire, believing their *akhara* could not tolerate weakness during a war. When facing consequences for his actions, he claimed Kelari had deceived him. However, he agreed to be bound to a barya as a Djinn for his actions, becoming known as the Blazing Sword.

Zarokh: a man who achieved great things in the war against the Lightless and helped build the Trial of Sekhemas. Varashta says he came to them a *taljari*, but became something more. His ambition grew and wanted to rule the Vastiri with Varashta, but she didn't, so he turned on her. He stole the wisdom of the tale-women and became the first Chronomancer, and cursed the

halls of the Trial. Varashta retaliated by trapping him as a Djinn in the farthest halls of the Trial, where aspirants don't need to go. He claims to be able to see the past and foresee the future, though his foretellings aren't always correct.

Halani, Goddess of Water: a Maraketh woman who ascended to godhood. She had a son when she was still mortal, who she left to die (possibly because he was considered imperfect). She claims she was later told that he'd died, so after ascending to godhood didn't seek him out. After the Beast put her to sleep she dreamed of living happily with her son, but when she awoke in an abandoned Keth she was unable to move (and appears to have been mutilated/disemboweled). Keth's second river was named after her, as were the Halani Gates that were once water-locks.

Azarian, the Forsaken Son: Halani's son, who she left to die. He lived with the Faridun for thirty years and says he had a harsh and painful life, while hating his mother for abandoning him. He was apparently resurrected by Corruption after the new Beast was brought to the Vastiri.

Solera: a sekhema and the twin sister of Lundara. During the Winter of the World, she and her sister are said to have wielded the essence of gold and silver, clearing up the grey sky and causing the winter to end. She wielded a legendary spear, which was later lost or stolen and which has been sought out by various people throughout the ages. One of Orbala's adventures involved tracking down the spear. Some believe that Solera may have been the same person as the Azmeri goddess Solaris.

Lundara: a sekhema and the twin sister of Solera. During the Winter of the World, she and her sister are said to have wielded the essence of gold and silver, clearing up the grey sky and causing the winter to end. Some believe that Lundara may have been the same person as the Azmeri goddess Lunar.

Balbala: a *sekhema* who betrayed her *akhara* for a promise of *welakath*, a mythical elixir said to bestow great power. She secretly led a band of foreign warriors to the top of the Halani Gates, where her *akhara* was slain to the last woman. Instead of rewarding her, the bandits put a spear through her gut. Death was considered insufficient punishment for her crime, and Balbala agreed to be imprisoned as a Djinn because she felt she deserved it. Her sentence was for one thousand years of suffering, but the location of her prison was later forgotten and she was left there much longer (by Zarka's reckoning, at least two or three thousand years). Balbala also says that even after her long imprisonment, her crimes will still not be forgiven until she successfully helps an aspirant through the Trial of the Sekhemas. She has scars on the left side of her face and may be blind her left eye.

Orbala, a.k.a. Garukhan, Queen of the Wind: a Maraketh woman famed for her eight adventures. One of these involved a hunt for Solera's Spear, which led her to Stridevolf and left it in flames. Another involved her having to impersonate a Vaal dignitary after killing a Maraketh spy who had in turn been impersonating a Vaal dignitary. This adventure left Lira Vaal in flames. Her eighth and last adventure began when she heard of the threat of the necromancer Sares and set out on a quest to master the elements, resulting in the Horn of the Vastiri. She blew it and dissipated the sandstorms, allowing the united *akharas* to defeat Sares. For this victory, Orbala was made the Sekhema of Sekhemas, and later became the Queen of the Wind, greatest goddess of the Maraketh. Her divine name was Garukhan, meaning "ultimate sovereign." Her war-steed was Ekbab the mastodon, and she wielded a sword called the Storm Blade, which was lost in the eastern desert during her battle against Sares. Statues depict her as having had

five sisters. She married the god Sin and they had a daughter, Shakari. Sin and Garukhan later parted ways, and he gives her as one reason he created the Beast and put the gods to sleep. Sin describes Garukhan as a prideful, stubborn, and vain woman who sought wisdom in the sky.

Shakari, Queen of the Sands: the daughter of Garukhan and Sin. As the daughter of two gods, it's possible that Shakari was born divine and didn't need to ascend on her own, though this isn't confirmed. Per Sin, she was envious of her mother's power, and so sought power for herself, finding it in the sand. He says she was driven by agony and shame and amassed her own army. It's suggested that she intended to wage war on the sky (and thus her mother) but was stopped when the Beast put her to sleep.

DURING THE DECLINE & FALL OF THE ETERNAL EMPIRE

Asenath, the Golden Sekhema: the Maraketh *sekhema* and archer who united the Maraketh tribes against the Eternal Empire. She was the last person to bear the Wings of Vastiri, which bestowed her with the title of "Sekhema of Sekhemas." She led the united Maraketh against Sarn, but was defeated and killed by General Hector Titucius.

Deshret, the Red Sekhema: the commander who led the Maraketh during the Purity Rebellion. Voll promised her the return of the Maraketh grazing lands stolen during the imperial conquest of the Vastiri Plains in return for her military support in the rebellion. She agreed, and led her *akhara* in an attack against General Hector Titucius' legionnaires. They were successful, and Deshret is said to have fashioned a rhoa saddle from his skin. She later joined Voll for the siege of Sarn. Following the Cataclysm, she led her *akhara* to Highgate to stop the Beast. However, she instead chose to seal off the mines and order her *akhara* to guard them. She was later killed by Emperor Voll, who had been corrupted into a monster by the Cataclysm. After death her spirit fell into the hands of Malachai's Godless Three, who each had their wicked way with her, attempting to subsume her into the collective corruption. They failed, leaving her spirit trapped within the mines.

RECENT TIMES

Torbik: a travelling merchant who struck off on his own several years ago, without a caravan. He says it's tough but he likes the freedom. He plans to accumulate goods and take them to the Karui archipelago, because he's heard there's water there as far as the eye can see and wants to see it for himself. He hopes the Khari Bazaar will become a trade hub again like it was in ancient times. He has a rhex named Dabu.

THE KİYATO AKHARA

Oyun: the *sekhema* of the Kiyato *akhara*, which was charged by Deshret with guarding the Highgate mines. She successfully defended Highgate against the Ebony Legion attack led by Captain Vincenti, which had been ordered by Piety.

Kira: a *dekhara* of the Kiyato *akhara*, which was charged by Deshret with guarding the Highgate mines. She is a descendant of Deshret.

Tasuni: Kira's brother. He was born blind so was left out on the plain overnight as per Maraketh tradition. However, he survived (apparently on his own, without the help of the Faridun), which had never happened before. He claims to be an augur with the ability to see things others cannot.

Irasha: a *dekhara* of the Kiyato *akhara* and possible successor to Oyun. She had a twin sister who died during her dance with the scorpion. When Irasha was twelve, she was attacked by three men and possibly raped. They were later caught and she executed them herself.

THE ARDURA AKHARA

Asala: the *sekhema* of the Ardura *akhara*. Shambrin describes her as beautiful, strong, and cunning.

Zarka: the tale-woman of the Ardura *akhara*, who was chosen by her predecessor.

Shambrin: a *dekhara* in the Ardura *akhara* until blinded in battle. She still practices with a sword in the hope of fighting again (Nasima is her inspiration), but she now serves as tradesmith and weaponmaster for the Ardura. She's a bit sympathetic toward the Faridun given her own injury and experiences.

Lailuma: a woman who Shambrin cares about. She went to Deshar alone and threw herself from the spires. As she was not sick or injured at the time, her act was likely considered dishonourable. A possible reason for her suicide is hopelessness regarding being with Shambrin, which may have been forbidden by the Ardura.

UNKNOWN

Devora: a Djinn. She mentions a drought, but also boats, the Seven Waters, and Halani. Thus she may be from an earlier era when the Vastiri was still lush.

Razel: a Djinn who speaks of sand, and thus he may be from a more recent time when the Vastiri has desertified.

Yoon: a Djinn trapped in a barya. He is remorseful and feels he deserves his punishment. He wants to suffer and serve in order to be redeemed.

Amnaah: the third servant of water. It's possible Amnaah is the author of the final testament found in Keth, suggesting that he/she remained behind after the Beast was created and the city abandoned, hoping that Halani would awaken. Amnaah is referred to as the last Djinn, which may mean the last one to have been created.

Aziza: the fourth servant of water. A tale claims that Aziza is a Djinn who lives in a lamp.

Aukuna, the Black Sekhema: a Maraketh general who was skilled at both archery and hand-to-hand combat. She rode a mount named Shiyo. She fought to defend Highgate against the risen dead, so may have been a *sekhema* of the Kiyato *akhara* before Oyun (and probably after the death of Deshret). Currently she resides in the Domain of Timeless Conflict and seems to believe she's still fighting the dead even when facing other human factions.

Nasima of the Second Sight: a woman born blind with red eyes, who was abandoned by the Maraketh for her imperfection. She was taken in by the Faridun and became a great warrior. One day, she was sent to raid the *akhara* that had abandoned her. While there she recognised her mother's voice, so turned on and began killing the Faridun. The Maraketh consider her a good role model. (The Brutal Restraint Timeless Jewel may imply that she became a *sekhema*.)

Wranga: a tale-woman of the Wahida *akhara*.

OUTCASTS (FARIDUN)

Saresh: (see The Order of the Djinn.)

Jamanra: a Faridun warrior who was alive during the time the gods were asleep. He believed the Faridun and Maraketh were equals, an idea the Maraketh saw as dangerous. He wanted to prove the Faridun were strong in order to convince the Maraketh that casting them out was a mistake, and to reunite with them, hoping to rebuild Keth together. (Per unused POE I lore, the Faridun consisted of scattered camps and he united them into a single people.) The Maraketh *sekhemas* joined together and met with him. Per them, he was in awe of their glory and killed himself, though even Zarka grows to doubt this account. (Per unused POE I lore, they'd agreed to meet with him to discuss recognising the Faridun as its own nation, but betrayed and poisoned him.) Jamanra was resurrected by Oriana using the new Beast. He was driven mad by Corruption and seeks to use the power of the Beast to get revenge against the Maraketh.

Nenet: (see The Ring.)

Risu: a woman who was left to die in the desert as an infant by the Maraketh and taken in by the Faridun. She has no idea who her mother or father are (they could be in the Ardura). She was horrified by the Beast Oriana brought to the Faridun and didn't want to go to war against the Maraketh with Jamanra, so after the Dreadnought was complete Jamara sealed her and other dissenters in Mawdun Mine. There she was kept in a locked cage by Rudja.

Rudja, the Dread Engineer: a Faridun engineer who likely helped build Jamanra's Dreadnought. She was left behind in Mawdun Mine by Jamanra, possibly to deal with the dissenters. She appears to be undead, and was likely reanimated by Corruption.

L'im the Impaler: a spearwoman who is part of the forward command of the Faridun offensive against the Maraketh under Jamanra.

Azmadi: a Faridun who desired to become the Sekhema of Sekhemas. He completed the Trial of the Sekhemas (becoming the first Faridun to do so) with Zarokh's help. He was granted some of Zarokh's power over time in exchange for agreeing to help Zarokh escape by stealing the First Barya. He considers himself a prince of the Faridun.

VAAL

ANTIQUITY

Xibaqua: the precursor to the Vaal. Xibaqua was said to have been born from the flesh of the gods, but later betrayed them. The gods reclaimed their flesh, leaving nothing left of Xibaqua save for a droplet of pure light, which was the first Vaal.

Ralakesh, Master of a Million Faces: a Vaal god said to be obsessed with governance and the subjugation of humanity through their base, animal instincts. He conducted experiments that wiped out so many of his people that he had to enslave many primitive Azmeri in order to repopulate his domain. He had a terror of grasping too much and having it all slip through his fingers and therefore remained on his throne surrounded by high walls while other deities waged war and conquered empires.

Yugul, Reflection of Terror: a Vaal scholar. He was interested in human terror and would terrify children and capture their reactions in eldritch mirrors for study. He used what he learned to manipulate his way into a leadership position and eventually became so renowned that he ascended to godhood.

Arakaali, Spinner of Shadows: a prostitute with insatiable lust, who used her talents as a temptress and predator to rise to godhood. Per Cadiro she was worshipped by the Ameri before the Vaal, so may have actually been an Azmerian. She would sedate her victims, have her carnal way with them, and then drain them completely of all fluids. The children of Gruthkul became envious of Arakaali's power and plotted against her, so Arakaali killed them. Gruthkul retaliated by attacking Arakaali's realm and bringing it to the brink of ruin. Arakaali lured Gruthkul into a cavern and collapsed it on her, trapping Gruthkul inside. She then began rebuilding her empire, but the Beast was born and she began to weaken. Her followers then betrayed her, binding her in silk and leaving her trapped in a pyramid.

Kopec, the Sun God: the Vaal God of the Sun. His temple in Utzaal contained a time machine powered by an artificial sun, which was intended to be used to preserve the Vaal people in the event of a cataclysm.

Kamasa, the Monkey God: the Vaal Monkey God and Vaal God of Wealth. He was initially curious, wise, and prone to mischief. Tales of his early life depict him as appearing to impart mysterious wisdom or steal something shiny from a wealthy noble. However, his greed grew as the Vaal expanded, and later tales portray him extorting peasants and blackmailing nobles for increasingly large tithes. His cult's core values became exploitation and ambition, and his high priests eventually ran everything remotely financial in the Vaal Empire. He had a temple, vault, and forge in Utzaal.

Yaomac: a Vaal god represented as a three-headed snake. Yaomac is said to be the shepherd of Vaal souls and the arbiter of the balance of the seasons, and to have found unity in balance. Three unique blessings are supposed to be conferred by each of Yaomac's three serpentine heads. The Venom Crypts in the jungle outside of Utzaal are the remains of the Temple of Yaomac. Yaomac was kidnapped by Ixchel (who later became the Trialmaster) while asleep due to the influence of the Beast. Servi's dialogue hints that Yaomac is female.

Chaos: an unknown entity. Per the Trialmaster, moments of chance lead to multiple diverging paths of reality, and Chaos sees all of them. Chaos is fascinated by the ability of the skilled to bend chance in their favour, and has tasked the Trialmaster with finding challengers and putting them through trials of skill and chance. Per the Trialmaster, Atziri is an enigma because her life is the one event that never changes in any version of reality.

Ahuatotli, the Blind: the Grand Architect of the Vaal Outpost, a city which was eventually buried beneath the Eternal Empire.

Tetzlapokal: a Vaal queen sometimes referred to as a "waif of disturbing proclivities." She was a devotee of Arakaali and supposedly had a deep fascination with mortality and the inert human form. It was said she would request that her subjects deposit the bodies of their deceased loved ones upon the steps of her palace, to be taken inside and used for disturbing purposes.

DURING THE TIME OF THE BEAST

Ixchel, a.k.a. The Trialmaster: a being who was once a mortal man named Ixchel. His people went mad with fear after the gods went to sleep, and he was taken in by the Order of the Djinn. He infiltrated the Priesthood of Yaomac and kidnapped the sleeping god. The Order then sent him to do the same to Chaos, though Chaos was discovered awake (and thus not a god). Following this, Ixchel served Chaos and became known as the Trialmaster. He has been tasked with searching for suitable challengers for trials of skill and chance. He may also award titles to those who successfully complete the trials. Through Chaos, the Trialmaster experiences many different outcomes or versions of the same events. (Note that most of the above lore came from scarabs that have now been removed from the game.)

DURING THE REIGN OF ATZIRI

Atziri: the last queen of the Vaal. Inspired by Zerphi, she sought out youth and longevity at the cost of sacrificing her own people. Historical records state that Doryani orchestrated a communion with the Beast involving Virtue Gems and the harvest moon, hoping to achieve immortality for his people. However, Doryani claims it was Atziri who attempted the communion and that he tried but failed to stop her. In either case, the result was the Fall and the destruction of Vaal civilisation. While believed to have died in the Fall, she somehow remained behind in a nightmare realm that is beginning to leak back into Wraeclast. Per the Trialmaster, Atziri is an enigma because her life is the one event that never changes in any version of reality.

Zerphi: a Vaalish noble and infamous serial killer who tortured and murdered thirteen people. He lived to be 168, but at the time of his death had the body of a 20-year-old. This inspired Atziri in her pursuit of youth and longevity.

Doryani, Royal Thaumaturge, First Seer to the Queen: a Vaal thaumaturgist who served under Queen Atziri. He was patroned by Chaos, who took an interest in him after his strategy in the Trial of Chaos greatly amused Chaos. Doryani assisted Atziri in her pursuit of youth and longevity at the cost of human sacrifice and experimentation. As part of this, he studied biology, machinery, Corruption, time, and other fields. He considered the study of the Beast to be his life's work and saw it as the means to achieve his goals. He disregarded any ethical boundaries and there was at least one attempt on his life. Historical records state that he orchestrated some sort of communion with the Beast involving Virtue Gems and the harvest moon, hoping to achieve immortality for his people, and per Sin he wounded the Beast. However, Doryani himself claims it was Atziri who attempted the communion and that he tried but failed to stop her, going so far as to make contingency plans in case the communion was catastrophic. In either case, the result was the Fall and the destruction of Vaal civilisation.

Viper Napuatzi: a woman who was taken as an unwilling sacrifice, but her blood was refused. She later rose to become a Vaal general, becoming known as the Fang of the Vaal and her troops as the Viper Legionnaires. In battle she used poison-based spells and had the ability to summon spectral snakes. She lived in Utzaal. After being defeated (by the player) shortly before the Fall of the Vaal, she was somehow transported to the Domain of Timeless Conflict.

Nezahul: a Royal Commander under Viper Napuatzi.

Ketzuli, High Priest of the Sun & Architect of Time: a Vaal architect who studied time, conducting his research in the Temple of Kopec. His writings are still extant. He believed that time is solid and cannot be changed, and thus travelling to the past won't affect what happens in the future. He considered Doryani to be the greatest hero of their era, and hoped to give him the time he needed to complete his work.

Atalui: a blood priestess and Atazek's twin sister.

Atazek: a blood priest and Atalui's twin brother.

Kishara: a Vaal sailor said to have explored every coast, cove and bay of Wraeclast. She was aided by the Star, an artefact she obtained on her first voyage that guided her wherever she wanted to go. She had seventeen children and was renowned for manning the helm while pregnant and even giving birth during battles more than once. Her children went on to found the Brinerot warband. There are stories and songs of her visiting Phaaryl and the Viridian Wildwood, and the Maraketh claim she was captain of a Maraketh merchant vessel. Supposedly, she sailed to Middengard on her last voyage and Queen Atziri didn't like the attention she was getting, so impounded everything Kishara brought back and made sacrifices of her crew. For her feats, Kishara was known as the Southern Star and the Wayward Gull.

Jaetai: a Vaal Queen's Advisor, including advisor to Queen Atziri (per Cadiro).

Ichlotl the Blackjaw: a notorious criminal who was imprisoned in a Soul Core for his crimes. He sparked the first rumours that those who were sacrificed remained aware inside their Soul Cores. The construct powered by his Soul Core was excessively violent when given the chance and seemed to display anger when in combat. The Vaal considered this a plus, and set him to guard the Machinarium where Soul Cores were manufactured.

Zicoatl, Warden of the Core: the most advanced construct ever built by the Vaal, powered by a large Soul Core. It was built into the structure of Jiquani's Machinarium itself and set to activate if interlopers ever infiltrated the heart of the facility, in order to protect the Machinarium's secrets. (Zicoatl is spelled "Zicoati" in the book *The Art of Path of Exile II*.)

Anub, the Pinata: a woman who was part scorpion and resided with the garrison in Atziri's Temple in Lira Vaal.

Coztic, the Forgehand: a man in Atziri's Temple in Lira Vaal who used a large hammer.

Cualli, Kamasan Smith: a male smith in Atziri's Temple in Lira Vaal.

Huitzil, Royal Blood Priest: a male priest in the Sacrificial Chamber in Atziri's Temple in Lira Vaal.

Kulka, Vaal Thaumaturge: a male thaumaturge in Atziri's Temple in Lira Vaal.

Menmek, Guardian Construct: a Soul Core-powered construct in the Alchemy Lab in Atziri's Temple in Lira Vaal.

Micata, the Remade: a woman in Atziri's Temple in Lira Vaal. She is part machine.

Pakteni, Flesh Surgeon: a doctor in Atziri's Temple in Lira Vaal. He was taught by Guatelitzi.

Temoc, Drill Overseer: a male solider who was part of the garrison in Atziri's Temple in Lira Vaal.

Xalapa, Spy Master: a spymaster in Atziri's Temple in Lira Vaal. She wielded claws.

Xolotl, Royal Commander: a commander who resides in Atziri's Temple in Lira Vaal. He wields a large axe. He was human during the Fall of the Vaal but in the present appears to occupy a Soul Core in a stone construct and has become known as Xolotl, the Forgotten.

ARCHITECTS

Xipocado, Royal Architect: an architect who designed the Royal Meeting Room, Hall of Lords, and Throne of Atziri in Atzoatl. Atziri was impressed when he openly spoke his mind about her and made him her personal architect. He rebuilt Lira Vaal, including designing a personal temple for Atziri that he described as "a living machine" able to modify its internal structure. He was precise, scientific, and calculated, and a devout adherent of Atziri.

Ahuana, Architect of Ceremonies: an architect who led countless human sacrifices. He designed the Sacrificial Chamber, Hall of Offerings, and Apex of Ascension in Atzoatl. (Note that there was also a Karui queen named Ahuana, who lived well over a thousand years later.)

Atmohua, Architect of Iron: a male architect who designed the Armourer's Workshop, Armoury, and Chamber of Iron in Atzoatl.

Azcapa, Architect of the Guild: an architect and notoriously talented jeweler. He designed the Jeweller's Workshop, Jewellery Forge, and Glittering Halls in Atzoatl. He had quarters in Utzaal.

Cholotl, Architect of the War: a male architect who designed the Guardhouse, Barracks, and Hall of War in Atzoatl.

Citaqualotl, Architect of the Swarm: an architect and crazed scientist who created moving devices of strange metals and later combined metal and insects. He designed the Hatchery, Automaton Lab, and Hybridisation Chamber in Atzoatl.

Estazunti, Architect of the Vault: a male architect who designed the Vault, Treasury, and Wealth of the Vaal in Atzoatl.

Guatelitzi, Architect of Flesh: a boy who was found moving among the prisoners, "preparing" (mutilating) their living bodies for sacrifice. The high priests recognised his inclinations and gave him a higher calling as an architect. He designed the Pools of Restoration, Sanctum of Vitality, and Sanctum of Immortality in Atzoatl.

Hayoxi, Architect of Destruction: an architect who designed the Explosives Room, Demolition Lab, and Shrine of Unmaking in Atzoatl. In Lira Vaal, he built up a pile of powder under the royal temple but never had the courage to light it. He committed suicide by blowing himself up, but Atziri had his body reassembled.

Jiquani, Architect of Industry: an architect obsessed with finding new and creative ways to get things done. He was the mastermind behind making constructs of stone animated by Soul Cores in order to help his people keep pace with their own rapid expansion. In order to achieve this, he sacrificed countless peasants, and some say their screams still echo inside their Soul Cores. He had his own machinarium near Utzaal. He also designed the Workshop, Engineering Department, and Factory in Atzoatl.

Juatalotli, Architect of the Hoard: an architect who designed the Storage Room, Warehouses, and Museum of Artefacts in Atzoatl. He gathered every piece of Vaal history he could, hoping to preserve them. He also obtained ancient and notable relics through trade, excavation, and raids. The elders from the Huntress player character's village gave him some sacred objects for preservation. He had a hoard of such objects in Atziri's Temple in Lira Vaal.

Matatl, Architect of Fortifications: a male architect who designed the Trap Workshop, Temple Defense Workshop, and Defense Research Lab in Atzoatl.

Opiloti, Architect of Strife: an architect and brutally violent warlord. He used to spill the blood of his greatest warriors, believing it would grant them immortality. He designed the Hall of Champions, Hall of Heroes, and Hall of Legends in Atzoatl.

Paquate, Architect of Corruption: an architect who performed nefarious experiments. He built a corruption mechanism in Jiquani's Sanctum, and also designed the Corruption Chamber, Catalyst of Corruption, and Locus of Corruption in Atzoatl. He also built the Locus of Corruption in Atziri's Temple in Lira Vaal.

Puhuarte, Architect of the Forge: a Vaal architect who designed the Flame Workshop, Omnitect Forge, and Crucible of Flame in Atzoatl.

Quipolatl, Architect of the Nexus: an architect who proposed building the Temple of Atzoatl as a prototype. There, he designed the Shrine of Empowerment, Sanctum of Unity, and Temple Nexus.

Tacati, Architect of Toxins: a male architect who designed the Poison Garden, Cultivar Chamber, and Toxic Grove in Atzoatl. He attempted to assassinate Atziri with a unique poison, but it required him to direct his anger to be effective and in her presence he could only feel lust.

Ticaba, Architect of the Arena: a male architect who designed the Sparring Room, Arena of Valour, and Hall of Champions in Atzoatl.

Topotante, Architect of Storms: an architect who designed the Tempest Generator, Hurricane Engine, and Storm of Corruption in Atzoatl.

Tzamoto, Architect of Torment: a male architect who designed the Torment Cells, Torture Cages, and Sadist's Den in Atzoatl.

Uromoti, Architect of Expansion: an architect who designed the Surveyor's Study, Office of Cartography, and Atlas of Worlds in Atzoatl. He had quarters in Utzaal. He went to the Azmeri and asked to buy Mount Kriar from them, but the Azmeri didn't understand the concept of owning a mountain so just let the Vaal pass. He built the Cuachic Vault and sent his children there, before returning to Atzoatl to play his part and placate Atziri.

Xopec, Architect of Power: an architect who experimented into electrical lifebloods. He designed the Lightning Workshop, Omnitect Reactor Plant, and Conduit of Lightning in Atzoatl.

Zalatl, Architect of Thaumaturgy: an architect who designed the Gemcutter's Workshop, Department of Thaumaturgy, and Doryani's Institute in Atzoatl.

Zantipi, Architect of Concealment: a male architect who designed the Strongbox Chamber, Hall of Locks, and Court of Sealed Death in Atzoatl.

Zilquapa, Architect of the Breach: a male architect who designed the Splinter Research Lab, Breach Containment Chamber, and House of the Others in Atzoatl.

RECENT TIMES

The Last to Die: the last survivor of the bloodlines of the High Priests of the Vaal. During the height of the Vaal empire's madness, the Blood Crucible was forged as part of a pact between the High Priests and the entity known as Chaos. For most of her life, The Last to Die has used the Blood Crucible to shift into Nightmare and fight the Scourge, three factions of horrific creatures, though says she's accomplished nothing but outliving everyone else. She implies she's seen countless different versions of Wraeclast, and that all were destroyed by the Scourge except one, which was dominated by High Templar Venarius. Per Divinia, she mysteriously disappeared from a Templar jail cell a few years before encountering the exile. It is very likely that The Last to Die is actually Alva Valai from an alternate Wraeclast.

Zelina: a blood priestess and current head of the Cuachic Vault with her twin brother Zolin. She used excess newborns in the vault to scry for dreams.

Zolin: a blood priest and current head of the Cuachic Vault with his twin sister Zelina.

Stormgore, the Guardian: like Blackjaw, Stormgore was a soul trapped in a Soul Core within a stone body, and was stationed as a guard at the entrance to the Cuachic Vault.

TRIBES REMAINING AFTER THE FALL

CENOBITES & ANCHORITES

The Queen of Filth: queen of the degenerated Vaal who remain in the flooded city of Utzaal. She resides at the top of Aggorat, surrounded by poisonous waters, and refers to outsiders as "cleanskins." Like the other survivors, she is a cannibal--who prefers to eat her victims alive--and implies that she's eaten members of her own family. She practices inbreeding and has multiple sons. She despises the Karui enough to refuse to eat them. She loves gold.

Cauldron Keeper: the gentle crone, who will give out flasks in exchange for the right mushrooms.

Mektul, the Forgemaster: the forgemaster in Kamasa's Molten Vault.

SERVI'S UNNAMED TRIBE

Servi: a guide from a tribe that's lived near Utzaal for generations. She's paid handsomely by treasure hunters to provide local knowledge and warn them about which plants, animals, and other dangers to avoid. She uses charms, says ritualistic phrases, and makes small sacrifices at idols. She has a son and a grandson (Apus), and describes them both as having a rowdy spirit. She says her tribe's darkest tales feature Doryani.

Apus: Servi's grandson, who she describes as having a rowdy spirit.

OROKS (AZAKH-KUL)

Ranbu the Pale Shaman: a female Orok Shaman.

Garkam, Ranbu's Maul: a male Orok giant.

AZAKS (CARVERS)

Ignagduk, the Bog Witch: the queen-witch of the Azak tribe. On the night of each blood moon, she steals a child from the local tribes and sacrifices it in a bloody ritual, causing his/her soul to serve her forever afterwards. Capable of horrific dark magic, Ignagduk is known as the deadliest witch in the jungle. She wields a spear adorned with the skulls of children.

Narag: a female shaman with a hut in the Matlan Waterways.

UNKNOWN

Ixtolatl, Artisan of Sacrifice: guardian of the Gifts of the Sacrificed Vaal Reliquary.

Mahuatzl, Artisan of Desire: guardian of the Gifts of the Red Queen Vaal Reliquary.

Zeel: a Vaal tinkerer in search of the secret of Matter Metamorphosis.

Mahuxotl: a banished architect who sought to employ the darkest secrets of the Vaal.

Kiravi: a Vaal archer.

KARUI

ANTIQUITY

Tukohama, Father of War: a Karui god who's considered responsible for transforming the Karui from a peaceful culture of farmers and fisherman into warriors with a hunger for conquest. Tukohama's tribe was in continual conflict with the Ngamahu tribe, so to put an end to it Tukohama and Ngamahu went through the traditions together, and she gave her ring to him. It's said that Tukohama went to war against the First Ones of the Ezomytes.

Ngamahu, Mother of Fire: a Karui goddess. Ngamahu's tribe was in continual conflict with the Tukohama tribe, so to put an end to it Ngamahu and Tukohama went through the traditions together, and he helped her forge her legendary axe.

Valako, Father of the Storm: a Karui god.

Tasalio, Father of Water: a Karui god.

Sione, Mother of the Sun: the Karui goddess of the Sun. Tales say that in the past, the Sun was green and no brighter than any other star. Sione traded away all of her tribe's possessions to foreign cultures in exchange for gold, and plated her palace with it. Her tribe was on the verge of starvation due to this, but put on a festival with what little they had left. Ramako was invited, and was so in awe of Sione's wealth that he agreed to go through the traditions together. His light was reflected by her gold palace, making the Sun what it is today and creating Day. This resulted in her tribe flourishing. Some claim that Ramako later had an affair with her sister, Lani Hua, and may be the father of her daughter, though Ramako denies this. Because of this, Sione went into the night sky to wage war on her sister. However, some claim that the sisters then discovered something so horrible that it drives even the strongest warriors to madness, and that since then the two sisters have been out protecting the rest of humanity by waging war with the stars themselves. Warriors wounded in this battle are tended to by Arohongui until well enough to rejoin the fight.

Lani Hua, Mother of the Moon: a Karui goddess and the sister of Sione. Arohongui is her daughter, who some claim is the product of an affair between Lani Hua and Ramako, her sister's husband, though Ramako denies this. Because of this, Sione went into the night sky to wage war on Lani Hua. However, some claim that the sisters then discovered something so horrible that it drives even the strongest warriors to madness, and that since then the two sisters have been out protecting the rest of humanity by waging war with the stars themselves. Warriors wounded in this battle are tended to by Arohongui until well enough to rejoin the fight.

Ramako, Father of Light, Father of the Sun: a Karui god. He was originally the Father of Light, but after being invited to a festival put on by Sione, he was in awe of her wealth and went through the traditions with her. Her golden palace reflected his light, making the Sun what it is today and earning Ramako the second title of Father of the Sun. Some believe that he secretly can't stand her, and asked his bother, Rongokurai, to provide darkness so that he could carry out an affair with Lani Hua, fathering her daughter, Arohongui. However, Ramako claims it was someone else who was visiting Lani Hua, and that Rongokurai is a liar. Because of this, he and his brother no longer speak. The Ramako tribe believe that a deceiver impersonated him and fathered Arohongui, before later being caught and locked away.

Rongokurai, Father of Night: a Karui god who hides and protects the innocent and brings relief from the heat of the day. Ramako is his brother. Some believe that Rongokurai provided darkness to hide Ramako while he carried on an affair with Lani Hua, though Ramako claims it was someone else who was with her and that Rongokurai is a liar. Because of this, Rongokurai and Ramako are no longer on speaking terms.

Arohongui, Daughter of the Moon: the daughter of Lani Hua. As the child of a goddess, she was born divine and thus can act as she pleases without the need of an agenda or accumulating loyalty. Some claim that her father is Ramako, though he denies this. The Ramako tribe believe

that a deceiver impersonated him and fathered Arohongui, before later being caught and locked away. While Sione and Lani Hua are out waging war, Arohongui tends to warriors wounded in the conflict until well enough to rejoin the fight.

Tawhoa, Father and Son of the Forest: a Karui god said to gift humanity with the trees and birds so that they can enjoy beauty and peace. He's also said to have gifted Ironwood to one Karui tribe, as an alternative to jade which was in limited supply. He has a perspective of ages and thus stands aside from such things as wars. He has a desire to teach, and supposedly gave humans the ability to dream.

Kitava, Father of Chaos: a Karui god representing the primal desire of hunger. Because he was unable to stop consuming things, he was punished by his fellow gods. Tukohama cut a large bleeding X on his face, leaving him blind. Valako impaled Kitava with his jawbone. Finally, Hinekora whipped him with her hair, driving him into the darkness of her island (possibly the Halls of the Dead) to suffer for time beyond measure. Another story says that Hinekora bound him to a rock to trap him. The Karui also know him by other names, including the Black Spirit, the Cannibal King, and the Ravenous One.

Hinekora, Mother of Death: a Karui goddess who cares for the souls of the Karui after death. Before her, the dead simply ceased to exist. She created the Halls of the Dead, where their souls can go after death to lend their wisdom and strength to future generations. After some Karui were on the verge of madness after being there too long, she devised trials of mock warfare to keep them engaged. Hinekora serves Order and works to ensure that what must happen, happens. She is opposed to Chaos, who takes amusement in unlikelihooods and surprising events. She can't see the future, but can see some of the past and thereby predict what will probably happen again.

Kahuturoa: a man who lived thousands of years ago, when the Vaal were a massive empire and the Karui and Azmeri were friends. Currently he is the oldest soul in the Halls of the Dead, and doesn't enjoy fighting but is good at it. He's grown lethargic and forlorn due to the length of his existence there, and wishes he could see the Chambers of the Dishonoured. It's implied he was in a relationship with Rakiata. He is currently a member of the Rongokurai Tribe.

Hikatomanga: a man with a family who is said to have cheated the gods, and against whom Tukohama sought retribution.

DURING THE TIME OF THE BEAST

Maata: a man who lived some time after Kahuturoa. He was a peacemaker and diplomat who maintained relations with the Vaal to protect the Karui from the blood fever caused by the gems. He now resides in the Halls of the Dead, where he looks old, apparently because that's how he sees himself. Currently he's a member of the Tawhoa Tribe.

DURING THE DECLINE & FALL OF THE ETERNAL EMPIRE

Kiloava: a man who became chieftain of the Valako Tribe. When he inherited the tribe's signet, "it surged with the power of the storm," which it had never done before. He therefore appointed himself as "the Herald of War," and claims to have laid the foundation for Karui unification, before Kaom killed him at the age of 74 as part of said unification. Some claim his bloodline ended with him, but he actually had many children. He was delighted to awake in the Halls of the Dead in his prime, and is energetic and virile. He attempted to court Ikiaho but was turned down, though says he's "gone through the traditions" with everyone else there and that "if it moves, I'll chase it!" He remains a member of the Valako Tribe.

Akoya: a Karui woman who was killed by Kaom after a day-long fight with him, as part of his campaign to unite the Karui tribes. The passing of the years in the Halls of the Dead weighs heavily on her, and she hopes for the end of Time. She takes traditions and the Karui Way seriously. She was apparently a member of the Ngamahu Tribe when she was alive, as she'd received the goddess' sign, but is currently a member of the Tukohama Tribe. She is sometimes referred to as the Chainbreaker.

Akayo: a male Karui who was decapitated by Kaom during his campaign to unite the Karui tribes.

Rakiata: a chieftain whose tribe was attacked by Eternals looking for a fabled spear when she was 13. Her chieftain and father were killed, and she hid the spear piece they had with Tasalio (who was presumably asleep). She found a ring that washed up on the shore and believed to be a gift from Tasalio. Per her, it had great power but she never used it. She was killed when Kaom cut off her head and hand during his campaign to unite the Karui tribes. She doesn't follow the Way, but has her own style, which she calls the Flow. Because of this, many other chieftains were hostile to her when she arrived in the Halls of the Dead, but Ikiaho defended her. It's implied she was in relationships with Kahuturoa and Kiloava. Currently she's a member of the Tasalio Tribe.

Kaom: the leader of the Karui during the Purity Rebellion. Voll recruited him into the rebellion, promising him Karui freedom in return for war. He united the Karui tribes by killing the weakest tribe leaders one by one until the others joined his cause. He led them in a successful invasion of Wraeclast, defeating Marceus Lioneye and his legion on the southern coast. Kaom cleansed the area of all Eternal citizens, including killing the women and children, and declared himself king of a new Karui kingdom in Wraeclast. He also intended to invade and conquer Oriath, as had been agreed upon with Voll. However, Kaom's new kingdom was devastated by the Cataclysm, causing the dead to rise and the animals to attack the living. He had a vision leading him to take his bravest 500 warriors north to Highgate and descend into the mountain to put an end to the Cataclysm. However, he became corrupted by Malachai's influence and went mad, killing his own 500 men. From then on he remained trapped in his own dream within the mountain. When he was finally killed, he was honoured with a place in the Halls of the Dead. When he arrived there he pursued Ikiaho because he'd heard she'd refused all the others, but she refused him too. He is currently a member of the Ngamahu Tribe, though was possibly a member of the Tukohama Tribe in life.

Lavianga Ngamako: a *hatungo* and Guardian of the Karui Way, who acted as Kaom's advisor. He was present for the Karui invasion of Wraeclast, though remained behind when Kaom took his 500 warriors north to Highgate. When Kaom did not return, Hyrri led the Karui, including Lavianga, back to their native Ngamakanui. Lavianga is the author of the carvings along the coast chronicling the invasion and its aftermath.

Hyrri Ngamaku: Kaom's niece. Prior to the Karui invasion of Wraeclast, she traveled to Thebrus and studied archery with Voll's finest military tutors. Sources disagree on whether this was at Kaom's behest or whether he was unaware and furious when he found out. Marceus Lioneye believed the Karui laws forbade the use of archers, not knowing this prohibition did not extend to women or to Hyrri's tribe, the Ramako Tribe. Thus he was unprepared for the attack by Hyrri's archers, and his legionnaires were defeated. She later joined Voll for the siege of Sarn, where she commanded the Karui forces. She had a relationship with Victario Nevalius, and they had a daughter together named Ahuana, who was born before the Cataclysm. Victario gifted her a signed copy of "O' Eternal" with the inscription, "To my Karui Queen, The Ngamakanui rose has never been so beautiful nor its thorns so deadly. Let your aim never waver, and your story ever be told." After the Cataclysm devastated her people and Kaom left for Highgate without returning, Hyrri led her remaining people back to Ngamakanui. There she held the title of queen of the still-united Karui tribes, until leaving to take an army to deal with a strange threat on the edge of Ngamakanui. She never returned, and was later discovered in the Domain of Timeless Conflict (thus never making it to the Karui Halls of the Dead), where she seems to think she's fighting against slavers. Despite the prohibition of archers by the Karui not technically applying to her, she is still sometimes referred to as the Dishonoured Queen.

Ahuana: the daughter of Hyrri Ngamaku and Victario Nevalius, who was born shortly before the Cataclysm. She became queen of the still-united Karui tribes after Hyrri left to deal with a strange threat and never returned, but the tribes fractured. Ahuana suggested they switch to a council of chieftains, which remains to this day. She died in childbirth and now resides cheerfully in the Halls of the Dead with her descendants. Currently she's a member of the Ramako Tribe. (Note that one of the Vaal architects of Atzoatl was also named Ahuana, but was a man who lived well over a thousand years earlier.)

Siosa Foaga: a Karui slave of the Eternal Empire during the Purity Rebellion who apparently survived the Cataclysm due to being bound to a painting by a Karui *motiata*. He still resides in the Sarn library.

RECENT TIMES

Hapihapi: a man who helped the formerly-enslaved Karui refugees who'd escaped from Oriath after Kitava's rebirth settle into new lives in Wraeclast. He was captured and killed by slave traders, who were furious about the fall of the slave trading business and sought revenge by hunting down, torturing, and murdering as many Karui as they could find.

Tavakai: chieftain of the Tukohama Tribe and Makoru's father. He's known to be stubborn and a strict adherent to tradition. He sees the recent arrival of the Kalguurans as a threat to the Karui

way of life and wants to unite the tribes to put the Karui first and make outsiders acknowledge their strength. Many Karui have been lost to foreign causes (the Kalguur and the Twilight Order) so he closed off Ngakanu to outsiders. He appealed to Tukohama and the other Ancestors for guidance. The earth rumbled and his axe glowed, causing him and others to believe he is the true leader of the Karui and to be followed without question. (In *The Art of Path of Exile II* his name is Hoko.)

Makoru: a woman who ran away from home (Ngakanu) to forge her own path rather than follow the strict traditions of the Karui Way. She joined the Kalguuran trade guild based in Kingsmarch as a deckhand. She later passed the test given by the Kalguur (the Captain's Challenge) with a unanimous vote, so was given command of a galleon named the *Aurora May*, becoming the first Karui captain on a Kalguuran ship. Her crew gathers what resources and artefacts they can and sends them back home in exchange for a cut of the profit. Her name means "shark" in Karui. Her father is Tavakai and she disagrees with him closing off the Karui to the outside world.

Kanu: first mate on the *Aurora May*. His family was from the Tasalio tribe but switched to the Tukohama tribe for their strength after the Kalguurans arrived. Growing up, he always liked to explore the waters and fish. He's said to be headstrong and loud, though had too many "modern" ideas for Tavakai's liking. He doesn't necessarily reject the Karui Way but disagrees with Tavakai's isolationist beliefs. He left his tribe before he was old enough to visit the Isle of Shrikes, and per Tavakai his father is ashamed. He is new to Kingsmarch.

Matiki: an Elder of the Tukohama tribe in Ngakanu. He became an Elder during the worst plague of Blood Fever the island had ever seen and gave of himself without a care. He is brave and wise per Kaimana. He's implied to have been with a woman named Rakana, who died. One day he took his canoe out and was deceived by a mysterious fog into thinking he saw Rakana. He followed her and crashed, ending up being held prisoner in a cage.

Rakana: a woman who Matiki says was sweet and strong. She's implied to have gone through the traditions with him but is now deceased.

Kaimana: Medicine Woman of the Tukohama Tribe. She calls herself a mystic, mother, doctor, protector, and follower.

Ruhaki: an apprentice carver on Ngakanu who is eager to trade for gold. He's tired of Tavakai's teachings and is interested in a future, not strength.

Harano, the Meat Carver: a Karui butcher of the Tukohama tribe.

UNKNOWN

Navali: a Karui *hatungo* from "long ago." In the Halls of the Dead, she fought for the Hinekora Tribe before apparently being replaced by Tawhanuku. Currently she remains there and serves Hinekora as "an interpreter of death and servant of prophecy." (In Prophecy League, Navali said she was greeted in the afterlife by her furry companion, Yama the White, holding a Seeing

Stone. Yama and the Seeing Stone were both imbued with a hair of Hinekora's dark knowledge, allowing them to guide Navali through visions of the future. She then came back to life in Wraeclast, where she was captured by the Faun in what she believed was a trick by Hinekora to remind her of her place. In Trial of the Ancestors League, Yama is gone and this storyline seems to have been removed.)

Tawhanuku: a woman who's been in the Halls of the Dead for an unknown length of time. Not much is known about her life, as she is cryptic and speaks in fables. She's currently a member of the Hinekora Tribe.

Ikiaho: a woman who's been in the Halls of the Dead for an unknown length of time. She enjoys fighting but refuses to participate in other traditions, saying they aren't her culture. She's fascinated by the pursuit of knowledge and says that in life this pursuit led her to "a vast lake" (possibly the Lake where Kalandra is trapped) but that she doesn't remember what she found there. She says that she doesn't know what love is and has spent her time in the Halls alone, declining to start a relationship with anyone. She is friends with Rakiata and feels understood by her. Currently she's a member of the Arohongui Tribe.

Oba: the Conqueror of Corruption.

AZMERI

ANTIQUITY

The Draíocht: a being or force with a mysterious nature. It's said that the Draíocht was originally a goddess, whose name has been forgotten. She had three aspects, known as the Three Sisters: the Mhacha, the Catha, and the Mórrigan. They sacrificed themselves to imbue every part of nature, living or not, with some of their essence. The result of this was the Draíocht.

The Mhacha: one of the three aspects of the Draíocht, also known as the Three Sisters. The Mhacha represented nature itself and was the one who convinced the sisters to sacrifice themselves to imbue every part of nature with some of their essence, resulting in the Draíocht.

The Catha: one of the three aspects of the Draíocht, also known as the Three Sisters. The Catha was said to be "the eternal battlefield betwixt good and evil" and represented the balance of opposites and that there is always hope. With her sisters, she sacrificed herself to imbue every part of nature with some of her essence, resulting in the Draíocht.

The Mórrigan: one of the three aspects of the Draíocht, also known as the Three Sisters. The Mórrigan was said to be a guide, representing bravery and the call to battle, and showed her people the way. With her sisters, she sacrificed herself to imbue every part of nature with some of her essence, resulting in the Draíocht.

Solaris, Eternal Sun: an Azmeri woman who ascended to godhood with her sister Lunaris. They lived together peacefully until the trickster Tangmazu captured Solaris, who believed her sister was responsible. This resulted in the two sisters being in endless conflict with each other. She's believed to represent various concepts including judgment, leadership, enlightenment, and belief. The Eternals considered her to be the right eye of their god.

Lunaris, Eternal Moon: an Azmeri woman who bathed her sick son in the ocean, killing him. She was put on trial by her tribe, and her sister Solaris tried to defend her, but she refused to admit any wrongdoing, saying that he was now safe beneath the dirt. She ascended to godhood with her sister, and they lived together peacefully until the trickster Tangmazu captured Solaris, who believed her sister was responsible. This resulted in the two sisters being in endless conflict with each other. She's believed to represent various concepts including mercy, dreams, inspiration, and wisdom. The Eternals considered her to be the left eye of their god.

Viridi: the sister of Solaris and Lunaris. It's likely that she was also a goddess, and had power related to nature and growth. Per the Azmeri creation myth, she appears to have been trapped inside the earth, and Solaris and Lunaris were unable to free her. It's also said that she was humble, in contrast to her sisters.

Prospero, Lord of the Underworld: the Azmeri god of the underworld and all treasures and substances that come from the earth. He's also the god of lost souls. Miners sometimes leave him tributes, and he's been known to make deals with people in exchange for riches or life. Cadiro claims to have located and made a deal with Prospero that has sustained him for three centuries. This would've occurred during the time of the Beast, and it's currently unknown how Prospero was able to have some cognizance and influence while the other gods were asleep.

Ryslatha, the Puppet Mistress: the Azmeri goddess of motherhood. She was once the matriarch of a peaceful and fertile tribe, until Tukohama swept through her lands and her people were butchered by war. She then vowed to make sure no one harmed her people again, by making everyone her people. She ascended to godhood and produced countless mindless offspring, to the point where the Azmeri feared that the world would collapse under the weight of them.

Tsoagoth, the Brine King: an Azmeri god. He was the beloved leader of a prosperous and sprawling seafarer tribe. However, he was unable to produce viable offspring to inherit his kingdom, which drove him to madness. After he ascended to godhood, sailors would often whisper a prayer to him before casting off, and under a full moon the more superstitious captains would drown a slave or failed mutineer to keep him happy. He ruled over the city of Tsoatha, and when the Beast put him to sleep, he sank into the ocean and the city sank with him.

Thruldana: an unknown Azmeri god or goddess.

Kulric: a faithful follower of Solaris. When the goddess was imprisoned beneath the earth and tortured, he set her free and tended to her wounds.

Kulina: the last faithful follower of Lunaris. After the goddess was imprisoned and tortured by her sister, Kulina set her free and later urged her to go to war against Solaris.

Oisín: the first Warden of Eaves.

RECENT TIMES

Greust: an Azmerian who resided in the Forest Encampment atop the dam in the Phrecian Forest.

Silk: an Azmerian warrior who resided in the Forest Encampment atop the dam in the Phrecian Forest.

Yeena: an Azmerian who resided in the Forest Encampment atop the dam in the Phrecian Forest. She served a god or entity she called the Spirit, which gave her knowledge of events beyond what she and others saw themselves as well as the ability to shapeshift into a fox.

Oshabi: an Azmeri woman from the same tribe as Yeena, before they were driven out of their home and forced to settle in the Forest Encampment. Oshabi had a deep connection to the land and believed it spoke to her. She felt that the land wanted a sacrifice, so she kidnapped a child but was stopped from sacrificing it by her tribe. As a result, she felt her connection to the land was severed. Her tribe exiled her for her actions. This led her to discover the Sacred Grove, which she thought to be older than the Eternal Empire. She believed the secret behind the dead rising in Wraeclast lay in something she called the Lifeforce, "the desire for survival in its purest form," which she sought to use to be reborn as Wraeclast intended (becoming the Avatar of the Grove). However, she discovered the Lifeforce was actually corruption.

Greeneyes Ryann, the Warden of Eaves: a Maji assigned to patrol the border between the Wildwood and the old world. She protects travelers who wander through and slays any Nameless or other beasts who try to enter the old world. Her mother and father were slain in the battle against The King in the Mists, and she has vowed one day to defeat him. On occasion she has seen the edge of the old world.

Dromion Ley, the Breaker of Oaths: a man who was raised a Maji but broke his oath to them by embracing forbidden and evil magics. He believes evil is necessary as a counterpoint to good to maintain the balance of the Wildwood. Therefore he doesn't wish to destroy The King in the Mists, but to replace him, believing that he could impose his own ethics on the darkness and that they would be an improvement to those of The King. He has been to the old world twice.

Flavia, The Primal Huntress: an Azmeri woman who resides in the Wildwood. She considers herself the apex, the only thing in the Wildwood that isn't hunted by something else. She feels it isn't her place to interfere with the King in the Mists, and is sympathetic towards him, understanding that while the Maji fight for their home, he came from a far worse place. She has never been to the old world, and has trouble understanding concepts like the sky and the Sun. Her earliest memory is being on hunt in the Wildwood with Einhar, who told her he loved her. It's hinted that she may unknowingly be one of the Nameless and that Einhar was the one who named her, and that she may be nearly as old as the Wildwood.

Tarryck: the uncle of the Huntress player character. It's implied that he's dead. The Huntress says that Lachlann reminds her of him.

Delwyn: an Azmerian hunter who knew the Huntress player character and has hunted alongside her, so is possibly from the same village. After her banishment, he heard that an Azmerian got taken prisoner in Ogham and went looking for her because wanted to ask her something (probably why she used a forbidden Virtue Gem).

Elder Crovan Madox: the elder of an Azmeri tribe.

Hilda: a hunter from Elder Madox's tribe living on Mount Kriar. She thinks the Spirit is nonsense as she's never seen anything to make her believe it exists. She had a brother who was starving and may be dead and her ailing mother was lost to the wilderness. She has been hunting a yeti for five years.

Lythara: a skilled hunter known as the Spear of Draelyn who is from a neighbouring tribe to Elder Madox's. She went mad and drove Madox's tribe out, then turned against her own tribe. She believes she's following the Spirit's will, though seems to have actually been deceived by the Snake.

ETERNALS

EARLY YEARS OF THE EMPIRE

Tarcus Veruso, Prima Imperialus: an Azmerian who led his people down from the mountains and established the Eternal Empire, becoming its first emperor. Per Clarissa he was a ruthless despot. He outlawed the use of thaumaturgy and Virtue Gems in the empire, referring to them as "Vaalish folly," and burned those who used them at the stake. However, when his wife Chiara died in childbirth, he himself resorted to thaumaturgy, using an artefact supposedly gifted to him from the Vaal known as the Ankh of Eternity in an attempt to revive her. He had one son, who died attempting to complete the labyrinth. Mount Veruso, where Highgate is located, was named after him.

Chiara: the wife of Tarcus Veruso. She died giving birth to his son, causing him to resort to thaumaturgy in an attempt to fully revive her. He used the Ankh of Eternity combined with an Azmerian ritual. While reports say he was successful, this is highly suspect.

Caspiro: a low-born legionnaire who became the second Eternal Emperor after surviving the labyrinth. He was dismembered by a dark being (probably the Vaal Oversoul).

Alano Phrecia: an Azmerian general who managed to defeat the dark being that had killed Emperor Caspiro. For this achievement he was named the third Eternal Emperor. His descendants ruled for over a thousand years, abandoning succession by labyrinth for succession by inheritance, until Chitus Perandus took the throne. Phrecia, the area of Wraeclest surrounding Sarn, was named after him.

MIDDLE YEARS OF THE EMPIRE

Romira Phrecian: the Eternal Emperor who ruled during the Night of a Thousand Ribbons, when Sarn burned. He was known for being a cannibal. His wife had two sons that were fathered by his brother. He got revenge by holding a banquet in his wife's honor at which he served her her two sons.

Tyndarus Phrecius: an Eternal Emperor in the late 800s. During his reign, undesirables were exiled to Trarthus. When he learned that warlords had risen there and begun establishing a society, he sent his legions to kill the warlords, occupy the area, and impose taxes. The Trarthans rebelled and war broke out. After two years, the war ended with the Trarthans as victors.

High Templar Andronicus: a high templar during the reign of Emperor Tyndarus Phrecius.

DURING THE DECLINE & FALL OF THE EMPIRE

Izaro Phrecius: the last Phrecian Eternal Emperor. He was unable to conceive an heir, so built a new labyrinth based on the ones used in Azmerian tradition in order to choose a successor. He was betrayed by the Perandus family, who pushed Chitus Perandus to power. Chitus locked Izaro in his own labyrinth, where he remains trapped along with the goddess he worshipped.

Xirgil: a trapbuilder in Izaro's labyrinth, implied to have been killed by one of his own traps.

Chitus Perandus: the Eternal Emperor who succeeded Izaro by successfully navigating Izaro's labyrinth. A member of the wealthy Perandus family, he tricked his way into becoming emperor by stealing detailed plans of the labyrinth's construction, bribing others to place caches of supplies within the labyrinth itself, and deceiving an Ezomyte warrior named Weylin into helping him fight his way through it. (Per *Path of Exile: Origins*, Chitus is not only a Perandus but also a descendant of Tarcus Veruso.) After his coronation he immediately began expanding the empire and making slaves of the conquered. With the help of Malachai, he began the use of thaumaturgy and Virtue Gems in the empire, which had been forbidden since its founding. During the Purity Rebellion he was stabbed and killed with a poisoned blade by his friend, Lord Mayor Ondar of Sarn. Since he'd had a Virtue Gem implanted above his heart that was linked to all of the Gemling legionnaires, his death also resulted in the death of all but a few of the Gemling legionnaires. This event thus brought the Purity Rebellion to a successful conclusion. Chitus was buried in the Imperial Gardens and a plum tree was planted upon his grave.

Julius Perandus: the father of Chitus Perandus.

Elano: a cousin of Chitus who was a secret bastard and not a Perandus by name. He was used by Chitus in an unsuccessful plot to assassinate Izaro prior to the labyrinth's completion.

Voll of Thebrus, the Brittle Emperor: the leader of the Purity Rebellion and last Eternal Emperor. Voll was the high templar during the reign of Chitus. He disapproved of the emperor's use of thaumaturgy and Virtue Gems and vowed to cleanse them from the empire. He started the Purity Rebellion and recruited others to his cause. After inciting uprisings by the Karui, Maraketh, and Ezomytes, he himself laid siege to Sarn. After the death of Chitus, Voll was crowned emperor. He had Malachai's thaumaturgists put to death, but spared Malachai and took him to Highgate based on his promise to destroy the Beast, the source of all thaumaturgy. However, Malachai betrayed Voll and instead harnessed the power of the Beast to incite a Cataclysm that destroyed the empire and corrupted or killed its citizens. Voll himself was corrupted into an undead creature that began to attack the living, including the Maraketh who guarded Highgate. Voll himself killed Deshret, the Red Sekhema.

Cadiro Perandus: Lord of the Coin and minister of finance who assisted Chitus in becoming emperor. Despite being a strong supporter of Chitus, he seemed to not like Malachai or the Godless Three. Prior to the fall of the Eternal Empire, he managed to empty the kingdom's treasury and hide its riches in secret caches throughout Wraecclast. Cadiro himself remains alive, sustained by his devotion to his household god, Prospero, continuing to search out these caches. He believes the Immortal Syndicate is a noble organization.

Medici Perandus: Prefect to the Treasury and an advisor who worked with Cadiro. They "devised many clever plots together to bolster the wealth of the Treasury."

Lazhwar: an old archbishop of the Eternal Faith who secretly conducted dark experiments, using thaumaturgy to create his own miniature worlds (maps) in which he could rule as a god. Malachai studied his work with interest, using Lazhwar's designs as the foundation for his Eternal Laboratory. When Emperor Voll took power, Malachai freely gave Lazhwar over to the Purity Courts. Lazhwar was burned at the stake for "fraternizing with unholy forces."

Malachai, the Soulless: a thaumaturgist who received the favor of Chitus. After studying the works of the Vaal with the unwilling help of Icius Perandus, he rediscovered the art of implanting Virtue Gems into people. He used this to turn imperial citizens into Gemlings, to create the powerful Gemling legionnaires, and to turn the empire's slaves into creatures more fit for their assigned labor. He was given Dialla, a former concubine of Chitus', who he fell in love with and turned into the Gemling Queen. He also experimented with maps, inspired by Lazhwar's designs as well as visions from the Beast. Following the Purity Rebellion and the death of Chitus, he convinced Voll to spare him by claiming he could destroy the Beast and thus wipe out the source of all thaumaturgy. However, he betrayed Voll and abandoned Dialla, and instead used the Rapture Device to enter and take control of the Beast. He used the Beast's power of Nightmare to incite a Cataclysm that destroyed the Eternal Empire and wiped out any resistance to his plan of shaping the world into his own vision. He also resurrected Shavronne, Maligaro, Doedre and Piety to act as his servants.

Icius Perandus: a Scholar to the Empire who was coerced by Malachai into helping him translate and study Vaal artefacts. (In 3.5 it was revealed he was connected to the Order of the Djinn, though this lore was removed in 3.16. Per this lore, the Order of the Djinn later rescued him from Malachai's grasp. Icius planned against the theft and plundering of artefacts by Cadiro and

helped the Order enact a plan to prevent the Cataclysm, which had been foreseen. Though the plan failed to save the Eternal Empire, Icius did manage to save some people's lives.)

Shavronne of Umbra: a student under Malachai who became one of the Godless Three. She experimented with transfiguration and the implantation of Virtue Gems into people. During the Purity Rebellion she created a thaumaturgical barrier to prevent the Karui invaders from reaching the inner empire. She also turned Brutus, the Warden of Axiom Prison, into a monster to stop the Karui from advancing beyond the prison. Brutus turned on her and killed her. She was later resurrected by Malachai after the Cataclysm and resided in the Harvest guarding Malachai's entrails.

Kadavrus the Defiler: Surgeon to the Umbra and a necromancer.

Brutus: the Warden of Axiom Prison. During the Purity Rebellion Brutus chose to have Shavronne of Umbra transform him into a powerful creature, who Shavronne intended to use to stop the Karui from entering the inner empire after they had defeated Marceus Lioneye. Brutus himself turned on and killed Shavronne.

Maligaro: a student under Malachai who became one of the Godless Three. He used thaumaturgy and the extracted essence of Virtue Gems to create a number of monsters, including the Great White Beast. He turned his own assistant, Raulo, into a creature named Fidelitas. During the Purity Rebellion Maligaro was burned at the stake by High Templar Voll on his way to lay siege to Sarn. He was later resurrected by Malachai after the Cataclysm and resided in the Harvest guarding Malachai's heart.

Fidelitas, the Mourning: formerly a man named Raulo, who was Maligaro's assistant. Maligaro injected the extracted essence of a Virtue Gem into Raulo, turning him into a creature who he named *Fidelitas* (Latin for "faithfulness" or "loyalty") in honor of his sacrifice. Fidelitas remained alive in the Chamber of Sins until discovered by Piety more than 250 years later.

The Prisoner: a nearly-unkillable being with strong regenerative powers. He was created by Maligaro and it took three legions to capture him. He couldn't be killed by Izaro, so was locked away in an island prison. After the Cataclysm, ships stopped coming to the island so the guards started cutting pieces off of him to feed to the other prisoners and quell them, and his flesh would then grow back. His cell flooded and he drowned for centuries.

Doedre "Darktongue" Stamatis: a student under Malachai who became one of the Godless Three. Maligaro was her master and was responsible for removing her tongue, earning her her nickname. During the Purity Rebellion she was burned at the stake by High Templar Voll on his way to lay siege to Sarn. She was later resurrected by Malachai after the Cataclysm and resided in the Harvest guarding Malachai's lungs.

Lady Dialla, the Gemling Queen: a former concubine of Chitus' who was given to Malachai for talking too much and asking too many questions. During the Purity Rebellion she met and befriended Victario Nevalius. Malachai turned her into a Gemling that he considered to be his finest work, and she became known as the Gemling Queen. As a Gemling, she betrayed Victario and killed his lover, Marylene. She loved Malachai and after the Rebellion wished to remain with him. However, he secretly planned to take control of the Beast and harness its power, and knew (despite loving her) that he couldn't take her with him. He therefore told her she'd have

to die in order for him to kill the Beast, knowing she'd refuse and that it would break her heart, but also knowing it would cause her to leave and thus spare her from his Cataclysm. Not having been aware of his plans, Dialla was left believing she was to blame for the Rapture Device failing to kill the Beast, when in actuality Malachai had never built it for that purpose.

Victario Nevalius, the People's Poet: a man who says he came from a long line of scholars, poets, and artists. A key figure in the Purity Rebellion, he helped High Templar Voll recruit others, including the Karui and Ezomytes, to the cause. Initially he convinced Emperor Chitus to allow him to visit the front lines of the rebellion to act as a chronicler, until he was discovered as a spy for the rebellion by Malachai. Afterwards he went underground and promoted the rebellion among the common people of Sarn, operating from the sewers. He was a friend of Dialla's before she became a Gemling, and was briefly the lover of Marylene before she was killed protecting him. Two of his works were "The Three Dragons" and "O' Eternal." He stole a powerful toxin capable of killing Gemlings from Maligaro, which Lord Mayor Ondar later used to kill Emperor Chitus. Victario died in the Cataclysm.

Lorenzi: first violinist of the Sarn Symphonic and friend of Victario Nevalius. He became a Gemling by having Malachai embed a Virtue Gem in his left palm so that he could have the fastest fingers in the empire. Victario disapproved of this as he felt it perverted Lorenzi into something other than a person, and he wrote about it to promote the Purity Rebellion.

"Fair" Marylene: a skilled fighter in Sarn arena and one of the leaders of the Purity Rebellion. She was raised in the slums by her maidservant mother. The identity of her father remains a mystery but was possibly Kre Faarblood. She was called "Fair" due to her dance-like style of fighting. She was a leader of the Purity Rebellion among the common people of Sarn, operating from the sewers. Victario Nevalius was briefly her lover. She was killed while protecting Victario early in the siege of Sarn by Dialla, who'd been newly turned into a Gemling.

Kre Faarblood: the duelist and swordsman who trained Chitus for the labyrinth. He was possibly Fair Marylene's father. Chitus discovered he was a commoner and only pretending to be of noble blood, and had Cadiro quietly try and execute him.

Kalisa Maas: an opera singer and the Prima Donna of Sarn, who became a Gemling when she had a Virtue Gem implanted in her throat. She gave her final performance in Sarn arena before Malachai unveiled his Gemling legionnaires. She was slain by her own composer, Adamantia. Kalisa's screams were so powerful that they killed Adamantia as well, and both of their souls became trapped inside a crossbow (presumably the weapon used by Adamantia). Kalisa's throat gem was later set into a necklace known as the Star of Wraeclast and given by Daresso, King of Swords in Oriath, to his beloved Lady Merveil. The gem twisted Merveil into a monster.

Adamantia Brektov: a composer who wrote at least one opera sung by Kalisa Maas. She later killed Kalisa, though Kalisa's Virtue Gem-empowered screams were so powerful that they in turn killed Adamantia. Both of their souls then became trapped inside a crossbow (presumably the weapon used by Adamantia)

Captain Alsarus: captain of what Malachai considered to be his finest group of Gemling legionnaires. During the siege of Sarn, Malachai ordered him and his legionnaires to remain at the warehouse, far enough from Emperor Chitus that they would not be affected by his heart

gem if he were killed. His men and women are likely the only Gemling legionnaires to have survived following the Purity Rebellion and Cataclysm.

Marceus Lioneye: a lord and general for the Eternal Empire. He led campaigns against the Karui and imprisoned them on Oriath, using Lioneye's Watch as a supply station. He was called "Lioneye" due to having his left eye taken out and replaced with a Virtue Gem. During the Purity Rebellion, the Karui, led by Kaom, invaded the coast and defeated Lioneye and his legion. It is said that after killing him, Kaom wore Lioneye's head on his belt. He somehow now resides in the Domain of Timeless Conflict, where he seems to believe he is still fighting against the Purity Rebellion.

Hector Titucius: a general who served under Emperor Chitus. He was an Ezomyte by birth. During Chitus' reign he had Malachai replace his joints with Virtue Gems. He was general of the Vastiri legion and charged by Chitus with subduing the Maraketh and holding their conquered lands, earning himself the nickname "Scourge of the Maraketh." Sekhema Asenath united the Maraketh tribes against the empire and attacked Sarn, but was defeated and killed by Hector. During the Purity Rebellion, Sekhema Deshret led her *akhara* to war against him in order to win back their conquered lands. They were successful, and Hector was killed. Deshret is said to have fashioned a rhoa saddle from his skin. Despite this, Hector was reanimated by the Cataclysm and remained in the Bath House, where his tomb was located.

Dimos: an advisor to General Titucius.

Gaius Sentari: a governor and general who served under Emperor Chitus and ran the "civilisation camps" that held the enslaved Ezomytes. During the Purity Rebellion the Ezomyte slaves rebelled, led by Thane Rigwald. Gaius fought back, but was ultimately defeated and killed by Rigwald in what became known as the Bloody Flowers' Rebellion.

Praetor Draven Sentari: an Eternal chosen as the custodian of Ogham. Instead of coming in peace to negotiate with the Ezomytes, he instead invaded Lachlann's village in the night and took Lachlann's family hostage to try and force a surrender. In return, Draven's son and daughter were killed. Draven was buried in a mausoleum in the cemetery the Eternals built in Ogham, though his cause of death is unknown. He remains there, undead, apparently due to Asinia's thaumaturgy. (In POE I there's a reference to a Draven and Asinia Grattus, though these seem to be different people.)

Asinia Sentari: a servant to Draven's family. It's claimed that she aspired to replace his first wife, so poisoned her. Draven later married her. She was a witch who had darkness within her, which Draven embraced. Per the Witch player character (POE II) she was from a coven of black thaumaturgy. She put hexes on the Ezomyte graves in their graveyard in Ogham so that the dead couldn't die, and the Ezomytes sing of her cruelty. She and Draven had a son and a daughter, though they were killed after the invasion of Ogham. She was buried in a tomb in the cemetery the Eternals built in Ogham, though her cause of death is unknown. However, she claims to have studied dark thaumaturgy and "transcended the chains of the flesh." (In POE I there's a reference to a Draven and Asinia Grattus, though these seem to be different people.)

Commander Adus: the legionnaire responsible for controlling the Karui, Maraketh and Ezomyte slaves who mined Highgate in search of Virtue Gems. He is said to have treated the slaves fairly and as human beings. During the Purity Rebellion he sided with High Templar Voll. He had a

secret penchant for archaeology and discovered a Maraketh artefact, the Calendar, in the foothills outside of Highgate. After the fall of the empire, he was reanimated by the Cataclysm.

Archbishop Geofri of Phrecia, the Abashed: a Templar and theologian who deplored anything thaumaturgical and therefore sided with Voll during the Purity Rebellion. It was Geofri who coined the title "Chamber of Sins" for Maligaro's lab, located near Geofri's Phrecia Cathedral (now the Fellshrine ruins). He sent his men to destroy Maligaro and his work, but Maligaro stopped them and struck back, attacking Phrecia Cathedral. Geofri was slain with Maligaro's Etcher at the foot of Saint Corutino the Golden Hand's Shrine. Geofri was reanimated by the Cataclysm into a Brittle Templar of some power.

Ondar: the Lord Mayor of Sarn during the Purity Rebellion. While he was a friend of Emperor Chitus, he secretly sided with the rebels. During the celebration of the Night of a Thousand Ribbons, Ondar stabbed and killed Chitus with blades tainted with a virulent poison (which Victario Nevalius had stolen from Maligaro). Before dying, Chitus managed to cleave Ondar in twain, and both died on the steps of the Sceptre of God. It was this event that brought the Purity Rebellion to a successful end and resulted in the coronation of High Templar Voll as emperor. After the Cataclysm Ondar's ghost remained behind, roaming the Grand Promenade.

Governor Kastov: Governor of Stridevolf and an ally of High Templar Voll's during the Purity Rebellion.

Trinian: Intellectus Prime who wrote about the history of the Vaal and the founding of the Eternal Empire. He was a Gemling who had a Virtue Gem implanted in his cranium. When the Cataclysm began and Sarn fell, he became one of the Undying and remained in the Archives within Sarn's Library.

Garivaldi: Chronicler to the Empire who recorded the events of the Purity Rebellion and its aftermath leading up to the Cataclysm.

Aramil: Cartographer to Emperor Chitus.

Caliga, Imperatrix: a Gemling aristocrat who became one of the Undying following the Cataclysm. She remains in the Sceptre of God.

Perpetus: one of the Undying who remains in the Slums.

Balabus Arimor: a little-known preacher during the days of Emperor Chitus, who believed eternal life could be achieved through ritual sacrifice.

Tani: a woman who lived in a village between Phrecia Cathedral and the Chamber of Sins during the fall of the Eternal Empire. She recorded some of the events of the Cataclysm in the form of wood etchings, before likely falling victim to the reanimated dead.

Denirus: Tani's husband. After the Cataclysm began to cause people to have violent and twisted night terrors, he went to Alliston in search of a doctor who could help. He did not return for three lunari, and when he did it was in the form of an undead creature who hunted Tani.

Corin: one of Tani's daughters, who had nightmares as a result of the Cataclysm. When the corrupted villagers came for her, she went to them with open arms. She was killed and reanimated, and began to hunt Tani.

Bravalo: a smith in Tani's village who was twisted by the Cataclysm. He hunted Tani and killed her uncle. He remains to this day in the Crossroads, animated by the Cataclysm.

Grattus: an unknown member of the Grattus family associated with the Eternal Empire, who was spoken about by Undertaker Arimor. Not much is known about him/her other than they are referred to as tactful and unseen, suggesting they had an important but behind-the-scenes role. Grattus wielded a dagger.

Forael, the Soulkeeper: a necromancer in the Empire's island prison.

PERANDUS GUARDIANS

Junith Perandus, Keeper of Vaults: a member of the Perandus family sustained by Prospero to guard the family's caches of wealth.

Tantalo Perandus, Seller of Secrets: a member of the Perandus family sustained by Prospero to guard the family's caches of wealth.

Actaeo Perandus, Master of Beasts: a member of the Perandus family sustained by Prospero to guard the family's caches of wealth.

Vitorica Perandus, Maker of Marvels: a member of the Perandus family sustained by Prospero to guard the family's caches of wealth.

Stasius Perandus, Merchant of Corpses: a member of the Perandus family sustained by Prospero to guard the family's caches of wealth.

Darsia Perandus, Collector of Debts: a member of the Perandus family sustained by Prospero to guard the family's caches of wealth.

Milo Perandus, Handler of Swords: a member of the Perandus family sustained by Prospero to guard the family's caches of wealth.

Celona, Vault Sentry: a Perandus associate bound by Prospero to guard the family's wealth.

Hortus, Knee Breaker: a Perandus associate bound by Prospero to guard the family's wealth.

Kuto, Hired Muscle: a Perandus associate bound by Prospero to guard the family's wealth.

Luthis, Bounty Hunter: a Perandus associate bound by Prospero to guard the family's wealth.

Belatra, Hired Assassin: a Perandus associate bound by Prospero to guard the family's wealth.

Liana, Indebted Peasant: a slain Perandus debtor bound by Prospero in eternal servitude to guard the family's wealth.

Marius, Indebted Smuggler: a slain Perandus debtor bound by Prospero in eternal servitude to guard the family's wealth.

Vera, Indebted Aristocrat: a slain Perandus debtor bound by Prospero in eternal servitude to guard the family's wealth.

Percia, Indebted Poacher: a slain Perandus debtor bound by Prospero in eternal servitude to guard the family's wealth.

RECENT TIMES

Albus Arimor: an undertaker who considers himself the last true citizen of the Eternal Empire. He employs exiles (including Torr Olgosso and Igna Phoenix) in collecting the scattered spirits of the Eternal Empire, which are haunting the monsters of Wraeclast. He refuses to disclose his purpose, though it's hinted that his line has been working to bring about the return of the Eternal Empire. Catarina was formerly his apprentice, though they didn't end on good terms. He also corresponds with the Breaker of Oaths.

UNKNOWN

Saint Corutino: a Templar known as "the Golden Hand" who lived in Phrecia Cathedral.

Erasmus: Imperial Gemcutter.

Hadrius Veruso: a member of the Veruso family. Nothing is known about Hadrius' life. After death, his spirit was full of anguish and haunted Wraeclast.

Titiana Veruso: a member of the Veruso family. Nothing is known about Titiana's life. After death, her spirit was full of anguish and haunted Wraeclast.

Claudia Veruso: a member of the Veruso family. Nothing is known about Claudia's life. After death, her spirit was full of anguish and haunted Wraeclast.

Fausta Veruso: a member of the Veruso family. Nothing is known about Fausta's life. After death, her spirit was full of anguish and haunted Wraeclast.

Albanus Phrecia: a member of the Phrecia family, which ruled over the empire for most of its duration. Nothing is known about Albanus' life. After death, his spirit was full of anguish and haunted Wraeclast.

Valerius Phrecia: a member of the Phrecia family, which ruled over the empire for most of its duration. Nothing is known about Valerius' life. After death, his spirit was full of anguish and haunted Wraeclast. (This is probably not the same person as Admiral Valerius, who isn't dead.)

Fabricia Phrecia: a member of the Phrecia family, which ruled over the empire for most of its duration. Nothing is known about Fabricia's life. After death, her spirit was full of anguish and haunted Wraeclast.

Iris Phrecia: a member of the Phrecia family, which ruled over the empire for most of its duration. Nothing is known about Iris' life. After death, her spirit was full of anguish and haunted Wraeclast.

Drusia Perandus: a member of the wealthy Perandus family. Nothing is known about Drusia's life. After death, her spirit was full of anguish and haunted Wraeclast.

Lucilius Perandus: a member of the wealthy Perandus family. Nothing is known about Lucilius' life. After death, his spirit was full of anguish and haunted Wraeclast.

Quintio Perandus: a member of the wealthy Perandus family. Nothing is known about Quintio's life. After death, their spirit was full of anguish and haunted Wraeclast.

Kostian Perandus: a member of the wealthy Perandus family. Nothing is known about Kostian's life. After death, his spirit was full of anguish and haunted Wraeclast.

Lilius Nevalius: a member of the Nevalius family, a long line of scholars, poets, and artists. Nothing is known about Kostian's life. After death, his spirit was full of anguish and haunted Wraeclast.

Octavius Nevalius: a member of the Nevalius family, a long line of scholars, poets, and artists. Nothing is known about Octavius' life. After death, his spirit was full of anguish and haunted Wraeclast.

Marius Nevalius: a member of the Nevalius family, a long line of scholars, poets, and artists. Nothing is known about Marius's life. After death, his spirit was full of anguish and haunted Wraeclast. (This is possibly the same person as the Perandus debtor.)

Julianis Nevalius: a member of the Nevalius family, a long line of scholars, poets, and artists. Nothing is known about Julianis' life. After death, her spirit was full of anguish and haunted Wraeclast.

Asinia Grattus: a member of the Grattus family. Nothing is known about Asinia's life. After death, her spirit was full of anguish and haunted Wraeclast.

Legius Grattus: a member of the Grattus family. Nothing is known about Legius' life. After death, their spirit was full of anguish and haunted Wraeclast.

Tyche Grattus: a member of the Grattus family. Nothing is known about Tyche's life. After death, her spirit was full of anguish and haunted Wraeclast.

Draven Grattus: a member of the Grattus family. Nothing is known about Draven's life. After death, his spirit was full of anguish and haunted Wraeclast.

TEMPLARS/ORIATHANS

ANTIQUITY

Maxarius, a.k.a. Innocence, God-Emperor of Eternity: an Azmeri man who became the first high templar. Per legend, he was gifted the Sign of Purity by the god Innocence, with which he "smote with flame the army of the faithless with one ray of its hallowing light." According to Lycia, this is a lie, and Maxarius was actually Innocence himself. Per her, he sought the power and wealth of divinity by taking advantage of a group of newcomers (who had likely encountered The Cleansing Fire or its champions) and their fear of fire, as well as vilifying his brother, eventually amassing enough followers to ascend to godhood. Many of the Azmeri regarded his new religion as a cult, and at some point they were banished, later settling on the island of Oriath.

Sin, Thief of Virtue: the brother of Innocence. His brother vilified him, giving Innocence an enemy to attack in order to amass enough followers and support to ascend to godhood. As a result, Sin ascended to godhood as well. Per Sin, he was in Utzaal in his youth and the Vaal were the height of civilisation at the time. He also loved the Maraketh people, and married Garukhan and had a daughter, Shakari, with her. Sin and Garukhan were together "longer than the lives of many mortal men," though eventually split up. He came to see the gods as a group of petty, warlike tyrants using the rest of humanity as pawns. It's implied that he spoke to Kalandra about this, and that her advice led him to create the Beast. At some point he answered a royal invitation from Arakaali and visited her as an emissary for a small and fragile alliance of (mostly weak) gods. She ensnared him with the illusion of love and leisure, while in reality he was trapped and unable to leave. He remained with her for years, until she began to succumb to the Beast. At that point her followers betrayed her, binding her in silk. This allowed Sin to escape, before succumbing to the Beast himself. After Sin awoke following the death of the Beast, he was burdened by guilt over the cataclysms that had occurred involving the Beast, though says if given the choice would still have done the same thing.

MIDDLE YEARS OF THE EMPIRE

High Templar Andronicus: (see Eternals.)

DURING & AFTER THE FALL OF THE ETERNAL EMPIRE

High Templar Voll: (see Eternals.)

Daresso: an orphaned slave who rose to become the King of Swords in the Grand Arena of Theopolis. He was trained as a fighter from a young age, eventually beginning to fight in the Grand Arena. There he met and fell in love with Lady Merveil. Inspired by her, he defeated the previous King of Swords and then asked her to marry him. He presented her with the Star of Wraeclast, a necklace set with a Virtue Gem that had previously been implanted in Kalisa Maas' throat. Merveil was twisted by the gem into a monster, causing Daresso to travel to Sarn in search of a way to reverse the transformation. He brought documents on the subject of thaumaturgy back to Oriath. After travelling to Wraeclast a final time he never returned, but instead somehow became trapped in his own dream inside the Highgate Mines.

Barkhul: a man whom Daresso challenged and defeated in the fighting pits in Theopolis, possibly his first kill.

Merveil: a lady who attended fights at the Grand Arena of Theopolis. There she was seen by Daresso, who fell in love with her and was inspired to win the Crown of Swords. He asked her to marry him and presented her with the Star of Wraeclast, a necklace set with a Virtue Gem that had previously been implanted in Kalisa Maas' throat. The gem gave her a beautiful voice, enabling her to sing opera in the largest concert halls of Oriath. However, the gem also began to twist her into a monster. Daresso left and promised to travel to Sarn in search of a cure. However, he never succeeded. She fled from Oriath and took up residence on the southern coast of Wraeclast. There, she lured sailors to their deaths to feed her children.

Cardinal Sanctus Vox: a Templar general who ended up in the Domain of Timeless conflict. He refers to Voll, so would've lived during or after Voll's time, but lived at least a few generations before Vic and Vinny Vox ([reference](#)).

RECENT TIMES

TEMPLAR OFFICIALS & RELATED CHARACTERS

Venarius: a high templar of Oriath. As a child he witnessed the brutal oppression of the Templars and grew to secretly despise them while rising through their ranks. He was determined to become powerful, and to this end sent smugglers to Wraeclast in search of powerful artefacts such as Malachai's map device, which he had Valdo Caeserius repair and attempt to weaponize. The device allowed him entry to the dreamlands (maps) created by the Elder. Venarius met with the Elder and restored its shade to its body, after which it fed on him and his memories.

Valdo Caeserius, a.k.a. the Shaper: a man named Valdo Caeserius who was the chief Arkhon of the Oriath academy in Theopolis. High Templar Venarius brought him a device recovered from Wraeclast and ordered him to repair and attempt to weaponize it. Valdo discovered that it opened the way to the dreamlands (maps) wherein dwelt the Elder, who taught him the ability of shaping things out of thin air. He attempted to hide this from Venarius, but the High Templar eventually learned the truth and forced Valdo to lead him to the Elder. Venarius restored the Elder to its physical body before being fed on by it. Valdo damaged the map device to close the portal between Theopolis and the dreamlands, exiling himself there with the intention of stopping the Elder and protecting his daughter Zana and the rest of Oriath.

Chimera: one of the Guardians of the Void protecting the entrance to the Shaper's Realm. He was possibly a Templar soldier who Venarius took into the Atlas with him.

Hydra: one of the Guardians of the Void protecting the entrance to the Shaper's Realm. She was possibly a Templar soldier who Venarius took into the Atlas with him.

Minotaur: one of the Guardians of the Void protecting the entrance to the Shaper's Realm. He was possibly a Templar soldier who Venarius took into the Atlas with him.

Phoenix: one of the Guardians of the Void protecting the entrance to the Shaper's Realm. He was possibly a Templar soldier who Venarius took into the Atlas with him.

Eagon Caeserius: a man raised by a foster family who came to believe he was the illegitimate son of Valdo Caeserius. He became obsessed with Valdo's work and with reaching or surpassing Valdo's achievements. To this end, he began exploring the Atlas and in doing so discovered threads of a person's memory that had been distorted by the Atlas. He believed this person was experimenting with the reality of the Atlas and had become trapped there. Through glimpsing these memories he realized it was Zana, who he believed to be his sister, and made it his mission to save her.

Dominus: the high templar of Oriath who succeeded Venarius. He had a last supper with a condemned criminal named Vinia and heard her confession. She told him of things that were possible through the use of thaumaturgy, and he decided to spare her. He created a laboratory for himself within Chitus Cathedral to study thaumaturgy. After renaming Vinia to Piety, he gave her charge of an expedition to Wraecclast to uncover its secrets. He began sentencing criminals to be banished to Wraecclast instead of put to death (likely to serve as test subjects for Piety's experiments). Through the use of thaumaturgy he became powerful and took up residence atop the Sceptre of God in Sarn.

Avarius: the man who succeeded Dominus as high templar. With Dominus away in Wraecclast, Avarius led some of the largest and most crippling raids against the Karui, bringing them back to Theopolis as slaves. He spent five thousand Karui lives building the Templar Courts and Chamber of Innocence. After the death of the Beast and return of the gods, Innocence took up residence inside him.

Casticus: a Templar justicar who supplied Karui slaves to Vilenta to experiment on for her research. When the slaves revolted, he was involved in attempting to quell the uprising.

Overseer Krow: a slave driver who worked in Theopolis' Slave Pens.

Cato, Scholar of Light: a priest in the Templar Courts. He testified against the Witch player character (POE I). He was killed following the rise of Kitava's cultists and the burning of the Courts, and was reborn as Cato, Defiler of Light.

The Matriarch: a Flame Mother in Oriath Square.

RESEARCHERS

Cassia: (see Exiles.)

Vinia, a.k.a. Piety: a poor Oriathan witch named Vinia who took to prostitution and selling her skills as a thaumaturgist to survive. She was arrested and condemned to death for "consorting with the unholy." Before her execution she had a last supper with High Templar Dominus, who heard her confession. She told him of things that were possible through the use of thaumaturgy, and he spared her. Renamed Piety, she was given charge of an expedition to Wraecclast to uncover its secrets. There she studied the works of the Godless Three and finally of Malachai himself. She experimented on numerous people, including those exiled from Oriath by Dominus, becoming quite proficient as a thaumaturgist. After being killed by an exile, she was revived by Malachai in the Belly of the Beast to be his servant.

Vilenta: a woman versed in medicine who devoted her life to Piety's work, experimenting on Karui slaves provided by Justicar Casticus. She created a device known as the miasmeter to sense and amplify the corruption in Wraecclast. When Piety began her expedition to Wraecclast Vilenta was left behind in Theopolis, leaving the latter furious. After the death of the Beast and the return of the gods, Vilenta got caught up in the Karui slave rebellion, but was spared by the rebels in return for saving Lani's life.

Davaro: a Templar who studied Vaal relics brought back to Theopolis from Wraecclast by High Templar Dominus. He discovered signs that the Vaal had dwelt on the island of Oriath. He became corrupted by the relics and began performing human sacrifice at one of their ancient sites. After doing so he began having visions of Queen Atziri. Falling in love with her, he kidnapped and sacrificed two children before killing himself, believing that in doing so they would join Atziri and become a family.

Eramir: (see Exiles.)

Divinia: an Adjunct Archivist of the Templar Order, academic, and relic enthusiast, who discovered an abandoned Templar enclave beneath the ruins of Fellshrine and seeks to explore it in order to learn more about Templar history. She met Helena while studying, as they pursued similar fields of research, and Divinia thinks fondly of her.

Lucan Octavius: a wealthy Oriathan alchemist of high status. Tane described him as fatherly and genial in public, but violent and lustful at home. He kept a safe distance from many of his experiments while having Tane handle the dangerous materials. Lucan created a concoction he called Sinner's Water, which he believed would draw out a person's or creature's Intrinsic Darkness, or base and violent instincts. He experimented with it by testing it on his own children and taking notes of their violent reactions. Due to Lucan's dark proclivities, Tane killed him in a fit of violence. The rest of Lucan's family were killed following Kitava's rise in Oriath.

Tane Octavius: a freedman from Oriath. He was formerly a Karui slave and became the apprentice to Lucan Octavius, who also gave him his name. He helped Lucan with his alchemical experiments, handling the more dangerous materials while his master watched from a safe distance. Tane was sometimes beaten by Lucan's children, after they were given a concoction to bring out their baser instincts as part of a series of experiments. Tane believed his master was a sick man with dark proclivities, and that Lucan passed the sickness on to him. In an uncharacteristic fit of violence, Tane killed his master. Since then, he's continued his master's search for what Tane calls the Intrinsic Darkness, a person's base and violent instincts. His ultimate goal is to isolate the Intrinsic Darkness from a person and destroy it, thereby purifying

them of their cruel impulses. Zana refers to him as a friend. (Fun fact: his name was originally spelled Tāne, but the accent mark was removed in 3.9.1 due to issues with character support.)

BLACKGUARDS

General Gravicius: the right hand of High Templar Dominus and general of the Ebony Legion. He was religious and claimed to fight for God. He stationed himself outside of the Lunar Temple while working to defeat the thaumaturgical creatures defending the Solaris Temple. After being slain by an exile from Oriath he was revived as a member of the Immortal Syndicate. He then claimed to serve a new God, who is implied to be Catarina, the Eternal One.

Declan: a person loyal to Dominus who was sent by him to protect and watch Piety as she studied the works of Shavronne, Maligaro and Malachai. A body probably belonging to Declan is found outside the Warden's chambers in Axiom Prison.

Arteri: a Blackguard captain and Piety's lover who she stationed in the western Phrecian Forest to prevent more exiles from entering the inner empire.

Aurelianus: a Blackguard captain stationed in the Solaris Concourse (which became known as the Battlefront) outside of the Solaris Temple to guard the Ribbon Spool and attempt to subdue the ribbons.

Vincenti: a Blackguard captain sent by Piety to Highgate to kill the remaining Maraketh and secure the entrance to the mines. He failed, and he and most of his men were killed.

Arturo: a Blackguard captain (possibly of the Oriath 3rd) whose unit didn't have many victories. Huck was in Arturo's unit.

Petarus: a captain in the Ebony Legion, like his father and grandfather. He met Vanja while she was a prisoner in Sarn, waiting to be experimented on by Piety. After falling in love with her, he deserted his post and freed her. Together they escaped to Highgate, and Vanja convinced the Kiyato to take them in.

Helena: an apprentice archaeologist from Oriath who claimed she could tell if a Vaal artefact was genuine simply by running her hand along it. She became convinced there was a pattern behind the absence of mythological artefacts and suspected a secret organization was at work, though her colleagues wouldn't listen. She accepted a position in the Ebony Legion to go on an expedition to Wraeclast but defected after witnessing the horrors of Piety's work. She was taken in by the Azmerians in the Forest Encampment, though remained paranoid that the scattered Blackguards remaining in Wraeclast were still hunting her for being a traitor. After the Fall of Oriath, she joined the Citizen Vanguard and served under Kirac.

Bannon: a Blackguard soldier who participated in a slave raid to Ngamakanui under High Templar Dominus. After the death of High Templar Avarius, the wounded god Innocence took up residence inside Bannon.

NAVY & RELATED CHARACTERS

Marcovius: a general and commander of the Templar Fleet under High Templar Avarius. As part of Operation Ocean Blades he was sent to Pondium Strait to massacre the Brinerot warband, but on the voyage there his fleet was attacked and mostly destroyed by the Brine King. He turned the survivors around and headed back for Oriath.

Admiral Darnaw: the Admiral of the Oriathan Navy. He changed the recruitment policy to allow boys to join the navy regardless of birth. He was corrupt and personally funded the Brinerot pirates.

Admiral Valerius: an admiral and possibly an Oriathan noble. Following the fall of Oriath he attacks shipping lanes and takes sailors prisoner, holding them for ransom. Faustus knows him (or of him) and insists Raulf not recruit him to work for the Kalguuran colonists.

Captain Fidium: a captain in the Oriathan Navy serving under Admiral Darnaw and alongside Captain Faustus. Per Faustus he is honest and clean, and suspects that Faustus is corrupt.

Captain Faustus: (see The Ring.)

Captain Caruso: captain of the ship *Lady in Waiting*. After the death of the Beast, he began to hear voices speaking of the Brine King's return. He tried to warn his crew, and sacrificed mutineers in the Brine King's name in the hope of appeasing him. However, his own men threw him overboard. The next morning the Brine King destroyed his ship. Caruso was stranded on a plank in the sea without food or water and hunted by the Brine King's crabs. The Templar player character (POE I) says he met Caruso's son.

Piken: first mate of the ship *Lady in Waiting*. The Brine King destroyed the ship and he was thrown into the sea. He washed up on a rock off the coast of the Twilight Strand and was hunted by the Brine King's crabs.

Benric: a man from Gulton who sought help from his friend Mercutio in rescuing a woman named Abi from the Brine King.

Abi: a woman Benric sought to rescue from the Brine King, most likely his wife (or possibly daughter).

Mercutio: a merchant and friend of Benric.

NOBLES

Nessa: a woman from Theopolis who used to live on an estate. The Ranger once stole a leg of venison from its grounds and was chased by her father's gamekeepers. She seems to have known the Duelist and Templar before they were exiled as well. Nessa's father was involved in trying to "save" the Karui from "ignorance and damnation," which ended up costing him his life. It is implied that he (along with everyone else she ever loved) died in a shipwreck. Nessa survived and made it to Wraeclast, where she resided in Lioneys's Watch caring for the exiles and other survivors who came through.

Clarissa: (see Exiles.)

Lani: a woman born from the union of an Oriathan lord and a Karui woman. She was educated in Oriath but sided with the Karui slaves in their uprising. She helped pass information to the rebels that she obtained from the nobility of Theopolis. She was also a fighter, and when the slaves rebelled she killed two overseers before being wounded herself. Vilenta tended to her injuries and Lani credited her with saving her life.

Victario "Vic" Vox: a member of the Vox family, who have been Oriathan nobles for several generations and are possibly related to Cardinal Sanctus Vox (the timeframes are inexact, but there are at least a few generations separating them; [reference](#)). Recently, he and his twin brother have resorted to consorting with the criminal underworld and using coercion, blackmail, and violence to ensure their family retains its status. The Vox crime family are often in competition with the Ring for the same jobs. Vic's parents liked Victario Nevalius' work so much they named him after the poet.

Vincent "Vinny" Vox: a member of the Vox family, who have been Oriathan nobles for several generations and are possibly related to Cardinal Sanctus Vox (the timeframes are inexact, but there are at least a few generations separating them; [reference](#)). Recently, he and his twin brother have resorted to consorting with the criminal underworld and using coercion, blackmail, and violence to ensure their family retains its status. The Vox crime family are often in competition with the Ring for the same jobs.

Rhys of Abram: a noble who fled Oriath following the rise of Kitava on the island. The refugee ship he was on was plundered by cultists. His body washed ashore on the Twilight Strand and was reanimated.

TREASURE HUNTERS

Alva Valai: an Oriathan woman who has an interest in archaeology and exploration. Her exact past is unknown, as her accounts contain some discrepancies and also involves time travel. She claims that when she was young her father enlisted her in High Templar Dominus' navy. She later became a treasure hunter, teaming up with Oswald to explore ancient Vaal ruins. She has some Vaal blood in her ancestry and after discovering a book on Vaal blood thaumaturgy (the Eztli Pilli) during a temple raid, found she was able to travel through time. It's implied that she founded the Reliquarians, a secret society of treasure hunters funded by the upper class of Oriath, after travelling back in time to an earlier period when Oriath was prosperous and had accumulated artefacts from many different cultures. However, she claims that she hid the book from the high templar, not wanting it to fall into the wrong hands, and as a result was no longer welcome among the upper class of Oriath. She then continued hunting treasure on her own instead. She learned to perform a fickle spell using ancient waystones and her own Vaal blood that opened a portal to the Temple of Atzoatl in the past and helped her locate it in the present. Her personality is insouciant. It's very likely that she becomes The Last to Die.

Oswald: a veteran treasure hunter who's been on a number of expeditions. He serves as quartermaster, keeping lists of supplies and ensuring the expedition has everything it needs. He also keeps death logs of those who've been lost on expeditions, to serve as a guide of dangers

to avoid. He's grim, cautious, and tends to worry, and considers himself to have terrible luck so rarely leaves camp himself anymore. He established a relationship with the Kalgaurans in Kingsmarch and ships artefacts that his expeditions find back to them to sell. Despite his caution, he's eager for treasure and is particularly interested in Kamasa, the Vaal God of Wealth. He has recently partnered with Alva and seems slightly annoyed at her good luck while seeming to have bad luck himself.

Gwendolyn Albright: a treasure hunter and part of Oswald and Alva's expedition. She feels such explorations are dangerous, but the treasure keeps her coming back.

Sebastian Carroway: a treasure hunter and part of Oswald and Alva's expedition.

Florence Caley: a treasure hunter on one of Oswald's expeditions who survived two hundred and one days and was killed by being stabbed by the animated corpse of Oswyn Shipwash.

Denise Chernocke: a treasure hunter on one of Oswald's expeditions who survived three hundred and nine days and died from excessive night terrors.

Godsgift Eldysley: a treasure hunter on one of Oswald's expeditions who survived nineteen days and died from eating berries; he had to be dismembered and burned to ash to end his suffering.

Rowland Hayton: a treasure hunter on one of Oswald's expeditions who survived eighty-two days and was killed by ants.

Martin Henshawe: a treasure hunter on one of Oswald's expeditions who survived one hundred and seventy-eight days and died from touching a flower.

Osmund Laken: a treasure hunter on one of Oswald's expeditions who survived forty-five days and died by being bitten by a snake and then being burned alive after baby snakes burst out of him.

Cybil Launceleyn: a treasure hunter on one of Oswald's expeditions who survived two days and died of old age.

Jeffrye Monde: a treasure hunter on one of Oswald's expeditions who survived fifty-nine days; was snatched from the middle of the encampment and found dead in a tree suspended by an unidentifiable sticky substance.

Jacob Nesbit: a treasure hunter on one of Oswald's expeditions who survived twelve days and died by falling out of a tree and snapping his neck.

Mabel Salle: a treasure hunter on one of Oswald's expeditions who mostly kept to herself; she vanished at some point and no one else knows what happened to her.

Oswyn Shipwash: a treasure hunter on one of Oswald's expeditions who survived ninety-eight days and was killed by a chimera.

Clemence Trenoweth: a treasure hunter on one of Oswald's expeditions (and Gregory's wife?) who survived two hundred and two days and was killed by being eaten by the animated corpse of Florence Caley.

Gregory Trenowyth: a treasure hunter on one of Oswald's expeditions (and Clemence's husband?) who survived two hundred and two days and died of a heart attack from grief after burning the animated corpse of his wife.

SAILORS & OTHERS

Sigmund Fairgraves: a sailor, pirate, whaler, and explorer who opened the door to new lands (often at the expense of the natives). Fairgraves funded a number of expeditions using Karui slaves. He recovered documents about thaumaturgy from Wraecclast and brought them back to Oriath for Dominus. After setting sail on another mission to Wraecclast, he disappeared for over thirty years. It was later found that based on a myth, he had searched the inner empire and discovered the Allflame, which bestowed him with a "unique gift" and also provided the wind for his ship's sails. After rescuing a slave girl from the flesh pits of Trarthus, she turned his first mate against him and stole the Allflame, leaving him marooned in Merveil's ship graveyard.

Bestel: the only survivor from the ship *Merry Gull*, which ran aground on the Tidal Island while fleeing from pirates. The other survivors were killed by cannibals. Tarkleigh found him hiding in the wreckage and brought him to Lioneys Watch. He claimed to be the captain, though Tarkleigh says he saw Bestel steal the hat from the real captain's head.

Arrol: the *Merry Gull*'s cook. He was found dead and was buried by Bestel, though was reanimated by the Cataclysm within a few days.

Doctor "Shaky hands" Opden: the *Merry Gull*'s doctor. He was said to have been a poor surgeon but well versed with medicines and in possession of a large supply of opiates. He was spit-roasted and eaten by cannibals.

Utula Makora: a Karui slave in Oriath and adherent of Kitava, who led a slave uprising against the Templars. He was killed during Kitava's reign in Oriath and was welcomed in the Halls of the Dead as a hero for helping free the Karui slaves. However, he resents his presence there and feels it is an eternal prison, and wishes he could escape to the Chambers of the Dishonoured instead. He's a member of the Kitava Tribe.

Irwen of Theopolis: the person who transcribed Utula's oral recounting of Kitava's history.

EXILES

NPC EXILES

Tarkleigh: an exile from Oriath. He was the partner and lover of Lilly Roth for a time, and together they smuggled booze to make money. She began to fear that he planned to settle down and have children with her, so she betrayed him. She tied him up and abandoned him on Penance Quay, where he was captured by Blackguards and exiled to Wraecclast for his crimes. He remained at Lioneys Watch, helping the other exiles survive.

Eramir: an exile from Oriath. Prior to his exile, he was a scholar who worked at a museum. In return for Dominus' patronage, he conducted research into the thaumaturgical arts practiced within the Eternal Empire. He knew Valdo Caeserius and assisted him in uncovering information about the Elder and the Watchers of Decay. He also knew Valdo's daughter Zana, who referred to him as "Uncle Eramir." After his exile he was taken in by the Azmerians in the Forest Encampment.

Clarissa: an exile from Oriath. She initially lived with her family at a manor in the country. Her father lost the family fortune gambling at cards, forcing them to move to Theopolis. There she was given jobs by Hargan that kept food on the table for her and her family, though these are implied to have been illegal in nature. Vinia used to buy things from her before she became Piety. These illicit activities are likely the reason for her exile. After being exiled, Clarissa took up residence in the ruins of Sarn. She has dined with General Gravicius twice, the first time when her family was still in good standing, and the second time on the eve of her exile.

Tolman: Clarissa's boyfriend (and probably an exile from Oriath). He was captured by Piety while foraging in Sarn with Clarissa.

Hargan: a criminal who was exiled from Theopolis. He gave Clarissa jobs (that were probably illegal) while they were in Theopolis. He claims to have acted as Clarissa's guardian, though per her he likes to pretend that he's a kindly, uncle-like figure, while in reality he isn't generous and always makes sure he gets his pound of flesh in return for anything he gives. After his exile he took up residence in the ruins of Sarn.

Maramoa Patua: a Karui woman originally from Ngamakanui. She was exiled from Oriath by High Templar Dominus for insubordination, inciting insurrection, assaulting an officer of the Ebony Legion and hericide. After her exile she took up residence in the ruins of Sarn.

Petarus: (see Blackguards.)

Vanja: an Oriathan who trained as a witch before being exiled to Wraeclast. There she was imprisoned in Sarn and awaiting experimentation by Piety when Petarus freed her. Together they escaped to Highgate, and Vanja convinced the Kiyato to take them in.

Niko the Mad: an Oriathan who grew up selling Voltaxic Sulphite to the Templars for use in powering their strange experiments. Exposure to the substance eventually caused him to start hearing voices that told him secrets, and he began to think he was a prophet. He reported this to the Templars, thinking they would help him, but was instead committed to a mental asylum. He dug his way out and escaped through the square, but soldiers tracked him down using the trail left by his bleeding hands. He was caught and exiled to Wraeclast. There, he began exploring the mines below the ruins of the Eternal Empire using the Crawler, a machine he built out of an old Eternal torture device. Per Cavas, Niko is the only master able to see him in his ghostly form.

Cassia: a Templar skilled in the mechanical arts. She was tasked by High Templar Dominus with building devices to tap into the power of Virtue Gems. She felt this was not in line with God's plan, so only built him mechanisms that were useless for this purpose. In response, Dominus exiled her to Wraeclast and replaced her with Piety. Once in Wraeclast she discovered fungal

growths beginning to appear and built devices to extract their toxic fluid and kill them. She enjoys singing Templar hymns.

LORDS OF LARCENY

Kraityn of Theopolis: a criminal from Theopolis who was caught while attempting to help Lilly Roth steal back the Teardrop from the Theopolis Reliquary. He was exiled to Wraeclast by High Templar Dominus for a long list of crimes. Together with Oak and Alira he survived some "ordeals" along the Siren Coast and made his way to the Forest Encampment. Shortly thereafter the three of them discovered a Vaal artefact (the Apex) that had the power to enhance one's innate strengths. They fought over it and broke it in trine, each taking a piece. Kraityn fled and established his own camp atop the Broken Bridge, where he struggled against Oak and Alira for control of the Phrecian Forest. He has a scar on his face given to him by Oak.

Oak: a criminal from Oriath who was caught while attempting to help Lilly Roth steal back the Teardrop from the Theopolis Reliquary. He was exiled to Wraeclast by High Templar Dominus. Together with Kraityn and Alira he survived some "ordeals" along the Siren Coast and made his way to the Forest Encampment. Shortly thereafter the three of them discovered a Vaal artefact (the Apex) that had the power to enhance one's innate strengths. They fought over it and broke it in trine, each taking a piece. Oak fled and established his own camp in the Wetlands, where he struggled against Kraityn and Alira for control of the Phrecian Forest.

Alira Darktongue: a witch from Oriath who was caught while attempting to help Lilly Roth steal back the Teardrop from the Theopolis Reliquary. She was exiled to Wraeclast by High Templar Dominus. Together with Kraityn and Oak she survived some "ordeals" along the Siren Coast and made her way to the Forest Encampment. Shortly thereafter the three of them discovered a Vaal artefact (the Apex) that had the power to enhance one's innate strengths. They fought over it and broke it in trine, each taking a piece. Alira fled and established her own camp to the west, where she struggled against Kraityn and Oak for control of the Phrecian Forest.

THE CONQUERORS OF THE ATLAS & RELATED CHARACTERS

Zana Caeserius, Master Cartographer: a woman who was exiled to Wraeclast. She was the daughter of Valdo Caeserius and an unnamed woman. Her mother stood up to the Templars about the truth about Innocence and paid for this with her life when Zana was young. When she was five, her father exiled himself to the Atlas of Worlds in an attempt to protect her and the rest of Oriath from the Elder. Orphaned, Zana lived in a series of well-off foster homes as an indentured servant. She studied the research left behind by father and managed to rebuild his map device. Her curiosity and tendency to question everything drew the ire of High Templar Dominus, and she moved to Wraeclast before her impending exile. After the defeat of Kitava she returned to Theopolis and began exploring the Atlas, recruiting exiles to assist her.

Sirus: a smuggler who was exiled from Oriath. He was recruited by Zana to help her explore the Atlas of Worlds, and was the group's leader. He and Zana became close. After the group

discovered the Elder, Sirius sacrificed himself to stop the Elder, forcing both of them out of reality. He eventually got free, but was trapped in the Atlas and unable to feel anything.

Al-Hezmin: a member of the Redblade warband who was exiled from Oriath. He was good at tracking and navigating land, and was recruited by Zana to help her explore the Atlas of Worlds. The group discovered the Elder and sealed it away. However, the Atlas' influence caused him to become obsessed with being better than the others, and he threatened to clash with Drox. The others slipped away in the night and left him. Frightened of what the exiles were becoming, Zana sealed the group in the Atlas. Al-Hezmin became more and more delusional, uncertain of what was real or not or how much time had passed. He discovered the Watchstones' ability to reveal new paths in the Atlas and sought to use them to escape.

Drox: an exile from Oriath. He was recruited by Zana to help her explore the Atlas of Worlds and was their commander in battle. The group discovered the Elder and sealed it away. However, the Atlas' influence caused him to become obsessed with creating a kingdom in the Atlas and establishing law, and he became distant towards the rest of the group. Zana pulled the rest of the group away from him. Frightened of what the exiles were becoming, Zana sealed them in the Atlas. Drox became more and more obsessed with violence and death. He discovered the Watchstones' ability to reveal new paths in the Atlas and sought to use them to escape.

Veritania: a woman who was exiled from Oriath for excessive charity. She was reserved and believed people were responsible for their own actions, and was recruited by Zana to help explore the Atlas of Worlds. The group discovered the Elder and sealed it away. However, the Atlas' influence caused her to become contemptuous of the others except for Drox, and she broke away from the group not long after they left him. Frightened of what the exiles were becoming, Zana sealed the group in the Atlas. Veritania became more and more delusional, uncertain of what was real or not or how much time had passed. She discovered the Watchstones' ability to reveal new paths in the Atlas and sought to use them to escape.

Baran: a Templar who was exiled from Oriath. He was Kirac's younger brother and was friends with Cassia. He disdained Dominus but had a strong faith in God, and was recruited by Zana to help her explore the Atlas of Worlds. The group discovered the Elder and sealed it away. However, the Atlas' influence caused him to lose his sanity as the group dwindled, until only he and Zana were left, and then they parted ways. Frightened of what the exiles were becoming, Zana sealed the group in the Atlas. Baran became more and more delusional, eventually believing he himself was God. He discovered the Watchstones' ability to reveal new paths in the Atlas and sought to use them to escape.

Kirac: Baran's older brother. He was a tracker and career military man. At one point he was assigned to a company tasked with hunting down groups of problematic rogue exiles. He also fought the Harbingers at the Battle of Phaaryl, after which he had nightmares for months. Following Kitava's demise, he returned to Oriath from a distant deployment and became an officer in the Citizen Vanguard, which was formed to protect the island from similar threats in the future. He became concerned by his brother's absence, and began searching for Baran and Zana, intending to arrest the latter and bring her to justice for her radical activities. After Baran's death, Sirius' defeat, and the second fall of Oriath, he became the Commander of the Citizen Vanguard. He says he worked "tangentially" with Cassia in the past, though she probably doesn't remember him.

Galhad: Baran's father.

Landren: a former Templar who served in the Courts along with Baran before being exiled. He is implied to have been Baran's lover.

Herules: a former Templar and friend of Baran who was exiled.

Gomin: a former Templar and friend of Baran who was exiled.

ROGUE EXILES, POE

Ailentia Rac: a Ranger rogue exile who wields a bow.

Ainsley Varrich: a Duelist rogue exile who wields a bow.

Antalie Napora: a Ranger rogue exile who wields a bow.

Antonio Bravadi: a Duelist rogue exile who wields a bow.

Aria Vindicia: a Witch rogue exile who wields two wands.

Armios Bell: a Duelist rogue exile who wields two swords.

Ash Lessard: a Shadow rogue exile who wields a claw and a shield.

Augustina Solaria: a Scion rogue exile who wields a two-handed sword.

Aurelio Voidsinger: a Templar rogue exile who wields a staff.

Baracus Phraxisanct: a Templar rogue exile who wields a dagger and a shield.

Bolt Brownfur: a Marauder rogue exile who wields a two-handed sword.

Damoi Tui: a Marauder rogue exile who wields a two-handed mace.

Darbel LePage: a Scion rogue exile who wields a two-handed sword.

Dena Lorenni: a Witch rogue exile who wields a wand and a shield.

Doven Falsetongue: a Templar rogue exile who wields a sword and shield.

Eoin Greyfur: a Templar rogue exile who wields a sword and shield.

Haki Karukaru: a Marauder rogue exile who wields a shield.

Ignia Phoenix: a Witch rogue exile who wields a staff.

Ion Darkshroud: a Shadow rogue exile who wields two claws.

Jade: a Scion rogue exile who wields a two-handed sword.

Jarek Irontrap: a Shadow rogue exile who wields two daggers.

Jonah Unchained: a Marauder rogue exile who wields a sword and shield.

Kirmes Olli: a Witch rogue exile who wields two daggers.

Lael Furia: a Scion rogue exile who wields a sword and shield.

Magnus Stonethorn: a Templar rogue exile who wields a wand and a shield.

Minara Anemina: a Witch rogue exile who wields a wand and a shield.

Ohne Trix: a Marauder rogue exile.

Orra Greengate: a Ranger rogue exile who wields a bow.

Oyra Ona: a Duelist rogue exile who wields a bow.

Sevet Tetherein: a Marauder rogue exile who wields a two-handed sword.

Silva Fearsting: a Ranger rogue exile who wields a bow.

Thena Moga: a Ranger rogue exile who wields a sword and shield.

Thom Imperial: a Shadow rogue exile who wields a wand and shield.

Tinevin Highdove: a Templar rogue exile who wields a two-handed mace.

Torr Olgosso: a Duelist rogue exile who wields a two-handed sword.

Ultima Thule: a Witch rogue exile who wields a staff.

Ulysses Morvant: a Shadow rogue exile who wields a wand and a shield.

Vanth Agiel: a Scion rogue exile who wields a two-handed mace.

Vickas Giantbone: a Marauder rogue exile who wields a staff.

Wilorin Demontamer: a Shadow rogue exile who wields a wand and a shield.

Xandro Blooddrinker: a Marauder rogue exile who wields a two-handed mace.

Zacharie Desmarais: a Duelist rogue exile who wields two swords.

ROGUE EXILES, POE II

Adrienne, the Malignant Rose: a Ranger rogue exile who wields a bow and poisons her opponents. She considers herself a scientist who likes to study the results of her toxins. She seems to know Renly and the Warrior player character and thus may be from the Ogham area.

Bronnach, the Manhunter: a Ranger rogue exile who wields a bow and uses cold damage. She lives to fight and considers opponents playthings. She says the Huntress player character is an Azmerian "not of her time."

Ciara, the Curse Weaver: a Witch rogue exile who casts curses and chaos spells and can summon minions. She's a believer in the Drafocht but believes the Spirit lies, and refers to the Ranger player character as a member of "the traitorous bloodline" whose "foremothers betrayed us." She sees death as a "strand snapped from the loom." It's hinted that Ciara is an Ezomyte.

Doran, the Deft: a Monk rogue exile who uses both a quarterstaff and unarmed attacks and specializes in cold damage. He's agile and evasive. He enjoys fighting and gets bored when he doesn't have an opponent.

Drusian, the Artillerist: a Mercenary rogue exile who wields a crossbow and ballistae to fire explosive and icy attacks. He considers himself an artist with artillery and Verisium and loves his job. He's Kalgauran and fights for his King, who pays him to kill. He refers to the Mercenary player character as an "old friend."

Hesperia, the Arcane Tempest: a Sorceress rogue exile who uses all three elements.

Izel, Atziri's Chosen: a Huntress rogue exile who wields a spear.

Nisha, the Fierce: a Huntress rogue exile who wields a spear.

Nyassa, the Flaming Hand: a Sorceress rogue exile who casts fire spells. She is a devotee of Kopec and thus may be of Vaal descent.

Raok, the Bloodthirsty: a Warrior rogue exile who wields a mace and shield. He's Karui and fights for Kitava, and believes "anger is power."

Sondar, the Stormbinder: a Monk rogue exile who wields a warstaff and uses storm-themed attacks. He doesn't want to fight but will if he has to.

Taua, the Ruthless: a Warrior rogue exile who wields a two-handed mace and attacks with slams and can call down the Hammer of the Gods. He's a Karui who fights for Tukohama and kills for glory. He uses the saying, "Weakness must be purged lest it poison the blood of all Karui," which can be found on the Eye of Conquest in POE I.

Ulfred, the Afflicted: a Mercenary rogue exile who wields a crossbow and uses explosives and fire damage. He's an Ezomyte who reveres the First Ones. He wants to be left alone and not fight, but has killed before and seems to be haunted by regret as a result. He seeks penance and looks toward his death as a relief. He believes "they" may be sending people after him to kill him, though when attacked isn't sure if his opponent is real or not. If he kills his opponent, he falls to despair and views it as a punishment and something he was tricked into doing.

Vasa, of the Death Akhara: a Witch rogue exile and necromancer who summons minions. She is Maraketh but was exiled. She has big ambitions, planning to become known throughout the Vastiri and claiming that "Nekraata herself will soon bend the knee." She says Sareesh fights with her.

OTHER EXILES

Fire Fury: a woman exiled from Oriath who became a cannibal living on the southern coast of Wraeclast.

Hailrake: a man exiled from Oriath who became a cannibal that scavenged on the Tidal Island.

Calaf, Headstaver: a man exiled from Oriath who became a bandit in the crossroads north of the Fellshrine ruins.

Targa, Beast Poacher: a man exiled from Oriath who became a bandit in the riverways of the Phrecian Forest.

Kole: a rapist exiled from Oriath. Piety experimented on him, turning him into a monster similar to Shavronne's Brutus, after which he guarded the Lunar Temple.

Dawn, Harbinger of Solaris: a man exiled from Oriath who became Solaris' most ardent devotee after her return. He guarded the Sun Orb within the Solaris Temple.

Dusk, Harbinger of Lunar: a man exiled from Oriath who became a sycophant of Lunar after her return. He took the Moon Orb into the Lunar Temple and remained there, guarding it.

Barden of Inkley: a person exiled to Wraeclast by High Templar Dominus for petty larceny and being unable to hold down a job.

Brylla of Cinderford: a person exiled to Wraeclast by High Templar Dominus for promoting heretical beliefs and practicing medicine with the proper qualifications.

Cafar of Beecham: a person exiled to Wraeclast by High Templar Dominus for possessing stolen goods and resisting Templar authority.

Carling of Mirfield: a person exiled to Wraeclast by High Templar Dominus for defaming a church official.

Ender of Romsey: a person exiled to Wraeclast by High Templar Dominus for petty and grand larceny.

Hadrey of Dayton: a person exiled to Wraeclast by High Templar Dominus for public heresy and challenging the authority of a church official.

Joy of Kimbey: a person exiled to Wraeclast by High Templar Dominus for harbouring a sentenced exile.

Lothar of Wetherdale: a person exiled to Wraeclast by High Templar Dominus for undermining Templar authority and defaming a Templar of "highest reverence."

Maitlin of Theopolis: a person exiled to Wraeclast by High Templar Dominus for negligence leading to bodily and financial harm.

Missy of Nashe: a person exiled to Wraeclast by High Templar Dominus for operating a "house of ill repute" without a license.

Ollin of Theopolis: a person exiled to Wraeclast by High Templar Dominus for petty theft, resisting an officer of the Ebony Legion and accidental homicide.

Salem of Theopolis: a person exiled to Wraeclast by High Templar Dominus for unauthorized political satire, blasphemy, inciting public unrest and performing in public without a license.

UNKNOWN

Lycia: a Templar who discovered that the Templars were lying about hallowing and preserving records of the dead, and that the dead were being discarded and forgotten. Wanting to be remembered and not forgotten herself, she studied necromancy and demons. Eventually she made a pact with Beidat, one of the demon-lords of the Scourge, in exchange for eternal life. Since then she has inhabited the Sanctum, an abandoned Templar enclave beneath the Fellshrine ruins, which she has populated with creatures created by lithomancy and the undead. There, she lures in adventurers with the promise of treasure and glory.

Fammal: a renowned duelist in the arenas of Oriath (and possibly a holder of the title of King of Swords). He perfected the techniques of Double Strike and Dual Strike.

EZOMYTES

ANTIQUITY

Craiceann, First of the Deep: the first of the First Ones, who taught the Ezomytes various lessons about survival. He is said to have left this world long ago for the realm of Spirit to seek out other survivors, but one day will return to lead those who have proven themselves to be survivors to the Great Grove.

Farrul, First of the Plains: one of the First Ones, who taught the Ezomytes various lessons about survival. She is said to have left this world long ago for the realm of Spirit to seek out other survivors, but one day will return to lead those who have proven themselves to be survivors to the Great Grove.

The Greatwolf: one of the First Ones, who taught the Ezomytes various lessons about survival. He is said to have left this world long ago for the realm of Spirit to seek out other survivors, but one day will return to lead those who have proven themselves to be survivors to the Great Grove. During the Purity Rebellion, Rigwald called upon the Greatwolf to aid him, and the Greatwolf bestowed him with power, including the ability to shapeshift into a wolf.

Mother Gull: one of the First Ones, said to protect the Ezomytes from the infinite darkness of ceasing to exist when their time comes.

Fenumus, First of the Night: one of the First Ones, who taught the Ezomytes various lessons about survival. She is said to have left this world long ago for the realm of Spirit to seek out other survivors, but one day will return to lead those who have proven themselves to be survivors to the Great Grove.

Saqawal, First of the Sky: the last of the First Ones, who taught the Ezomytes various lessons about survival. He is said to have left this world long ago for the realm of Spirit to seek out other survivors, but one day will return to lead those who have proven themselves to be survivors to the Great Grove.

DURING THE DECLINE & FALL OF THE ETERNAL EMPIRE

Weylin: an Ezomyte warrior from Ezomyr who attempted to defeat Izaro's labyrinth in order to become emperor and help his people. In the labyrinth he allied himself with Chitus, and together they managed to reach its end. However, Chitus then betrayed and poisoned him, resulting in Chitus becoming emperor. Weylin chronicled his journey through the labyrinth with Chitus in a five-part poem.

Skothe: the king of the Ezomytes in Ezomyr prior to the Purity Rebellion. He was apparently loyal to Chitus despite his people being enslaved and left to starve, so he was killed by Thane Rigwald.

Rigwald: a thane and leader of the Ezomytes in Ezomyr after killing King Skothe. He was recruited into the Purity Rebellion by Victario Nevalius and led his people in revolt against Governor Gaius Sentari in what became known as the Bloody Flowers' Rebellion. The Ezomytes were successful, and Rigwald himself chased down and killed Gaius Sentari. He later joined Voll for the siege of Sarn. Seeing that a single Gemling legionnaire could defeat three Ezomytes, he realized that the Purity Rebellion needed monsters of its own to combat the Gemlings. He therefore called upon the Greatwolf, one of the First Ones, to aid him. His call was answered and he gave himself over to the Greatwolf. After the rebellion, he left his people so that his new instincts to hunt would not cause him to hunt his own people. He remains in Wraecclast, endlessly hunting for the ancient talismans of the First Ones.

Count Lachlann: count of the Ezomyte clans in Ogham at the time of their uprising against the Eternals and the battle in the (not-yet-Red) Vale. As the title of count was established around this time, he may have been the first count. He had a wife named Isabel and two sons, Calum and Torcall. Praetor Draven Sentari invaded Lachlann's village and took his family hostage to try and force him to surrender. He may have been killed by the Eternals, though this is unclear. He later came back as a ghost in the cemetery, still striving to rescue his family from Draven and seemingly unaware that he was dead and of how long had passed since then. (Per an older version of the lore, Lachlann was alive in the present as the Head Servant of Count Geonor. In this version he helped ally with the clanless and attempted to overthrow Geonor.)

Isabel: the wife of Count Lachlann. She may have been killed by the Eternals.

Calum: one of Count Lachlann's sons. He may have been killed by the Eternals.

Torcall: one of Count Lachlann's sons. He may have been killed by the Eternals.

Artair: the last survivor of the Ogham rebellion, probably in the Red Vale.

RECENT TIMES

Grigor: an Ezomyte who became interested in Dialla, the Gemling Queen, after hearing an ode called *Of Jewels and Eternity*. He believes her to be the "enigma" behind the fall of both the Eternals and Ezomyr, and walked all the way to Sarn (presumably from Ezomyr) in search of answers. He was caught by General Gravicius while trying to get into the Solaris Temple to find Dialla's remains. Gravicius gave him to Piety, who experimented on him. He was either let go or escaped back to the ruins of Sarn.

Count Geonor: count of the Ezomyte clans by birth, who has served in the role for years. He was apparently thought of as kind and had the support of his people. He married Oriana, who came to Ogham from the Vastiri. She manipulated him into fearing that his bloodline had been tainted with Eternal blood during their brief conquest, and he became obsessed with proving himself and gaining power. He even became a client of the Ring, seeking Ezomyte artefacts such as the Crest of Ezomyr, the Ogham Candelabra, and the Urn of the Original Ashes, which were looted from Ezomyr by the Eternals, in the hope of using them to restore his family's name. Oriana told him about the Seed of Corruption and the power it could bestow on him, leading him to seek it out. During his reign he's been known as the Iron Count.

Renly: a blacksmith from Ogham Village. He found a Karui boy washed up on the riverbank and took him, raising him as his own son. One day, Count Geonor's men came to Renly asking for free weapons, but he refused. He knew he'd face their ire and planned to fight, but Finn convinced him to flee instead, so he took up residence in the Clearfell Encampment.

Finn: an Ezomyte man whose father refused to acknowledge him, so he's been clanless from an early age. His mother was kind and honest, though seems to be gone or dead. As a result of being clanless, he's a wanderer and his personality is guarded. He stayed in a monk enclave one winter but was kicked out due to (alleged) thievery. He scrounged and stole things to sell in Ogham Village and was frequently run out of town (sometimes by fathers with daughters). After Count Geonor began to go mad, Finn took up residence in the Clearfell Encampment, where Renly suspects him of stealing from the forge. Finn has been known to gamble and seems to have a crush on Una. He has a scar on his face and appears to be blind in his left eye.

Una: a commoner from Ogham Village who sings, plays the lute, and composes songs. She knows songs that have been passed from mother to daughter for centuries. She met Count Geonor once as a child. After he began to go mad, he arrested Una's father for bringing in the harvest one day late. Una thinks he's probably dead. The rest of her family, including her mother and two younger brothers, fled when the soldiers came for them, and might still be alive. Una was

away at the time and was warned by neighbors on her way home, so fled to the Clearfell Encampment instead of returning to Ogham Village.

Mortimer: has been a steward (or the Steward) in Ogham for a long time. He keeps watch at the entrance to the Clearfell Encampment and calls to the player for aid against Branoc (the Bloated Miller). He has dogs.

Leitis: a woman from a prominent family in her clan. She married Eamon, a commoner, and they lived in Ogham Manor together. When Count Geonor and others in the manor started to go mad, she and Eamon tried to escape, but were caught.

Eamon: a commoner, who married Leitis and lived in Ogham Manor with her. When Count Geonor and others in the manor started to go mad, he and Leitis tried to escape, but were caught. Per Renly, he is a good man.

Branoc: the chief miller of the Clearfell logging camp and noted to be a kind man. A strange sickness began to affect the people in the area and he went to warn Clearfell about it but instead was killed and reanimated by Corruption. He then spent five days trying to batter his way into the Clearfell Encampment.

Samuel: an Ezomycete man who followed Branoc to warn Clearfell about a strange sickness, when he was attacked and killed by a zombie. (His name isn't given in-game.)

Ervig: a mystic in the Grelwood who would allow Una and her mother entry into the Grim Tangle to forage mushrooms when she was young.

Beira: a well-known witch who lives in Clearfell. As a child, she was found tied to a pyre. It's likely that her village attempted to burn her for being a witch, but the village burned down instead, while she was protected from the fire by ice. At least one sonnet has been written about her.

Areagne: a witch who lives in the Grelwood. The Ranger and Warrior player characters (POE II) know her or of her.

Provost Connal Preas: a man tortured on a rack for six hours by Count Geonor, who was attempting to gain information about a supposed coup attempt by shapechangers. (This coup attempt was explained in a piece of lore that has since been removed, when Lachlann was Count Geonor's Head Servant instead of a former count himself.)

Thane Wulfric: thane of the Thanedom of Holten, who became known as the Red Thane. His wife is Elswyth.

Lady Elswyth: Wulfric's wife.

Oswin: the warden of Wolvenhold, Holten's prison.

Ferryman: a mysterious undead spirit who serves as a merchant in Holten.

Aoife: the wife of the Druid player character, who was killed along with the rest of their kind by the King in the Mists.

Heldra of the Black Pyre: a fire witch who is unfriendly towards Isolde.

Isolde of the White Shroud: an ice witch who is unfriendly towards Heldra.

UNKNOWN

Einhar Frey: an Ezomyte who sailed to Wraeclast alone. According to Jun Ortoi, he claims to be from Oriath. Per Cadiro, Einhar poached a few exotic animals from Perandus estates and escaped their soldiers, indicating he has been alive since before the Cataclysm. He has also been to the Viridian Wildwood, where he knew Flavia and told her he loved her, and it's hinted that this may have been as long ago as during the Winter of the World. Thus Einhar may have lived for thousands of years, though it's been stated that time passes differently in the Wildwood so he may not be unnaturally old. He hunts and studies beasts in the hope of learning the secrets of the First Ones. Einhar believes the world will end soon (within the next three years), and that when it does the First Ones will return and take those who have proven themselves to be "survivors" to the Great Grove. Per Kalandra, he once encountered her lake on a hunt.

Hrimnor: an Ezomyte who sought vengeance. He apparently enjoyed fighting and was killed by a weapon that "passed right beneath his chin."

Girt: an Ezomyte Thane.

Grannell: an Ezomyte Thane.

Leld: an Ezomyte Thane.

Myrk: an Ezomyte Thane.

Weylan: an Ezomyte. (Possibly a misspelling of Weylin.)

KALGUUR

King Cadigan the First: a king of the Kalguur who conquered every city-state on Middengard one by one, using the power of each against the next.

AFTER THE FALL OF THE VAAL

King Cadigan the Third: a king of the Kalguur who commissioned an expedition to Wraeclast after witnessing the Fall of the Vaal. He banned the use of Virtue Gems by his people.

King Cadigan the Fourth: a king of the Kalguur who ruled after Cadigan the Third.

Olroth: leader of the Knights of the Sun in the Kalguur colonies in Wraeclast. When new monsters arose to attack the fringes of the colonies, he evacuated them and then burned the forests. After returning home he began retreating into seclusion each night. He led his knights against a monster he called the Empty-Eyed Fiend and found he couldn't kill it, so they resorted to using Virtue Gems, despite them being banned. Uhtred discovered that Olroth was sneaking out at night in a sleep-like state and believed he'd become the leader of the monsters, so had him attacked and nearly killed. Olroth was encased in glass to keep him alive, though later the glass was found shattered and Olroth missing. It was eventually discovered that he had escaped and stolen the Triskelion Flame that defended the colonies, causing them to fall.

Medved: leader of the Druids of the Circle, who were "nature-mystics" with the power to see the future by looking into the past. He was declared a blasphemer by Uhtred for studying the Virtue Gems, and paid Uhtred to not exile him and his order. Once Olroth began using the Virtue Gems, Medved's Order could no longer see the past or future, and so became known as the Druids of the Broken Circle. Vorana then convinced him to start using the gems as well. When a leader arose among the monsters that beset the colonies, Medved went out to challenge it but didn't return. After the leader of the creatures was discovered to be Olroth and was defeated, Medved became their new leader, having turned into a monster himself. He was still alive two thousand years later.

Vorana: founder and leader of the mercenaries of the Black Scythe in the Kalguur colonies in Wraeclast. She helped defend the colonies against the monsters of Wraeclast, and convinced Medved to use Virtue Gems for this purpose even though they'd been outlawed by King Cadigan. They later had a daughter together. When the Triskelion Flame that defended the colonies was stolen, she placed Virtue Gems in her own flesh and went out to kill the creatures. Her fate was unknown until it was discovered she'd become a monster herself and was still alive two thousand years later.

Uhtred: High Priest of the Order of the Chalice in the Kalguur colonies in Wraeclast. He declared the use of the Virtue Gems unclean. When a leader arose among the monsters that beset the colonies, Uhtred believed it was actually Olroth and had his priests attack him. Vorana threatened to kill Uhtred for this, so he went into hiding at an "ancient site of power" built around an unknown artifact, which appears to be a Primeval shrine. The Triskelion Flame that defended the colonies later disappeared, and Vorana believed Uhtred had stolen it and branded him a traitor. However, it was Olroth who had taken it. Uhtred somehow became a monster himself and was still alive two thousand years later.

Prime Remembrancer: an unnamed person who recorded the events that transpired when the Kalguur attempted to colonise Wraeclast.

Annest: the daughter of Medved and Vorana. She was born in the Kalguur colonies in Wraeclast and sent back to the homeland to be raised in safety. Olroth's son went with her as her guardian.

Owen: Uhtred's son. He was sent to the homeland to avoid retribution for Uhtred's actions.

Dannig, Warrior Skald, the Blacksmith: a runesmith who had a forge in Kalguur. He led an expedition to Wraeclast (following the failed rebellion and possibly as an excuse to leave) to discover the fates of the Kalguur who had tried to colonise the continent. His quest is to investigate the Knights of the Sun. The others describe him as a dreamer and an intrepid and charismatic leader. As a skald, he composes and recites poems honouring heroes and their deeds. When the king got wind of the expedition and decreed that their camp be built up into a city and trading port, Dannig once again took up runesmithing as a member of the Artificers' Guild. He's interested in Isla and she reciprocates. He has recurring nightmares about what was done to his comrades after the failed rebellion, and even Tangmazu declined to torment him when he witnessed them. Dannig has been to Te Onui.

Gwennen, the Gambler: a descendent of Annest, Medved's daughter, and therefore honor-bound to discover the fate of Medved and the Druids of the Broken Circle. She traveled to Wraeclast for this purpose. In Kalguur, she fought in a war involving a failed rebellion and gave Johan a scar. Leaving for Wraeclast may at least partly have been to escape in the aftermath. When Johan arrived to Wraeclast with a charter from the King, she avoided him out of fear he'd recognise her and be able to deduce who her allies were. The others describe her as honest and one who thinks belief can shape events, and she believes in Chance as a force. She is a distant cousin of Tujen.

Tujen, the Hagglar, the Harbourmaster: a descendent of Annest, Vorana's daughter. He traveled to Wraeclast to find out what happened to Vorana and the Black Scythe mercenaries. After Kingsmarch was established, he became the harbourmaster. The others describe him as a loyal friend who protects the others, who manages to remain cheery despite all his scars and injuries. He is a distant cousin of Gwennen. He drinks a lot and is likely in an amorous relationship with Sonja.

Rog, the Dealer, the Disenchanter: a descendent of Owen, Uhtred's son. He traveled to Wraeclast to discover the fate of Uhtred, and whether or not he was a traitor. After Kingsmarch was founded, he established his own shop/apothecary as a member of the Meridian Free Traders guild. As a pastime, he set up a game night with the others, where they play a game involving figurine, lots of dice, and roleplaying. The others describe him as a sweetheart with excellent logistical skills.

Johan: the King's Hand, who was sent to Wraeclast to oversee the execution of the charter. He serves as Treasurer in Kingsmarch and handles the finances, resources, and administration of the charter. He admits that his loyalties are divided: he serves the King's wishes but also the best interests of Kingsmarch and its settlers. Johan is aware that many of the colonists aren't exactly upstanding citizens, but as long as there's no open sedition he seems happy to look the other way, even finding excuses to fail to carry out punishments directed by the King. Per Gwennen, she gave him a scar, presumably during the failed rebellion.

Raulf, the Recruiter: a man sent by his guild, the Meridian Free Traders, to recruit labourers and specialists for those who have jobs available. He's been trying unsuccessfully to recruit Sasan and The Black Knight. He's missing an eye and doesn't drink.

Sonja, the Farmer: a woman probably living under an assumed name. She chose to leave her past behind in Kalguur and move to Wraeclast, feeling that her family name was forced on her, not given. She also implies that someone hurt her, who might be able to hear what she says (directly or via others) even on a different continent. She seems to be in an amorous relationship with Tujen.

Tolis: a person who may have been a casualty of the failed rebellion.

Oskar: a person who may have been a casualty of the failed rebellion.

Naja: a person who may have been a casualty of the failed rebellion.

Thea: a person who may have been a casualty of the failed rebellion.

Sven: a person who may have been a casualty of the failed rebellion.

Sasan, the Bandit Lord: a male bandit. Raulf sends him letters trying to recruit him, which he unsuccessfully tries to avoid. He believes the Kalguuran colonisation must be stopped and that those helping them are ignorant.

Rhodri: a member of the trade guild who serves as the cook on the *Aurora May*.

Ange: a marketeer who has been in Kingsmarch for many years and has studied under Rog and Faustus. She says she's given up on finding a life companion.

Jacob, the Town Crier: a boy who sells newspapers for the Kingsmarch Chronicle.

Freya Hartlin: a woman disappeared around 1615 IC. She had a son named Grisham but had a falling out with him.

Captain Grisham Hartlin: Freya's son. He's known as a capable seafarer who is well respected by his crew, and good drinker.

UNKNOWN

Edryd, the Second Seer: a cultist who may have died during the first Kalguur colonisation and been reanimated.

Avon Bruhn: an illustrious member of the Druids of the Broken Circle.

Gronel Starseer: an illustrious member of the Druids of the Broken Circle.

Smalon Thickett: an illustrious member of the Druids of the Broken Circle.

The Black Knight: a mysterious person or being who has supposedly been around for centuries and knows the runic arts. Raulf heard stories of him growing up and sends letters trying to recruit him as a guard for the Kingsmarch shipping lanes.

WARBANDS

RECENT TIMES

Uruk Baleh: a Redblade warband leader and smith.

El'Abin, Bloodeater: a Redblade warband leader.

Leli Goya, Daughter of Ash: a Redblade warband leader.

Bin'aia, Crimson Rain: a Redblade warband leader.

Yorishi, Aurora-sage: a Mutewind warband leader.

Jeinei Yuushu: a Mutewind warband leader.

Otesha, the Giantslayer: a Mutewind warband leader.

Musky "Two-Eyes" Grenn: a Brinerot warband leader.

Susara, Siren of Pondium: a Brinerot warband leader.

Weylam "Rot-Tooth" Roth: a Brinerot warband leader until he was betrayed and marooned by his younger sister, Lussi (see Warbands section). He was the captain of the Black Crest, a ship whose hull was said to have been reinforced by the bones of the Leviathan that he'd killed. In an attempt to regain his notoriety, he tried to kill the sea-witch Merveil. However, his ship ran aground and she ate him alive. He was later reanimated somehow, retaining his full mental faculties.

Meredith: the deceased wife of Weylam Roth.

Lussi "Rotmother" Roth: a Brinerot warband leader and the younger sister of Weylam Roth. She was Weylam's first mate for years until she mutinied and marooned him on an island off the coast of Wraeclast. Per Weylam, she is responsible for transforming the Brinerot from a clan of honourable pirates into raving lunatics.

Lilly Roth: a pirate captain, smuggler and the granddaughter of Weylam Roth. She was Tarkleigh's lover and partner for a time, smuggling booze with him to make money. However, she began to fear that he planned to settle down and have children with her. She betrayed him and left him on Penance Quay, where he was captured by Blackguards and exiled for his crimes. At one point she managed to acquire the Teardrop, a map to the sunken city of Tsoatha, but it was taken by Oriathan privateers and she was thrown in the slave pens. She escaped and broke into the Theopolis Reliquary in an attempt to retrieve it but failed, and her three accomplices (Kraityn, Alira and Oak) were captured and exiled. After the second fall of Oriath, Kirac

convinced her to become a naval officer for the Citizen Vaguard, in exchange for her pirating crimes being forgiven.

Rama, The Kinslayer: a Renegades warband leader.

Kalria, The Fallen: a Renegades warband leader.

Invari, The Bloodshaper: a Renegades warband leader.

Lokan, The Deceiver: a Renegades warband leader.

Marchak, The Betrayer: a Renegades warband leader.

Berrots, The Breaker: a Renegades warband leader.

Vessider, The Unrivaled: a Renegades warband leader.

Morgrants, The Defeaning: a Renegades warband leader.

UNKNOWN

Rami: a male Mutewind who helped murder aspirants (for leader of the clan) before being murdered himself. This was recounted in a Synthesis memory.

TRARTHANS

DURING THE 800S

Quilon Bardiya: a member of the first-born generation in Trarthus. He was the first to back the Trarthan Code, and led his house to power through the use of intelligence and the control of finances in Korathin. He had a feud with Ixan Keita which eventually broke out into the open conflict known as the Merchant Wars. House Bardiya won and established the Merchant Council, primarily to keep House Keita in check.

Ixan Keita: a member of the first-born generation in Trarthus. He rose to power as a slaver with a reputation for brutality, and used his slaves to build the capital city of Korathin. He also declared himself a god and built temples where he could be worshipped, but failed to ascend to godhood. His ambition caused a rivalry with Quilon Bardiya that led to the Merchant Wars, which Keita lost and which resulted in the establishment of the Merchant Council to keep his house in check.

Kylian Cyaxan: a member of the first-born generation in Trarthus. He was a merchant who traded in spices and cloth, though when business faltered he turned to more sordid markets and came to rule over the Trarthan underworld. He established the Trarthan militia as enforcers, operated a series of brothels that pushed drugs, and flooded Trarthus with virtue gems, using the latter primarily to enhance sensation and dull pain. Cyaxan instigated the Merchant Wars by acting as a third party, playing both sides in the rivalry between Houses Keita and Bardiya.

Ratha Azadi: a member of the first-born generation in Trarthus. She established her house as a powerful one through a reputation as skilled contract killers.

UNKNOWN

Arjun: a Trarthan of House Bardiya who falsified ammunition supply reports to lure the Keitans into a trap. This may have been during the Merchant Wars, though isn't confirmed.

Tsarsk: (see the Order of the Djinn.)

TWILIGHT ORDER

RECENT TIMES

Benedictus, First Herald of Utopia: a member of the Twilight Order.

Torvian, Hand of the Saviour: a member of the Twilight Order.

Cnaeus, of the Order: a Twilight Order Oathsworn and guard to Torvian. He casts offensive spells.

Herius, of the Order: a Twilight Order Oathsworn and guard to Torvian. He casts defensive spells.

Vel Axna, of the Order: a Twilight Order Oathsworn and guard to Torvian. He casts utility spells.

Marius: a servitor, meaning he tends to a congregation but is not a preacher.

Lorandis: a missionary of the Twilight Order who proselytizes in Kingsmarch for the enclave on Arastas. He says he's there to spread the word about the New Tomorrow.

OTHER/UNKNOWN

OTHER GODS

Gruthkul, Mother of Despair, the Porcelain Queen: one of the Nameless, who came into being when a young man in the Viridian Wildwood got the idea of a powerful mother from the shadow realm and gave her a name. When she emerged, she brought her countless children with her. Her children grew to fear Arakaali and became envious of her power, so plotted against her. Arakaali got wind of this and killed them. Gruthkul fled north and sought refuge with some of her loyalists. They, however, saw her grief as a weapon and nurtured it into hatred and then violence. Gruthkul descended into animalism and ferocity, wrenching free of her human loyalties and slaying her followers to the last woman and child. Through this devastation she ascended to godhood. She then retaliated against Arakaali by attacking her realm and bringing it to the brink of ruin. Arakaali lured Gruthkul into a cavern and collapsed it on her, trapping Gruthkul inside.

Abberath, the Cloven One: a renowned alchemist who used his knowledge to burn away flesh and liquidate the life force within, which he then consumed. Initially his victims were goats. His cruelty became his curse, and as he began to ascend to godhood he became the Cloven One, taking on a goatlike appearance himself. He then began to consume human souls instead, either in an attempt to cure himself or to quench his growing thirst. He took a woman from a local tribe, and she gave birth to his son, the Faun.

The Faun: the son of Abberath and a woman from a local tribe. His mother sheltered and raised him, but she was shunned and reviled for it due to his goatlike appearance. Wary of being a pariah, she took him out one night and struck him with a large rock, leaving him for dead. He didn't die, however. He began to kidnap virgins and impregnate them, thus giving birth to the race of goatmen. (In earlier lore, his name is spelled "Fawn.")

Tangmazu, the Trickster: a trickster god who uses illusions and manipulation to foster depression, paranoia, and hatred in those around him. He was originally from a small civilisation that was "a rare haven from the world's ills." He told a lie that resulted in his people being killed and mutilated, probably when he was still a boy. This traumatized him and filled him with hate, and he vowed to make those responsible suffer through paranoia and fear. He became a torturer and deceiver who tormented countless people. Eventually he became so skilled at deception that he was able to convince himself he was a god and it became true without the need for admiration from others, as long as he remained alone. He started the long-running feud between the goddesses of the Sun and Moon. He was later captured and imprisoned for this by the Ramako tribe, who guarded his prison until the Tukohama tribe took over. Tangmazu refers to Ralakesh as his brother, though it's likely he simply means they're both gods. The Ezomytes called him the Black Crow, the Azmeri called him the Raven, and the Karui called him Tekaru, the Deceiver.

The Goddess of Justice: a goddess of whom Izaro is a follower. She judges people's minds and hearts to find their flaws and strengths and determine if they're worthy of redemption and

loyalty, or only death. Nothing is known of her history prior to the reign of Izaro. When Chitus locked Izaro in the labyrinth, she was apparently locked in with him. She remained awake while the Beast was alive, and therefore may not actually be a goddess, despite her title.

THE KEEPERS OF THE FLAME

Ailith, First of the Keepers: the woman who founded the Keepers of the Flame, possibly around the time the Third Pact was established. Per Ketzuli, the Maraketh communicated with Chayula and thus Ailith may have been Maraketh. She died but was resurrected by Chayula and thus is still alive in the present. She's unaware of her resurrection, though does know that a long time has passed since she founded the Keepers. Chayula uses her to fight the forces of Xesht and shares information with her through dreams. She can wield "the Flame" (a power apparently granted to her by Chayula) to destroy fortified breaches, though is destroyed herself in the process. Each time this happens she is unknowingly resurrected by Chayula, who grows many copies of her from trees akin to the Genesis Tree.

THE PALE COUNCIL

Eber, the Plaguemaw, Mouth of the Masses: a man whose people began to starve after their land went barren, driving him and his people to turn cannibalistic and feast on their own.

Yriel, the Feral Lord, Lord of the Wild: a lord who fed his crops with blood during a drought, resulting in the flora becoming corrupted and turning into a jungle of thorny and monstrous plants.

Volkuur, the Unbreathing Queen, She of Many Bodies: a woman who raised an army of soulless corpses to act as her puppets, in mockery of death.

Inya, the Unbearable Whispers, the Infinite Mind: a queen with an unending thirst for knowledge, which she fed by reading countless tomes. As her knowledge grew her wisdom slipped away, driving her insane. It was Inya who arranged for the Pale Council to become immortal, unable to be killed unless all four were killed. She had the others bring their most loyal and healthy retainers as sacrifices.

THE ORDER OF THE DJINN

Ahkeli: a woman (likely a Primeval) known as the Clayshaper due to her command of golems. She fled the destruction of her home, probably due to a volcanic eruption, which left her scarred.

It's implied that the rest of her people were then wiped out by the Lightless, who may have emerged after the eruption choked the sky. Ahkeli made an alliance with the survivors of a Maraketh *akhara*, directing them to seek out relics of power, and thus saved the Vastiri Plains from destruction. These actions led to the establishment of the Order of the Djinn, with Ahkeli as its founder. She was buried in a tomb in Keth in a place of honour. (Note that most of the above lore came from scarabs that have now been removed from the game.)

Saresh, Surgeon of the Dead, Necromancer of Weeping Black: an orphan who was rejected even by the Faridun outcasts and later taken in by the Order of the Djinn. He studied the dead in search of the secrets of human darkness and became a necromancer. He commanded not only armies of the dead, but vast roiling storms as well. The goddess Garukhan went to battle against him and dissipated his sandstorms using the Horn of the Vastiri. This allowed the united Maraketh *akharas* to defeat him, leaving his undead horde scattered throughout Wraeclast. (Note that some of the above lore came from scarabs that have now been removed from the game.)

Egrin of the Dark Between Stars, Forger of the Sealing Blade: an orphan who had visions that led the Azmeri down into the ruins of the Vaal civilisation. Cast out by the Azmeri, Egrin was taken in by the Order of the Djinn and later forged the sword Starforge that was used to trap the Elder. (Note that the above lore came from scarabs that have now been removed from the game.)

Betucia, Bearer of the Sealing Blade: an orphan from the Eternal Empire who was welcomed into the Order of the Djinn and eventually tasked with investigating maps. Betucia assisted in using the sword Starforge against the Elder. (Note that the above lore came from scarabs that have now been removed from the game.)

Qianga of the Stars, Deliverer of the Sealing Blade to the Watchers: an orphan disdained by the Mutewind for being different, but accepted by the Order of the Djinn. She delivered the sword Starforge to the Watchers of Decay so that they could imprison the Elder. (Note that the above lore came from scarabs that have now been removed from the game.)

Sumei, Master Lorekeeper: a Maraketh orphan left to die in desert by her *akhara* but rescued by the Order of the Djinn. She was later charged with investigating the duplication of unique items, and her final years were burdened by a terrible secret. (Note that the above lore came from scarabs that have now been removed from the game.)

Revna: a person implied to be Kalguuran who was taken in by the Order of the Djinn after his/her people departed Wraeclast. Revna studied the past to the point of being consumed by it, and became a runesmith. He/She spent their final days terrified of the stars and took the secret of what they'd learned to their grave. (Note that the above lore came from scarabs that have now been removed from the game.)

Narumoa: a Karui who died in war and implied to have been revived by the Order of the Djinn. This seems to have endowed Narumoa with the gift of second sight, and he/she used it to serve the Order for centuries before dying again. (Note that the above lore came from scarabs that have now been removed from the game.)

Omid, Master Researcher: an orphan rescued from the Redblade by the Order of the Djinn. He was tasked with investigating Xoph and artefacts related to Breaches. Upon his death, his final commandment was "the world must never know." (Note that the above lore came from scarabs that have now been removed from the game.)

Raethan the Betrayer: an orphan and the first Brinerot to join the Order of the Djinn. He researched Voltaxic Sulphite as a new form of energy. It is implied that he betrayed the Order by making his discoveries public, resulting in "madness...in machine form," though later seems to have been forgiven. (Note that the above lore came from scarabs that have now been removed from the game.)

Master Warrior Rindwik: an orphan, possibly from a Renegades warband, abandoned and accepted into the Order of the Djinn. Charged with leading the martial defense of the Order's expeditions, Rindwik fell only to old age. (Note that the above lore came from scarabs that have now been removed from the game.)

Tsarsk: a young orphan discovered and taken in by the Order of the Djinn in a flesh-pit in Trarthus. Tsarsk helped save other tormented spirits from eternal misery. (Note that the above lore came from scarabs that have now been removed from the game.)

Agnar, Beastmaster: an Ezomyte orphaned by feuding clans and rescued by the Order of the Djinn. He received Visions from the First Ones about the beasts of the world so was tasked by the Order with investigating them. When he died, his Visions passed to another. (Note that the above lore came from scarabs that have now been removed from the game.)

Jun Ortoi: a Maraketh woman who was orphaned and taken in by a secretive organization known as the Order of the Djinn. As part of the Order she was tasked with guarding the Forbidden Vault, within which resided artefacts deemed dangerous enough to put the world in jeopardy. Janus Perandus sold out the Order, resulting in the death of all its members save for himself and Jun and the theft of a number of powerful artefacts. Following this, Jun began investigating the rise of the Immortal Syndicate and the disappearance of several prominent exiles. The Order forbids having relationships with men or having children, but she is interested in a relationship with Zana and adopting orphans with her.

Sarina Titucius: a member of the Order of the Djinn who managed to translate the Harbinger language and thus was directed to study them. Sarina made it through the Gate to the Harbinger realm and returned. She was the first member of the Order to be awarded with a Gilded Scarab while still alive. Jun considered her to be family. Sarina was killed after Janus Perandus sold out the Order to Catarina. (Note that most of the above lore came from scarabs that have now been removed from the game.)

Deacon Eutyclus: a Templar orphan and member of the Order of the Djinn who became a deacon and served as the Order's hand within "the Chamber" (possibly the Chamber of Innocence). For this Eutyclus was gifted by the Order the opportunity to explore the Domain of Timeless Conflict, whose eternal vile hunger is implied to have taken his life. (Note that the above lore came from scarabs that have now been removed from the game.)

Dhunan: a person from "distant shores" who was rescued from the ocean by the Order of the Djinn and became a member. He used techniques from his homeland to contain the blight, and then led a war to destroy it, though failed to locate and destroy the Blightheart. He was returned to his homeland to be buried. (Note that the above lore came from scarabs that have now been removed from the game.)

Janus Perandus: (see the Immortal Syndicate.)

Arin Kent: a member of the Order of the Djinn whom Jun considered to be family. Arin was killed after Janus Perandus sold out the Order to Catarina.

Brin Barius: a member of the Order of the Djinn whom Jun considered to be family. Brin was killed after Janus Perandus sold out the Order to Catarina.

Killam Creary: a member of the Order of the Djinn whom Jun considered to be family. Killam was killed after Janus Perandus sold out the Order to Catarina.

Lynn Grey: a member of the Order of the Djinn whom Jun considered to be family. Lynn was killed after Janus Perandus sold out the Order to Catarina.

Ngahari Atui: a member of the Order of the Djinn whom Jun considered to be family. Ngahari was killed after Janus Perandus sold out the Order to Catarina.

Tej Alhamba: a member of the Order of the Djinn whom Jun considered to be family. Tej was killed after Janus Perandus sold out the Order to Catarina.

Xian Song: a member of the Order of the Djinn whom Jun considered to be family. Xian was killed after Janus Perandus sold out the Order to Catarina.

Jado: a member of the Order of the Djinn who infiltrated the *sel khari*.

THE IMMORTAL SYNDICATE

Catarina, Master of Undeath: a witch and powerful necromancer from Oriath who was exiled to Wraeclast by High Templar Dominus. After Janus Perandus sold out the Order of the Djinn, likely at her behest, she was able to obtain the Horns of Kulemak from the Forbidden Vault. Using the Horns, she could fully revive others from the dead without them turning into mindless zombies. Thus she established the Immortal Syndicate, becoming known as the Lifegiver or Eternal One. She believed the lifespan of humans was too short to direct the course of the world, thus leaving it in the hands of Chaos. She intended to use immortality to build up the knowledge of humanity by preventing advances from being lost due to death, and to establish herself as the queen of a new utopian empire in Wraeclast that would never be destabilized due to the death of its ruler.

Janus Perandus: the great grandson of Chitus Perandus and an avowed gambler. He was orphaned, but as the Perandus line had lost its fortune no one would take him in save for the Order of the Djinn. However, likely in an attempt to bring some glory back to the Perandus name, he sold them out. His actions resulted in the deaths of the entire Order save for himself and Jun Ortoi, and the theft of the Horns of Kulemak, which enabled the formation of the Immortal Syndicate.

Cameria the Coldblooded: a murderer who, as a boy, used to get close to "the rich and proper" and then kill them. He would steal from his victims and make it look like a robbery to cover up the fact that he was killing for pleasure. Cameria has a reputation for being violent and "getting his jollies" with the dead bodies of his victims. He's been locked up in the past, and may also have been a soldier. Kirac refers to him as a "psychotic disciple" of General Gravicius. Eventually he became a member of the Immortal Syndicate.

Korell Goya, Son of Stone: a member of the Redblade warband originating from a caldera, who joined the Immortal Syndicate. As with other Redblades he worships fire and a god named the Molten One, and is said to be unharmed by flames. He is recognisable by his spiky red armour.

Rin Yuushu: a member of the Mutewind warband originating from the mountains, who joined the Immortal Syndicate. She is an archer and like other Mutewinds believes strongly in the purity of her blood, referring to non-Mutewinds "muckbloods."

Guff "Tiny" Grenn: a member of the Brinerot warband who was a ship captain and merchant/pirate before joining the Immortal Syndicate.

Riker Maloney, Midnight Tinkerer: a trapper skilled with gadgets and machines, who is searching for the secret to eternal life and resurrection. He was a client of the Ring on contracts to find the Hand of Arimor and the Blood of Innocence, which he thought may have had the answer. He also had a brief alliance with the researchers attempting to recreate unique items, but left when they failed to produce results on resurrection. Finally, he joined the Immortal Syndicate. He's an eloquent speaker with an affinity for alliteration and he wears a mask, leaving his true identity a mystery. There's a hint that two people he loved may have died in his arms.

Thane Jorgin the Banished: an Ezomyte Thane from the green hills of Ogham, which was located on an island (possibly the Isles of Skothe). (Note that per POE II, Ogham is in Phaaryl, not on an island.) His brother was murdered and he was found guilty of the crime, which was likely the reason for his banishment. In Ogham there are wanted posters of him on display, and if he returned he'd be hung. Instead, he joined the Immortal Syndicate. Jorgin claims he is innocent and was framed, and that his brother was murdered by a member of the Brotherhood of Silence. However, none of the other Syndicate members appear to believe him. In particular he suspects it was Vorici, though the latter denies it was him. Jorgin wears a bear pelt and is able to call upon the power of the First Ones to gain ursine abilities. He believes in a philosophy of "might makes right" and that the strongest should absorb the might of the meek and make it his own.

It That Fled: a creature from the Breach realm. It was born on the Red Pyre like the others of its hive but felt flawed, not rejoicing in the prospect of serving and dying for the Breachlords like its siblings. Instead It fled and joined the Immortal Syndicate, though still draws upon the power of the Breachlords. It speaks of itself in the third person and per Cameria doesn't sleep.

Aisling Laffrey, The Silent Butcher: an assassin and sadist who joined the Immortal Syndicate. She disassembles and reassembles the corpses of her victims into "art."

Vorici, Silent Brother: an Oriathan assassin and member of the Brotherhood of Silence who was exiled to Wraeclast by High Templar Dominus. Jun Ortoi feels he was a good person and a capable fighter doing what he could to bring light to the darkness of Wraeclast. He later joined the Immortal Syndicate. Thane Jorgin suspects that Vorici killed Jorgin's brother, but Vorici denies this.

Haku, Warmaster: a Karui originally from Ngamakanui who somehow ended up in Oriath and then was exiled by High Templar Dominus to Wraeclast. Jun Ortoi feels he was a good person and a capable fighter doing what he could to bring light to the darkness of Wraeclast. He later joined the Immortal Syndicate.

Elreon, Light's Judge: a Templar from Oriath. He was exiled by High Templar Dominus, who felt Elreon was too soft for Templar leadership and that his radical ideas might turn others against him. While Elreon claims to retain his faith in God and feels he is on a "crusade," he says he has left the Templars due to his distaste for bloodshed. Jun Ortoi feels he was a good person and a capable fighter doing what he could to bring light to the darkness of Wraeclast. He later joined the Immortal Syndicate.

Tora, the Culler: an exile from Oriath who is an archer and huntress. She's in tune with nature and doesn't care for material things. Jun Ortoi feels she was a good person and a capable fighter doing what she could to bring light to the darkness of Wraeclast. She later joined the Immortal Syndicate.

Leo Redmane, Wolf of the Pits: an arena gladiator from Oriath who was exiled to Wraeclast. In Theopolis he preferred being the Pitmaster to a fighter. Leo lost his left hand and has a hook in its place. He considers Vagan an old friend. Jun Ortoi feels Leo was a good person and a capable fighter doing what he could to bring light to the darkness of Wraeclast. He later joined the Immortal Syndicate.

Vagan, Victory's Herald: a duelist from Oriath who exiled to Wraeclast by High Templar Dominus. Jun Ortoi feels he was a good person and a capable fighter doing what he could to bring light to the darkness of Wraeclast. He later joined the Immortal Syndicate. He's attracted to Tora.

Hillock of Slauch, the Blacksmith: a blacksmith who used to make swords until he was exiled to Wraeclast by High Templar Dominus for a long list of crimes, including murder, murder of a child, extortion, armed larceny, rape and rape resulting in death. After his exile he remained outside of Lioneys Watch, attacking other exiles. He was slain but later revived as a member of the Immortal Syndicate.

General Gravicius: (see Templars.)

Arzaak: a Syndicate researcher.

THE RING & THEIR ASSOCIATES

The Boss: leader of the Ring. Many stories are told about him, but few knew the truth. He is rumoured to have gotten his start when he took a bribe as a stable boy in the Grand Arena of Theopolis and double-crossed his client in order to get rich himself. He's also said to have walked into the First Bank of Theopolis in the middle of the day, moved all the money around, and destroyed all records of who it belonged to. Personally, the Boss has been rumoured to be completely hairless, private to the point of paranoia, and requires all guests to wear nothing but a sleeveless robe he provides. He's also been said to be a man of style who attends the theatre. Because he's rarely, if ever, seen, some believe he doesn't actually exist, and that the Ring is actually run by another, such as Kurai herself.

Kurai, the Administrator: a Karui woman who acts as an administrator for The Boss. She was exiled from Oriath and prefers not to talk about her past other than to say that she did what she had to in order to survive, and that Oriath still fills her nights with terror. Vic Vox, an Oriathan nobleman, had a signed copy of a book by Victario Nevalius that had belonged to Hyrri Ngamaku. Kurai took out a contract to have the book retrieved and returned to Ngamakanui. She seems to get along with all the other rogues, and has a cat named Hana.

Adiyah, the Wayfinder: a Maraketh woman from the northern reaches of Vastiri, who is a veteran dekhara. Her sister Nashta was rebellious and refused to follow their akhara's rules and traditions, and eventually left with many others to become a bandit. Adiyah considers the members of the Ring to be thieves and scoundrels, but associates with them in order to keep track of Nashta's activities. She doesn't get along with Niles.

Nashta, The Usurper: a Maraketh woman and the sister of Adiyah. She was rebellious and grew up refusing to follow her akhara's rules and traditions, earning many tattoos of shame. She eventually left Vastiri altogether, and scores of other delinquents went with her, forming a group of bandits that terrorized others.

Captain/Admiral Faustus, the Fence: an Oriathan sailor, who in his youth was rowdy and liked to drink, and later became captain of the ship *Fair Marylene* in the Oriathan Navy. Sometimes he confiscates stolen goods on the job and returns them to nobles for a reward or certain privileges, and uses this to fence items procured by the Ring as well. He feels only those of noble birth should be allowed into the navy and hates Admiral Darnaw for letting those of low birth serve. Faustus has a rivalry with Captain Fidium, who is honest and suspects Faustus of being corrupt. He enjoys doling out punishments to his crew and likes wordplay. When the Kalguurans arrived to build Kingsmarch, they contracted Faustus for his access to the trade markets of Wraeclast. After the fall of Oriath, given that the Oriathan Navy no longer existed, he declared himself an admiral and sought establish his own flotilla.

Captain Fidium: (see Templars.)

Admiral Darnaw: (see Templars.)

Gianna, the Master of Disguise: an Oriathan actress associated with the Theopolis Thespian Society who worked in Chitus Theatre, and has played Shavronne, Dialla and Merveil. She met Vinderi when he was hired to do pyrotechnics for a play at a basement theatre called the Wilted

Quill. She was later exiled to Wraeclast for pecuniary lust, after which the Boss--who'd seen her perform--recruited her into the Ring. She flirts with the other rogues, and wants to be friends with Tullina, who isn't too friendly in return.

Huck, the Soldier: a former Blackguard who served in the Oriath 3rd for five years before being dishonourably discharged. Dark days followed until the Boss arranged a place for him in the Ring, though Huck's never met the boss personally. In the Ebony Legion he was friends with a man named Enoch, who was transferred to a special unit under Piety shortly before Huck was discharged, and Huck wishes to track him down. He also served with Captain Arturo and mentions his unit didn't have many victories. Huck has a temper and once hurt another member of the Ring, but was given a second chance by the Boss. He doesn't really like Niles.

Enoch: a Blackguard soldier who served and became friends with Huck. According to Huck, he was a good and honourable man. He was recruited to be part of an elite strike force under the direction of Piety and was later used as a research subject. He died when Piety tried to make him into a gemling. Enoch was cremated and his remains placed in the tunnels beneath the city, along with other Blackguards who died on duty.

Isla, the Engineer: an Oriathan inventor and engineer. In her first year at the Academy she was picked by the high templar and taken to the Chief Arkhon's laboratory to repair and maintain the map device, and ended up taking it apart. She feels she wasn't treated well in Oriath, and her own inventions were declared heretical. She was exiled to Wraeclast for the damage she caused in the course of her work. Later Isla discovered that the Templars actually wanted her designs for themselves, as they included plans for a superweapon. When the Kalguurans arrived to establish Kingsmarch, she worked for them as an engineer. At the same time, she moonlighted as a member of the Ring to fund her work, and has created dangerous inventions including a rogue mechanical spider and potentially hazardous spores. She also built a working recombinator and map device. She seems interested in Niles, but he's wary as the torture devices she's designed are too much even for him. She's also interested in Dannig, and he returns her interest. During her time in Oriath she knew Valdo and it's hinted that she still corresponds with Zana.

Karst, the Lockpick: an Oriathan who ran with criminals and spent his youth learning to pick locks. He thought they were loyal, but they beat him half to death and stole his best lockpicks, which had belonged to his grandfather. Shortly thereafter the Templars came for him, and without his lockpicks he wasn't able to escape. He was exiled to Wraeclast and joined the Ring. He enjoys learning new words and flirts with Nenet and Gianna. He doesn't like Niles and owes Huck money.

Nenet, the Scout: a Faridun outcast, rejected by her Maraketh mother due to her unsightly face. She joined the Ring because everyone was welcome, as long as they were willing to work. She hopes to force the Maraketh to recognise the worthiness of the Faridun warriors and accept them back. At one point Nenet asked Isla to build her a humanoid golem, though doesn't want the other rogues to know. Her general outlook is bleak.

Niles, the Interrogator: an interrogator and torturer for the Templars, who has a mild ability to read minds. When young, he served next to some very powerful men, including High Templar Venarius. He seeks to prove that gods, divinity, and even medicine aren't real. Most of the other

rogues dislike him. He has a creepy crush on Tullina, and asks Gianna on a date but she laughs at him.

Tibbs, the Giant: a man from Oriath named Gil, though is called Tibbs by the Ring. He joined the circus as a strongman at age fourteen, where he met Tullina. He helped take care of an abandoned girl named Opal, until he was exiled to Wraeclast and joined the Ring. Since then his circus troupe has disbanded and he's sought to track down Opal and ensure her safety.

Opal: a girl with bright red eyes but very pale skin and white hair, who was abandoned and left with a circus troupe leader as a baby. The troupe took care of her, and Tibbs in particular looked after her. After the troupe disbanded, the Templars took an interest in her because she was "unique," but she hid from them and continued living with some members of the former troupe.

Tullina, the Catburglar: a woman from Oriath who fell in love with a nobleman named Julius Farrow. He proposed to her, but less than a week later she was exiled to Wraeclast. She fell in with the Ring, where she prefers not to make friends but to keep things strictly professional. She already knew Tibbs, who she'd met in the circus.

Julius Farrow: an Oriathan nobleman and Tullina's fiancé.

Vinderi, the Dismantler: a man who got caught trying to set off a bomb below the high templar's office and was exiled to Wraeclast. He mentions that he has "loads of children," had a twin who is long dead, and knows Niko. Exposure to explosive fumes and voltaxic sulphite have left him added, and he may also be hard of hearing. He doesn't like Niles.

Whakano, the Barber: a Karui man who uses his profession as a barber to pick up information and sell it to others. After the fall of Oriath, he became concerned about slave traders kidnapping, torturing, and murdering Karui men, women and children as revenge for the fall of the slave trade.

Hapihapi: (see Karui.)

Freidrich Tarollo, Slave Merchant: a small-time slave trader who loved the thrill of the chase of capturing slaves. He became furious when the Karui slaves in Oriath rebelled against the Templars, causing the slave trade to collapse. He declared himself ruler of the slavers, and began coordinating them to hunt down, torture, and murder as many Karui as they could get their hands on as an act of revenge.

CLIENTS OF THE RING

Administrator Qotra: (see Replica Unique Item Researchers.)

Aline Koltz: a client of the Ring, who seeks the Abberathine Horns and the Celestial Stone for her "collection of oddities."

Anton Laffrey: a client of the Ring, who seeks the Golden Napuatzi Idol as a gift for a woman he is courting. Selwyn Eddard is apparently a rival suitor. He is possibly related to Aisling Laffrey.

Bazira: a client of the Ring who seeks relics from ancient Keth, including the Urn of Farud, Incense of Keth, the Flask of Welakath, the Forbidden Lamp, and Dekhara's Resolve. Bazira apparently has some kind of rivalry with Kondor Larcus.

Cardinal Uthelius: a client of the Ring, who seeks the Golden Slave Idol.

Castor Pollinius III: a client of the Ring who seeks the Golden Xoplotli Idol, possibly hoping to learn the secrets of immortality.

Count Geonor: (see Ezomytes.)

Grond Ironeye: a client of the Ring who seeks the Golden Hetzapal Idol.

Kondor Larcus: a client of the Ring, who seeks the Bust of Emperor Caspiro, The Goddess of Water, the Ancient Seal, and Orbala's Fifth Adventure. He seems uninterested in the pieces themselves, and mostly wants them to keep them out of Bazira's hands.

Marcine Clavus: a client of the Ring, who seeks the Heart Coil as well as pieces of a device known as the Enigmatic Assembly.

Nishem: a client of the Ring from a race many consider not to be human, possibly an offspring of Tsoagoth. He/She seeks The Sea Pearl Heirloom and the Tusked Hominid Skull in order to prove "human" has a broader definition and his/her people are not inhuman abominations.

Remus Hestor: a client of the Ring who seeks the Golden Matatl Idol.

Selwyn Eddard: a client of the Ring, who seeks the Mirror of Teklatipitzi as a gift for a woman he is courting. Anton Laffrey is apparently a rival suitor.

The Crimson Scribe: a client of the Ring, who seeks the Ez Myrae Tome, The Golden Ibis, the Seal of Lunaris, the Seal of Solaris, and the Staff of the first Sin Eater. He/She is interested in revealing the truth of the past and piecing together a history of the Winter of the World.

The Midnight Tinkerer (Riker Maloney): (see The Immortal Syndicate.)

Tsvet Matvei: a drug smuggler and client of the Ring who seeks the Box of Tripyxis, Admiral Proclar's Pipe, and the Essence Burner.

REPLICA UNIQUE ITEM RESEARCHERS

Administrator Qotra: the administrator overseeing the research into duplicating unique items, who believes that "science and thaumaturgy are one and the same." She is also a client of the Ring, and seeks the Alchemical Chalice, the Impossible Crystal, and the Sword of the Inverse

Relic in order to study their properties, as well as Living Ice in order to learn to control it and protect Wraeclast from its spread.

Lead Researcher Ksaret: the lead researcher involved in duplicating unique items.

Researcher Graven: a researcher involved in duplicating unique items. At one point he was electrocuted for eleven hours but was kept alive by Replica Winterheart.

Researcher Arn: a researcher involved in duplicating unique items, who was disturbed to find he was affected by an item that affects minions (Replica Grip of the Council).

Researcher Olesya: a researcher involved in duplicating unique items, who found killing the test subjects delightful and satisfying.

Doctor Bircus: a doctor who may have attended the test subjects used in the research into duplicating unique items.

THOSE WHO STOLE THE SEED OF CORRUPTION (POE II)

Captain Oren: the leader of a group of fighters/mercenaries helping Count Geonor steal the Seed of Corruption. He was accidentally killed by Dorman.

Rain: an archer in a group of fighters/mercenaries helping Count Geonor steal the Seed of Corruption. He was attacked and possibly killed by Sin.

Shalon: a sorceress in a group of fighters/mercenaries helping Count Geonor steal the Seed of Corruption. She's implied to have been attacked and possibly killed by Sin.

Dorman: a rookie with "a mean cleave" in a group of fighters/mercenaries helping Count Geonor steal the Seed of Corruption. His throat was cut by Count Geonor and he was fed to the Seed to start its growth.

CHARACTERS FROM SYNTHESIS MEMORIES

Anaris: a man who pursued the Elder after it stole a child, and dropped dead as a result.

Bryn: a male (Eternal/Templar) who died of a fever but then came back to life as a creature. His mother believed his soul was with Innocence, so she leapt to her death to meet him.

Drusus: a man with a family who committed suicide in the baths when he saw a member of the Brotherhood of Silence coming for him.

Micah: a sailor, possibly from Weylam Roth's crew.

Sapinti: a female who went fishing and washed ashore mummified/drained of blood. After she was buried, the land soured and had to be abandoned.

NON-HUMAN CHARACTERS

Kalandra: a birdlike being of unknown origin. In the primordial days of Wraeclast she encountered a lake and thereafter found she couldn't leave it. From there she watched as life and eventually humans and gods arose. Sometimes people would come to her in need and she would give them direction, though said she otherwise couldn't help them; she mentions there is an unknown cost to her guidance. It's hinted that she may have spoken and given advice to Sin. Kalandra also says she has met the Clayshaper, Einhar, and the Master Fisherman (Krillson) when they visited her lake. At one point, some (possibly the Order of the Djinn) promised to free her. However, once they learned the truth of the lake, they instead took steps to make it harder to find and to erase Kalandra from history, then burned themselves alive. She later devised a plan to escape, which depended on someone finding her and setting the proper events in motion.

ENTITIES FROM THE VOID

The Elder: a creature born of the oblivion from before time began. Once only an abstract expression, it was given physical form and entered the human realm out of hunger. It fashioned a bauble of chaos and secret worlds (maps) to use as a hunting ground. The Elder would drag children off into the night and feast on their imagination and nightmares. In such a way it cultivated and spread the oblivion from outside time and space, also known as the Decay. To stop it, a group of parents known as the Watchers of Decay entered its realm and used the sword Starforge to trap its body in stone, though its spirit was left free to roam the worlds it had created. Eventually it was discovered by Valdo Caeserius, who led High Templar Venarius into its realm. Venarius freed its body, after which it began to prey upon the children of Oriath.

The Constrictor: a guardian who protects the Elder's realm.

The Enslaver: a guardian who protects the Elder's realm.

The Eradicator: a guardian who protects the Elder's realm.

The Purifier: a guardian who protects the Elder's realm.

The Envoy: a being created and given a duty to "protect and limit and never leave" the Maven. He refers to this as a punishment.

The Maven: a childlike being who struggles to understand the concept of life and the difference between things that live and things that don't. In her boredom she sought out struggle and

conflict, and in doing so created such agony "that it seeped deep into the fabric of the void." After the Elder was banished from the Atlas, she claimed it for herself, defending this claim against the champions of The Cleansing Fire and The Tangle.

The Searing Exarch: the primary mortal champion of The Cleansing Fire, who challenged The Maven's claim on the Atlas.

The Black Star: a mortal champion of The Cleansing Fire, who challenged The Maven's claim on the Atlas.

The Eater of Worlds: the primary mortal champion of The Tangle, who challenged The Maven's claim on the Atlas.

The Infinite Hunger: a mortal champion of The Tangle, who challenged The Maven's claim on the Atlas.

TITANS

Amrit: a titan.

Rajendra: a male titan, said to be consumed by endless rage.

Shakti: a male titan who has been wronged.

Sundari: a male titan.

The Molten One: a titan revered by the Redblade warband, and apparently the only titan remaining.

Zalmarath, the Colossus: referred to as a champion or emissary of the Titans for the Rite of Flame, and thus probably not a Titan himself.

LOST-MEN

Iktab, the Deathlord: a Lost-men necromancer who helps resurrect Ekbab the mastodon.

SUN CLAN (HYENA PEOPLE)

Rathbreaker: a leader of the Sun Clan.

SERPENT CLAN (SNAKE PEOPLE)

Kabala, Constrictor Queen: a serpent queen who was banished from Keth by the Third Pact but given the eastern sands. At some point, apparently recently, she returned to Keth, for reasons unknown.

Elzarah, the Cobra Lord: a serpent who seeks vengeance for Kabala's death. Elzarah sided with Azmadi, who promised them glory.

LIGHTLESS (ABYSSALS)

Kulemak, Master of Undeath: one of the Lightless who was exalted and ascended to godhood. He created the Lich Lords by granting power to his servants. He attempted to conquer the world and was apparently defeated, possibly before his ascension. He then turned to deception, convincing Aul to give him a single stone golem. Later, possessed golems destroyed the Primeval civilization and the Lightless flooded out across Wraecclast. Kulemak's body was killed several times, but this didn't stop him. Eventually he was bound and his Divine spark was stolen by Sin.

Ulanan, Sovereign of the Well: a Lich Lord who seeks dominion over the light and to banish it.

Amanamu, Liege of the Lightless: a Lich Lord who seeks dominion over the surface-dwellers and for the authority it brings.

Kurgal, the Blackblooded: a Lich Lord who can be found in the Lich's Tomb within the Abyssal City, which is buried deep underground.

Tecrod, the Hated Slave: one of the Lightless. His body was destroyed, but he still persists in some form. He seeks revenge and dominion over his own kind.

Tasgul, Swallower of Light: an Abyssal Commander who resides in the Lightless Void.

Vandroth, Blackblooded Enslaver: an Abyssal Commander who resides in the Dark Domain.

Igrulog, the Incubator Queen: a giant slug-like creature who is an unusually powerful Lightless.

Lurking Creature: one of the Lightless who watches and serves. Since Kulemak's defeat it has served one of the Lich Lords, though which one it serves has changed over the years.

BEYOND DEMONS (THE SCOURGE)

[Note: In 3.19 the former Beyond bosses were permanently retired. They were replaced by the Scourge bosses, who are now referred to as Beyond bosses.]

Beidat, Archangel of Death: a Scourge demon from the pale faction.

Ghorr, the Grasping Maw: a Scourge demon from the flesh faction.

K'tash, the Hate Shepherd: a Scourge demon from the demon faction.

HIVEBORN

Xoph, Dark Embers: a Breachlord associated with fire, who commands an army of loyal followers. He merged with Esh, Tul, and Uul-Netol to become Xesht.

Esh, Forked Thought: a Breachlord associated with lightning, who commands an army of loyal followers. She is sometimes referred to as "she of many mouths." She merged with Xoph, Tul, and Uul-Netol to become Xesht.

Tul, Creeping Avalanche: a Breachlord associated with cold, who commands an army of loyal followers. She merged with Xoph, Esh, and Uul-Netol to become Xesht.

Uul-Netol, Unburdened Flesh: a Breachlord associated with physical damage, who commands an army of loyal followers. She merged with Xoph, Esh, and Tul to become Xesht.

Chayula, Who Dreamt: a Breachlord associated with chaos, who commands an army of loyal followers. He has communicated with the Maraketh and was part of the Third Pact, and seems to be responsible for the dreams that led Aility to form the Keepers of the Flame. He attempted to merge with the other Breachlords but the merging failed and he was cast into the void. Since then he has been regenerating.

Xesht-Ula, the Open Hand: an entity that the Keepers of the Flame believed would one day arise when the five Breachlords merged into a single being. The Breachlords attempted to merge but Chayula was cast out, resulting in Xesht being created instead.

Xesht, We Who Are One: an entity formed from the merging of Xoph, Esh, Tul, and Uul-Netol. Xesht refers to themselves as "we." They can summon Xoph, Tul, and Esh (or facsimiles of them), and refers to commanding them or controlling them like puppets. Xesht says they will consume Chayula, which may mean they wish to merge with him as well, or that they wish to destroy him. Per Chayula, Xesht is imbalanced and filled with endless rage and hunger.

Vruun, Marshal of Xesht: a high-ranking follower of Xesht. It's implied that there has been more than one Vruun, and that when one dies or is killed another one is created or arises.

HARBINGERS

: a Harbinger who can be found in the Beachhead at the gateway leading from the Harbinger realm. He bears a crown and therefore may be a king.

NAMELESS

Gruthkul, Mother of Despair, the Porcelain Queen: (see Other Gods.)

The King in the Mists: a being from "the unseen reflection opposite the mortal world" who came into existence in the Viridian Wildwood when he was Named. As the realm he came from was a place of eternal torment, he vowed to save his people by becoming darkness against the Wisps, which he saw as opposed to him. He's described as cold and calculating.

The Incarnation of Agony: a banshee from the realm of the Nameless, who came into being in the Viridian Wildwood when she was Named. She is said to be the most evil of the Nameless in the Wildwood and full of mindless rage.

Nameless Seer: a being from the realm of the Nameless. He believes in listening to the Wisps, but also praises The King in the Mists, and feels the Wildwood can be shared between the Maji and the Nameless.

Flavia, The Primal Huntress: (see Azmeri.)

CREATURES OF THE SEA

Diamora, Song of Death: a sea creature who can sing to lure humans into her lair to feed on. She also turns people to stone.

Adrapheme, Voice of Death: a creature, possibly once human, who shared Tsoatha with the Brine King. After his death, she went to the Singing Caverns and sent out her handmaidens (probably Brine Maidens) to punish explorers for encroaching on the bounty of the ocean, which she believed belonged to her kind.

Adelina, Guardian of the Pearl: a Brine Maiden who guards a giant beckoning clam containing a humming pearl.

Deathflay: a Brine Maiden who has a large brood of eggs. She sings.

APPENDIX C: HUMAN RACES & CULTURES

PRECURSORS

Currently nothing much is known about the Precursors.

PRIMEVALS

Not much is known about the Primevals other than they were apparently a humanoid race living in Wraecclast contemporary with the Maraketh. There is a mention of gods on one of their artefacts, though no Primeval gods are known. (Tangmazu apparently interacted with Aul, though as Aul is apparently immortal this may have occurred after the fall of their civilization.) Per Doryani, they lived in the same regions that the Vaal and later the Eternal Empire occupied. Their ruins can be found buried beneath the remains of the Eternal Empire and lie deeper even than the cities of the Lightless.

Mosaics found in their ruins depict some events from their history, including the building of a pyramid and a volcanic eruption that filled the sky with ash. Three people are also depicted, including a woman called the Clayshaper (who wielded the Clayshaper mace and created golems from clay), a figure wearing Ahn's Contempt and wielding Ahn's Might and Ahn's Heritage, and a third with a lightning bolt on its forehead who may have been Aul (though Aul has only been seen wearing a helmet so far).

Mosaics:





LANGUAGE

The only thing known about the language of the Primevals are some phrases said by Aul when fighting him, for which there are no translations:

Word/Phrase	Meaning	Source
<i>uor al-Nahm</i>	?	Aul, at start of fight
<i>habra Ahn</i>	? (something about Ahn)	Aul, at start of fight
<i>utem Zazul</i>	?	Aul, at start of fight
<i>hatem ahk Aul</i>	? (something about Aul)	Aul, at start of fight
<i>azu Azar</i>	?	Aul, during fight
<i>hur-nak</i>	?	Aul, during fight
<i>otemba</i>	?	Aul, during fight
<i>zem Zamarr</i>	?	Aul, during fight

LOST-MEN

Little is known about the Lost-Men other than that some, or possibly all, of them reside in the Mastodon Badlands. They perform rituals and their culture seems to heavily emphasize necromancy. They also worship the bones of the Mastodons.

Dannig says that during the first Kalguuran colonisation of Wraeclest, lost-men came to their villages to build new lives. "Lost-Men" isn't capitalized, however, so it's possible he was referring to lost men in general and not this specific culture. It's also possible that Kalguuran lost-men made their way to the Mastodon Badlands and formed the Lost-Men culture (the Lost-Men style of dress is similar to that of the Druids of the Broken Circle).

LANGUAGE

The Lost-Men have their own language, though no outsiders know it. The few known examples are listed below:

Word/Phrase	Meaning	Source
<i>dagok</i>	?	Iktab, during fight
<i>gral</i>	?	Iktab, during fight
<i>hak-grum</i>	?	Iktab, during fight
<i>nir hagok</i>	?	Iktab, during fight

MARAKETH

The Maraketh are native to the Vastiri Plains in northeastern Wraeclest. In ancient times they consisted of scattered tribes (*akharas*) of nomadic hunter-gatherers who lived in fertile valleys. The Winter of the World came, and the harsh conditions resulted in their culture evolving into one with strict traditions and severe punishments. During this period they also built the Trial of the Sekhemas as a series of ordeals one must go through to be accepted as a warrior or clan leader.

They have a role known as tale-woman, who keeps an oral history of their legends and traditions. Per this history, it was two Maraketh *sekhemas*, Solerai and Lundara, who united the various Maraketh tribes for the first time and managed to end the Winter of the World. This was followed by a thousand-year period of prosperity when they were apparently the largest and most thriving empire in Wraeclest. Their city of Keth, located at the intersection of seven rivers, supported a riverboat culture of merchants and was considered by many to be the continent's most prosperous trading hub.

Over a period of a thousand years or more the climate changed, resulting in the fertile valleys and rivers drying up and eventually becoming a desert.

Their current culture consists of a tribal matriarchy, and according to Vanja they have their own "unique cosmology of strange creatures, pagan gods and powerful treasures." They are still nomadic, at least in part, and practice pastoralism. The Maraketh often ride rhoas and may or may not ride rocs (Garukhan was said to have ridden one). They also used to ride mastodons, though these died out as the desert spread. They keep conquered enemies as slaves as justify this as being better than putting them to death, though their slaves are treated quite severely. The Maraketh are referred to as dark-skinned by Victario, though many of them appear quite fair.

Different *akharas* may have different rules. At least some don't tolerate witches. It's implied that the Ardura may not allow lesbian relationships and that the punishments for such are harsh.

The Maraketh use tattoos as marks of shame or criminality (in contrast to the Karui, who earn tattoos in battle). Maraketh who are born "flawed" (such as Nenet, Tasuni, and Risu) are seen as worthless and left out in the desert to die. A group of such outcasts who have survived have banded together and formed their own culture, calling themselves by various names throughout history but currently referred to as the Faridun. Unlike the Maraketh, the Faridun do not believe in any gods. The Maraketh seem to view the Faridun as captors who steal their outcasts, and don't recognise them as equals.

The Maraketh built tall burial towers at a place called Deshar, and those who earn it are buried there, referred to as being "buried in the sky." In some *akharas*, those who don't earn this honor may throw themselves from the towers when injured or ill to die alongside them. The Maraketh consider it their greatest fear to be swallowed and forgotten beneath the sand. Faridun can't earn burial in the sky, and may be cremated and kept in urns instead.

LANGUAGE

The Maraketh have their own language, which according to Voll is called Marak. Example of writing from a waystone in Keth:

ΠΟΤΛΗΥΠΑΡΗΙΕΝΕΙ ΜΕΝΚΛΑ
 ΙΕΡΕΙΣΟΛΗΥΕΥΟΙΑΠΑΡΤΗΙΑΜ
 ΙΑΥΠΟΤΟΥΦΟΑΩΕΤΕΠΙΦΑΗΟΥΤΕ
 ΧΥΠΟΥΤΥΦΑΟΕΤΙΟΗΛΗΜΖΕΥΧΡ
 ΤΑΣΕΟΜΕΝΟΥΕΛΠΑΡΤΑΣΥΠΑΙΧ
 ΡΥΡΙΚΑΕΤΕΚΑΛΕΙΤΙΧΑΙΠΡΕΟ
 ΥΑΠΟΤΛΗΥΠΑΡΗΥΣΙΑΝΕΝΔΙΓΥ
 ΙΜΑΟΦΕΙΑΜΙΛΑΤΑΛΠΡΟΤΑΦΕΓ
 ΙΡΟΝΟΥΑΠΕΛΥΙΕΤΑΜΕΝΚΕΚΑΡ
 ΧΑΛΟΜΟΙΑΙΤΟΙΣΟΕΙΣΑΠΟΥ
 ΛΗΟΡΛΕΜΗΣΕΜΠΛΕΙΟΝΑΙΔΛΙ
 ΟΤΑΛΟΥΠΡΟΕΕΤΑΧΕΜΑΒΛΙΤ
 ΝΑΠΑΝΤΛΕΝΤΟΙΣΠΡΟΥΒΡΗΧΙΟ
 ΕΝΕΙ ΜΕΝΚΛΑΔΑ ΠΕΡΕΙΠΗΙΟ
 ΤΕΛΟΝΩΙΜΕΝΕΙΝΕΠΙΤΑΝΙΑΙΟΝ
 ΙΤΗΝΗΠΕΙΡΟΝΥΠΟΜΕΙΝΑΙΣΔ
 ΙΗΝΚΑΤΕΙΝΙΝΜΕΝΗΚΑΙΟΥΧΥ
 ΣΕΠΙΣΙΝΑΧΘΕΙΣΙΟΥΕΙΣΑ

Modern examples of writing using a flowing script:



Known Marak words and phrases:

Word/Phrase	Meaning	Source
<i>akh'salla</i>	greeting	Jun Ortoi (when you approach)
<i>salla</i>	greeting	Nenet (when you approach)

<i>selah</i>	greeting (older variant of <i>salla</i> ?)	Balbala (when you approach)
<i>salla temut</i>	?	Vasa, during fight
<i>mik karkin*</i>	greeting?	Nenet (when you approach)
<i>selarim</i>	goodbye / good luck?	Jun Ortoi (when you leave), Nenet (before a heist)
<i>akhara</i>	"tribe"	Kira, "Oyun"
<i>sekhema</i>	"commander"	Kira, "Oyun"
<i>dekhara</i>	"warrior(s)"	Kira, "Oyun"
<i>garukhan</i>	"ultimate sovereign"	Zarka, "The Tale of the Horn"
<i>jingakh</i>	outsider / non-Maraketh?	Balbala, "Victory in the Trial"
<i>taljari</i>	outsider? orphan / abandoned?	Etchings of Varashta I
<i>balbalakh</i>	pariah, undesirable?	Zarka, "Nasima of the Second Sight"
<i>darakatha</i>	battle cry?	Path of Exile: Origins #3
<i>chin sol</i>	?	Asala, during fight
<i>hakh hakh nor</i>	?	Asala, during fight
<i>akh barya</i>	? (barya = a coin)	Balbala, during fight
<i>atul</i>	?	Balbala, during fight
<i>desh danak</i>	?	Balbala, during fight
<i>ko</i>	?	Balbala, during fight
<i>kun'dek</i>	?	Balbala, during fight
<i>na'kai</i>	?	Balbala, during fight
<i>verkhada</i>	?	Azarian, during fight
<i>zadha o aka</i>	?	Zarka, on disenchanting an item

*The spelling is a guess since the phrase is heard but not seen in writing.

VAAL

The Vaal, often referred to as "the red ones," were once said to be the oldest known culture in Wraecclast, though the Precursors and Primevals both appear to have been older, and some evidence now suggests the Maraketh may be older as well. The Vaal existed in central Wraecclast and on the island of Oriath. Three of their cities were Azala Vaal, Lira Vaal, and Utzaal, and they also had a temple in the jungle named Atzoatl. The Vaal worshipped multiple gods, and the followers of Ralakesh enslaved many primitive Azmerians long before the Vaal established peaceful contact with them. They traded with the Maraketh and early Karui, and also seem to have had contact with the Templars as the Descry symbol used by the Templars can be found on some of their artefacts, such as Zeel's Amplifier and Vaal totems. Their unit of currency seems to have been the crown.

The Vaal were possibly the largest and most prosperous empire following the creation of the Beast, as the Maraketh empire seems to have been on the decline during that period. The Vaal were known to be peacekeepers who sent emissaries to other lands to establish peaceful contact, and they tended to disapprove of more militant cultures such as the Maraketh.

They were strong advocates of science and the use of Virtue Gems. The Azmeri described them as having "their flesh adorned with glittering crystals," though per Mektul this was reserved for nobles. Their technology was more advanced than that of any other known civilization, including those that came much later. Vaal ruins are populated in part by creatures referred to as "constructs," said by Alva Valai to have been created by combining metal and insects. They also built mechanical creatures and powered them with Soul Cores (crystals containing the souls of slain people), which they used as general labour as well as for security. The Vaal conducted research into such areas as explosives, "electrical lifebloods," bioengineering, weather manipulation, and even time travel, and they studied other realms, including breaches and maps. They also experimented extensively with human sacrifice and torture--which may have stemmed from the myth that they were created from the flesh of the gods and that it was their duty to return this flesh to them--as well as the Beast's power of corruption.

The final ruler of the Vaal was Queen Atziri, who became obsessed with the pursuit of youth and longevity. She tasked her lead thaumaturge, Doryani, with finding a way to attain these at any cost. The culmination of this was an attempt to commune with the Beast itself, though accounts differ as to whether this was done by Doryani, or by Atziri despite Doryani's attempts to stop her. In either case, this resulted in the Beast being wounded, and when it reacted to defend itself the Vaal empire was wiped out in event later known as the Fall.

Supposedly only a few thousand Vaal survived, who were then taken in as refugees by the Azmeri. However, this is not true. After the Fall, the city of Utzaal was flooded and many Vaal were trapped inside. These survivors degenerated over many generations into depraved, cannibalistic cultists, a transformation aided by their ingestion of hallucinogenic fungi that grew in the area. In former Vaal areas there are also a number of primitive tribes. The origins of these tribes are unknown, but they are possibly descended from other survivors of the Fall.

LANGUAGE

The Vaal have their own language, which according to Trinian is called Vaalish. Due to the size and influence of their empire, the common tongue spoken in Wraeclast in the modern day is based on Vaalish. Their written language may have been logographic, as seen in their ruins:



Some examples of Vaal glyphs:



The only known Vaalish words and phrases are from a sermon delivered at Aggorat and things said during fights. There are currently no translations.

Word/Phrase	Meaning	Source
<i>a'te 'Ibil tlayeb kutsen ?</i>		Aggorat sermon
<i>a'te ik'el tlayeb kifba ?</i>		Aggorat sermon
<i>a'te líimek</i>	?	Zelina chant

<i>a'te yuquia</i>	?	Zolin chant
<i>aiokmo til xu'te</i>	?	Aggorat sermon
<i>aiokmo tul jare elba</i>	?	Aggorat sermon
<i>ascenada akal</i>	?	Aggorat sermon
<i>Atziri le'itzil</i>	?	Zolin chant
<i>azcado</i>	?	Ahuatotli, during fight
<i>ek te mucane Vaal</i>	?	Aggorat sermon
<i>gyan'uks ko'janti</i>	?	Zolin chant
<i>huatat</i>	?	Ahuatotli, during fight
<i>ikba'yucane Vaal</i>	?	Aggorat sermon
<i>ipkaat</i>	?	Mektul, during fight
<i>kextal xi kujkuali ik'bala</i>	?	Aggorat sermon
<i>ka'tse-ik</i>	?	Mektul, during fight
<i>kahk-tche</i>	?	Mektul, during fight
<i>koriek</i>	?	Mektul, during fight
<i>kuxte' kl'imil'</i>	?	Zelina chant
<i>ma kilya Zerphi</i>	?	Aggorat sermon
<i>ma'oxe ik'el</i>	?	Zelina chant
<i>quiquate</i>	?	Ahuatotli, during fight
<i>táak'iin</i>	?	Mektul, during fight
<i>tatlat Atziri</i>	?	Ahuatotli, at start of fight
<i>teoyuxtlane ascensionada</i>	?	Aggorat sermon
<i>teoyuxtlane Yutsal</i>	?	(Yutsal possibly = Utzaal) Aggorat sermon
<i>ti itsok anab nochira</i>	?	Aggorat sermon
<i>tlaxye' le Vaal</i>	?	Zolin chant
<i>tlayeb kifba</i>	?	Zolin chant

<i>tlayeb kutsen</i>	?	Zelina chant
<i>tzokan'te ik'el</i>	?	Zolin chant
<i>U'Te kuxkal</i>	?	Zelina chant
<i>Vaal a xomaplat</i>	?	Ahuatotli, at start of fight
<i>xatlene kujkuali</i>	?	Zelina chant
<i>xictep cutlotl</i>	?	Ahuatotli, at start of fight
<i>xecwa</i>	?	Mektul, during fight
<i>yatle yutsal</i>	?	Zolin chant
<i>yaxe chikula'</i>	?	Zelina chant
<i>zahua moti</i>	?	Ahuatotli, during fight

KARUI

The Karui are a race apparently native to a number of islands that lie to the south of Wraecclast, and possibly elsewhere. The archipelago is called Ngamakanui by outsiders. However, the word *Ngamakanui* roughly means "anywhere we bring the Way." They don't see it as a specific location on a map, as they are nomadic, but rather anywhere they've established their culture. Currently they're known to inhabit two main areas: the Karui archipelago to the southwest of Wraecclast ("Ngamakanui"), which includes Te Onui, and a second group of islands ("Northern Ngamakanui") to the north of Oriath, which includes Ngakanu.

Their origin myth is that their people emerged from a volcano. This may be related to the Great Fire and the fact that they have no records of their history before their gods arose following this event. They are divided into tribes, each devoted to following a specific god, and each is led by a chieftain. Karui may switch from one tribe to another, and often do. There are so many tribes and gods they don't all know of each other. The Karui are referred to as dark-skinned by Victario.

"Ngakuramakoi" is a name for those who have passed their test of adulthood. "Wayborn" is a name they use for each other and seems to indicate one who follows the Karui Way. The Karui seem to refer to marriage and/or having a family as "going through the traditions."

The Karui are a tribal society with a culture that heavily emphasizes the honour of warriors and battle, and the "Karui Way." It is common for them to be seen with tattoos, which are earned in battle (contrary to the Maraketh, who use tattoos as marks of shame or criminality). The Karui apparently leave their dead to be eaten by gulls, who seed their souls to the earth and deliver them to their ancestors. There are also some mentions of the Karui burying their dead.

When implanting Virtue Gems in their flesh, the Karui fall ill with a "blood fever" and become filled with rage and unnatural strength, which also infects others nearby. Other races, such as the Vaal and Azmeri, are apparently not susceptible to this.

LANGUAGE

The Karui have their own language, which according to Voll is simply called Karui. Their writing and symbols seem to resemble long flowing or swirling lines:





Known Karui words and phrases:

Word/Phrase	Meaning	Source
<i>tala moana</i>	"I greet you as the waves greet the shore"	Erik Olofsson
<i>tala kura</i>	goodbye?	Maata & others (when you leave)
<i>Karui</i>	informal name for anyone of the blood	Akoya, "Ngakuramakoi"
<i>Ngakuramakoi</i>	adults who truly comprise the culture	Akoya, "Ngakuramakoi"
<i>nga</i>	"from" or "of"	Kahuturoa, "Ngamakanui"
<i>madanui</i>	"the Way of the Warrior"	Clarissa, "Maramoa"
<i>Ngamakanui</i>	"anywhere that the Karui bring the Way"	Kahuturoa, "Ngamakanui"
<i>makanga</i>	"honoured warrior"	Maramoa, "Dominus"
<i>hatungo</i>	"wise woman/man"	Navali, "Introduction"
<i>makoru</i>	"shark"	Maramoa, "General Gravicius"
<i>waikoama</i>	"canoe"	Maramoa, "General Gravicius"
<i>motiata</i>	possibly "song/ritual" or "holy man"?	Siosa, "The Painting"
<i>tavukai</i>	"sacred prohibition"	The Purity Chronicles Book 3
<i>korangi</i>	"he who wins wars with false promises"	Maramoa, "Hargan"
<i>ti siwila arako talah wasalo ai garango</i>	"the honeyed tongue speaks greedy words"	Path of Exile: Origins #3

<i>kaivana</i>	a Karui who doesn't follow the Way	Makoru, on the Way
<i>kurimo</i>	lost/stolen Karui?	Tavakai, when Warrior approaches
<i>pakarui</i>	outsider / non-Karui?	Hyrri (used in a taunt)
<i>arakatunomai</i>	?	Raok, during fight
<i>rapatu</i>	?	Taua, during fight
<i>hatuko ma koro</i>	?	Kaimana, after giving quest
<i>vala Ngamahu</i>	battle cry ("for Ngamahu"?)	Path of Exile: Origins #3
<i>vala Tukohama</i>	battle cry ("for Tukohama"?)	Akoya (used in battle)

AZMERI

The Azmeri resided in a chain of mountains in western Wraeclast known as the Azmerian Ranges, which per Izaro was "the most inhospitable range of mountains in all of Wraeclast." They had a primitive culture based on oral tradition. Their chieftains were selected by putting aspiring leaders through a labyrinth of beasts and traps to test their strength, wisdom, and spirit. The Azmeri worshipped their own gods, though many also worshipped the Vaal goddess Arakaali, and some (such as Tarcus Veruso) may have followed the Templar faith. Many of the Azmeri were enslaved by followers of the Vaal god Ralakesh long before the two civilizations established peaceful relations.

Around 900 BIC a Vaalish ambassador made peaceful contact with the Azmeri, and for the next five hundred years the Vaal helped elevate their civilization into a cohesive culture of settlement, agriculture and literature. Following the Fall, the Azmeri took in the few thousand Vaal survivors and integrated them into their civilization.

Four hundred years later, Tarcus Veruso led most of the Azmeri down from the mountains and into the ruins of the Vaal civilization, where he established the Eternal Empire. Some of the Azmeri, however, didn't follow Tarcus. Greust, Silk, Yeena, and Oshabi are descendants of the original Azmerian culture.

LANGUAGE

The Azmeri had their own language prior to their contact with the Vaal, though may have adopted Vaalish afterwards. As the common language currently spoken in Wraeclast is based on Vaalish, the Azmeri may have adopted it and then used it throughout the Eternal Empire. The Azmeri in the Forest Encampment don't natively speak the same language as the exile from Oriath, which may mean that they retained their original language. It's also possible the language spoken in Oriath is different than it was elsewhere in the Eternal Empire, though this is less likely.

Most of the known words and phrases in the Azmeri language are those spoken by The King in the Mists. While he is not Azmeri, he seems to have learned their language and to speak it in the Wildwood. There are currently no translations for what he says.

Word/Phrase	Meaning	Source
<i>dia dhuit</i>	greeting	The Warden of Eaves, when you approach
<i>mharú an koriak</i>	?	The King in the Mists, when you approach
<i>keéd un eé</i>	?	The King in the Mists, on a loss
<i>amadán thú</i>	?	The King in the Mists, on a win
<i>ko leor</i>	?	The King in the Mists
<i>loamsa tú</i>	?	The King in the Mists
<i>tobair devoid</i>	?	The King in the Mists, during fight
<i>tobair ómós</i>	?	The King in the Mists, during fight
<i>doradas ert, thek thuram</i>	?	The King in the Mists, during fight
<i>leth-creag</i>	?	The King in the Mists, during fight
<i>agrik armach</i>	?	The King in the Mists, during fight
<i>slaogarn</i>	?	The King in the Mists, during fight
<i>rith</i>	?	The King in the Mists, during fight
<i>básaich</i>	?	The King in the Mists, during fight
<i>thosai</i>	?	The King in the Mists, during fight
<i>stodd</i>	?	The King in the Mists, during fight
<i>marbod</i>	?	The King in the Mists, during fight
<i>fàs</i>	?	The King in the Mists, during fight
<i>lonnsaigh</i>	?	The King in the Mists, during fight
<i>atá... oré Wisps maah</i>	?	The King in the Mists, during fight
<i>an dire ed</i>	?	The King in the Mists, during fight

ETERNALS

The Eternal Empire was first established in central Wraeclast, and at its height seems to have covered much of the continent including the Vastiri Plains, the Mantle, Phrecia, and all the way to the southern coast. It also included the island of Oriath, and following the Cataclysm Oriath was the only part of the empire to survive.

The empire was founded by the Azmeri and therefore may have kept much of the Azmerian culture and its traditions. In its first years it continued the Azmerian practice of succession by labyrinth, though later abandoned this.

The Eternals are said to have revered the Azmerian goddesses Solaris and Lunaris "as the two eyes of their God," and their capital (Sarn) contained temples to both. However, the Eternals are also shown to have been associated with the Templars and their faith, with the High Templar vowing "to care for this Empire with eyes open" upon the coronation of each emperor. The Templars were banished from the Azmeri, apparently in the early days of the religion, though they seem to have reconciled by the time the empire was established.

LANGUAGE

As the common language currently spoken in Wraeclast is based on Vaalish, it's possible that the Azmeri adopted it during their contact with the Vaal and then used it throughout the Eternal Empire. In any case, there are no known references to or examples of the Eternals having their own separate language. However, there may have been multiple languages used throughout the empire. Per Maramoa, Oriath had its own language, called Oriathan, which is not understood by descendants of the original Azmeri.

Some examples of writing from the Eternal Empire:



TEMPLARS

The Templars are a religious group that has its own culture. It was founded by an Azmeri man named Maxarius, who actively sought to start a new religion in order to gain enough followers to become a god. He tried many times, but failed to gain sufficient support among his own people. At some point he encountered a group referred to only as "the newcomers." He found that they were terrified of fire and responded to a specific symbol (the symbol used by The Searing Exarch, suggesting they had encountered the Cleansing Fire or one of its agents). He adopted this symbol (the Descry) as his own and claimed that his god could protect them. This resulted in them following him. He still didn't have enough adoration to become a god, so he vilified his brother. By "sparking zealotry" against his brother and threatening nonbelievers with fire, he finally ascended to godhood, becoming known as Innocence. His brother Sin was chained to a cliff, but later rescued by an unknown woman (possibly Garukhan). The origin myth for the Templars states that Maxarius was the first High Templar chosen by Innocence, and hides the fact that Innocence was Maxarius.

The Azmeri apparently saw the Templars as a cult and banished them to the island of Oriath. As the Vaal also had a presence on Oriath, the two likely coexisted on the island for a time. The Vaal have been known to use the Descry, such as on artefacts like Zeel's Amplifier and on Vaal totems. At some point the Azmeri and Templars seem to have reconciled, as Oriath became part of the Eternal Empire founded by the Azmeri, and the High Templar would make the vow "to care for this Empire with eyes open" upon the coronation of each Eternal Emperor. In Sarn, the empire's capital, the Sceptre of God was built apparently as a monument to Innocence, along with temples for the goddesses Solaris and Lunaris. The Templar seat of power may also have moved from Oriath to Sarn, evidenced by the fact that High Templar Voll urged Kaom to invade and conquer Oriath during the Purity Rebellion.

Following the Cataclysm and the empire's collapse, the survivors on Oriath established their own civilization, which was apparently a theocracy.

Upon death, the bones of Templars are placed in massive ossuaries, where they are said to be hallowed and remembered. Templar beliefs may also describe an afterlife, as on his death Cardinal Sanctus Vox claims he will be going to paradise.

LANGUAGE

Per Maramoa, the Templars on Oriath have their own language, called Oriathan. This language is not natively understood by the Azmeri remaining in Wraecclast, such as those in the Forest Encampment, and therefore may be different than the language used by the Eternal Empire. It's also possible that Oriathan is based on Vaalish (as is the common language currently spoken in Wraecclast), and the Azmeri in the Forest Encampment still speak an Azmerian language.

Templar writing appears similar to that of the Eternals, and they may have used the same alphabet:



No Oriathan words or phrases are known, though the above images contain possible examples.

EZOMYTES

Little is known about the origins of the Ezomytes. The name "Ezomyte" itself seems to be relatively new as there are multiple mentions of very old characters never having heard it, including the Vaal in 400 BIC. What they were called previously is unknown. Their geographic origin is also unknown.

At some point in their history there was a great storm and a group of fey folk appeared out of a ring of runes in the forest and turned human. The not-yet-Ezomytes gave them food and shelter and in exchange were given knowledge of runes and "magicks born of the stars." These fey folk then integrated into the not-yet-Ezomytes.

There was "a time of chaos and terror" filled with Corruption and darkness when "much was lost." The sword Agnar was forged and runed for the original clan leader (presumably by the fey folk) to lead his people to a new, safer land. This brought them to Phaaryl. There, in 1132 IC, Ogham County was established, though they may have arrived long before then. At some point some of them continued on and settled Ezomyr and the Isles of Skothe. This may be when the name "Ezomyte" came into being. (Note that Agnar is also the name of an Ezomyte who was orphaned and became a member of the Order of the Djinn.)

During the reign of Chitus, Ezomyr was enslaved by the Eternal Empire. Ogham was also invaded by the Empire, possibly around the same time. Eventually both won their independence.

Possibly due to the Cataclysm, a plague swept through Ezomyr. Afterwards, only the Ezomytes in Ogham and on the Isles of Skothe remained.

The Ezomytes are structured as clans, each led by athane. In Ogham, after the Empire invaded, the title of count was established senior to the thanes in order to unite the clans.

The Ezomytes revere a group of animalistic avatars known as the First Ones, who teach them how to fight and survive and who bestow gifts in exchange for animal sacrifices. There are mentions of the First Ones existing in Phaaryl and Ezomyr, so the Ezomytes may not have encountered or followed them until after arriving in these areas. Per Einhar Frey, the First Ones will return at the

end of the world to collect those who've proven themselves to be "survivors" and take them to a place called the Great Grove.

Garivaldi describes the Ezomytes as being "romantic," and some examples of Ezomyte poetry are known.

LANGUAGE & RUNES

The Ezomytes have their own language, which according to Voll is called Ezo. Weylin's poem is written in script and might be an example of Ezo, though it also may have been written in the language used by the Eternals. Rigwald's inscriptions, probably written about twenty-five years later, are written in runes. These may be examples of Ezo writing, or they may have been written in an ancient language such as one used by the fey folk or the First Ones.



Pages from Weylin's poem



Rigwald's inscriptions

No Ezo words or phrases are known other than Einhar's name:

Word/Phrase	Meaning	Source
<i>einhar</i>	"lone fighter"	Einhar Frey, "Introduction"

The Ezomytes also use runes, which per Johan are oddly similar to those used by the Kalguur. The following are runes specifically seen to be used by the Ezomytes:

Rune	Meaning	Source
⚔	freedom: for a worthy cause	Runed Skull Cap
⚔	truth: to strike true	Runed Guard



KALGUUR

The Kalguur are a race from a place also named Kalguur, which resides on the continent of Middengard about 2,300 km southeast of Wraeclast. Per Gwennen and Sonja, Middengard is mostly covered with volcanoes but still has "verdant valleys and sparkling waterfalls."

Lineage is important to the Kalguur, and is seen as "an ongoing tally of renown and accomplishment." These accomplishments are often recorded as songs. They also have remembrancers, who are responsible for recording their history. The Kalguur have priests and religious orders, though are unfamiliar with the concept of gods and instead worship knowledge.

Their architecture and equipment have a distinct style, often made of metal with sharp curving blades or spikes. They have smiths known as artificers or runesmiths, who inscribe runes on their artifacts. These runes can "capture and shape starlight" and imbue an object with magic-like properties. Based on a comment by Raulf, it's possible that runes may also be earned or awarded for accomplishments. In the past there were four other known groups, which apparently no longer exist. The Druids of the Circle, later known as the Druids of the Broken Circle, believed they could see the future by looking at the past. The Black Scythe Mercenaries were a group of warriors founded by Vorana. The Order of the Chalice were a priesthood and religious order who "interpreted the stars and the workings of mysterious forces, such as alchemy, machinery, and runes." The Knights of the Sun are described as poetic fighters. Currently the Kalguur have guilds, such as the Artificers' Guild or the Meridian Free Traders.

Little is known of their origins, homeland, or history. The Fall of the Vaal was visible to them even in Middengard, and they interpreted it as an omen. The king at the time (Cadigan the Third) commissioned an expedition to investigate it. The Kalguur then began a colonisation of Wraeclast, which ultimately resulted in failure and the survivors returning home. Their history for the next two thousand years is unknown.

Currently the Kalguur are led by a king whose nature is mysterious. It's hinted that he may not be just a man, and might consider himself a god if the Kalguur had such a concept. He's unpopular with some of the Kalguur, and there was a rebellion against him that failed. Dannig, Gwennen, Tujen, and Rog apparently sided with the rebellion and fled when it collapsed; this may be part of the reason they came to Wraeclast. The rebellion appears to be a taboo subject that most Kalguur don't dare speak about openly. Those who support the king are referred to as royalists.

After Dannig, Gwennen, Tujen, and Rog established an outpost in Wraeclast, it became popular enough with other Kalguur that the king issued a charter to build it into a city named Kingsmarch, under Kalguuran law and customs, thus beginning their second attempt at colonisation.

In Kingsmarch the currency used is gold coins called Dinar, which may be the currency used in Kalguur as well.

LANGUAGE & RUNES

Being from a distant land, the Kalguur presumably have their own language. What it's called isn't known. No words in their language are known, though this is possibly an example of their writing:



The runes used by the Kalguur have their own meanings, though as far as is known aren't part of their language per se. Runes can be combined together to have special meanings. For example, combining truth, unity, and freedom runes means (or can represent) "an oath of peaceful passage and a request for freedom in pursuit of an important cause."

The following are the runes that have been encountered so far:

Rune	Meaning	Source
	bound: the connections between things	Rune
	bounty: cryptic; plenty is a matter of perspective	Rune, Dannig
	journey: a determinant, used if there's a question or doubt	Dannig
	life: living things move and change in patterns	Rune
	mountain: an expert rune, can mean many things	Dannig
	power: naught else matters; only for use by true artificers	Rune, Dannig
	river: all things flow, stillness is an illusion; helps direct energies	Rune, Dannig
	sun: magnanimous, gifts heat and light	Rune
	time: onwards; time has one direction and we can only follow	Rune, Dannig
	war: opposite energies; represents conflict, often in surprising ways	Rune, Dannig

The following are runes that can be found throughout Wraeclast (in POE II). They aren't specifically tied to the Kalguur, but have a similar style and may be related to the same rune system:

Rune	Meaning	Source
------	---------	--------

	body	Rune
	desert	Rune
	glacial	Rune
	inspiration	Rune
	iron	Rune
	mind	Rune
	rebirth	Rune
	stone	Rune
	storm	Rune
	vision	Rune

TRARTHANS

Trarthus is a landmass that lies to the west of Wraecclast. Nothing is known about it prior to the Fall of the Vaal, but following the Fall it was barren and more or less uninhabited. The name of the area is also unknown, as it didn't bear the name Trarthus until later.

In roughly the mid-800s, the Eternal Empire began exiling undesirables there. These established their own society ruled by warlords, which operated on a set of principles passed on verbally, later known as the Trarthan Code. Emperor Tyndarus Phrecius learned of this and sent his legions to occupy the area, execute the warlords, and impose taxes. Trarthus rebelled, led by the heads of four families from the first generation that had been born in Trarthus. They initially used guerilla tactics to fight back, but this escalated into open war in 870. In 872 the Trarthans were victorious, having received aid from the Karui and Ezomytes. The Empire withdrew its legions and stopped sending exiles there.

In 872 the capital city of Korathin was built using slaves controlled by the Keita family. Keita, along with houses Cyaxan, Azadi, and Bardiya, rose to power in Korathin by capitalizing on sordid activities, including slavery, prostitution, drugs, violent enforcement, theft, assassination, and the use of Virtue Gems. Tensions between them led to a conflict known as the Merchant Wars. Bardiya emerged as the primary victor and established the Merchant Council to maintain a semblance of order, including establishing laws and taxation.

LANGUAGE

The Trarthans originally came from the Eternal Empire and speak the same language as the current exiles in Wraeclast. However, some Trarthan mercenaries from House Azadi speak a different language. Currently there are no translations for this.

APPENDIX D: NON-HUMAN RACES

LIGHTLESS (ABYSSALS)

The Lightless are a race (or group of races) of various dark grey or black creatures that come in many forms, including some resembling bats, squid, worms, and skeletons, as well as more humanoid forms. Per Mortimer, they have green eyes and black blood. Many of these creatures may actually be undead servants instead of Lightless themselves, as it's been said that the dead serve the Lightless. The Lightless are intelligent and can communicate. Their leaders are known as Liches. They refer to humans and possibly others as "fleshborn."

They were created by necromantic magic and spawn from the Well of Souls. They exalted one named Kulemak, who ascended to godhood. He granted power to a few of his servants, who became the Lich Lords. They granted power to their servants, who became the necromancers.

During the Era of Despair the Lightless flooded across the Vastiri Plains and possibly other parts of Wraecclast. The Maraketh fought back against them but apparently were losing until forming an alliance with Ahkeli, the Clayshaper. Eventually this era came to an end and the Lightless were driven underground. Those on the surface seemed to think that the Lightless were extinct, but in reality they thrived and multiplied below ground, where they built cities of stone and bone. Recently, they've begun erupting through the ground and attacking the surface once more.

Per the Lurking Creature, the Lightless suffer punishment and torture because their masters know only hate and endless war.

LANGUAGE

The Lightless have their own language, which includes both a written and spoken form. A few examples of their writing that have corresponding translations have been encountered:

You are no Lich. You are no Lightless. What are you?

The Thief of Virtue! Stealer of Kulemak's spark!

No harm is meant. This one waits and watches. This one serves.

So far all examples of their writing consist of glyphs grouped into sets of four. Because of this, individual glyphs may not equate to words, though a few of them have speculated meanings. Due to the fuzzy, shifting character of most examples of their writing, isolating a distinct list of symbols is difficult. However, below are a list of known glyphs with their possible meanings.

Glyph	Meaning	Source
	beginning?	POE II 0.3 teasers
	?	POE II 0.3 teasers
	?	POE II 0.3 teasers
	?	POE II 0.3 teasers
	well, darkness?	POE II 0.3 teasers
	?	POE II 0.3 teasers
	?	POE II 0.3 teasers
	lich?	POE II 0.3 teasers
	?	POE II 0.3 teasers
	birth, grow, thrive?	POE II 0.3 teasers
	winter?	POE II 0.3 teasers
	in?	POE II 0.3 teasers

SCOURGE

The Scourge are a group of related creatures of many differing forms, at least some of whom are intelligent. They have skin that is primarily grey and/or red in varying shades. What they call themselves is not known.

There are three known factions of Scourge. Creatures in the Pale Faction are blind but can sense others and can smell fear. They are described as being the most like humans, in that they think, speak, and can be communicated with. Currently they are led by a demon-lord named Beidat. The Demon Faction is currently led by a demon-lord named K'tash. Some of them don't have heads, and

it's been theorized that they may not think at all, or if they do they may simply be "drones" in which something else thinks for them. Flesh Faction creatures seem capable of thought, though no one has succeeded in communicating with them as far as is known. Their primary drive is a hunger for flesh, and all they seem to do is pursue it. Currently they're led by a demon-lord named Ghorr.

Nothing is known about their origins, history, or where they come from. Per The Last to Die, there are countless alternate versions of reality, and one by one these have been invaded and taken over by the Scourge. She has only ever seen one version of Wraecclast survive them, though implies that reality may be just as bad or worse.

LANGUAGE

Nothing is known about the language or languages of the Scourge, and so far there are no examples of their writing or speech.

THE BREACHLORDS & THE HIVEBORN (FOULBORN)

Breach creatures come from another domain and enter Wraecclast through Breaches, which are "tears in the fabric of reality." These beings are humanoid and red-skinned, and often surrounded by a purple aura or glow. They are intelligent and can speak. Little is known about their origins or the domains in which they reside.

Breach creatures are referred to as the Hiveborn by outsiders. They refer to themselves individually as "It," refer to others as "It" or "It That (description)," and refer to their kind as "Its." Sometimes they also refer to their kind as the Foulborn. Animals, insects, and other twisted creatures reside in the Breach domains and are also referred to as "It," such as "It of Sharp Claws" or "It of Many Legs." The Hiveborn are a hivemind and experience pain when being separated from others. There are references to them being born on the Red Pyre, which teaches them things at birth (though it's possible this is only true for followers of Xoph). They seem to delight in pain, violence, and even death, both giving and receiving it, and refer to these things as "play."

The Hiveborn follow the Breachlords. The Lords are referred to either as "he" or "she," or by name. The Hiveborn "rejoice" in being "pulp and bone for the Lords," and seem to heavily emphasize sacrificing themselves to or for the Lords, only to be replaced by new Hiveborn. Each It seems to primarily serve one Breachlord, though It That Fled refers to being accompanied or empowered by different Lords at different times, so the domains and followers of each Lord may not be entirely separate. Chayula is implied to be the chief Lord, with the other Lords possibly being chosen by and sacrificed to him.

The following things are known about It That Fled and may or may not apply to others of its kind as well. It likes to collect things such as bone splinters, skins, and claws. It doesn't seem to understand human shape and thinks that a human must be in pain because of the way it "wears its skin." It also doesn't understand blood or why humans "leak from their skin," and thinks that it might be "liquid fear." It might not understand death, as it questions why a dead person has stopped moving and won't play anymore. Later, after dying and being revived by Catarina, it refers to death as "the Dark Place, where the Lords whisper and laugh at It, mocking It, hurting It." It says

that Elreon, a former Templar, has a "hideous glowing," and refers to the First Ones as "the hated enemies from Before All" and "diseased animals."

The domains of the Lords are similar to areas of Wraeclast, including outdoor volcanic areas, indoor and outdoor temples, and mines. Each Lord resides in an organic area with walls and a floor made of flesh. The outdoor areas are relatively dark; It That Fled and Xesht both mention a "Broken Sun," which may explain why.

Chayula, unlike the other Lords, has human followers. This began when a woman (possibly Maraketh) received visions. She founded a group originally known as the Keepers of the Pale Vision, which later became known as the Keepers of the Flame (likely due to the ability to wield "the Flame" which could destroy Breach fortifications). The group was referred to as the Cult of the Purple Flame by the Vaal. There are suggestions that the members of the Cult don't really understand the nature of the forces they devote themselves to.

At one point the five Breachlords attempted to merge into a single being named Xesht-Ula, though Chayula failed to merge with the others, resulting in a mad being known as Xesht. Chayula was cast into the void and has since then been regenerating, while opposing the forces of Xesht via the Keepers.

LANGUAGE

The Hiveborn can speak, though nothing is known about their language. Being a hivemind that can apparently communicate through non-physical means, it's possible they don't use language per se to communicate among themselves. However, Chayula successfully communicated with the Maraketh on at least one occasion and was included in the terms of the Third Pact.

HARBINGERS

Harbingers are humanoid beings ("spirits," per the Help panel glossary) from an unknown place. They're a dark blue and purple that is almost black, and they're usually surrounded by a bright blue aura or glow. They're intelligent and have their own language, though what they call themselves isn't known. They are referred to as Harbingers because they're often encountered alone or in small groups as advance scouts for a larger invasion. It's not known if Harbingers have individual names or not. When encountered in Wraeclast, they are referred to only by the abilities they possess or skills they use. They have leaders who wear crowns. They have a god, who they call the God of Domination.

A unique aspect of Harbingers is that they are immune to direct harm by any known means. They fight by summoning and empowering minions from the local area and casting supportive spells. When their minions are slain, the Harbinger that summoned them is harmed. A Harbinger dies if too many of its minions are killed. Gear with certain properties can allow others to summon Harbingers themselves, in which case the Harbinger will cast supportive spells but will not summon any minions.

Not much is known of their origins or history. They have invaded Wraeclast multiple times. The Order of the Djinn was aware of their existence and referred to them as "the inscrutable ones." A

thousand-year truce was established with them that ended when they imprisoned their god. A member of the Order, Sarina Titucius, deciphered their language and was directed to study their intent. She made it "beyond the Gate," possibly to the place where they come from, and returned alive. The Harbingers began invading Wraeclast again, and Oriath fought back. One major engagement was the Battle of Phaaryl in northern Wraeclast, which lasted a week and resulted in 3,800 Oriathan casualties. In addition to Wraeclast, the Harbingers have taken an interest in the Atlas and attempted to gain a foothold there.

Nothing is known about the place from which the Harbingers come. Per Kalandra, they "have journeyed farther than you know." They apparently establish beachheads in map realms that act as staging grounds from which they can spread elsewhere. These beachheads contain gateways that presumably lead back to where they come from.

LANGUAGE

The Harbingers are notable due to the fact that more examples of their language are known than any other culture in Wraeclast or Oriath. Their language consists of glyphs, each representing a being, thing, action, concept, etc., as well as simpler symbols that apparently act as prepositions or conjunctions. To date, only two glyphs have verified translations, with the remaining being guesses based on context.

Glyph	Meaning	Source
◆	connects compound words, of/hyphen?	Harbinger items
◆	to/intention?	Harbinger items
✕	around, 's (possession)?	Harbinger items
◆	produce/create, cause?	Harbinger items
➤	go to, toward, send?	Harbinger items
❖	not/negation?	Harbinger items
⌞⌞⌞	"God of Domination"	<u>GGG</u>
⌞⌞⌞	gateway?	Harbinger items
⌞⌞⌞	minion?	<u>GGG news post</u>
⌞⌞⌞	map?	<u>GGG news post</u>

	time?	Harbingers
	righteous, followers?	Harbingers
	buff/empower?	Harbingers
	"The Beast"	<u>GGG</u>
	ball/projectile, emerge/creation?	Harbingers
	enfeeble, make/become powerless?	Harbingers
	warp/teleport, move, leave?	Harbingers
	prison?	Harbinger items
	desire?	Harbinger items
	arcane, secret knowledge?	Harbingers
	ground/earth, land?	Harbingers
	vulnerable, susceptible?	Harbingers
	brutality?	Harbinger items
	attack?	Harbinger items
	will?	Harbinger items
	break/broken, dead?	Harbinger items
	type of being or state of being?	Harbinger items
	blast, spread, area, large/greater?	Harbingers
	focus, concentration, small/lesser?	Harbinger items

	?	Harbinger items
	Wraecclast?	Harbinger items
	return?	Data mined
	?	Harbinger items
	?	Harbinger items
	?	Harbinger items
	fire?	Harbingers
	defend against?	Harbinger items
	?	Harbinger items
	?	Harbinger items
	?	Harbinger items
	?	Harbinger items
	energy, recovery?	Harbinger ascendancy
	long, endure/persist, survive/live?	Harbinger ascendancy
	one/first?	Harbinger items
	two/second?	Data mined
	three/third?	Data mined
	four/fourth?	Harbinger items
	five/fifth?	Data mined



ten/tenth?

Data mined



lightning, storm?

Harbingers



ice?

Harbingers



harbinger?

Harbingers



type of being or state of being?

Harbinger items



travel?

Harbinger gateways



call, summon, target?

Harbingers



empty, nothing, space?

Harbinger gateways



leader?

Harbinger bosses



?

Harbingers



reward?

[GGG news post](#)



?

Data mined



obelisk?

Harbinger obelisks

APPENDIX E: DATES & PLACES

DATES

The only known dating system used in Wraeclast and Oriath is that of the Eternal Empire, which based their years on the founding of the empire.

IC	=	Imperialus Conceptus, the founding of the Eternal Empire
[year] BIC	=	Number of years prior to the Imperialus Conceptus
[year] IC	=	Number of years following 1 BIC
lunari	=	(probably) one cycle of the moon (from Etchings on Wood IV)

"The calendar used by the Eternal Empire does not completely match what players know from their own lives. It has seven days of the week, but there are thirteen longer time spans known as moons.

"The days of the week were generally named after the primary components of existence as the Eternals believed them to be: Solaro, Lunaro, Fiero, Glacio, Galvano, Kaso, Sacrato.

"The thirteen moons of the year were generally created in honour of certain renowned figures, or naturally arose as part of the harvest cycle: Verusi, Divini, Derivi, Phreci, Caspiri, Astrali, Eterni, Atziri, Vivici, Lurici, Sagari, Vitali, Azmeri.

"Both of these categories were subject to significant drift in meaning and spelling over the centuries."

--<https://www.pathofexile.com/forum/view-thread/2991402>

"Wraeclast does indeed experience seasons. Derivi emerged from a celebration of the harvests of the cooler season when the leaves turned vibrant colours and fell. Astrali was marked by the arrival of snow and the Aurora Astralis. Vivici brings a celebration of life returning to the land for the year, and Vitali was a time of heat and sun."

--<https://www.pathofexile.com/forum/view-thread/2991402>

Based on the above, if the moons are listed in order, we get the following:

Verusi	
Divini	
Derivi	autumn
Phreci	
Caspiri	
Astrali	winter

Eterni
Atziri
Vivici spring
Lurici
Sagari
Vitali summer
Azmeri

In Trarthus, "mensis" is used as a unit of time, and likely roughly corresponds to a month.

PLACES

Middengard: The continent of Middengard, from which the Kalguur hail, lies about 2,300 km to the southeast of Wraeclast, and so would lie beyond the edges of any current world map.

Aesclast: In 3.14 a reference was added to a place named Aesclast, which was possibly another continent (and could be the "east" to Wraeclast's "west"). However, this reference was changed in 3.15 to refer to an unnamed place. So currently there are no references to Aesclast in the game.

List of place names not found on the map:

Abram (from Rhys of Abram, might not be a place)
Alliston (from Etchings on Wood I)
Carian (from obsolete Water Elemental lore)
Glarryn
Glargarryn
Gulton (from Benric of Gulton, might not be a place)
Ogham (per POE I, on an island; per POE II, in Phaaryl in northern Wraeclast)
Penance Quay
Thebrus
Umbra? (might not be a place, since umbra means "darkness" or "shadow")

List of places from the Letters of Exile not found on the map, possibly cities in Oriath:

Beecham
Cinderford
Dayton
Inkley
Kimbey
Mirfield
Nashe
Romsey
Slaugh
Wetherdale